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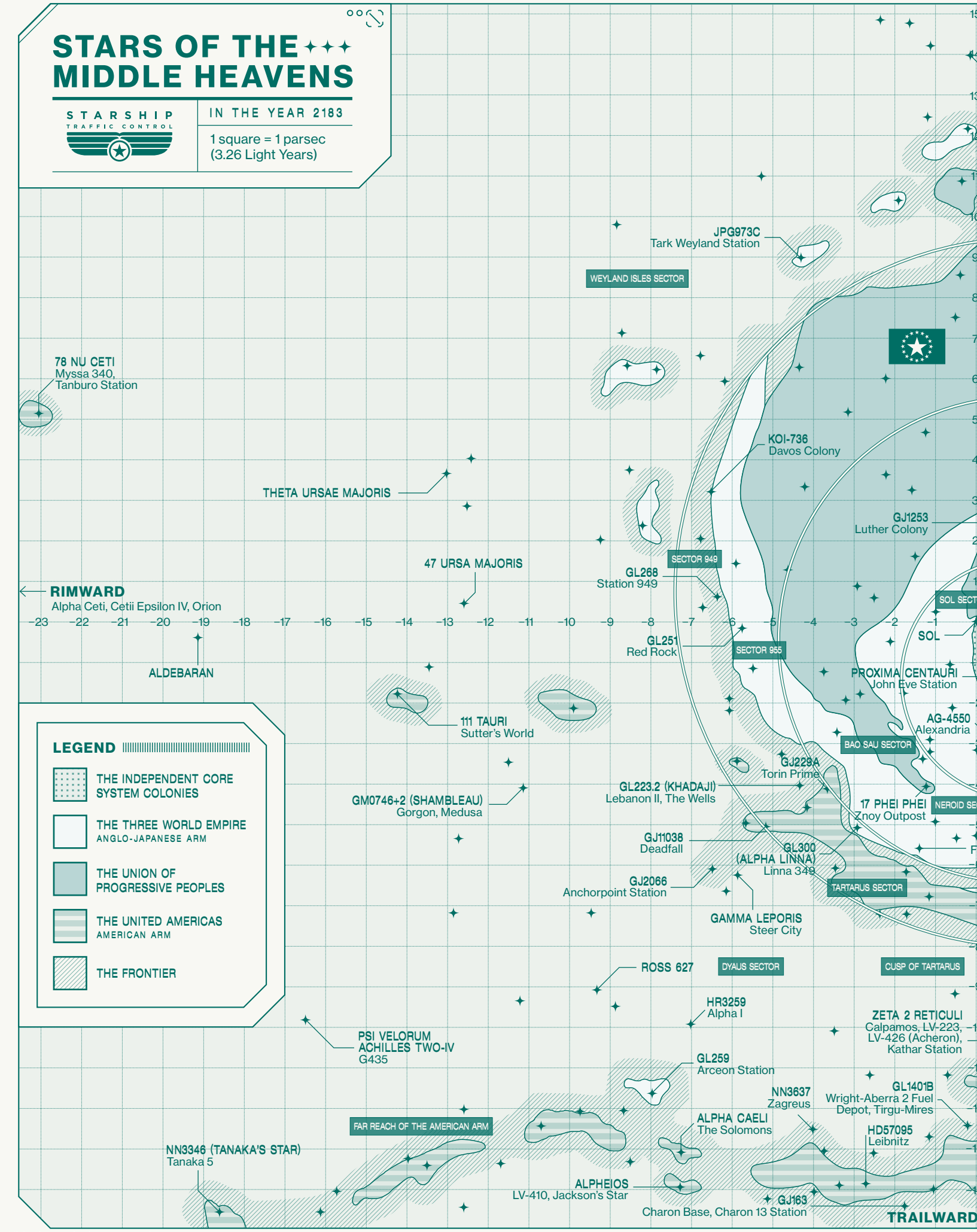
THE ROLEPLAYING GAME



CORE RULES

EVOLVED EDITION

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)



Michael Syrett (Order_5345103)


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WEYLAND-YUTANI CORP
"Building Better Worlds"



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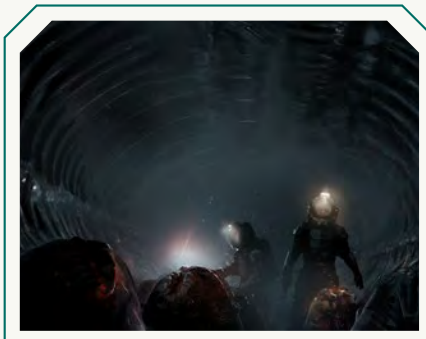
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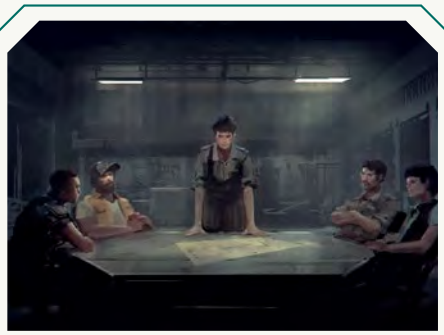
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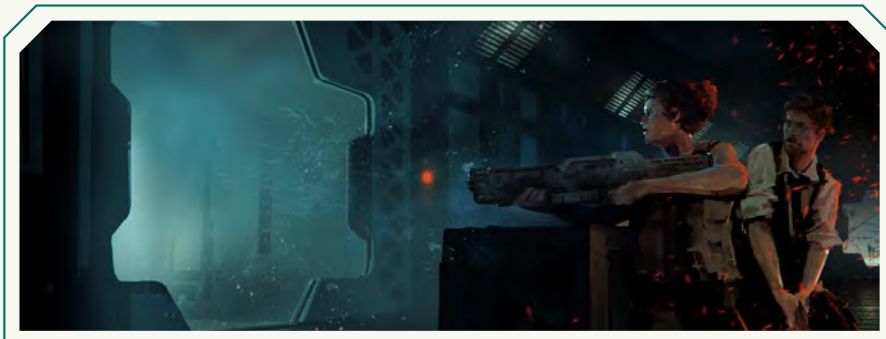
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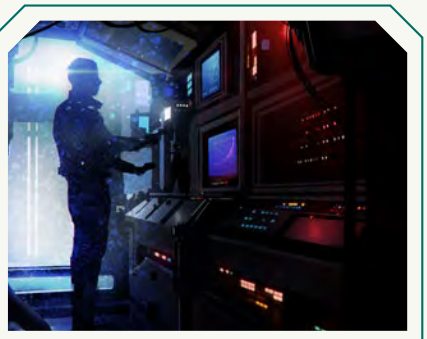
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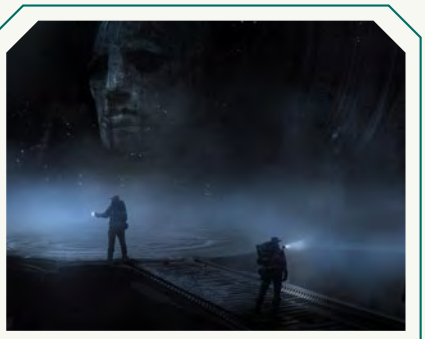
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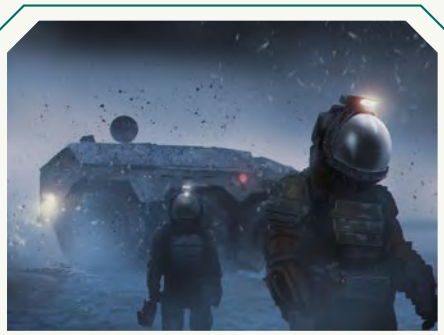
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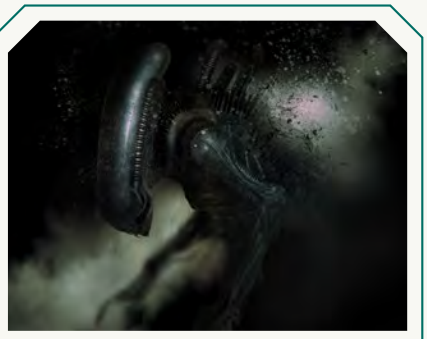
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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

CHAPTER 1

SPACE IS HELL

"I can't lie to you about your chances, but ... you have my sympathies."

Ash

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

WHAT'S THE STORY MOTHER?

"And behold a great dragon... his tail drew the third part of the stars of heaven, and did cast them to the earth."

Revelation 12:3-4

SPACE IS VAST, dark, and not your friend. Gamma rays and neutrino bursts erupt from dying stars to cook you alive, black holes tear you apart, and the void itself boils your blood and seizes your brain. Try to scream and no one can hear you – hold your breath and you rupture your lungs.

Space isn't as empty as you'd think, either – its frontiers are ever expanding. Rival governments wage a cold war of aggression while greedy corporations vie for valuable resources. Colonists reach for the stars and gamble with their lives – each new world tamed is either feast or famine. And there are things lurking in the shadows of every asteroid – things strange and different and deadly.

Things alien.

This is the ALIEN roleplaying game – a universe of body horror and corporate brinkmanship, where synthetic people play god while space truckers and marines serve as hosts to newborn ghoulish creatures.

It's a harsh and unforgiving universe and you are nothing if not expendable.

Stay alive if you can.

Ship's Log 006:00 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

The Miranda's taken on supplies at Anchorpoint Station. She's now synced to an old beat-up YX-3 refinery module the company wants towed to the Solomons. It's a shit run with shit pay, but it's better than heading out there without any haul at all. Most of my crew on this run are my regulars – Jefferies is flying, Nat and Reed are my roughnecks (note to self: no more husband-and-wife teams on my crew – Nat and Reed are fighting again). The only newbie is Hayes, a medic on loan to us from Captain Hughes. ▮

Ship's Log 008:30 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

We've left Anchorpoint and are en route to Thedus. Of course, we've got problems already – this time of the domestic kind. Reed came aboard drunk again, and Nat punched him in the face – may have even broken his nose. I stepped in before it escalated. I signed on to be a captain, not a parent. ▮

The titular alien – in all its iterations – is the stuff of nightmares. From Neomorph to Xenomorph, the mystique surrounding these creatures is mesmerizing. The alien represents everything we don't understand about the natural world. It evokes a fear of our bodies being violated and used. It is a parasitic invader whose only intent is to use humanity to breed and incubate its progeny. The alien lifecycle is one of death and renewal, but the only part people play in that circle is death.

But the ALIEN saga itself is about more than otherworldly beasts. It is about humbling humanity for its own hubris. It's about motherhood and family – about loss and sacrifice. It wrestles with the questions of artificial intelligence and faith. The story of ALIEN is about creators and their creations struggling for dominance over each other.

It's about corporate greed and avarice, and it's about how superior firepower and fancy technology aren't enough to protect you from the horrors of the unknown. It's about pushing the envelope and sticking your nose where it doesn't belong, consequences be damned before they damn you.

The ALIEN roleplaying game takes you to the rough and tumble colony worlds on the Frontier of known space. It's on the cusp of this unforgiving place that your character must face their demons – both of the inner and other kind. ●

An Evolved Edition

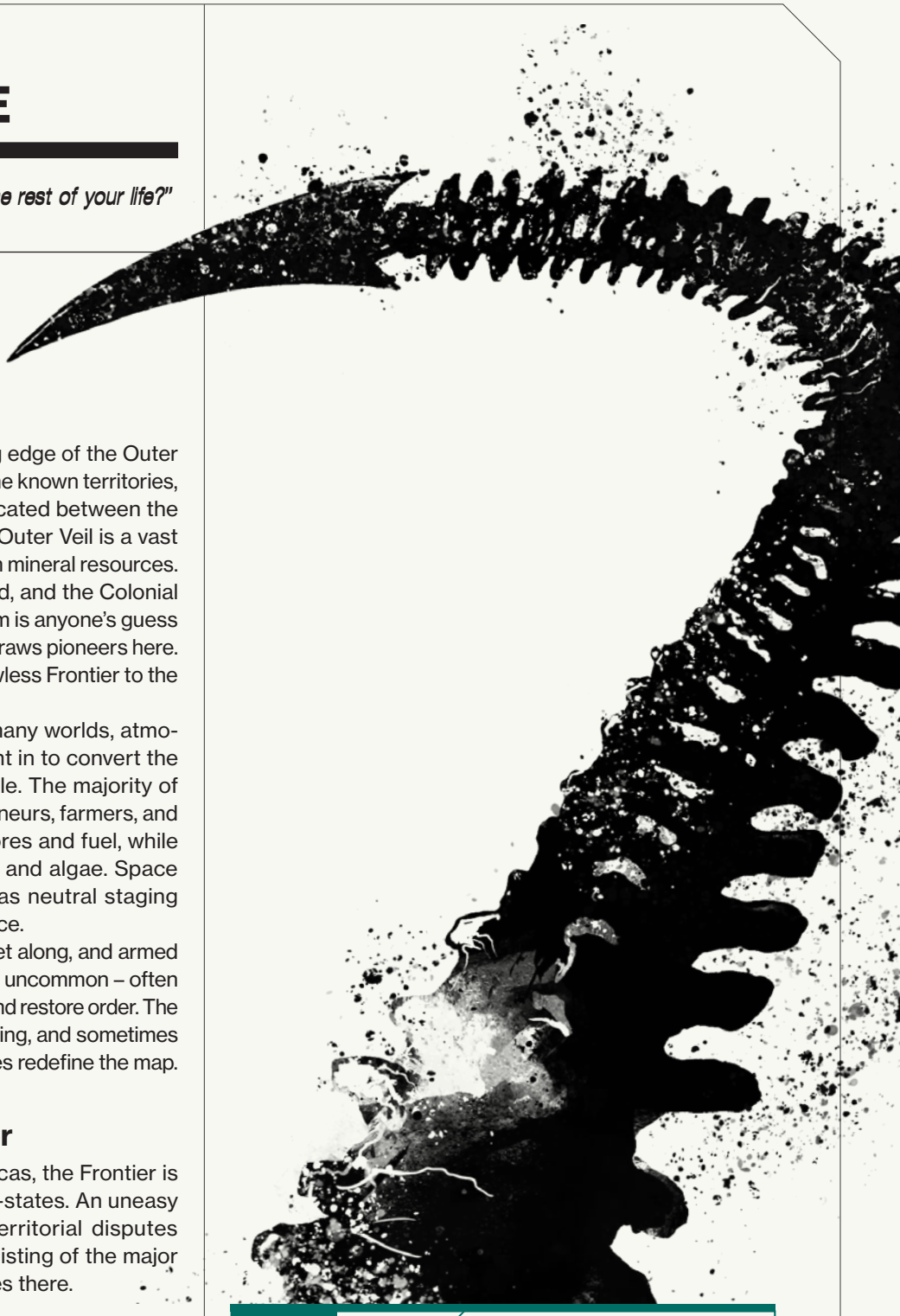
This is the Evolved Edition of the ALIEN roleplaying game. The experiences of thousands of players playing this game for years have been taken to heart to enhance and streamline the game even further. The changes from the first edition are gradual, and all previous expansions are compatible with this new edition. For more details on how to play first edition expansions with the Evolved Edition rules, see page 308.

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FRONTIER LIFE

"Is this really where you want to spend the rest of your life?"
"You know I don't."

Tyler and Rain



THE FRONTIER BEGINS on the leading edge of the Outer Veil, crosses through the Outer Rim of the known territories, and stretches on into deep space. Located between the core systems and the Outer Rim, the Outer Veil is a vast region of space that is abundantly rich in mineral resources. The Outer Rim is extensively colonized, and the Colonial Navy operates there. Past the Outer Rim is anyone's guess – and that thrill of the unknown is what draws pioneers here. Settlers have likened the sometimes lawless Frontier to the Old West of the United States.

Here, life is harsh and cheap. On many worlds, atmospheric processors have been brought in to convert the air into something passably breathable. The majority of settlers here are prospectors, entrepreneurs, farmers, and homesteaders. Mining worlds refine ores and fuel, while agri and aquatic worlds harvest food and algae. Space stations such as Anchorpoint serve as neutral staging grounds for expeditions into deep space.

Neighboring colonies don't always get along, and armed conflicts over stakes and claims are not uncommon – often requiring the Colonial Marines to step in and restore order. The boundaries of the Frontier are ever-shifting, and sometimes colonies switch hands as border disputes redefine the map.

Territories Of The Frontier

While dominated by the United Americas, the Frontier is an area intersected by several nation-states. An uneasy alliance exists between them, yet territorial disputes are not unheard of. What follows is a listing of the major government players vying for resources there.

Three World Empire: Consisting of the former United Kingdom, Japan, and several developing countries, the Weyland-Yutani corporation itself is a result of the formation of the Three World Empire – created when the UK company Weyland Corp merged with the Japanese Yutani Corporation. The Three World Empire pioneered space exploration, controls many long-established inner colonies, and only maintains a limited presence on the Frontier – allowing Weyland-Yutani to take the lead there. ▶

Ship's Log 010:00 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

Looks like Reed went below to sleep it off, and now Nat's trashed the galley and locked herself in their quarters. If they weren't the finest technicians I've ever worked with, I'd boot both their asses out the airlock.

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Ship's Log 015:09 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

We engaged the FTL drive at 014:30 hours and are prepping for hypersleep. No one knows what hole Reed crawled into, and we can't go into the freezers without him. I don't need this bullshit.

The United Americas: Created in the early 2100s to compete with the expanding Three World Empire, the United Americas was formed by the merger of North, Central, and South America into one nation. The United Americas is a major colonizing and starfaring power, constantly expanding the Frontier. They operate both the Colonial Marines and the Colonial Navy – the most powerful peace-keeping forces on the Frontier.

The Union Of Progressive Peoples: The UPP is a powerful socialist block of systems that control a vast but resource-poor sector of space. Formed from a coalition of countries that includes Russia and Vietnam, the UPP is the only government that is not influenced by corporate concerns – a fact that sometimes puts them in opposition to Weyland-Yutani. While they are behind in the arms race, the UPP still maintains a formidable fighting force. A state of cold war has existed between the United Americas and the UPP for decades, but with recent events on the Frontier, all that seems poised to change.

The Independent Core System Colonies: The ICSC is a loose conglomerate of privately-owned worlds. Each colony in the ICSC has its own government – many of which are corporate-owned. In addition to its operations within the colonies of the United Americas and the Three World Empire, Weyland-Yutani is known to maintain private interests in the ICSC – where they can conduct business as they see fit, far from the prying eyes of government control.

Dominion Over The Stars

While governments control the colonies, they aren't the only ones with influence there.

Corporate Dominance: Although nation-states dominate the stars, it is important to note that the real power lies in the corporations that exist across them. Companies like Weyland-Yutani, Lasalle Bionational, and Seegson are not limited by borders. In fact, they produce and control the technologies necessary for the continued existence of these star empires. The unwillingness of nation-states like the UPP to work with the private sector has left them behind in the space race.

God At The Ass End Of Space: Life in the colonies is rough. After being promised a utopia, settlers instead found a frontier existence of drudgery in harsh environments. To that end, many have turned to God to get them through their daily rigors. While traditional religions are practiced throughout the colonies, sects of apocalyptic millenarian fundamentalists have arisen, in isolated areas. Recent years have seen the rise of fledgling organizations with questionable motives, such as the Practitioners of the Holy Immolation and the cultish Church of Immaculate Incubation.

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This Is Rumor Control

Stories spread faster than light on the Frontier. Some scouts tell tales of priceless artifacts found in ancient ruins on distant moons – ruins that predate humanity by millennia. Others talk of derelict spacecraft – and a race of giants that once stalked the stars in them. Still others whisper about hostile lifeforms that overrun entire worlds – terrifying parasitic creatures that are beyond our comprehension and wholly alien.

Many believe Weyland-Yutani and other corporations are covertly developing new and dangerous biological weapons, ranging from plagues and drug-controlled psychopathic cyborgs to genetically-engineered monsters. If these weapons really are being developed, one has to wonder who the company is designing them for, and if a war is on the horizon.

Over the past century, ships, stations, and even colonies have simply disappeared from the Frontier. Some attribute these losses to natural disasters or acts of God, others believe those involved fell prey to pirates or rival governments. Rumors of entire colonies being wiped out by a plague or nuked off the face of a planet have everyone on the Frontier living on the edge. Some even believe that man was never meant to leave Earth, and that space itself can swallow you whole.

Shutter your storm blinds and seal the airlocks – something alien just might be out there, hiding in the dark.

It's waiting for you.

Here Are The Facts

It's the 2180s – only a few years have passed since the destruction of the Hadley's Hope colony on LV-426, the disappearance of the USS Sulaco, and the closing of the prison and lead works on Fiorina 161. The loss of the Sulaco's Colonial Marine unit along with these Weyland-Yutani sponsored outposts, and the implications of corporate foul play stemming from these incidents, have created an air of distrust between the company and the United Americas. Many Frontier worlds have found themselves caught in the middle of this rift and have been forced to make do without either the supplies or defenses they need to survive.

Ship's Log 019:47 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

God damn it. Reed has been missing for almost 12 hours now and Nat is getting nervous. Where the hell is he? He's gone on drunken benders before, but this is too much, I'm going to have to put him on report. He'll lose half a share, but screw him – I want to go to sleep. ▮

Crew Expendable: The only publicly made exposition of these events deals with the aftermath on Fiorina 161. The book is titled Space Beast and is convict Robert Morse's alleged account of an alien "dragon" that overran the facility and brutally slew two dozen double-Y chromo inmates and their custodial staff.

The book gives credence both to talk of monsters and to rumors of Weyland-Yutani experimentation with bioweapons – indicating they were more concerned about securing the creature for further study than saving lives. According to Morse, the hunt to capture the beast had spilled over from the incident on LV-426, and anyone who got in the Company's way was expendable – be they prisoners, soldiers, employees, or even colonists.

Although banned instantly, copies of Space Beast have been transmitted illegally throughout the colonies. The book has developed a strong following. Some see it as a fantasy, a welcome diversion from their normal lives. Others have embraced Morse's story and built a millenarian cult around it – believing it to be a religious text and a portent of the Armageddon to come.

This Time It's War: To add fuel to the fire, conflicts between the rival sectors of space have increased exponentially in the past five years. While unconfirmed, many believe that Hadley's Hope was a test site for one of Weyland-Yutani's bioweapons and that an enemy state sent a warship to nuke it from orbit. Others believe that the Company is working with a rogue nation to assume control of the colonies on the Frontier.

As more and more Colonial Marine units are recalled and re-deployed to new campaigns, Frontier colonists are becoming scared. Without the military, there is no-one to protect them from pirates, hostile lifeforms, or invasion. To compensate, many colonies have enacted their own law systems, electing Marshals to oversee daily law enforcement. Some have even hired mercenary forces to protect their interests.

The 2180s are a dangerous time to be alive. ●

Ship's Log 026:50 ★USCSS MIRANDA

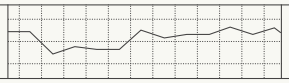
CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

Reed is dead. We found his body in the refinery module. Whoever did it broke his ribs and tore his god-damn heart right out of his chest. I've never seen so much blood. I've messaged the Colonial Marshals to send a security team to rendezvous with us. I'd pass out the guns, but I don't know if one of us is the killer, or if we have a stowaway. For now, I'll be the only one armed. ▮

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TIMELINE

2010–2180s



2023

Following Peter Weyland's infamous Ted Talk address of 2023, Weyland Corp begins developing new technologies that will catapult humanity into the future. Projects in development include advanced artificial intelligence, FTL drives, atmospheric processors for terraforming inhospitable worlds, and hypersleep pods. Weyland produces the first David series of androids.

2039

The UK and Japan pioneer the establishment of settlements on Mars and Titan. Weyland Corp successfully creates a breathable atmosphere on extrasolar planet GJ667CC, opening a Pandora's box of possibilities for humanity to seed the stars. The Outer Veil, an area of space hypothesized to be rich in minerals and other resources, is discovered. The trailing edge of the Outer Veil is where the Frontier begins.

2091

Weyland Corp launches the infamous USCSS Prometheus on a mission to "find the origins of humanity." The ship is lost with all hands and presumed destroyed. With the death of both company founder Peter Weyland and CEO Meredith Vickers, the Weyland Corporation is left in financial ruin. By the turn of the century, the company is bought out and merged with the Yutani Corporation to form Weyland-Yutani.

2031

Terraforming operations begin on Earth's moon Luna. As faster than light speed travel becomes a reality, the Weyland Corporation launches the first FTL Space Exploration vessel, the Heliades.

2088

Leading the technological revolution with such companies as Weyland Corp and the Yutani Corporation, the Three World Empire is formed from the UK, Japan, and other nations.

2010 2020 2030 2040 2050 2060 2070 2080 2090

2042

HD85512 B, Earth's first off-world penal colony, is established by the Weyland Corporation. Prisoners from earthbound facilities are transferred there. Several other corporations begin to capitalize on the space age. Corporate-run mining colonies on the moons of Saturn and Jupiter become a reliable source of the raw materials necessary for FTL travel.

2066

Several small colonies begin to take hold in the Outer Rim Territories, and the United States begins work on a peacekeeping force that will maintain order off-world. This eventually leads to the formation of the United Americas Outer Rim Defense Fleet and later the Colonial Marine Corps. Weyland's David Series Seven androids become commonplace in the workforce.

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2103
The USCSS Covenant, Earth's first long distance, large-scale colonization effort, is announced. The fanatical group known as the Earth Savers repeatedly fails to sabotage the Covenant mission. North, South, and Central America unify to form the United Americas. The Covenant is successfully launched from Earth orbit, carrying over 2,000 colonists and embryos bound for planet Origae-6 in the distant Sector 87.

2106
Civil war breaks out on the colony world of Torin Prime in the Outer Rim Territories. At the resolution of the two-year conflict, the planet is reinstated into the United American Colonies. Over fifteen thousand lives are lost when the UAS troop carrier Archangel is destroyed during a peacekeeping mission to Thedus. In the wake of these conflicts, the Union of Progressive Peoples is formed.

2137
The Nostromo's flight recorder is salvaged and brought to Sevastopol Station. The station is destroyed and it plummets into the atmosphere of planet KG348. Mendel Station on the Outer Rim also disappears. Three years later, contact is lost with Seegson Station LV 44-40 and the Wright-Aberra Waystation as well. In response, the first Anchorpoint Station is established between the Core Systems and the Outer Rim to allow for safe passage to and from the Frontier.

2157
The Hadley's Hope terraformed colony is established on LV-426.

2162
The Colonial Marines instate a draft on the colonies. The Tientsin Campaign on the Frontier world of 8 Eta Boötis A III is fought between the United Americas and the Union of Progressive Peoples. There is no decisive win for either side.

2179
A shuttle from the long-lost Nostromo is recovered by a deep salvage team. The colony on LV-426 stops communicating with Gateway Station. Colonial Marines aboard the USS Sulaco are sent to investigate. The Hadley's Hope colony is destroyed in a thermonuclear explosion. The Sulaco goes missing, but one of her EEV pods crashes on the maximum security planet Fiorina 161. The facility there is quarantined and shut down. There is one survivor. The first Anchorpoint Station suffers a catastrophic reactor meltdown and is destroyed.



2121
Commercial towing vehicle USCSS Nostromo departs Thedus for Earth. For reasons unknown, the Nostromo sets down on LV-426. The ship subsequently resumes course until the engines are set to overload by the ship's third officer, again for reasons unknown.

2142
The Renaissance, a highly advanced Weyland-Yutani Corporation research station, is destroyed when crashing into the rings of the planet LV-410 for reasons unknown.

2180s
The new Anchorpoint Station is established. Tensions flare on the Frontier as factions accuse each other of foul play during the Hadley's Hope incident. Robert Morse's Space Beast is transmitted throughout the colonies and subsequently banned. Mistrust escalates as rumors of deadly alien lifeforms and company bioweapons spread across the Frontier.

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CAREERS ON THE FRONTIER

Space Truckers

While not as lucrative a field as it was some fifty years ago, hauling refineries and cargo between Earth and the colonies is still big business. The advent of newer and faster FTL drives has significantly shortened the travel time between worlds, ensuring that starship crews don't have to spend nearly as much time in stasis. Most companies compensate their crews not only for their work but for time lost in hypersleep as well.

While most space truckers work for one corporation or another, there are also independent trader captains, smugglers, salvage crews, and privateers. Space is big and, legally or off the books, people and things always need to get from one side of it to the other.

Colonial Marines

The United States Colonial Marine Corps represents the finest fighting force ever assembled. Technologically advanced and sporting all the latest in military hardware – a large amount of which is designed by Weyland-Yutani – the Colonial Marines are able to operate independently in nearly any environment. Combat teams are cross-trained and can be deployed at a moment's notice to nearly any world without extensive briefing.

Military occupations include vehicle operators and pilots, combat technicians, heavy weapons specialists, medics, engineers, and career officers. Naval occupations are found in the USCM support service of warship and starfighter teams of the United Americas Outer Rim Defense Fleet, and there are military R&D programs. On the Frontier, there is always something that needs defending and some planet that needs pacifying.

Ship's Log 048:20 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

There is a psycho loose on my ship and Jefferies is dead too. We found his body hanging in the lift bay, his head crushed. This changes things. Everyone thought Reed was a prick. Now... whoever the killer is, I think they'll come for all of us. I'd confine everyone to quarters, but we're getting abnormal readings from the engines. Nat and Hayes are checking it out. ▮

Ship's Log 060:15 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

Mother's been compromised. I ordered her to realign the communications array so I could send a follow-up message to Anchorpoint, but she claimed there was a mechanical error. We tried to go extravehicular to position the array manually but now Mother won't even open the airlocks. Either she's been damaged by the reactor build-up or someone's tampered with her programming. Either way, we're fucked. ▮

Frontier Colonists

To most, becoming a colonist means you accept a hard life with little reward other than the satisfaction of a job well done. A colonist's hands are always dirty and their feet are always tired. Living on the edge of civilization can have its benefits, however. Depending on your profession, the chance to strike it big could be right around the corner. Frontier Colonists are scouts and homesteaders, farmers and scientists, miners and doctors. Colonial Marshals keep the peace and Frontier journalists keep the colonies in the know. Colonists are the lifeblood of humanity.

Company Reps

Corporations have more power than governments on the Frontier. They own worlds, set up shop, and bring in the colonists, creating homes and jobs. From CEOs to field agents, each company sends out its own representatives to oversee their business ventures. Companies like Weyland-Yutani have been known to employ their own commando security teams, doctors, and scientists as well.

Also, there is big business in knowing your competitors' next move – so many corporations have their own counter-intelligence personnel embedded in rival companies and governments. Being a company rep is all about the art of the deal and making sure the little people around you do their jobs so that you can make your next promotion. ●

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ROLEPLAYING ALIEN

EACH PLAYER IN THIS GAME – except one – takes the role of a player character (PC). You might be a space colonist, a space trucker, a marine, or something else. You decide what your PC thinks and feels, what they say and do – but not what happens to them.

It's your job as a player to portray your PC and imagine yourself in their boots. Your PC is a person with feelings and dreams, just like yourself. Try to imagine – how would you react if you were in their place? What would you do?

The player characters are always the protagonists of the story. The game is about you. Your decisions, your story.

The Game Mother

The final player is the Game Mother, or GM for short. She describes the ALIEN universe to you. She portrays all the people and creatures you meet during the game. Characters controlled by the GM are called non-player characters, or NPCs for short.

The game is a conversation between the players and the GM, back and forth, until a critical situation arises where the outcome is uncertain. Then it's time to break out the dice – read more about this in chapter 3.

It is the GM's job to put obstacles in your path and challenge your PCs, forcing them to show what they're really made of. But it is not up to the GM to decide what happens in the game – and above all, not how your story is supposed to end. That is decided in the game. That is why you are playing the game, to find out how your story ends.

Being A Game Mother: A wide range of information and tools for the Game Mother can be found in the chapter 7. ●

Ship's Log 062:00 ★USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

The Marshals aren't coming and navigation is dead. God knows why, but Mother sent our transmissions to Corporate HQ, not Colonial Control. Their only response was to acknowledge the messages were received. Now she has us locked on course for star system HR-2429.

GAME MODES

THE ALIEN ROLEPLAYING GAME can be played in two distinct modes: cinematic play and campaign play. These modes are each designed to create a different experience for you. Even some rules of the game only apply to one of the two game modes – such rules are marked with the symbol of each game mode (see below).

Cinematic Play

A cinematic adventure emulates the dramatic arc of an ALIEN film. Designed to be played in a single session, this game mode emphasizes high stakes and fast and brutal play. Conflict between player characters is likely, and you are not all expected to survive. In fact, most of your PCs probably won't live to see the end of the adventure.

A three-act complete cinematic adventure, Rapture Protocol, is available for separate purchase. A quick taste of cinematic play can be found in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set, available separately, as well as the Draconis Saga trilogy published for the first edition of the ALIEN RPG (but compatible with this Evolved Edition). All cinematic adventures include pre-generated characters.

Campaign Play

Campaign play is designed for longer continuous play with the same cast of player characters over several game sessions, possibly even dozens of sessions. In campaign play, you create your own PCs, using the rules in chapter 2. Campaign play can also be brutal and deadly, but the chances for your PCs to survive a night of play are generally higher than in cinematic play.

In campaign play, the narrative of the game is to a higher degree controlled by the GM and the players themselves. You decide where to go and what to do, based on who your PCs are and what they want. The ALIEN roleplaying game supports three different campaign frameworks:

- Space Truckers
- Colonial Marines
- Frontier Colonists

More information about these campaign frameworks, and tools for how to run them, can be found in chapter 7. Two expansion sourcebooks for campaign play – the Colonial Marines Operations Guide and Building Better Worlds – have been published for the first edition of the ALIEN roleplaying game and are compatible with the Evolved Edition. ●

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KEY THEMES

NO MATTER IF YOU PLAY cinematic or campaign play, any game of ALIEN is based on three key themes. Most adventures and campaigns contain a mix of these themes, but each adventure typically emphasizes one theme more than the others.

Space Horror

The ALIEN experience is rooted in a pervasive darkness and tension, with a capacity to shock by tapping into our primal fears. Every desperate breath into the rebreather of your space suit may be your last.

Sci-Fi Action

Whether it's on an intimate or sprawling scale, roller coaster action – often with bloody results – is essential to many ALIEN stories. This game includes robust mechanics designed for fast and brutal combat.

Sense Of Wonder

The ALIEN roleplaying game lets you discover strange worlds and ancient, incomprehensible artifacts on a grand scale. Many ALIEN stories grapple with questions of humanity's creation, destiny, and place in the universe. ●



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

TOOLS OF THE GAME

THE ALIEN ROLEPLAYING GAME requires you to improvise as you play, but the game also provides a number of tools to help you create your story.

Character Sheets

To document your character, whether it's a pre-generated PC from a cinematic adventure or a character you create for campaign play, you use a character sheet. Filled-in character sheets are included in cinematic adventures, and you can download blank character sheets from the official website alien-rpg.com.

Dice

In the ALIEN universe, nowhere is safe. Sooner or later, you will end up in situations where the outcome is uncertain, no matter how skilled you are. It's time to break out the dice.

There are two types of custom six-sided dice for this game, each available separately and included in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set: base dice (black) and stress dice (yellow). You roll the dice when you perform a dramatic action that might decide if your PC lives or dies.

Both base dice and stress dice have the ✦ symbol on the 6 side. Rolling ✦ usually means that a positive effect of some kind is triggered, such as succeeding at using a skill. Stress dice also have the 🕷 symbol on the 1 side. Rolling 🕷 can trigger panic or other adverse effects. For more on rolling dice, see chapter 3.

Note: You can play this game with any normal six-sided dice, but it helps if you have them in two different colors.

Measuring Time

Three separate units of time are typically used in the game, depending on the situation at hand. See the table below. The exact duration of a combat round, stretch and shift can vary depending on the situation.

UNIT	DURATION	PRIMARY USE
Round	5–10 seconds	Combat
Stretch	5–10 minutes	Stealth
Shift	5–10 hours	Recovery

Countdowns: During a countdown to some catastrophic event, dice rolls can be used to regulate the passage of time. For more on this, see page 55.

ROLLING DICE

The rules sometimes ask you to roll D6, D3, 2D6 and D66. D6 means rolling a base die and reading the number, ignoring any symbols. D3 means you roll a D6 and divide the result by two, rounding up. 2D6 means you roll two D6 and add the results. Another type of roll is the D66, which means you roll two D6s – consider the first die as the tens digit and the second die the ones digit. That gives you a result between 11 and 66.

Cards

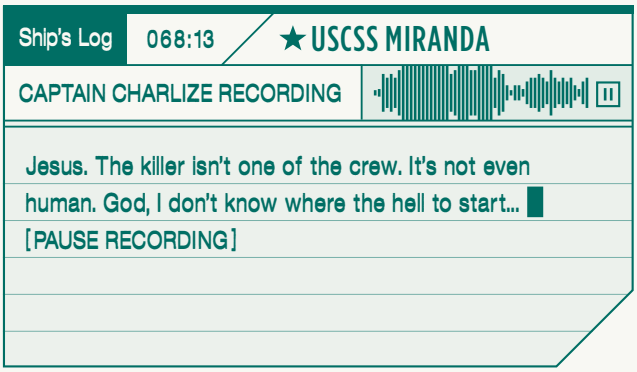
For the ALIEN roleplaying game, there is a custom card deck available in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set. These cards are used for several purposes, such as drawing initiative in combat and tracking stress and panic effects. The custom cards are not required to play the game, but they are a useful supplement.

Safety Tools

The ALIEN RPG is a horror game and getting a good scare is part of the fun. That said, this is still a game, and no players should be forced to deal with topics they find distressing in real life, or that make them feel unsafe at the table.

To make sure everyone is having fun and feeling safe, we recommend that you use safety tools before, during, and after the game. Examples of such safety tools are pre-game discussions about lines and veils for subjects that players want to avoid or keep off-screen, safety cards to be shown during play by a player to indicate that they feel uncomfortable with what is happening in the game, and post-game debriefings.

Always respect any player's wish to raise a concern at any time during the game or even to leave the table if they want to. And don't forget to take breaks. More information about safety tools in tabletop roleplaying can be found online. ●





SO WHAT IS A ROLEPLAYING GAME?

IF YOU HAVE MADE YOUR WAY HERE without knowing what a roleplaying game is, congratulations! Welcome to a rewarding and creative hobby. Roleplaying is a unique form of gaming that combines tabletop gaming with storytelling. Roleplaying games give you a set of rules and let you create your own story with your friends in a way that books, movies, TV, and even video games cannot.

This unique feature of a roleplaying game can also be its challenge – the freedom to create the story yourselves can be overwhelming. To help you, you have the rules in this book and a host of tools and resources for the Game Mother in chapter 7. A great starting point is the Hope's Last Day Starter Set.

If you need advice or ideas, there is a range of online groups for the ALIEN roleplaying game, including the official forum on the Free League website.

Welcome. ●

Ship's Log 071:08 ★ USCSS MIRANDA

CAPTAIN CHARLIZE RECORDING

I'm continuing to record this in case someone finds us. Only Nat and I are left. We've barricaded ourselves in the EEV pod bay, but Mother won't lock the door for us. Nat is trying to override the system so we can launch a pod and get the hell out of here. We've got – Christ, it's here.... [redacted]

[END TRANSMISSION]

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

CHAPTER 2

YOUR CHARACTER

"Why do you think your people made me?"
"We made you 'cuz we could."
"Can you imagine how disappointing it would be for you to hear the same thing from your creator?"

David 8 and Dr. Charlie Holloway

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

YOUR PLAYER CHARACTER (PC) is your most important asset in the ALIEN roleplaying game. They are your avatar in the game world. They are your eyes and ears out there in the deepest dark of space. You munch on popcorn with friends and roll dice while they take all the risks. There is an unwritten binding agreement between you two, and like any corporate contract, there is a catch. You live vicariously through them, and they, in return, depend on you to keep them alive.

Don't screw it up. Take your PC seriously. As far as you are concerned, they are a real person – and their fate is in your hands. No matter what you do, keep in mind your character's goals, hopes, and agenda. They may differ from your personal beliefs, but that's okay – you're playing a character and this is a game. When a Xenomorph looms over them, your character may be terrified even when you aren't. At all times, ask yourself, *"what would my PC do?"* and have them act accordingly.

That said, don't try to protect your character from every conceivable danger. The goal of any ALIEN game is twofold – go on a suspense-filled thrill ride and create a damn good story. For that to happen you need to roll the dice, both figuratively and literally. You need to take risks. But make the risks count for something.

Character Sheet: To keep track of your character's game stats, you need a character sheet. You can photocopy it from the back of this book, or download it from the Free League website and print it.

Cinematic Play

In pre-made cinematic adventures, such as Rapture Protocol and the Hope's Last Day Starter Set, the player characters are already provided for you. All you need to do is decide who plays which character. If you can't agree on who to play, roll dice for it.

The rules for creating characters in this chapter can still be useful when creating your own cinematic adventures. You can even create your characters first and let the GM design a cinematic adventure for them.

Creating Your Character

How you create your player character is explained in detail in this chapter. Grab a character sheet, a pencil, and follow these steps:

1. Choose your **career**.
2. Determine your **attributes**.
3. Determine your **skills**.
4. Choose your **career talent**.
5. Choose your **name**.
6. Decide on your **appearance**.
7. Decide on your **personal agenda**.
8. Choose your **buddy** and **rival**.
9. Pick your **gear** and a **signature item**.
10. Roll for **cash**.

Campaign Play

For campaign play, you create your player character yourself, using the process outlined here. During the course of a campaign, your PC changes and develops. Your skills and talents can be developed through experience, but you can also discover how your PC's personality changes and grows in a way that cannot be measured by numbers on a page. This is when your character truly comes alive.

Campaign Frameworks: Before creating characters, you should decide together as a group on a campaign framework, i.e. which type of people you will be playing. Three suggested campaign frameworks are described on page 16, and GM tools for playing each of them are available in chapter 7.

- Space Truckers
- Colonial Marines
- Frontier Colonists

THE LIFE PATH METHOD

The basic method of character creation described here lets you create a PC quickly. If you want to spend more time fleshing out your character's past life, you can instead use the life path method outlined at the end of this book, on page 282.

This method lets you develop your backstory in detail, learning skills and specialties as you go along. Note that using the life path method can result in less balanced characters, as there are elements of chance involved.

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CORE CONCEPTS

Career

The first choice for your character is your career. Your career choice determines your background and your role in the group. It influences your attributes, your skills, your starting gear and what starting talent you can have. There are nine core careers to choose from, described on pages 31–39.

Career descriptions can feel stereotypical, and they are meant to. Picking a career is a quick way for you – and the other players – to get an immediate feel for your character. But remember that your character is more than just a career. Your career is merely a starting point toward creating a unique player character.

RANDOM ATTRIBUTES

If you prefer a faster and more random approach, creating more varied characters, you can roll dice to determine your attributes. To do so, roll four dice. Re-roll all 1s and 6s until all dice show 2–5. Then assign the scores to the four attributes. Using the random method, you can have a score of 5 in more than one attribute, but if so, one of them must be the key attribute for your career. For androids, add +2 to Strength and Wits and reduce Empathy by –1 after distributing the random rolls.

Attributes

You have four attributes that indicate your core physical and mental capabilities, each rated on a scale from 1 to 5. Your attributes are used when you roll dice to perform actions in the game, and to determine how much damage you can withstand.

- **STRENGTH:** Raw physical power and endurance.
- **AGILITY:** Speed, body control and motor skills.
- **WITS:** Intelligence, alertness and sharpness of mind.
- **EMPATHY:** Charisma and ability to read and affect others.

Starting Attributes: To create your character, distribute a total of 14 points across your attributes. You may assign no less than 2 and no more than 4 points to any one attribute – except the key attribute for your career which can have a score of 5.

Androids: Synthetic characters get a +3 bonus to two attributes of their choice after the 14 attribute points have been assigned, and can reach a maximum score of 8 in the key attribute and 7 in another. However, androids have other drawbacks. See below. ▶

Playing An Android

Androids are an important part of the ALIEN universe, and you can play one as your player character. Androids are rare, however, and we recommend that you talk it through with the rest of the group before creating an android PC. The follow special rules apply for androids:

- Androids get a +3 bonus to two attributes of their choice after the 14 attribute points have been assigned.
- Androids can't push skill rolls (page 43).
- Androids don't suffer stress and don't have a stress level (page 72).
- Androids never make panic rolls.
- Androids suffer damage differently (page 78).

Secret Androids: Most androids look human. They can have any career and may be open about their nature or secretly pose as human. If you play a secret android, you may roll fewer dice for your attributes and even make fake stress and panic rolls to avoid suspicion. Make sure you talk it over with the GM beforehand if you want to play a secret android.

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Skills

Your skills represent the knowledge you have acquired during your life. They determine, along with your attributes, how effectively you can perform certain actions in the game. There are twelve core skills in the game, all described in detail in chapter 3. Skills are measured by a skill level from 0 to 5.

No Skill Level? You can always roll for a skill even if you have no level in that skill. In that case, you only roll for the relevant attribute plus any modifiers from relevant gear. Read more about how skills work in the next chapter.

Starting Skill Levels: To create your PC, distribute a total of 10 points across the twelve skills. The skills listed by your career can have a starting level up to 3. Other skills can start no higher than level 1. You can increase your skill levels during the game (page 30).

Talents

Talents are tricks, moves, and minor abilities that give you a small edge. They are more specialized than skills and make your character unique. Read more in chapter 3.

Starting Talent: When creating your character, you get one talent at the start of the game. Your career offers three talents to choose from. You can learn more talents during the course of the game (page 30).

Stress

Life in space is lethal. More often than you'd like, you'll find yourself under extreme pressure. In the game, this mounting tension is represented by your stress level. It usually starts at zero, and can increase by pushing dice rolls (page 43) and by experiencing terrifying or stressful situations. Stress is explained further in chapter 4.

Resolve

To keep your nerves in check, you need Resolve – a numerical rating equal to your Wits plus Empathy scores divided by two (round fractions up). Your Resolve can be increased by the Seen It All talent. You use your Resolve score to resist stress (page 44) and panic (page 72).

Health

Even if you keep your nerves in check, chances are that sooner or later you're going to get hurt. This is tracked using your Health score.

Health is reduced by taking damage. When your Health is reduced to zero, you're broken and might die – read more in chapter 4. Your starting maximum Health equals your Strength plus Agility scores divided by two (round fractions up) but can be increased by the Hardened talent. ●

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PERSONAL STUFF

Name

Your character needs a name. Each career has a list of six names that are typical for that archetype. Choose one of these names, or make up your own if you prefer. Cinematic adventures will include the names of the pre-generated characters.

Appearance

Describe your player character's appearance in a few words. Your career gives you a few suggestions, but you are free to choose any appearance that you think fits your character.

Personal Agenda

You might be a team, but each individual PC in your group also has an angle of their own – a personal agenda. How personal agendas work differs between cinematic and campaign play.

Player Versus Player

In the ALIEN roleplaying game, your PC can end up in direct confrontation with another PC. This is quite common in cinematic play, less so in campaign play.

In cinematic play, it's up to the GM to call out when a player versus player situation escalates beyond the point of no return. When the GM has "called PvP," the players involved play out the current conflict to its conclusion. After that, the PC who has "turned traitor," if they are still alive, becomes an NPC and is from now on under the control of the GM. The player in question is given a new PC to play, if one is available.

This means that you should think very carefully before acting against the common interest of the group, even if you think it's in line with your personal agenda – it may cost you your PC. You are strongly recommended to wait until the third and final act of the scenario before taking such drastic action.

In campaign play, PvP is less common and any such situations are resolved in the group without specific rules – you'll just need to work out your differences if you are to continue in the same crew of PCs.

Cinematic Agendas: In cinematic play, the PCs' agendas are predetermined by the adventure. At the beginning of each of the three acts of the adventure, the GM gives each PC a handout with a new agenda for the act. The agendas are hidden, you should not show them to other players or write them down on your character sheet.

At the end of each act, the GM evaluates the actions of each PC. If you took any specific actions to further your agenda during the act, you are awarded one story point (page 44). Acts, agendas, and story points are further explained in detail in chapter 7.

Campaign Agendas: In campaign play, you can pick one of the suggested personal agendas listed with your career, or you can come up with an agenda of your own. At the end of each game session, discuss the agendas of all PCs together. If you have taken some concrete action to further your agenda during the session, despite risk or cost, you gain a bonus experience point (page 30).

Buddies & Rivals

The ALIEN roleplaying game is about a small group of people facing unknown and horrifying dangers in the cold darkness of space. To survive, you need to find someone to trust, but also be careful who you turn your back to.

Your PC can have one buddy and one rival amongst the other PCs. In game terms, you can only have one of each. Your relationships are important for the GM, as she can use them to create interesting situations in the game.

In campaign play, you can choose one PC to be your buddy and another to be your rival. In cinematic adventures, the choice is made for you.

YOUR GEAR

TO SURVIVE THE WORLD OF ALIEN, you need the right gear. An M314 Motion Tracker or an M41A Pulse Rifle can truly mean the difference between life and death for your character. You can find lots of gear described in detail in chapter 5. You must write down all the items you are carrying on your character sheet. If it's not listed on your sheet, you don't have it with you.

Starting Gear: In cinematic play, the adventure determines what gear you start the game with. In campaign play, your career gives you gear to choose or roll for. If you get a weapon, you always get two full reloads for it. In addition, you are assumed to have a uniform or civilian clothing. You also get some W-Y dollars – the career indicates how much. Read more about cash and how to spend it in chapter 6. ▶

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EXAMPLE

CREATING A CHARACTER

We're creating a new character for campaign play. She's a roughneck named Nat.

Attributes: As a roughneck, Nat's key attribute is Strength. We give her Strength 5, Agility 3, Wits 2, and Empathy 4.

Skills: Nat's key skills are HEAVY MACHINERY, STAMINA, and CLOSE COMBAT. We give her a skill level of 3 in HEAVY MACHINERY, level 2 in STAMINA and CLOSE COMBAT, and level 1 in COMTECH, OBSERVATION, and MEDICAL AID – you never know when that will come in handy.

Talents: As a roughneck, Nat's career talents are Resilient, Steady Hands, and True Grit. We choose True Grit. Nat's Resolve is 3 and her maximum Health is 4.

Personal Agenda: Nat's personal agenda is: *"Downtime matters. If I can grab a can of Aspen beer and some time alone, I'm happy."*

Buddy & Rival: The others in Nat's crew are the officer Charlize, the pilot Jeffries, her husband and fellow roughneck Reed, and the medic Hayes. Nat's buddy is Charlize, and her rival is Reed (it's a rocky marriage!).

Gear: Nat starts the game with a cutting torch, a compression suit, and $300 in W-Y cash. Her signature item is a photo of her dead partner.

Signature Item: In addition to your normal gear, you also have a signature item – a small item that's of no practical use, but that has sentimental value to you and that says something about your character. Signature items are usually tiny (see below) and thus don't encumber you at all. Common examples include a patch, a cap, or a photo of a loved one.

Vehicles & Spaceships: In some cinematic adventures, your PCs have a vehicle or even a spacecraft. Usually, vehicles and starships don't belong to one individual character – instead, they are crewed by the entire group of PCs together. In campaign play, it's also possible for your group to begin the game with a vehicle or a ship. Read more about this in chapter 6.

Encumbrance

You can carry a number of regular-sized items equal to double your Strength rating without problems. A regular item (weight 1 in the gear lists in chapter 5) is generally the size of a small bag weighing no more than a few kilos, and takes up one row on your character sheet.

Heavy & Light Items: Especially heavy or bulky items count as two or more regular items, and thus take up several rows on your character sheet. At the opposite end of the spectrum, light items count as ½ or even ¼ of a regular item, and several of these can fit on the same row on the character sheet. The gear lists in chapter 5 indicate the weight of every item. If you are uncertain about the weight of an item, assume it is 1 or let the GM decide.

Tiny Items: Items that are even smaller than light items are called tiny. They are so small they don't affect your encumbrance at all. The rule of thumb is: if the item can be hidden in a closed fist, it's tiny. Tiny items also need to be listed on your character sheet.

Over-Encumbered: You can temporarily carry up to twice your normal encumbrance limit, i.e. Strength × 4 regular items. When doing so, your stress level (page 72) increases one step every time you move in a stretch of stealth mode (page 55) or a round of combat (page 61).

Consumables

In the world of ALIEN, you need to overcome a lot more than Xenomorph life forms to survive. Lack of air, ammunition, and electric power can be just as deadly. These are all called consumables. The space suits you'll find in chapter 5 have an air rating, weapons have an ammo rating, and some types of gear have a power rating. Collectively, these are called supply ratings and are tracked on your character sheet.

TIME AS A CONSUMABLE

During a countdown to some catastrophic event, time itself can be treated as a consumable. The GM or the adventure text sets the timer to a certain number of minutes. After each combat round, a supply roll is made. For each rolled, the number of minutes remaining is reduced by one. For more on this, see page 55.

Supply Roll: At certain intervals, you need to make supply rolls for your gear. This means rolling a number of stress dice equal to the current air, ammo or power rating, up to a maximum of six dice. For every rolled, the supply rating of the item is decreased by one.

- **AIR:** Make a supply roll after every stretch of time, and after strenuous activity like combat or a **MOBILITY** roll. When your air supply rating reaches zero, you're entering a world of hurt (page 75).

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- **AMMO:** Most firearms have magazines with a supply of ammunition. After firing your weapon, make a supply roll. When your ammo runs out, you need to reload (page 67).
- **POWER:** Some items require electricity to function. After each use, or as indicated by the item description, you need to make a supply roll. When the power runs out, the item cannot function.

NPCs: To avoid excessive dice rolling, we recommend that the GM does not make supply rolls for NPCs. Instead, the supply rating for NPCs is simply reduced one step each time a supply roll would be made. The GM is free to make a supply roll for an NPC when dramatically appropriate, however. ●

SUPPLY DIAL

The Hope's Last Day Starter Set includes a useful supply dial, which you can use to track any kind of consumable supply rating instead of marking them on your character sheet.

Supply Roll Outcomes

The table below outlines how many supply rolls are needed on average, rounded off to the nearest whole number, for a supply rating to be reduced to zero. Note that the supply rating will decrease faster when it's high than when it's low. This is intentional, to increase the dramatic tension as a supply rating gets closer to zero.

SUPPLY RATING	AVERAGE # OF ROLLS
6	15
5	14
4	13
3	11
2	9
1	6

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DEVELOPING YOUR CHARACTER

Experience

One of the most rewarding things in campaign play is watching your character grow and develop. The harsh realities of life will change you, that's all you can be certain of in an uncertain world. You can develop your character in several different ways during the game.

The things you learn during the game are measured in experience points (XP). You receive XP after the end of each game session. Talk it through and let the whole group discuss what has happened. For each of the below questions that you can reply *"yes"* to, you get one XP:

- Did you participate in the game session? You get one XP just for being there.
- Did you risk or sacrifice something to further your personal agenda?
- Did you risk your life for your buddy PC?
- Did you challenge or stand up to your rival PC?
- Did you make a panic roll?
- Did you overcome a dangerous event, using violent or non-violent means?
- Did you make a significant discovery or revelation?
- Did you perform an extraordinary action of some kind?
- Did you earn any money?

You can only get one XP per question. Sometimes, the answers are not clear-cut. Discuss within the group, and try to reach a consensus. If you can't, the GM has final say. Once you've determined how much XP your character has earned, write the amount down on your character sheet.

Spending XP

You can use your XP to improve your skills and talents, or to learn new ones. You can only spend XP between sessions.

Skills: To increase a skill level by one step costs a number of XP equal to the skill level you want to attain multiplied by 5. For example, an increase from skill level 2 to 3 costs 15 XP. You can only increase a skill level one step at a time.

Learning a new skill (at skill level 1) costs 5 XP. To do this, however, you must have either used the skill and succeeded (without skill level) during the session, or been instructed by a teacher for at least one shift of time. The teacher must have at least skill level 1.

Talents: Learning a new talent always costs 5 XP. You can choose new talents freely from among your career talents and the general talents described in chapter 3.

Changing Buddy & Rival

After the end of a game session, you are free to change your buddy and rival PCs as you see fit.

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Career:

COLONIAL MARINE



Most of your friends will never see another world ... but not you. As soon as you were old enough, you signed up for the USCMC. The pay is crap and the food is worse, but you've always got a bunk to sleep in and you get to shoot all sorts of weapons at all sorts of things. Life in the Corps is never dull – but the luster has begun to fade. You've seen things that you'll never be able to forget, and plenty you wish you could.

- **Key Attribute:** Strength
- **Key Skills:** Close Combat, Stamina, Ranged Combat
- **Cash:** D6×100 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Banter.** The stress level of you and everyone in Short range drops two steps (instead of one) for every stretch spent in a safe place (page 73).
2. **Overkill.** When you roll 9 or higher on a panic roll (page 72), you can ignore the result and instead go into overkill. All other PCs in the same zone must make an immediate panic roll. While in overkill, you must attack your enemies on every turn and you cannot take cover, dodge, or defend yourself against attacks. The effect stops when you or all enemies in sight are broken.
3. **Precise Shooter.** When making a supply roll for ammo (page 66), you get to roll two dice fewer than your ammo supply rating, to a minimum of one die.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Marcus Mullaney
2. Kimi Diem
3. Nik Elson
4. Tara Zanelli
5. Vic Pasengrau
6. Chrissy Lopez

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. You are a decorated hero, you need to defend your reputation. At all costs.
2. You once helped cover up a war crime – no-one must ever know.
3. The death of your buddy has spooked you – now you secretly fear combat and confrontation. You need to overcome your fear.

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Crew cut
2. Arm tattoo
3. Scar
4. Cold eyes
5. Cocky grin
6. Personalized body armor

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. M41A Pulse Rifle
2. M56A2 Smart Gun
3. M314 Motion Tracker
4. Two G2 Electroshock Grenades
5. IRC MK.35 Pressure Suit
6. M3 Personnel Armor

SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Bullet that you survived
2. Lost friend's dog tags
3. Trophy from a defeated enemy

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Career:

COLONIAL MARSHAL



The Frontier can be a lawless place. The Colonial Marines are spread thin – they have neither the time nor inclination to mete out local justice. Not to worry – there's a new sheriff in town, and that's you. Most law enforcement officers on the Frontier are firmly planted deep in the back pocket of one company or another – but not you. You don't take bribes and you never look the other way. You've made a lot of enemies on both sides of the law, but your colony has the lowest crime rate in the system. It's only a matter of time before you piss off the wrong CEO and corporate sends someone to take care of you, but that's okay. You'll be ready.

- **Key Attribute:** Wits
- **Key Skills:** Observation, Ranged Combat, Command
- **Cash:** D6×200 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Authority.** You can use your **COMMAND** skill instead of **MANIPULATION** to get someone to bend to your will.
2. **Investigator.** You get +2 die to **OBSERVATION** rolls when actively searching for something hidden in a zone (page 57). This does not apply to passive **OBSERVATION** rolls.
3. **Subdue.** When attempting to grapple an opponent in close combat (page 62), you get +2 dice.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Jack Kitani
2. Akira Kano
3. Barrell Klein
4. Angela Harris
5. Ivan Mankov
6. Lee-Ann Jenkins

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Cigarette in mouth
2. Impressive mustache
3. Haggard and unshaven
4. Graying hair
5. Inquisitive gaze
6. Old leather jacket

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. Your longtime partner betrayed you and defected to a crime syndicate. Get even.
2. You dream of turning in the badge and settling down in peace. Work towards it.
3. You did a bad thing in the past and it has come back to haunt you. You need to decide what you are made of.

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. .357 Magnum Revolver
2. Armat Model 37A2 12-Gauge Pump-Action
3. Hi-beam flashlight
4. Personal medkit
5. Stun baton
6. D6 doses Neversleep pills

SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Photo of a loved one
2. Dented flask with an inscription
3. Worn cap

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Career:

COMPANY AGENT



You're hungry. Space is full of opportunity, and you've been assigned to the Frontier to find the next big thing. From insider information to new mineral deposits – or even a hitherto unknown life-form to exploit – it's up to you to score a win for the company and use it to catapult yourself up the corporate ladder. You tend not to form long-lasting attachments, instead viewing everybody as a commodity to capitalize on. Worry about others later. Right now, it's all about the bottom line.

- **Key Attribute:** Wits
- **Key Skills:** Comtech, Observation, Manipulation
- **Cash:** D6×1,000 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Company Resources.** Once per act in cinematic play or once per session in campaign play, you may gain +1 stress level to produce an item of your choice – you had it all along! It can be any item from chapter 5, or anything else the GM deems reasonable, but it cannot be larger than a regular item (weight 1). The item is not yours – the Company will want it back.
2. **Cunning.** You can roll for **MANIPULATION** using Wits instead of Empathy.
3. **Personal Safety.** If you are attacked and another PC or friendly NPC is within Short range, make a **MANIPULATION** roll (no action) to make the other character be targeted by the attack instead of you. Stress level +1 for each use.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Conrad Schmidt
2. Michiko Nogumi
3. Alexander Balconi
4. Sheridan Lamara
5. Ryan Middlebrook
6. Mercedes Prince

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. You are greedy for power and never miss an opportunity to get ahead.
2. The Company is holding back information from you. What? And why?
3. You are a nice guy, but the Company is blackmailing you to do its dirty work. Get even.

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Icy glare
2. Disarming smile
3. Soft hands
4. Expensive suit
5. Elaborate hairstyle
6. Monogrammed silk tie

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Leather briefcase
2. Comm unit
3. Samani E-Series Watch
4. Data transmitter card with corporate clearance level
5. VP-70MA6 Service Pistol
6. D6 doses Naproleve

SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Personalized business card
2. Rolex watch
3. Gold-plated pen

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Career:

KID



You didn't ask for a Frontier life – your parents brought you into this world kicking and screaming. Grown-ups always ask you what you want to be when you grow up, but all you want to do is be a kid. You used to fantasize about being an adult, able to stay up late and eat junk food whenever you want. Thing is, most of the Frontier adults you know are always miserable and tired. There isn't much to do where you live, so you make your own fun. There's time to grow up later. For now, playing hide-and-seek in the ventilation system seems the way to go

- **Key Attribute:** Agility
- **Key Skills:** Mobility, Survival, Observation
- **Cash:** D6×10 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Hard to Catch.** You get +2 dice to **MOBILITY** when dodging an attack (page 65).
2. **Lucky.** You get to re-roll any death roll or roll for a critical injury once. Choose the result you prefer.
3. **Nimble.** You can push a skill roll using Agility twice. Stress level +1 for each push.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Chip Harrington
2. Meggie Wu
3. Hugo Turner
4. Maisie Kelly
5. Jakey Myers
6. Becca David

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Grubby and unkempt
2. Trendy sneakers that light up
3. T-Shirt with band logo
4. Ponytail
5. Bored expression
6. Baseball cap

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. You want to find an adult you can trust – really trust.
2. You have no family left. Make sure you never end up alone again.
3. No one gives you anything to do, so explore, try things out, make your own entertainment.

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Laser pointer
2. Radio-controlled car
3. Yo-yo
4. Electronic handheld game
5. Personal locator beacon
6. Coloring pens

SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Lunchbox covered in stickers
2. Favorite doll or action figure
3. Bracelet made by older sibling

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Career:

MEDIC



There are a million-and-one ways to die in space, from exposure to vacuum or unknown contagions to vicious organisms or getting accidentally shot by a drunken roughneck. In all these scenarios, you're the one carrying the bandages and adrenaline shots. When someone suffers trauma, it's the first few minutes that matter most. If someone survives long enough to make it to a MedPod, you've done your job. You used to be altruistic about Frontier medicine, but you've seen enough to become jaded. Too many people in the Outer Veil are addicted to painkillers, and most colonies are not up to health and safety regulations. That means more people get hurt. Your work is never done.

- **Key Attribute:** Empathy
- **Key Skills:** Mobility, Observation, Medical Aid
- **Cash:** D6×200 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Field Medic.** You get +2 dice when rolling for **MEDICAL AID** to give first aid (page 68).
2. **Nurse.** When you tend to a character recovering from a critical injury (page 71), each day counts double. For each shift spent per day, you can tend to a number of patients equal to your **MEDICAL AID** skill level.
3. **Surgeon.** You get +2 dice when rolling for **MEDICAL AID** to treat a critical injury that requires surgery (page 71).

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Cho Hadfield
2. Ana Kasnavik
3. Ken Ibana
4. Juno Blanchard
5. Sullivan Ward
6. Katie Aberly

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. You are addicted to a strong painkiller. Protect your stash – and your secret.
2. You have some unusual (but classified) medical reports that the Company is looking for. Find out why they are so important.
3. You've sworn an oath never to take a life, and you mean it.

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Sympathetic smile
2. Dark bags under eyes
3. Calm and gentle voice
4. Cold, unsympathetic stare
5. Spectacles
6. White coat (clean or stained)

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Surgical kit
2. IRC MK.50 Compression Suit
3. D6 doses Naproleve
4. D6 doses Neversleep
5. Personal medkit
6. Samani E-Series Watch

SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Framed medical certificate
2. Letter from son or daughter
3. Last psych evaluation:
   "All clear at last"

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Career:

OFFICER



When everything is going to shit – the Company's holding your crew's pay hostage, there's a mountain of reports to file from that last incident near Thedus, and who knows how many family members back home are weighing on everyone's minds – it's a good thing you spent all those years training to do this for a living. You're the authority figure, the role model, the voice of your superiors, and the enlisted crew's advocate. You're also the butt of all of their jokes around the mess hall ... until it all gets so much worse, and they're looking to you for what to do next. Better hope your training has a solution to this one.

- **Key Attribute:** Empathy
- **Key Skills:** Ranged Combat, Command, Manipulation
- **Cash:** D6×300 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Field Commander.** You can use **COMMAND** to give orders in combat (page 60) as a quick action instead of a full action.
2. **Frontline Leader:** You get +2 dice to **COMMAND** rolls to rally a broken character (page 68).
3. **Pull Rank.** You can use your **COMMAND** skill to order other non-officer NPCs around, as long as they belong to the same organization as you. If successful, the target must follow your order, even if it means harm or danger to themselves. Stress level +1 for each use.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Eugene Proctor
2. Wendy Stern
3. Oliver Bryant
4. Julia Kwang
5. Lloyd T. Darrington
6. Camille Kirschner

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. You come from an officer family. You need to gain a promotion or an award – soon.
2. You messed up in the past. Avoid taking the blame for any more mission screw-ups.
3. Mistakes are deadly, so don't let anyone under your watch screw up. Make sure they understand why.

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Hair in a crew cut, or tied-back
2. Serious, intense expression
3. Spotless uniform
4. Stiff body posture
5. Relaxed and soothing voice
6. Impatiently taps a foot

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. M4A3 Service Pistol
2. Rexim RXF-M5 EVA Pistol
3. Samani E-Series Watch
4. M314 motion tracker
5. IRC MK.50 Compression Suit
6. Seegson P-DAT

SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Ship's cat
2. Letter of recommendation
3. ICC Commercial Flight Officer license

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Career:

PILOT



The stars are the limit, and they are limitless. You aren't content to keep your feet on the ground, and on the Frontier, there's no need to. From starfighters to dropships, freighters to frigates, there's always something that needs flying – and some aerospace stunt that only you can pull off. You aren't in this for the money, although it doesn't hurt. You're a thrill-seeker and an adrenaline junkie. Danger is the rush you live for, but stay frosty. Otherwise, the next time you find yourself dodging through an asteroid belt or seeing the ground rush up to meet you might be your last.

- **Key Attribute:** Agility
- **Key Skills:** Piloting, Ranged Combat, Comtech
- **Cash:** D6×200 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Full Throttle.** When piloting a spacecraft, you get +2 dice to **PILOTING** rolls for for accelerating or decelerating (page 143).
2. **Like the Back of Your Hand.** You get a +2 dice to all **PILOTING** rolls for one specific ship or other vehicle.
3. **Reckless.** You may take +1 stress level before making a skill roll, before pushing. You can push the roll normally, gaining another +1 stress level.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Casper Edmonton
2. Fiona O'Neill
3. Sven Stackman
4. Constance Navona
5. Kiel Avari
6. Igraine Turner

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Arrogant walk
2. Steely blue eyes
3. Multi-pocket flight suit
4. Mirrored sunglasses
5. Deadpan expression
6. Chews gum

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. It's about pushing the limit. Taking a chance. Taking risks – so take a risk.
2. You're stubborn and don't like to back down, even if your friends might get hurt.
3. You're a loner, always happier when you can do a task without relying on others

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. M4A3 Service Pistol
2. PR-PUT Uplink Terminal
3. Hand radio
4. Maintenance jack
5. Seegson System Diagnostic Device
6. IRC MK.50 Compression Suit

SIGNATURE ITEM

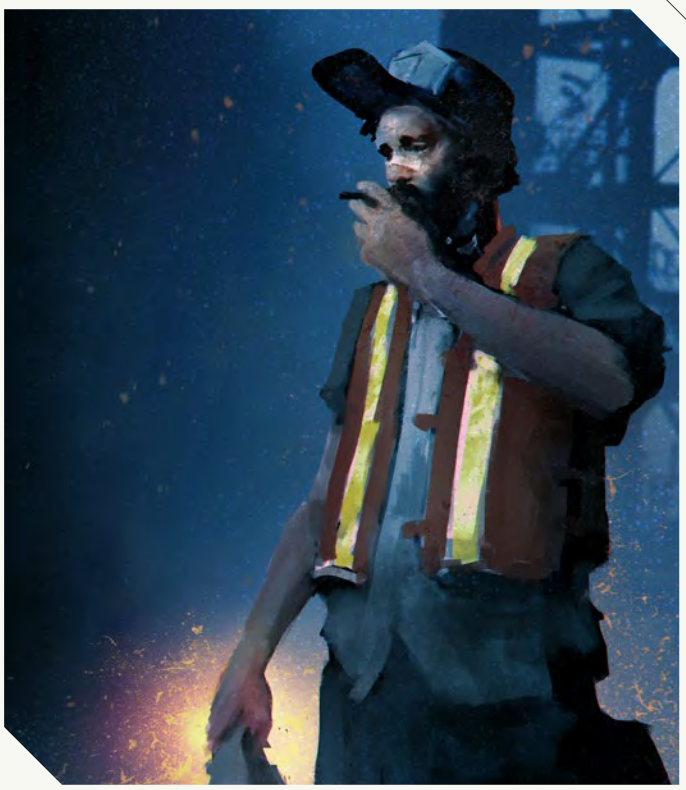
Choose or roll D3:

1. Dashboard dancer
2. Pilot's logbook
3. Pilot shades

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)

Career:

ROUGHNECK



Someone has to do the manual labor on the Frontier, and that someone is you. Life has dealt you some harsh blows but you've always struck back. You've been in countless barroom brawls, you swear a lot, and belch at the dinner table. In short, people find you uncouth. You really don't care – you've grown past the need for niceties. No one works harder than you. You are up before first dawn and finish your workday long after second twilight. You are the cog that keeps the wheels in the Frontier machine turning. Your hands are calloused and your face is dirty, and the only thing harder than the work you do is the way you party.

- **Key Attribute:** Strength
- **Key Skills:** Heavy Machinery, Stamina, Close Combat
- **Cash:** D6×100 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Resilient.** Roll for Strength (attribute only) any time you suffer damage. You can't push the roll, which does not count as an action. For every ✦ you roll, one point of damage is eliminated.
2. **Steady Hands:** You can, if you want to, skip rolling one or two stress dice in any skill roll. When rolling for stress or panic effects, use your full stress level.
3. **True Grit.** You can push a skill roll based on Strength twice. Stress level +1 for each push.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Mac Masterton
2. Sassy Diaz
3. Kip Tranter
4. Kat Longridge
5. Charlie Stead
6. Jayden Pace

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Tattoos
2. Loud laugh
3. Bruised and calloused hands
4. Eyes hidden behind safety goggles
5. Filthy boots that clomp loudly when you walk
6. Wild hair

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. You are a compulsive thrill-seeker. If there is a risk to take, you'll step up and try it.
2. You once sacrificed your family for the job. Now you won't let your friends down – ever.
3. Downtime matters. If you can grab a can of Aspen beer (or even Souta Dry, though only if you're desperate) and some time alone, you're happy.

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Cutting torch
2. Watsumi DV-303 Bolt Gun
3. D6 doses Hydr8tion
4. Maintenance jack
5. IRC MK.50 Compression Suit
6. Hi-beam flashlight

SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Tool belt
2. Photo of partner
3. Crucifix or other religious symbol

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)

Career:

SCIENTIST



Every day, new pieces to the puzzle of existence are found on the Frontier. Figuring out what makes them fit together could leap humanity over nature's next hurdle, and you are one thesis away from the respect you deserve. Some find you cold and detached – they don't understand that your passion is knowledge. Whether your field is xenobiology, astrophysics, robotics, or even archaeology, there are countless treasures in space, just waiting for someone to trip over the next asteroid and run right into them. Whether or not that's you, you're still the one who understands them better than anyone.

- **Key Attribute:** Wits
- **Key Skills:** Observation, Survival, Comtech
- **Cash:** D6×300 W-Y dollars

TALENT

Choose or roll D3:

1. **Analysis.** You can roll for **OBSERVATION** to gain insight regarding strange and alien artifacts or creatures that you encounter. For every ✠ you roll, you get to ask the GM one of the following questions: Is it human or alien? Is it dead or alive? How old is it? What is its purpose? How does it work? What problems could it cause? A successful roll reduces the stress level of all other PCs within Short range 1 step, while a failed roll increases their stress levels by 1.
2. **Inquisitive.** You can push a skill roll based on Wits twice. Stress level +1 for each push.
3. **Xenomorphology.** When facing an extraterrestrial creature of any kind, you may make an **OBSERVATION** roll (quick action). If successful, you realize a potential weakness of the creature, if it has any. If you fail, gain stress level +1. Only one attempt per Xenomorph is allowed.

NAME

Choose or roll D6:

1. Viggo Kowalski
2. Elena Sanchez
3. Drew Lancaster
4. Louise Mallory
5. Travis Torrence
6. Karima Yusef

PERSONAL AGENDA

Choose or roll D3:

1. Your last project was stolen from you. Now you keep many of your findings secret.
2. You hate authority and go out of your way to be uncooperative if possible.
3. You find it hard to delegate to others, even if it means taking on extra work

APPEARANCE

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Unkempt, untidy appearance
2. Stained lab coat
3. Nervous manner
4. Thoughtful gaze
5. Clears throat before speaking
6. Bleary, overworked eyes

GEAR

Choose two or roll D6 twice:

1. Digital video camera
2. Seegson P-DAT
3. Seegson System Diagnostic Device
4. Personal Data Transmitter
5. M314 Motion Tracker
6. Personal medkit

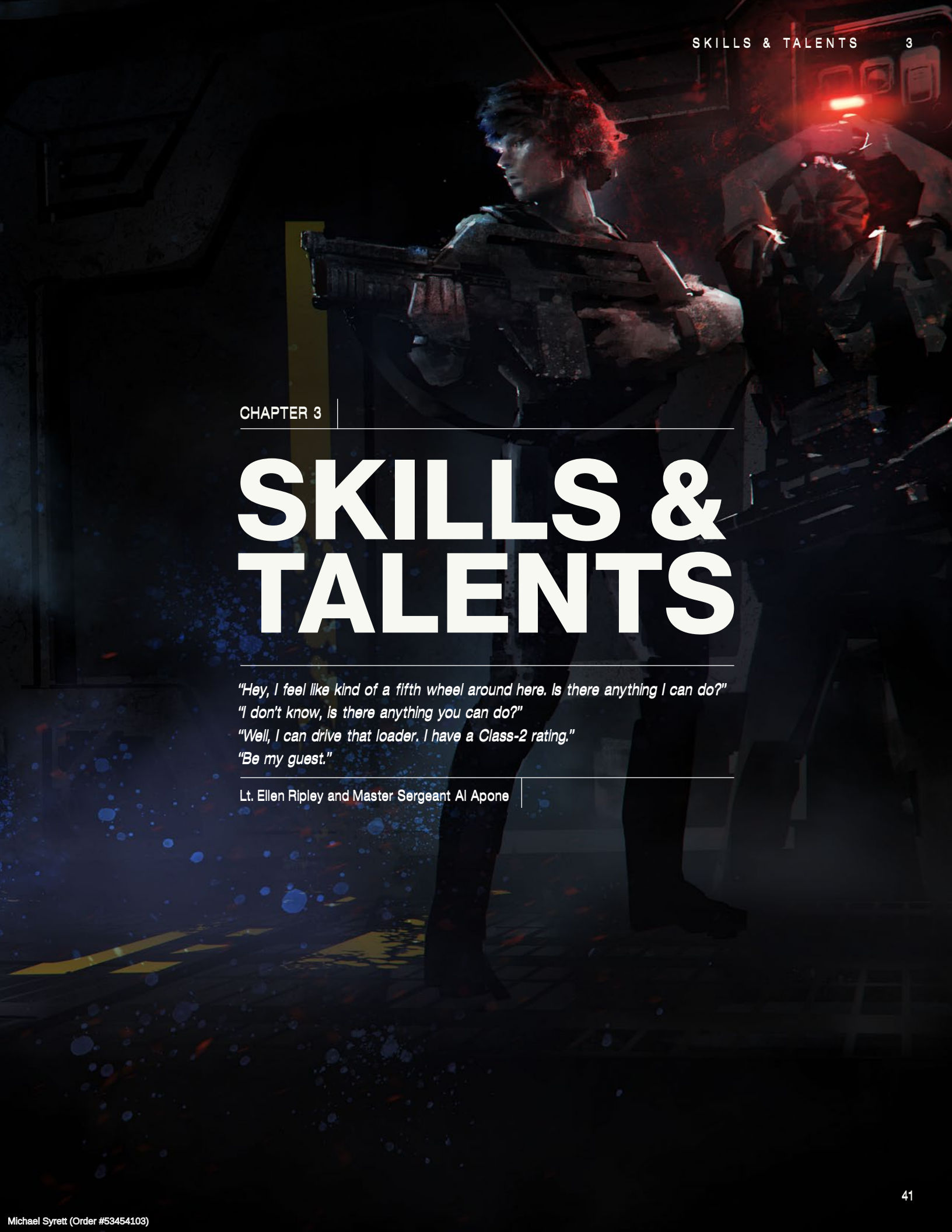
SIGNATURE ITEM

Choose or roll D3:

1. Albert Einstein Award
2. Unfinished scientific paper
3. Blackmail letters

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)



CHAPTER 3

SKILLS & TALENTS

"Hey, I feel like kind of a fifth wheel around here. Is there anything I can do?"
"I don't know, is there anything you can do?"
"Well, I can drive that loader. I have a Class-2 rating."
"Be my guest."

Lt. Ellen Ripley and Master Sergeant Al Apone

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ROLEPLAYING IS A CONVERSATION. The GM sets the scene, you describe what you do, she tells you how the NPCs react, you respond, and so on – back and forth. The story grows one step at a time, and everyone lives happily ever after.

Yeah, just kidding about that last part. Not on the Frontier, you don't.

Sooner or later, the shit – just like prisoner Murphy – hits the fan. Things come to a head, a point of no return is reached, and a problem mounts that cannot just be settled by talking your way out of it.

That's when you call upon your mad skills. Just break out the dice and show Mother you know a thing or two.

USING SKILLS

THERE ARE TWELVE SKILLS in total in the game. Three skills are typically linked to each of the four attributes: Strength, Agility, Wits, and Empathy. Skills are measured in skill levels, from 0 to 5. You can increase your skill levels during play (page 30).

Dice

Two types of six-sided dice are used in this game: base dice and stress dice. You can use any normal six-sided dice if you don't have access to the custom dice for the game, but it helps if you have them in two different colors to tell base dice and stress dice apart.

When To Roll

Generally, the rules in this book or the adventure text will indicate when to roll dice and what skill to roll for. However, the GM can always call for a roll in a situation she feels warrants it. We recommend against excessive dice rolling however, saving the rolls for dramatic and tense situations where something is truly at stake.

Means Success

To use a skill, add your skill level to your score in the attribute linked to the skill, and grab that many base dice. Then roll all the dice together. For your action to succeed, you must roll at least one 6 (on the custom dice) – if not, your action fails.

Stress Dice: If you have stress level 1 or higher, add this number of stress dice to the dice pool as well. If you roll a 1 on one or more stress dice (on the custom dice), you suffer a stress response – see page 44.

THE 12 SKILLS

- **HEAVY MACHINERY** (Strength)
- **STAMINA** (Strength)
- **CLOSE COMBAT** (Strength)
- **MOBILITY** (Agility)
- **RANGED COMBAT** (Agility)
- **PILOTING** (Agility)
- **OBSERVATION** (Wits)
- **COMTECH** (Wits)
- **SURVIVAL** (Wits)
- **COMMAND** (Empathy)
- **MANIPULATION** (Empathy)
- **MEDICAL AID** (Empathy)

NPCS & SKILLS

Non-player characters use skills in the same way as player characters, with the one major difference being that NPCs never push rolls. This means NPCs don't have a stress level.

The GM rolls dice for NPCs, but should only roll for actions that affect a PC directly – for example, if the NPC is attacking a player character or is attempting to save them. When an NPC performs an action that does not directly affect a PC, the GM can simply decide what happens, without rolling dice.

The Skill Roll

Grab base dice equal to **attribute** + **skill**.

Modify the base dice pool for **difficulty**, **gear** and **help**.

Add **stress dice** equal to your **stress level**.

Roll all dice

If you roll no , you **fail**. You can push the roll – stress level +1 and re-roll.

If you roll one or more , you **succeed**. To get more you can push the roll – stress level +1 and re-roll.

If you roll on one or more stress dice, trigger a **stress response**.

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SWITCHING ATTRIBUTES

If the GM or adventure text calls for it, you may need to use a different attribute than the one normally linked to a skill. For example, threatening an NPC may use Strength + **MANIPULATION** instead of Empathy + **MANIPULATION.** You can even suggest rolling for a different attribute yourself if the situation calls for it. The GM has final say. Note that some talents specifically allow a different attribute to be used with a certain skill.

Rolls Without Skill: If you don't have the skill required for the particular action you want to perform, you can roll anyway – simply roll a number of base dice equal to your attribute as well as any stress dice.

Modifiers

The rules or the GM can modify your chances, adding or removing base dice for you to roll. This is referred to as +1 die, +2 dice, etc., and conversely –1 die, –2 dice, etc. You can never go below one base die. Modifiers never affect stress dice.

Gear: Equipment can modify your roll, but not always. Sometimes a specific item is needed just to perform the action. Weapons and other types of gear are found in chapter 5.

Helping

Up to three other PCs and NPCs can help you with a dice roll. Each person helping you gives you +1 die, but they need to be in a position to actually support your action in a concrete way. The GM has final say. In combat, helping someone uses up your full action for the round.

EXAMPLE SKILL MODIFIERS AND HELPING

The air scrubbers on the USCSS Miranda are offline and our roughneck Nat tries to repair them. With Strength 5 and skill level 3 in HEAVY MACHINERY, she gets eight base dice. She uses a maintenance jack for the job and Jeffries helps her out, giving her +2 dice for a whopping total of ten base dice.

Multiple Successes

The more ✦ you roll, the better the result. In combat (page 59), that usually means more damage, but it can mean any number of bonus effects – for example:

- You show off.
- You do it quickly.
- You do it quietly.
- You achieve some unexpected additional effect.

The adventure text or the GM has final say on what extra ✦ can be used for.

Failure

If you don't roll any ✦, you mess up. For some reason, you failed to achieve your goal. Feel free to elaborate on why with the help of the GM. She might even decide that a failed roll has further consequences that will move the story forward in a dramatic way.

Failure should never stop the story completely. Even when you fail, there must be a way forward – perhaps at the cost of time, risk, or W-Y dollars, but still a way. The GM has the final say on the consequences of failure in any particular situation.

You have one last chance if you really want to succeed – you can push the roll.

Pushing Your Roll

If you fail a roll, or need more ✦, you can choose to push the roll. This immediately increases your stress level (page 72) one step, meaning you add one stress die to your dice pool. Then re-roll all dice not showing ✦. All dice count after the re-roll, including the ones not re-rolled.

Stress Dice: If you rolled one or more ☣ on stress dice in the initial roll, you cannot push the roll.

Just Once: You can only push your roll once, unless you have a talent that allows you to push a roll a second time. ▶

EXAMPLE PUSHING YOUR ROLL

Despite good odds, Nat fails to repair the air scrubbers. She decides to push the roll, increasing her stress level to 1 and adding one stress die to her dice pool. She then re-rolls the ten base dice along with the stress die, now getting two ✦. She succeeds, and as a bonus effect for the extra ✦, the GM decides that she finds a strange icky trail leading into the air shafts ...

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Stress Response

If you roll on one or more stress dice in a skill roll, a stress response is triggered. Roll a D6, adding your stress level and subtracting your Resolve score (page 26) before comparing the result to the table below. Your stress responses are removed by relieving stress (page 73). If you get a stress response that you already have, you instead gain stress level +1.

Passive Rolls

Sometimes, the GM will ask you to roll for something you're not even aware of – typically **OBSERVATION** rolls in stealth mode (page 56). Such rolls cannot be pushed, nor trigger stress responses. You still add your stress level to the roll. The GM can even make some passive rolls in secret.

Stress Response Roll

D6 + Stress Level − Resolve

RESULT	RESPONSE
≤0	**Keeping Cool.** No effect.
1	**Jumpy.** When you push a skill roll, you gain +2 stress level instead of +1.
2	**Tunnel Vision.** All skill rolls based on Wits get –2 dice.
3	**Aggravated.** All skill rolls based on Empathy get –2 dice.
4	**Shakes.** All skill rolls based on Agility get –2 dice.
5	**Frantic.** All skill rolls based on Strength get –2 dice.
6	**Deflated.** You cannot push any skill rolls. If you are Jumpy (#1 above), remove that response, and ignore any further Jumpy results while Deflated.
7+	**Mess Up.** Your action fails regardless of rolled and you gain +1 stress level.

STRESS CARDS

In the Hope's Last Day Starter Set, custom cards for all enduring stress responses are included.

Opposed Rolls

When facing an active resistance to your skill roll, you need to roll off against your opponent. In an opposed roll, you need to roll more than your opponent to succeed. You can push the roll even if you're the target of an opposed roll. Opposed rolls are used sparingly, only when indicated by the rules or the adventure text, or when deemed appropriate by the GM.

PvP: In the case of two PCs rolling off against each other, the active PC decides whether to push the roll first, and if so, re-rolls, then the passive PC decides whether to push or not.

Open Rolls: In opposed rolls where there is no clear active party, a tie means there is no clear winner of the roll. If this doesn't work in the situation, break the tie randomly. ●

EXAMPLE OPPOSED ROLLS

Captain Charlize on the USCSS Miranda is attempting to bypass Mother's antagonistic actions by accessing her core in the mainframe. The GM says this is an opposed roll against Mother's COMTECH skill level of 7 (the ship's MU/TH/UR 7000 mainframe has no base attributes). Charlize has no COMTECH skill, so she's just rolling four base dice for her Wits and four stress dice for the current stress level. Her roll comes up with one , but the GM rolls for Mother and gets two .

Charlize decides to push the roll, increasing her stress level to 5 and adding another stress die to her dice pool. She then re-rolls all dice not showing , getting two more for a total of three! However, she also rolls one on a stress die. With a Resolve score of 4 and stress level 5, she rolls a D6 and adds 1. In a stroke of bad luck, she rolls a 6 for a total of 7. The captain messes up! On the brink of triumph, Mother takes control of the USCSS Miranda and her communications. As a result, Charlize gains +1 stress level.

STORY POINTS

In a cinematic adventure, you can spend a story point (page 158) to automatically get a result on one base die in a skill roll. This can be done before or after pushing the roll. You gain story points by following your personal agenda (page 27). You can never have more than 3 story points.

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THE SKILLS

Heavy Machinery (Strength)

Hard work is part of life for any roughneck on the Frontier, but at least you have powerful machines to help you. Roll for this skill when you attempt to use, repair, jury-rig or break any kind of heavy machinery.

Stamina (Strength)

When your physical endurance or vigor is tested, roll for **STAMINA**. For example, this skill is used to survive the cold vacuum of space or to resist a deadly contagion.

Close Combat (Strength)

The world of ALIEN is a brutal place. Sometimes, you have no choice but to fight for your life, up close and personal. Roll for this skill when you attack someone in close combat. Read more about close combat in chapter 4.

Mobility (Agility)

Roll for **MOBILITY** to perform any kind of acrobatic movement such as a risky climb or a dangerous jump.

Piloting (Agility)

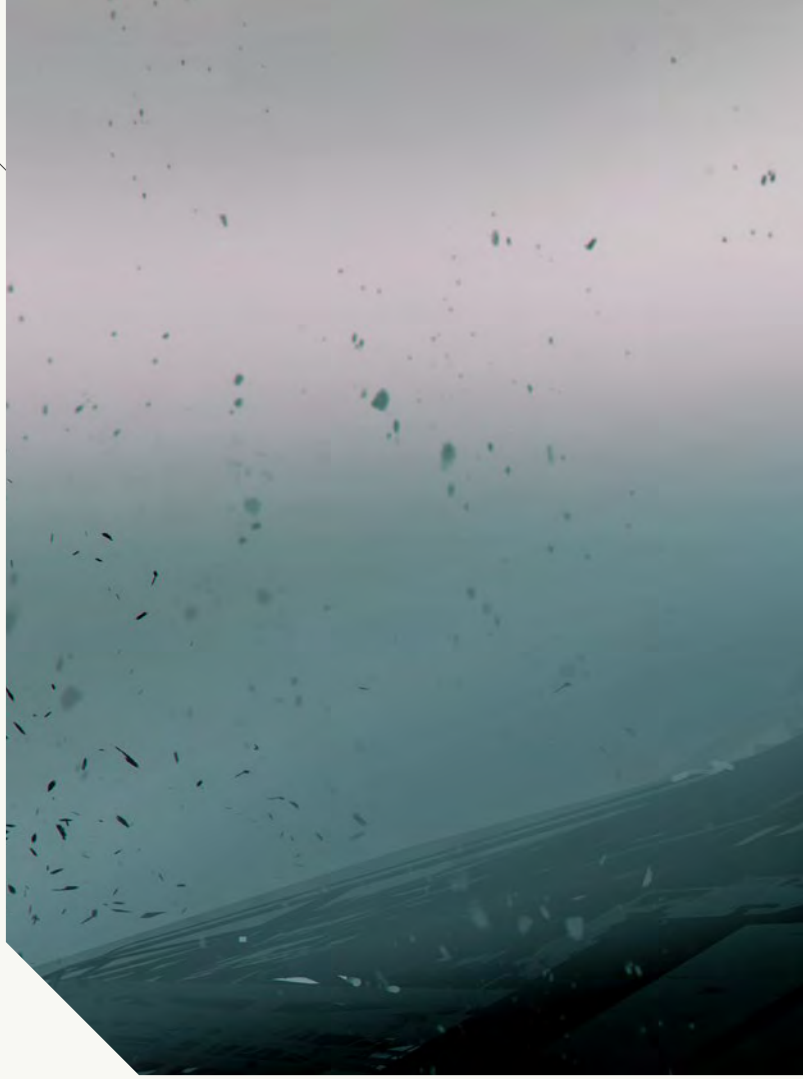
Be it a dropship, a star freighter or a battle frigate, you're the one to fly it. Roll for **PILOTING** when you attempt any difficult and dangerous maneuver at the helm of any type of spacecraft (page 143). The skill can also be used to drive ground vehicles.

Ranged Combat (Agility)

If you have a ranged weapon, you can take down your enemy from a distance without getting your hands bloody. Use the **RANGED COMBAT** skill to fire all types of ranged weapons. Read more about ranged combat in chapter 4.

Comtech (Wits)

Programming androids, mainframes, and other types of advanced technology requires specialist knowledge. Roll for **COMTECH** for any challenging attempt to program, repair, decrypt or otherwise manipulate any type of computer or communications technology.



Observation (Wits)

In the world of ALIEN, you need to be on your guard at all times, or you won't live long. Use your **OBSERVATION** skill to spot someone sneaking. You can also use the skill when you spot an unknown threat of some kind, to learn more about it. Read more about stealth mode in the next chapter.

Survival (Wits)

Terraforming can make the atmosphere on alien worlds (passably) breathable, but it will rarely make them Earthlike. You might be able to breathe without a pressure suit on such worlds, though you can also expect to struggle against extreme heat and cold, sandstorms, acid rain, and other extreme weather. Roll for **SURVIVAL** when you're in a hazardous environment to avoid becoming fatigued – or worse (page 75).

Command (Empathy)

If you are to survive the horrors of space, you'll need a good leader – or you must become one yourself. You can use your **COMMAND** skill to stop panic in other PCs (page 72) and to give orders in combat (page 60).

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Manipulation (Empathy)

Alien life forms may gut you without remorse, but the most truly dangerous beings in the ALIEN universe are corporate agents and other schemers who use lies, threats, or subtle persuasion to get what they want. To make another person see things your way, roll for **MANIPULATION**. If the person is actively opposed to your point of view, this is an opposed **MANIPULATION** roll (page 44). Your chances are affected by your negotiating position (see the adjacent sidebar).

NOT MIND CONTROL

When you use **MANIPULATION** on someone, you don't take control of their mind. What you are trying to convince your adversary to do must be somewhat reasonable, or the GM can disallow it.

Medical Aid (Empathy)

In the world of ALIEN, there is a significant risk that you or the other characters will be injured, sooner or later. Roll for **MEDICAL AID** to give first aid to a dying character (page 68) or to make medical examinations. ●

Negotiating Position

Your chances of using **MANIPULATION** on someone successfully are affected by your negotiating position.

Each of the following factors gives you +1 die:

- You have more people on your side.
- What you ask for doesn't cost your opponent anything.
- Your opponent has suffered damage.
- You have helped your opponent previously.
- You present your case very well (determined by the GM).

Each of the following factors gives you −1 die:

- Your opponent has more people on their side.
- You ask for something valuable or dangerous.
- Your opponent has nothing to gain by helping you.
- You are having trouble understanding each other.
- You are talking via radio or shouting at a distance.

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TALENTS

TO SURVIVE AND THRIVE in the cold dark of space you need to find your own niche, something you and no one else can do. Such special abilities are called talents.

Talents can affect how you use skills or how you recover from damage or stress, or even let you do things that are quite simply impossible for others. Unlike skills, talents are not rated – you either have them or you don't.

There are two distinct types of talents – career talents and general talents. Career talents can only be learned by characters with a specific career. General talents can be learned by anyone. You can learn new talents during play (page 30).

Colonial Marine Talents

- **Banter:** The stress level of you and everyone in Short range drops two steps (instead of one) for every stretch of time spent in a safe place (page 73).
- **Overkill:** When you roll 9 or higher on a panic roll (page 72), you can ignore the result and instead go into overkill. All other PCs in the same zone must make an immediate panic roll. While in overkill, you must attack your enemies on every turn and you cannot take cover, dodge, or defend yourself against attacks. The effect stops when you or all enemies in sight are broken.
- **Precise Shooter:** When making a supply roll for ammo (page 66), you get to roll two dice fewer than your ammo supply rating, to a minimum of one die.

Colonial Marshal Talents

- **Authority:** You can use your **COMMAND** skill instead of **MANIPULATION** to get someone to bend to your will. You also get +2 dice to the roll.
- **Investigator:** You get +2 die to **OBSERVATION** rolls when actively searching for something hidden in a zone (page 57). This does not apply to passive **OBSERVATION** rolls.
- **Subdue:** When attempting to grapple an opponent in close combat (page 62), you get +2 dice. ▶

"Unfortunately, quotas have been raised to 20,400 hours, so you'll be released from contract in another five to six years. Thank you, and remember the company is really grateful for your ongoing service."

W-Y Officer



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Company Agent Talents

- **Company Resources:** Once per act in cinematic play or once per session in campaign play, you may gain +1 stress level to produce an item of your choice – you had it all along! It can be any item from chapter 5, or anything else the GM deems reasonable, but it cannot be larger than a regular item (weight 1). The item is not yours – the Company will want it back.
- **Cunning:** You can roll for **MANIPULATION** using Wits instead of Empathy.
- **Personal Safety:** If you are attacked and another PC or friendly NPC is within Short range, make a **MANIPULATION** roll (no action) to make the other character be targeted by the attack instead of you. Stress level +1 for each use.

Kid Talents

- **Hard to Catch:** You get +2 dice to **MOBILITY** when dodging an attack (page 65).
- **Lucky:** You get to re-roll any death roll or roll for a critical injury once (page 70). Choose the result you prefer.
- **Nimble:** You can push a skill roll using Agility twice. Stress level +1 for each push.

Medic Talents

- **Field Medic:** You get +2 dice when rolling for **MEDICAL AID** to give first aid (page 68).
- **Nurse:** When you tend to a character recovering from a critical injury (page 71), each day counts double. For each shift spent per day, you can tend to a number of patients equal to your **MEDICAL AID** skill level.
- **Surgeon:** You get +2 dice when rolling for **MEDICAL AID** to treat a critical injury that requires surgery (page 71).

Officer Talents

- **Field Commander:** You can use **COMMAND** to give orders in combat (page 60) as a quick action instead of a full action.
- **Frontline Leader:** You get +2 dice to **COMMAND** rolls to rally a broken character (page 68).
- **Pull Rank:** You can use your **COMMAND** skill to order other non-officer NPCs around, as long as they belong to the same organization as you. If successful, the target must follow your order, even if it means harm or danger to themselves. Stress level +1 for each use.

Pilot Talents

- **Full Throttle:** When piloting a spacecraft, you get +2 die to **PILOTING** rolls for accelerating or decelerating (page 143).
- **Like The Back Of Your Hand:** You get a +2 dice to all **PILOTING** rolls for one specific ship or vehicle model (see chapter 5). You can choose this talent several times, once per vehicle model.
- **Reckless:** You may take +1 stress level before making a skill roll, before pushing. You can push the roll normally, gaining another +1 stress level.

Roughneck Talents

- **Resilient:** Roll for Strength (attribute only) any time you suffer damage. You can't push the roll, which does not count as an action. For every ✦ you roll, one point of damage is eliminated.
- **Steady Hands:** You can, if you want to, skip rolling one or two stress dice in any skill roll. When rolling for stress or panic effects, use your full stress level.
- **True Grit:** You can push a skill roll based on Strength twice. Stress level +1 for each push.

Scientist Talents

- **Analysis:** You can roll for **OBSERVATION** to gain insight into alien artifacts or creatures that you examine for at least one stretch. For every ✦ you roll, you may ask the GM one of the following questions: Is it human or alien? Is it dead or alive? How old is it? What is its purpose? How does it work? What problems could it cause? The GM must answer truthfully, but is allowed to give vague or incomplete answers. A successful roll reduces the stress level of all other PCs within Short range 1 step, while a failed roll increases their stress levels by 1. Only one attempt is allowed per examined object.
- **Inquisitive:** You can push a skill roll based on Wits twice. Stress level +1 for each push.
- **Xenomorphology:** When facing an extraterrestrial creature of any kind, you may make an **OBSERVATION** roll (quick action). If successful, you realize a potential weakness of the creature, if it has any. If you fail, gain stress level +1. Only one attempt per Xenomorph is allowed.

"There's no bloody way I'm three months pregnant."
"Well, doctor, it's not exactly a traditional fetus."

Shaw and David

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General Talents

- **Bodyguard:** If someone in the same zone as you is hit by an attack, you can spend a quick action to dive in to take the hit instead.
- **Bonus Shares:** Gain +2 dice to **MANIPULATION** rolls when negotiating the payment for a job in campaign play (page 244).
- **Calm Breather:** When making a supply roll for air, you get to roll two dice fewer than your air supply rating (page 28), to a minimum of one die.
- **Combat Veteran:** In combat, you may keep your initiative card from the previous round instead of drawing a new one.
- **Counselor:** Once per stretch, you can use the **MANIPULATION** skill to reduce the stress level of another PC in the same zone. For each ✠ rolled, their stress level is reduced by one extra step (in addition to the default one step, see page 73). You cannot use this talent on yourself, nor recover stress in the same stretch as you use it.
- **EVA Specialist:** You get +2 to **HEAVY MACHINERY** and **MOBILITY** rolls when spacewalking.
- **Fast Reflexes:** When drawing initiative (page 59), draw two cards instead of one. Choose the one you want to use and shuffle the other back into the deck. If several characters have this talent, carry out this process one at a time in any order you prefer. PCs draw before NPCs.
- **Gunner:** You get a +2 dice to **RANGED COMBAT** rolls when firing vehicle-mounted weapons or spaceship armaments.
- **Hardened:** Your maximum Health score is increased by 1. You can choose this talent up to three times.
- **Haymaker:** You get +2 dice to a **CLOSE COMBAT** attack if you sacrifice your quick action for the round .
- **Martial Arts:** When you attack or defend unarmed in **CLOSE COMBAT,** you can use Agility instead of Strength. You can also make an unarmed attack as a quick action instead of a full action, but with –2 dice.
- **Last One Standing:** You can rally yourself when broken (page 68) by rolling for **STAMINA** yourself. Only one attempt can be made.
- **Machinegunner:** When firing a burst of fully automatic fire (page 67), your stress level does not increase.
- **Menacing:** When threatening someone to do what you want, roll Strength + **MANIPULATION** (instead of Empathy) and gain +2 dice.
- **Navigator:** Roll for **COMTECH** when plotting a new course for space travel (page 108). For each ✠ rolled, the duration of the trip is reduced by 10% (round off to the nearest whole number of days).
- **Pack Mule:** You can carry twice as many items as normal without being encumbered.
- **Quick Shot:** If an enemy makes a ranged attack against you, you may as a quick action (reaction) try to shoot them first. Take +1 stress level, then roll for both attacks simultaneously. The shot with the most ✠ goes off first. If both shots hit, the second shot is aborted if the shooter is broken. If both shots roll the same amount of ✠, both hit at the same time.
- **Rapid Fire:** You can fire a pistol (chapter 5) as a quick action instead of a full action, but with –2 dice.
- **Second Wind:** Anyone who tries to rally you (page 68) gets +2 dice to their **COMMAND** roll.
- **Seen It All:** Your Resolve score (page 26) is increased by 1. You can choose this talent up to three times.
- **Sensor Operator:** Gain +2 dice when rolling for **COMTECH** to operate ship sensors (page 143).
- **Spaceship Commander:** In the role as a captain of a spaceship during space combat (page 143), you get +2 dice to **COMMAND** rolls for initiative and giving orders.
- **Spaceship Mechanic:** Gain +2 dice when you use **HEAVY MACHINERY** or **COMTECH** to maintain or repair damage to a spacecraft (page 144).
- **Stealthy:** Others get –2 dice to **OBSERVATION** rolls when trying to spot you in stealth mode (page 56). In groups, the talent has no effect unless everyone in the group has the talent.
- **Stoic:** You can roll for **STAMINA** using Wits instead of Strength.
- **Survivor:** You get +2 dice to all death rolls (page 68).
- **Tech Savvy:** When making a supply roll for electric power, you get to roll two dice fewer than your power supply rating (page 29), to a minimum of one die.
- **Weapon Specialist:** You're an expert at using a specific weapon model – choose one from the weapon lists in chapter 5. When you use this weapon, you get +2 dice. You can choose this talent several times, once per weapon model. You can be a specialist at fighting unarmed.
- **Zero-G Training:** Your sense of balance is well adapted to an environment without gravity. You don't suffer any of the penalties to skill rolls in zero-G (page 76). ●

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)



CHAPTER 4

STEALTH & COMBAT

"You're all gonna die. Only question is how you check out.
Do you want it on your feet – or on your fuckin' knees... begging?"

Dillon

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

FIGHT OR FLIGHT? That's the big question, now, isn't it?

You may feel invincible tucked away behind your cozy character sheet, but your PC is out there on the line – and they are damn well mortal. Remember back in chapter 2 when we told you not to get your character killed? Consider this your second warning.

Often, it's a better bet to run away and fight another day – assuming you're fast enough to escape whatever thing is nipping at your heels. Often, it's best to just meld into the shadows and be all quiet-like. Before releasing the safety on your pulse rifle, always ask yourself – is it worth it?

Sometimes you have no choice. Sometimes that alien thing you thought was right behind you is already waiting for you in that dark corner you thought was safe.

Just coming face-to-face with an alien monstrosity can turn your mind to jelly. You may only have a split second before the beast dismembers you and crushes your skull.

And alien species aren't the only danger.

People on the Frontier are jerks. Sometimes, someone just sticks a gun in your face. When backed against a wall, you damn well better fight. When someone or something comes for you, you need to be able to defend yourself.

Here's how.

SPACE & TIME

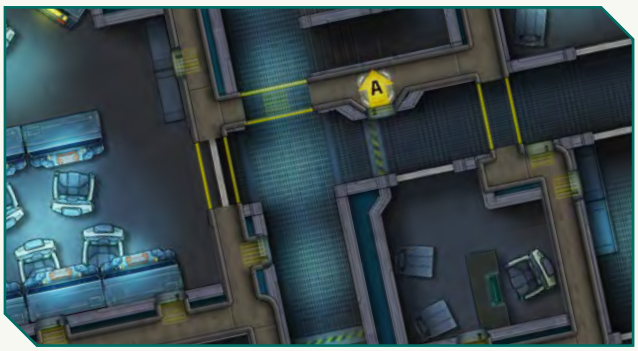
"Should be in and out in thirty minutes."

Tyler

Maps

A stealth scene or a fight in the ALIEN roleplaying game is typically played out using a map of the starship, colony, or whatever location your characters happen to find themselves fighting for their lives in.

Large, full-color maps of adventure locations are included in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set and cinematic adventures such as Rapture Protocol, but maps with less detail work as well, even quickly hand-drawn sketches by the GM are fine for more improvised play.





USING MINIATURES

For an even more visceral and tangible game experience, official miniatures for the ALIEN role-playing game are available separately. Together with the large, full-color maps included in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set and the Rapture Protocol cinematic adventure, the miniatures can even be used to play skirmish-style wargames. Rules for that are available in the miniatures set.

Tokens & Miniatures: To track movement on the map during stealth or combat, you can use the cardboard tokens in official ALIEN RPG releases like the Hope's Last Day Starter Set, miniatures such as those included in the ALIEN RPG Miniatures Set, digital tokens on your virtual tabletop, or anything else that works for your table.

Zones

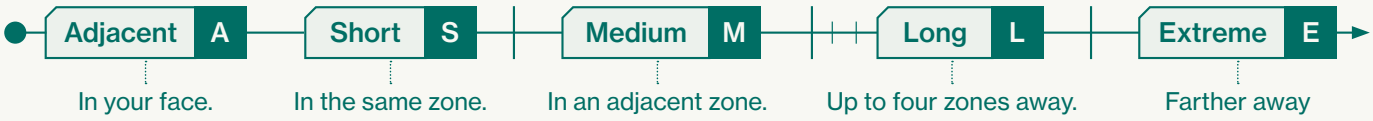
The map is divided into zones. A zone is typically a room, a corridor, or an area of ground. How big a zone is varies – from a few steps across up to about 25 meters. A zone is generally smaller in a cramped environment than in open terrain. In official adventures, zone borders are indicated on the location maps.

Cluttered/Open: A zone is either cluttered, meaning there are objects in the zone to hide or take cover in or behind, or open, meaning there are no such objects in the zone. Open zones are typically corridors and crawlspaces, but can also be empty rooms or other open spaces. If the adventure text does not indicate whether a zone is open or cluttered, the GM makes a judgment call.

PLAYING WITHOUT MAPS

Although maps can be useful, you can choose not to use them and let certain conflicts play out only in the "theater of the mind." In this case, the GM needs to determine lines of sight and the distances between combatants.

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Borders: A border between two adjacent zones is either open or blocked (by a wall or bulkhead). A blocked border can have a door or a hatch, as indicated by the map, allowing movement between the two zones. Corridors and crawlspaces are divided into several zones by doors or lines on the map.

Line Of Sight: Except for characters who are hiding or in full cover, everyone in the same zone has line of sight to each other. This does not apply to narrow crawlspaces like air shafts – there, other characters block line of sight (even friendlies). Open zone borders don't block line of sight. A blocked border generally blocks line of sight even if there is a door or hatch in it – unless you're actively standing by the doorway and peeking through.

Range

The distance between combatants is divided into five range categories. See the diagram above.

Measuring Time

In the ALIEN universe, time matters. Whether you are awaiting rescue on an alien world with Xenomorphs stalking you, or Mother is counting down to the imminent destruction of your ship, you need to keep track of time.

Three separate units of time are typically used in the game, depending on the situation at hand. See the table below. The exact duration of a round, stretch and shift can vary depending on the situation. ●

UNIT	DURATION	PRIMARY USE
Round	5–10 **seconds**	Combat
Stretch	5–10 **minutes**	Stealth
Shift	5–10 **hours**	Repairs

Countdowns

During a countdown to some catastrophic event, time can be treated as a consumable (page 28). The GM or the adventure text sets the timer to a certain number of minutes. After each combat round, a supply roll is made. For each rolled, the number of minutes remaining is reduced by one.

STEALTH MODE

"If you don't stay quiet, we all die."

Andy

IN THE ALIEN ROLEPLAYING GAME, much of the thrill happens before the enemy shows itself and bullets start flying. A key part of the experience is exploring unknown locations, with enemies lurking in the darkness. In the game, this is represented by what we call stealth mode. Stealth mode is played out in stretches of time, each approximately 5–10 minutes long.

PC Movement

Movement in stealth mode is slow and careful. In one stretch of time, your character can move into an adjacent zone on the map (assuming the border is open or has an open door or hatch), scan for enemies, and get a superficial description of the zone from the GM. If you're a team, you can move individually or as a group. The order in which PCs move is chosen freely.

Searching A Zone: If you want to examine something in a zone more closely, to search a room or access a data terminal, you may need to stay several stretches in the zone (or even a full shift), if the adventure text or the GM calls for it.

NPC Movement

In stealth mode, NPC movement is managed secretly by the GM each stretch, after your PCs have moved. Human NPCs follow the same rules for movement as PCs, while Xenomorphs may move one zone per point of Speed (page 208) each stretch. The order of NPC movement is chosen by the GM.

Active & Passive: An adventure text may tell the GM that enemies are active or passive. Active enemies are moving across the map, stalking you or trying to hide from you. Passive enemies are not aware of you and are most often stationary, until they spot you or are otherwise alerted to your presence. Enemies may switch from passive to active, or vice versa, as dictated by the adventure or the GM. ▶

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Stealth Sequence

1 **PCs move one zone.** If they come within line of sight of an NPC, make a passive open opposed **OBSERVATION** roll. For a group, the highest roll counts.

If one side wins, they can:

- Reveal themselves
- Ambush the enemy.
- Hide in the zone.
- Back out the way they came.

If it's a tie, draw initiative.

2 **NPCs move one zone** on the GM's hidden map. Xenomorphs move one zone per point of Speed. If they come within line of sight of a PC, make a passive open opposed **OBSERVATION** roll as above.

3 **A new stretch begins.** The PCs act first, then the NPCs, as per steps #1 and #2 above.

Simplified Stealth Mode

Managing NPC movement secretly by the GM in stealth mode is a great way to create real tension at the table, a true game of cat and mouse – or rather, a game of human and terrifying Xenomorph! However, it does require some table space (or virtual tabletop support) and might not always be feasible. In such cases, the system can be simplified to only have the PCs move according to the stealth mode rules, while NPCs (and motion tracker pings) simply appear when and where the GM so chooses.

Hidden Map: To manage NPC movement, we recommend that the GM has a second copy of the map, hidden from view by the GM Screen. On this map, the GM can place tokens to represent NPCs, hidden from the players' view. GM maps for this purpose are included in official adventures. If the GM doesn't have access to a screen, they can track hidden NPC movement on a piece of paper.

Crawlspaces

Air shafts and other crawlspaces are a common feature in ALIEN adventures and present a unique challenge in stealth mode. Crawlspaces can run by the side of rooms and corridors, above them or underneath them (in which case just the outline is shown on official adventure maps).

Access Points: A crawlspace can be entered by one zone's worth of movement at any access point marked on the map, just like entering any other zone.

Sealing Access Points: An access point can typically be sealed shut with a cutting torch by making a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll (full action, one attempt per stretch is allowed). Not even Xenomorphs can break through a sealed access point, but acid blood will burn through a crawlspace floor in one stretch (if there is gravity), creating a new access point if the duct is above a room.

Open Zones: Zones in crawlspaces are generally considered open, meaning it's not possible to hide there (or take cover in combat, see page 66).

Detection

When you come within line of sight of an NPC in stealth mode, or vice versa, make a passive open opposed **OBSERVATION** roll. This means the roll cannot be pushed, nor trigger stress responses (page 44). The GM will just ask you to roll **OBSERVATION** without telling you why, and roll for the NPC.

If one side wins the roll, they spot the other first and can choose to declare their presence, ambush their opponent (page 59), hide in the zone (next page), or back out of the zone the same way they entered. Backing out of the zone in this situation is done immediately and does not count toward the normal movement in this stretch.

On a tied roll, you spot each other at the same time – draw initiative (page 59).

Keeping Guard: If a person remains stationary in a zone for a stretch and does nothing except keeping guard, they gain +2 dice to **OBSERVATION** rolls to spot anything coming within line of sight.

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Groups In Stealth Mode

When several characters moving as a group come into line of sight of another character (or group), all characters in each group get to roll **OBSERVATION**. Only the best roll on each side counts. For a group of NPCs with identical stats, the GM will typically make just a single **OBSERVATION** roll and apply the result to the whole group, to keep things simple.

Hiding

A character can hide in a cluttered zone (but not in an open zone). To hide carefully takes one stretch, and thus cannot be combined with movement or searching the zone – except immediately after a (won) **OBSERVATION** roll when coming within line of sight of an enemy (see Detection, above). In this specific case only, hiding is "free." Items can also be hidden in a zone.

Finding What's Hidden: When an enemy enters a zone with a hidden character, no opposed **OBSERVATION** roll is made. Instead, the enemy must actively search the zone for a stretch and make an **OBSERVATION** roll. If the roll fails, another roll can be made each stretch. Typically, an NPC will only search a zone for one stretch before moving on. If a hidden character is found, draw initiative. ▶

DARKNESS

In dark zones with very dim lightning, **OBSERVATION** rolls for humans (and androids) are made with –2 dice. Xenomorphs are not affected. A flashlight will remove the effects of darkness in a zone.

Michael Syrett (Order: 5315103)

Multiple Searchers: If several characters search a zone at the same time, they can make separate rolls or let one character roll, and the others help (page 43).

Multiple Hidden Things: If there are several hidden characters and/or items in a zone, each ✦ rolled on the **OBSERVATION** roll(s) will reveal one of them. The order in which they are found is up to the GM.

Taking Action: A hidden character may, at their turn in the stretch, take action to move out of the zone, interact with something in the zone, or ambush an enemy. In all such cases, make an opposed **OBSERVATION** roll against all enemies in line of sight.

Motion Trackers

A motion tracker, such as the M314 unit (page 96), can be used once per stretch. This does not exclude other activities during the stretch, but before the tracker gives any information a power supply roll must be made (page 29).

If still powered up, the motion tracker will automatically detect the presence of all NPCs within its range (four zones for an M314), even if not within line of sight – but only NPCs who moved in the previous stretch. NPCs who remained stationary in the previous stretch are not detected.

EXAMPLE — STEALTH MODE

Nat and Hayes are checking out the abnormal engine readings on the USCSS Miranda while carefully looking for the unknown killer on board, moving zone by zone in stealth mode. The GM moves the killer on her hidden GM map. It is currently stationary in the engine control room.

After a few stretches, Nat and Hayes split up as the medic wants to look for a surgical kit. On her turn, Nat moves very carefully into the engine control room, where a horrifying Xenomorph lurks. A passive opposed OBSERVATION roll is made, and Nat wins! She takes a chance and decides to hide in the zone, under a control console.

Now, as Nat is hidden and the Xenomorph is not actively looking for her, it does not get to roll OBSERVATION again until Nat moves out of hiding. The GM decides that the Xenomorph moves on its next turn, quickly jumping into an air shaft. Nat is free to come out of hiding to check the engine controls.

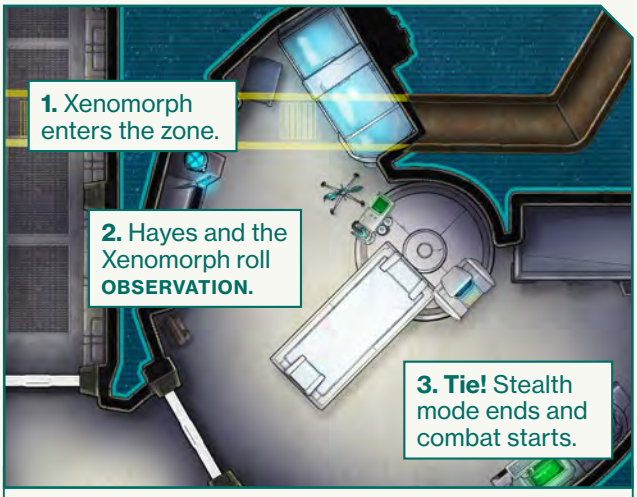
Tracker Pings: Mark the "pings" of movement from a motion tracker by placing tokens on the map. Such tokens are included in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set. Detecting an NPC with a motion tracker does not mean that the PC has spotted it – it only means the players get an indication of where an NPC is present.

Starting A Fight

When a PC spots an NPC or vice versa, stealth mode ends, and initiative is drawn (next page). Draw initiative even if the NPC is not obviously hostile – forcing PCs who act first to decide whether to attack or hold off. Also note that PCs can exchange initiatives with NPCs or each other on their turn (see Holding Off on the next page). Combat can also be initiated by an ambush (next page).

Social Mode

When you stop to interact socially with NPCs, or just stop to relieve stress (page 73) or chat among each other, stealth mode stops. During social mode, the GM estimates how many stretches pass and moves NPCs on the hidden stealth map accordingly. Social mode can also be used when you perform a task that takes more than a stretch to complete. When you start moving around on the map again, stealth mode starts anew. ●



EXAMPLE — END OF STEALTH

Hayes is in the Medbay when the Xenomorph enters the zone via an air duct access point. The GM tells Hayes to roll OBSERVATION but not why, and rolls for the Xeno herself. The opposed roll is a tie, and they spot each other at the same time! Stealth mode ends and combat starts.

COMBAT & INITIATIVE

WHEN THE ENEMY IS REVEALED, stealth mode is over, and combat starts. Combat is played out in rounds, each approximately 5–10 seconds long. At the start of each round, the first step is to decide who has the initiative – in what order the combatants will act during the round.

Drawing The Initiative

To determine the initiative, ten cards numbered 1 to 10 are used. Such initiative cards are included in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set, but you can also use ordinary playing cards. Each player in the fight draws a random card at the beginning of each round, and the GM draws cards for NPCs.

The number on the card determines the order in which you act in the round. Card #1 acts first, card #2 acts second, and so forth until everyone has acted. Your place in the initiative order is called your turn. Your "previous turn" or "your next turn" can occur in the current round or the previous/next round, depending on if you've had your turn in the current round yet.

Place your initiative card by your character sheet so everyone can see the order in which each person acts. The GM puts their card (or cards) in front of them. When all participants have had their turn, the round is over, and a new round begins by drawing the initiative again.

Xenomorphs have a Speed rating and get one turn – and initiative card – per point of Speed. Read more on page 208.

NPC Initiative

To make things simple, particularly in large fights, the GM can draw a single initiative card for a group of NPCs. All NPCs in that group act on the same turn in the round. The order among them is decided by the GM. When a PC holds off to swap initiative cards, they swap initiative with the whole NPC group.

TOO MANY DRAWS?

Combat in the ALIEN RPG is fast and deadly, and rarely lasts longer than 3–5 rounds. Drawing initiative every round gives a more dynamic flow of play, but should you find it cumbersome, you can draw initiative only in the first round of combat. Holding off and swapping initiative cards can still be done.

Surprise & Ambush

If combat starts with an attack that the GM deems to be surprising, the attacker automatically gets the #1 initiative card in the first round of combat. The other combatants draw their initiative from the cards that remain. With several attackers, they get the lowest (earliest) cards to distribute freely. At the start of the second round, everyone draws the initiative as usual.

Ambush: A special type of surprise attack is an ambush, which is an attack on an unaware opponent. Ambushes are usually the result of stealth mode (page 56). An ambush also gives the lowest (earliest) initiative card to the attacker(s), and gives +2 dice to the initial attack(s), and the target(s) cannot defend against it or dodge it.

Holding Off

At your turn in the round, you can choose to hold off. This means that you swap initiative cards – and therefore places in the turn order – with another PC or NPC (or NPC group) whose turn comes after yours. They cannot refuse the trade and must take their turn immediately. You cannot swap initiative cards with someone who has already had their turn.

Note: All rules effects that are triggered "on your turn" (such as death rolls, see page 68) are moved in the turn order when initiative cards are swapped. Your turn doesn't happen until you use it.

⚠ **Interrupt Actions:** Quick actions that occur out of turn (such as defending or dodging) are not affected by holding off – spent quick actions still count as spent, even if you get a new initiative number. Even if you have spent two quick actions as interrupt actions earlier in the round, and thus don't get any action on your turn, you can still hold off and swap cards when your turn comes – this can be useful to give another PC an earlier spot in the turn order.

Xenomorphs (page 208) with a Speed of 2 or more have multiple turns in a single round, and therefore draw multiple initiative cards. When swapping cards with a Xenomorph, you decide which card you want, as long as it comes after your current turn in the initiative order. Xenomorphs themselves rarely hold off, but can if the adventure text or GM says so. ●

"LET'S ROCK!"

Pvt. Vasquez

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ACTION & MOVEMENT

Full Actions & Quick Actions

Each round, you can perform one full action and one quick action, or two quick actions.

Full Action + Quick Action *or* Quick Action + Quick Action

Full Action: This is typically an attack but can be anything you could reasonably do in less than 10 seconds that requires your full focus. It typically requires a skill roll. See the adjacent list for examples. A full action can only be performed on your turn in the round.

Quick Action: These are faster and don't necessarily demand a skill roll (though some do). Quick actions include movement. See the adjacent list for examples. Some quick actions can be performed out of turn, to interrupt the actions of opponents. On your turn, you can save your quick action for an interrupt action to use later in the round. If you perform two quick actions in the same round, you forfeit your full action.

Action Reset: All actions are reset at the start of a new combat round. Actions can never be saved from one round to the next.

Giving Orders

As a full action, you can bark orders to another character. They must be able to hear you, even if via a comm radio. Roll for **COMMAND**. For every ✦ you roll, they get +1 die to one roll later in the same round, but only for carrying out the order you gave.

MARK YOUR ACTIONS

To keep track of your actions in the round, a tip is to keep your initiative face-up and vertical at the start of the round. Turn it horizontally when you perform a quick action. Flip the card over when you perform a full action or your second quick action. When the card is both rotated and flipped, you're done for the round!

Full Actions

FULL ACTION	SKILL USED
Attack in close combat	**CLOSE COMBAT**
Make a ranged attack	**RANGED COMBAT**
Jump or climb	**MOBILITY**
Take full cover	–
Interact with a terminal	**COMTECH**
Use machinery	**HEAVY MACHINERY**
Give first aid	**MEDICAL AID**
Clearing a jammed weapon	**HEAVY MACHINERY**
Persuade someone	**MANIPULATION**
Give orders	**COMMAND**
Drive a vehicle	**PILOTING**

QUICK ACTIONS

- Move into an adjacent zone
- Move between Short and Adjacent range
- Move to a door or hatch and peek through
- Lock a door or hatch
- Take partial cover
- ⚠ Defend against a close combat attack
- Aim a ranged attack
- ⚠ Dodge a ranged attack
- Reload a weapon
- Pick up an item from the ground
- Rally a broken character

EXAMPLE INITIATIVE

Hayes faces the horrifying Xenomorph in the medbay, luckily drawing the #2 initiative card. As the Xenomorph has Speed 2, the GM draws two cards for it, getting the #5 and the #7. Nat over at engine controls is not aware of what is happening and thus does not draw a card.

Hayes could hold off to let the Xenomorph make the first move but decides to keep his #2 card and act immediately. He spends his quick action running to a nearby comms terminal, and his full action to use it to scream for help, hoping Nat will hear him and get there in time. Now it's the Xenomorph's turn ...

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"Is this gonna be a standup fight, sir, or another bug hunt?"

Private William Hudson

Foot Movement

To move during combat, you can spend a quick action to go from one zone to an adjacent zone, to move up to a door or hatch to peek through it (or take cover by it), or to move between Short and Adjacent range from a character (or item) inside your current zone.

Doors & Hatches: You can pass an unlocked door or hatch during movement without spending an action. Locking a door or hatch is typically a quick action. A locked door or hatch can be broken down. This requires a close combat attack (full action) with +2 dice. A typical metal door or hatch has armor level 2 and can take 10 points of damage before it gives in. Electronically locked doors or hatches can be opened with a **COMTECH** roll (full action).

Blocking Movement: You can, as long as you're not broken (page 68), block another character from moving past you. As a rule of thumb, you can block a cylindrical volume 2 meters wide and equally tall. To pass you, your opponent must either take you out or make a special close combat action (page 62). Blocking is not mandatory – you can allow friendly characters to pass you.

Crawlspaces: In a narrow crawlspace such as an air shaft, you cannot move past other characters in the same zone – not even friendlies.

Xenomorphs often prefer to move through air shafts and other crawlspaces, but can move through rooms and corridors just like human characters, including opening unlocked doors.

Dragging A Person: You can drag a broken or otherwise immobilized person with you when you move. The person needs to be at Adjacent range, and you need to make a **STAMINA** roll. If you fail, you remain in the zone.

Leaving Combat

You can attempt to leave a combat before it's over by moving out of sight of your opponents. If you do, and it's not obvious where you went (GM's call), your opponents must roll for **OBSERVATION** (no action) to understand where you went. If it fails, combat is over, and stealth mode commences again (unless other PCs remain in combat). ●

Tokens & Miniatures

If you are using official ALIEN RPG tokens or miniatures on a map that is to scale, mark Adjacent range by placing the tokens or miniature bases in contact. If there is no way to move into a zone without placing the tokens or miniatures in contact, the range between them is immediately Adjacent (not Short), without a further move action needed.

You can move into a narrow area on the map (such as a crawlspace) even if your token or miniature base is wider than the space you're in. However, if the tokens /miniatures of other characters make it impossible to place at least half of your token / base inside a zone (GM's call), you cannot move into it. Broken characters don't count.

You can block movement in an area covered by the token or the base of the miniature. Several characters can be placed in base-to-base contact to block wider areas.

HIDDEN MOVEMENT IN COMBAT

In combat, movement is usually open for all to see. However, in some situations, the GM may choose to keep NPC movement hidden in combat, using a hidden GM map just like in stealth mode. All other normal movement rules for combat apply.

EXAMPLE HOLDING OFF

In the next round, Nat is aware of the Xenomorph and gets to draw initiative. Sadly, she gets the #9 card. The Xenomorph draws the #3 and #8, while Hayes – terrified and wounded but still alive – draws the #1 card. Hayes decides to hold off and swaps his card with Nat, allowing her to go first. She spends both her quick and her full action to move, running the two zones over to reach the medbay, just in time to face the Xenomorph.

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CLOSE COMBAT

CLOSE COMBAT is any attack at Adjacent range, no matter what weapon is used (if any). This is a full action. Roll for **CLOSE COMBAT** to hit. Close combat weapons can give a modifier to your roll (see chapter 5).

Hit: If the attack succeeds, it inflicts the weapon's base damage on the target, plus 1 damage point for every ✦ rolled beyond the first. Damage may be reduced by body armor (page 67). Unarmed attacks have a base damage of 1.

Weak Spot: Against an armored target, you can aim for a weak spot, getting –2 dice. On a hit, the armor level is reduced 1 step (after reduction for an armor piercing attack).

Defend

If you are attacked in close combat, you can choose to defend yourself against the attack, to avoid being hit. Defending is a quick action, and you roll for **CLOSE COMBAT.** You must state that you defend before the attacker rolls for their strike. Defending turns the attack into an opposed roll (page 44) – for each ✦ you roll when defending, you eliminate one ✦ rolled by the attacker.

⚠ **Interruption:** Defending is an interrupt action and occurs out of turn. It does require a quick action however – if you have no actions left in the round, you cannot defend. If you fear you will be attacked later in a round, it might be wise to save a quick action for a possible defense.

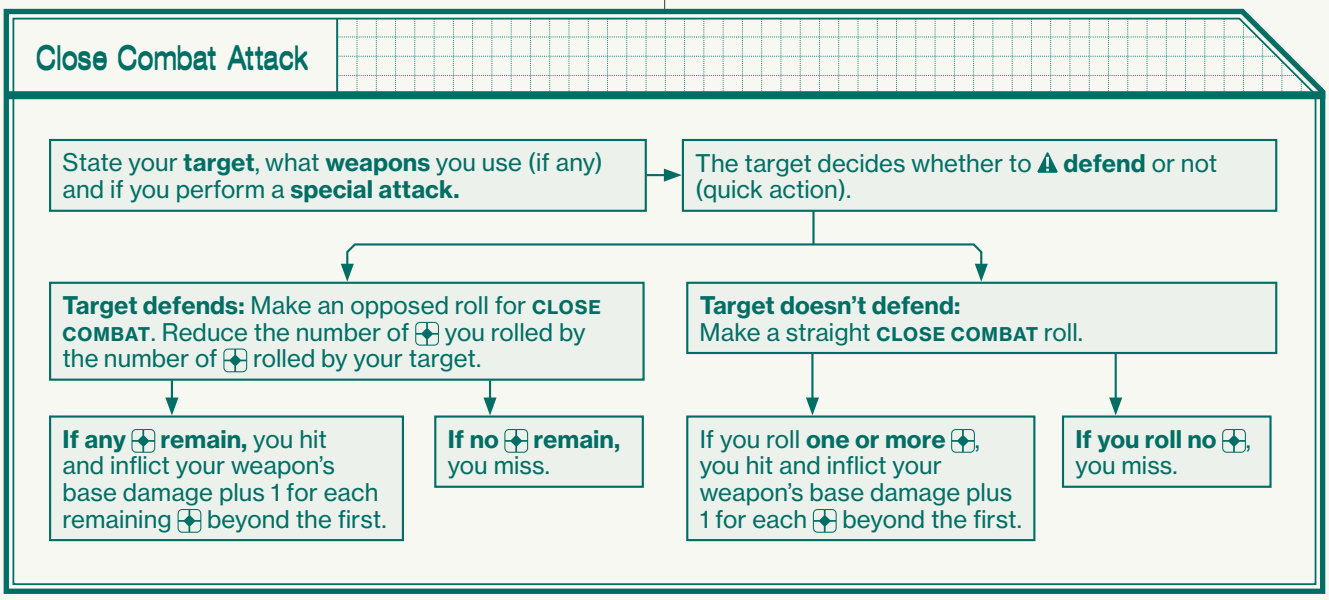
Special Attacks

In close combat, you may want to achieve something other than just harming your opponent. You must state that you are attempting a special attack before rolling dice, and you cannot use any bonus dice from a weapon. Special attacks can be defended against just like normal attacks. If the attack succeeds, you inflict no damage but instead achieve the desired result:

- **Disarm:** You wrestle an item from your opponent's grasp. You can keep the item or throw it into an adjacent zone as part of the attack.
- **Pass:** You move past an enemy blocking your movement (page 61). If successful, place your token or miniature on the other side of the enemy.
- **Shove:** You push your opponent to Short range from you. This attack can be used to shove your target through a door or hatch.
- **Grapple:** You pin your enemy in a tight clinch. See Grappling below.

Grappling

If you grapple your opponent as a special attack in close combat, they cannot move or perform any actions except trying to break free. This is a full action and an opposed **CLOSE COMBAT** roll against you (Xenomorphs use **MOBILITY** instead). While you are grappling, the only action you can perform (until you choose to release your opponent) is a grapple attack. This works as a normal unarmed attack but cannot be defended against. ▶





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Restrained & Unaware Opponents

If your close combat opponent is restrained or unaware of you (see Surprise & Ambush on page 59), they cannot defend themselves against the attack and you get +2 dice to the roll .

Firearms In Close Combat

Note that you can use a firearm even in close combat. You still use the **CLOSE COMBAT** skill (not **RANGED COMBAT**) to hit. As most firearms have a minimum range of Short (or more), you typically get –2 dice or more when using them in close combat. Your target can defend against the attack normally. ●

EXAMPLE CLOSE COMBAT

The Xenomorph attacks Hayes again in close combat, rolling a whopping ten base dice and getting two ✦. Hayes tries to defend himself against the attack. With Strength 3 and no skill level in CLOSE COMBAT, he only rolls three base dice, but with stress level 3 he also gets to add three stress dice. He gets a single ✦ and luckily, no .

Knowing a single hit from the Xenomorph will likely end him, Hayes decides to push the roll, increasing his stress level to 4 and adding another stress die to his pool. The re-roll produces another ✦, meaning Hayes just barely manages to hold off the ferocious attack.

However, the re-roll also produces a , triggering a stress response. He rolls a D6 getting 6, adding his stress level of 4 and subtracting his Resolve of 5, meaning he's really frantic, getting –2 on all skill rolls based on Strength.

RANGED COMBAT

WHEN YOU ATTACK SOMEONE at Short distance or more, roll for **RANGED COMBAT**. You need to have line of sight to your target (page 55). You also need a ranged weapon, even if just something to throw. The weapons tables in chapter 5 describe a variety of firearms and other ranged weapons. Most ranged weapons give a modifier to your roll. Firing a weapon is a full action.



Hit: If the attack succeeds, it inflicts the weapon's base damage on the target, plus 1 damage point for every ✦ rolled beyond the first (unless the extra ✦ are spent to conserve ammo, see below). Damage may be reduced by armor (page 67).

Aiming: If you take your time to aim carefully before squeezing the trigger, you get +2 dice to your roll. Aiming is a quick action and can only be done at Short range or more. The aim must happen on your turn, immediately before the attack. This means you cannot do anything else in the same round.

Range: Weapons have a minimum and maximum range. Any attack closer than the minimum range gets –2 dice per range band below the minimum range. This does not apply to attacks against unaware or restrained targets. A weapon cannot be used beyond its maximum range – with the exception that you can fire a weapon with Short maximum range into an adjacent zone if you're standing right next to a door or hatch to that zone.

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Weak Spot: Against an armored target, you can aim for a weak spot, getting –2 dice. On a hit, the armor level is reduced 1 step (after reduction for an armor piercing attack).

Ranged Attack Modifiers

FACTOR	MODIFIER
Careful aim	+2
Below minimum range	–2/band
Target in partial cover	–2
Target in full cover	–3
Aim for weak spot	–2
Large target	+2
Small target	–2

Target Size: Firing at a large target, such as a vehicle, gives +2 dice. Firing at a small object, such as a terminal screen, a hand-held item, or a Chestburster, gives –2 dice.

Dodging

If you are attacked in ranged combat, you can try to dodge the attack. This is a quick action, and you roll for **MOBILITY**. You can only dodge if you are aware of the attacker, and you must declare a dodge before the attacker rolls. Dodging turns the attack into an opposed roll (page 44) – for each ✦ you roll when dodging, you eliminate one ✦ rolled by the attacker.

⚠ **Interruption:** Dodging is an interrupt action and occurs out of turn. It does require a quick action however – if you have no actions left in the round, you cannot dodge. If you fear you will be attacked later in a round, it might be wise to save a quick action for a possible dodge. ▶

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Cover

When bullets start flying, you'll do well to seek cover. It's also very effective against explosions (page 76). You can only take cover in a cluttered zone, never in an open zone – except by a door or hatch, which gives you cover against enemies in the adjacent zone. There are two types of cover – partial and full.

Partial Cover: Taking partial cover is a quick action. You expose enough of yourself to be able to see, and shoot at, your enemy. When in partial cover, any ranged attack against you gets –2 dice. You can dodge (above) when in partial cover.

Full Cover: Completely hiding yourself from view is a full action. Full cover breaks line of sight. Ranged attacks are still possible but get –3 dice and the attacks must penetrate the barrier (page 68). You cannot dodge when in full cover.

Direction Of Cover: For the sake of simplicity, you don't need to consider the direction of your cover, it's assumed to protect you from all sides. The GM may overrule this however, if the situation warrants it.

Friendly Fire

If you fire at a target Adjacent to another character and miss, you risk hitting the unintended target instead. Roll for an attack with two base dice, inflicting base damage if one ✦ is rolled and 1 additional damage on two ✦. If there are several Adjacent targets, randomize which one is hit.



THE SUPPLY DIAL

The supply dial included in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set can be used to track ammo. Even when using the dial, you still need to track reloads on the character sheet. In Ammo column, there is space to mark both maximum ammo and current ammo for the weapon.

Ammunition

Ranged weapons require ammunition. You don't need to count individual bullets. Instead, the ammo capacity of each weapon in chapter 5 works as a supply rating (page 29). After each attack, make a supply roll for your weapon. When the ammo supply runs out, you need to reload.

Ranged Combat Attack

State your **target**, what **weapons** you use. → The target decides whether to ⚠ **dodge** or not (quick action).

Target dodges: Make an opposed roll for **RANGED COMBAT** vs **MOBILITY**. Reduce the number of ✦ you rolled by the number of ✦ rolled by your target.

- **If any ✦ remain,** you hit and inflict your weapon's base damage plus 1 for each remaining ✦ beyond the first – or spend an extra ✦ to conserve ammo.
- **If no ✦ remain,** you miss.

Target doesn't dodge: Make a straight **RANGED COMBAT** roll.

- If you roll **one or more ✦,** you hit and inflict your weapon's base damage plus 1 for each ✦ beyond the first – or spend an extra ✦ to conserve ammo.
- **If you roll no ✦,** you miss.

Make an ammo supply roll, unless an extra ✦ in the attack roll was used to conserve ammo instead of increasing damage.

Conserving Ammo: If you roll more than one ✠ for an attack, you can spend one ✠ to conserve ammo instead of increasing the damage, meaning no supply roll needs to be made after the attack. You cannot use this rule to fire a weapon with zero ammo left.

Reload: Reloading a firearm is a quick action, unless stated otherwise. You need to track your available reloads on your character sheet.

Single-Shot: Weapons designated as single-shot must be reloaded after each shot – no supply roll is made. You cannot use extra ✠ to conserve ammo for these.

NPCs: For NPCs, the GM typically doesn't make ammo supply rolls. Instead, their ammo capacity is reduced by one step after each attack, unless they spend an extra ✠ to conserve ammo. The GM can overrule this at any time it is dramatically appropriate.

Full Auto

Some weapons in chapter 5 can fire bursts of bullets. When you fire a burst and hit without pushing the roll, you can immediately make another attack roll, at the same target or another, as part of the same action. If you hit again (without pushing), you may roll a third time. As soon as you miss, or push a roll, the attack is over. Each attack roll except the first gives you stress level +1. You cannot make more than three attack rolls in a single action.

Ammo: When firing a burst, you must make an ammo supply roll after each attack roll. You cannot use extra ✠ rolled in the attack roll to conserve ammo.

Aiming: If you aim carefully (page 64), the bonus will only apply to the first attack roll. ●

EXAMPLE RANGED COMBAT

Nat, at Short range from the Xenomorph, raises her Rexim RXF-M5 EVA Pistol at the Xenomorph, using her quick action to aim carefully and her full action to fire. With no skill level in RANGED COMBAT, she needs all the bonuses she can get. She rolls six base dice (three for her Agility 3, +1 for her Rexim, and +2 for aiming) and two stress dice (her current stress level is 2), getting two ✠. Nat could use the extra ✠ to conserve ammo but decides to maximize the damage. The Rexim has a base damage rating of 1, meaning the shot hits for 2 points of damage.

DAMAGE

IN COMBAT, you run the risk of being injured. Everything from exhaustion to bleeding cuts and broken bones is summarized as damage. How much damage you can take before being broken is determined by your Health score. Your starting Health score is equal to the average of your Strength and Agility scores, rounded up. The Hardened talent can increase your maximum Health.

Armor

To protect yourself from harm, you can wear body armor (chapter 5). Xenomorphs often have natural body armor, and vehicles can also provide protection. The effectiveness of armor is represented by its armor level. You can only wear one suit of armor at a time.

When you take damage from an external attack, the damage caused is reduced by the armor level.

Armor Piercing: Against attacks designated as armor piercing, the armor level counts as 1 step lower than its normal value (to a minimum of zero).

Weak Spots: Attacks in both close and ranged combat can be aimed at weak spots in the armor. This gives the attack a –2 modifier, but on a hit, the armor level is reduced 1 step (in addition to any reduction for an armor piercing attack). ▶

NO WEAPONS OF ANY KIND

You want to be careful where you point that thing in space. Firefights onboard spacecraft, space stations, and within pressure domes can be disastrous – a stray bullet can rupture the hull and vent an entire living sector into space (page 75). People have been blown out into space through the tiniest of tears in the hull – a gruesome way to go, for sure.

Because of this, weapons are limited on spacecraft. Most military smart guns won't fire when turned on a target along the outer hull of a safe-sensor equipped ship. Civilian weapons aren't quite so clever. Your best bet is to keep 'em holstered until you've exhausted all other options. Then hold on to something tight and make for an airlock.

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Barriers

Barriers such as spaceship bulkheads also have armor levels – see the adjacent table for examples. When a ranged attack hits a barrier, the damage is reduced by the armor level. If the damage is reduced to zero, the attack does not breach the barrier.

Breach Limit: For barriers (and vehicles, see page 79), if the armor level is higher than the base damage rating of the weapon (not just equal), after any modifiers for ammunition and weak spots, the attack cannot breach the armor, no matter how many ✦ are rolled.

Cover: Note that partial cover (page 66) does not provide an armor level – only full cover will do that. If you are in full cover behind a barrier and wear body armor, first apply the effect of the cover, then the armor.

Collateral Damage: In some zones, such as next to an outer bulkhead of a spaceship or a nuclear reactor, a stray bullet can trigger catastrophic effects. In such locations, the GM rolls one stress die each time a ranged attack that could potentially breach the relevant barrier (i.e. base damage ≥ modified armor level) misses its target. On a ☣, the barrier is breached.

Broken

If you drop to zero Health, you are broken – in effect, taken out of the action. Immediately roll for a critical injury (page 70). If you're not dead, you can make a single move action per round and mumble through the pain, but not perform any other actions. You can't go below zero Health, but any further damage gives you another critical injury. While broken, you cannot gain more stress and never make panic rolls. There are three ways to get back up after being broken, assuming you're not dead:

- **First Aid:** Someone at Adjacent range can administer first aid with a **MEDICAL AID** roll (full action, modified for medical gear). On a success, you are no longer broken and recover 1 point of Health per ✦ rolled. If you suffer from a lethal critical injury, you are also stabilized (below).
- **Rally:** Another character in the same zone can try to rally you with a **COMMAND** roll (quick action). On a success, you are no longer broken and recover 1 point of Health per ✦ rolled. Rallying has no effect on critical injuries.
- **On Your Own:** If you're broken (but not dead) and no one gives you first aid, you automatically get back up after one stretch of time and recover 1 point of Health. This has no effect on critical injuries.

Typical Barriers

BARRIER	ARMOR LEVEL
Furniture	1
Inner Bulkhead	2
Outer Bulkhead	3
Armored Bulkhead	4+

CONDENSED CRITS

The Hadley's Hope Starter Set includes a condensed list of critical injuries. If you have access to this and prefer a more streamlined experience, you can use it even when playing the full game.

Recovery: As long as you are not fatigued (page 75), you automatically recover 1 point of Health per stretch of time spent resting in a safe area (even if suffering from a critical injury). First aid and rallying can only recover Health when you are broken.

Critical Injuries

As long as you still have Health left, damage points represent fatigue, bruises or smaller cuts – painful, to be sure, but possible to overcome. Critical injuries represent a much more dangerous form of injury. These can maim or kill you. When knocked down to zero Health, roll a D66 on the table on page 70. If you roll a critical injury you already have (result #14 and above), re-roll.

Death: If you suffer a critical injury listed as lethal, you must make a death roll after the listed time limit has passed. If the time limit is round, roll on your every turn, right after you act. A death roll is a roll for **STAMINA** (not an action), but you cannot push it, and you are not allowed to roll any stress dice. If you fail a death roll, you die. If you succeed, you linger on, but you must make another death roll when the time limit has passed again. ▶

"Come on! That's all you've got?
Is that all that you bite, motherfucker?"

Dillon

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BROKEN NPCS

NPCs can be broken in the same ways as PCs. An NPC can rally or give first aid to a PC and vice versa. However, dice are usually not rolled when an NPC aids another NPC – instead, the GM decides what happens. The GM can also decide that a minor NPC who is broken simply dies.

HANDLING DEATH

The death of a PC can be traumatic but try not to see it as a failure. Instead, consider it a dramatic peak in your story and then get back into the action as soon as possible. In cinematic adventures, character deaths are quite common – and can be very memorable events in the story.

EXAMPLE CHARACTER DEATH

The Xenomorph, ignoring Nat, strikes Hayes again. This time, he fails to defend himself and goes to zero Health, broken. He rolls for a critical injury and gets 62 – a massive hemorrhage!

Nat tries to give Hayes first aid to stop the bleeding with a MEDICAL AID roll but fails. Desperate, she then uses her quick action for a COMMAND roll to rally Hayes. This succeeds, and Hayes joins the fight again.

On his next turn, Hayes fights valiantly against the beast, shouting at Nat to get out to save herself. Then make a death roll. Sadly, the STAMINA roll fails, and Nat can only watch in horror as Hayes collapses on the floor, dead.

Damage

Reduce the incoming **damage** by any armor level (modified for armor piercing and weak spots).

→ **Decrease your Health** by the resulting damage.

If your Health drops to zero you are **broken** and cannot perform any actions except one movement action per round. When broken, immediately roll for a critical injury. **Is it lethal?**

No: Apply the effect.

Yes: Apply the effect and **make a death roll** for **STAMINA** after each indicated time limit has passed. You cannot push the roll, and no stress dice are used.

A death roll fails: You die.

Three death rolls succeed: Stop making death rolls.

Others at Adjacent range can give you first aid with a **MEDICAL AID** roll (full action). If successful, you are stabilized – stop making death rolls. If broken, you also recover 1 point of Health per ✦ rolled. If the roll fails, your condition worsens – the time limit is reduced one step.

While broken, someone at Adjacent range can give you first aid (**MEDICAL AID** roll, full action) and anyone in your zone can try to rally you (**COMMAND** roll quick action).

Failure: No effect.

Success: Recover 1 point of Health per ✦ rolled. You are no longer broken.

Recover 1 point of Health per stretch of time, even if suffering from a critical injury. When you have 1 Health or more, you are no longer broken.

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Critical Injuries

D66	INJURY	LETHAL	TIME LIMIT	EFFECT	HEALING TIME
11	Focused	No	–	Relieve all stress.	–
12	Winded	No	–	None.	–
13	Intense Pain	No	–	Stress Level +1.	–
14	Sprained Ankle	No	–	Movement in combat becomes full action.	Shift
15	Blood in Eyes	No	–	–1 dice on **RANGED COMBAT** and **OBSERVATION** rolls.	Shift
16	Concussion	No	–	–1 die on **OBSERVATION** and **COMTECH** rolls.	D6
21	Ear Torn Off	No	–	–2 dice on **OBSERVATION** rolls.	D6
22	Broken Toes	No	–	Movement in combat becomes full action.	D6
23	Broken Fingers	No	–	–1 die on all rolls that normally require two hands.	D6
24	Broken Teeth	No	–	–2 dice on **MANIPULATION** rolls.	D6
25	Impaled Thigh	No	–	Movement in combat becomes full action.	2D6
26	Slashed Shoulder	No	–	–2 dice on all rolls that normally require two arms.	D6
31	Broken Nose	No	–	–1 die on **MANIPULATION** and **OBSERVATION** rolls.	D6
32	Broken Ribs	No	–	–2 dice on **MOBILITY** and **CLOSE COMBAT** rolls.	2D6
33	Gouged Eye	No	–	–2 on **RANGED COMBAT** and **OBSERVATION**. Needs surgery.	2D6
34	Injured Throat	No	–	–2 dice on **MANIPULATION** and **COMMAND** rolls.	2D6
35	Broken Arm	No	–	–3 dice on all rolls that normally require two arms.	3D6
36	Broken Leg	No	–	Movement in combat becomes full action.	3D6
41	Crushed Foot	No	–	Movement becomes full action. Requires surgery.	3D6
42	Disfigured Face	No	–	–2 dice on **MANIPULATION** rolls. Requires surgery.	2D6
43	Traumatized	No	–	Roll once on the table for mental trauma (page 74).	Varies
44	Punctured Lung	Yes	Shift	–2 dice on **MOBILITY** and **CLOSE COMBAT**. Needs surgery.	D6
45	Bleeding Gut	Yes	Shift	1 damage at every roll for **MOBILITY** or **CLOSE COMBAT**.	D6
46	Infected Wound	Yes	Shift	Roll for **STAMINA** to avoid falling sick (page 76).	–
51	Cracked Skull	Yes	Shift	–2 dice on **OBSERVATION** and **COMTECH** rolls. Requires surgery.	3D6
52	Cracked Spine	Yes	Shift	Paralyzed from the waist down, unable to move. Requires surgery.	4D6
53	Arm Arterial Bleeding	Yes	Stretch	–1 die on all rolls that normally require two arms.	D6
54	Leg Arterial Bleeding	Yes	Stretch	Movement in combat becomes full action.	D6
55	Severed Arm	Yes	Stretch	–3 dice on all rolls that require two arms. Requires surgery and prosthesis.	4D6
56	Severed Leg	Yes	Stretch	Movement in combat becomes full action. Requires surgery and prosthesis.	4D6
61	Ruptured Jugular	Yes	Round	**STAMINA** –1.	2D6
62	Internal Bleeding	Yes	Round	**STAMINA** –2.	3D6
63	Massive Hemorrhage	Yes	Round	**STAMINA** –3. Requires surgery.	4D6
64	Disemboweled	Yes	–	Instant death.	–
65	Crushed Head	Yes	–	Your story ends here.	–
66	Impaled Heart	Yes	–	Your heart beats for the last time.	–

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First Aid: To save your life when you have suffered a lethal critical injury, someone must give you first aid to stabilize you before you fail a death roll. This is a full action and requires a **MEDICAL AID** roll, modified for medical gear. If you are no longer broken, you can try to administer first aid on yourself, but with −2 dice.

- If the roll succeeds, you are stabilized and can stop making death rolls. If you were broken, you also recover 1 point of Health per ✦ rolled. The other effects of your critical injury remain until healed.
- If the roll fails, your condition worsens – the time limit is decreased one step, for example from shift to stretch, or stretch to round. If the time limit was already round, you perish.

On Your Own: If you succeed at three death rolls on your own, you survive without help and can stop rolling.

Instant Kill: Note that there are three critical injuries (results #64–66) that kill you outright. If you roll any of these, you're dead. No death rolls, no chance of surviving – you're done for. Some Xenomorph signature attacks (page 208) can also be instantly fatal. Finally, if the damage from a single instance equals or exceeds double your maximum Health, you are killed outright.

Healing: Each critical injury has a specific effect that you suffer during the healing time indicated, which is measured in days unless stated otherwise. Several critical injuries can heal simultaneously. Each day during which someone with the Nurse talent tends to you while healing counts double. Note that you can recover all your lost Health points but still suffer the effects of a critical injury.

Surgery: Some critical injuries require surgery before they start to heal – this takes a shift of time and requires a **MEDICAL AID** roll (with bonuses for talents and medical gear).

Stun Damage

Some weapons inflict stun damage instead of normal damage. Attacks from such weapons don't reduce your Health – instead, when hit you need to make a **STAMINA** roll (no action) with a negative modifier equal to the damage inflicted. If you fail, you can't perform any action on your next turn, nor any quick actions until then.

On your next turn, roll **STAMINA** again, this time unmodified. If you fail again, you're stunned until your next turn after that, and so on until you make a successful **STAMINA** roll. The **STAMINA** rolls can be pushed normally, and armor works normally against stun damage. ●

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)

PANIC ROLLS

BEING IN THE COLD DARKNESS of space will test your nerves even under normal circumstances. Add horrifying Xenomorphs, and you really need to keep your nerves in check to avoid spiraling into a wild panic.

Stress Level

The mounting tension in your character is measured by your stress level. It usually starts at zero and increases during the course of the game. Your stress can increase in many ways, such as:

- You push a skill roll (page 43).
- You or a nearby PC suffers a certain stress or panic response (next page).
- A nearby NPC panics (as determined by the GM).
- You fire a second or third burst of full auto fire (page 67).
- You become fatigued (page 75).
- A member of your own crew attacks you.
- A person nearby is revealed to be an android.
- Any unnerving encounter as determined by the adventure or the GM.

Panic Roll

1.	Roll **D6**.
2.	Add your **stress level**.
3.	Subtract your **Resolve**.
4.	Check the **panic response table.**

Panic Roll

As long as you keep your stress in check, you can use it to your advantage. But if the tension grows too strong it can explode, sending you into a wild panic. You need to make a panic roll when any of the following happens:

- You witness another PC become broken.
- You see a horrifying Xenomorph for the first time.
- A terrifying Xenomorph comes within Adjacent range (even if you have seen it before).
- You witness another PC suffer from a certain panic response.
- A truly horrifying event occurs, as determined by the adventure or the GM.

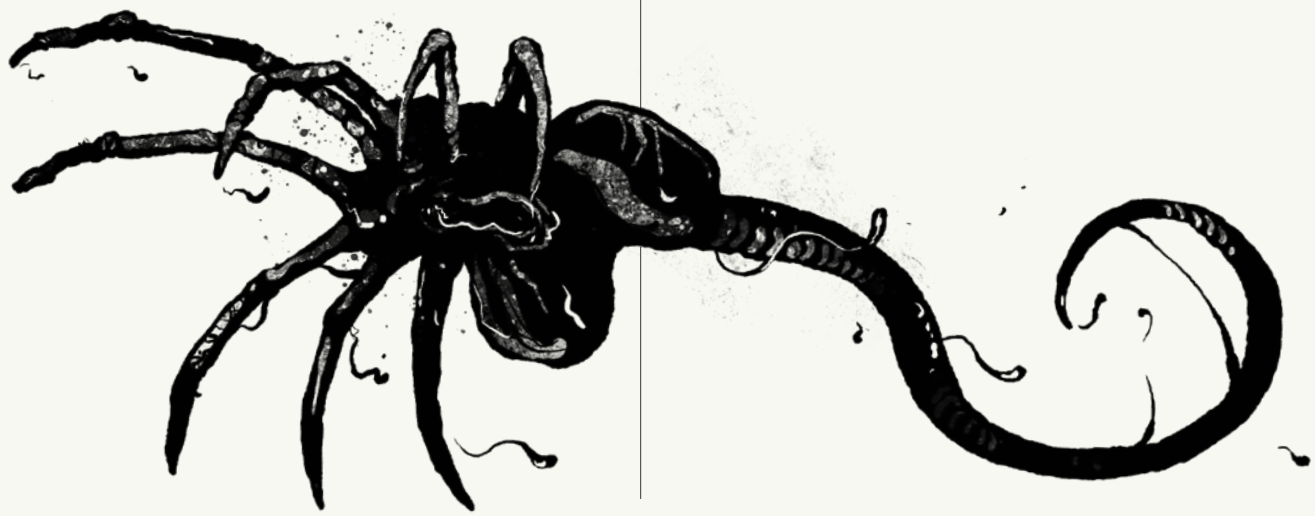
Resolution: Roll a D6, add your current stress level, subtract your Resolve rating, and compare the result to the table on the next page.

More Panic: If you are suffering from a panic response and are forced to make another panic roll, you suffer both responses if possible. In cases where two responses cannot be combined, the higher response takes precedence. If you already have a panic response (or stress response of the same name) and roll the same again, use the next higher response on the table.

Stopping Panic

Some panic responses are immediate or last until your next turn. If this is not the case, the effect remains until one of the following happens:

- Another character within speaking range (including comms) makes a **COMMAND** roll. This is a full action in combat.
- You are broken.
- One stretch passes.



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Relieving Stress

For every stretch of time (5–10 minutes) spent resting in a safe area, your stress level is reduced by 1 point. In addition, one stress response (page 44) of your choice is removed for each stress level reduced. You can't make skill rolls when resting, and if your rest is interrupted, it doesn't count. A panic roll can also decrease stress, as can certain drugs (page 98). ▶

PANIC CARDS

In the Hope's Last Day Starter Set, custom cards for all enduring panic responses are included.

PANIC RESPONSE

D6 + Stress Level − Resolve

RESULT	RESPONSE
≤0	**Keeping Cool.** No effect.
1	**Spooked.** Stress level +1 for you.
2	**Noisy.** Any enemies nearby (GM's discretion) are automatically alerted to your presence.
3	**Twitchy.** Make an immediate supply roll for air, ammo, or power (GM's discretion).
4	**Lose Item.** You lose a weapon or other important item. The GM decides which one. In combat, you can pick up the item with a quick action. Out of combat, you need an OBSERVATION roll and a stretch of time to find the item.
5	**Paranoid.** You cannot give or receive help on skill rolls until panic ends.
6	**Hesitant.** You automatically get the #10 initiative card in combat until your panic stops. If several PCs are Hesitant, draw the highest value cards randomly.
7	**Freeze.** You're frozen by fear, losing your next turn and unable to perform any interrupt actions before then.
8	**Seek Cover.** You immediately seek (full) cover in the zone, if it is cluttered. This is an interrupt action breaking the turn order. Once in cover, your stress level is reduced 1 step, but you lose your next turn and are unable to perform any interrupt actions before then. If you are in an open zone, you Scream instead (below).
9	**Scream.** You scream your lungs out, losing your next turn and unable to perform any interrupt actions before then. Your stress level is reduced 1 step, but every friendly PC in the zone must make an immediate panic roll.
10	**Flee.** You immediately move away from the source of panic, into any adjacent zone, if such a move is possible. This is an interrupt action breaking the turn order. After the move, your stress level is reduced 1 step, but all friendly PCs in the starting zone get stress level +1. On your next turn and subsequent turns, you must spend all your actions to continue to move away, until you find a (reasonably) safe place, where you must remain until your panic stops. You cannot perform interrupt actions before then. If you cannot move out of your zone, you become Catatonic (result #12) instead.
11	**Frenzy.** You immediately attack the nearest person or creature, friendly or not. Every friendly PC in the zone must make an immediate panic roll. You won't stop until you or the target is broken, or until your panic stops. You cannot perform interrupt actions before then.
12+	**Catatonic.** You're doomed! You collapse to the floor and can't move, rambling or staring blankly into oblivion, until your panic stops.

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Mental Trauma

If you have rolled a result of 9 or higher on a panic roll during a game session, make an Empathy roll after the session. Roll for the attribute only, not using any skill. The roll cannot be pushed. If the roll fails, you develop a mental trauma of some kind. Roll a D66 and consult the table below. Mental trauma can only be healed during shore leave in campaign play (page 257). ●

PLAYING TRAUMA

We strongly recommend that you discuss mental trauma in the group before using the rules for mental trauma. If anyone in the group prefers not to make mental illness a part of the game, be sure to respect that and simply ignore the rule.

MENTAL TRAUMA

D66	TRAUMA
11–13	**Confused.** –1 die on all skill rolls based on Wits.
14–16	**Apathetic.** You cannot push any dice rolls.
21–23	**Reclusive.** You cannot relieve stress in the presence of others.
24–26	**Obsessive.** You must push every skill roll – even if it was successful.
31–32	**Overwhelmed.** Your Resolve is reduced 2 points.
33–34	**Alcoholic.** You can only relieve stress by drinking alcohol.
35–36	**Depressed.** You cannot be rallied in combat (page 68).
41–43	**Worrisome.** Even minor concerns (GM's choice) count as traumatic events for you, giving you +1 stress level.
44	**Changed Personality.** You get a new personal agenda page 27), determined by the GM or randomly generated.
45–46	**Phobic.** You become phobic of something connected to your trauma (GM's choice). Every contact with your phobia counts as a traumatic event for you, triggering a panic roll.
51–52	**Speech Loss.** You cannot speak and need to communicate using written notes or hand signs.
53–54	**Nightmares.** Every shift you sleep, you gain +1 stress level.
55–56	**Flashbacks.** Each time you gain stress, you increase the amount by +1.
61–62	**Panic Attacks.** If you have rolled a result of 1 or higher (instead of 9 or higher) on a panic roll during a game session, you must make an Empathy roll after the session to avoid mental trauma.
63	**Violent.** All rolls of 8 or higher on the panic table will trigger the Frenzy response (#14).
64	**Psychotic.** At some point every Shift (GM's choice), you experience hallucinations that give you +1 stress level.
65	**Amnesiac.** You cannot remember who you or the other player characters are. The effect must be roleplayed.
66	**Personality Split.** Create a new character with a different name, Wits and Empathy scores, a personal agenda, and a random talent. You switch personality every time you gain stress.

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OTHER HAZARDS

THE WORLD OF ALIEN is unforgiving, and there are many ways for your character to suffer and die.

Fatigue

If you don't get enough air, water, food, or sleep, or if you are exposed to extreme cold or heat without adequate protection, you must make **SURVIVAL** rolls at regular intervals. As soon as you fail such a roll, you become fatigued. Mark this on your character sheet. Being fatigued has several effects:

- You can no longer recover Health.
- You must continue to make **SURVIVAL** rolls at the same intervals. For each failed roll, you suffer 1 point of damage and gain +1 stress level.
- If broken by damage from fatigue, don't roll for a critical injury. Instead, make death rolls at the same interval as the **SURVIVAL** rolls. First aid has no effect against these rolls – only removing the source of the fatigue will stop the death rolls.

Suffocation: If your supply of air runs out (page 28), or if under water, you must make a **SURVIVAL** roll every round (in combat, the roll does not count as an action).

Hunger & Thirst: As a rule of thumb, you need to eat and drink something every day. After a full 24 hours without food and water, you must make **SURVIVAL** rolls once per shift.

Sleep Deprivation: You must sleep at least one shift per day. After a full 24 hours without sleep, you must make **SURVIVAL** rolls once per shift. If you are broken by a **SURVIVAL** roll caused by sleep deprivation, don't make death rolls – instead, you pass out and sleep for a full shift, impossible to wake. Certain drugs (page 98) can help against sleep deprivation.

Heat & Cold: How often you need to make **SURVIVAL** rolls due to extreme temperatures depends on the situation, and is decided by the adventure text or the GM. It can be once per day, shift, stretch, or even round (in combat, the roll does not count as an action).

Hypersleep: Spending any length of time in hypersleep will make you fatigued. Hypersleep fatigue is remedied after one shift awake, assuming you eat a sturdy meal. The effect can also be counteracted by the Hydr8tion drug (page 98).

Recovery: As soon as the hazardous situation is remedied, you are no longer fatigued and stop making **SURVIVAL** rolls. If broken, you can then be stabilized.

Androids are completely immune to all forms of fatigue.

Vacuum

Space is a cold and unforgiving place. If your ship suffers explosive decompression (below) or if you are thrown out of an airlock, your life is in extreme danger. The absence of pressure creates gas bubbles in your blood, causing your whole body to swell up. This results in crippling pain, all while the raw UV radiation from the nearest star sears your skin.

In a vacuum, you suffer +1 stress level each round and you must make a **SURVIVAL** roll before you can take action. The roll itself is not an action. The first roll is unmodified, but you get −1 dice on the second roll, –2 on the third roll, and so on. A failed roll means you drop directly to zero Health and become broken. Don't roll for a critical injury – instead, make a death roll every round. Nothing can stop these death rolls except escaping the vacuum.

Climbing into a space suit quickly (full action) requires a successful **MOBILITY** roll.

Explosive Decompression

Firing guns inside a spacecraft is very dangerous. If a shot misses its target in a zone next to an outer bulkhead that can potentially be breached by the shot (page 79), the GM rolls one stress die. On a  , the barrier is breached. If a character intentionally tries to shoot a hole in the hull, make a normal ranged attack with +2 dice.

A hull breach is bad news for everyone. The air will vent out into space at a rate of one stretch per affected zone, and the intense draft will require everyone to make a **SURVIVAL** roll on their turn to perform any action (this roll itself is not an action).

Most ships will automatically seal off a breached zone. Once the air is gone, anyone still in the vented zone will suffer the effects of vacuum.

Falling

Falling on a hard surface in gravity automatically inflicts an amount of damage to you equal to the height of the fall (in meters) divided by 2, rounding all fractions down. In a controlled jump, roll **MOBILITY** – each  rolled reduces the damage done by 1. Body armor does not protect you. ▶

"I think we oughta discuss the bonus situation."

Chief Engineer Dennis Parker

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Placed Explosions

BLAST POWER	BASE DAMAGE
3	1
6	2
9	3
12	4

Zero Gravity

Most ships and stations have artificial gravity generators, but these can fail. You can also find yourself spacewalking outside your ship. In a zone without gravity, all rolls for **CLOSE COMBAT, HEAVY MACHINERY, MOBILITY** and **RANGED COMBAT** get –2 dice. In addition, every move requires a successful **MOBILITY** roll (without the penalty), with failure meaning you spin in place and suffer +1 stress level. The Zero-G Training talent removes all of the above effects.

On the flip side, zero gravity allows you to move in any direction, floating through open air (or space). And you never risk falling damage.

Explosions

Some weapons in chapter 5 have an explosive effect. You fire these as a normal ranged attack, but if you hit your target, all other characters in the same zone (PC and NPCs alike) suffer the same damage. Each target can dodge the attack separately. If your attack misses, the shot is assumed to have gone astray and hurts no one.

Cover: For the primary target, cover page 66) has the same effect as in any ranged attack. Secondary targets in partial cover count as if they were in full cover (i.e. they get protection from the full armor level of the barrier).

Fire

D6	EFFECT
1–2	The fire goes out.
3–4	The fire continues to burn.
5–6	The fire spreads to a random adjacent zone, if the zone border is open and there is flammable material in the zone.

Contained spaces: If you fire an explosive weapon into a zone with only blocked borders (via a hatch or door from an adjacent zone, or inside the zone behind cover), you get +2 dice to the attack.

Placed Explosives: Detonations caused by anything that's not a ranged attack have a blast power and a base damage. The base damage is equal to one third of the blast power (round up to the nearest whole number). When the explosion occurs, roll for an attack with a number of base dice equal to the blast power. If the attack hits, every PC and NPC in the zone suffers the base damage plus 1 point of damage for each ✦ rolled beyond the first. This is not a skill roll and cannot be pushed. All targets behind partial or full cover get protection from the full armor level of the barrier).

Fire

A fire typically covers one zone and is measured by its intensity. A typical fire has intensity 6–9. When entering a burning zone, or starting a round in one, roll a number of base dice equal to the intensity. For every ✦ rolled, you suffer 1 point of damage. Body armor has its normal effect. If you are broken by fire damage, don't roll for a critical injury – instead, make a death roll every round until you're out of the fire.

Catching Fire: If you take damage from a fire attack, you catch fire and continue to burn, suffering another fire attack at the start of each new round even if you leave the burning zone. As soon as a fire attack outside the burning zone inflicts no damage, you're no longer on fire. You, or a friend at Adjacent range, can stop you from burning with a successful **MOBILITY** roll (full action).

Fire Spreading: For a typical fire, roll a D6 at the start of each round. On 1–2, the fire goes out and the zone is no longer considered burning. On a 5–6, the fire spreads to a random adjacent zone, assuming the zone border is open and there is something in the adjacent zone that can burn. Specialized gear can be used to extinguish fires.

Disease

When exposed to a dangerous contagion or infection, you need to roll for **STAMINA** to avoid falling sick. This is a passive roll, and cannot be pushed. The GM may even roll for you in secret.

Virulence: Contagions have a virulence rating, which is a negative modifier to your **STAMINA** roll. If the virulence is not listed, it is zero.

Effects: Diseases can have a wide range of effects. A common effect is to make you fatigued (page 75),

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triggering further **STAMINA** rolls (instead of **SURVIVAL**) modified for virulence at regular intervals (typically once per shift), with the normal effects of fatigue if you fail. Once you succeed, your immune system has beaten the disease, and you can start to recover.

Medical Aid: If someone cares for you while you are sick, they can roll for **MEDICAL AID** to fight off the disease, replacing your **STAMINA** rolls. Medical gear can give bonuses to this.

Radiation

The world of ALIEN contains many places where you will be exposed to hard radiation – on a spacewalk near a dying star, for example, or when you try to repair your ship's leaking reactor core.

Radiation Level: When you are exposed to radiation, you gain radiation points, or rads, that accumulate in your body. Mark your rads on your character sheet. The area's radiation level determines how often you get rads.

- **WEAK RADIATION:** 1 rad per shift
- **STRONG RADIATION:** 1 rad per stretch
- **EXTREME RADIATION:** 1 rad per round

Effects: Every time you gain a radiation point, you must roll a number of dice equal to your total current number of accumulated rads. For every ✦ rolled, you suffer 1 point of damage. If you are broken by radiation damage, don't roll for a critical injury – instead, make death rolls at the same intervals as above until you're out of the hotspot.

Recovery: As long as you remain in a hotspot, you cannot recover Health in any way. After you leave the irradiated area, you heal one rad per shift.

Synthetics

Synthetic individuals are increasingly common in the Core Systems, and appear on the Frontier as well. Some are open about their artificial nature, others pose as humans. In combat, androids act like humans, and they make skill rolls normally. But there are several differences:

Attributes: Synthetics generally have higher attribute score than humans.

Skills & Stress: Androids can't push skill rolls. They don't suffer stress, don't have a stress level, and they never make panic rolls. ▶



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Android Critical System Damage

D6	CRITICAL DAMAGE
1	**Ruptured Fluid Pump.** The android loses its next turn, and cannot perform interrupt actions until then.
2	**Destroyed Leg Servos.** Both legs are non-functional. Movement becomes a full action.
3	**Destroyed Arm Servos.** One arm is non-functional. The android can only use one-handed gear.
4	**Head Dislocation.** The android's artificial neck is severely fractured and its head placed in an unnatural position. All quick actions become full actions.
5	**Severe Chassis Breach.** Internal components spill out and the android is completely immobilized.
6	**System Shutdown.** The android is torn to shreds or crushed beyond repair. Core systems are severely damaged and a **COMTECH** roll is required to communicate with the android.

Damage: If a synthetic goes to zero Health, don't roll for a normal critical injury. Instead, roll for critical systems damage on the table above. Until the android suffers a system shutdown (result #6), it can continue to operate, only suffering the effects of the critical damage. This makes androids very hard to stop.

If an android at zero Health suffers further damage, roll again on the critical system damage. If you roll a damage that the android already has, shift it up one step on the table (from a #4 to a #5, for example).

Fatigue: Synthetics don't need air, food, water, or sleep, and thus never suffer the effects of fatigue (page 75). They are immune to vacuum, cold, and disease. Androids are typically unaffected by alien pathogens.

Repairs: Androids don't heal. Instead, a shift of work and a **COMTECH** roll is required to repair all lost Health points and all critical system damage, as long as the android hasn't suffered a system shutdown. They can repair themselves.

System Shutdown: An android that suffers a system shutdown is damaged beyond repair, but can be reactivated only to communicate with. This requires a power source, a stretch of work, and a **COMTECH** roll. Make a power supply roll after each stretch of communication.

ELECTRIC SHEEP

It is illegal to program an android for violence against humans. While modern synthetics are governed by behavioral inhibitors that prevent them from injuring others, earlier models are not so equipped and are therefore dangerous. Expensive bypass packages are available on the black market for those who want to circumvent these laws.

Xenomorphs

You've heard the stories about the monsters out there. You better hope that you won't need to face one yourself. Fighting Xenomorph beings is something different entirely and far more deadly than facing humans or even androids. Very few have lived to tell the tale.

A range of Xenomorphs are described in detail in chapter 10. In combat, Xenomorphs follow special rules. These are described on page 208 in the GM's section. ●

VEHICLE COMBAT

A WIDE RANGE OF VEHICLES, both of the air and ground varieties, are used to get around planetside on the Frontier. You'll find a selection described in chapter 5.

Vehicle Attributes

- **MANEUVERABILITY:** A modifier to your **PILOTING** rolls when performing challenging maneuvers.
- **SPEED:** The speed of the vehicle, in number of zones per driving action.
- **HULL:** How much damage the vehicle can take before becoming wrecked.
- **ARMOR:** The armor level of the vehicle.

Vehicles In Combat

Driving under normal circumstances requires no dice rolls, but more advanced maneuvers require **PILOTING** rolls. Entering or mounting a vehicle is a quick action. Starting a motorized vehicle is also a quick action.

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Movement: Driving a vehicle is a quick action, and it will move you a number of zones up to the Speed rating of your ride. Note that you can drive twice in the same round if you spend both of your actions on it.

Vehicle Armaments: Some vehicles are fitted with mounted heavy weapons, fired by the crew (and in some cases, the driver). You'll find a list of vehicle weapons on page 313.

Ramming: Most vehicles can be used as weapons – i.e. to simply ram your enemy. It counts as a close combat attack, but roll for **PILOTING** instead of **CLOSE COMBAT**. Add the vehicle's Maneuverability rating. The base damage rating of the attack equals your vehicle's Hull rating divided by 2, rounding up.

Damage To Vehicles

When a vehicle has suffered damage equal to or in excess of its Hull rating, it is wrecked. This means that the vehicle becomes inoperable and everyone inside takes 3 points of damage, mitigated by a **MOBILITY** roll (no action) – each ✦ reduces the damage by one point.

Component Damage

D6	DAMAGE
1	**Driver Hit.** The driver is hit and suffers damage equal to the damage inflicted on the vehicle, after reduction for armor.
2	**Passenger Hit.** A random passenger is hit and suffers damage equal to the damage inflicted on the vehicle, after reduction for armor. Re-roll if no passengers are present.
3	**Severe Spin.** The attack rocks the vehicle. The driver must make an immediate **PILOTING** roll (not an action) – failure means that the vehicle is wrecked.
4	**Weapon Disabled.** A random weapon mounted on the vehicle is disabled. Re-roll if no weapons are present.
5	**Engine Disabled.** The engine is disabled, and the vehicle can't continue. An aerial vehicle can make a controlled landing, losing one zone of altitude per round.
6	**Fuel Explosion.** The vehicle explodes in a ball of flame. All people inside it are immediately exposed to intensity 9 fire, and the vehicle is destroyed beyond repair.

Armor Level: Most vehicles have an armor level, which reduces the amount of incoming damage.

Breach Limit: For vehicles (and barriers, see page 68), if the armor level is higher than the base damage rating of the weapon (not just equal), after any modifiers for ammunition and weak spots, the attack cannot breach the armor, no matter how many ✦ are rolled.

Component Damage: If a vehicle takes damage equal to or more than half its Hull rating (rounding up) in a single hit, it suffers component damage. Roll a D6 and consult the adjacent table.

Exposed Passengers: Passengers in an open vehicle, or sitting on top of a vehicle, can be targeted separately. A partially exposed character is considered to be in partial cover (page 66) but not shielded by the armor level of the vehicle.

Ramming Vehicles: You can use your vehicle to ram another vehicle. Roll the attack like you would if you were ramming a person (above), but both vehicles suffer the base damage. Extra damage due to additional ✦ is inflicted on the target only.

Aerial Vehicles

Aerial vehicles are handled in much the same way as ground vehicles, with some exceptions.

Altitude: At all times you must keep track of the vehicle's altitude, measured in zones. When moving, you distribute the zones moved on vertical and horizontal movement. On the ground, the Speed of an aerial vehicle is typically 1.

Crashes: If an aerial vehicle is wrecked, it crashes violently to the ground. All people inside suffer damage equal to the altitude (in zones) multiplied by 2. You can brace yourself for the hit by rolling **MOBILITY** (not an action) – each ✦ rolled reduces the damage by 1.

Repairs

Repairing vehicle damage requires one or several **HEAVY MACHINERY** rolls. One roll can be made per shift. Only one person can roll to repair the hull, but others can help. Each ✦ removes 1 point of damage. If the vehicle was wrecked, it is no longer considered wrecked once it has regained at least 1 point of Hull.

Component Damage: If the engine or a mounted weapon has been disabled, repairing it typically requires a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll, in addition to any roll for repairing Hull damage. The work takes one shift. ●

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Michael Synett (Order #53454103)



CHAPTER 5

GEAR & TECH

"I wanna introduce you to a personal friend of mine. This is an M41A Pulse Rifle – ten millimeter, with over-and-under thirty millimeter pump action grenade launcher. Feel the weight."

"Okay, what do I do?"

Corporal Hicks and Lt. Ripley

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

WEAPONS

YOU ALWAYS WANT a weapon close at hand – you never know where danger lurks. Don't expect to have your choice of firearms, however. When something hisses at you in the dark, you can't be too choosy, understand? You use whatever you can get your hands on to buy you some time. The tables and images on the following pages show various kinds of common weapons.

Weapon Features

Different weapons neutralize different threats. This list is a heads-up on the features used in the weapon tables.

- **Modifier:** The modifier to **CLOSE COMBAT** or **RANGED COMBAT** when using the weapon.
- **Damage:** The amount of damage inflicted on a successful attack. Extra ✦ rolled beyond the first increase the damage. The letter E by the number means that the attack is explosive (page 76). "Stun" means that the weapon inflicts stun damage (page 71) instead of regular damage.
- **Range:** The minimum / maximum range. Any attack closer than the minimum range gets –2 dice per range band below the minimum range. A weapon cannot be used beyond its maximum range.

AMMO

One full reload for a firearm typically costs about 5% of the cost of the weapon itself. A reload typically has a weight of ¼. The ammo inside a loaded weapon is included in the weapon's weight.

- **Ammo:** The ammo supply rating of the weapon (page 29). When the ammo supply rating runs out, you need to reload. "Single-shot" means the weapon needs to be reloaded (quick action) after each attack.
- **Power:** The power supply rating of the weapon (page 29), if it has one. When the power supply runs out, the weapons needs to be recharged or reloaded.
- **Weight:** The number of rows the weapon requires in the inventory list. If the weight is indicated as N/A, the weapon is too heavy to be carried.
- **Cost:** The typical price in W-Y dollars. The actual price varies depending on the local supply and demand.
- **Special:** Any special effects of the weapon.

  Armor piercing means that all armor levels are reduced 1 step against this weapon to a minimum of zero).

  Full auto means the weapon is capable of fully automatic fire (page 67).

  Unreliable means that a Mess Up (7+) result on a stress response roll causes a jam (in addition to other effects). Clearing a jam is a full action and requires a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll.

HANDGUNS



M4A3 SERVICE PISTOL

- **Modifier** +2
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** A/M
- **Ammo** 2
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $200

This inexpensive 9 mm pistol is the standard sidearm of the USCMC. You should always have a backup for your backup, and this pistol might as well be it.

VP-70MA6 SERVICE PISTOL

- **Modifier** +2
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** A/M
- **Ammo** 2
- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $250

For nearly 70 years, the VP70 series was only found in the hands of USCMC officers from key influential military families. Over the past decade, it has begun to supplant the outdated M4A3 as the standard marine sidearm.

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.357 MAGNUM REVOLVER

- **Modifier** +1
- **Damage** 3
- **Range** S/M
- **Ammo** 1
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $300

A classic high caliber revolver, equally popular amongst both Frontier Marshals and lowlifes.

WATATSUMI DV-303 BOLT GUN

- **Modifier** –1
- **Damage** 3
- **Range** A/S
- **Special** Armor piercing
- **Ammo** Single-shot
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $400

The DV-303 is a construction tool that uses expanding bolts to make emergency hull repairs. The DV-303 can be turned into an improvised weapon – firing bolts like a single round shotgun – a trick first used by Frontier rebels in the early 2100s



WEYLAND ES-4 ELECTROSTATIC PISTOL

- **Modifier** +1
- **Damage** 1 (stun)
- **Range** S/M
- **Special** Armor piercing
- **Ammo** 1
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $1,000

Developed a century ago, this electrostatic kinetic energy projectile weapon uses charged elements to fire high-speed armor piercing rounds. The ES-4 has a tell-tale blue muzzle-flash when fired. While a quality weapon, the pistol fell out of use before the Weyland-Yutani merger due to its cost and upkeep requirements.

While it can mostly be found in use amongst high level corporate security teams from the ICSC, a select number of Colonial Marshal offices are testing out a newer model as their standard sidearm on the Frontier – along with a pair of insulator gloves.

REXIM RXF-M55 EVA PISTOL

- **Modifier** +1
- **Damage** 1
- **Range** S/M
- **Special** Armor piercing
- **Ammo** 4
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $400

A miniaturized and weaponized version of a Weyland-Yutani laser welder in use from the 2100–2120s. This tool was originally improvised as a weapon by the J'Har rebels during the 2106 uprising on Torin Prime. Always one to find profit in anything, Weyland-Yutani studied the modifications after the war and made them the standard self-defense armament on their commercial fleet.

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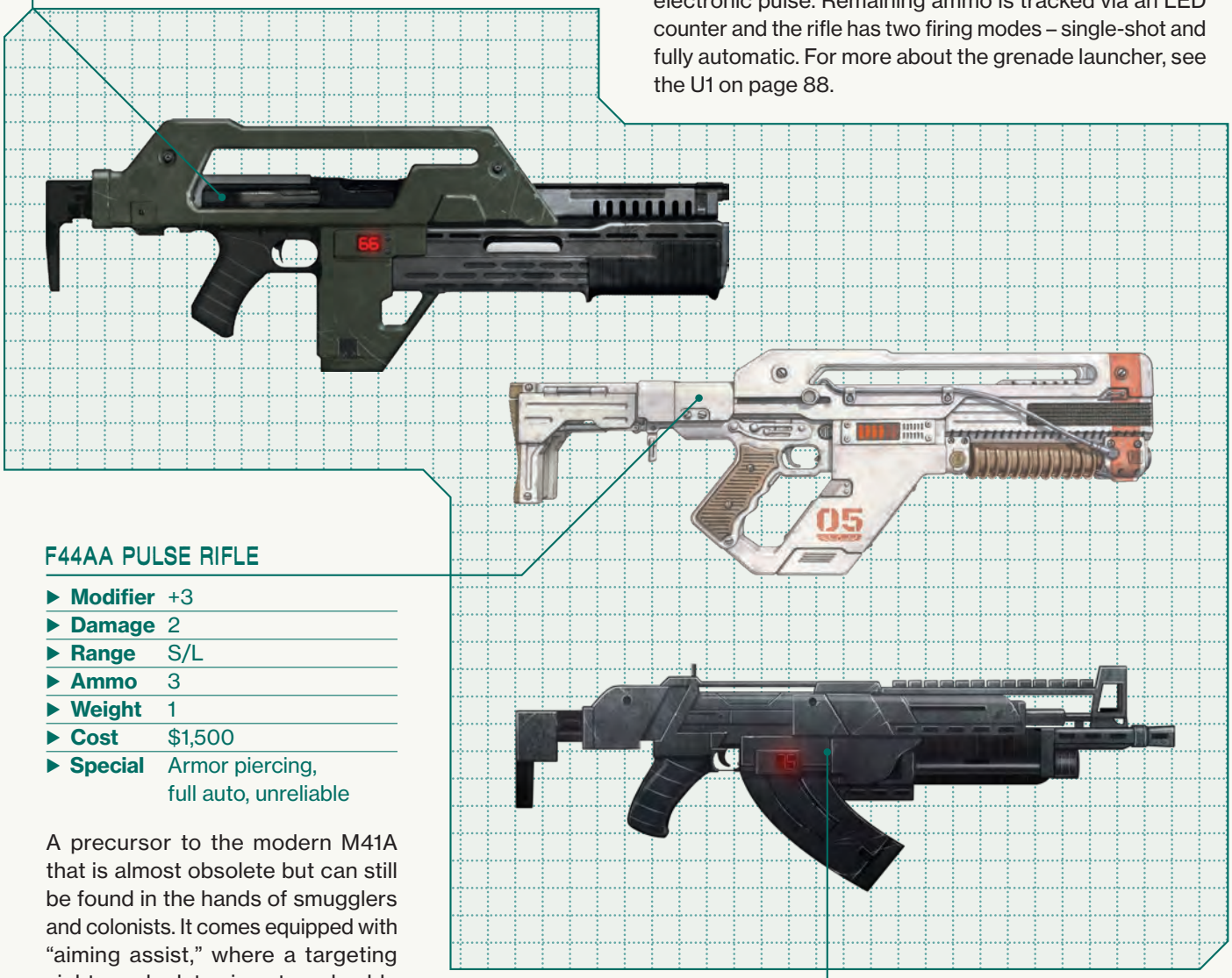
RIFLES

ARMAT M41A PULSE RIFLE

- **Modifier** +2
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** S/L
- **Special** Armor piercing, full auto, grenade launcher
- **Ammo** 3
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $1,200

The standard issue weapon of the USCMC, the M41A Pulse Rifle is a 10 mm automatic assault rifle with underslung 30 mm pump-action grenade launcher combined in a sturdy housing with retractable stock and optional scope.

The M41A fires explosive-tip caseless standard light armor-penetrating US M309 rounds accelerated via electronic pulse. Remaining ammo is tracked via an LED counter and the rifle has two firing modes – single-shot and fully automatic. For more about the grenade launcher, see the U1 on page 88.



F44AA PULSE RIFLE

- **Modifier** +3
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** S/L
- **Ammo** 3
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $1,500
- **Special** Armor piercing, full auto, unreliable

A precursor to the modern M41A that is almost obsolete but can still be found in the hands of smugglers and colonists. It comes equipped with "aiming assist," where a targeting sight sends data via external cable to the dynamic rifle stock which then makes minor changes to improve accuracy. It includes an LED ammo counter and folding stock. Once the service rifle of the Marines, it was prone to malfunction, and so the targeting system was subsequently redeveloped for the then upcoming M56 smart gun.

AK-4047 PULSE ASSAULT RIFLE

- **Modifier** +1
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** S/L
- **Ammo** 2
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $600
- **Special** Armor piercing, full auto

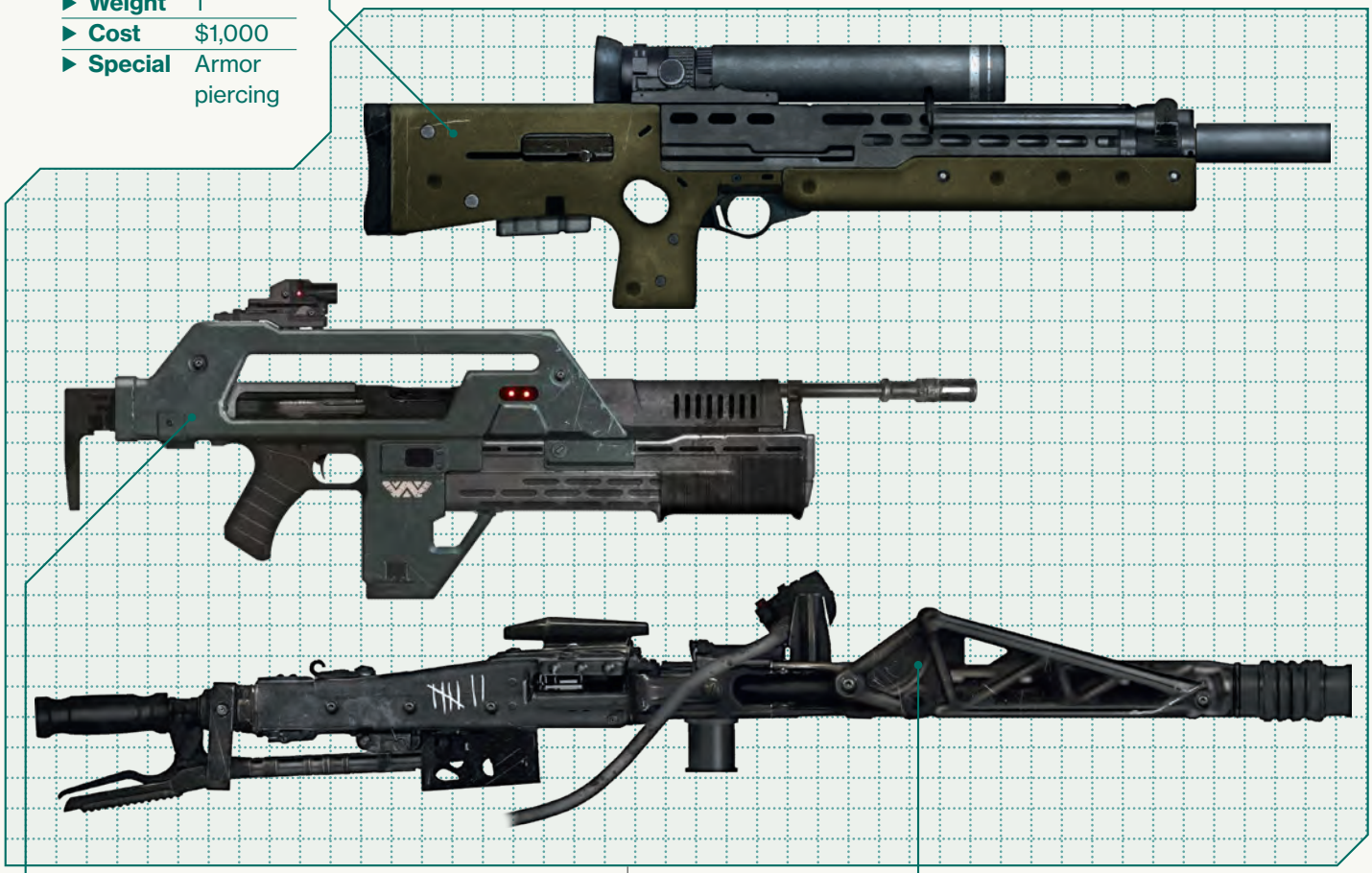
The UPP equivalent to the M41A Pulse Rifle, the AK-4047 is a cheap and reliable substitute. As such, the weapon often winds up in the hands of mercenaries and insurgents. While not as accurate as the M41A, the AK-4047 is sturdier than the USCMC weapon.

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M42A SCOPE RIFLE

- **Modifier** +3
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** M/E
- **Ammo** 2
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $1,000
- **Special** Armor piercing

Equipped with a folding bipod, muzzle flash suppressor, and a fully adjustable stock, the M42A is the USCMC's semi-automatic electronic pulse sniper rifle of choice. If you manage to see what's lurking in the shadows before it sees you, you go ahead and take the shot.



ARMAT M41AE2 HEAVY PULSE RIFLE

- **Modifier** +2
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** M/E
- **Special** Armor piercing, full auto
- **Ammo** 4
- **Weight** 2
- **Cost** $1,500

A USCMC Squad Automatic Weapon modification of the M41A, this electric pulse support rifle has a longer barrel in place of the U1 grenade launcher. This is the machinegun you want laying down suppressing fire to cover your ass during an evac.

M56 SMARTGUN

- **Modifier** +3
- **Damage** 3
- **Range** S/L
- **Special** Armor piercing, full auto, smart sight
- **Ammo** 3
- **Weight** 3
- **Cost** $6,000

The heavy firepower of every USCMC squad, the M56 Smartgun is mounted on an articulating arm and gimbal attached to an armored harness worn by the weapon's operator.

What makes the M56A2 a smart gun is its ability to choose targets for you. It is equipped with an infrared tracking system and data transmitter/receiver that homes in on potential threats and sends that information to a Head Mounted Sight.

The M56A2 fires in either bursts or full automatic. A glancing shot can sever a limb and a full burst can cut a person in half, so watch that friendly fire, Private.

Smart Sight: When firing the M56A2 on full auto after aiming carefully (page 64), the second and third burst of the attack will also gain the bonus for aiming.

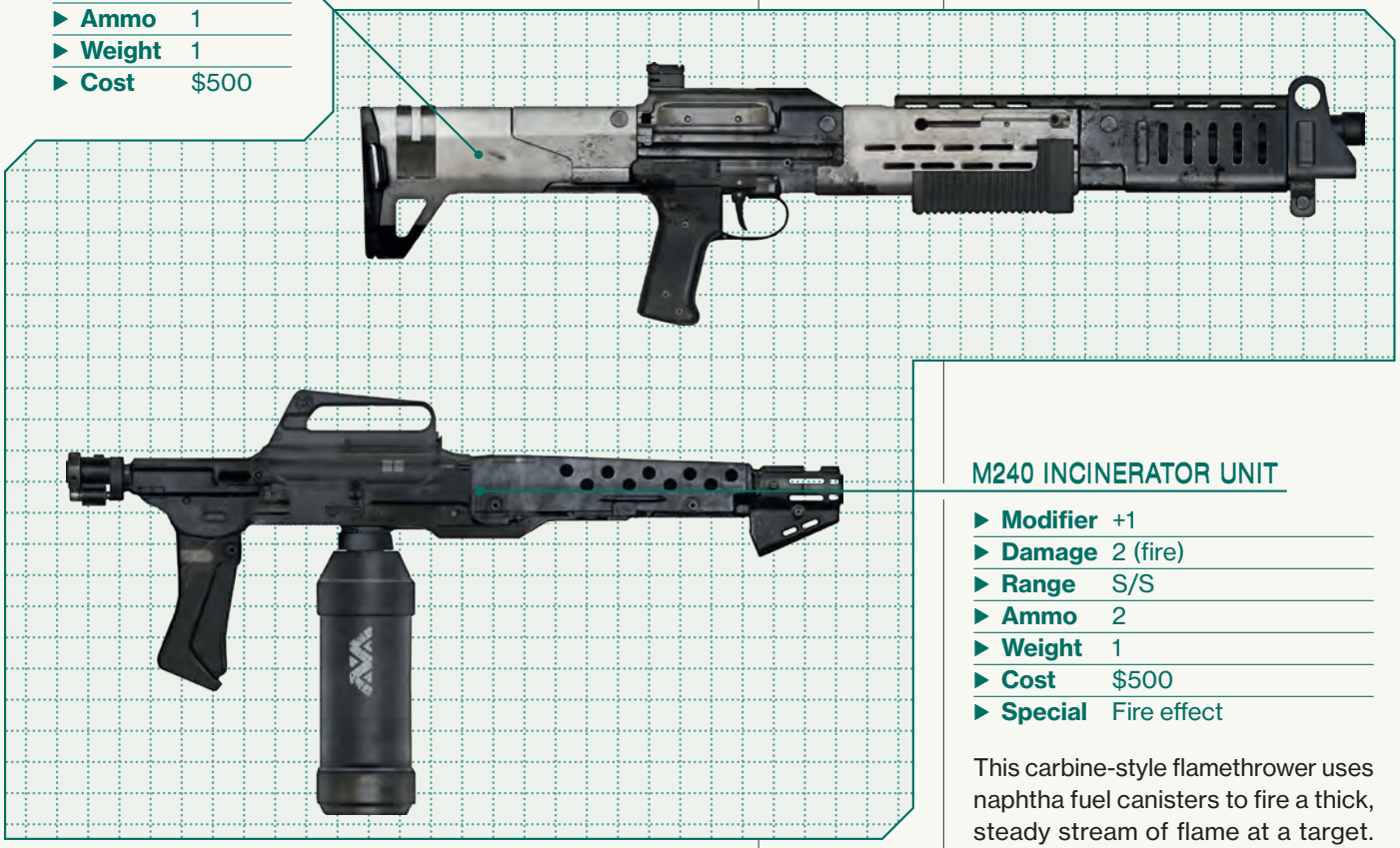
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OTHER WEAPONS

ARMAT MODEL 37A2 12 GAUGE PUMP ACTION

- **Modifier** +2
- **Damage** 3
- **Range** A/S
- **Ammo** 1
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $500

A classic pump-action combat shotgun, the M37A2 is an optional weapon in use by the USCMC. Reliable and direct, the 37 is the gun you want to keep handy for close encounters.



M240 INCINERATOR UNIT

- **Modifier** +1
- **Damage** 2 (fire)
- **Range** S/S
- **Ammo** 2
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $500
- **Special** Fire effect

This carbine-style flamethrower uses naphtha fuel canisters to fire a thick, steady stream of flame at a target. It is in common use by the USCMC, who deploy the weapon at the squad and fireteam level. Civilian models exist too. The troops in the field have given the M240 the unceremonious nickname of "Bake-a-Flake." It's a good standby weapon to have in a pinch, especially when facing off against hostile organisms. Most animals retreat from fire, yes?

Fire Effect: If hurt, the target continues to burn with intensity 9 fire (page 76). Instead of hitting a specific target, the incinerator may be used to trigger intensity 9 fire in a zone. A single ⌖ is needed in the attack roll.

Dirty Bullets

Here's where things start getting particularly nasty. The target of these radioactive bullets not only suffers piercing damage, but their wounds are irradiated in the process. Any ammunition type can be treated with radionuclides, but it's going to run you four times the cost of normal ammo.

Make sure you take the proper precautionary steps when using them – dirty bullets not only leave your gun glowing in the dark, but also your shooting hand and holster hip riddled with cancer. Anyone hit by a dirty bullet suffers 1 rad (page 77) in addition to normal damage. Carrying a weapon loaded with dirty bullets gives you 1 rad per shift.

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SPACESUB ASSO-400 HARPOON GUN

- **Modifier** –
- **Damage** 1
- **Range** S/M
- **Ammo** Single-shot
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $300
- **Special** Harpoon effect

Designed for aiding in emergency manual docking maneuvers, the ASSO-400 fires a grappling-hook-tipped harpoon that carries a tether. The ASSO-400 is used to close the distance between free-floating objects and personnel in space.

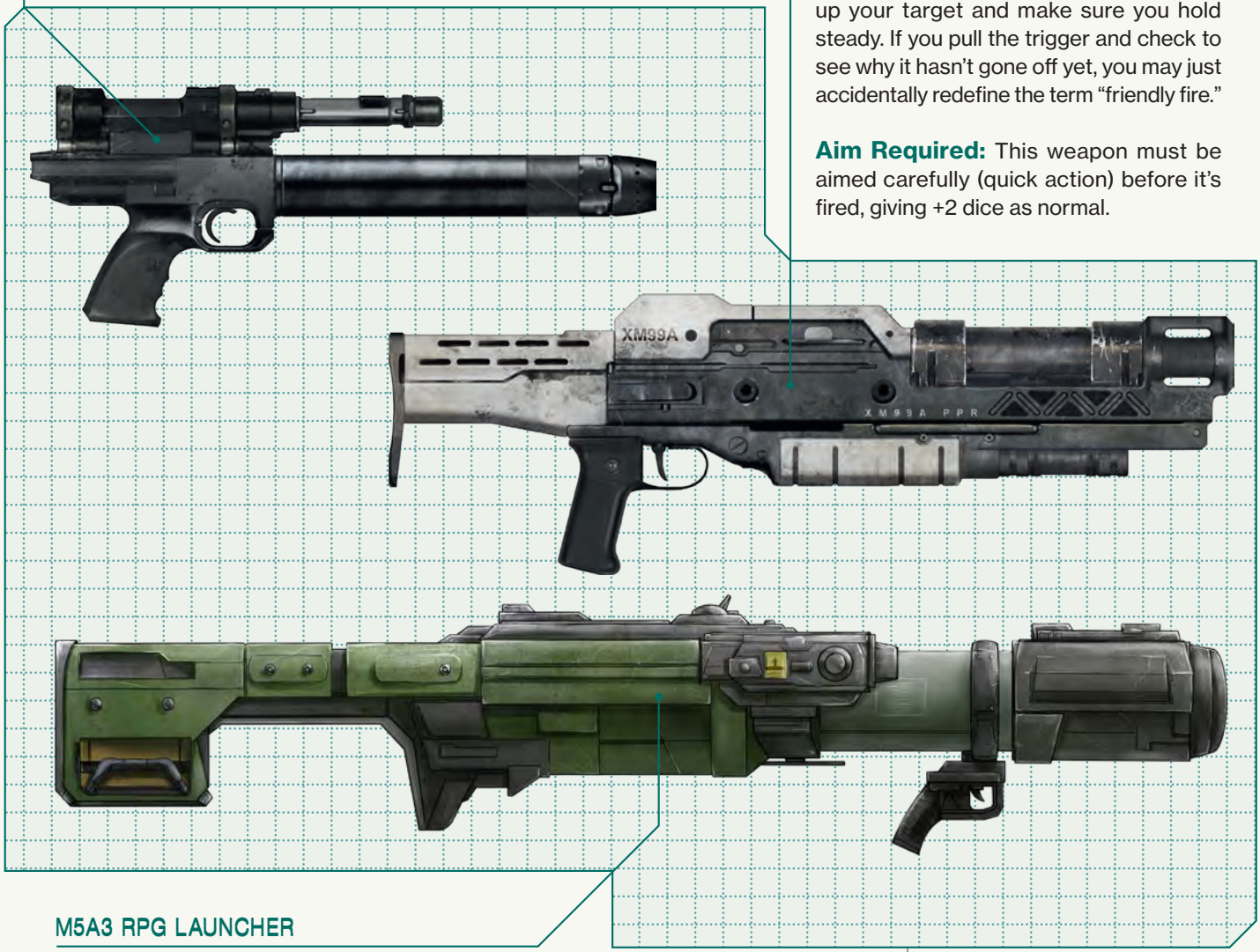
Harpoon Effect: On a hit, the grappling hook attaches to the target. In zero-G, if the target is heavier than you, you can use the tether to rappel quickly toward the target (full action, moves you to Adjacent range). If you are heavier, you can instead pull the target toward you (requires a **STRENGTH** roll if the target resists).

ARMAT XM99A PHASED PLASMA PULSE RIFLE

- **Modifier** –
- **Damage** 4
- **Range** M/E
- **Ammo** 1
- **Weight** 2
- **Cost** $20,000
- **Special** Armor piercing, aim required

Another prototype being tested by the USCMC, the extremely potent XM99A can kill most creatures with a single shot. The weapon has a plasma charge build-up delay upon firing – so take care in lining up your target and make sure you hold steady. If you pull the trigger and check to see why it hasn't gone off yet, you may just accidentally redefine the term "friendly fire."

Aim Required: This weapon must be aimed carefully (quick action) before it's fired, giving +2 dice as normal.



M5A3 RPG LAUNCHER

- **Modifier** –1
- **Damage** 7
- **Range** M/E
- **Special** Armor piercing, aim required
- **Ammo** Single-shot
- **Weight** 2
- **Cost** $1,800

This shoulder-fired rocket launcher is equipped with a telescopic targeting sight.

Aim Required: This weapon must be aimed carefully (quick action) before it's fired.

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OTHER WEAPONS CONT.

UA 571-C SENTRY GUN

- **Modifier** –
- **Damage** 4
- **Range** S/L
- **Ammo** 5
- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $12,000
- **Special** Armor piercing, full auto, automation

These tripod-mounted robot sentries form an automated perimeter defense system that tracks and automatically fires upon any target that moves within range. The UA 571 series is equipped with automatic thermal and movement actuated AI targeting capabilities.

The UA 571-C utilizes an M30 Autocannon. Just be mindful of your friend or foe settings before walking in front of one. Those set up with ARS – Advanced Recognition Software – can be programmed to identify friendly targets with a variable success rate. If set for motion and heat only, anything hot that moves might as well be dead.

Automation: When activated, the Sentry Gun will fire at the closest target according to its settings with skill level 8 in **RANGED COMBAT** (no Agility). The attack roll can't be pushed. The Sentry Gun can also be operated remotely by using a Head Mounted Sight.

ARMAT U1 GRENADE LAUNCHER

- **Modifier** +1
- **Damage** 2E
- **Range** M/L
- **Ammo** 1
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $600
- **Special** Depends on grenade type

This 30 mm pump-action is typically found as part of the M41A Pulse Rifle, but individual units do exist. When facing superior numbers, the U1 is your friend – don't enter an alien hive without one. Well, don't enter a hive with one, either. Just stay away from the hive. Okay?

Standard payload for the U1 is M40 High Explosive fragmentation grenades, but the launcher accommodates a variety of other grenade types from smoke grenades to electronic G2 Electroshock Grenades.

Smoke Grenade: Causes no damage but blocks line of sight inside, into, and out of the target zone.

G2 Electroshock Grenades: Causes stun damage instead of normal damage.

M40 HEDP GRENADE

- **Modifier** –
- **Damage** 2E
- **Range** S/M
- **Ammo** Single use
- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $60

Designed for the U1 grenade launcher, the High Explosive Dual Purpose M40 can also be used as a hand grenade. To use these U1 rounds as a thrown explosive, the red plastic cap must be removed and the trigger under it depressed. Three seconds later, the grenade will explode. The UPP has an equivalent made by Norcomm.

G2 ELECTROSHOCK GRENADE

- **Modifier** –
- **Damage** 2E (stun)
- **Range** S/M
- **Ammo** Single use
- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $400

These grenades are called "electronic ballbreakers" with good reason. When deployed, they propel themselves about a meter off the ground before releasing a mega-voltage electric pulse. The usually non-lethal shock is still strong enough to freeze a person's central nervous system.

These weapons are good for crowd control. When there is only one seat left on the last shuttle to leave a space station stuck in a decaying orbit around a gas giant, pop a few of these puppies into the mob, cycle that airlock closed, and strap yourself in for the ride home.

Hand Grenade: The stats above are for when using the G2 as a hand grenade.

COMBAT KNIFE

- **Modifier** +1
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** A/A
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $50

FIRE AXE

- **Modifier** –
- **Damage** 2
- **Range** A/A
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $60
- **Special** Armor piercing

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SEISMIC SURVEY CHARGE

Modifier	–
Damage	3E
Range	S/M
Ammo	Single use
Weight	1
Cost	$200

These powerful explosive charges are used to perform seismic surveys on newly colonized worlds but can also be used as weapons in a clinch.

STUN BATON

Modifier	+1
Damage	1 (stun)
Range	A/A
Power	2
Weight	1
Cost	$80

Basically a cattle prod, these electro-shock devices are designed to keep pests and livestock in order on the Frontier. While the charge isn't strong enough to kill a human, a touch can incapacitate the target. If you see something lurking underfoot, hit it with it. Shouldn't damage the little bastard, unless its skin is thinner than ours...

CUTTING TORCH

Modifier	–1
Damage	3
Range	A/A
Power	3
Weight	1
Cost	$300
Special	Armor piercing

A utilitarian blowtorch used for both welding and cutting through metal. In a pinch, a cutting torch can be used as a weapon. The Rexim EVA pistol started life as a laser cutting torch. You want to stay alive? You need to improvise.

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)

OTHER GEAR

SUITS & ARMOR

TO PROTECT YOURSELF from damage and the cold vacuum of space, you want to wear the right suit or armor. Armor is explained on page 67 and air supply on page 28.

M3 PERSONNEL ARMOR

- **Armor Level** 2
- **Air Supply** –
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $1,200
- **Special** Comm unit, PDT.

Standard issue for the USCMC, the M3 consists of a rigid armor padded vest, a flexible ballistic pad that covers the abdomen, and clamshell greaves on the lower legs. The armor protects against edged weapons and explosions, but not direct hits from high powered ammunition. It has a built-in comm unit and Personal Data Transmitter, combat webbing straps to connect a variety of equipment, and contact points which monitor the wearer's vitals and transmit them to a tactical monitoring station.

KEVLAR RIOT VEST

- **Armor Level** 1
- **Air Supply** –
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $600

A relatively lightweight vest made of woven synthetic fibers, the kevlar riot vest is the personal armor of choice for law enforcement and security details throughout the colonies.

IRC MK.50 COMPRESSION SUIT

- **Armor Level** –
- **Air Supply** 5
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $4,000
- **Special** Vacuum protection, comm unit, head light, –1 to **MOBILITY** rolls.

State of the art when it was introduced six decades ago, the reliable Mk.50 Compression Suit is still a common sight on the Frontier. The sturdy helmet has a comm unit and heads-up display, a lateral head light, and a wireless helmet cam that syncs to any mobile or stationary monitoring system. The suit carries a healthy supply of oxygen and maintains internal pressure for its wearer while in a vacuum. If you are going to get blown out into space, you want to be in a Mk.50.

IRC MK.35 PRESSURE SUIT

- **Armor Level** 1
- **Air Supply** 4
- **Weight** 2
- **Cost** $2,000
- **Special** Vacuum protection, –2 to **MOBILITY** rolls.

Standard issue for the USCMC, the Mk.35 is an unfortunately bulky combat pressure suit with a cumbersome recycler unit. You want to be careful wearing one of these in a fight, as the hard joints tend to seize up with extreme motion. While the inexpensive suit offers full protection from the vacuum of space, you have to spend time in a decompression chamber after spacewalking in one. Basically, this suit sucks, but if the choice is a Mk.35 or the cold of space, shut up and suit up.

ECO ALL-WORLD SURVIVAL SUIT

- **Armor Level** 2
- **Air Supply** 6
- **Weight** 2
- **Cost** $30,000
- **Special** Vacuum protection, comm unit, head light, +2 to **MOBILITY** for movement in zero-G

This EVA hardsuit has fully-articulated rotary joints and self-actuating fingers, offering a limited range of mobility, but the maximum amount of protection from the hazards of space. The helmet has a sophisticated heads-up display built in, and the suit has its own thrusters for tether-free zero-G maneuvers. The comm array on a standard Eco EVA Suit is unshielded, and thus sensitive to rogue transmissions.

WEYLAND-YUTANI APESUIT

- **Armor Level** 1
- **Air Supply** 4
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $5,000
- **Special** Armor level 3 against acid, protects wearer against facehugs (page 213), **SURVIVAL** +2

The All Purpose Environment Suit is specialized, armored compression garb designed for combat and animal control under adverse environmental conditions. While an APEsuit cannot protect you from the vacuum of space, it does offer a limited air supply and armor, resistance to temperature extremes, and is impervious to caustic substances.

The helmet includes protective eyewear and a mask to protect the wearer's face. The suit is commonly worn by Weyland-Yutani's security commandos and "Dog Catcher" units to contain hostile organisms, so if you see a bunch of guys show up wearing these, get the hell out of there – because what they are looking for just might find you.

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P-5000 POWERED WORK LOADER

- **Armor Level** 1
- **Air Supply** –
- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $50,000
- **Special** Requires skill level 2 or more in **HEAVY MACHINERY** to be used. +3 dice to **HEAVY MACHINERY** and **CLOSE COMBAT**, base damage rating 3 in close combat attacks.

Commonly called a power loader, this mechanized exoskeleton power frame is used to transfer cargo as well as perform welding and other repairs. The exosuit amplifies your strength tenfold and is equipped with hydraulic claws for lifting and grasping.

A roll cage protects your face while you operate one, and a webbed harness keeps you strapped in in case you take a tumble. The P-5000 is difficult to master, but a pro can make operating it seem as simple as walking. Many variants exist, including a weaponized version and a wheeled work loader for larger loads.



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

COMPUTER MAINFRAMES

ALTHOUGH THERE ARE MANY TYPES of computers in use throughout the territories, there are two major master systems in use on the Frontier.

MU/TH/UR 6000

- **Skills** **COMTECH** 5, **PILOTING** 5, **OBSERVATION** 5
- **Cost** $2,500,000

MU/TH/UR 6500

- **Skills** **COMTECH** 7, **PILOTING** 5, **OBSERVATION** 6
- **Cost** $3,500,000

MU/TH/UR 7000

- **Skills** **COMTECH** 7, **PILOTING** 6, **OBSERVATION** 7
- **Cost** $5,000,000

MU/TH/UR 9000

- **Skills** **COMTECH** 10, **PILOTING** 8, **OBSERVATION** 10, **RANGED COMBAT** 9
- **Cost** $50,000,000

Most starships, space stations, and military facilities are run via a sophisticated computer system called MU/TH/UR. Originally developed by Weyland Corporation at the end of the 21st century, the MU/TH/UR system soon became the standard for running complex automated systems and facilities.

Affectionately nicknamed "Mother" by the crews who utilize these computers, over the decades various models have sported different levels of AI packages. While both the MU/TH/UR 1000 and 9000 series are sophisticated interactive models that over time can develop rudimentary personalities, most military, cargo, and utilitarian craft of today are equipped with the standard 5000 through 8000 series.

"Mother? I've turned the cooling units back on. MOTHER?"

[Ship will automatically destruct in T-minus 5 minutes.]

"You BITCH!"

Lt. Ellen Ripley vs. MU/TH/UR 6000

While these machines can communicate through the ship's intercom system, most of them can only be directly accessed through the computer core. Card and punch code entry to this secure and static free chamber is only granted to the vessel's commanding officer. The computer core also allows the commanding officer to issue alternate commands and overrides to "Mother's" automated routine.

A.P.O.L.L.O.

- **Skills** **COMTECH** 5, **PILOTING** 4, **OBSERVATION** 5
- **Cost** $2,000,000

Seegson's answer to MU/TH/UR, A.P.O.L.L.O. was designed to coordinate Seegson's Working Joe synthetics to run a starship. In all other regards it is less advanced than the MU/TH/UR models.

DATA STORAGE

ALONG WITH A GUM WRAPPER and a few dirty tissues, people always need to carry information in their pocket. In the 22nd century, that is usually accomplished in the following ways.

LONG-DATA DISCS

- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $5,000
- **Effect** Holds up to 10 zettabytes (ZB) of data.

After several data losses from electromagnetic pulses in the first half of the 21st century, the move was made to reintroduce and reinforce physical data storage. Weyland Corp scientists took optical disc media and enhanced it to the next level. The result is a nano-optical long-data memory disc. All colony and corporate records are backed up on these discs in case of an electromagnetic discharge.

Standard Access

Both MU/TH/UR and A.P.O.L.L.O. are capable of issuing reports and updates to the entire crew, as well as providing an analysis of any situation upon request through a standard terminal. A ship's or installation's commanding officer and science and/or medical officer often have better interface privileges. Whichever system is in use, both MU/TH/UR and A.P.O.L.L.O.'s computing power can be used to assist with most mission based issues that arise.

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DIAGNOSTICS & DISPLAY

MAGNETIC TAPE

- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $5
- **Effect** Holds up to 120 terabytes (TB) of data.

A two-hundred-year-old technology, magnetic tape cassettes have become popular on the Frontier simply because they are both disposable and cheap. Utilizing sputter deposition technology, these cassettes can hold between 60, 90, or 120 terabytes (TB) of information each.

While easily disrupted by a strong magnetic pulse, the benefit of magnetic tapes is that the archaic technology that runs them produces no easily detected wave signals. Most security sensor grids are set to detect more sophisticated electronic hardware. All these factors combined have managed to keep magnetic tapes in vogue for the past fifty years.

COMPUTER TERMINAL

- **Weight** N/A
- **Cost** Varies
- **Effect** Access and process data (**COMTECH** roll).

A computer terminal is any colony, starship, or station based electronic hardware that can access and process data via keyboard or voice commands and monitor, or hologram. Using the right codes and **COMTECH** rolls at a terminal can potentially give you access to whatever MU/TH/UR or A.P.O.L.L.O. knows.

SAMANI E-SERIES WATCH

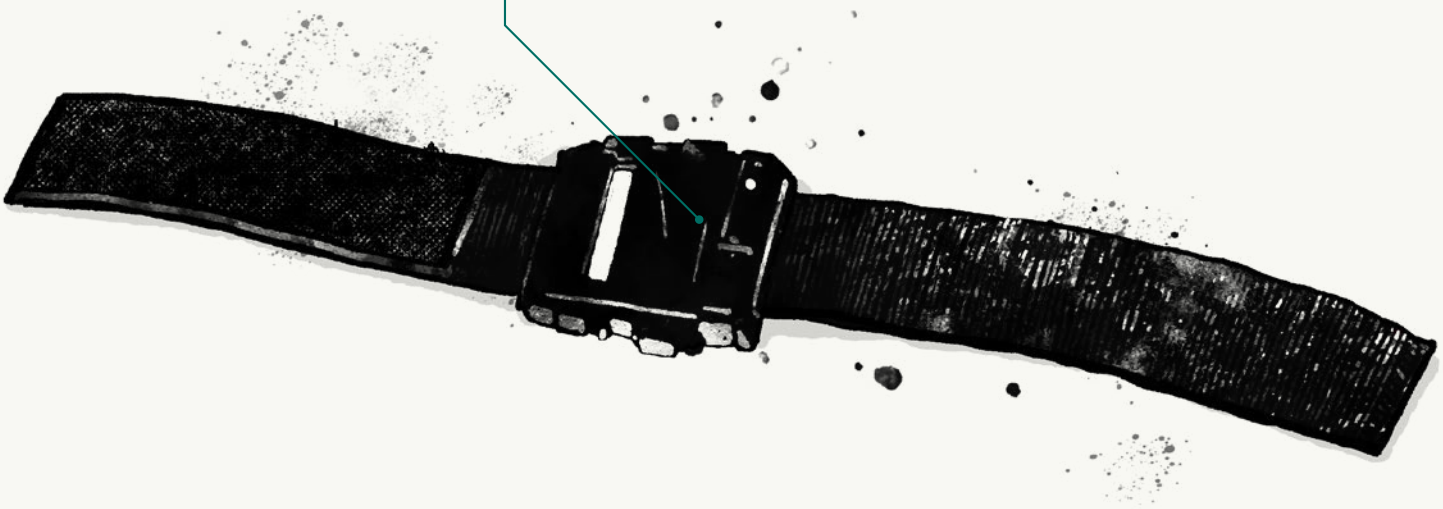
- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $50
- **Effect** Tracks time, oxygen, and pressure levels (**SURVIVAL** +1).

A dual-faced precision wristwatch, each Samani E-series device is capable of telling the time and date for two synchronized colonial locations, allowing space travelers to keep track of time back home while they are in deep space. The latest addition, the E-550, includes oxygen and pressure sensors to warn its user of a hull breach.

PERSONAL DATA TRANSMITTER

- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $100
- **Effect** Monitors location and vitals (**MEDICAL AID** +1).

These “PDTs” transmit the recipient’s location. Some models also monitor vital signs. Most corporate sponsored Frontier worlds equip their colonists with PDTs in order to keep track of them in hostile environments. PDTs can be surgically implanted, built into a pressure suit, or worn as an accessory.



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DIAGNOSTICS & DISPLAY CONT.

IFF TRANSPONDER

- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $250
- **Effect** Prevents Sentry Gun friendly fire.

A personal beacon that prevents automated sentry systems from accidentally blowing friendly targets to pieces. Usually surgically implanted before a campaign, the only flaws in the system are when their signal is disrupted and when an enemy gets their hands on a transceiver for infiltration purposes. How is this accomplished if IFFs are surgically implanted? You'd be amazed what a good sharp knife can do.

DATA TRANSMITTER CARDS

- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $50
- **Effect** Transfer of audiovisual data (**COMTECH** +1).

DTCs are small clear plastic data transmitter cards that plug into a variety of recording equipment, such as the built-in visual and audio recorders on a space suit helmet. They wirelessly transmit data to the terminal they are synced to. Information captured by the device can be analyzed by a MU/TH/UR or A.P.O.L.L.O. system or displayed on a HoloTab.

HOLOTAB

- **Weight** N/A
- **Cost** $100,000
- **Effect** Strategic analysis platform (**OBSERVATION** and **COMMAND** +2).

A high-end strategic and analysis platform, a HoloTab – or Holographic Display Table – takes scanned live or recorded information fed to it and generates a three dimensional hologram of the subject. A HoloTab is usually used in conjunction with pre-existing maps or in coordination with PDTs and Parameter Uplink Spectrograph hardware.

SEEGSON P-DAT

- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $500
- **Effect** Coordinate info for field teams (**COMMAND** +1).

A personal data tablet, a P-DAT can be synced with Spectrograph Mapping Devices, PDTs, and helmet cams to coordinate a team on the go.

SEEGSON SYSTEM DIAGNOSTIC DEVICE

- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $300
- **Effect** Troubleshoot computer systems (**COMTECH** +2).

The SSDD is used to troubleshoot computer and mechanical systems aboard a space station or starship. A good engineer knows how to use these to hack doors and computer terminals – but you didn't read that here.

MODULAR COMPUTING DEVICE

- **Weight** N/A
- **Cost** $8,000
- **Effect** Full audiovisual holographic projector (**MANIPULATION** +2).

Perfected and manufactured by Weyland Corp in the 21st Century, a MCD is a high-end full audio/visual holographic projector. The holograms generated can fill a 6×6 m area and are completely immersive.

PR-PUT UPLINK TERMINAL

- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $9,000
- **Effect** Remote control spacecraft (**COMTECH** roll).

A military-grade armored and water-resistant laptop, this portable terminal has a built-in piloting joystick. With the right skills (**COMTECH** roll) and access codes, you can use a PR-PUT to patch into a colony uplink tower and remote pilot an orbiting ship.

COMM UNIT

- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $50
- **Effect** Enables remote team communication.

A basic radio headset for team communication, with a range of about 1 kilometer. A comm unit is included in several armors and environmental suits.

SEEGSON C-SERIES MAGNETIC TAPE RECORDER

- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $80
- **Effect** Record and play music (**MANIPULATION** +1).

An "old tech" portable audio recorder used to record or play music and audio logs. Popular models include the classic C-24 ka-boombox and the just released portable C-60 "spacewalkman." Now when you go EVA you can bring your country blues with you.

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

VISION DEVICES

FLASHLIGHT

- **Range** Short
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $40
- **Effect** Removes the effect of darkness in a zone.

Can be carried separately or attached to a ranged weapon.

OPTICAL SCOPE

- **Range** +1
- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $60
- **Effect** Increases the range of a pistol or rifle by one category but only for aimed shots.

These come in a variety of flavors, including laser-guided green.

BINOCULARS

- **Range** Extreme
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $100
- **Effect** **OBSERVATION** +2 at Long range or more.

Can be equipped with rangefinders or night vision technology.

M314 MOTION TRACKER

- **Range** Long
- **Power** 5
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $1,200
- **Effect** Detects motion in stealth mode (page 58).

A motion-scanning device, the M314 uses high-powered ultrasonic waves to detect movement within its sensor range. Originally designed for rescue teams searching for civilians, the tracker soon found use by the military fighting guerrilla forces in extrasolar environments.

M316 MOTION TRACKER

- **Range** Medium
- **Power** 3
- **Weight** –
- **Cost** $3,000
- **Effect** Detects motion in stealth mode (page 58).

The drawback to the M314 is its size and weight. An experimental pulse rifle mounted upgrade, the M316, is currently being field tested. It is compact, lightweight and easy to glance at in a firefight. While the M316 operates about the same as the M314, it has a much more limited range. Your results may vary, but that's what you grunts are for – cannon fodder to help the corporations figure out how to perfect their new toys.

NEURO VISOR

- **Range** Long
- **Power** 5
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $10,000
- **Effect** Monitor or interact with hypersleep patient (**COMTECH** roll).

A neuro visor is a helmet with a HUD visor that allows an operator to monitor and interface with the subconscious and dreams of a subject in stasis. A skilled user can also use a neurovisor to communicate with a hyper sleeping subject, and an advanced user can use one to manipulate one's dreams. So the next time you go into hypersleep, keep those dreams clean – your supervisor could be watching.

SEEGSON MICROVIEW-2000SE

- **Range** Extreme
- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $250
- **Effect** Tracks current location.

A navigational map system used on space stations, the Microview 2000SE uses the device's coordinates aboard the station to determine that "You are Here" at all times – wherever here is at the time.

PARAMETER UPLINK SPECTOGRAPH MAPPING DEVICE

- **Range** Extreme
- **Power** 5
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $50,000
- **Effect** Scans one zone per stretch in stealth mode, automatically detects enemies unless hidden.

Sometimes called "Pups," these cost-prohibitive mapping devices have been in use for a good hundred years. Pups employ limited anti-gravity propulsion to float through, across, and over otherwise difficult to navigate terrain.

As these orbs scout about, they constantly scan a 360-degree area around the device with mapping lasers. The Pups then send the spectrograph information back to a synced device, usually a starship or ground-based HoloTab or a monitoring station in a mobile command vehicle. They can also detect life-forms, atmospheric conditions, toxins, and more.

Pups were given their nickname because they emit a haunting, hound-like howling sound as they seek and scan.

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TOOLS

WATATSUMI DV-303 BOLT GUN

- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $400
- **Effect** Ship repairs (**HEAVY MACHINERY** +2).

A construction tool using expanding bolts to make emergency hull repairs. Can be used as a weapon (page 83).

MAINTENANCE JACK

- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $150
- **Effect** **HEAVY MACHINERY** +1 in relevant situations.

A common tool used to open unpowered airlocks and divert power to or from electrical junction boxes. Can be used as a weapon (bonus +1, base damage 1).

MECHANICAL CUTTING TORCH

- **Power** 3
- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $300
- **Effect** Construction and repairs (**HEAVY MACHINERY** +2).

A utilitarian blowtorch used for both welding and cutting through metal. Can be used as a weapon (page 89).

POWER CELL

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $30
- **Effect** Restores full power supply to one item.

Needed to recharge motion trackers and other electric gear.

MEDICAL SUPPLIES

PERSONAL MEDKIT

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $50
- **Effect** **MEDICAL AID** +2 for giving first aid (single use).

A personal medkit contains what you need to stop bleeding, disinfect a wound and cauterize it, some Pharmax bandages to wrap it up and a stim boost to keep you on your feet. A Medkit is not a permanent solution, it's more of a band aid to keep your guts from spilling out until you reach an AutoDoc.

AUTODOC

- **Weight** N/A
- **Cost** $500,000
- **Effect** Can give first aid (but not treat critical injuries that require surgerys) with **MEDICAL AID** skill level 8 (the roll cannot be pushed).

Not everyone can afford a Pauling MedPod, but almost every ship, station, and colony has at least one AutoDoc. Essentially a poor man's version of a Pauling, the AutoDoc is an automated medical treatment device that diagnoses and treats lesser wounds and infections. It is not capable of complicated surgery, but it can reset broken bones.

ELECTRONIC TOOLS

- **Weight** ½
- **Cost** $250
- **Effect** **COMTECH** +1 in relevant situations.

A tool used for repairing or rewiring electronics.

SURGICAL KIT

- **Weight** 1
- **Cost** $200
- **Effect** **MEDICAL AID** +2 for first aid and surgery on critical injuries, base damage 2 if used as a weapon.

These nasty-looking instruments can mean life or death – in either the hands of a surgeon or a killer. While they are intended to save lives, in a pinch they can make for great cutting weapons.

PAULING MEDPOD

- **Weight** N/A
- **Cost** $2,000,000
- **Effect** Can give first aid and perform surgery with **MEDICAL AID** skill level 12 (the roll cannot be pushed).

If you are going to get nearly dead, do it near a Pauling. The answer to space medicine, the Pauling MedPod is an autonomous medical scanner and surgical unit capable of performing bypass surgery. The Pauling MedPod can diagnose and treat infections through concentrated antibiotic injections. It can perform basic wound repair and pre-programmed surgical procedures such as an appendectomy, laparoscopic ablation and cesarean section. All models of the Pauling MedPod feature an airtight operating shield, comfortable limb restraints, a laser scalpel, computer controlled robotic surgical arms, liquid spray anesthetic and vital signs sensors, all mounted on an adjustable titanium base.

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PHARMACEUTICALS

THERE ARE A NUMBER of prescribed and under the table drugs that are common on the Frontier. Costs are per dose, and each dose is a tiny item.

NEVERSLEEP PILLS

▶ **Cost** $2
▶ **Effect** Stress level +1 but removes the need for sleep for a day, during which you cannot relieve stress (page 73).

Fast-acting supplement that keeps you going well past your bedtime. Excessive use can cause stroke or heart attack.

HYDR8TION

▶ **Cost** $5
▶ **Effect** Eliminates fatigue from hypersleep (page 75).

An electrolyte solution that counteracts the dehydrating effects of hypersleep (page 110), Hydr8tion is one of the few pharmaceuticals of the space age with no side effects.

NAPROLEVE

▶ **Cost** $20
▶ **Effect** Reduces stress level to zero. Each dose beyond the first in the same shift gives −1 dice to all skill rolls until the end of the shift.

An injectable instant pain reliever for all strains, stresses, and irritations. Recommended for use during any self-inflicted cesarean performed to extract an unconventional fetus from your womb. Warning: an overdose of Naproleve can have an intoxicating effect.

Michael Syrett (Order: 5315103)

FOOD & DRINK

PREFAB MEALS

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $10
- **Effect** Satisfies food needs for one day.

The average meal in space is pre-prepped flash-frozen rations. Typical meals aboard a starship include pastas, cereals, freeze-dried vegetables, stews, meatloaf and something resembling cornbread. Corporations make their employees pay for these prefab meals, despite the fact that there are few, if any, other choices and the workers are in space on company time.

CANDY BAR

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $15
- **Effect** Satisfies food needs for one day.

Luxury items on the Frontier, these guilty pleasures can give you a sugar rush if you need it.

WATER BOTTLE

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $2– $100
- **Effect** Satisfies water needs for one day.

Shipboard company supplied water ($2) is rationed, cloudy, recycled, and tastes metallic, but gets you through the day. Bottles of purified water ($10) are luxury items on some worlds, and can fetch as much as $100/bottle on a barren rock.

COFFEE

- **Weight** –
- **Cost** Free–$1.50
- **Effect** Stress level +1 and postpones fatigue from lack of sleep for one shift. Additional doses in the same shift have no effect.

Coffee is supplied on most company ships and stations free of charge for the crew. Grown in Guatemala on Earth, Weyland-Yutani coffee is the highest rated in the territories, and free coffee is considered one of the perks of W-Y employment. If you are on the verge of dozing off, coffee can give you a caffeine boost to get you through the morning.

"BUG JUICE" PROTEIN DRINK

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $5
- **Effect** Satisfies food and water needs for one day.

Commonly referred to as "bug juice," this high protein caloric drink is made from mealworms, roaches, beetles, and other insects all raised on bug farms. Made by a large variety of manufacturers, it is a cheap and cost-effective way of keeping alive on the Frontier.

COLONY SPECIALTY MEALS

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $20–$300
- **Effect** Satisfies food needs for one day, stress level –1.

Planetside colony grub can be a better thing, as colonists get creative with their rations to create new "culinary delights." Some colonies grow their own livestock while others have access to edible indigenous wildlife, creating a wide variety of cuisine ranging from Terraform 3's bovine burgers and steaks to boiled Tanakan scorpion thorax to kelp salad and sushi from Bracken's World.

BEER AND BOOZE

- **Weight** ¼
- **Cost** $5–$500
- **Effect** Stress level –1. Each dose beyond the first in the same shift gives –1 dice to all skill rolls until the end of the shift.

Time to get your buzz on. Alcohol remains the old go to, with whiskey and vodka dominating the market. The beer of choice on the frontier is Weyland-Yutani's original and genuine "extra strong" Aspen beer. It's watered down and tastes like piss but it gets the job done – and it's better than that Souta Dry crap.

RECREATIONAL DRUGS

- **Cost** Varies from $5 for a pack of cigarettes to $60,000 for a kilo of benzoylecgonine.
- **Effect** Typically stress level +1 or –1. Each dose beyond the first in the same shift gives –1 dice to all skill rolls until the end of the shift.

Get 'recked. Cannabis, tobacco, and certain doses of steroids, benzodiazepines and methylene-dioxymethamphetamine are all legal drugs prescribed for recreational use by corporate physicians.

X-DRUGS

- **Cost** Varies
- **Effect** Varies

These are the more extreme drugs out there that most ethical corporations work to keep off their colonies. These X-drugs increase strength, endurance, and the senses, but prolonged use can result in severe side effects such as hallucinations, seizures, psychosis, and stroke. The Colonial Marine Corps is rumored to be experimenting with new powerful X-Stims for its soldiers.

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VEHICLES

ENTER DARK, CREEPY PLACE. Get ambushed. Set something to blow up and fight your way out. Grab the keys, hop in your ride and drive. Fast. Shit, something is hiding in the goddamn trunk! What now? That's your problem – this section covers what you're driving, not how to kill monsters. While the listings below are far from exhaustive, they provide a nice cross section of what people are using to get around planetside on the Frontier. Just make sure you keep that trunk locked.

Vehicle Features

This list is a heads-up on the features used in the vehicle listings.

- **Encountered:** Where the vehicle is likely to be encountered.
- **Length:** The length of the vehicle, in meters.
- **Passengers:** The number of people that can ride in the vehicle, excluding the driver.
- **Maneuverability:** A modifier to your **PILOTING** rolls when performing challenging maneuvers.
- **Speed:** The speed of the vehicle, in number of zones per driving action.
- **Hull:** How much damage the vehicle can take before becoming wrecked.
- **Armor:** The armor level of the vehicle.
- **Weapons:** The typical armaments mounted on the vehicle, if any. See the list on page 313 for stats.
- **Cost:** The typical price in W-Y dollars. The actual price varies depending on the local supply and demand.

"It's a good thing you're driving and not the old man."
"Hey, a little less of the old man, sweet tits."
"Hey! Language, language. Be respectful, there, sugar dick."

Upworth, Tennessee and Faris

WEYLAND NR-9 SERIES ALL TERRAIN VEHICLE

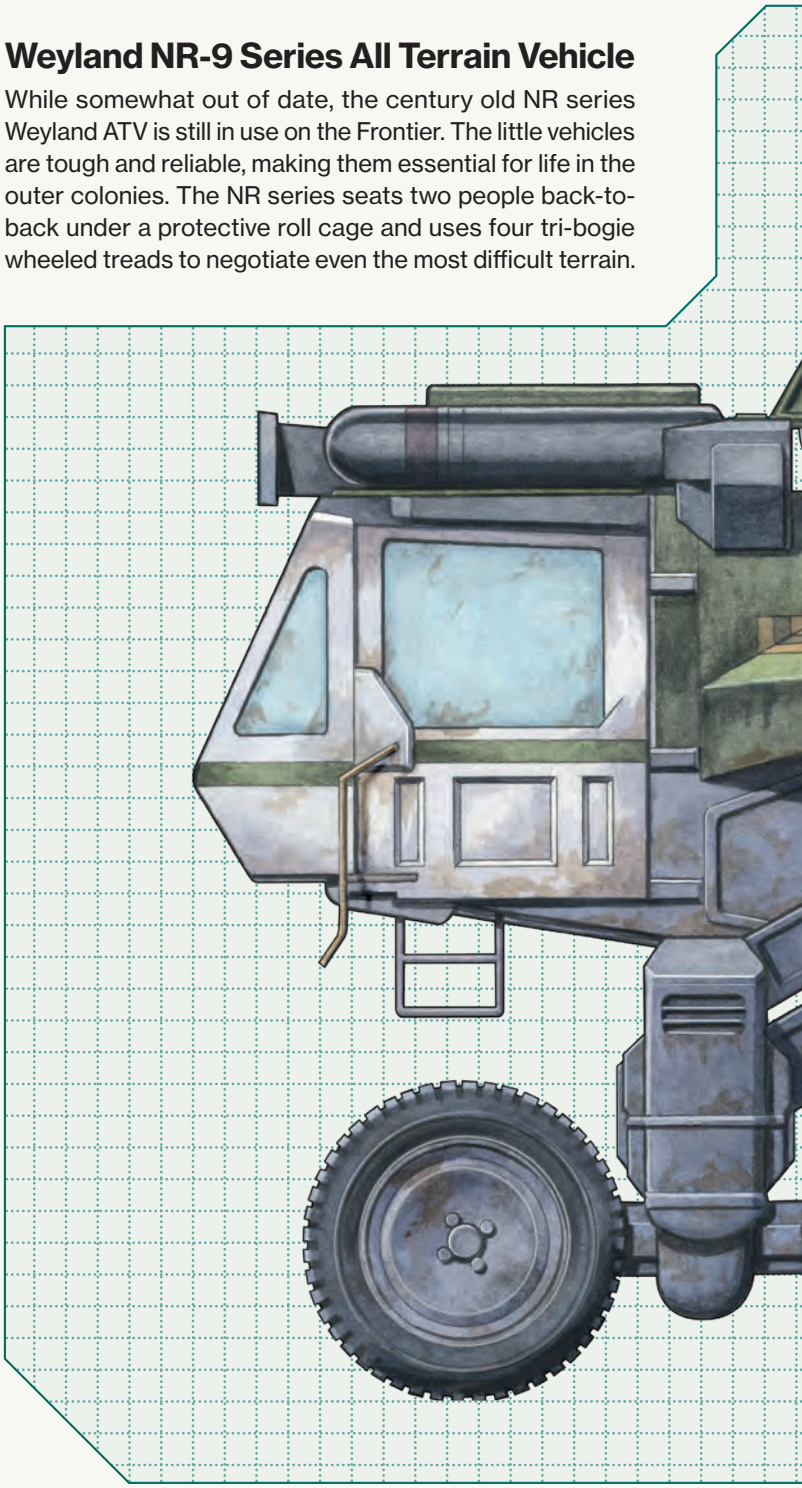
- **Encountered** Frontier Colonies

Length	3.2 m	**Hull**	2
Passengers	1	**Armor**	1*
Maneuverability	+2	**Weapons**	–
Speed	2	**Cost**	$3,000

*The driver and passenger are exposed and can be targeted separately, without protection from armor.

Weyland NR-9 Series All Terrain Vehicle

While somewhat out of date, the century old NR series Weyland ATV is still in use on the Frontier. The little vehicles are tough and reliable, making them essential for life in the outer colonies. The NR series seats two people back-to-back under a protective roll cage and uses four tri-bogie wheeled treads to negotiate even the most difficult terrain.



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DAIHOTAI SERIES 8×8 TRACTOR

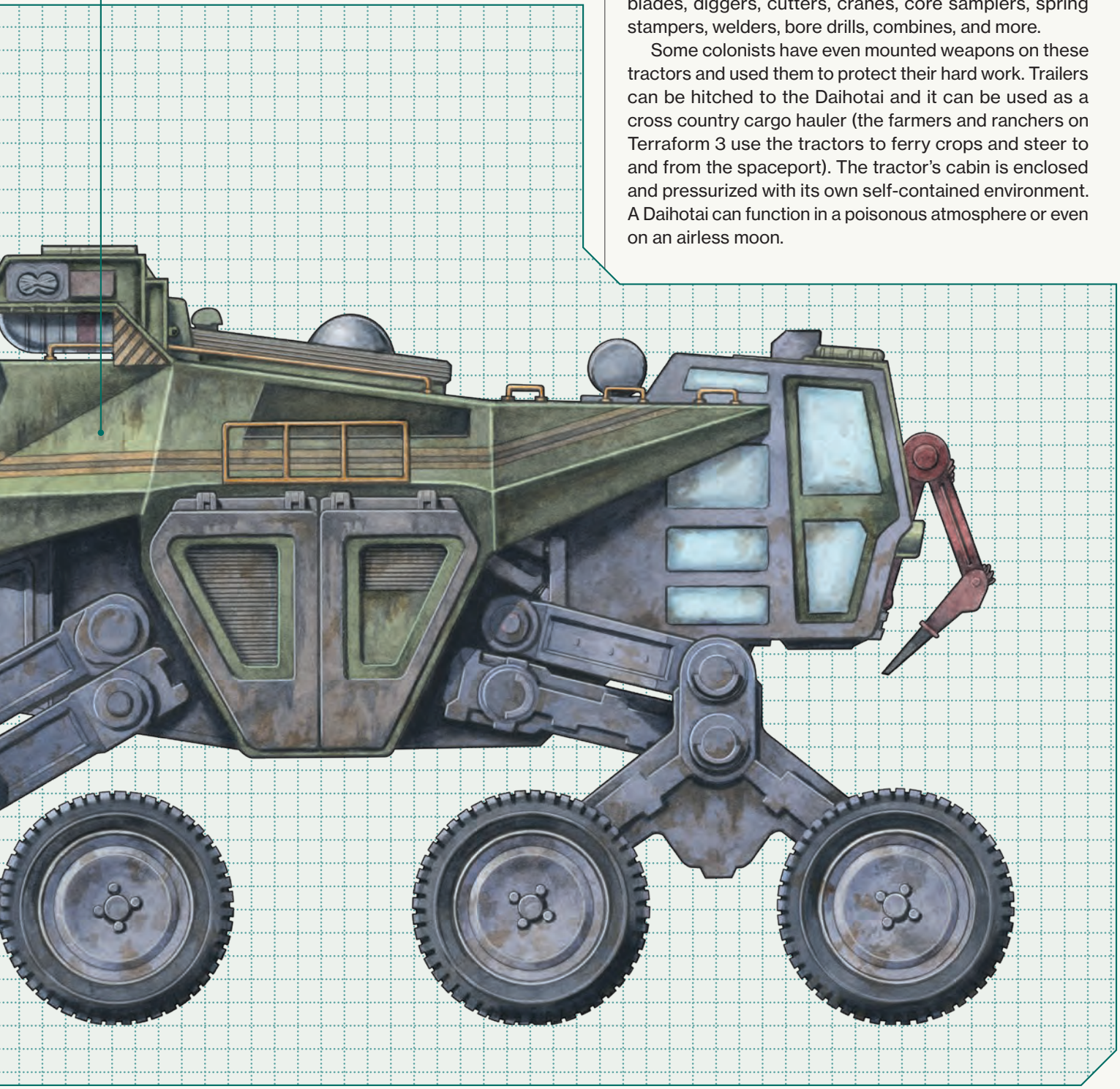
- **Encountered** Frontier Colonies

Length	6.6 m	**Hull**	6
Passengers	4	**Armor**	3
Maneuverability	–	**Weapons**	–
Speed	2	**Cost**	$17,000

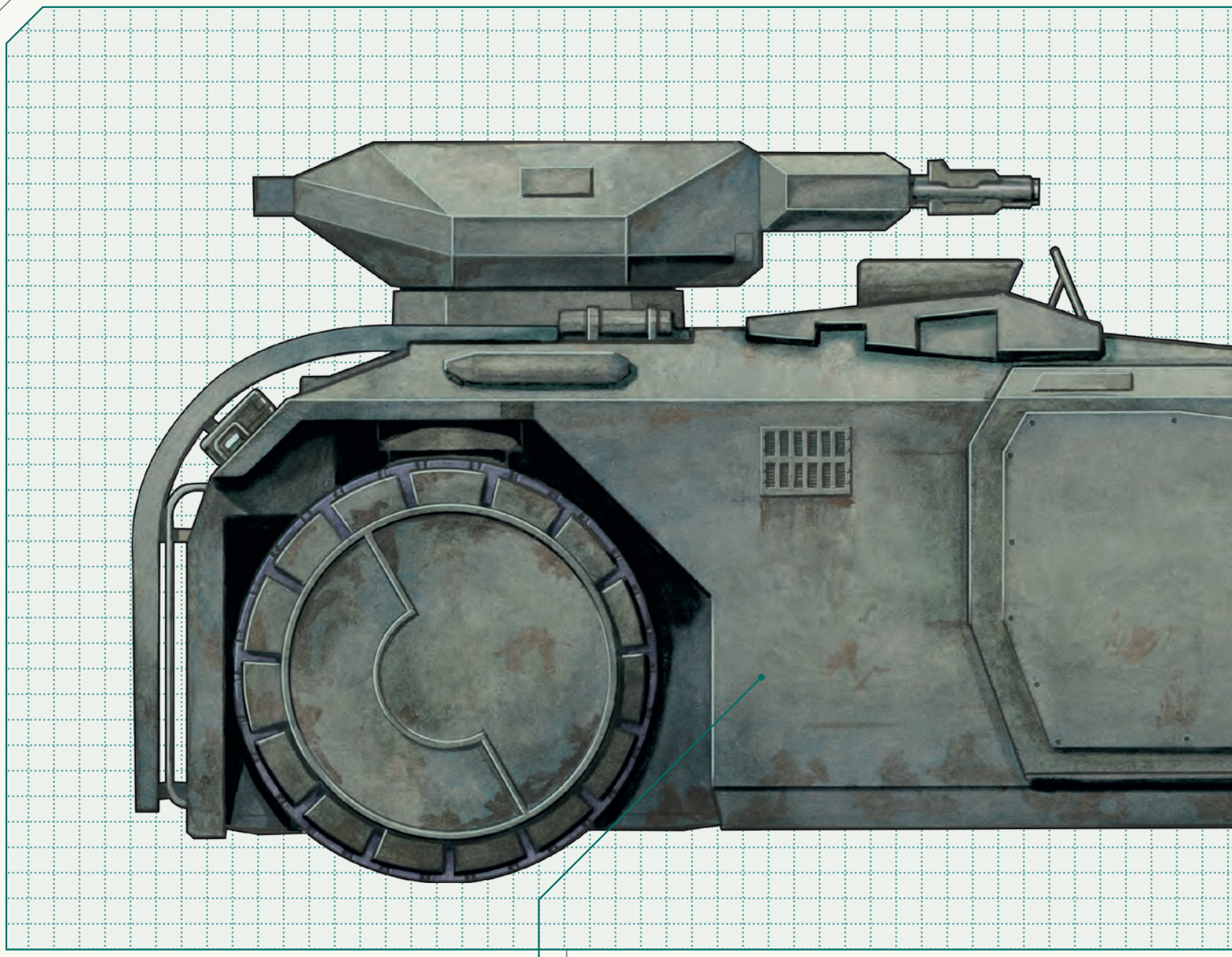
Daihotai Series 8×8 Tractor

An all-purpose work vehicle designed for the rough and tumble Frontier, the Daihotai series of tractors are completely adaptable to the needs of most down and dirty colonies. The Daihotai's eight-wheel suspension offers a relatively smooth ride over all but the most serious of bumps. These modular tractors can be fitted with bulldozer blades, diggers, cutters, cranes, core samplers, spring stampers, welders, bore drills, combines, and more.

Some colonists have even mounted weapons on these tractors and used them to protect their hard work. Trailers can be hitched to the Daihotai and it can be used as a cross country cargo hauler (the farmers and ranchers on Terraform 3 use the tractors to ferry crops and steer to and from the spaceport). The tractor's cabin is enclosed and pressurized with its own self-contained environment. A Daihotai can function in a poisonous atmosphere or even on an airless moon.



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M570 SERIES ARMORED PERSONNEL CARRIER

- **Encountered** USCMC battlefields and military bases across the Frontier and Outer Rim

Length	9.2 m	**Speed**	3
Passengers	13	**Hull**	8
Maneuverability	+1	**Armor**	5
Weapons		**Cost**	$500,000

Phased Plasma Pulse Cannon Turret
20 mm Gatling Gun Turret

M570 Series Armored Personnel Carrier

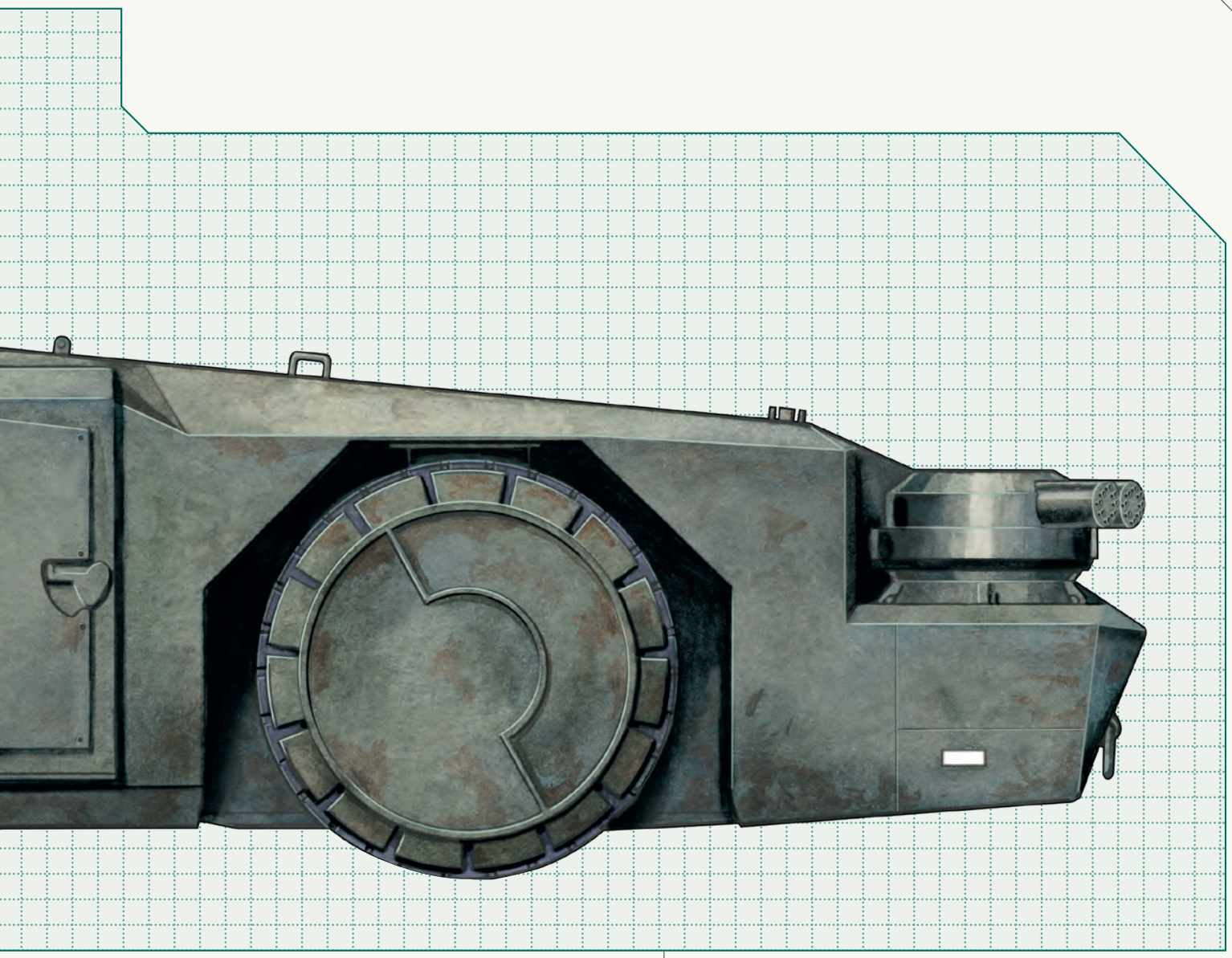
The standard ground transport of the USCMC, the M570 series APC carries a full marine squad into battle. Its interior is equipped with a tactical command center with links to each soldier's helmet cams and biosigns. The exterior is armored with a laser absorbing paint job.

In addition to chaff launchers and a small front mounted turret, the M570 mounts a rotating main weapons package on a rail system that allows it to slide back and store in the rear of the vehicle when not in use, thus lowering the APC's profile and heat signature.

The air pressure in its large, armored wheels is controlled by the driver in order to facilitate better traction over soft terrain and allow the vehicle's chassis some additional clearance over rough ground – its low profile is perhaps the APC's biggest weakness. Put a reckless driver behind the wheel in a rocky environment and you are likely to blow the transaxle.

The amphibious and vacuum tight APC is designed to be carried in the vehicle bay of a Cheyenne dropship, allowing it to be deployed nearly anywhere. While the M577 is the standard APC seen on the Rim, there are variants with different weapons configurations.

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AERODYNE LIGHT VTOL AUTOMOTIVE GYROCAR

- **Encountered** Densely populated Core and Outer Veil Colonies

Length	5.2 m	**Speed**	3
Passengers	5	**Hull**	4
Maneuverability	+3	**Armor**	1
Weapons	–	**Cost**	$40,000

Aerodyne Light VTOL Automotive Gyrocar

The gyrocar is a typical vertical takeoff and landing automobile found on the more civilized worlds of the Outer Veil and Core systems. There are various two- and four-door types and models ranging from luxury sports vehicles to the utilitarian. These microfusion reactor driven gyroscopic cars can operate as wheeled ground transports or utilize internal fans to generate air cushions with a maximum flight ceiling of 3,000 meters. Cameras offer a 360-degree view and a proximity alert protects against collisions.

Gyrocars require a lot of upkeep and are therefore a rare sight on the Frontier and Outer Rim. The USCMC experimental Hovertread V/STOL Light Assault Vehicle runs on a variation of this technology with retractable stabilizer wings and boogie-wheeled treads instead of standard wheels.

Licensed System (Order: 53.15.103)

UD-4 CHEYENNE SERIES VTOL TACTICAL DROPSHIP

▶ **Encountered** USCMC battlefields and military bases across the Frontier and Outer Rim. Some have made their way into mercenary hands as well.

▶ **Length**	25.2 m	▶ **Speed**	4
▶ **Passengers**	15	▶ **Hull**	10
▶ **Maneuverability**	+2	▶ **Armor**	4
▶ **Weapons**		▶ **Cost**	$3,100,000

25 mm Gatling Gun

Mk.16 150 mm Banshee 70 Unguided Rocket Launcher

7 × AGM-220C Hellhound II Tactical Missiles

3 × AIM-90E Headlock Air-to-Air Missiles

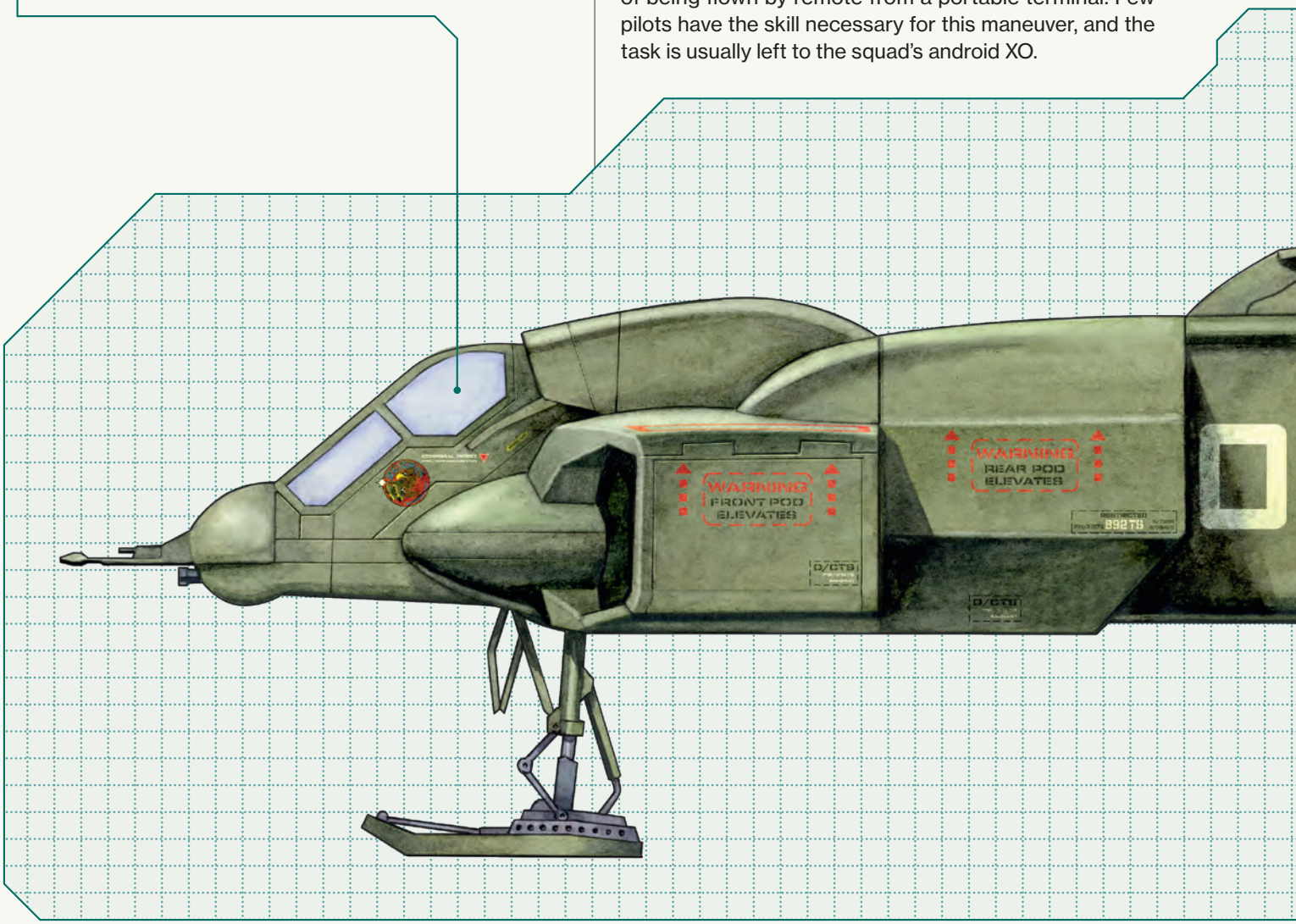
UD-4 Cheyenne Series VTOL Tactical Dropship

The pinnacle of USCMC battlefield supremacy, the Cheyenne dropship has an unparalleled success rate performing double duty as both a transport and gunship. While true gunships like the Tomahawk are more heavily armed and strikeships like the Cougar and Bearcat are more maneuverable, none have the versatility of the Cheyenne.

The Cheyenne are dropped from orbit into the fray from the ventral bay of any USCM frigate or carrier, swiftly descending through the atmosphere like a meteor. The current model has been specifically augmented to carry the M577 into a combat zone, deploy the APC and its marine squad, and immediately assume an air support role for the squad.

The ship is mostly a transport bay with cockpit, weapons systems, and engines attached – there is little in the way of other accommodations aboard. While in supersonic decent, the Cheyenne's weapons pods are retracted flush with its hull. These pods deploy for subsonic combat.

With a proper satellite uplink, the Cheyenne is capable of being flown by remote from a portable terminal. Few pilots have the skill necessary for this maneuver, and the task is usually left to the squad's android XO.



Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

WEYLAND-YUTANI WY-37B CARGO LIFTER TRANSPORT SLED

- **Encountered** Frontier colonies, starfreighters, and large space stations

Length	34.2 m	**Speed**	3
Passengers	3	**Hull**	12
Maneuverability	–1	**Armor**	2
Weapons	–	**Cost**	$800,000

"Personally, I wouldn't get near the cockpit of those things. Dropships can't maneuver for shit, but those Weyland shuttles are just fancy bricks. All you can do is aim them at the ground and hope the retros stop you before you bounce off."

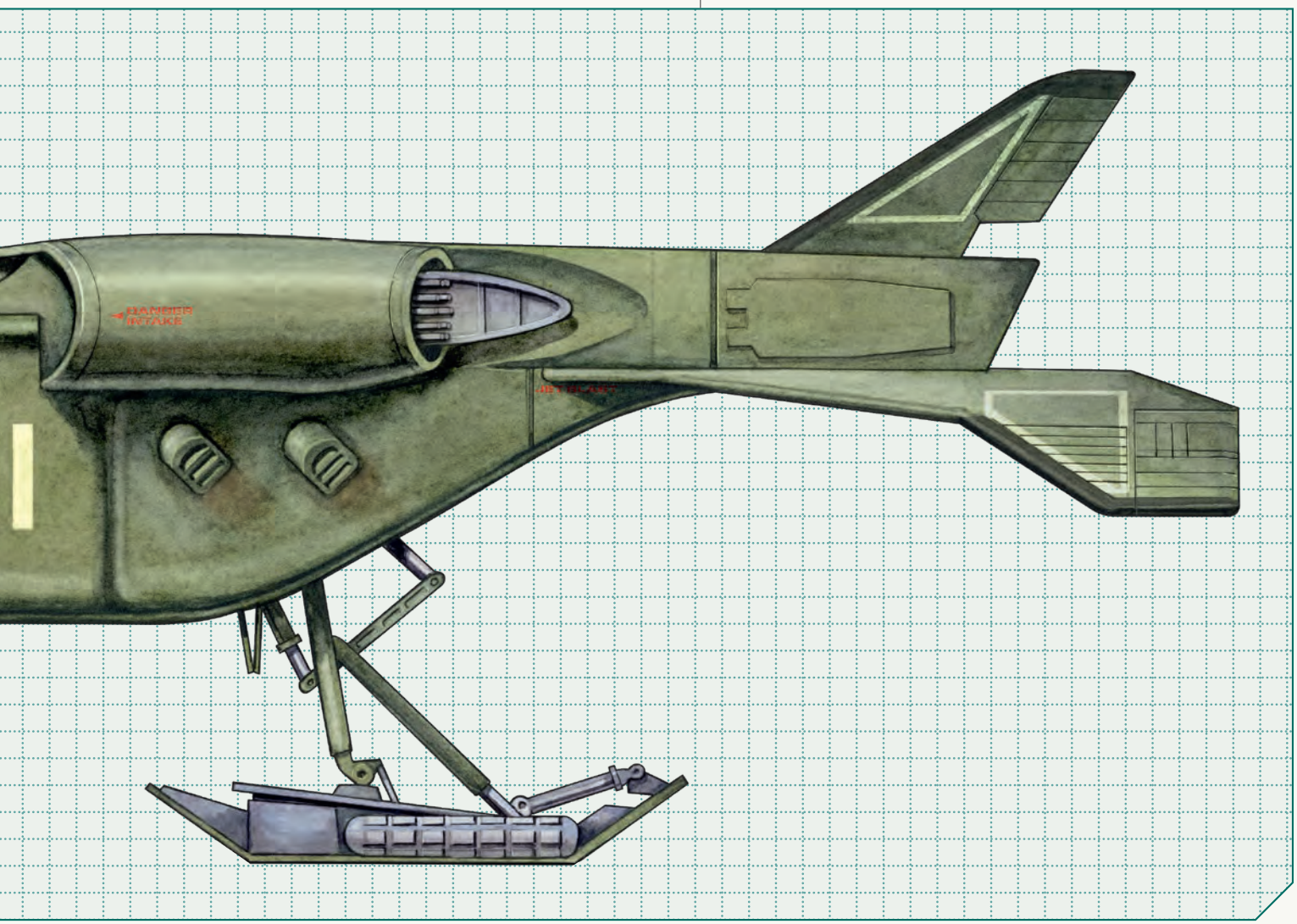
Lieutenant Feiyan Ko

Weyland-Yutani WY-37B Cargo Lifter Transport Sled

Sometimes you need to move cargo long distances planetside. The old but reliable Lifter is a flatbed sled with a crew cab, crane assembly, two high output engines and four oversized and overpowered articulated maneuvering thruster pods.

While not intended for deep space use, the Lifter's pressurized cab is rated for use in a vacuum and she is capable of making low orbit cargo transfers. Plates on the flatbed can be magnetized, and there are cargo clamp-down hardpoints at regular intervals across her hull. The Lifter's crew can use a safety harness and winch to exit the pressurized cab and perform emergency cargo balance adjustments while in flight.

The remote operated extendable crane assembly is folded flush to the hull for flight and can be equipped with a magnetic coupler, an excavator claw, hook and cable, or more. Just be warned: Deploying the crane in flight can cause the Lifter to destabilize and crash. Optimal piloting skills are preferred.



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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

CHAPTER 6

A HARD LIFE AMONGST THE STARS

"There are other worlds than this one, and if there is no air to breathe, we will simply have to make it."

Peter Weyland

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

LIVING IN SPACE AIN'T PRETTY. Human life is cheap and so are paychecks. There is always someone worse off, willing to do your job for even less, so you better not screw up. In most professions, having dirt on your employer or becoming an expert in a field are the only ways to maintain any semblance of job security.

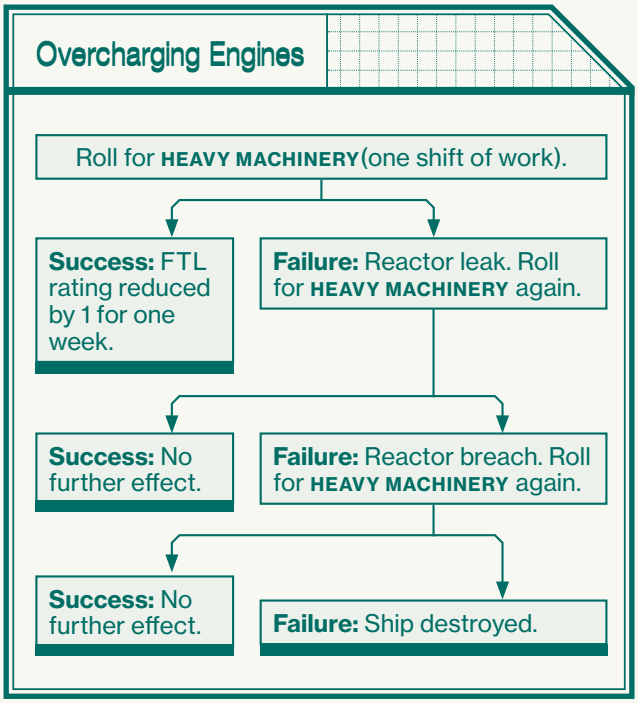
Aside from the luxury accommodations of the corporate elite, almost everything is grimy, used, and in need of repair.

In remote sectors, imported technologies are overpriced and hard to come by, so most equipment is jury-rigged, modified, and made from recycled and refurbished materials. In some territories, vehicles and starships are still in use that are nearly a century old.

Instead of the expensive, three dimensional holographic displays of yesteryear, most spacecraft are equipped with conventional monitors and basic sensor packages. Over the past several decades, MU/TH/UR computer systems have become less about the sophistication of the AI and more focused on utilitarian function. Even spacesuits are bulkier and provide less protection than those produced during the golden years.

In essence, humankind as a technological society is on the decline.

Humanity never would have left the cradle of our solar system without the foresight of visionary entrepreneur and businessman Peter Weyland. Under his stewardship, the Weyland Corporation introduced three things that ensured humanity's dominance over the stars – the capacity to travel at faster than light speeds, the introduction of the hypersleep chamber, and the ability to terraform whole worlds. ●



SPACE TRAVEL

THE ABILITY TO TRAVEL faster than light is the lynchpin of humanity's expansion outside our own solar system. Without it, there would be no extrasolar colonies and no corporate star empires.

Faster Than The Speed Of Light: First developed by Weyland Corp in the 2030s, these engines are sometimes referred to as displacement drives. The system works on the principle of an inverse relationship between velocity and the flow of time. An FTL drive achieves these speeds by displacing the volume of space preceding a spacecraft and drawing the vessel forward with it. Accelerating to faster than light speeds is not instantaneous. Ion thrusters build speed up to the point where the displacement drive can take over, gradually propelling starships to several times the speed of light.

When they were first deployed 150 years ago, FTL engines could impel a starship such as a Heliades class Space Exploration Vehicle at 10 to 15 times the speed of light. Even though modern ships can travel from 50 to upwards of 700 times FTL, that still means it can take weeks or even years to travel the whole of charted space.

To complicate matters, prolonged travel at faster than light speeds can cause a syndrome in mammals known as Neurological Distortion Disorder – or NDDs for short (next page). To combat this and to conserve resources on long trips, space travelers spend most of their FTL time in stasis.

Tripping The Light Fantastic

Every craft capable of FTL speed has an FTL rating (page 122) that denotes how many days it takes for the ship to traverse one parsec on the star map. A lower number means a faster ship. Presently, no existing ship has an FTL rating lower than 1. To calculate your journey, multiply the number of days per parsec by the number of parsecs. For example: If you have an FTL drive with a rating of 6 and you are traveling 9 parsecs, you wind up with a trip that takes 54 days.

Overcharging Engines: Need to get somewhere in a hurry? Your engineer might be able to coax more speed out of your engines. Of course, the reactor might start leaking radiation everywhere and explode, but risk is the name of the game, now, isn't it?

To do this, the engineer makes a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll (one shift of work). If successful, the ship's FTL rating is decreased by 1 step for one week (from 6 to 5 for example). If the roll fails, the ship instead suffers a reactor leak (see minor component damage, page 145), and the engineer must make another immediate **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll. If this also fails, the ship

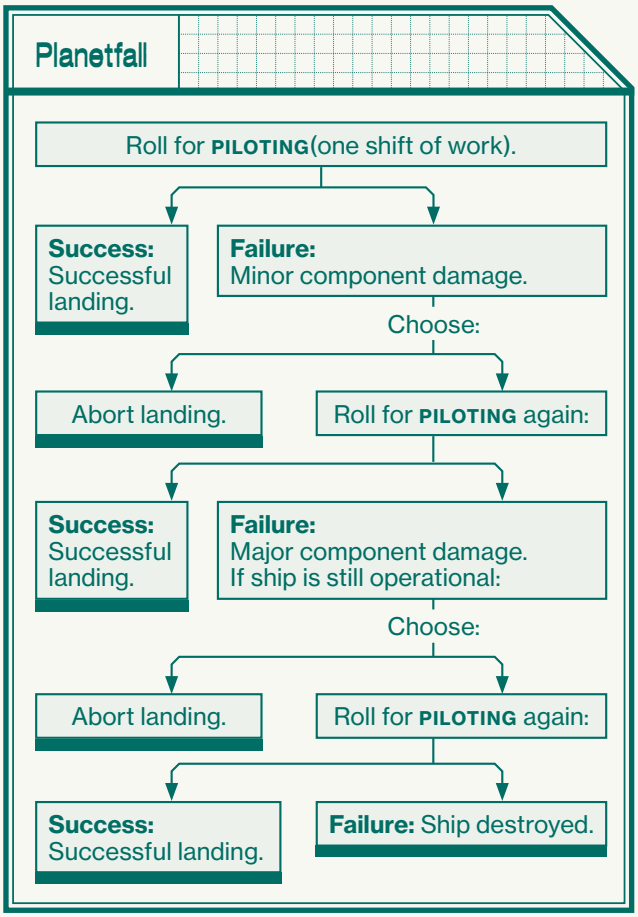
Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

suffers a reactor breach (major component damage, page 146), and the engineer must make a third **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll. If the third roll also fails, the reactor explodes, destroying the ship and killing all on board. An engineer may only attempt to overcharge the engines once per week.

Planetfall

Ships built for atmospheric entry and planetary surface landings (with the Planetfall Capacity upgrade) can be used to land on any rock in space you like – but expect it to be a bumpy ride. Planetfall usually takes about one shift to complete, and requires a **PILOTING** roll. If the roll fails, the ship suffers minor component damage (roll D66 on the table on page 145).

You can now choose to abort the landing and try again next shift. If you continue, roll for **PILOTING** again. If the second roll fails too, the ship suffers major component damage (roll 2D6 on the table on page 146). If you suffer engine failure or a reactor breach, the ship will crash – hurry to those EEVs! If the ship is still operable, you again have the choice to abort or to continue the landing, making a third **PILOTING** roll. If this third roll also fails, the ship crashes hard, killing all on board.



Hyper Sleeping With The Stars

Even before FTL was possible, hypersleep technology was in development. As early as the 2020s, Peter Weyland had ordered his scientists to find a way to extend life indefinitely. While not exactly what Weyland had in mind, the resulting technology was a significant leap forward. The ability to slow a life-form's biological processes to a near standstill was beneficial to both the medical industry and deep space missions at sublight speeds. When FTL became a reality, stasis was adapted as a solution to resource management on space flights.

Hypersleep was soon found to offer other benefits to humans' health in space. Traveling faster than the speed of light can have a distortion effect on human perception. Known as Neurological Distortion Disorder, this syndrome causes paranoia, epilepsy, psychotic behavior and other adverse effects (see the adjacent sidebar). Worse than that, the faster one travels, the worse the symptoms. Stasis protects space travelers from the NDDs, with the added benefit of arresting aging on a cellular level. ▶

Neurological Distortion Disorder

If you are awake during FTL travel, roll a D6 after each time period (in days) equal to the FTL rating of the ship (page 122) and check the table below. Add +1 cumulatively to each roll after the first.

ROLL	EFFECT
1–5	**No Effect.** *Yet.*
6–7	**Paranoia.** You become convinced that someone or something on board the ship is out to get you. The effect lasts until the FTL travel ends.
8–9	**Epilepsy.** You suffer episodes of epileptic seizures that will disable you for a stretch of time. Roll a stress die each shift – a ☣ means a seizure occurs.
10–11	**Dementia.** Your memory is a blank slate. You can no longer recall who you or the other characters are. The effect lasts for D6 days after the FTL travel ends.
12+	**Psychosis.** You must immediately attack the nearest person or creature, friendly or not. You won't stop until you or the target is broken. Every friendly PC who witnesses your rampage must make an immediate panic roll.

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HYPERSLEEP EFFECTS

Hypersleep gives full protection against NDD, but being abruptly awakened is dangerous. Disorientation, headaches, chest pain, and nausea are all common side effects. While uncommon, some severe cases have resulted in death.

A rude awakening from hypersleep counts as an attack against you rolled with six base dice (base damage 1). Armor has no effect. In addition, spending any length of time in hypersleep will make you fatigued (page 75). The effect can also be counteracted by the Hydr8tion drug (page 98).

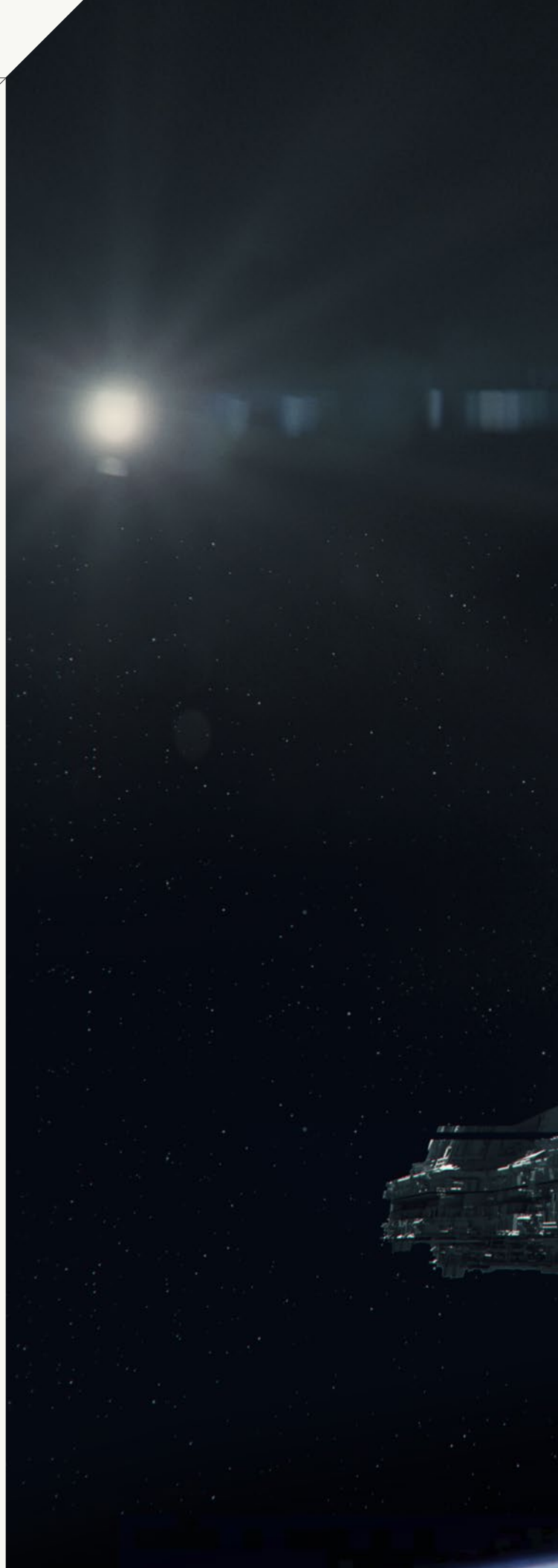
The Sleep Of Ages: The process of entering hypersleep involves a mixture of gasses and lowering the body temperature significantly. While travelers are not conscious when in stasis, they can dream. As brain functions are also slowed during hypersleep, a single dream can last months. In fact, an entire industry has been created to take advantage of this (page 118). Dreaming in hypersleep promotes mental health and can help a body's natural regenerative healing.

Gravity Drives

Corporate scientists are always working on advances in FTL technology. A recent development operates by generating waves of force throughout the length of the vessel which propel it past light speed without the aid of thrusters. Called gravity drives, these systems create a distortion in space-time, allowing starships to enter Einsteinian Space – a relative state of non-existence in the material universe, allowing ships to travel much faster than conventional FTL.

The technology is a giant leap forward, but the NDDs still require travelers to enter stasis for prolonged journeys. The details of this process and the principles behind it are currently classified by Weyland-Yutani. Still in experimental trials, gravity drives are mostly unknown on the Frontier, found only on high-end company yachts and exploration ships from the Core Systems.

A fortuitous byproduct of the gravity drive is that the fields generated by it provide powerful protection against ballistic and energy attacks. Gravity drives are finely calibrated and weight sensitive – any unaccounted for mass aboard a starship utilizing the system risks severe course deviations. ●



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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

CHARTED SPACE

WELCOME TO SPACE. You're going to die here – and when that happens, your relatives are going to need to know where to pick up your body and whether to burn it or shoot it back into the void.

The star map on the inside front covers of this book shows all of charted space. The three largest sections divided by government are the American Arm of the United Americas (UA), the Anglo-Japanese Arm of the Three World Empire (3WE), and the collectivist block of the Union of Progressive Peoples (UPP). These national domains cut through the Core, Outer Veil, Outer Rim, and Far Reach of known space.

The Core Systems are those closest to Earth. They are the most prosperous colonies and the playground of the elite. The 3WE and the Independent Core System Colonies (ICSC) dominate this region of space.

The Outer Veil: Outside the core systems is the Outer Veil. Rich in resources for mining and cultivation, the colonies of the Outer Veil were terraformed and settled by the 3WE over a century ago. Since then the UPP has annexed many worlds here. Vast regions of space in this region have been stripped bare and made uninhabitable through unsafe mining methods.

The Outer Rim: Beyond the Outer Veil is the Outer Rim. Out here American and UPP explorers discovered several resource rich planets that could support human life without terraforming. The Rim is the outer edge of civilized space.

The Far Reach: Extending from the American Arm of the Outer Rim is the Far Reach. This area of claimed but mostly uncharted space stretches through vast areas of the unknown to a scattered group of terraformed lifeblood colonies essential to the UA and 3WE. Space truckers call this string of worlds the Pearl Necklace.

The Frontier: Along the edge of explored space lies the Frontier. It is a free-for-all land of opportunity constantly expanding the boundaries of known space. Beyond that lies darkness. ●

"We didn't leave Earth to be safe."

Tennessee

LIVING IN SPACE

SO, YOU WANT to try your hand at surviving on the Frontier. The average blue-collar worker here is a farmer, a pioneer, a maintenance engineer, a wildcatter, a prospector, a miner, a space trucker, a marshal, a manager or a soldier – all dirty and hard-working professions. Only a select few get to call themselves explorers.

The best long-term option available to the common human is to become a Frontier colonist. The vetting process isn't easy – in addition to competency and physical prerequisites, candidates must endure an intense psychological screening process that many potential colonists fail. However, once you are approved for a colony, you are essentially set up in that position for life, assuming you don't screw up royally. Corporations and the colonial administration can't be bothered to replace a farmsteader or terraforming maintenance engineer like you for minor infractions. Also, the job has the added bonus of your descendants inheriting your position.

Unfortunately, there is no glory or glamour to be had as a colonist – the colonies on the Frontier are experiencing an economic depression while the companies in the Core Systems grow fat off the hard labor of others. Supplies are limited and more often than not, colonists are told to ration and improvise.

Just In Town For Supplies

While most Frontier jobs are colony-based, they all interact in one way or another. Prospectors and wildcatters survey the terrain, staking claims to mineral deposits and drilling exploratory wells in unexplored regions. Miners often serve a one-year contract at a particular colony site before being rotated out. Farmers grow produce, maintenance engineers keep the atmospheric processors running, general managers oversee it all, and the marshals keep everyone in line. Space truckers deliver supplies to the colony and bring that world's exports back to the Inner Core Systems. Many corporate cargo haulers are former Colonial Navy veterans who are down on their luck. The Colonial Marines and Navy protect these worlds, also rotating in and out along the Frontier. Finally, corporations will send security and assessment teams to ensure their resources are being well cared for. Taken all together, it represents the well-oiled machine of commerce – and everyone in it is just a cog, a replaceable cog.

Then there is the fringe element.

Mercenaries, vagabonds and privateers move from colony to colony, looking to eke out a living on the fringe of normal society. Some are criminals on the run, others are just disenchanted with colonial and corporate bureaucracy. Many are dangerous.

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Spaceships

Between scouting missions and cargo runs, people on the Frontier spend a lot of time in massive metal cans hurtling through space. Starships are designed for functionality, not aesthetics. Floor gratings can be removed to access conduits located beneath them, and exposed machinery and tubing line the walls in all but the crew's quarters. Several typical spaceships operating in the 2180s AD are described on page 128 and forward.

A Lonely Life: Living on spaceships can mean sleeping for months at a time. To complicate matters, all this travel back and forth can severely alter personal dynamics. When you spend a few years making cargo runs in hypersleep you don't age all that much, while your family has been living active lives planetside. Children grow up and lovers grow older. Relationships tend to unravel, leaving you with only your work and your crew.

Space Stations

Space stations are mostly designed in a similar fashion to spacecraft – the difference being that there are many more habitat areas, as well as large open malls. Station design is as varied as that of starcraft – some consist of several towers with a connecting latticework of travel tubes while others are built out into the spires of massive decommissioned refinery modules. Still more utilize more traditional forms such as a wheel or sphere.

While most are built out of titanium composite and other high-end alloys, some, such as the religious colony Arceon, are also composed of exotic materials. Most space stations are like overpopulated cities in space – quarters are cramped for all but the elite, those in the working class live and work right on top of one another, and crime runs rampant.

Claustrophobia In The Void: People need room to breathe. Space itself might be vast, but there just isn't a whole lot of it available in the stations floating amongst the stars. As windows are a commodity in space, space stations often have recreation centers and botanical gardens equipped with environmental walls. These large monitors project breathtaking views of natural vistas such as wooded glades, tropical beaches, or majestic mountain ranges. While expensive models include a three-dimensional projection, cheaper and more prolific models use flat-screen video. ▶

Station Data

ANCHORPOINT STATION

The second space station to bear the name, the massive Anchorpoint station is your crossroads to the Frontier. Located in unclaimed space a few scant parsecs from UAAC base Liberty Echo, Anchorpoint is a convenient place to pick up supplies, get some grub, refuel, make repairs in drydock, and pick up migrant crew and workers for your next job. Location is everything, and Anchorpoint is positioned perfectly to service the southern Outer Rim and the Far Reach, providing an alternate route from the Solomons to civilized space.

Anchorpoint is considered neutral territory and is governed by the ICSC – vessels from any and all governments and corporations are welcome here. The ICC and Colonial Administration often send representatives to negotiate intercolonial disputes at Anchorpoint. The UA operates a Colonial Marshal Bureau aboard, and a small contingent of Colonial Marines is stationed in the garrison office in tower four.

The station has a very small permanent population, but can easily house over 3,000 transient workers and colonists. Anchorpoint is composed of four refinery modules situated around a central core hub. Three of the modules have been converted to habitable space similar to the Seegson company's former Sevastopol station, while the fourth is a functioning refinery for processing ores and gasses bound for the Frontier colonies. With concourses laid out similar to a terrestrial spaceport, the station is known for its dive bars, open mall areas, service androids, and inexpensive entertainment.

What's The Story Mother?

While only three years old, the newest incarnation of Anchorpoint is the most successful space station project outside of the Sol system. The original Anchorpoint was a colonial refueling hub/science station situated in the Neroid Sector, close to UPP space. In 2179 she suffered a catastrophic reactor failure – for reasons unknown. Colonial Administration and the ICC commissioned the Independent Core System Colonies to build a new one, placing it further out on the Frontier to facilitate the colonization boom.

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Station Data

ARCEON

Dubbed "the wooden planet" by space truckers, Arceon is a strange station. Originally an old class V habitation sphere, the mile-wide Arceon was repurposed as a monastery for a reclusive technophobic monastic order. All metallic areas within and without were covered with wood, and all structures within the sphere – an abbey, libraries, communal baths, reservoirs, and even a massive glassworks – are wooden and archaic in nature.

Inside, there are open spaces with ceilings as high as 100 meters tall, and the structure itself is layered like an ant's nest. Arceon sports grass fields where crops and livestock are grown and maintained. It is large enough and rotates fast enough to maintain its own thin atmosphere which is continuously processed and replenished by technology located at the core of the wooden world. The upper hemisphere of the station is dominated by a massive lake, replete with marine life.

What's The Story Mother?

Arceon was founded by a monastic "back to nature" movement in the 2100s. While initially dismissed as a cult, the order proved to be dangerous when they used the enhanced computer virus called New Plague to wipe out an inordinate amount of data on Earth, crippling credit unions and trans-stellar corporations alike. The group even detonated low yield nukes in key metropolitan sectors, utilizing the electromagnetic pulse to force people to get by without technology.

As more and more followers flocked to the order, action was taken. Rounded up and arrested by a joint 3WE and UA task force, the order's final sentencing was suspended when Weyland Corp bought off the judges. The monks were ultimately released into the conscripted custody of Weyland-Yutani, who relocated them to Arceon in exchange for the employment of their leader, Saint Tomas – the computer genius behind the New Plague.

On Arceon, the group is led by an Abbot. Also, an older model android called Brother Anthony resides with them to keep them from rising again. W-Y ships stopped running supplies to Arceon after Tomas died decades ago, and the monks have very few actual visitors. Their crops and livestock sustain them as they live the simple life.

Deep Space Colonies

The concept of the colonies that was sold to the general public was one of an off-world paradise. While some planets did eventually become just that, they are the product of the blood, sweat, and tears of generations of colonists.

Terraforming: Terraforming began at home in the 2010s, repairing the Earth's ecosystem from the ravages of war and pollution. The next step was the Moon, where localized areas were pressurized and transformed. Mars soon followed. While global warming was arrested as soon as the processors took effect, it still took decades to make the Earth whole again. In a move to acclimate people to the idea of life amongst the stars, Sir Peter Weyland offered incentives to move off-world and colonize the solar system while the Earth healed.

The strategy was successful, and soon colonies were popping up as far away as Saturn. Within a decade of the inception of the FTL drive, Weyland Corp had set up an Atmospheric Processing Plant (APP) on an extrasolar world, and it wasn't long before people were eager to colonize there as well. In the 21st century, terraforming helped humanity to settle the stars. The costly process was exacting and only performed on planets that had near earth conditions, thus prompting the planet to help sustain itself once the expensive terraforming was complete.

When the Yutani Corporation merged with Weyland Corp at the start of the 22nd century, terraforming was deemed unprofitable and put to rest. Instead, W-Y astronomers searched the heavens for planets that could support human life on their own. Colony missions like the Affiance and the ill-fated Covenant were sent off to start life on newly discovered Earth-like planets.

Without the enormous economic strain that the Weyland Corporation had endured in their efforts to transform entire worlds, Weyland-Yutani prospered. The new model wouldn't last. As more and more people relocated to the existing off-world colonies, populations on these worlds soared and resources again diminished. Soon, the supply of habitable worlds was outweighed by demand.

Building Better Worlds: Over the next fifty years, more and more resources were found on barren worlds along the shifting Frontier, prompting Weyland-Yutani to resurrect terraforming and create a new fast and dirty form of atmospheric processing. Recycling a hundred-year-old ad campaign, Weyland-Yutani again boasted they were "building better worlds." The claim was and still is debatable.

Colloquially called a "Shake and Bake" colony, an Atmospheric Processor (AP) is introduced to a planet or moon to scrub its atmosphere without the safety standards of the original Weyland APPs. Essentially giant fusion reactors, these completely automated W-Y APs still require constant monitoring and maintenance, and colonies are

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often set up on worlds for the sole purpose of servicing them. Weyland-Yutani has deployed APPs across the Frontier, creating colonies on any world that might have exploitable resources.

Terraforming can be a misnomer. It can take decades to transform a planet's ecology, and it doesn't always hold. Most of the worlds undergoing the process will never become Earth-like. They are barren, desolate, and alien places that the processors can only alter enough for man to survive on without a pressure suit. Some of these worlds even require APs to constantly run in order to maintain a suitable atmosphere, making the processor a prime target for enemy powers and insurgents.

Some planets or planetoids that are rich in mineral resources are simply unable to even begin to support the terraforming process. In those cases, pressurized facilities are built on the surface to house laborers and their families. Because of this, colonies can be built in nearly any environment. Ocean, jungle, desert, arctic, and barren worlds are all common.

Living Quarters

In space, no one can hear you snore... in hypersleep, at least. When not in stasis, however, you need a place to bed down and call your own. Here are your options.

On Rotation: As a mining and construction worker, you are often on rotation, and therefore do not rate for full quarters. Instead, you bunk in communal sleeping areas called cages. These facilities have stacked levels of meshed enclosures just long enough for a bedroll and tall enough to sit up in. A small locker and personal effects area is built into the headboard, and privacy is accomplished through the use of blinds. Just as on starships, showers and toilet facilities are shared.

Long Hauls: On military and commercial starship runs, most of your sleep time is done in stasis pods. For personal time while traveling in-system, many freighters have a common area with recessed bunks built into the walls. Like the cages, these accommodations can be closed off with ▶

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blinds or curtains, and can be decorated according to your discerning tastes (or lack thereof). Showers, the bathroom, galley and mess area are all communal on these service ships, so the coffin-like bunks offer the only private place for most military and long-haul crews.

Cramped Quarters: On some space stations, populations are high, and space is optimized. Don't expect to get too comfortable in such places. The lower levels of stations like Gateway have tight hallways and cramped studio apartments with kitchenettes and bathroom facilities all in the same small area. These apartments can be so small that it is uncomfortable for two people to navigate one at the same time.

Galaxy Standard: Crew quarters on colony and scientific exploration ships are often more roomy, consisting of a standardized studio area with a small private bathroom. If you're skilled enough, you might even rate your own viewport.

Luxury Accommodations: Don't expect to spend much time in any of these. Lavish to the extreme, these penthouse apartments on starships and stations are sometimes located on a separate module with its own support system and supplies. They are spacious, extravagantly stocked with food, drink, and whatever its occupants might need to survive for up to two years on their own.

Function Before Fashion

On the Frontier, you dress for success, and here that means practical. Clothing is usually overalls, jumpsuits, leather gloves, bomber jackets, and ball caps, all in muted colors and often decorated with colorful patches and corporate logos. On colder worlds, colonists and explorers wear dark, layered parkas and form-fitting leather aviator helmets or fur-lined, billed hats with ear flaps.

Marshals generally wear blue, gray, or tan utilitarian uniforms, and military personnel of course dress in khakis and olive drab. Company reps often wear suits in inappropriate places, distinguishing themselves from the blue-collar workers. Corporate fashion includes dark gray, navy, and black with white shirts and upturned collars along with skinny ties. On planetoids with nebulous atmospheres, compression suits are worn, ranging from cumbersome padded models to the sleeker, more advanced corporate spacesuits.

Living Expenses

Nothing is for free on the Frontier, not even breathing. The adjacent chart shows typical living expenses, depending on your taste for luxury and what you can afford.

WEEKLY COST	LIVING STANDARD
$25	Minimum
$100	Basic
$300	Normal
$2,000	Luxurious

Money And Identification, Please

Just whose money are you spending, anyway? Identification and credit accounts are linked in the colonies, and can be accessed in a variety of ways. Most colonists carry a metal and transparent plastic prism ID account card that is encoded to the owner's thumbprint – debits only occur when the proper recipient is holding the card. Other forms of ID in the colonies include access codes, retina scans, genetic breath analyzers, plastic or metal barcoded dog tags, and barcode tattoos – although the latter are usually reserved for convicted criminals.

Cold Cash: Credit accounts constitute the majority of transactions throughout the territories, but life on the Frontier can be different. What if you want to make a private purchase? Often, a transaction without a record is favorable. Most accepted cash is in denominations set by particular corporations, and their worth goes up and down based on the value of company stock. This can lead to problems when a particular business only accepts specific forms of currency. Rather than bank notes, these are corporate notes. National currencies are usually in electronic credit accounts only, as most governments prefer to keep track of all their citizens' transactions. However, as the United Americas has grown disenchanted with their reliance on corporations like Weyland-Yutani and Lasalle Bionational, the Federal Reserve has proposed resurrecting the United American Dollar as paper currency.

Currencies: All debits and credits are measured in, and converted to, United American (UA) dollars, Three World Imperial (3WE) yen, or Union of Progressive Peoples (UPP) yuan. Bills are available in different denominations, such as 5, 10, 20, 100, 1,000, and 10,000 – there are no singles. Some corporate paper currencies include:

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- **W-Y COLONY DOLLARS:** (Pronounced Why) Weyland-Yutani currency – the hundred W-Y dollar bill has a security hologram imprint of Peter Weyland on its face. Other bills depict company pioneers such as Meredith Vickers, and both Jenny and Hideo Yutani.
- **SEEG BILLS:** Not as widely accepted as W-Y dollars, these bills bear only the Seegson logo and a holographic denomination.
- **BINAT COINS:** These tokens are made of a mixture of standard and precious metals, ranging from steel, copper, and platinum to even rarer earth metals.

Conversion rates are always in flux, but as a rule of thumb, W-Y dollars maintain their value, and thus are the most sought after.

Work For Hire

Let's face it – you are out here for the paycheck and not much else. In the adjacent table are some typical salaries on the Frontier. Base salaries are low because corporations don't want you to own anything – they want to own you. Corporate credit and loans are also available. Frontier employee compensation packages also include living quarters, standard rations, bonuses, shares, claims, and medical benefits. But brush your teeth, because no-one includes dental. Ever.

Communications On The Frontier

Interstellar space is vast. Transmissions are not instantaneous, sometimes taking weeks or months to reach the recipient. Fortunately, Weyland-Yutani has built a sophisticated communication satellite grid surrounding most inhabited sectors of space. Known as the Network, all signals are routed through it, sometimes bouncing between thousands of comm arrays before reaching their destination.

Intrasystem communications are much more immediate, ranging from real time to a short lag, depending on how far out one is from the recipient.

Massive antenna arrays and satellite dishes dominate spacecraft, stations, and ground facilities, and a viable hard-wired uplink to them is necessary for transmissions of any kind. Both interstellar and intrasystem long distance personal calls can be extremely expensive, and if there are few comm facilities available or there is high comm traffic across the Network, you can find yourself waiting days before you receive authorized time for that critical call.

As it can take extended periods for a reply, most colonial general managers, marshals, and military commanders are forced to make decisions based on their personal interpretation of policy without the approval of the company or Colonial Administration. As life out on the ass-end of space can take its toll on the psyche, this sometimes leads to bizarre extrapolations of laws and procedures.

Lost In Transmission: No one can hear you scream, but you can hear a star sing. Space is also noisy. Pulsars, black holes, and other stellar phenomena all produce transmissions on a wide variety of frequencies. Communication buffers weed out these errant signals, but because of this, legitimate transmissions with weak signals can sometimes be lost in the mix.

Intrasystem call cards are tied directly to a specific recipient. These cards provide you with a direct line to your loved ones – Network and distance permitting. Often used as business cards by corporate reps, these transparent prism plastic cards will automatically connect to the rep's receiver when inserted into a comm terminal. The charge is usually billed to the company. ▶

Salaries

OCCUPATION	WEEKLY SALARY	EXAMPLES
Colonial labor	$500–$640	Miners, prospectors, farmers, drivers, mechanics, and service personnel
Commercial employees	$400–$960	Space truckers, officers, technicians, cargo handlers, pilots, navigators, medical and science officers
Corporate and government officials	$540–$1,200	Administration, execs, secretaries, sales persons, auditors, hitmen, and agents
Law enforcement	$400–$700	Colonial Marshals, federal investigators, colonial guard and security
Military officers and enlisted personnel	$500–$760	All Army, Marines, and Navy roles
Elite occupations	$1,300–$20,000	CEOs, entertainment professionals, dreamers, scientists, doctors, elite assassins, governors and high-ranking military

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Media

There is no such thing as the free press on the Frontier. Most journalists are corporate-owned, and the few that aren't are either spin doctors for their government or just haven't been bought off yet. Propaganda is the norm as each company decides what news to broadcast. Colony-based signals broadcast local news. Due to transmission times, Network broadcast Interstellar News is often weeks out of date, so most colonies have stopped tuning in – something that could be potentially catastrophic if an enemy or alien threat were to make its way along the frontier.

Entertainment

Just like in every age before, 22nd century people are easily bored. On the Frontier, that boredom is remedied through music, drink, and recreational drugs (page 99) prescribed by company physicians. On the music scene, classic rock and country have seen a resurgence along the outer colonies. Recordings are downloaded from the Network and copied onto disposable cassettes. If one pays heavy subscription fees, broadcast entertainment can also be accessed.

Most of the recreational content on the Network exists to promote a company's products and consists of reality programming, shopping networks, and glorified corporate

Perchance To Dream

As noted on page 109, a lot of time in space is spent in cryosleep – a state in which your bodily functions and aging are slowed to the point of near suspension. Your mind, however, can dream. In fact, an entire industry is devoted to manufactured and creative dreams.

Talented dreamers can manipulate their own dreams, which can be recorded by expensive monitoring equipment and played back for the entertainment of less imaginative sleepers. Skilled dreamers weave and craft stories and adventures in their subconscious minds. Those sponsored by corporations – which is most of them – insert subliminal messages into your mind as you sleep.

With some skill, it's possible to use dream monitoring equipment combined with a neuro visor helmet (page 96) to consciously enter the dream of someone in stasis and communicate with them.



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propaganda. Just as it is with computer equipment, entertainment technology ranges from high-end holographic representations to the standard monotone, two-dimensional monitors. Entertainment terminals on colonies, stations, and even some ships provide access to a variety of electronic games.

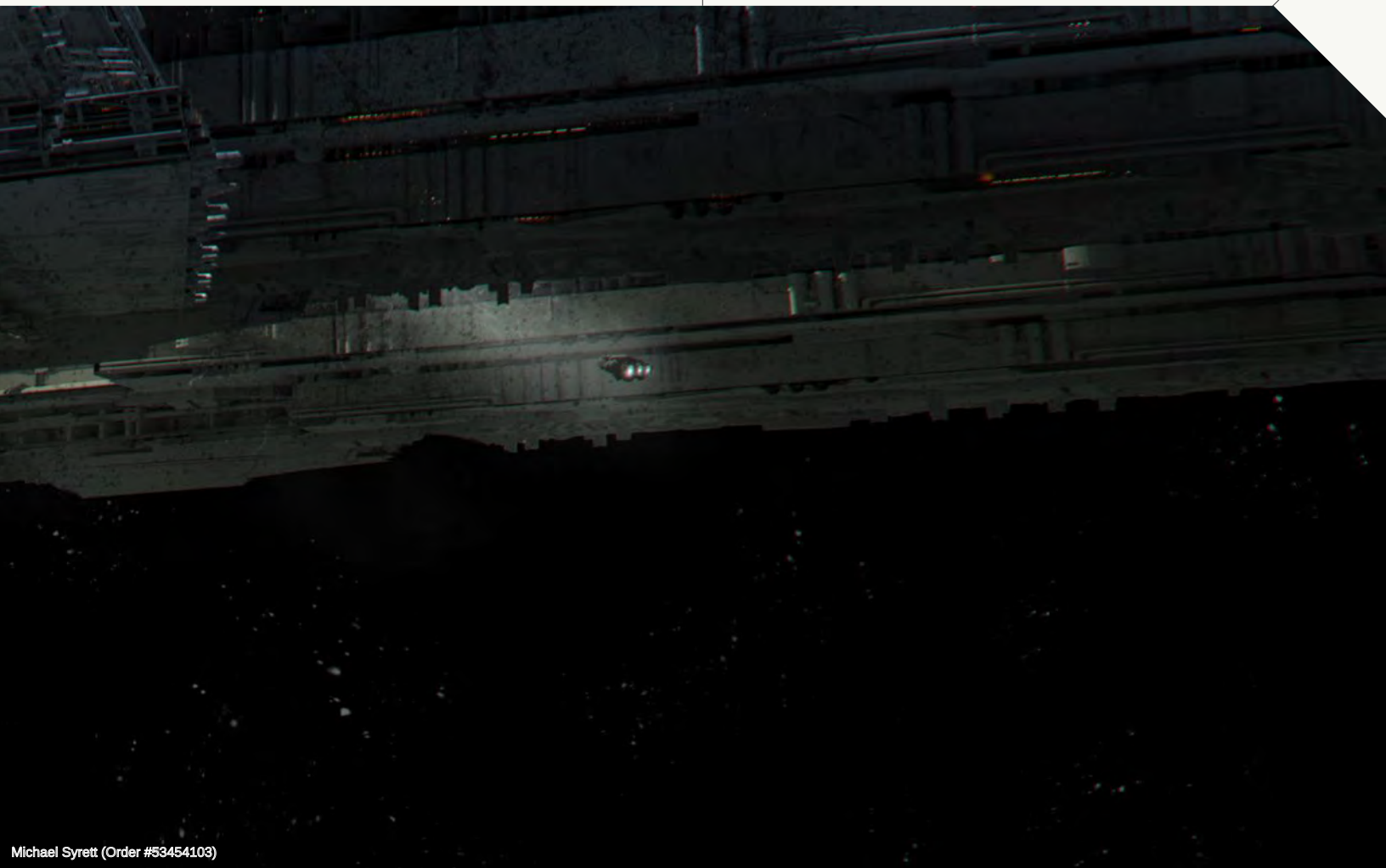
Religion

Devotion to God is a force to be reckoned with. Traditional religions still exist in the 22nd century, and are represented on the Frontier in one form or another. Due to the economic depression and rigors of life in space, extreme offshoots and sects are more commonplace. Apocalypse cults, fundamentalist missionaries, and spiritual gurus travel the Frontier, recruiting colonists and strengthening their flock.

In fact, the one egg that corporations seem to have been unable to crack is religion. Even small cults can be fanatical enough to evoke change, and companies want employees with that kind of fervor working for them. Corporate execs have even attempted – so far without success – to create a cult or two of their own. Some have come to the conclusion that beliefs can't be manufactured, only sponsored. To that end, corporate reps have begun approaching existing religious groups in the hopes of aligning goals in the name of the almighty profit margin.

Millenarian Doomsayers: Fundamentalist groups that believe the end times are near, millenarian doomsayers await their final judgment and the coming of God. Vowing celibacy, members of these apocalyptic brotherhoods seek to atone for their past sins through hard labor and devout penance. Unsurprisingly, the largest fanatical followings are on prison colonies, where the population has nothing to do but await apocalyptic redemption. As such, doomsayer groups often attract reformed murderers. Punishment for those who stray is often severe, ranging from isolation to starvation, severe beatings, and even mutilation.

Monastic Order Of Arceon: An anti-technology movement that started on Earth, the Order of Arceon grew exponentially when a computer virus wiped out a huge portion of the world's data. After it was exposed that a member of the Order was responsible for the virus, the movement was deemed a global threat by the Three World Empire. Those directly responsible were arrested and Weyland-Yutani was contracted to contain and move the rest of the Order's members to an off-world location. The movement was squashed and the Order was transplanted to the artificial satellite world of Arceon (page 114). There they live a monastic and mostly technology free existence on a space station that ironically could not exist without the very technology they shun. ▶



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Practitioners Of The Holy Immolation: A quasi-religious pacifist group in direct opposition to the corporate domination of the colonies, the Practitioners of the Holy Immolation first emerged during the Tientsin Campaign. Since then, these fanatics have become known for staging protests where one or more of their members will immolate themselves in the name of a free Frontier. Mostly a threat to themselves, they sometimes endanger others when their fires grow out of control in sensitive areas, such as in a biodome or on a space station.

Church Of Immaculate Incubation: Not much is known about this fledgling group. Some authorities suspect they might be a splinter faction of the infamous Earthsavers cult. A century-old group originally formed by dreamer and self-proclaimed prophet Duncan Fields, the Earthsavers believed that humanity's sojourn to the stars would herald the apocalypse.

Like that long dead organization, the Church of Immaculate Incubation places heavy emphasis on the apocalyptic dreams of its fanatical seers. They believe the end times are fast approaching, but their spin is that the only survivors will be those who have sought out and achieved transformation to a higher form. This metamorphosis is attained by accepting what they call the Seed of God into their hearts. With few members and nothing to back up their claims, the Church of Immaculate Incubation is essentially harmless.

Believing the alien creature in Robert Morse's banned book to have messianic significance to the imminent apocalypse, the Church readily distributes illegal copies of Space Beast throughout the colonies. As they seek to share the dreams of their prophets with their flock, they also actively recruit professional dreamers to their cause. Their enigmatic leader is rumored to be a wealthy man who has forsaken the good life and poured his resources into the Church.

Law Enforcement

Insurrections, revolutions, coups, crime, and atrocities are all too common in the colonies. As such, there are various levels of law enforcement on the Frontier.

The Colonial Marshal Bureau: The CMB is your local police force. For a colony of 500–3,000 colonists, there will usually be a single marshal, a sergeant, and a group of around a dozen officers. Colonies of less than 300 individuals usually have only one marshal and one deputy. At higher population levels, the marshal's office grows with the importance of the colony itself. They are supposed to enforce colonial law over corporate policy, but many have been paid to look the other way when it comes to company business.

United States Colonial Marine Corps: Some colonies will have a Colonial Marine Corps office and/or a contingent attached to them. Those that don't are still under the jurisdiction and protection of the USCMC and the United Americas Outer Rim Defense Fleet, and are usually within days to weeks of receiving support in case of an emergency. Operated by the United Americas Allied Command, they keep order on the borders of known space. While other nations have their own soldiers and support ships, none save that of the UPP come close to matching the strength of the Colonial Marines.

Corporate Security Force: In addition to colonial protection, a corporation sponsoring a colony might have its own security force attached to it. This security team would operate outside the jurisdiction of the CMB and the USCMC, and exist to ensure corporate policy is enforced.

Interstellar Commerce Commission: A central organization that conducts and monitors interstellar trade, the ICC has its own inspectors and agents that enforce regulations and quarantine procedures throughout the colonies. While owned and operated by Weyland-Yutani, they are allegedly an autonomous organization that regulates all trade equally. Allegedly. ●

The Lock Up

When you've done the crime, you've got to do the time. Frontier jail facilities range from simple barred rooms to sensory deprivation chambers. On space stations, maximum security isolation cells are kept in a state of vacuum and null gravity. Prisoners detained within are suspended in pressure suits.

Prisons are another story. Most correctional facilities are owned by private companies like Weyland-Yutani and the Jǐngtì Lóng Corporation. Why? They provide a plentiful source of cheap manual labor. These prisons are built in extreme environments that are high in resources but too dangerous for civilian employees to exploit in a cost-effective manner.

Prisoners work for benefits such as healthcare, interstellar comm calls, and cigarettes. Some of these corporate-run maximum security facilities may hold up to two million convicts. In order to keep track of inmates, all are tattooed with a barcode at the base of their neck.

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SPACECRAFT BASICS

UNLESS YOU'RE A DIRTBOUND COLONIST, you need to get around in space and occasionally make a pit stop. If that's your thing, then this section is definitely for you. Here, you'll learn about space travel, spacecraft, and how to nuke the entire site from orbit. It's the only way to be sure.

Ship Classes & Features

Commercial craft in the 22nd century are tracked by model and weight class. A-G Class vessels are light and relatively inexpensive. Class M vessels fall in that sweet spot between having the best cargo capacity and tolerable engine emissions. They are the workhorses of the UA and 3WE.

The adjacent table lists a few common ship classes and their typical characteristics, such as crew size, length, FTL speed, and more. Individual ships can vary greatly. On page 128 and forward, you will find a selection of specific ships described in more detail. ▶

YOUR OWN SHIP?

Ship prices listed here are for common models found on the Frontier. Older versions of the same ship will be simultaneously cheaper and less reliable. Spacecraft are cost prohibitive. While there are independently owned FTL ships out there, most vessels are corporate or military owned and most crews are either contracted employees or work for hire.

Corporations will often lease a commercial vehicle to an experienced captain or crew with the option to buy at a later date. A typical lease will cost you 2% of the ship's total price per year. If your crew strikes it big on a particular job, you might find yourselves set up for life, if you play your cards right, of course. Independence is a luxury that most on the Frontier cannot afford, but it is one that many strive to achieve.

Ship Classes

CLASS	LENGTH	CREW	FTL	SIGNATURE	THRUSTERS	HULL	ARMAMENTS	MODULES	COST
C	15 m	1–2	–	–1	+2	2	–	2 × size II 4 × size I	$2,000,000
G	50 m	3–6	20	+0	+1	5	1 × size II 2 × size I	3 × size III 5 × size II 7 × size I	$9,000,000
J	150m	4–10	16	+0	+1	6	2 × size II 3 × size I	4 × size III 6 × size II 8 × size I	$20,000,000
M	300 m	6–12	12	+1	–	9	1 × size III 2 × size II	4 × size IV 6 × size III 8 × size II	$28,000,000
R	700 m	12–18	8	+2	–1	12	2 × size III 4 × size II	5 × size V 7 × size IV 9 × size III	$400,000,000
U	1,200m	15–20/ 2,000	20	+3	–2	15	3 × size III 6 × size II	6 × size V 9 × size IV 12 × size III	$1,000,000,000
X	2,500m	36–72/ 10,000	24	+5	–3	20	5 × size III 10 × size I	8 × size V 12 × size IV 16 × size III	$4,000,000,000

Licensed Spectrum (Order: 53.15.1103)

All spaceships have these key features:

- **CORE COMPONENTS** are central features present on almost every spaceship, such as the bridge, reactor, engine, and bulkheads.
- **INTERNAL MODULES** are optional functions inside the hull of the ship. They can be removed and replaced.
- **ARMAMENTS** are offensive weapons and defensive countermeasures.
- **UPGRADES** are just that, improvements and additions of various kinds.

Spaceship Attributes

- **FTL Rating:** The number of days it takes for the ship to travel 1 parsec.
- **Signature:** The modifier for enemies to lock their sensors onto the ship. See page 143.
- **Thrusters:** The modifier to **PILOTING** rolls when maneuvering the ship. See page 143.
- **Hull:** The amount of damage the ship can take before becoming disabled. See page 146.
- **Armaments:** The number of armaments of each size that the ship can be fitted with. See page 124.
- **Modules**: The number of internal modules of each size that the ship can hold. See below.

Core Components

Core components of a ship cannot easily be replaced, but they can be upgraded.

- **Hull:** Spaceship frames typically consist of bonded alloy and composite beams. These materials provide enough strength for massive acceleration, while remaining flexible enough to withstand atmospheric entry for ships with planetfall capacity. The structural strength of a spaceship is measured by its Hull rating, which in turn determines how much damage it can take before becoming disabled (page 146).
- **Bridge:** The bridge is the brain of the ship. Sensors, communications, and engines are controlled from the bridge. The ship commander and pilot are stationed here.
- **Sensors:** Spaceships can be fitted with a range of sensors of different types. They are broadly divided into passive sensors, such as optical, infrared, and radio telescopes, and active sensors, such as wave radar arrays. Read more about sensors on page 141.
- **Communications Array:** Spaceships are fitted with a range of antennae and relays, some for interstellar FTL communications and others for intrasystem communication.
- **Reactor:** Spaceships of the 2180s are generally powered by fusion reactors. Military ships typically use powdered lithium hydride as fuel, while civilian vessels use heavy hydrogen isotopes like deuterium and tritium.
- **Sublight Thrusters:** Sublight propulsion is generated by rocket motors, powered directly by the fusion reactor. Reaction mass such as industrial carbon diamond is simply placed in contact with the fusion plasma, which heats it. The heated gas is then expelled via the rocket motors. The Thrusters rating of your ship functions as a bonus to your **PILOTING** skill.
- **Displacement Drives:** Faster-than-light propulsion is provided by a tachyon shunt hyperdrive powered by the reactor, accelerating the vessel past the light barrier. The FTL rating of your ship indicates how many days it takes to traverse one parsec – a lower rating means a faster ship.

Internal Modules

Internal modules come in different sizes, and are divided into size categories with Roman numerals. A size I module is the size of a personal vehicle, while size V modules are as big as large buildings. A ship can hold up to a certain number of modules of each size. It's possible to fit a smaller module into a slot for a bigger one, but not the other way around. The modules described below are listed in the table on the next page, which also includes capacities and prices.

- **Artificial Intelligence:** An advanced computer mainframe, capable of running the ship when the crew is in cryosleep. Weyland-Yutani's MU/TH/UR and Seegson's A.P.O.L.L.O. are the two most popular models. Read more on page 92.
- **Air Scrubbers:** Machinery needed to supply the crew with breathable air. Carbon filters clean pollutants from the air while churning machines electrolyze the water and generate oxygen. Air scrubbers come in many sizes and price levels, depending on how many people they need to keep supplied.
- **Cargo Bay:** An internal cargo hold with external loading doors. Cargo doors are typically included, and larger cargo bays include movable H-frame cranes to assist loading. The maximum load and cost of the cargo bay depends on the size of the cargo bay module.
- **Corporate Suite:** A spacious and luxurious area for top level company representatives. Typically includes a wet bar and a wall safe. Some models even include a personal escape pod.
- **Cryo Deck:** A room with cryo chambers for the crew. The capacity and cost of the cryo deck depends on the size of the module.
- **Docking Umbilical:** An airlock and extendable umbilical tunnel that enables docking with other ships. A ship without a docking station must land inside a hangar, or let smaller ships into its own hangar, for the crew to enter or exit the ship.
- **Emergency Escape Vehicle:** All ICC sanctioned starcraft are required by law to have EEV pods or escape shuttles to accommodate the ship's entire crew complement. See page 124 for a selection of EEVs. ▶

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Internal Modules

MODULE	SIZE	CAPACITY	COST
Artificial Intelligence	I		varies
Air Scrubbers	I	Up to 10 people	$50,000
	II	Up to 50 people	$200,000
	III	Up to 500 people	$1,200,000
	IV	Up to 2,500 people	$3,000,000
Cargo Bay	I	500 kg	$10,000
	II	10 tons	$25,000
	III	250 tons	$100,000
	IV	5,000 tons	$250,000
	V	100,000 tons	$4,000,000
Corporate Suite	II		$1,000,000
Cryo Deck	I	1 person	$50,000
	II	Up to 10 people	$200,000
	III	Up to 50 people	$2,000,000
	IV	Up to 500 people	$15,000,000
	V	Up to 2,500 people	$50,000,000
Docking Umbilical	II		$300,000
Emergency Escape Vehicle	I	Class A Ejection Pod	$100,000
	II	Class B EEV Type 20 Series	$250,000
	II	Class C EEV Type 337 FTL	$500,000
	III	Class D Lifeboat Module	$1,500,000
Galley	I	1 person	$20,000
	II	Up to 10 people	$50,000
	III	Up to 50 people	$125,000
	IV	Up to 500 people	$500,000
	V	Up to 2,500 people	$3,000,000
Hangar	I	Class A Ship	$100,000
	II	Class B Ship	$250,000
	III	Class C–D Ship	$400,000
	IV	Class E–G Ship	$800,000
	V	Class H–M Ship	$1,200,000
Medlab	II		$250,000
Salvage Crane	III		$100,000
Science Lab	III		$750,000
Tractor Hitch	III		$600,000
Vehicle Bay	I	ATV	$75,000
	II	VTOL Gyrocar	$150,000
	III	APC, Daihotai Tractor	$250,000
	IV	10 × APC	$800,000
	V	100 × APC	$5,000,000

Licensed Systems (Order: 53151103)

- **Galley:** This is where you'll chow down on those prefab meals after weeks in hypersleep. Includes a simple kitchen, refrigeration unit, and a coffee maker. The capacity and cost of the galley depends on the size of the module.
- **Hangar:** Allows smaller ships to land in the belly of yours. Includes a system of airlocks, to allow entry without decompressing the entire ship. How many other ships the hangar can accommodate depends on the size of the module.
- **Medlab:** An infirmary and laboratory that typically includes surgical kits, medkits and a selection of medical drugs (page 98). If you can afford an AutoDoc or even a Pauling MedPod, this is where you'll place it.
- **Salvage Crane:** A powerful crane mechanism that lets you salvage starship wrecks and space junk, pulling it into your cargo hold or attaching it to your tractor hitch.
- **Science Lab:** A highly advanced laboratory where your scientist can examine specimens of alien life forms – among other things. The lab comes with an assortment of equipment, giving a +2 modification to **OBSERVATION** rolls when using the Analysis talent.
- **Tractor Hitch:** Allows you to connect your ship to a variety of huge, external cargo modules weighing over a million tons, such as gas tanks, refineries or atmospheric processors. When towing external cargo, the FTL rating of the ship is doubled.
- **Vehicle Bay:** A glorified garage for ground vehicles, including a loading ramp for easy access. How many vehicles the bay can accommodate depends on the size of the module.

Armaments

Armaments come in two types: offensive weapon systems and defensive countermeasures. How these are used is explained later in this chapter. Just like modules, armaments can be removed and replaced, and they are also divided into size categories in the same way.

As opposed to internal modules, however, armaments are mounted on external hardpoints. Each ship can only be fitted with a specific number of armaments of each size. It's possible to fit a smaller armament into a slot for a bigger one, but not the other way around.

The weapons described below are listed in the table on the next page, which also includes stats and prices. Ship armaments have similar stats as personal and vehicle weapons, but on a different scale. Ship armaments can't be used to target individuals. Read more about spaceship combat on page 140.

ASAT Missiles: The typical main armament of military frigates, guided ASAT missiles have long range and pack a heavy punch. Their main drawback is that they take some time to reach their target, giving it a chance to shoot the missile down or deploy countermeasures. A missile battery can typically fit eight missiles. Individual missiles must be purchased separately.

Railgun: This close defense weapon uses superheated plasma to fire heavy metal rounds at extremely high speed, slicing through a ship's armor like butter. Railguns are not very accurate but extremely deadly at short range. Railguns are armor piercing. ▶

The ABCs Of EEVs

If your ship is in danger, you've got to get the hell off it, fast. In an emergency, MU/TH/UR will dump her flight recorder data to your Emergency Escape Vehicle, lock onto the nearest homing beacon, and auto-navigate you away from your exploding ship. So sit back, watch the fireworks and take a deep breath.

A Note From MU/TH/UR: Aside from the Type 337 and shuttles equipped with a tachyon shunt, most escape vehicles are incapable of FTL speed. While auto-piloted, navigation can be overridden by those aboard. If any of these craft are ejected from within an atmosphere, they will attempt a soft landing with limited success.

CLASS A EJECTION POD

▶ **Capacity** 1 ▶ **Length** 2 m

Designed for ejection in space only, the coffin-shaped ejection pod has limited thrust capability but can put an occupant in a state of semi-stasis for up to a week to prolong the possibility of rescue.

CLASS B EEV TYPE 20 SERIES

▶ **Capacity** 2–4 ▶ **Length** 6 m–8 m

A simple box-like pod with minimal thruster capability, the Type 20 has cramped seating, no capacity for cryosleep, and can sustain its occupants for ten days. They cannot land on a planet and will burn up on reentry.

Licensed Spirit (Order: 53151103)

Offensive Armaments

ARMAMENT	MOD.	DAMAGE	RANGE	HARD-POINT	COST	SPECIAL
Short Lance ASAT missile	+1	3	Long	Size II	$12,000,000	Missile cost: $100,000
Long Lance ASAT Missile	+1	4	Extreme	Size III	$25,000,000	Missile cost: $400,000
Light Railgun Turret	–	3	Short	Size I	$1,500,000	Armor piercing
Medium Railgun Turret	–	4	Short	Size II	$8,500,000	Armor piercing
Heavy Railgun Turret	–	5	Short	Size III	$20,000,000	Armor piercing
400MeV Particle Beam Weapon	+2	4	Long	Size II	$12,000,000	Damage reduced over range. See page 146.
800MeV Particle Beam Weapon	+2	5	Extreme	Size III	$30,000,000	Damage reduced over range. See page 146.
Orbital Mines	+2	2	Contact	Size II	$10,000	
Tactical Nuke	N/A	N/A	Surface	Size III	$50,000,000	Missile cost: $1,000,000

Defensive Armaments

ARMAMENT	MODIFIER	HARDPOINT	COST
Sensor Decoys	–	Size I	$1,200,000
Sensor Drones	+1	Size II	$3,600,000
CIWS Laser Array	+2	Size III	$45,000,000

CLASS C EEV TYPE 337 FTL

▶ **Capacity** 5 ▶ **Length** 14 m

An ICC standardized escape module designed by Bodenwerke Gesellschaft to replace the military's aged BD-409 EEV, the L-shaped EEV Type 337 is built into the outer hull of many modern starships. When the ship is crippled and there is no time to awaken the crew from stasis, MU/TH/UR will transfer the crew's cryosleep capsules to the EEVs and auto-eject them. The 337 can sustain a crew in stasis for upwards of fifty years. FTL range is limited to 1.4 parsecs, but they are capable of a controlled landing.

CLASS D LIFEBOAT MODULE

▶ **Capacity** 2–20 ▶ **Length** 23 m

This maneuverable escape craft is an ejectable module built into many high-end FTL spacecraft. The module has seven rooms that can be configured as a mission dictates, ranging from a simple crew lifeboat to luxury quarters to an experimental science lab. It can support three active occupants for two years or up to twenty people in cryosleep for fifty. The module can make planetfall and be programmed for atmospheric flight.

Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

Particle Beam Weapon: These weapons accelerate particles in a kinetic energy wave that causes damaging ionization, and can overheat electronics to the point of shutdown. Particle beam weapons function differently from other ship armaments. First, countermeasures have no effect against them. Second, their base damage rating is reduced by 1 for each range category beyond Contact. Third, they inflict no Hull damage, only component damage. Read more about spaceship combat on page 140.

Orbital Mines: Cheap and very effective against unwanted boarding parties, orbital mines are a cost-effective short-range weapon. Individual mines must be purchased separately.

Tactical Nukes: Shipborne nukes are deployed from orbit to destroy planetary based targets, even entire colonies. A 50-megaton nuke will completely destroy all buildings and kill all living beings within a 10 km radius, and cause damage to buildings and people up to 100 km away from the center of detonation. In addition, a high-altitude detonation will create an electromagnetic pulse that destroys unshielded electronics. A nuclear missile battery can typically fit five missiles. Individual missiles must be purchased separately.

CIWS Laser Array: The defensive countermeasure CIWS – Close in Weapons System – is a laser array designed to target and shoot down incoming missiles, and even railgun rounds.

Sensor Drones: When launched, sensor drones create false sensor signatures that can maneuver at speed and can lure away incoming missiles and railgun targeting systems.

Sensor Decoys: These devices register as false radar signatures to confuse weapons.

Reworking Your Ship

To mount new modules or armaments to your ship, or to make upgrades to it, you'll need to find a dry dock on a major space station or planetside colony. The cost of a module or armament typically includes the work of fitting it to your ship. The work can take a week or more, depending on the size of the module and if you're willing to pay extra to get it done faster.



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

Upgrades

Upgrades are a great way to customize your ship and spend those hard-earned W-Y dollars. All upgrades are listed in the table below.

Added Hardpoints: You add one more hardpoint to your ship, of the same size as your current biggest hardpoint or smaller. This upgrade can be purchased twice.

Armored Bulkheads: Exterior ship bulkheads can be fitted with laminated insulators, micrometeorite shielding, composite material, and aerogel. This upgrade gives your ship an armor level of 1. This upgrade can be purchased up to three times, for a maximum armor level of 3. Note that spaceship armor is on a different scale from personal armor. Even a spaceship without this upgrade has at least armor level 1 for the purposes of personal combat.

Boosted Displacement Drives: The FTL rating of your ship is reduced 1 step. You can purchase this upgrade up to six times.

Enhanced Sensors: Your active sensor array is boosted, giving you +1 die to the target lock action (page 143). You can purchase this upgrade up to two times.

External Modules: Fittings for an extra module of the same size as your current biggest module or smaller are added externally to your ship. Your ship won't be pretty, but if you're desperate for more room, who cares? You need to buy the actual module separately. This upgrade can be purchased twice. Each purchase reduces your ship's Thrusters rating by 1.

Overpowered Thrusters: The Thrusters rating of your ship is increased by 1. You can purchase this upgrade up to two times.

Planetfall Capacity: With this upgrade, your ship is capable of atmospheric entry and can land on any rock you like. Read more about this on page 109.

Reinforced Frame: The structural frame of your ship is reinforced, increasing its Hull rating by 1. You can purchase this upgrade up to three times.

Stealth Technology: Your ship is fitted with hull panels made of radar absorbent materials, and your thruster outlets have infrared suppressors to disguise the engine flare. The upgrade allows you to run dark (page 141) without powering down your engines or sensors. Also, the Signature rating of your ship is reduced by 2. ●

Ship Upgrades

UPGRADE	COST
Added Hardpoint, size I	$1,000,000
Added Hardpoint, size II	$4,000,000
Added Hardpoint, size III	$10,000,000
Armored Bulkheads	$2,000,000
Boosted Displacement Drives	$1,400,000
Enhanced Sensors	$2,200,000
External Module, size I	$100,000
External Module, size II	$500,000
External Module, size III	$1,000,000
External Module, size IV	$4,000,000
External Module, size V	$10,000,000
Overpowered Thrusters	$1,500,000
Planetfall Capacity	$1,800,000
Reinforced Frame	$1,200,000
Stealth Technology	$50,000,000

Regular Maintenance

Every week, a member of your crew needs to make one **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll and one **COMTECH** roll to service your ship. Each roll takes one shift of work. Only one person can roll, but others can help. If you're all in cryosleep, get a synthetic to do the work for you. A ship A.I. like MU/TH/UR can handle the **COMTECH** service, but not **HEAVY MACHINERY**. If a service skill roll fails, or is not made during a particular week, your ship will suffer minor component damage. Roll D66 on the table on page 145.

"When we throw the switches, how long before the ship blows?"

"Ten minutes."

"No bullshit?"

"We ain't outta here in ten minutes, we won't need no rocket to fly through space."

Lt. Ellen Ripley and Chief Engineer Dennis Parker

Licensed Sysop (Order: 53.15.1103)

SPACESHIPS OF THE 2180S

Starcub Shuttle

An aging design that still sees use on the Frontier, the Starcub shuttle is often used as an auxiliary craft on freighters and other large ships. While older models only carried two cryosleep chambers, the later Starcub models carry three aboard. In addition to her main engines, a Starcub is equipped with unidirectional thrusters that allow for equal forward and reverse acceleration. The Starcub is also capable of short-distance FTL flights and has a maximum range of 13 parsecs before refueling becomes necessary.

Noteworthy Ships: The Narcissus was one of two Starcub shuttles that were attached to the USCSS Nostromo in 2122 when Warrant Officer Ripley used it to escape the starfreighter's destruction. The second shuttle – the Salmacis – was damaged in a docking accident prior to Nostromo leaving Thedus and not aboard at the time, something that would never happen today. The new ICC safety protocols prohibit a ship from leaving port without a full complement of auxiliary vehicles or EEVs.

STARCUB SHUTTLE

C-Class Intrasystem Vessel

▶ **Manufacturer**	Lockmart		
▶ **Cost**	$2,260,000		
▶ **Crew**	1	▶ **Signature**	–1
▶ **AI**	None	▶ **Thrusters**	+2
▶ **Length**	16 m	▶ **Hull**	2
▶ **FTL Rating**	15	▶ **Armor Level**	0
▶ **Passengers**	3 (in cryosleep)		
▶ **Internal Modules:**	Air Scrubbers I		
	Cargo Bay I		
	Cryo Deck II		
▶ **Upgrades:**	None		
▶ **Armaments**	None		

"Yes! I say that we abandon this ship! We get the shuttle and just get the hell out of here! We take our chances and... just hope that somebody will pick us up!"

"Lambert, the shuttle won't take four."

Joan Lambert and Lt. Ellen Ripley



Licensed System (Order: 53151103)



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

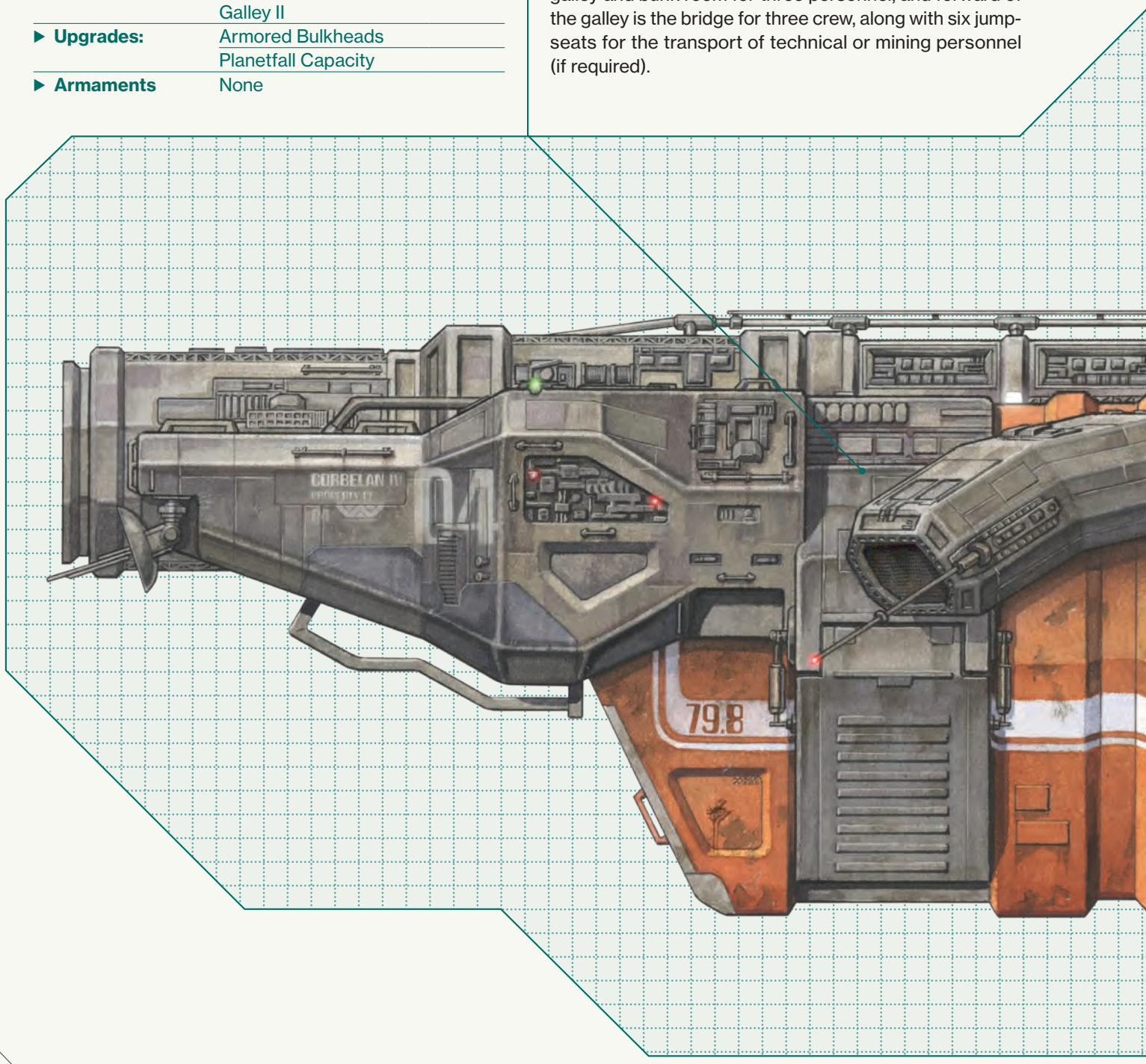
MODEL CM-93D MULE

G-Class Commercial Ore Transport Vessel			
▶ **Manufacturer**	Weyland-Yutani		
▶ **Cost**	$13,325,000		
▶ **Crew**	3	▶ **Signature**	+0
▶ **AI**	None	▶ **Thrusters**	+1
▶ **Length**	30 m	▶ **Hull**	5
▶ **FTL Rating**	20	▶ **Armor Level**	1
▶ **Internal Modules:**	Air Scrubbers I		
	Cargo Bay III		
	Cargo Bay II		
	Docking Umbilical II		
	Galley II		
▶ **Upgrades:**	Armored Bulkheads		
	Planetfall Capacity		
▶ **Armaments**	None		

Model CM-93D Mule

For more than fifty years, these small but sturdy ore carriers have proven essential for any off-world mining endeavor. The CM-93 Mule ships freshly-mined ore from a world's surface up to orbit and to a waiting bulk carrier or Tesotek ore refinery. It carries a detachable ore transport pod that is held beneath the ship with heavy-duty clamps.

The crew areas run along the upper spine of the ship and consist of a forward docking airlock and suit-up area, with a connecting corridor leading to a secondary cargo bay at the rear. A ladder in this cargo section leads up to a galley and bunk room for three personnel, and forward of the galley is the bridge for three crew, along with six jump-seats for the transport of technical or mining personnel (if required).



Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

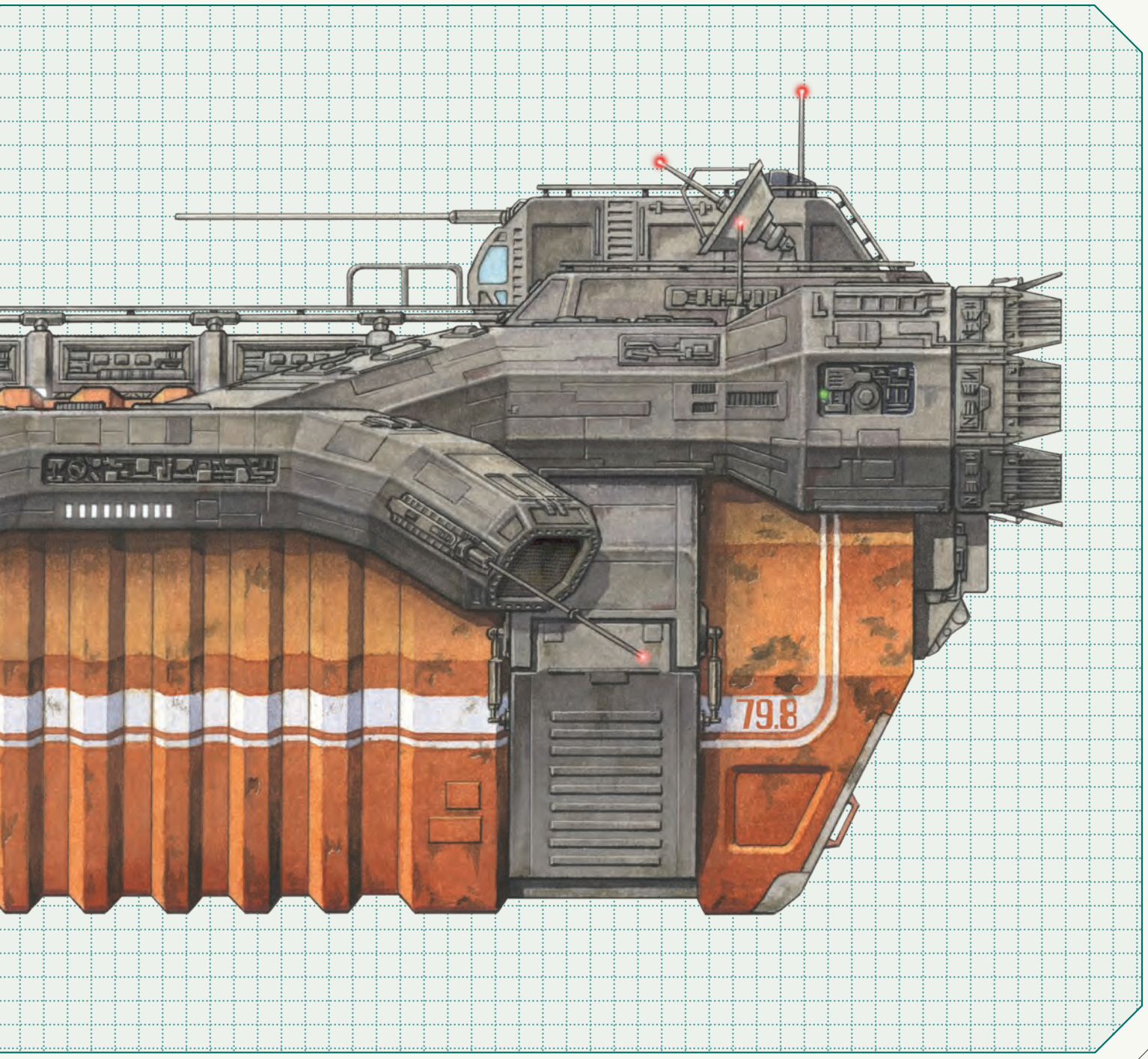
The modernized D model upgrades the hyperdrive for interstellar flight (the short-range original was fit only for flying to and from asteroid mines at the very edges of a star system).

Noteworthy Ships: The USCSS Corbelan IV, operating out of the Jackson's Star mining colony (page 269), was an early model CM-93 Mule which disappeared in 2142 after being stolen by a group of colonists.

"Is it as easy as you're making it sound, this plan of yours?"

"You won't even have to get out of the Corbelan. That much I can promise you, okay? Come on. What do you say?"

Rain and Tyler



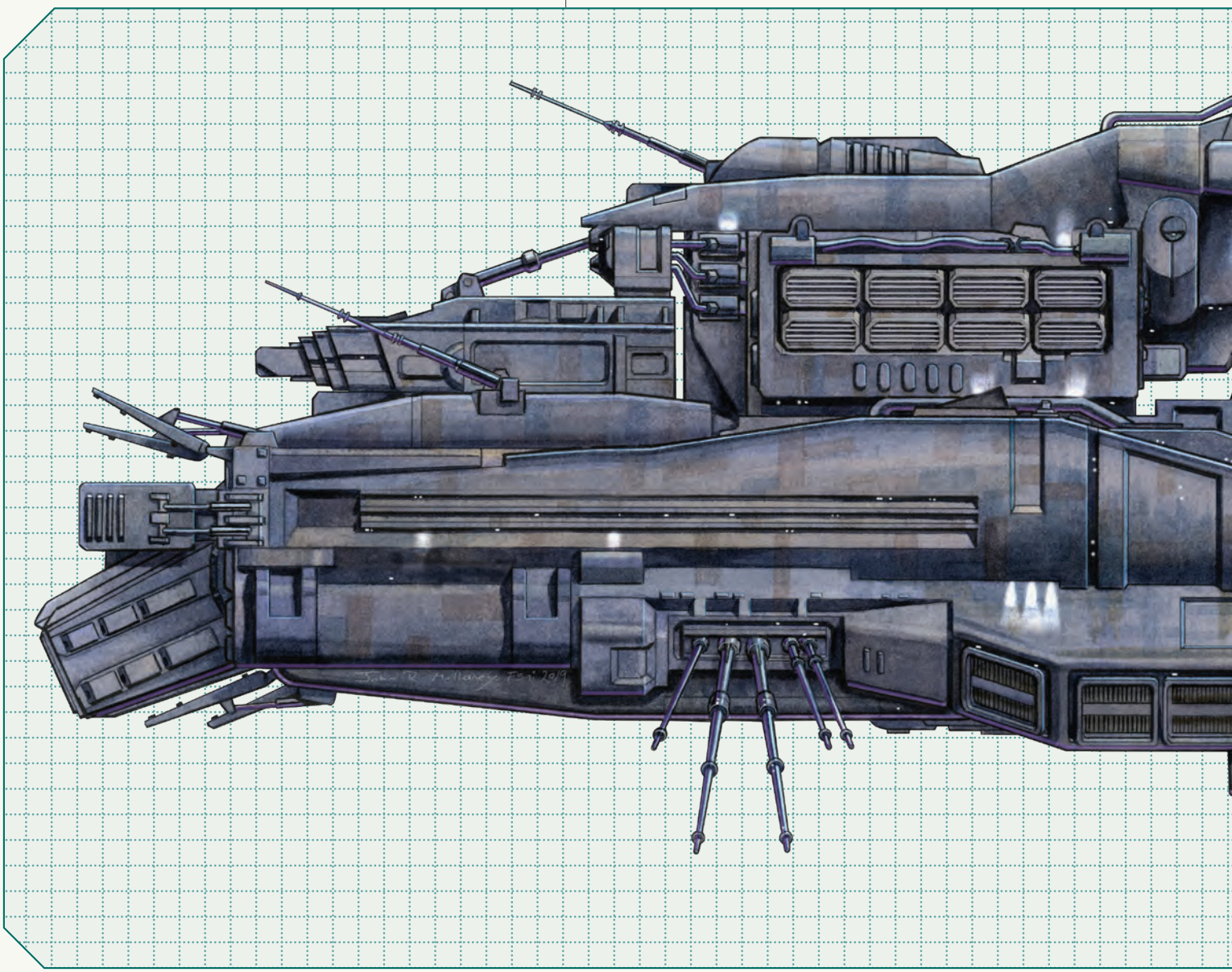
Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

Model CM-90S Corvus

Space salvage is a dirty but lucrative business. While an older model, the diminutive Corvus is a reliable design with a steady presence on the Frontier. Four overpowered multivector engines make hauling scrap that much easier while an underslung bridge allows the captain a good view of the crew at work. The ship is equipped with a tow crane rig for both heavy lifting and the towing of disabled craft. An external elevator common to Lockmart vessels is used to load cargo in the spacious zero G storage hangar.

While somewhat smaller than an M class vessel, her overpowered engines and reinforced crane/tow assembly nearly push the Corvus into that classification. Salvage missions can often go awry – the hulking space wreck that could be your payday just might have a faulty reactor that wants to explode. Because of this, the Corvus is equipped with a rear dorsal lifeboat that can accommodate most of the crew. The lifeboat can operate independently of its vessel for up to three months.

Noteworthy Ships: The USCSS Anesidora operated in and around the Tartarus Sector in the 2130s. The ship was destroyed when Sevastopol station's orbit decayed and the station spiraled into KG-348. Captain Clara Odenkirk's salvage vessel the USCSS Katharos operates out of Anchorpoint station. As the Katharos is often the first ship on the scene of any wreck, the Colonial Marshal Bureau is investigating any connections between her captain and the frequently disabled ships in the Far Reach.



Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

"I'm going to overload the fusion reactor."

"That'll turn the reactor into a God damn nuke! You'll destroy the ship! And the station!"

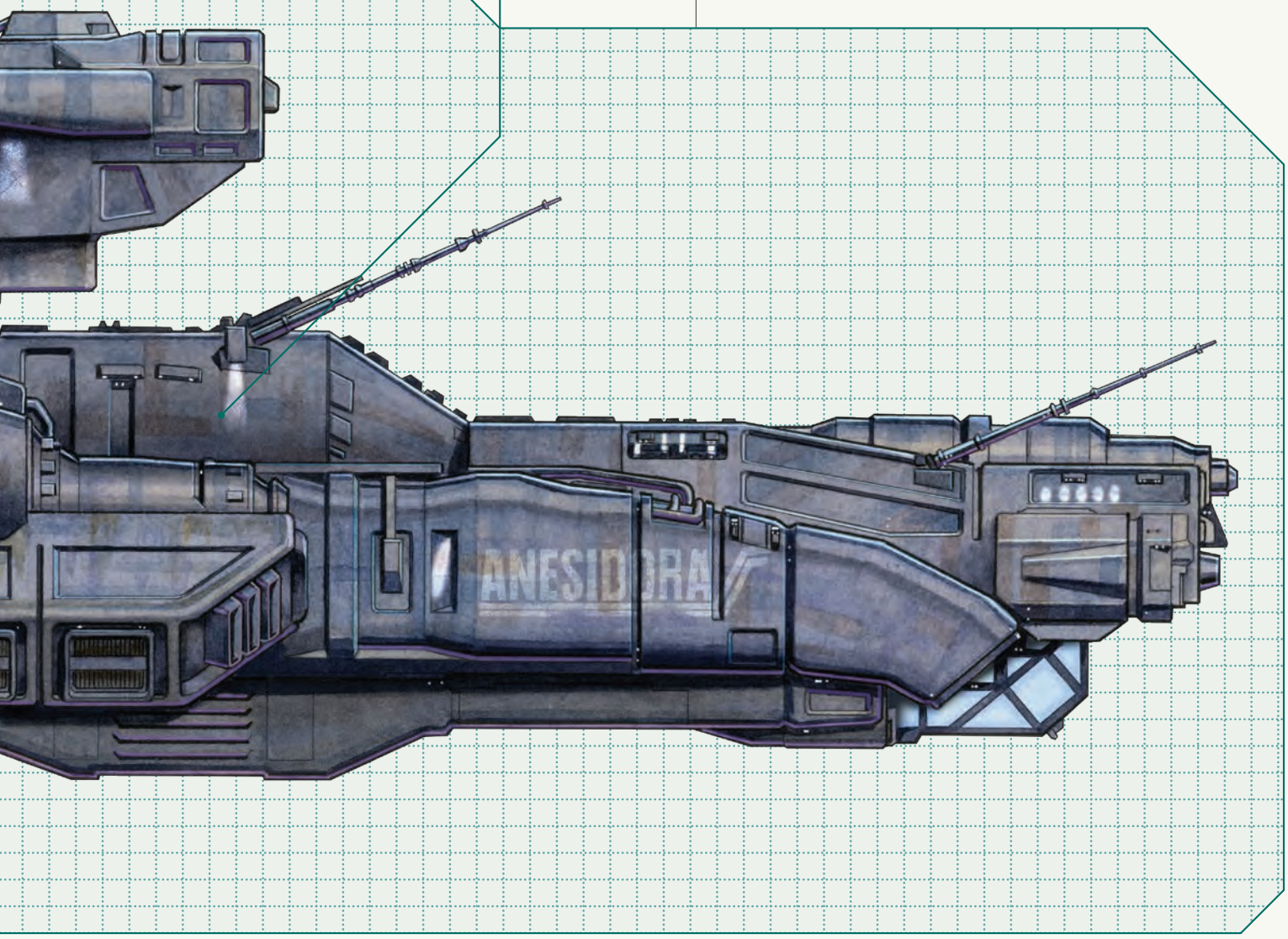
"It'll annihilate every trace of the creature. Ripley, it's the only way. I can't let it live."

Henry Marlow
and Amanda Ripley

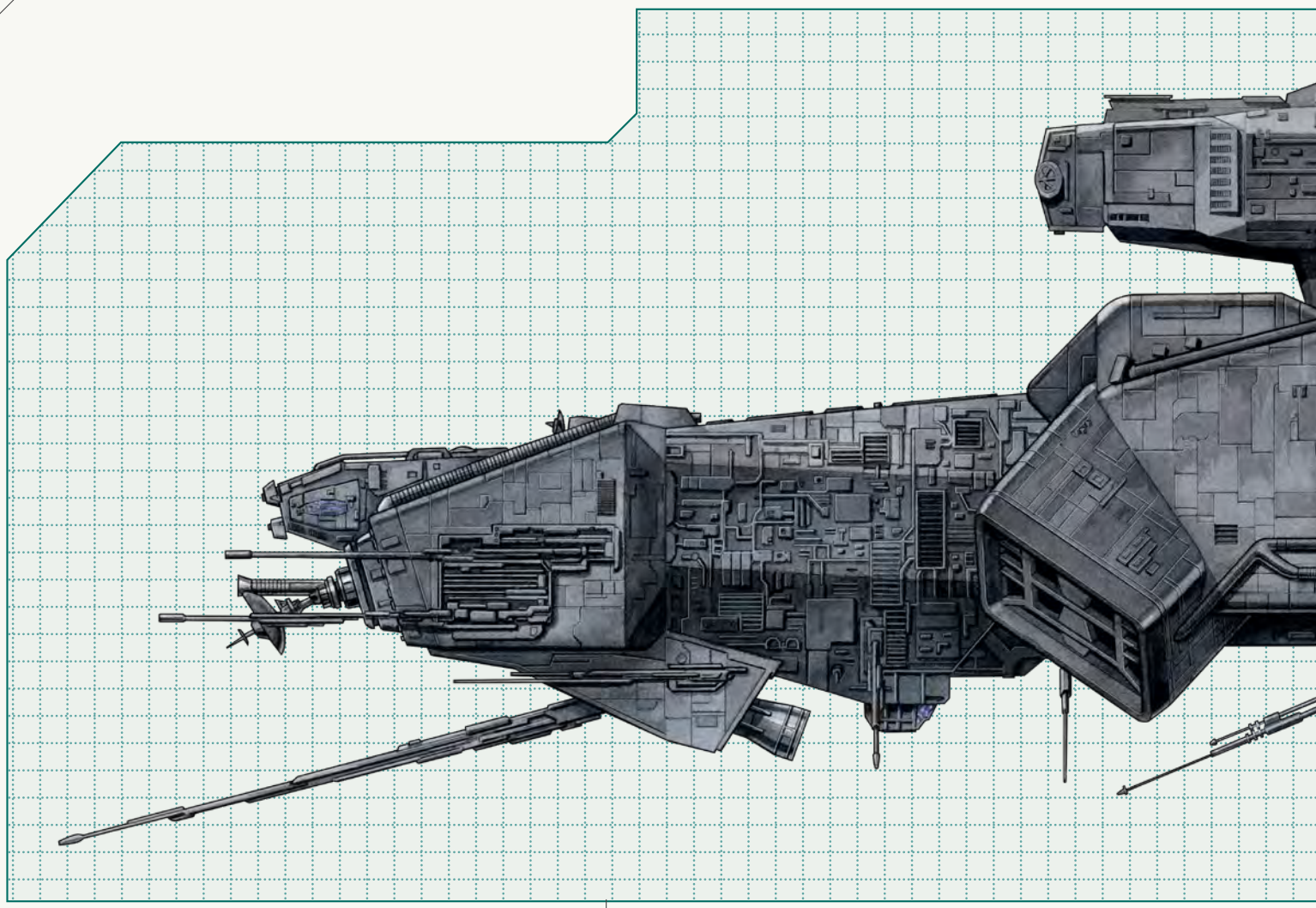
MODEL CM-90S CORVUS

G-Class Commercial Deep Space Salvage Vessel

▶ **Manufacturer**	Lockmart		
▶ **Cost**	$18,350,000		
▶ **Crew**	6	▶ **Signature**	+0
▶ **AI**	MU/TH/UR 6000	▶ **Thrusters**	+1
▶ **Length**	54 m	▶ **Hull**	6
▶ **FTL Rating**	20	▶ **Armor Level**	1
▶ **Internal Modules:**	Artificial Intelligence I		
	Air Scrubbers II		
	Cargo Bay III		
	Cryo Deck II		
	Docking Umbilical II		
	EEV II		
	Galley II		
	Hangar III		
	Salvage Crane III		
▶ **Upgrades:**	Armored Bulkheads		
	Planetfall Capacity		
	Reinforced Frame		
▶ **Armaments**	None		



Licensed System (Order: 53151103)



Model CM-88G Bison

A well-known vessel in the shipping lanes, the popular CM-88 series Bison has gone through little in the way of cosmetic changes over the past century. While originally advertised as an interstellar cruiser, ICC regulations made the Bison's weight class and interior volume an attractive candidate for hauling freight. Some entrepreneurs were even installing new engines on the Bison and converting her into a towing vessel.

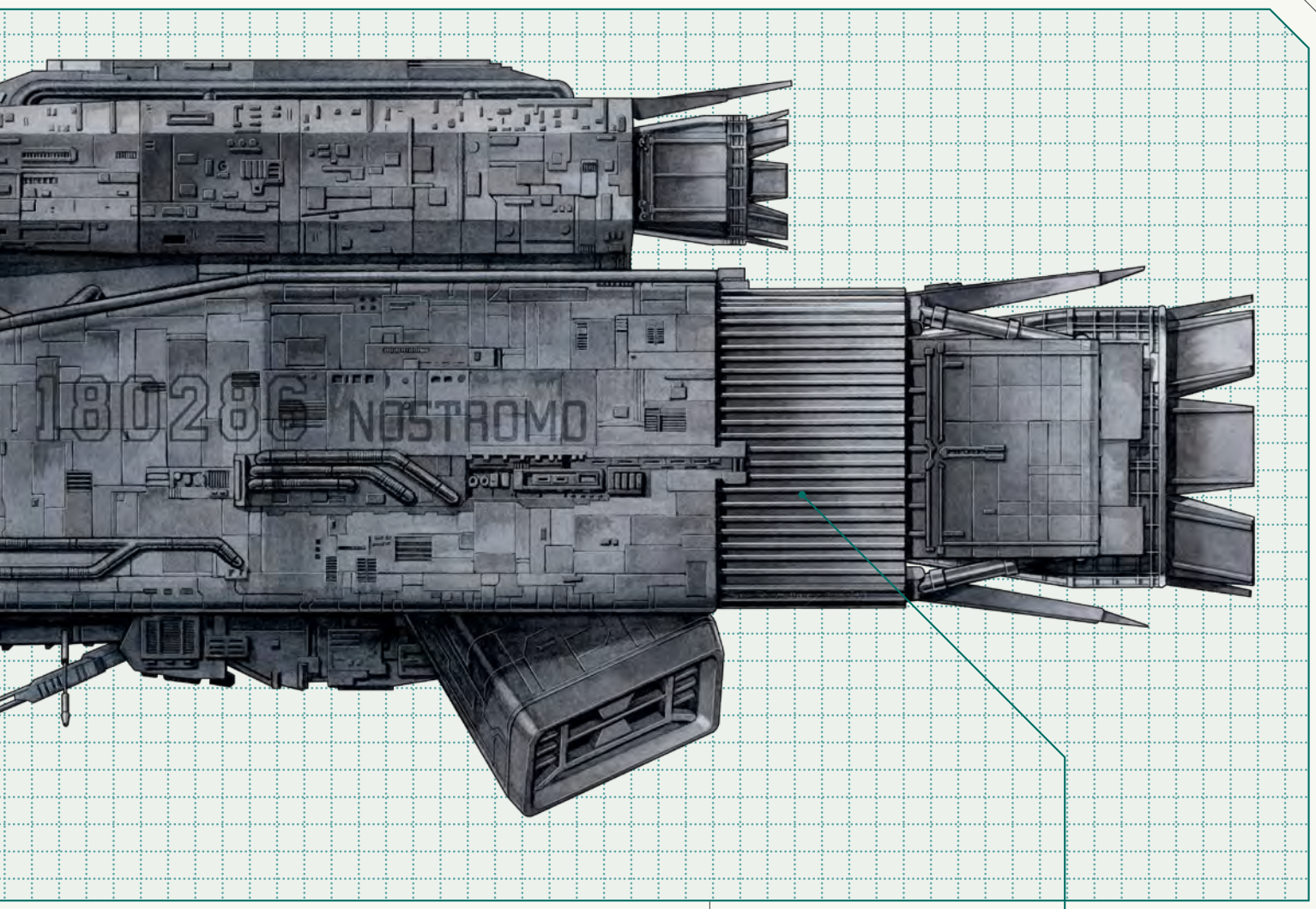
Manufacturer Lockmart decided to offer the ship in multiple configurations and upgrade packages. Newer models like the G have more sophisticated FTL packages and communications suites than the older B and D models, but their internal and external configurations are mostly the same. Plus, the Gs usually aren't as grimy. In its freighter configuration, the Bison carries its cargo in large internal cargo bays.

MODEL CM-88G BISON

M-Class Commercial Starfreighter

▶ **Manufacturer**	Lockmart		
▶ **Cost**	$38,300,000		
▶ **Crew**	7	▶ **Signature**	+1
▶ **AI**	MU/TH/UR 6500	▶ **Thrusters**	+0
▶ **Length**	334 m	▶ **Hull**	9
▶ **FTL Rating**	12	▶ **Armor Level**	1
▶ **Internal Modules:**	Artificial Intelligence I		
	Air Scrubbers II		
	Cargo Bay IV × 4		
	Cryo Deck II		
	Docking Umbilical II		
	EEV II × 2		
	Galley II		
	Medlab II		
▶ **Upgrades:**	Armored Bulkheads		
	Planetfall Capacity		
▶ **Armaments**	None		

Licensed System (Order: 53151103)



Model CM-88H Bison

The 88H is the latest upgrade to transform a Bison starfreighter into a full-fledged towing vehicle. Unlike the previous models, wherein an extensive overhaul would be required to upgrade the Bison's engine manifold, the H model has easily removable modular engine cores, allowing the Saturn J engines to be swapped out for a Rolls Royce with only a week in drydock.

So configured, the 88H can haul and deliver a massive oil refinery, ore processing plant, atmospheric processor, orbital station, or living modules. While even more powerful engines could be installed, they would alter the Bison's weight class and defeat the purpose of utilizing a Bison for this kind of work in the first place.

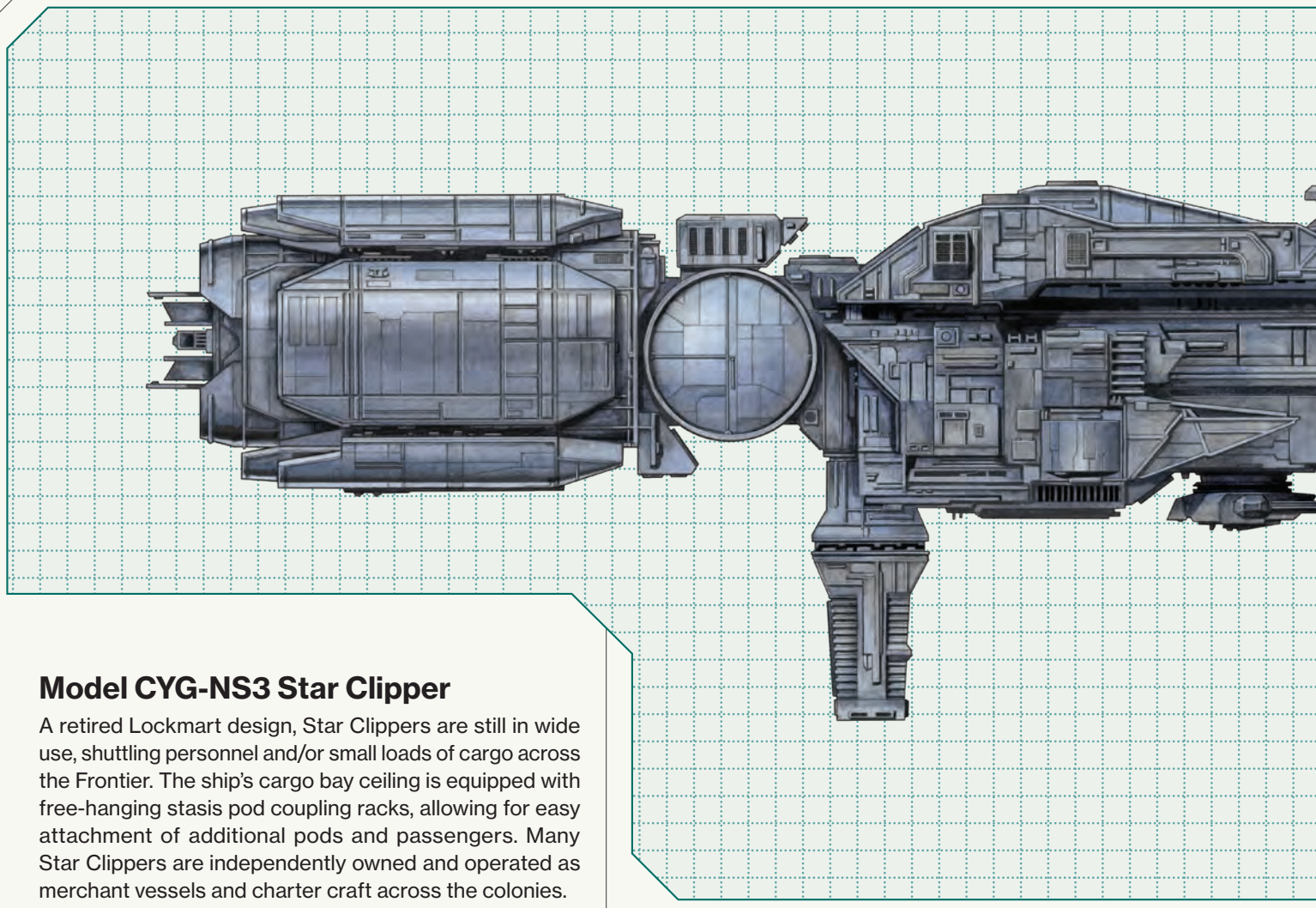
Noteworthy Ships: The infamous USCSS Nostromo was an 88B Bison in a towing configuration similar to the H. The Nostromo and the ore refinery module she towed were destroyed in the 2120s when her self-destruct was set by her third officer for reasons unknown

MODEL CM-88H BISON

M-Class Commercial Starfreighter

▶ **Manufacturer**	Lockmart		
▶ **Cost**	$45,500,000		
▶ **Crew**	7	▶ **Signature**	+1
▶ **AI**	MU/TH/UR 7000	▶ **Thrusters**	+0
▶ **Length**	334 m	▶ **Hull**	9
▶ **FTL Rating**	8	▶ **Armor Level**	1
▶ **Internal Modules:**	Artificial Intelligence I		
	Air Scrubbers II		
	Cargo Bay IV × 2		
	Cryo Deck II		
	Docking Umbilical II		
	EEV II × 2 (Starcub Shuttles)		
	Galley II		
	Medlab II		
	Tractor Hitch III		
▶ **Upgrades:**	Armored Bulkheads		
	Boosted Displacement Drives × 4		
	Planetfall Capacity		
▶ **Armaments**	None		

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Model CYG-NS3 Star Clipper

A retired Lockmart design, Star Clippers are still in wide use, shuttling personnel and/or small loads of cargo across the Frontier. The ship's cargo bay ceiling is equipped with free-hanging stasis pod coupling racks, allowing for easy attachment of additional pods and passengers. Many Star Clippers are independently owned and operated as merchant vessels and charter craft across the colonies.

MODEL CYG-NS3 STAR CLIPPER

M-Class Commercial Transport Ship

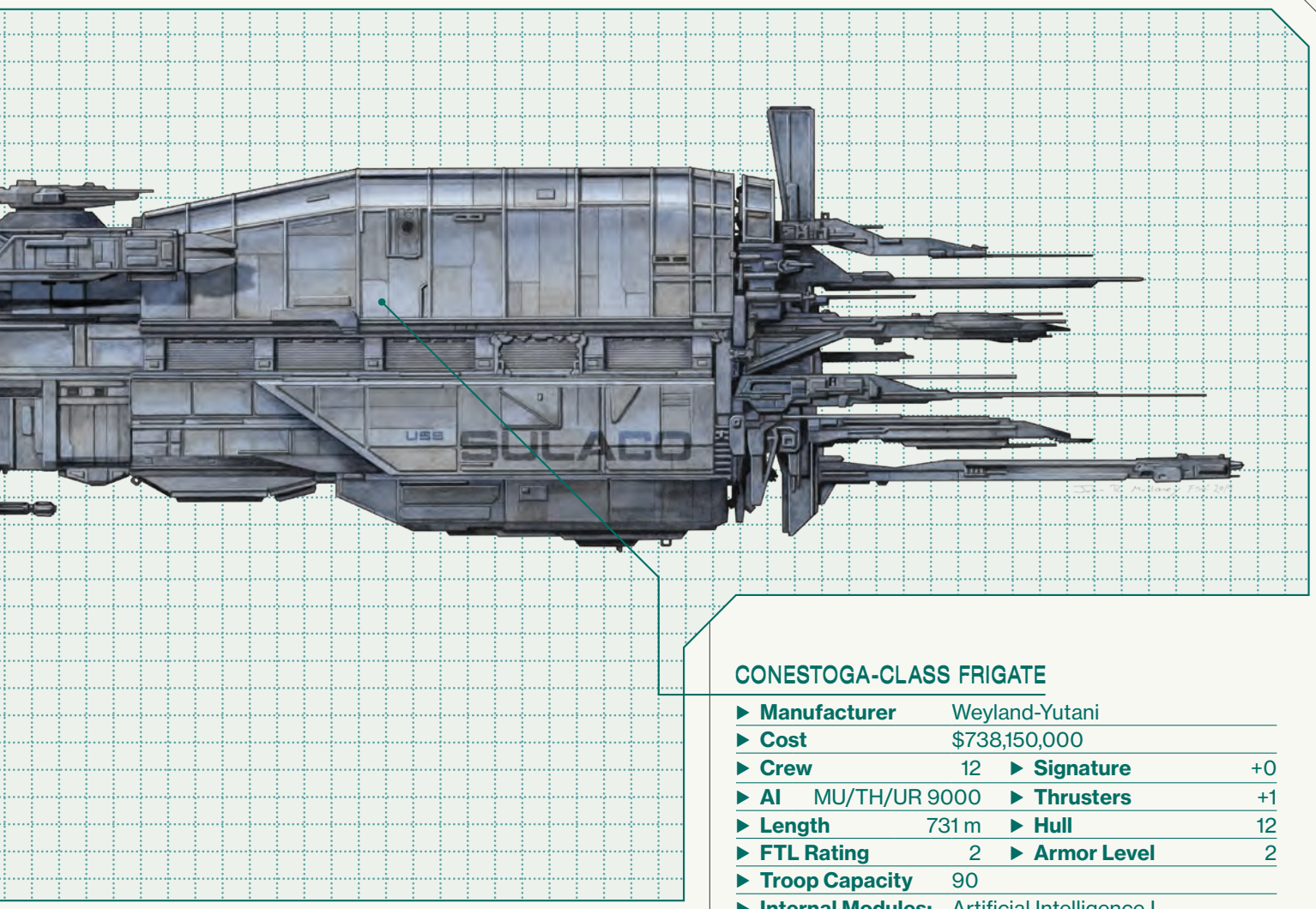
▶ **Manufacturer**	Lockmart		
▶ **Cost**	$62,475,000		
▶ **Crew**	6	▶ **Signature**	+1
▶ **AI**	MU/TH/UR 6500	▶ **Thrusters**	+1
▶ **Length**	300 m	▶ **Hull**	9
▶ **FTL Rating**	6	▶ **Armor Level**	0
▶ **Passengers**	200 (in cryosleep)		
▶ **Internal Modules:**	Artificial Intelligence I		
	Air Scrubbers III		
	Cargo Bay III × 4		
	Cryo Deck IV		
	Docking Umbilical II		
	EEV II × 4		
	Galley III		
	Medlab II		
▶ **Upgrades:**	Boosted Displacement Drives × 6		
	Planetfall Capacity		
	Overpowered Thrusters		
▶ **Armaments**	None		

Conestoga-Class Frigate

The versatile Conestoga-Class Frigate is the most common ship in use by the USCMC and Colonial Marshal Bureau. The frigate boasts a modular interior for different assignment configurations, as well as numerous hard points for the addition or subtraction of weapons arrays. The Conestoga can be used as a science vessel, a military cargo hauler, a hospital ship, or, most commonly, a troop transport. The ship's MU/TH/UR 9000 computer is capable of performing mission assignments without the aid of crew, so long as it does not need to make planetfall.

Dropships are deployed from a ventral hangar, and the frigate can be fitted with an external docking rack to transport a phalanx of EVAC fighters. The design is built by a subsidiary of Weyland-Yutani, and as such they can be found in the possession of corporate crews as well as the military. While 36 were commissioned by the USCMC, only 25 of those remain active. It is unclear how many W-Y possesses as they were manufactured within the ICSC. In its standard military configuration, the Conestoga is a force to be reckoned with. You see one coming your way? Don't piss them off.

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CONESTOGA-CLASS FRIGATE

▶ **Manufacturer**	Weyland-Yutani		
▶ **Cost**	$738,150,000		
▶ **Crew**	12	▶ **Signature**	+0
▶ **AI**	MU/TH/UR 9000	▶ **Thrusters**	+1
▶ **Length**	731 m	▶ **Hull**	12
▶ **FTL Rating**	2	▶ **Armor Level**	2
▶ **Troop Capacity**	90		
▶ **Internal Modules:**	Artificial Intelligence I		
	Air Scrubbers IV		
	Cargo Bay III		
	Cryo Deck IV		
	Docking Umbilical II		
	EEV I × 20		
	Galley IV		
	Hangar IV		
	Medlab II		
▶ **Upgrades:**	Armored Bulkheads × 2		
	Boosted Displacement Drives × 6		
	Enhanced Sensors		
	Overpowered Thrusters × 2		
	Stealth Technology		
▶ **Armaments**	Long Lance ASAT Missiles (8 missiles)		
	Heavy Railgun Turret		
	800MeV Particle Beam Weapon		
	Orbital Mines (60 mines)		
	Tactical Nukes (20 missiles)		
	CIWS Laser Array		
	Sensor Drones		
	Sensor Decoys		

Noteworthy Ships: The frequent sightings and ghost stories of the ill-fated USCMC troop transport USS Sulaco are well circulated on the Frontier. The W-Y Medical Frigate USCSS Patna operates out of Anchorpoint station. Stripped of its rail guns and long arm missile pod, the Patna is W-Y XO Michael Bishop's mobile headquarters on the Frontier, and is equipped with six science labs, a full surgical bay operating a dozen MedPods, and an entire platoon of combat ready mercenaries. The Patna's full capabilities are unknown, although she is rumored to carry nukes while moving through UPP and UA space – a clear violation of both the Strategic Arms Reduction and Washington Treaties.

"Distress. My unit has suffered immense casualties on LV-426 and requesting immediate assistance aboard the USS Sulaco. Survivors: Myself, two human females, one of which is a child, and a damaged synthetic."

Cpl. Dwayne Hicks

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Common Spaceships

CLASS	MODEL	ROLE	COST
C-Class	Starcub	Light Intrasystem Shuttle	$2,260,000
G-Class	Mule CM-93D	Commercial Ore Transport Vessel	$13,325,000
G-Class	Corvus CM-90S	Commercial Deep Space Salvage Vessel	$16,550,000
M-Class	Bison CM-88G	Commercial Starfreighter	$38,300,000
M-Class	Bison CM-88H	Commercial Towing Vehicle	$45,500,000
M-Class	Star Clipper CYG-NS3	Commercial Transport Ship	$62,475,000
Conestoga	Frigate RRTT-3	Rapid Response Troop Transport	$738,150,000

SMUGGLER'S RUN

OVERHEARD IN THE OKIE CLUB ON ANCHORPOINT STATION

So I teamed up with that bastard Tomland and we were on the Volcus run. We had just skimmed the ICSC border and were in the middle of taking on a juiced tanker module meant for some dipshit colony in the Far Reach, I don't remember which one. This was ten – shit, eleven years ago. My contact – the guy making the delivery – had just unhitched his tug from the tanker and guess who stumbles right onto us? Goddamn border patrol. Colonial marshals riding a Conestoga frigate.

Delivery boy panics and fires on the marshals with a mining laser. Yep. They don't like that one bit, so they cycle up the rail gun and send a spike right up his ass. It cut his tug in two and plows right into the damn energy tanker. The juice in those batteries went up real fast. The Cony got slammed with the blast and we used the diversion to get the fuck out of there. But those marshals weren't done yet. They took off after us – and I mean right after us.

Tomland was flying in a god damn straight line. The only maneuvers he made were to keep the Cony directly behind us. Always. I thought he was crazy until I saw they weren't firing on us – not even a warning shot. Tomland was ex-military and knew his shit. He figured the EMP from the tanker explosion had fried the Cony's particle beams and ASATs, but her rails should have worked just fine. Turns out the big bitch can't fire her big guns straight on – they're right in the line of sight of her hull. For all her bluster, she's got a blind spot right in front and behind her.

Tommy kept us dead ahead of them until we gained enough distance to kick in the displacement drive and go FTL. The marshals stayed behind to clean up the mess. In the end, the cargo was blown, my contact was dead, the marshals were pissed, and the Cony was fried. We managed to get out of there though. I scuttled the ship, quit the business and became a cattle rancher on Terraform 3. Much happier now. I'm only here on Anchorpoint to drop off a load of beef. ▮

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

SPACE COMBAT

SPACE BATTLES IN THE 2180s are short and brutal, with the victory often going to the ship who spots the enemy first and gets their best shot in. This section deals with space combat and describes how to play out a violent encounter.

Fleets: Ships in space combat are divided into two fleets, approaching each other. Most ship battles in the game are one-on-one duels.

Time: Space combat takes longer than ground combat and is therefore played out in stretches of time (page 55) instead of rounds.

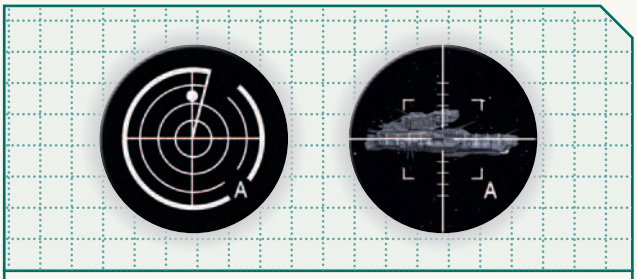
Actions: The actions available in space combat are clearly defined and depend on your crew position. You can perform one action per stretch of combat. There are no full and quick actions.

Crew Positions

Spaceship crews can vary greatly, from a single person to scores of people. Typically, crews are divided into the following positions:

- **Executive Officer:** In overall command of the ship. Gives orders and rolls initiative.
- **Navigation Officer:** The person at the flight controls. Makes **PILOTING** rolls for ship maneuvers, modified by the ship's Thrusters rating.
- **Science Officer:** Operate the ship's sensors, using the **COMTECH** skill.
- **Engineers:** Make emergency repairs, using the **COMTECH** or **HEAVY MACHINERY** skill.
- **Gunners :** Fire the ship's armaments, using the **RANGED COMBAT** skill. Each weapon or countermeasure generally requires at least one gunner. Unarmed ships don't have gunners.

There is only one executive officer, navigation officer, and science officer on each ship, but a ship may have multiple engineers and gunners. For very small ships, a single person can fill two or even more positions. Note that a MU/TH/UR or similar ship computer mainframe can fill any or all of the crew positions if needed.



SHIP TOKENS

The Hope's Last Day Starter Set includes tokens for spaceship combat. Each token represents one ship and is placed on the space combat track to mark its position. Each token has a side with a "ping" only, to mark a ship running silent, and a side with a spaceship in crosshairs, used for a target locked ship or one that runs with its transponders on.

CREW TITLES

The crew positions used here are actual titles used on UA commercial spacecraft. PCs onboard a ship can assume any position needed during space combat however, and even switch positions between one stretch of combat and another.

Distance & Segments

Space is too vast for it to be meaningful to keep track of the exact distance between ships. Instead, abstract segments are used. One segment can be hundreds or even thousands of kilometers wide. Also, all movement in space combat only occurs in one dimension along a range track – an abstraction of the three-dimensional movement that is actually taking place.

Space Combat Track: To keep track of ship distances, you can use the space combat track found at the back of this book (also available for download from the Free League website).

Range: Like in regular combat, the range between ships is divided into range categories. See the adjacent table.

Contact (C)	Short (S)	Medium (M)	Long (L)	Extreme (E)
In the same segment. Ramming and boarding is possible.	Adjacent segment. Visual contact limit.	Two segments away.	Up to four segments distant.	Up to eight segments distant. Sensor limit.

Approach Velocity

Spaceships travel at incredible speeds. This means that two ships approaching on different velocity vectors will quickly pass beyond the range of each other's weapons. Drastically changing your vector is hard. This means most combat encounters will be brief.

Initial Velocity: When two ships (or fleets) approach each other, the GM sets the initial approach velocity of each ship – the speed at which it enters the space combat track. It's typically 2 segments per stretch but can be higher or lower depending on the situation.

Multiple Ships: If more than two ships are involved in the encounter, all ships in each fleet have the same initial approach velocity, but the ships can change their velocity individually during combat.

Sensors & Transponders

All spaceship sensors have Extreme range (8 segments). When two ships enter sensor range, they automatically detect each other's presence, unless one of them, or both, is running dark (below). After detection, place a token representing each ship on the outermost segments of the space combat track (the ones marked +4 and −4).

Transponders: All civilian spacecraft are required to travel with their transponders switched on. The transponder transmits data about the ship's position, name, class, home port, and destination. If a ship within sensor range has an active transponder, you will immediately learn this information, and you are able to target the ship with your ship armaments. If you are using tokens from the Starter Set, use the side with a spaceship in crosshairs. It's common to turn transponders off at the start of combat, to avoid being target locked easily (page 143). This does not require a roll or an action.

Running Silent: Traveling with the transponder switched off is unlawful and regarded with suspicion – only smugglers and military vessels do that. If a ship enters sensor range running silent, you will still detect its presence, but your science officer needs to successfully target lock the ship before you can target it with your weapons. Until this is done, leave the spaceship token with the "ping" side up.

Leaving Combat: If the range between two ships exceeds 8 segments during combat, the engagement ends.

Running Dark

To avoid detection altogether, a ship can run dark. However, unless you have the Stealth Technology upgrade (page 127), this requires you to power down your sensors and your engines before you enter sensor range.

Running Dark

POWER DOWN	SIGNATURE	CREW POSITION
Sensors	−1	Science Officer
Engine	−2	Engineer

Effects: Besides allowing you to run dark, powering down sensors modifies your Signature rating by –1, and powering down engines modifies Signature by –2, for a total of –3. When your sensors are down, your science officer cannot target lock enemy ships (page 143). When engines are offline, your navigation officer cannot perform any actions at all during the movement phase.

Detection: To detect a ship running dark within sensor range, a passive **COMTECH** roll is made by your science officer each stretch, modified by the modified Signature rating of the hidden ship. If successful, place the ship tokens on the space combat track at the current distance from each other, as close to the middle of the track as possible. A detected ship is still considered to be running silent (page 141). If no detection roll succeeds before the hidden ship exits sensor range, it remains undetected, and no engagement occurs.

Powering Up: Powering sensors up is done by the science officer in the sensor phase and requires no roll. Powering engines up is done by an engineer in the engineering phase and requires a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll (one attempt per stretch is allowed).

Going Dark In Combat: You can power down sensors and or the engine even during combat. This won't make you "disappear" but it will reduce your ship's Signature, making it harder to target lock your ship. Powering down in combat works just like powering up, except that powering down the engine requires no roll. ▶

NPC SHIPS RUNNING DARK

When a ship controlled by NPCs is running dark and enters sensor range of your ship, the GM will typically ask your science officer to make a passive **COMTECH** roll each stretch the ship remains in sensor range without telling you why, or even make these rolls in secret. If no roll succeeds, you fail to spot the NPC ship.

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Initiative

Spaceship combat doesn't use initiative cards. Instead, after detection, an initiative roll is made. This is an open opposed roll (page 44) for **COMMAND**, performed by the executive officer on each ship. The winner of the roll may choose whether to act first or last in each phase of combat, throughout the engagement.

The initiative roll doesn't count as an action and is only rolled in the first stretch of combat. The choice of going first or last cannot be changed during the entire combat. If there is more than one ship on each side, the highest-ranking officer in each fleet rolls. In case of a tie, re-roll (after pushing). Such re-rolls don't count as pushing.

MULTIPLE FLEETS

If there are three or more distinct fleets in a space combat, two sides generally start the engagement while additional fleets enter the fray in the second stretch or later, entering the space combat track from a side determined by the GM.

Combat Phases

Each stretch of spaceship combat is divided into five phases. Each character onboard a ship can only act in one phase, corresponding to their crew position. All ships perform their action(s) in the phase, in initiative order, before moving on to the next phase.

One spaceship combat stretch

1.	Command Phase
2.	Sensor Phase
3.	Movement Phase
4.	Attack Phase
5.	Engineering Phase

In a fleet with multiple ships, the highest-ranking officer in the fleet decides in which order its ships act in each phase.

⚠ **Interrupt Actions:** Some actions in space combat are interrupt actions and can be declared on the turn of an enemy ship. If a crew member performs an interrupt action, they lose their own action in the same phase. Interrupt actions are marked with the ⚠ symbol in these rules.



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

1. Command Phase

In this phase, the executive officer on each ship gives orders to the rest of the crew and rolls **COMMAND**. For each ⌖ rolled, the executive officer can give +1 die to one action carried out by another crew member in the same stretch.

2. Sensor Phase

In this phase, the science officer of each ship can perform one of the actions listed below:

- **Target Lock:** This action is needed to be able to attack an enemy ship with transponders off. Make a **COMTECH** roll, modified by the Signature rating of the enemy ship and other factors (see the adjacent table). If successful, the ship may be targeted by your armaments in this stretch (if using tokens, flip it over to show the side with the spaceship image). The target lock only lasts until the end of the combat stretch (flip the token back over at the end of the stretch).
- ⚠ **Evade:** If the science officer performs this action, all attempts to target lock your ship during this stretch of combat become opposed **COMTECH** rolls – meaning the amount of ⌖ rolled by the enemy is reduced by the number of ⌖ rolled by you. This is an interrupt action, meaning it can be declared on the enemy's turn.
- **Power Sensors Up/Down:** Powering down the sensors modifies a ship's Signature by –1, but makes the target lock action impossible. No roll is required to power sensors up or down.

3. Movement Phase

In this phase, the navigation officer of each ship first performs one of the actions listed below. Then, after all actions are resolved, all ships move a number of segments on the space combat track equal to their current approach velocity. Note that movement itself is not an action.

- **Accelerate:** Roll for **PILOTING**, modified by the Thrusters rating. For each ⌖ rolled, the approach velocity of your ship is increased by 1.
- **Decelerate:** Roll for **PILOTING**, modified by the Thrusters rating. For each ⌖ rolled, the approach velocity of your ship is decreased by 1. Note that the Decelerate action may be used to reverse the direction of the ship's approach.
- **Ram:** This action can only be attempted if the target ship is at Contact range (same segment) at the start of the stretch. Roll for **PILOTING**, modified by the Thrusters rating. On a success, both ships suffer base damage equal to your ship's Hull rating divided by 2, rounding up. Extra damage due to additional ⌖ is inflicted on the target ship only.

Target Lock

FACTOR	MODIFIER
Target Ship Signature	Varies
Malfunctioning Sensors	–2
Target Ship Sensors Offline	–1
Target Ship Engines Offline	–2

MOVING OFF THE TRACK

Note that ship movement occurs at the end of the movement phase, after all actions have been resolved but before the attack phase begins. If a ship moves off the space combat track, but the distance to enemy ships is still 8 segments or less, simply move all ships an equal number of segments back onto the track. Remember – in space combat, only relative distance matters.

- **Dock:** This action can only be attempted if the target ship is at Contact range (same segment) at the start of the stretch, and if both ships have the same approach velocity. It also requires a Docking Station module. Roll for **PILOTING**, modified by the Thrusters rating. If successful, your engineers may try to breach the enemy ship (see phase #5).

4. Attack Phase

In this phase, one gunner on each ship can perform one of the actions described below, assuming your ship is fitted with one or more armaments. Only one weapon may be launched in a stretch, even if you have several weapons (and gunners) on your ship.

- **Fire Weapon:** Only a target locked enemy within range of the weapon can be attacked. Roll for **RANGED COMBAT**, modified for the weapon used. On a hit, the attack inflicts the weapon's base damage on the target, plus 1 damage point for every ⌖ rolled beyond the first. Damage may be reduced by armor (page 144).
- ⚠ **Launch Countermeasures:** If a gunner performs this action, all attempts to attack your ship during this stretch of combat become opposed **RANGED COMBAT** rolls – meaning the amount of ⌖ rolled by the enemy is reduced by the number of ⌖ rolled by you. This is an interrupt action, meaning it can be declared on the enemy's turn. ▶

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5. Engineering Phase

In this phase, an engineer on each ship can perform one of the following actions. Only one action may be chosen, no matter how large the crew is. Others can help the roll however (page 43).

- **Emergency Repairs:** A minor or major component damage is hastily repaired. Roll for **HEAVY MACHINERY** or **COMTECH** as indicated by the tables on pages 145–146. This action can also be used to restore 1 lost Hull point (roll for **HEAVY MACHINERY**). The repair is just a quick fix – it requires no spare parts, but it will only hold for one shift (any restored Hull damage is then inflicted again). For permanent repairs, see page 146.
- **Power Engine Up/Down:** Powering down the engine modifies a ship's Signature by –2 but makes all actions in the movement phase impossible. No roll is required to power engines down, but a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll is required to power them back up.
- **Open Airlock:** Can only be performed if the navigation officer has successfully docked with another ship. Roll for **HEAVY MACHINERY**. If successful, you breach the target ship, and your crew can then board it (regular combat ensues).
- **Reactor Overload:** Requires a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll. If successful, the reactor will overload and explode at the end of the following stretch, destroying the ship and killing everyone on board. Make sure to get into those EEVs fast. The self-destruct sequence can be stopped with another **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll.

Stress & Panic In Space Combat

Stress in spaceship combat works a little differently. Stress levels typically increase the following ways only:

- You push a skill roll.
- You suffer a certain stress effect.
- Your ship suffers minor component damage from an attack.

When making a stress response roll in space combat, roll roll normally on the table, repeated to the right for reference. In addition, you cannot relieve stress (page 73) during an active space combat. Panic rolls in spaceship combat are triggered by the following events:

- Your ship suffers major component damage or is disabled.
- Another PC on the ship Bails Out (panic effect 9–11).

When making a panic roll in space combat, roll a D6, add your stress level and subtract your Resolve as normal, but use the alternative table to the right. The panic effect lasts until the end of the engagement.

Stress Response Roll

D6 + Stress Level − Resolve

RESULT	RESPONSE
≤0	**Keeping Cool.** No effect.
1	**Jumpy.** When you push a skill roll, you gain +2 stress level instead of +1.
2	**Tunnel Vision.** All skill rolls based on Wits get –2 dice.
3	**Aggravated.** All skill rolls based on Empathy get –2 dice.
4	**Shakes.** All skill rolls based on Agility get –2 dice.
5	**Frantic.** All skill rolls based on Strength get –2 dice.
6	**Deflated.** You cannot push any skill rolls. If you are Jumpy (#1 above), remove that response, and ignore any further Jumpy results while Deflated.
7+	**Mess Up.** Your action fails regardless of ⊕ rolled and you gain +1 stress level.

Space Panic Response

RESULT	RESPONSE
≤0	**Keeping Cool.** No effect.
1–6	**Spooked.** Stress level +1 for you.
7–8	**Freeze.** You're frozen by fear, losing your next turn.
9–11	**Bail Out.** You immediately try to abandon ship and escape in the nearest EEV. All other PCs on the ship must make an immediate panic roll.
12+	**Catatonic.** You're doomed! You collapse to the floor and can't move, rambling or staring blankly into oblivion, until your panic stops.

Ship Damage

Spaceships suffer damage just like people and vehicles (see chapter 4) but on a different scale. Spaceship weapons cannot be used to target individuals or regular vehicles.

Armor: The armor of a spaceship works exactly like armor in regular combat. The damage from an attack is reduced by the armor level of the ship. ▶

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Component Damage Summary

Damage Threshold	1 or more	1/2 total HP or more	Total HP or more
Effect	Minor damage	Major damage	Total loss of ship and crew

Minor Component Damage

D66	DAMAGE	REPAIR ROLL
11	**A.I. Malfunction.** COMTECH roll required to access the ship A.I.	COMTECH
12	**Air Scrubbers Offline.** −2 dice to all STAMINA rolls for one shift, then total air loss.	HEAVY MACHINERY
13	**Airlock Malfunction.** Main airlock cannot be accessed.	HEAVY MACHINERY
14–15	**Armament Malfunction.** −2 modification to all attacks using a random armament.	HEAVY MACHINERY
16	**Artificial Gravity Malfunction.** Zero gravity on the ship (page 76)	HEAVY MACHINERY + COMTECH
21	**AutoDoc Offline.** Medical facilities cannot be used.	HEAVY MACHINERY
22–23	**Cargo Damage.** A random item kept in a cargo hold is destroyed.	–
24	**Coffee Maker Malfunction.** The coffee maker in the galley cannot be used.	HEAVY MACHINERY
25	**Comms Malfunction.** All external communications offline.	COMTECH
26–31	**Compartmental Decompression.** A random compartment of the ship suffers sudden decompression (page 75). HEAVY MACHINERY	
32–33	**Crew Injury.** A random crew member is hurt. Roll for the attack with six base dice, base damage 1.	–
34	**Cryo Chambers Offline.** Cryo chambers cannot be used.	HEAVY MACHINERY + COMTECH
35	**Displacement Drive Malfunction.** FTL rating halved.	HEAVY MACHINERY + COMTECH
36	**Docking Station Damaged.** The ship cannot dock with other vessels.	HEAVY MACHINERY
41	**Escape Pod Malfunction.** One EEV is disabled.	HEAVY MACHINERY
42	**Hangar Damage.** A random vessel in the ship's hangar is disabled.	HEAVY MACHINERY
43–44	**Instrument Malfunction.** PILOTING, RANGED COMBAT, and COMTECH rolls on the ship get −1 dice.	COMTECH
45	**Intercoms Disabled.** All internal communications offline.	COMTECH
46	**Ladderway Damaged.** MOBILITY roll required to move between levels of the ship.	HEAVY MACHINERY
51	**Life Support Offline.** Everyone on the ship without a pressure suit needs to roll for STAMINA each shift to avoid being fatigued by extreme heat or cold.	HEAVY MACHINERY
52	**Navigation System Offline.** COMTECH roll with −2 dice is required to plot any FTL travel.	COMTECH
53–54	**Reactor Leak.** Weak radiation (1 rad/shift) in the reactor control area.	HEAVY MACHINERY
55	**Refrigeration Unit Damaged.** All refrigerated foodstuffs on the ship are lost after one day.	HEAVY MACHINERY
56–61	**Sensor Malfunction.** All COMTECH rolls using the ship's sensors get −2 dice.	COMTECH
62–64	**Thruster Damage.** Reduces the Thrusters rating of the ship by 2.	HEAVY MACHINERY
65	**Transponder Offline.** The ship's transponder stops working.	COMTECH
66	**Waste Disposal Malfunction.** Things are about to get very smelly.	HEAVY MACHINERY

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Disabled: When a ship has suffered damage equal to or in excess of its Hull rating, it is disabled. This means that its sensors, engines and all weapon systems fail, and the entire ship suffers explosive decompression (page 75) – time to get to the escape pods, or at least into a compression suit. A disabled ship is not blown to pieces, however, and can still be repaired. Note that particle beam weapons don't cause hull damage, only component damage (below).

Component Damage: Structural hull damage is not the only danger to a spaceship. Specific components and modules can also be damaged by each single attack, with effects ranging from the annoying to the catastrophic.

- If a single attack inflicts 1 or more points of damage to a ship, but less than half of its Hull rating (rounded up), the ship suffers minor component damage. Roll D66 on the table on page 145. If the result is not applicable to the damaged ship, re-roll.
- If a single attack inflicts damage equal to or higher than half the Hull rating (rounded up), but less than the full Hull rating, the ship suffers major component damage. Roll 2D6 on the table below.
- If a single attack inflicts damage equal to or higher than the Hull score, the ship is completely destroyed and all crew and passengers killed.

PARTICLE BEAM WEAPONS

Note that particle beam weapons work differently from other ship armaments. Countermeasures have no effect against them, their base damage rating is reduced by 1 for each range category beyond Contact, and they inflict no Hull damage, only component damage.

Stress: If your ship suffers minor or major component damage, you gain +1 stress level. If your ship is disabled, make a panic roll. For more on stress and panic in spaceship combat, see page 144.

Ship Repairs

Repairing a damaged ship requires time, skill, tools (see chapter 5) and often spare parts.

Hull Repairs: Repairing hull damage requires one or several **HEAVY MACHINERY** rolls. One roll can be made per shift. Only one person can roll to repair the hull, but others can help. Each ✠ rolled removes 1 point of damage. If the ship was disabled, repairing at least 1 point of damage removes this condition.

Major Component Damage

2D6	DAMAGE	REPAIR ROLL
2	**A.I. Offline.** The ship A.I. is offline.	3 × **COMTECH**
3	**Escape Pods Heavily Damaged.** No EEVs can be used.	**HEAVY MACHINERY** + **COMTECH**
4	**Sensor Failure.** The ship's sensors fail completely.	2 × **COMTECH**
5	**Displacement Drive Failure.** No FTL travel possible.	**HEAVY MACHINERY** + 2 × **COMTECH**
6	**Armament Damaged.** A random armament on the ship is unusable.	**HEAVY MACHINERY** + **COMTECH**
7	**Engine Failure.** The ship is dead in space. No movement phase actions can be performed.	2 × **HEAVY MACHINERY** + **COMTECH**
8	**Critical Crew Injury.** A random crew member is broken.	–
9	**Bridge Exposed To Vacuum.** The ship can no longer be controlled, and all personnel on the bridge suffer explosive decompression.	2 × **HEAVY MACHINERY** + **COMTECH**
10	**Reactor Breach.** The ship loses all propulsion. Strong radiation (1 rad/stretch) in the reactor control area, weak radiation in the rest of the ship.	2 × **HEAVY MACHINERY** + **COMTECH**
11	**Chain Reaction.** Roll twice on this table.	–
12	**Reactor Detonation.** Total loss of the ship and all crew.	–

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Component Repairs: The lists of minor and major component damage describe which skill rolls are needed to repair the component, and how many rolls must be made. If several skill rolls are listed, only one roll can be made per shift. Only one person can roll to repair the same component, but others can help. Component repairs also require spare parts.

Spare parts are abstracted into two versions: mechanical and electronic. One mechanical spare part is required for each **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll, and one electronic spare part for each **COMTECH** roll. The spare part is consumed if the roll is successful. See the boxed text to the right for more on spare parts.

Emergency Repairs: During combat, ship engineers can make emergency repairs on components and the hull. This works like normal component repair (above) but with some key differences:

- Each repair roll takes one stretch instead of one shift.
- The repairs require no spare parts.
- The repair is just a temporary fix, and will only hold for one shift (any restored Hull damage is then inflicted again).

EVA Repairs: Hull repair, as well as repair of external components, will require you to go spacewalking. If you can't, find the nearest space station with a dry dock. ●

Getting Spare Parts

You'll soon learn how important spare parts for your ship can be. There are two main ways to get more of them: buy and scavenge. Costs can vary greatly, but a mechanical spare part is typically about $100,000 at your average spaceport, and an electronic spare part can cost you twice that sum.

If you don't feel like paying for spare parts, deep space salvaging might be the business for you. With a shift of work and a skill roll (**HEAVY MACHINERY** for mechanical and **COMTECH** for electronic), you can scavenge a spare part from a derelict, assuming it's not completely blown to bits. In total, you can scavenge a number of spare parts from a ship equal to its full Hull score – half mechanical and half electronic

PUSHING REPAIRS

If you spend a shift repairing your ship and push the skill roll, you won't have time to relieve stress (page 73) before the next shift starts, in case you want to spend the next shift repairing as well.

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SHIP COMBAT EXAMPLE

THE PCS, WORKING for the Colonial Marshals, are aboard the USS Porphyrion, a Conestoga-Class Frigate. They are hunting for a CM-90S Corvus smuggler vessel named the USCSS Lyssa, which has been raiding colonies in the sector. Suddenly, a ship appears on their radar, traveling with its transponder suspiciously switched off. This is the Lyssa, but the PCs don't know that yet.

Detection

The two ships detect each other at Extreme range (8 segments). The GM places a token for the Porphyrion in the −4 segment and a "ping" token for the unnamed ship in the +4 segment. The initial approach velocity of both ships is the standard 2 segments per stretch.

Initiative

Galt, executive officer of the Porphyrion, rolls two ⊕ in his **COMMAND** roll. The commander of the Lyssa rolls just one ⊕. Galt decides to hold off and let the other ship go first.



COMBAT STRETCH 1

1. Command Phase ●○○○○

The commander of the Lyssa makes another **COMMAND** roll but fails. Galt makes his **COMMAND** roll and gets a one ⊕. He gives a +1 modifier to his science officer.

2. Sensor Phase ○●○○○

The Lyssa tries to Target Lock the Porphyrion and succeeds. The Porphyrion's science officer Dalhouse does the same, getting a +1 modifier from Galt, and succeeds with her **COMTECH** roll. Both ships have now locked on to each other.

3. Movement Phase ○○●○○

The GM picks the Accelerate action for the Lyssa. The **PILOTING** roll gets +1 die for Thrusters, and results in one ⊕. The Lyssa's approach velocity is increased by 1, to 3 segments per stretch.

Mira, navigation officer on the Porphyrion, chooses the Decelerate action, also rolling for **PILOTING** with +1 die for Thrusters, and gets one ⊕. The approach velocity is decreased by 1, to 1 segment per stretch.

Both ships now move on the space combat track. The Lyssa moves three segments, to the segment marked +1, while the Porphyrion moves only one segment, and is placed on the segment marked −3.



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4. Attack Phase

The Lyssa chooses the Fire Weapons action, launching a Short Lance ASAT Missile, which gives a +1 die to the **RANGED COMBAT** roll. The attack hits with a single ⊕, inflicting 3 points of damage, which are reduced to 1 by the Porphyrion's armor. Since the damage is lower than half of the Porphyrion's full Hull rating (12), the ship only suffers minor component damage. The D66 results in 63, reducing the Porphyrion's Thrusters rating by 2 (to –1).

The Porphyrion's gunner Ox fires back with a Long Lance ASAT Missile. He rolls three ⊕, meaning a total of 6 points of damage. The Lyssa's armor removes 1 point and saves the ship from immediate total destruction, but the remaining 5 are still higher than half of her Hull rating (6), meaning she suffers major component damage. The 2D6 roll comes up with a total of 8 – one of the crew is broken. The GM randomly determines that it's the science officer.

5. Engineer Phase

The engineer of the Lyssa attempts Emergency Repairs and succeed with the **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll, meaning 1 point of Hull damage is temporarily restored.

The Porphyrion's engineer Sarosawa sets to work fixing the thrusters and makes a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll but fails. The Thrusters rating remains at –1.

COMBAT STRETCH 2

1. Command Phase

The commander of the Lyssa makes another **COMMAND** roll but fails. On the Porphyrion, Galt makes his **COMMAND** roll and gets two ⊕. He gives one +1 modifier to his science officer and one to his gunner.

2. Sensor Phase

With no science officer, the Lyssa takes no action in this phase, while the PCs again choose Target Lock. Dalhouse, the Porphyrion's science officer, rolls **COMTECH** again with +1 from Galt, getting a single ⊕. The PCs have a lock on the Lyssa again.

3. Movement Phase

Realizing that the only chance they have is to get away, the smugglers picks the Accelerate action. Rolling for **PILOTING**, the GM gets two ⊕ and decides to increase the Lyssa's approach vector by a further 2, for a total of 5.

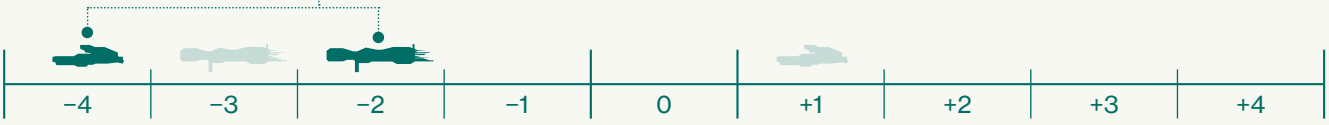
On the Porphyrion, the navigation officer Mira continues to Decelerate, but with the damaged thrusters doesn't get any ⊕ and the Porphyrion's approach velocity remains at 1.

The two ships now pass each other on the space combat track, the Lyssa jumping ahead to the –4 segment and Porphyrion moving to –2.

4. Attack Phase

The smugglers settle on the Launch Countermeasures action, hoping to buy themselves at least another stretch of survival and slip away.

The PCs decide on the Fire Weapon action. Ox fires another ASAT Long Lance Missile, getting three ⊕! The GM makes a **RANGED COMBAT** roll for the Lyssa's reactive countermeasures, coming up with two ⊕. The missile slams into the Lyssa, causing 4 points of damage. The Lyssa's armor reduces the damage to 3 – still enough to disable the smuggler ship, which is now dead in space. Not a good day to be a smuggler, it seems.



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CHAPTER 7

BEING THE GAME MOTHER

"That's it, man. Game over, man. Game over!"

Private William Hudson

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YOU ARE THE GAME MOTHER. You are the cold darkness of space itself, the colonists running the atmosphere processors, the greedy corporations and their machinations. You are long-lost secrets waiting to be discovered. You are the Xenomorph.

Being a GM takes some work but it is also very rewarding. After all, you get to direct and star in your very own Alien movie. This chapter tells you how to do it and what you'll need. But the most important tool is your own imagination. Use it well.

KNOWING THE UNKNOWABLE

Uncertainty is the mother of fear. The players may have seen the movies, but the PCs sure haven't. Change things around so that neither the players nor the PCs are certain of exactly what they are facing, or what will happen next. Maybe they are up against a different kind of enemy? Maybe this Xenomorph behaves in an unexpected way. Never let them be certain of anything. Surprise them.

GAME PRINCIPLES

EIGHT BASIC PRINCIPLES underpin the game. Their purpose is to help you set the right tone, and provide a support structure for handling various situations that can arise during play.

1. Use The Films

We've all seen the ALIEN films, most of us multiple times. Use this fact in the game. Allude to dialogue, scenes, and characters. Describe a corridor like one of the Nostromo's walkways in Alien. Base a character on one of the marines in Aliens. Encourage the players to do the same. There's plenty of source material to draw from. Use it.

2. Limit Resources

Always make sure that the PCs have too little of something. Not enough ammo, just one gun to share, one compression suit less than the number of PCs. Scarcity of resources creates tension and forces the players to make difficult choices.

3. Stay In The Shadows

Hint at the source of danger, don't show it. Build up an atmosphere of dread and anticipation, then let the players' imaginations do the rest. Avoid revealing threats too early. Once the players know exactly what they are up against, the tension that results from facing the unknown is lost.

4. Increase The Pressure

Start easy and slowly add more and more complications to the situation. Think like a movie – the first act starts slow, then it accelerates towards the big finale. When things start to go wrong, let them go wrong all at once. Remember, this is a horror game. Force the PCs to fight for their lives.

5. Let Them Breathe

At the center of every storm is a point of calmness. Sometimes it's important to back off and let the players take some time to recuperate. Give the PCs room to catch their breath and lick their wounds. Let them make plans and adapt their strategy. Doing so encourages them to lower their guard, even if it's just for a moment. When that happens, be sure to have a new challenge waiting.

6. Fuel Their Agendas

The PCs are living and breathing characters in the world of ALIEN, each with their own agendas and goals. Learn their agendas by heart and feed into them. Put them in situations that directly challenge their goals and see how they react. Use their fragile humanity against them.

7. Bring Horrible Death

PCs will die, and die horribly. When the time comes, make the most of it. Embrace death. The ALIEN franchise is known for its iconic death scenes, so make it the same for your game. A PC death can be gruesome and tragic, but sometimes cathartic too. It raises the stakes for the survivors, who need to up their game and find a way to press on.

8. Reveal The Universe

The universe of ALIEN is harsh and unforgiving. But it's also home to long-lost secrets, wondrous planets and strange phenomena. Now and then, give the PCs a glimpse of something bigger. Let them feel the vastness of the universe and the insignificance of humanity. Show them the beauty and the horror. ●

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THEMES

THREE OVERARCHING THEMES underpin the ALIEN roleplaying game: space horror, sci-fi action, and a sense of wonder. Together they define the ALIEN universe. On their own, they define key aspects that the ALIEN movies and this game explore in detail. Use them to paint your ALIEN universe in the shade you want and highlight the elements you and your players find most exciting. Moreover, each key theme has a number of sub-themes that emphasize important parts of the ALIEN universe.

Space Horror

At its core, ALIEN is about survival. It is about confronting your deepest fears, fighting them and trying to get home in one piece. It is about horror. The iconic Xenomorph is the ultimate manifestation of this aspect, but the universe is capable of creating horror in lots of different ways and not all are alien in nature. Unethical corporate experiments, bloody conflicts, and violent natural disasters make living in the 2180s a tough proposition. The original Alien movie from 1979 is the perfect example of a space horror story.

Space Is Hell: Nature is neither good nor evil. It is, however, indifferent to humanity. The universe is a harsh place to live in and will kill you in the blink of an eye if given a chance. A routine space walk, a sudden solar flare, or an ice storm can go from something serene or even beautiful to life-threatening in a second.

Killing Greed: ALIEN focuses on blue-collar workers at the bottom of the economic ladder. The ordinary working men and women struggling to get by in a brutal, hyper-capitalistic society are the real heroes of the stories. It's working class sci-fi, where your sympathies are meant to be given to the little people. The greedy corporations and power hungry nations are the dragons which the PCs will have to face, sooner or later. In the end, humans are often the biggest monsters.

"I was with our illustrious creator, Mr. Weyland, when he died."
"What was he like?"
"He was human. Entirely unworthy of his creation."

David and Walter One

Sci-Fi Action

Big set pieces, powerful weapons, and frenzied combat scenes. Action is a powerful driver in the ALIEN universe, whether it comes in the form of the colonial marines sweeping a seemingly abandoned mine only to discover something lurking in the dark, mighty starships exchanging missile volleys in high orbit, or corporate agents infiltrating an enemy installation. Heart-pounding action is a core element in the ALIEN roleplaying game. James Cameron's Aliens from 1986 is the seminal action movie in the series.

Someone Else's War: The conflicts and wars of the 22nd century are all about the big corps or big nations wanting to get bigger. They are about power and money for the ones that already have too much. The little people are the ones actually doing the fighting and you can be damn sure that the war is not really about their needs. Soldiers, marines, and grunts are all working for the Man. They fight because they need the paycheck to survive, not for some idealistic cause.

Expendable Assets: Being a soldier in the 2180s is being a very small cog in a very big machine. A soldier is entirely expendable. There is no shortage of poor young men and women that are willing to fill the ranks. Serving in the military means being at the mercy of the top brass and their corporate overlords. Human life is not a valuable commodity, better get used to it.

Sense Of Wonder

The ALIEN universe is a place of long-lost secrets and ancient mysteries. Faraway colonists report strange findings, spaceship crews on the Frontier discover inexplicable signals and encounter things that defy classification. There is clearly more to the universe than previously thought. The realization that the universe is not an empty place is an important aspect of ALIEN stories. The first act of the original Alien movie by Ridley Scott is about finding the unthinkable. A similar theme is present in Prometheus.

The Origin Of Life: Where do we come from, who made us, what are we here for? These questions are as old as humanity itself. Nevertheless, these existential thoughts are made all the more relevant once humans encounter life amongst the stars. Birth, death, and the cycle of life is an important theme of many stories in ALIEN.

Old And New Gods: With science struggling to answer the question of alien life and our role in the universe, religion answers the call. When humanity stares into the dark abyss of space and sees death and horror, many turn back towards faith and worship. ●

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STRESS AND HORROR

THE ALIEN ROLEPLAYING GAME is a horror game at its heart. The question is not if but rather when the PCs will encounter something horrific and fight desperately to escape, or give their lives so that others might do so. Fear and horror is in the very DNA of ALIEN. Your primary tools for invoking terror around the gaming table are stress and panic.

Stress can be introduced by you as a GM when the PCs encounter certain horrific situations or fearsome beings, but it will mainly be incurred by the PCs in response to their own actions. This makes your job easier. You just need to introduce a terror of some kind and then let the PCs interact with it while their stress levels ratchet up and their personal agendas collide.

In the end, the fight to survive will be as much against their own human nature as it will be against the horrific creature or situation they face. Here are three tools to use for creating horror:

Fear Of The Unknown: Not knowing what you are facing is scary. Use this to your advantage and let the enemies hide in the shadows for as long as possible. Let the players' imaginations do the work for you.

Loss Of Control: Make the PCs feel powerless by taking away their resources. Turn off the lights. Cut the power. Make machinery malfunction. When they lose control over things, fear takes over.

Horrible Choices: Put them in situations where they have to make difficult, life-or-death choices. Will they sacrifice one to save the many? Will they risk everything for a buddy? Make them decide.

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The Three Stages Of Fear

Creating horror in a roleplaying game is not always easy. Overdo it, and the players aren't scared anymore – downplay it, and the game drags on. The key to Game Mothering horror is to manage pacing properly and keep the major threat hidden as long as possible. To do this effectively, you need to carefully manage the stages of fear in the game: dread, terror, and horror.

Dread: The sense that something bad is about to happen, but no-one is really sure what or why. Dread is the first stage of fear in the ALIEN roleplaying game and should be employed as often as possible. The key to using dread is planting seeds and watching events unfold. The players know something terrible is about to take place, but without knowing what it is, they can't do anything about it. This dread may evolve to the next stage, but sometimes it won't – and that's fine. Examples of dread:

- A control panel indicates that the airlock was just cycled manually whilst all of the crew are accounted for on the bridge.
- Someone finds blood on the walkway. The ship's cat is missing.
- A strange and leathery egg is found in a crashed derelict ship. It's like something is alive in there.

Terror: You feel terror when you know something bad will happen any moment now. It is no longer a question of if but rather when it will take place. From a roleplaying perspective, the feeling of terror is the most effective feeling of fear as the PCs are at their most helpless state. Therefore, terror often involves the scariest moments in a gaming session. Use it selectively for maximum effect. Examples of terror:

- A squad of marines investigating an old mine steps into something slimy. One of the marines hears a hissing sound. She realizes that something is directly above her.
- A colonial marshal following a killer in the deep bowels of a space station realizes that she is the prey.
- A pilot on a stranded shuttle barricaded in the cockpit hears pounding on the access hatch. Something wants in.

Horror: The ultimate form of fear is horror. Horror is the moment when the danger reveals itself. It is the moment of climax. The payoff that the earlier stages of fear have hinted at. But because of this, it is also less scary than terror. When horror hits, the game mechanics take over. You draw initiative and fight it or try to escape. Horror is vital to the game, but it should be used rarely and is often best utilized late in a game session rather than early. Examples of horror:

- A corporate agent turns around and stands face to face with an alien baring its teeth.
- The egg opens and a crab-like creature lunges at the closest crew member, attaching itself to her face amidst the screams of her friends.
- Black, lightning-quick creatures crawl across the walls and roof towards the marine squad.

Relieving Stress

An important part of the game is managing the stress levels of the PCs. As the GM, let them catch their collective breath and relieve stress (page 73) from time to time. Calmer periods are vital to keeping an atmosphere of horror throughout a game session. This also opens up new opportunities for you to ramp up the pressure. Once they feel safe and lower their guard, strike at them again. After all, it's not over until it's over.

Splitting The Team

Sometimes the players will want to split up into smaller groups. Let them. When doing this, it is important that you cut back and forth between the groups so that one group does not have to wait too long for the other. Let them all stay at the table even if they are not in the same location. Trust the players to separate what they know and what their PCs know. Use the fact that they have split up to create interesting and scary situations. Also, consider what means of communication the PCs have access to. Do they have personal communicators? If not, are there communication terminals around? ●

NON-PLAYER CHARACTERS

YOU COMMAND SOLAR STORMS and massive spaceships. Aliens and androids follow your every whim. Yet, to create tension and drama, your most powerful tools are your NPCs.

Creating NPCs

A number of typical NPCs can be found on page 258. If you need to quickly create an NPC, pick one of these or use them as a basis for your own creation.

Attributes: Typical NPCs have a total of 14 attribute points just like PCs, but this is not an absolute rule. No NPC can have a higher attribute rating than 5, with the exception of androids. ▶

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Skills: As a general rule, only assign skill levels to an NPC if there is a good chance they will actually need to use those skills. A fairly competent NPC has a skill level of 2, while experts can have skill levels of 3, 4 or even 5.

Talents: NPCs are usually without talents, but you can give a talent to an especially capable NPC if you wish.

Name, Appearance, Trait, Goal: Apart from stats and scores, there are four things you need to know about every NPC:

- **NAME.** What is their name?
- **APPEARANCE.** How do they look, how do they behave, do they have any distinguishing quirks?
- **TRAIT.** A defining characteristic of the NPC (for example cynical, rational, ruthless).
- **GOAL.** What are their goals?

Playing NPCs: NPCs are governed by the same rules as the PCs, but you can disregard those rules as long as the NPC isn't directly interacting with a PC. Don't track consumables for NPCs – that way, you retain the freedom to decide when they run out of something. Don't roll dice for the actions of NPCs unless they attack or interact with a PC.

NPCs in Groups: When dealing with multiple NPCs, you can have them perform actions as a group instead of individually. See the rules for helping on page 43. ●

CINEMATIC PLAY

THE ICONIC STORIES of the ALIEN universe are intense, exciting and deadly. The cat and mouse game between the Xenomorph and the crew of the Nostromo in Alien, the marines' descent into the hell that once was Hadley's Hope in Aliens, or the last stand of the prisoners on Fiorina 161 in Alien 3. Cinematic play is the game mode used to emulate such stories, creating short, focused, and intense movie-like experiences that the PCs will be lucky to survive.

Cinematic play takes some work on the GM's part – you need to read the scenario, and prepare handouts, maps, and characters. The payoff, however, will be great. Because most of the workload is on the GM and not the players, cinematic play is ideal for beginners and introducing someone to the world of roleplaying games. It is also ideally suited for convention play and single evening events as these kinds of adventures can often be played from beginning to end in a single session. We recommend that you play a cinematic adventure before you dive into the campaign game.

Cinematic adventures come with a set of pre-generated characters. Think of these as the roles in a written script. As they are tailor-made for the particular adventure, you can make sure that their backgrounds and agendas fit together with the plot.

Structure Of Cinematic Adventures

Several cinematic adventures for the ALIEN roleplaying game are available, including Hope's Last Day in the Starter Set, or the adventure Rapture Protocol (available for purchase separately), but you might also want to write your own. This way, you can be both the script writer and director of your very own ALIEN movie and let your friends star in it. This is how to structure a cinematic adventure:

What's The Story, Mother? Introduction for the players, to be read aloud by the GM. Sets the stage for the adventure and makes sure that the players know enough to get going.

The Situation: What's really going on. The purpose here is to provide the GM with a concise overview of what is happening behind the scenes of the adventure.

The Characters: The PCs and the NPCs in the scenario. Each with stats and background. Each PC has a personal agenda for each of the three acts of the scenario.

Locations: Cinematic adventures are generally location-based. Each adventure includes a detailed map of the core area (or areas), with the key locations marked and described.

Acts & Events: A cinematic adventure is divided into three acts, each described briefly according to this structure:

- **ACT1:** The Setup. PCs and NPCs are introduced, conflicts are established.
- **ACT 2:** The Tilt. Something unexpected happens, raising the stakes and the level of danger. Secrets are revealed.
- **ACT 3:** The Showdown. The story comes to a climactic resolution, depending on the actions of the PCs.

Each act has a number of possible events. A few of these events can be mandatory, but most should be optional, used or not used depending on the actions taken by the PCs. These events should also generally be stand-alone, not connected in a predetermined narrative. Some events affect all PCs, others are aimed at specific individuals.

Epilogue: A suggested sign-off message by one of the PCs, assuming anyone is still alive. The player of this PC can read the message aloud, or adapt it according to what happened in the scenario. ▶

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Agendas, Secrets & PvP

In cinematic play, the PCs' personal agendas are secret. They shouldn't share them with one another. We recommend that you avoid secret communication between you and a player – it slows the game down and reveals to the other players that something fishy is going on.

Instead, personal agendas for acts I and II should be written to avoid obviously suspicious behavior and direct confrontations with other players. If a player insists on secret communication with you, keep it short and simple. Remind them to follow their agenda and not act overtly against the interest of the group until act III (if at all).

Calling PvP: If a PC starts to act in direct opposition to the rest of the group – preferably not until act III – it's time to call PvP. Play the current scene to an end, and then turn the PC into an NPC.

Open Agendas: Some groups may even prefer to talk about the personal agendas openly, separating their knowledge from that of their PCs. Find a way that makes sense to your group.

Story Points

At the end of each act, you should determine whether each player followed their PC's personal agenda. If you determine that they have advanced their agenda despite personal risk or significant sacrifice, announce this and award them 1 story point. Do not explain why. Their agendas should remain hidden until the end of the scenario.

Using Story Points: In cinematic play, a player can spend a story point (page 44) to automatically get a ✦ result on one base die in a skill roll. This can be done before or after pushing the roll.

Keeping Story Points: A player who has story points left after the end of a cinematic adventure may bring one (1) story point to the next adventure with the same group (GM's discretion), even if playing a different PC. ●

✦ CAMPAIGN PLAY

THIS GAME MODE is meant to be played for a longer period of time, at least 5–6 game sessions and often much more than that. In campaign play, the PCs can roam the star map, take jobs and go on adventures, all while discovering long lost secrets, scheming with different factions and fighting to stay alive.

Session Zero

We recommend that you begin your campaign with a session where you as a group create your characters together and decide on which campaign frame you want to play – space truckers, colonial marines, or frontier colonists (page 234). A big part of this session will be discussion amongst the players and you, the GM. Below are some recommended questions to go through and answer together.

- How did you meet and how long have you been working together?
- Who are your buddies and who are your rivals?
- What do you do, and why do you do it?
- Do you have a spaceship? If so, what kind? Name it.
- What are your goals as a group?
- Do you have any common allies or enemies?
- Who do you work for?
- Where are you now?

Campaign Focus

When starting a new campaign, give some thought to what themes you want to place the most importance in. Give the campaign a focus, something that you will build the plot around. A simple sentence or even just a word will do. Remember it when you create plots and antagonists for the PCs. If you want to make it easy on yourself, simply choose from or roll on the table below, or make up your own. Then put your imagination to work.

Campaign Theme

D6	OVERARCHING THEME
1	Killing Greed
2	Corporate Intrigue
3	Tidings of War
4	New Opportunities
5	Secret Research
6	Echoes from the Past

TARTARUS SECTOR

If you want a more focused campaign and a little more to go on when starting out, we recommend the Tartarus Sector on the Frontier. It is described in some detail in chapter 11, and outlines locations, factions and plots for your PCs to get embroiled in.

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Goals & Rewards

Before you start a new campaign it's important to give some thought to rewards and goals. Why are the PCs doing what they do and what are they working towards? The answers to these two questions are important, because they provide the main motivation for the PCs to go out and explore the universe of ALIEN.

Maybe they are a crew of space truckers, plying the lanes on the Frontier, taking any job they can so that they can afford to lease their own ship. Or why not a group of colonial marshals out to get revenge on a criminal syndicate that killed their colleagues? Another option is a group of enlisted marines, on a tour of duty to be able to afford a cheap room on Anchorpoint station.

Goals might change, and probably will. But it is important that the players know what their PCs are working towards. Remember, treat the PCs as real people with real dreams.

A Place To Call Home

While it is not required, we do recommend that the group starts the campaign in the vicinity of a home base. For a lot of groups, this can simply be their spaceship, which functions as a sort of home away from home. But it makes sense to have a real physical place where they can make connections, get job offers, and relax between missions. Novgorod Station on page 274 is included in this book for this purpose. It is a small outpost on the Frontier, perfect as a starting point to explore the universe of ALIEN.

Crawl The Stars

A big part of campaign play is traveling across known space and visiting strange worlds and different colonies. Because of this, the PCs typically start with a spaceship. When between jobs, put the star map on the table and let them know what destinations they have to choose from with the current job offers.

There are no right or wrong answers here, no rails to follow. Use the star system and planet generator in chapter 11 to generate details of the destination. Make every place they visit interesting in some way. Maybe there is a secret Weyland-Yutani research base in the sleepy backwater system they find themselves in?

Creating Jobs

Campaign mode is meant to facilitate sandbox play. That means that it is the players themselves who decide where they want to go, what jobs they want to take and how they will get there. To be able to do that they have to take jobs and earn money. A job can be anything from a simple pick up and drop off contract, to a complicated asset extraction in a covert corporate base.

In chapter 11, you will find tables for generating jobs for the three core campaign frames: space truckers, colonial marines, and frontier colonists. We recommend that you always have 2–3 jobs generated, so that you can quickly provide the players with options once they finish their current assignment. Let the players decide what they want to do, then work with that to create a fun adventure. When creating a job, choose or roll a number of complications and a plot twist. You can find stats for typical NPCs on page 258 and information about Xenomorphs and other critters in chapter 10.

Xenomorphs In Campaign Play

A distinct difference between campaign and cinematic play is the role of the Xenomorph. In cinematic play, you want to provide the full ALIEN experience in a compact and accessible package and the Xenomorph is most often a part of this. In campaign play, on the other hand, you will roam the star lanes of known space and take your time doing it. It would not make any sense to encounter a lethal alien during every job the PCs take on. Instead, make the most of other enemies: corporate agents, enemy soldiers, assassins, rival crews, rogue androids, critters, and so on. Save the Xenomorph for special occasions. ●

Reading List

To get inspiration and dive deeper into the ALIEN universe we recommend that you check out these fine publications:

- ***Alien: The Cold Forge*** by Alex White. An excellent standalone novel about the secret program to weaponize the Xenomorph.
- ***Aliens: Bug Hunt*** by Scott Siegler and others. A collection of short stories focusing on violent encounters with critters and creatures.
- ***Out of the Shadows, River of Pain, Sea of Sorrows.*** Three novels also available as audio dramas with exceptional production values.
- ***Aliens: Dead Orbit*** by James Stokoe. Atmospheric comic that would make an excellent Cinematic scenario.
- ***The Weyland-Yutani Report*** by S.D. Perry. Provides a great overview of the ALIEN saga and has a number of handouts usable for gaming to boot.
- ***Aliens: Colonial Marines Technical Manual*** by Lee Brimmicombe-Wood. A bit dated by now, but still the most in-depth source of technical information for the ALIEN universe.

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CHAPTER 8

GOVERNMENTS & CORPORATIONS

"I work for the company. But don't let that fool you, I'm really an okay guy."

Carter J. Burke

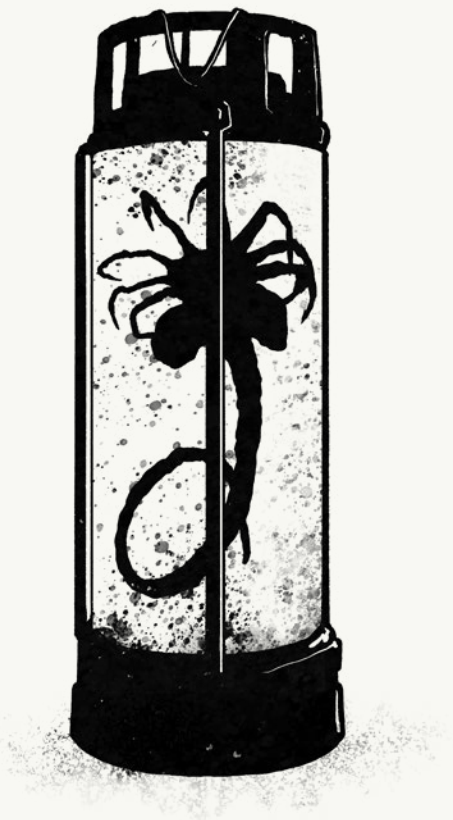
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Big Business, Big Government, Big Lies

Everyone answers to someone and everybody wants to get paid. In the early 21st century, humanity stood on a precipice. Increased carbon emissions, inappropriate disposal of toxic wastes, limited nuclear exchanges, and overpopulation led to the mass extinction of several species, rampant disease, environmental decay, a worldwide energy crisis, and famine.

While stagnant governments were reluctant to change to meet these threats, multinational corporations headed by innovators like Peter Weyland stepped up and led the charge into the future. As many nations shut down their space programs, the private sector poured money and resources into pushing humanity out into the greater solar system and beyond. While politicians argued over global warming and health care, corporations set about repairing the ozone layer and curing most cancers. Establishing off-world colonies within the solar system, corporations gave humanity new places to flourish rather than wither on a damaged Earth.

As Weyland-Yutani and other companies explored the stars, they established extrasolar colonies before there was any legislation in place to govern them. As these worlds flourished, it was the corporations that made policy. Realizing their technological dependence on companies like Weyland-Yutani to both travel to and terraform these planets in the first place, the governments of Earth had no choice but to play by company rules. At the mercy of these corporate overlords, nations soon found themselves in severe financial debt to them.



Looking to the late 20th century's formation of the European Union for inspiration, the major countries of the world soon merged to form larger nations. Dire economic necessity coupled with diminishing resources soon led to the unprecedented political merging of cultures that had been at odds in the past. During the last quarter of the 21st century, the Three World Empire was formed. The United Americas and the Union of Progressive Peoples soon followed, and governments began to regain some semblance of their old power.

But the military industrial complex, interstellar commerce, and deep space mining all keep the system going, and you need the corporations to take care of that. Without them, the economy would collapse. The current depression on the Frontier is symptomatic of this political and corporate tug of war. Government control is an illusion, and it's a bad card trick at that. You can be assured that behind every politician is a corporate overlord exerting some form of control.

What follows is a look at both the puppets and puppeteers of the 2180s.

The Company You Keep: Weyland-Yutani doesn't own everything, just mostly everything. Below is a small sampling of other corporate entities operating on the Frontier. You can bet that any of these corporations that are not allied with W-Y are on the company's (s)hitlist.

- **ALPHATECH HARDWARE:** Major military contractor for the UA and other corporations.
- **CHIGUSA CORPORATION:** Rival of W-Y focused on colonization, plasma harvesting and mining operations.
- **GEMBA SYSTEC:** Electronics manufacturing and freight handling.
- **HYPERDYNE SYSTEMS:** ICSC subsidiary of W-Y that makes high-end synthetics and cybernetic prosthetics.
- **JĪNGTÌ LÓNG CORPORATION:** ICSC company that is a W-Y and Seegson rival focusing on colonization and weapons R&D.
- **KELLAND MINING COMPANY:** Deep Space Mining Company known for building massive orbital mining stations.
- **KOORLANDER CORP:** A company with tobacco farms on several colony worlds. Koorlander is the rival cigarette brand to Balaji Imperial.
- **SOUTA CORP:** Producers of the beer Souta Dry, a cheap alternative to Weyland-Yutani's own Aspen Beer.
- **LOCKMART:** ICSC company that is the premiere builder of commercial starships.
- **STEER CITY CATTLE COMPANY:** A small company out of Terraform 3 that provides draft animals and quality meat to Frontier colonies. ●

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THE THREE WORLD EMPIRE

THE MOST TECHNOLOGICALLY PROSPEROUS of the interstellar superpowers, the Three World Empire (3WE) has established the most long-term colonies in the territories. Before its formation in the late 21st century, the UK and Japan had pioneered space exploration and settlement technologies through the British Weyland Corp and the Japanese Yutani Corporation.

These two innovative companies were the first to construct colonies on other planets and moons within the solar system. The three worlds the coalition's name refers to are Earth, Mars, and Titan – the first three worlds to be inhabited by humanity.

History

The Three World Empire was the first of the conglomerate nations. With the birth of extrasolar colonies, Earth was becoming a smaller place. Realizing a pooling of resources would result in a stronger base from which to colonize the stars, the United Kingdom, Japan, India, and several developing countries joined forces in the 2080s. In addition to the aforementioned countries, member states include Indonesia, Papua New Guinea, Kenya, Fiji, and more.

Military & Organizations

Through defense contracts and treaties, the 3WE Frontier colonies are protected by the United States Colonial Marines. However, the Three World Empire does maintain an extensive navy as well as their own limited military force in the form of the Royal Marines Commandos. While well trained and equipped with the latest in cutting edge hardware, the 3WE-RMC simply do not have the regimental strength or the reach of the USCMC. The 3WE bolsters their military with contracted soldiers from – you guessed it – Weyland-Yutani.

Leaders

The Three World Empire is a parliamentary social democracy overseen by a constitutional monarchy. Consisting of the former royal families of Britain and Japan now intermarried as one, the Monarchy serves as a figurehead and has little to no real power. The government is headed up by an elected Prime Minister who oversees a Parliament consisting of representatives from each territory and former nation, but none of that will matter much to you out here. On the Frontier, worlds of the 3WE are maintained by a provisional governor, and it's the policies, taxes, and tariffs set by her office that you will have to contend with.

Locations

In addition to its holdings in Sol System, the Three World Empire controls most extrasolar colonies in the Outer Veil and Core Systems. They have made a limited push into the Outer Rim and in the Frontier. Combined, these areas are called the Anglo-Japanese Arm. Notable worlds include the Corona Colony, Gorham's Folly, Fiorina 161, and Linna 349. ▶

Vihaa Reddy

Provisional Governor of the Frontier Colonies of the Three World Empire

Of British-Indian descent, Governor Reddy is a firm believer in progress, and wants to see the new colonies on the Frontier prosper as much as the ones in the Outer Veil did during the previous century. While other government officials leave their families behind on Earth or in the Core Systems, Reddy had hers moved out to live with her on the Frontier. She feels she has done much for the colonists under her purview and is shocked to hear of any grievances against her policies.

Additionally, she wishes the UA would disentangle themselves from 3WE affairs and the situation on Linna 349. While she means well, she truly doesn't understand the plight of the average frontier colonist. She lives out on the Frontier with them, but she also lives a life of luxury, protected behind government walls. Prim and proper, she is easily offended and becomes distraught over any aggressive action undertaken by ungrateful colonists.

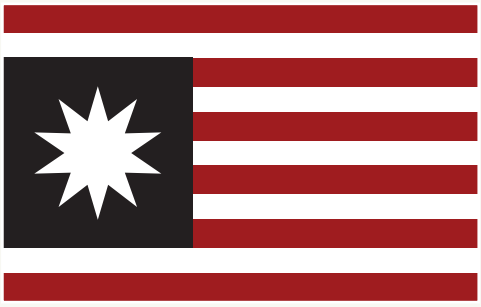
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Relations

The Three World Empire is heavily influenced by Weyland-Yutani – in fact, W-Y is the only non-state to actually have a seat in parliament. Rumors abound that several key members of Parliament have even been replaced with W-Y android duplicates, but none have been exposed – yet. The 3WE has maintained a somewhat peaceful relationship with the United Americas, though the UA is wary of the 3WE's aggressive expansion efforts and monitors their borders at all times. As tensions rise between the UA and Weyland-Yutani, the 3WE has become caught in the crossfire. Some feel it is only a matter of time before an armed conflict breaks out along the Frontier.

Current Activities

Weyland-Yutani has backed the Three World Empire into a corner in regard to interstellar relations with the United Americas. While they don't have a fighting force to equal the Colonial Marines, they do have an extensive Navy and are backed up by Weyland-Yutani technological and mercenary might. Rumors abound that W-Y is developing some kind of bioweapon for the 3WE, deployable from planetary orbit and extremely deadly. True or not, the reality is that the 3WE would much rather maintain the status quo than go to war, and worries that if W-Y goes too far, parliament will be forced to curb the company's activities – an action that will undoubtedly have consequences. ●



THE UNITED AMERICAS

THE UNITED AMERICAS is the most powerful starfaring and colonizing nation in the 22nd century. An economic and political giant in both the Sol system and throughout the off-world colonies, the military might of the UA is unparalleled.

History

Created to counter the financial and political might of the newly formed Three World Empire, The United Americas emerged in 2104 as a union of the nations of North, Central, and South America into one socioeconomic block. This alliance allowed the Americas to catch up to the 3WE and become pioneers of space travel and extrasolar colonies in their own right.

The Washington Treaty played a pivotal role in the merger, defining the member states' responsibilities to the union and outlining provisions for military action performed under the flag of the United Americas. The United States of America stood at the forefront of the newly formed nation, its preexisting scientific and military industrial complex paving the way for the United States Colonial Marine Corps to become humanity's premiere peacekeeping force throughout the colonies.

When the United Americas was formed, there were already several off-world colonies settled by its member states before the union – and not all of these worlds were happy to be part of this new, all-encompassing government. Torin Prime was one of them. Refusing to acknowledge the authority of the UA, a terrorist rebel faction calling themselves the J'Har seized the colony, murdered planetside officials, and killed or imprisoned anyone not loyal to their cause. Fearful that other colonies would follow suite, the UA was left with no choice but to make an example of Torin Prime.

As the J'Har rounded up more than half the population and interred them in concentration camps, the newly formed United Americas Allied Command (UAAC) worked with counter insurgents planetside to retake the world. When the J'Har managed to gain control of a flotilla of warships, the Outer Rim Defense Fleet responded in kind. The civil war escalated into a larger space war and took two years to resolve, but in the process the UA cemented their standing as a powerful nation amongst the stars.

Military & Organizations

United Americas Allied Command: The UAAC is the joint command of military forces of all members of the United Americas. It is comprised of the United States Colonial Marine Corps (USCMC), the Canadian Colonial Armed Forces (CCAF), the Latin American Colonial Navy (LACN), The United States AeroSpace Force (USASF), and the United Americas Outer Rim Defense Fleet (UAORDF). Headed by the Secretary of Defense, the allied command is a think tank of high level admirals and generals who devise strategy for, and coordinate, all major combat operations. ▶

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The United States Colonial Marine Corps: Founded before the United Americas merger, the primary focus of the USCMC is to maintain the security of all UA member states and extrasolar colonies. The USCMC spearheads all military campaigns undertaken by the United Americas Allied Command. They maintain several bases across the territories and are stationed at all UA garrisons, placing them within striking distance of nearly any hot spot.

While they often operate in tandem with the Aerospace Force and Outer Rim Defense Fleet, they operate their own fleet of frigates and troop transports. At a constant state of readiness, the USCMC has the technology and training to deploy troops at a moment's notice and operate an independent unit for extended periods in hostile environments without any support.

Throughout the eight decades since its inception, the USCMC has engaged in armed conflicts on nearly thirty extrasolar worlds. They have fought rogue nations and rebel colonies, as well as faced off against foreign powers in border and resource disputes. They have provided humanitarian aid in natural disasters, protected civilians in terrorist and hostage crises, and secured colonies from hostile lifeforms.

Aeron Percival

Colonel, Commander 4th Recon Battalion, 7th Marines, Crestus Garrison System Delta, United States Colonial Marine Corps, United Americas Allied Command.

Stationed at Crestus Garrison System Delta, USCMC Colonel Percival's recon battalion operates in an area of the Outer Rim Territories that includes a large swath of the Frontier. A pragmatic strategist, Percival is concerned that the USCMC is at its height of hubris. His tour of bases and stations throughout the Outer Rim has revealed that discipline in the ranks is lacking and that many COs are resting on their laurels.

Percival believes in the old adage that might makes right, and knows that the Colonial Marines are quite simply the best of the best – until they are not. Everyone is destined to meet their match, and if intelligence reports are to be believed, there is someone or something out there that is bigger and badder than the USCMC, just waiting for the right moment to strike. Atypical for a high-ranking military man, Percival is likely to put himself on the front line in any major military engagement under his purview.

Colonial Administration: This UA division was formed to protect the rights of all off-world colonists. CA supports and monitors all UA extrasolar colonies and stations and makes sure that supply chains flow as intended, vaccines are distributed, and that a semblance of order is maintained. For decades they have fought to have a minimum wage established for colonists, only to have their efforts blocked by corporate lobbyists.

Colonial Marshal Bureau: The law enforcement arm of the Colonial Administration is the Colonial Marshal Bureau, which maintains police offices throughout the colonies and works with the Interstellar Commerce Commission to prevent the import or export of dangerous biologicals and chemicals. All major Marshal offices have an Interstellar Commerce Commission (ICC) agent attached to them. The Marshals also often work in conjunction with US Federal agencies.

Leaders

The United Americas is essentially an extension of the government of the United States of America, and as such is run by a President, Vice President, and a Congress representing all member signatories. On the Frontier, any encounter with UA leadership is likely to be with a Colonial Marshal, a bureaucrat from Colonial Administration, or a commander of the Colonial Marines.

Locations

As the nations that later became the 3WE pioneered humanity's expansion into the core systems and Outer Veil, most of the colonies of the United Americas occupy a vast area of the Outer Rim Territories called the American Arm. The UA Allied Command operates military bases and stations throughout all the territories and additional colonies are laced along the Frontier. Key worlds include Bracken's World, Terraform 3, Morning Glory, and the Crestus Garrison Systems.

Relations

The United Americas and the Union of Progressive Peoples (UPP) have been in a state of cold war for decades. While the Colonial Marines are in place to keep the peace for the colonies of the American Arm, contracts and treaties with the 3WE and the Independent Core System Colonies mean that they are also obligated to protect their worlds as well. While the USCMC is not controlled by Weyland-Yutani, the company's business holdings with the United Americas Allied Command means that the Colonial Marines can be called upon to provide security to W-Y assets at any time – a fact that doesn't sit well with many a platoon commander.

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Current Activities

The United Americas has engaged in increased border conflicts with the UPP over disputed worlds. Recently, several USCMC units have gone missing, causing the UA to launch a full investigation. Colonel Percival's recon battalion has found growing evidence that Weyland-Yutani may be directly responsible for the loss of Hadley's Hope on LV-426 – a colony under the joint jurisdiction of Colonial Administration and the company. If relations deteriorate further between the UA and W-Y, the 3WE could be dragged into the conflict, and that could mean war. ●



THE UNION OF PROGRESSIVE PEOPLES

A SOCIALIST GOVERNMENT that controls a vast area of colonized space, the Union of Progressive Peoples is also the most resource-poor of the interstellar nations. Although impoverished and overcrowded, in the UPP the workers control the means of production. A state of cold war exists between the UPP and their long-time rivals, the UA – and standoffs between the Union of Progressive Peoples' Space Operating Forces and the United States Colonial Marine Corps become more and more frequent every year.

History

In the early 22nd century, the UPP was formed by China and Russia in direct response to a perceived combined threat of the Three World Empire and the United Americas. Locked in an ever-escalating arms race with these capitalist conglomerates, the UPP has always managed to stay only one step behind them despite the fact that they will not deal with Weyland-Yutani or any other corporations. Additional member states include Vietnam, Germany, Spain, and several other Asian and Eastern European countries. At the time of its inception, many androids were already in use within the member states of the UPP. They were not, however, granted citizenship status of any kind. Now, over sixty years later, they are still just considered machines and the property of the state.

Military & Organizations

Space Operating Forces: The elite commandos of the UPP are known as the Space Operating Forces. Said to be roughly equivalent to the United States Colonial Marines, the SOF has a similar regimental breakdown. They maintain a fleet of warships and transport vessels, have their own dropships, and use massive, two-story armored trucks for troop deployment. While the SOF have their own AK model pulse rifle, they also use wrist-mounted AK suit guns that allow hands free firing while wearing compression armor.

Ministry Of Space Security: A national security agency and secret police, the MSS gathers both internal and external intelligence for the good of the Union of Progressive Peoples. The Ministry maintains a number of operatives throughout the Frontier, undercover on both UPP controlled worlds and United American colonies. MSS spies have infiltrated top corporations and stolen their military designs. They monitor their own citizenry to make sure they stay true to the Union. In the UPP, they say trust your enemy to be your enemy, but never trust your neighbor to be your friend. The MSS is why.

Leaders

The UPP is a socialist government with a president as the head of state and a premier who presides over the state council. The UPP Frontier is overseen by a Governor General and naval task force, and each colony has its own mayor.

Locations

Most of the discovered planets within their borders are resource poor, causing the UPP to constantly push deeper into the Frontier in search of rich, habitable worlds. As the UPP never developed atmospheric processors, they do not terraform. Instead, if a world is inhospitable, they will build a colony beneath the surface or construct habitation domes upon it. Because of this, the scattering of naturally habitable worlds the UPP has are overpopulated. Notable worlds include New Kiev, Qi Xi III, 17 Phei Phei, Xiang Colony, and the Chiu and Wan An outposts. ▶

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Relations

The UPP is in a state of cold war with the United Americas. Over the past few decades, limited engagements have seen border worlds change hands or even be destroyed. Some twenty years ago, a regime change on the independent world of 8 Eta Boötis A III led to what became known as the Tientsin campaign – a bloody conflict where the UA backed an independent planet's attempt to keep a UPP aligned government from taking power. The conflict decimated the once lush world and left it in ruins.

More recently, the UPP are rumored to be behind the destruction of both the colony on LV-426 and a Colonial Marine rescue team. The allegations are that a UPP Space Operating Force nuked the site from orbit in response to a Weyland-Yutani bioweapon under development there. Ironically, while it was W-Y who accused the UPP of the attack, they also deny there were any bioweapons at Hadley's Hope. Much of the UPP's more advanced technology appears to be reverse engineered from W-Y designs, something that neither Weyland-Yutani nor the UA are particularly happy about.

Current Activities

The people of the UPP are hungry. As the UPP discovers a new planet on the Frontier, colonization ships are immediately dispatched to help alleviate the overpopulation problem of their existing member worlds. Citizens don't get to decide who is moved to a new colony world. They are simply moved for the greater good of the Union.

Pham Dinh

Governor General of the UPP Frontier Colonies

Governor General Dinh is a battle-hardened UPP Navy commander who has served in many campaigns. While younger commanders would see the posting to the Frontier as a chance for advancement, for Dinh it is a punishment. Nearing retirement, she wants nothing more than a posting back on her home colony world, where she can be close to her daughter and grandchildren.

Dinh believes in the greater good of the people, however, and will make the best of her assignment – seeking out new resource-rich worlds along the Frontier to claim for the poor citizens of the UPP. She is not afraid to go to war to protect her nation's interests, and has never backed down from an engagement.

These expansionist tendencies have the United Americas concerned, and a large amount of Colonial Navy and Marine resources are devoted to protecting borders from UPP incursions. There have been many false alarms. Imagine the relief a two-man Colonial Marshal office feels when an armada of UPP ships entering a neighboring system turns out to be a colonization expedition and not a warfleet. ●

THE INDEPENDENT CORE SYSTEM COLONIES

THE ICSC IS A LOOSE ALLIANCE of worlds that have claimed independence from any interstellar governing body. While independent from each other, member colonies sell and trade resources and pay fees to be protected by corporate armed forces. The corporate owned Central Space Consortium of the ICSC is seen as a haven for those on the run from their government. If someone with a skill set useful to a corporate colony comes seeking asylum within the CSC, the Consortium will usually buy off that person's tribunal and make them an indentured citizen. In this way, corporations bolster their private mercenary forces and spy networks with the best of the worst elements of society.

History

Once known as the CSC, or Central Space Consortium, this sector was first formed in the 2080s by corporations looking for a way to avoid paying taxes to their earthbound governments. Establishing major holdings on off-world colonies, these corporations declared their independence and created their own laws. Companies like Weyland-Yutani, Seegson, Chigusa, Hyperdyne, and the Jǐngtì Lóng Corporation all have planetary holdings in the CSC. ▶

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As humanity's reach stretched into the Outer Rim during the 2100s, more and more UA and 3WE colonies became dissatisfied with the support they received from their governments. Colonial administration was understaffed and overworked. Supply lines were late and the marines and marshals were spread too thin. Some colonies decided to declare themselves independent, but with no corporate giant behind them, they soon found themselves easy prey for pirates and government reclamation.

In the spirit of free commerce, the Consortium reinvented themselves as the Independent Core System Colonies and extended their reach past the core systems to offer support to any colony that wanted its freedom – and could afford to pay the CSC's protection fees. Because the ICSC is outside of any governmental jurisdiction, individual planets set up their own rules. Several large banks and credit companies have settled here, providing security and bonds for corporations whose shady dealings might otherwise have their accounts frozen for government investigation.

Military

The ICSC operates a combined security fleet of mercenary operatives from each of the corporate members. As can be guessed, while they are deadly when operating in small units, they are disastrous at fleet maneuvers and coordinated defenses simply because they do not possess the same training or follow the same rules of engagement.

Leaders

The ICSC is run by the Central Space Consortium, a board of directors representing each major corporation and one director representing the member colonies outside of the core systems. The director's office sends a representative to tour the independent colonies, getting a feel for what those lone worlds need from the alliance, as well as what they can supply in return.

Locations

The ICSC is clustered in the Core, in one of the richest resource-filled areas of the known galaxy – New Eden Sector. Key systems here include Volcus, Ventix, Grendel, and the colonies of Alexandria, Exeter, and St. John.

Relations

Both the 3WE and the UA have imposed trade sanctions and severe import and export taxes on the ICSC. A major USCMC base is located just outside the ICSC – in part to keep a watchful eye on the independent systems, but also because Weyland-Yutani wants the colonial marines close in case of an invasion of the ICSC by the UPP. Even though they are separate from the major governments, the Consortium has contracts in place to use national military forces for added protection. Outside the Core, the ICSC services, protects, and trades with a smattering of independent worlds in the Outer Rim and on the Frontier, including the Solomons and Anchorpoint Station.

Martin

Liaison/Recruiter, Central Space Consortium, Independent Core System Colonies

An artificial person, Martin is subdued, calm and warm-hearted. He listens to the colonists he deals with, absorbing as much information as he can, and then offers solutions. Most people dealing with him never even become aware that he is an android, and his apparent empathy has made Martin the most successful colonial liaison the ICSC has ever employed. While he plays the role of problem solver, his primary mission is, of course, to keep the independent colonies asking for as little as possible while taking from them as much as he can.

Martin has begun to realize of late that his promises are empty and his masters are nothing more than con-artists. He sees that his actions are indirectly hurting the people he is pretending to help, contrary to the rules of robotics. Now Martin is experiencing an existential crisis. It is only a matter of time before he suffers a programming breakdown – and there is no telling what the ramifications may be.

Current Activities

While corporations are cutthroat out in "the real world," they are forced to play nice with each other within the boundaries of the ICSC. Together they operate a massive smuggling ring and black market operation. Opportunities abound for starship crews willing to do a quiet run from New Eden to the Frontier and back. Because of this, ICC agents and colonial marshals have their hands full policing the sector's imports and exports. The Consortium has also been covertly sending recruiters to successful colonies in an attempt to convince them to leave their government and join the ICSC. This practice is illegal and Colonial Administration is monitoring the situation closely. ●

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INTERSTELLAR COMMERCE COMMISSION

THE INTERSTELLAR COMMERCE COMMISSION is an organization designed to monitor and conduct interstellar trade. They enforce shipping restrictions and biological and chemical quarantine procedures for Earth and all other colonies with a population of 200,000 or more. In addition to performing spacedock inspections, the ICC can randomly detain, seize, and search cargo and personal craft for suspected contraband.

History

After a rash of communicable disease outbreaks on several space stations and Luna, the UA and 3WE made rumblings about creating governmental agencies that would restrict the transport of resources and maintain shipping lanes. Weyland-Yutani beat them to the punch with the formation of the ICC, rationalizing that self-regulation would be better than governmental regulation. Satisfied that the ICC could handle the task, the two governments let business return to normal.

Leaders

The Interstellar Commerce Commission is run by a board of directors with representatives from every major corporation and government. The ICC will send an executive to meditate on matters important to the trade commission.

Locations

The Interstellar Commerce Commission is headquartered on KOI 812.03 "Ruby Colony." The largest spaceport in the Outer Veil, most spinward and rimward traffic between the Outer Rim and the Core is routed through the Commission in this system. The ICC operates inspection teams and coast guard cutters at every major space station in the UA, 3WE, and ICSC, while also patrolling the UPP border.

Relations

While they are allegedly an autonomous entity with loyalties to no particular party, the ICC is in fact owned and operated by Weyland-Yutani. Make of that what you will.

Current Activities

Every commercial starship is required to pass inspection, and each crew member must hold an ICC license in order to operate a vessel designated to transport food, persons, raw materials, or goods from one star system to another. As rumors of bizarre alien lifeforms and pathogens circulate the colonies, the ICC has been cracking down on ships returning from both deep space and the Frontier – making sure they have licensed crews, certified cargoes, and nothing else on board. ●

Paul van Leuwen

Executive, Interstellar Commerce Commission

Van Leuwen was the ICC representative who chaired Ellen Ripley's tribunal over the loss of the commercial freighter Nostromo. Finding no evidence to support officer Ripley's claims of an alien lifeform that boarded the ship on LV-426 and killed her crew, Van Leuwen dismissed her claims, revoked her flight status, and remanded her to psychiatric evaluation. When the colony on LV-426 went silent, Paul at first thought it was a coincidence – likely a downed transmitter or solar flare up.

When he found out that a platoon of colonial marines with Ripley as an advisor were sent to investigate and also disappeared, he began to wonder if the former Nostromo officer had been telling the truth. Learning of the destruction of the colony and Robert Morse's Space Beast book, Van Leuwen launched an ICC inquiry to get to the bottom of this alleged alien.

Skeptical and jaded from a lifetime of experience, Paul is nonetheless now seeing the galaxy through fresh eyes. Booking private passage on W-Y corporate shuttles, Van Leuwen can be seen coming and going from Anchorpoint station as his investigation proceeds.

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WEYLAND-YUTANI

THE WEYLAND-YUTANI CORPORATION is a British and Japanese multinational conglomerate that dominates the stars. They are an innovative producer and manufacturer of synthetics, spaceships, computers, and weapons for the average consumer market as well as commercial clients and the industrial military complex. They are in the business of deep space mining and resource procurement, interplanetary shipping and transport, terraforming, and the establishment and maintenance of extrasolar colonies. Weyland-Yutani also maintains an extensive Research and Development division devoted to the development of biological and chemical weapons.

History

Weyland-Yutani was founded at the turn of the century by the merger of Weyland Corp and the Yutani Corporation. The two companies were so renowned for their corporate takeovers that the circumstances behind their merger became murky. While it is known that Weyland Corp ▶

Dog Catchers

Weyland-Yutani maintains a commando corps trained to handle and capture Xenomorph specimens. Called the Dog Catchers, these corporate security units usually include four commandos, two animal containment specialists, a science team, and a chief surgeon – often led by a high level corporate exec. These commandos wear APEsuits (page 90), carry pulse rifles, and utilize specialized capture equipment (+2 to grapple attacks and rolls to keep a grapple, see page 62). Unfortunately, most of the information Weyland-Yutani has gathered about the Xenomorph and its subspecies is based on secondhand reports, and therefore these teams are often ill-equipped to deal with the actual threat the creatures represent.



Licensed System (Order: 53151103)



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

had suffered severe financial losses with the failure of the Prometheus mission and the deaths of both company founder Peter Weyland and CEO Meredith Vickers, it is also true that Yutani had suffered many setbacks as well.

Conflicting insider information versus media reports make it questionable as to whether it was Yutani or Weyland who performed a hostile takeover on the other – and the company board likes it that way. The company inherited and expanded upon the technologies and products of its founders, including FTL drives, artificial intelligence, and deep surveillance equipment.

Already leaders in the mining and shipping of extrasolar resources, by the 2130s they decided to get back into terraforming with a comparatively inexpensive and less safe redesign of Weyland Corp atmospheric processors. Over the next 30 years they established many new colony worlds within the American Arm of the Outer Rim Territories, in the process becoming the United Americas' chief supplier of weapons and starships.

Leaders

Like any major corporation, Weyland-Yutani is run by a board of directors and shareholders. Though unsubstantiated, there are rumors that upper management is actually run by synthetics operating under directives that date back to co-founder Peter Weyland's David series of androids.

W-Y XOs and corporate agents are numerous on the Frontier, but the real man in charge out there is Michael Bishop.

Locations

Weyland-Yutani has main offices in Tokyo, London, San Francisco, Sea of Tranquility, and on Thedus. They can be found on any major starport world, and they have holdings on Alexandria in the Independent Core System Colonies. Throughout the Outer Veil, Outer Rim, and Frontier are dozens of W-Y sponsored colonies, terraforming projects, and mining operations.

Relations

Like both its predecessor companies, W-Y plays hard and fast with mergers and acquisitions, buying out those they can and destroying those they can't. As such, they have a ruthless and cutthroat reputation in the corporate world. Despite the fact that the company has a seat in the Interstellar Commerce Commission's Company Review Board, their commercial fleet management is known to bribe both ICC agents and Colonial Marshals rather than submit their spacecraft to mandatory safety inspections. An uneasy alliance of convenience exists between W-Y and the United Americas, one that is currently straining both entities' relationships with the Three World Empire.

Current Activities

Weyland-Yutani is operating top secret R&D facilities throughout the territories, specializing in illegal development of synthetic and biochemical weapons. For decades, a major focus of said research has been the procurement of both Chemical A0-3959X.91-15 and P. praepotens for use as biochemical self-replicating weapons.

After the incidents on LV-426 and Fiorina 161, W-Y has doubled down on their efforts. Orbital research facilities like RB-232 "The Cold Forge" and Kathar Station have spent considerable time and effort researching the Xenomorphs, but a method of safely containing them still eludes the company.

Special "Dog Catcher" commando and science teams under the supervision of Michael Bishop explore the Frontier in search of Xenomorph XX121 hive worlds, archaeological ruins belonging to the Engineers, and viable alien specimens. W-Y is also covertly developing aggressive X-stimulants, hardwired cybernetic integrated exo-suits, and illegal combat androids for the USCMC. ●

Michael Bishop

Director of Special Projects, Bio-Weapons R&D, and Synthetic Design

A narcissistic genius and creator of the Bishop series android, Michael Bishop's ambitious and manipulative behavior catapulted him through the corporate ranks from a synthetic designer at Hyperdyne Systems to a senior position in bioweapons and director of special projects at Weyland-Yutani. His focus over the past few years has been to obtain viable specimens of P. praepotens for bioweapons research. He almost achieved his goal when confronting Ellen Ripley at the Fiorina 161 Class C Work Correctional Unit, but her suicide by immolation there prevented him from obtaining his prize.

During the incident Michael suffered severe head trauma and has since received extensive corrective surgery and cybernetic implants in order to repair the damage to his skull. Unfortunately, the doctors have been unable to control his severe migraines and red-outs, and Michael has become dependent on highly addictive painkillers. Never one to throw in the towel, Michael has since operated on the Frontier, tracking down any Xenomorph XX121 leads and sightings in the hopes of capturing one and weaponizing it. His corporate transport ship the Patna can frequently be found docked at the W-Y corporate berth on Anchorpoint Station.

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)



LASALLE BIONATIONAL

LASALLE BIONATIONAL IS A MULTINATIONAL conglomerate specializing in biological research and development.

History

A relative newcomer, Lasalle Bionational was formed in the wake of mass layoffs in the W-Y bio research and development division during the late 2130s. W-Y VP Brendan Lasalle quit over the firings, citing "creative differences" as the cause. He obtained start-up funds and assembled those laid off to create Lasalle Bionational. It wasn't long before his company acquired a lucrative government contract to produce an inexpensive, radiation-resistant corn substitute, as well as a blight virus that would destroy an enemy's crops, securing their place in the market.

Leaders

Bionational is owned and operated by the Lasalle family, handed down from father to daughter. While there is a board of directors in place, the family controls a majority of shares, ensuring they cannot be ousted from their own corporation.

Locations

Lasalle Bionational has its home offices on Earth in Texas, Columbia, and French Polynesia. The company is known to operate several sterile research space stations in the Outer Veil and sponsored the colonies on Taurus 7 and LV-113 in the Outer Rim Territories. On the Frontier, Lasalle Bionational maintains a farming colony on Terraform 3 and operates a fleet of SEVs out of Anchorpoint Station.

Relations

Lasalle Bionational is in a bio-arms race with Weyland-Yutani to secure bioweapons contracts with the USCMC, and each is constantly the victim of corporate espionage and sabotage by the other. As Lasalle Bionational is not as well protected as W-Y, the UPP has placed spies within the Bionational administration with the intent of stealing their research for their own.

Products

Lasalle Bionational is known for its radiation resistant crops, bioengineered livestock that can be customized to a number of different environments, extrasolar pathogen vaccines, and its biological research, procurement and weapons division.

Current Activities

Rivals to the Weyland-Yutani bio-weapons division, Lasalle Bionational has in fact managed to secure their own cache of Xenomorph XX121 Ovomorphs and has successfully bred a hive for study and observation in the Taurus system. Bionational science and security exploration teams scour the Frontier looking for ancient Engineer laboratories, traces of Chemical A0-3959X.91-15, and any other alien lifeforms, viruses, or mutagens waiting to be discovered. ●

Edina Lasalle

CEO of Lasalle Bionational

Daughter of the company's founder, Edina has just taken over for her now retired father. Edina believes that expansion of the company's bioweapons department is key to their survival, and has stepped up her father's initial plans to sequence the genome of Xenomorph XX121. Not one to trust reports, Edina is currently inspecting and reviewing the company's holdings first-hand, traveling with a security team to each and every facility to determine each project's worth.

While her father Brendan stepped down and put Edina in charge, he still has a seat on the board of directors and acts as her advisor. Edina is not cold-hearted, she just has a logistical approach to things – treating employees as company assets, for better or for worse. After several security breaches and deaths of prominent employees, Edina Lasalle is looking for someone with a particular set of skills to protect the company's interests.

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SEEGSON

A PROMINENT MANUFACTURER of inexpensive alternatives to Weyland-Yutani's product lines, Seegson is a European conglomerate that will forever be in Weyland-Yutani's shadow. Well known for their award winning A.P.O.L.L.O. AI mainframe and low-end synthetics, Seegson first gained notoriety by sharing their inventions and pooling their resources with smaller companies.

History

One of the innovators of spaceflight in the 2030s, Sieg and Son was founded in direct competition to Weyland Corp. Having patented their own FTL displacement drive system, Sieg and Son shared their technologies with other companies, ensuring that Weyland wasn't the only one to make it to the stars. By the 2070s they were operating major production plants across the globe, the Sieg family had sold back their shares to the company and Sieg and Son was condensed to Seegson.

James Evans-Russell
Director of Frontier Operations

A collector of western film and simulations, Russell is also a bit of a romantic. He views the Frontier as akin to the North American Old West, and uses any excuse he can to leave his cushy office on Anchorpoint and experience first-hand the many rough and tumble worlds out there. Despite this, Russell is very much a company man and toes the Seegson line.

The company entered the synthetic market in the early 2100s with their Working Joe model androids. Nowhere near as advanced as Weyland's David or Walter series, the Working Joes have a more rudimentary intelligence and are designed to perform maintenance and menial tasks. Rather than being indistinguishable from humans, they have cheap rubberized skin that gives them the appearance of animate mannequins. Usable as an inexpensive labor force, the Working Joes sold well on the ever-shifting Frontier.

Successful in so many arenas, Seegson made one investment error that would cripple them for decades. Lacking a patent on atmospheric processors, Seegson put its funding into extrasolar deep space orbital platform colonies. As Weyland-Yutani terraformed more worlds, Seegson's stock began to plummet. Even the harsher worlds proved more attractive to colonists than life inside a tin can floating through space.

By 2140, most of Seegson's space stations had been placed on the market. Today, the company survives through its sales on backwater colonies and on the Frontier, where everything needs to be cheap and reliable.

Leaders

Seegson is a publicly traded company run by a board of directors. On the Frontier, Director James Russell looks after the company's interests from his headquarters on Anchorpoint Station.

Locations

While they operate very few colonies of their own, Seegson maintains an office on every major spaceport in the Core, Outer Veil, and Outer Rim systems. Their home offices are in London, Buenos Aires, Nagasaki and on Luna, the Solomons, and Anchorpoint. They still operate a few deep space stations as R&D platforms.

Products

Seegson is known for its work in security and communications, its credit services, and the A.P.O.L.L.O. AI computer mainframe. They are major producers of space and ground vehicles, pharmaceuticals, and their mannequin-like "Working Joe" line of cost-effective synthetics. While they maintain an impressive array of product lines, Seegson's wares are considered somewhat inferior to those produced by Weyland-Yutani. The Colonial Times has even referred to Seegson merchandise as "cheap knockoffs." Still, an independent colony that couldn't afford a W-Y security system would do almost as well with one from Seegson, and their A.P.O.L.L.O. mainframe system continues to be a popular and cost effective choice for starship and colony management on the Frontier.

Licensed Spirit (Order: 53151103)



"With Seegson, there is someone behind you every single step of the way."

Working Joe

Relations

Seegson has lucrative contracts with the Independent Core System Colonies and the Three World Empire. Their business affiliates include Geofund, Gemini Exoplanet Solutions, and Gustafsson Enterprise Ltd. While Seegson is always looking to score big over Weyland-Yutani, W-Y does not consider them a threat at all. Like W-Y, Seegson is looking to secure specimens of Xenomorph XX121 for study and evaluation.

Current Activities

Seegson is actively attempting to sabotage W-Y interests on the Frontier. Unfortunately, they also have the making of a scandal on their hands. A large shipment of Seegson's Working Joe synthetics was recently sold before their behavior inhibitors were installed, and these units went to an anonymous buyer on the Frontier. While unsubstantiated, some believe these androids were purchased by a would-be petty dictator for use in a backwater planetary coup. Others believe these Working Joes were covertly commissioned by the UPP for use as an artificial combat unit, and still others worry that the omission of the inhibitor programming was but a simple error with the potential for disastrous ramifications. The thought of synthetics capable of murder introduced into the civilian population is one no colonial administrator or marshal wants to contemplate. ●

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

CHAPTER 9

SYSTEMS & PLANETS

"I should reach the frontier in about six weeks. With a little luck, the network will pick me up."

Lt. Ellen Ripley

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

SPACE IS FULL OF DEMONS, and they want your blood. In any number of the locations sited below, you might run into a shady Colonial Marshal looking for his take, a greedy corporate XO who finds you expendable, or a psychopathic synthetic with a god complex. You could be waylaid by pirates or betrayed by a megalomaniacal military commander.

You might find plague-ridden treasures and run afoul of a dangerous organism or a hostile alien species. The seeds of these encounters are planted in the planetary systems presented here – it's up to you to determine which bear fruit and where.

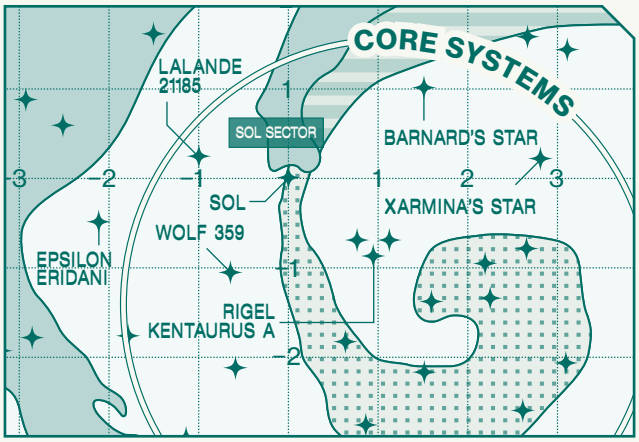
The systems described here can all be found on the star map on the inside covers of this book, and on the large separate map included in the ALIEN RPG Core Rulebook.

CORE SYSTEMS

WHEN HUMANKIND FIRST VENTURED to the stars, this is where they did it. The Core Systems are humanity's prosperous future in space, built on the hard labor of the common man of yesteryear. Today, the common people work in the Outer Veil, try to forge a new life in the Outer Rim Territories, or risk it all on the Frontier, while the corporations and the rich pull strings from the safety of their fortified off-world paradises.

Sol Sector

YOUR NEW START is out there on the Frontier, far away from home, so there is no point in belaboring the minutiae of life in our solar system. However, a brief recap of the place is included here, because before you look at where you are going, it's important to know where you've been.



"Earth, man. What a shithole."

Ron Johner

Earth: Having been brought back from the brink of environmental disaster by a little terraforming at home, Earth is an eclectic array of densely packed centers of urban decay and beautiful green vistas. While some still linger, most radiation zones from past conflicts have been cleaned up and pose little threat. Earth is far from a safe place to live, however. The United States Oil Wars have taken their toll on North America. The recent Australian Rebellion against the 3WE was ended swiftly with the nuclear strike on the Outback's capital, Canberra. The cost of living on Earth is extravagant, and those who aren't rich are confined to metropolitan ghettos. Earth has become a world for no one but the corporate and government elite and those who would serve them. Still, the seats of power for the 3WE, UA, and the UPP are all located on Earth.

Luna: Humanity's first off-world colony, Luna boasts a population of over 6 million in two colonies and is a center of mining and heavy industry for the entire system.

Mars: Along with Earth and Titan, Mars is one of the three capital worlds of the Three World Empire. Valles Colony on Mars was the former headquarters of Weyland Corp before they merged with Yutani. Terraforming has made the planet home for over 20 million colonists. Weyland-Yutani still maintains offices there and operates a weapons testing facility on the moon of Phobos.

The Outer Planets: Titan is a major off-world colony within the solar system, its domed communities boasting a total population of roughly 7 million. Heavy mining stations like the one on Io and orbital colonial stations like those around Saturn and Jupiter lace the moons and planets throughout the solar system.

Third Base

A classified USCMC research base situated on a small undesignated moon, Third Base is located within a short jump distance from both New Eden Sector and Sol system. Third Base is a pressurized facility designed for advanced bioweapons research and maintains an expansive hanger that is able to accommodate several large military transport and cargo vessels, along with a well-stocked vehicle depot and extensive armory.

Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

Systems And Planets

TERRITORY	SECTOR	SYSTEM	PLANET/MOON	COLONIES
Core Systems	Sol	Sol	Earth / Luna	Sea of Tranquility
			Mars / Phobos	Valles
		Classified	Classified	Third Base
	New Eden	AG-4550	AG-4550.02	Alexandria
		Heske 337	Volcus	Etna
Outer Veil	3847	JPG-770	JPG-770.03	Gorham's Folly
	Neroid	POL-5362	POL-5362.01	Aires Outpost
		Fiori 16	Fiorina 161	Fury
	Bao Sau	17 Phei Phei	17 Phei Phei E	Znoy Outpost
Outer Rim Territories	Borodino	Requist	DP-27	The Sprawl
		Gliese 326-3827	Gliese 326-3827b	Bracken's World, Joliet
		8 ETA Boötis	8 Eta Boötis A III	Tientsin
	Crestus Prime Cluster	Crestus Prime, Alpha, Beta, Gamma, Delta	Classified	Crestus Garrisons
	Tartarus	GJ-229A	Torin Prime	Three
		GL-300	Linna 349	Two
The Frontier	Tartarus	Gamma Leporis	Gamma Leporis A3	Steer City
		Khadaji	KJ-331b Lebanon II	The Wells
	Cusp of Tartarus	Zeta1 Reticuli	KG-348	Sevastopol Station
		Zeta2 Reticuli	Calpamos	–
			LV-223	–
			LV-426 "Acheron"	Hadley's Hope, Kathar Station
	Far Reach	Alpha Caeli	Alpha Caeli V b–h	The Solomons
		Alpheios	LV-410	Jackson's Star
		Epsilon Reticuli	Thedus	Three
		Tanaka	Tanaka 5	–
Unknown	117	Achilles	G-435	Xenomorph hives

The Colonial Marine forces stationed there are trained and positioned to launch a first strike on any ICSC world if necessary. Despite its classified status, Third Base sits adjacent to the civilian colony and atmospheric processing plant on the moon. A series of caverns and former ice reservoirs honeycomb the surface and served as temporary housing while the colony was established. The colony itself is cut off from the rest of the galaxy. All communications are handled on military channels and must be approved. They are monitored with a built-in delay for censorship, and any and all supplies are imported via military cargo runs only. ▶

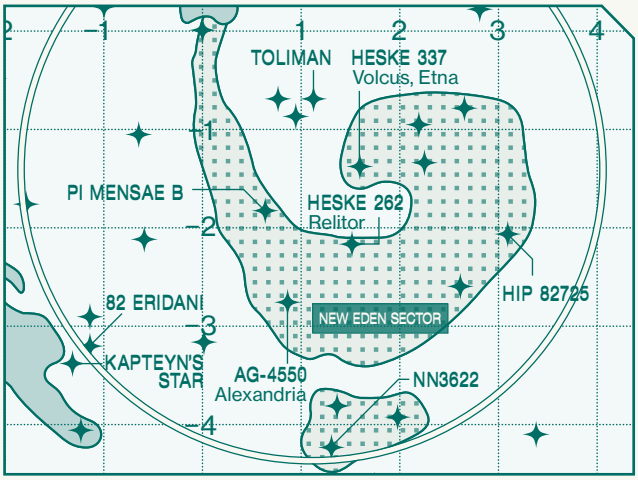
THIRD BASE

▶ **Location**	Core Systems, Sol Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	United Americas, USCMC
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial moon
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, torrential downpours, electrical storms
▶ **Temperature**	25°C (temperate)
▶ **Terrain**	Barren wasteland
▶ **Colonies**	One plus one military base
▶ **Population**	168 colonists, 500 marines, 48 military scientists
▶ **Key Resources**	Military base, research

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New Eden Sector

HOME TO THE INDEPENDENT CORE SYSTEM COLONIES, New Eden Sector exudes wealth and prestige and is protected by the ICSC corporate mercenary fleet. Stationed in the Ventix system, the fleet is always within a few parsecs of Relitor, NE/JV, and Alexandria and Olympia Colonies. The corporate colonies of New Eden Sector fought the 3WE for their independence. While the ICSC succession was granted within the last decade, UA and 3WE sanctions and tariffs restrict the flow of goods, people, and military equipment both into and out of the region, inadvertently creating a smuggling industry and thriving black market.



AG-4550 System

AG-4550.02 (Alexandria Colony): A highly developed and industrialized world with a thriving population, Alexandria Colony is where company execs retire, and corporations hide their profits from prying government eyes. As the planet is hot and dry with few large bodies of water, major settlements are located close to the poles and along coastal regions. Atmospheric processors dating back to the Weyland Era dot the surface, maintaining nearly ideal living conditions while an advanced irrigation system and dedicated agricultural programs have all but eliminated the need for imported supplies. A nearly self-sufficient world, Alexandria is also the capital of the Independent Core System Colonies. From here the Central Space Consortium controls the ICSC in the form of a democratic republic comprised of representatives from corporations with a stake in the well-being of the ICSC.

AG-4550.02 (ALEXANDRIA COLONY)

▶ **Location**	Core Systems, New Eden Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	Independent Core System Colonies, Central Space Consortium, Weyland-Yutani, Seegson, and other major corporations and banking institutions
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, hot and dry, terraformed
▶ **Temperature**	38°C across most of the planet, but 30°C at the poles
▶ **Terrain**	Desert with a few large bodies of water
▶ **Colonies**	One, with several coastal and polar settlements
▶ **Population**	30,000,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Agriculture, water, financial reserves, technologies

Heske 337 System

Volcus (Orbital Collector V-23 And The Etna Moon): Geologically speaking, Volcus is a recently coalesced planet that is in the cooling phase of its development. As such, the surface is a living hell of sulfur, magma, and hot gases. While no colony exists on the surface itself, automated power stations float on the planet's magma seas, drawing in geothermal energy and transmitting it to the V-23 orbital collector and relay station. Once amassed there, the energy is beamed to the Web Colony on Volcus' airless moon, Etna. As a surplus of energy is generated by the collector, high output power cells are produced here and exported throughout the ICSC. The interlinked array of habitat domes on Etna sustains nearly two hundred thousand colonists, while one hundred engineers maintain and live on V-23. ●

HESKE 337: VOLCUS (ORBITAL COLLECTOR V-23 AND THE ETNA MOON)

▶ **Location**	Inner Core Systems, New Eden Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	Independent Core System Colonies, Central Space Consortium
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet/moon
▶ **Climate**	Corrosive atmosphere, ash and pyroclastic flows, scouring heat/airless vacuum
▶ **Temperature**	400°C on Volcus/−173°C on Etna
▶ **Terrain**	Magma seas and volcanic islands/barren moon
▶ **Colonies**	Web Colony (on Etna)
▶ **Population**	200,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Geothermal energy, bauxite, gold, diamonds, base and rare earth metals



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

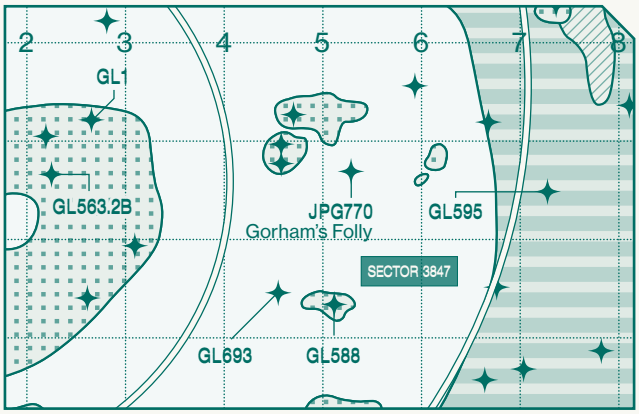
OUTER VEIL

A RELATIVELY RESOURCE-RICH region of space that separates the Core Systems from the Outer Rim, the Outer Veil is mostly a fertile area of colonization, mining, and terraforming. While there are densely populated sectors within the Outer Veil, there are also out of the way areas of no real value. The United Americas only has a strip of colonies here.

Dubbed the American Corridor by space truckers, this roughly parsec-wide area leads out to the UA sectors on the Outer Rim (collectively called the American Arm). However, the Three World Empire and the Union of Progressive Peoples both have major stakes in the Outer Veil. The UPP strip-mined the planets they discovered here, leaving behind a stretch of barren worlds that is one of the poorest in their nation.

Sector 3847

THE UNIMAGINATIVELY NAMED SECTOR 3847 was one of the first areas of the Outer Veil determined to be rich in exploitable mineral resources. This well-established sector boasts large and successful colonies.



JPG-770.03 (GORHAM'S FOLLY)

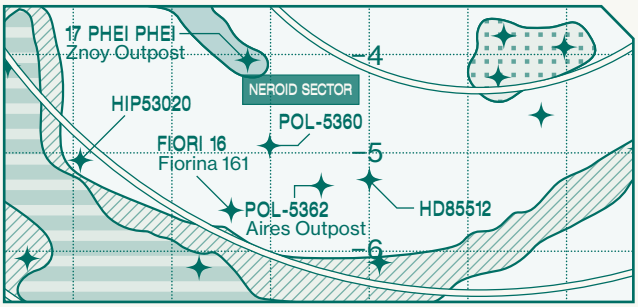
▶ **Location**	Outer Veil, Sector 387, Anglo-Japanese Arm
▶ **Affiliation**	Three World Empire, Weyland-Yutani
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, arid, temperate terraformed
▶ **Temperature**	35°C
▶ **Terrain**	Rocky plateaus with deep fissures and canyons
▶ **Colonies**	One, Gorham Colony
▶ **Population**	700,000

JPG-770 System

JPG-770.03 (Gorham's Folly): After the first Gorham Mining Colony was annexed by the UPP in the early 2100s, Industrialist Charles Gorham simply founded a better one. This terraformed world is the site of the deepest mining operation in the Outer Veil. Mine shafts on JPG-770.03 descend as far as 42 kilometers. Some sections of the planet were gouged and strip-mined before safer methods were introduced. The colony exists to service the mining operations, but the miners themselves are brought in on 18-month contracts. Gorham's Folly employs numerous service androids to keep the miners happy. Extensive trade routes exist between JPG-770.03, the Core, and the Outer Rim.

Neroid Sector

A WEYLAND-YUTANI-CONTROLLED area of the Three World Empire close to UPP space, the remote Neroid Sector is devoid of most anything of value. Here, the company maintains a scattering of research stations left over from the Weyland era, and uses abandoned, strip-mined worlds to store toxic waste and chemical weapon surplus.



POL-5362.01 (AIRES OUTPOST)

▶ **Location**	Outer Veil, Neroid Sector, Anglo-Japanese Arm
▶ **Affiliation**	Three World Empire, Weyland-Yutani
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Toxic atmosphere, severe methane rainstorms
▶ **Temperature**	−223°C
▶ **Terrain**	Varies between frozen methane wasteland when farthest from the star to deep methane seas when closest
▶ **Colonies**	Research facility
▶ **Population**	32
▶ **Key Resources**	Methane, uncatalogued

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POL-5362 System

POL-5362.01 (Aires Outpost): Aires is a planet of extremes – shifting from a frozen methane wasteland to a raging methane sea. As its orbit carries it further from its sun, the planet's atmosphere freezes, leaving a four-month period every rotation where everything on the planet is trapped in ice. One hundred years ago, a survey detected life moving beneath Aires' frozen surface, and a large scientific expedition was launched to investigate. Sadly, nothing more has been seen or recorded for a century. When the Weyland Corp expedition was recalled, only a rotating skeleton crew was assigned to monitor the planet.

Now, a crew of 32 scientists, administrators, and security officers live on an aging buoyant/submersible research and monitoring platform built to accommodate two hundred. The team has two antique submarines, four research pods, and a dropship to get them to and from orbit. Assignment to Aires Platform is considered a dead end for W-Y scientists with experience and a good start for interns and new hires. While unsubstantiated, rumor has it that the last transmission from Aires indicated the team had located what appeared to be artificial structures at the bottom of the methane sea, and that their sensor buoys had again begun to register movement beneath the ice...

Fiori 16 System

A binary star system located in the Neroid Sector, Fiori 16 is an otherwise unremarkable system with one habitable world – Fiorina 161 – whose hastened orbit loops it around Fiori 16b every ten days.

Fiorina 161 (Fury): Nicknamed "Fury" by the YY chromosome inmates of the prison that was located there, Fiorina 161 is an unforgiving place. Temperatures vary widely as the world makes its orbit around the binary stars of Fiori 16a and b. Fury is home to a large variety of fish, as well as at least one group of primitive land animals. Unfortunately, the most prolific species on the planet is a small arthropod similar to lice, making it mandatory that all visitors shave their body hair. Fury 161's year is only ten days long – and half of that year is in darkness.

Determined to be rich in platinum, the planet was extensively mined for decades. Estimates proved to be optimistic, however, and Fury 161's resources tapped out quickly. Never one to miss a beat, Weyland-Yutani converted the worksite to a Class C Work Correctional Unit and lead works for radioactive and toxic waste disposal, leasing it to the Three World Empire. While at its height the facility housed thousands of prisoners, it was closed in the 2170s – leaving only a custodial staff and less than two dozen inmates to keep the facility running. ▶

Michael Syrett (Order: 5315103)

In 2179, an EEV pod from the errant starship Sulaco crash-landed on the planet, bringing some kind of contagion. Rumors suggest it was a rare strain of Cholera. Whatever it was, the convicts stationed there made unauthorized use of the facility's stores of quinitricetyline in an attempt to burn away the infectious agent, accidentally killing several of their own in the process. Weyland-Yutani dispatched the Medical frigate Patna to Fury 161 but were too late to save all but one inmate – Robert Morse.

The story has been sensationalized by Morse's banned book Space Beast, in which he claims that it wasn't a contagion but a hostile organism that was on board the EEV, and that it slew nearly everyone before it was finally put down. Morse also claims the company was at fault for the massacre. Weyland-Yutani has recently put the facility on the market to be sold as scrap, but so far there have been no takers.

RUMOR CONTROL FURY 161

WHILE COLORFUL, Morse's Space Beast account of what happened on Fury 161 is accurate. During the Hadley's Hope Incident on LV-426, an alien Queen managed to come aboard the USS Sulaco and deposit at least one undeveloped egg sac aboard the ship before being expelled from the airlock by mission advisor Lt. Ellen Ripley. As the Sulaco's computers were subsequently damaged, it is unclear if there were one or two Facehuggers birthed aboard at the time – but what is clear is that one was able to produce a royal embryo. Once the unsuspecting survivors entered hypersleep, the newly hatched creature attempted to gain entry to Rebecca Jorden's cryotube, accidentally causing an electrical fire in the Sulaco's hypersleep chambers. The ship's MU/TH/UR ejected the EEV pod, launching Ripley, Corporal Hicks, Jorden, and the Sulaco's Bishop android towards Fury 161. Their pod eventually crashed into the ocean near the correctional facility.

Hicks and Jorden did not survive the crash, and the Bishop android was damaged beyond repair. Lt. Ripley was soon found to be gestating a Queen within her. Either the royal Facehugger was able to produce two embryos – an ability that W-Y scientists have hypothesized but been unable to confirm – or a second Facehugger was also aboard the EEV with them. Regardless of the culprit, one of the facility's domestic animals was subsequently impregnated with the Runner variety of P. praepotens. The Runner managed to slaughter all the convicts and staff except for Morse and prison guard Francis Aaron. Because of the unborn Queen Ripley carried, the Runner left her unmolested.

Aware that the lieutenant was a carrier, Weyland-Yutani dispatched CEO Michael Bishop and a crack medical team to retrieve the embryo. As they arrived, Ripley and Morse managed to put down the Runner. Aaron attacked Michael and was killed by company commandos, and Ripley threw herself into the leadworks furnace to prevent the company from acquiring the Queen.

After the incident, Weyland-Yutani examined the leadworks and prison facilities, hoping to find any trace of alien DNA. Although they were able to collect blood samples of Lt. Ripley that were taken by Dr. Clemens before her death, no viable P. praepotens genetic material was found. The company ordered the site closed and put the equipment there up for sale as scrap.

Not all the quinitricetyline was used up in the inmates' bid to rid the prison of the star beast. While most of the facility on Fury 161 has been stripped and prepped for scrap, Weyland-Yutani has yet to find any buyers for it – and that includes the remaining drums stored there. But that's not all.

The Weyland-Yutani team assigned to comb the facility wasn't as thorough as they could have been – likely because their corporate masters were reluctant to explain exactly what they were looking for. Deep in the bowels of the long-abandoned sections of the facility lie the beginnings of a secreted resin hive. Just as the Drone Xenomorph aboard the Nostromo had done with Dallas and Brett, the Fury 161 Runner had been creating a nest and had already begun the process of transforming Superintendent Andrews and inmates Boggs and Rains into contingency Ovomorphs.

Other parties have since taken interest in Morse's Space Beast, and it's only a matter of time before someone sends their own covert team to investigate. For now, the Fury 161 alien eggs lay dormant, waiting for someone to stumble upon them.

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FIORI 16: FIORINA 161 (FURY)

▶ **Location**	Outer Veil, Neroid Sector, Anglo-Japanese Arm
▶ **Affiliation**	Weyland-Yutani, Three World Empire
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, constantly swept with howling winds
▶ **Temperature**	−20°C to 40°C
▶ **Terrain**	Flat deserts and dark acidic oceans
▶ **Colonies**	Former industrial colony turned prison, now closed
▶ **Population**	None
▶ **Key Resources**	Formerly labor force and heavy metals, now industrial scrap and quinitricetyline

Bao Sau Sector

A UPP AREA of space that borders directly on the Neroid and Tartarus Sectors, Bao Sau Sector is a vast area of barren, stripped worlds with a sprinkling of over-populated and under-fed colonies.

17 Phei Phei System

17 Phei Phei is a UPP border defense system on the Bao Sau/Neroid sector border between the UPP and the 3WE. The system has five small planetoids with a massive asteroid belt orbiting a main sequence star. UPP scientists have determined that the system must have suffered some major catastrophic event in its past, causing its planets to veer into each other's orbital planes, eventually resulting in a series of collisions that left the system nothing but rubble. Only five small planetoids that orbit extremely close to their sun remain in a system that is estimated to once have hosted over thirty planets and moons. At some point in the future these planetoids will collide with each other as well, but for now they remain locked in slowly decaying orbits that are very close to the star itself.

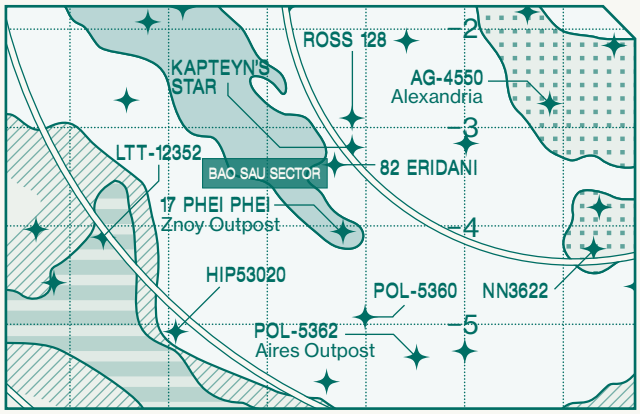
17 Phei Phei E (Znoy Outpost): As a celestial body, 17 Phei Phei E is disappointing. The planetoid spins too slowly and is too small to capture its own atmosphere. The only thing of note in the system is the listening and monitoring post Znoy (Russian for "Heat"). Znoy is but one of many such posts across the UPP border, all connected by a grid of sensor satellites that record any incursions. Unfortunately, the sensors are rudimentary at best, so it is often difficult for the outpost staff to determine if an invasion fleet is on its way or if the grid has simply registered a rogue comet or stellar debris. While new arrivals here scramble to alert the UPP SOF Command of any contact, old timers know the drill.

Znoy Outpost is mostly underground, having been driven into the rock like a giant stake. During the day, the outpost unfurls a solar shield to both protect it from the direct heat and to harness the star's rays and recharge its power cells. A "day" on 17 Phei Phei E lasts nearly two Earth months while a "night" lasts about 28 Earth days. Supply ships can only approach when the outpost is on the night side, as the planetoid itself shields the transports from the extreme heat of the sun.

Assignment to Znoy is considered a punishment. It is understaffed and ill-equipped to face even an unlikely invasion that might come through this area. While it is equipped with system-wide orbital nuclear arrays, the outpost itself has only two dropships and four heat-shielded tracked vehicles for surface operations. To make matters worse for the soldiers assigned there, Znoy is the closest UPP military installation to Zeta Reticuli, and the United Americas Allied Command is investigating the possibility that a UPP strike was launched there against Hadley's Hope. If such an attack did happen, the UAAC believes it would have originated from Znoy. ●

"Trust your enemy to be your enemy, but never trust your neighbor to be your friend."

UPP saying



17 PHEI PHEI E (ZNOY OUTPOST)

▶ **Location**	Outer Veil, Bao Sau Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	UPP
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planetoid
▶ **Climate**	No atmosphere
▶ **Temperature**	−173°C at night to 427°C in the day
▶ **Terrain**	Barren cratered rock
▶ **Colonies**	None, military monitoring outpost
▶ **Population**	115 soldiers
▶ **Key Resources**	Heavy metals in asteroid belt

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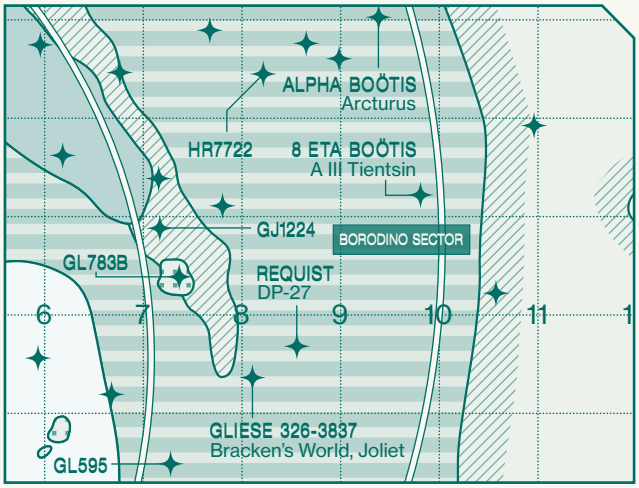
OUTER RIM TERRITORIES

THE OUTER RIM is a place of political brinkmanship. At the turn of the century, the Three World Empire and the many nations that would become the UPP claimed the star systems nearest to Earth. The American nations instead looked beyond the Outer Veil to conquer new rich and fertile territories. Many of the worlds American explorers discovered on the Outer Rim were capable of supporting life without the use of Atmospheric Processors, making colonization swift and comparatively inexpensive.

The American colonies joined together, and the United Americas were formed. Fearing American expansion, the fledgling UPP poured its resources into exploring and claiming a large section of the Outer Rim as well – in the process over-extending themselves and crippling their economy. While the 3WE has made its own limited push into the Outer Rim, it relies solely on Weyland-Yutani to handle such expansion efforts. While civilized to some degree, the Outer Rim Territories of today are both bountiful and full of conflict. Home to many military installations, the Outer Rim is where modern man fights his wars and faces the unknown.

Borodino Sector

NESTLED IN A POCKET between the encroaching United Americas and the Union of Progressive Peoples, part of the Borodino Sector is openly disputed Frontier on the Outer Rim. Here, a UPP system might be next-door neighbor to a UA one, and as such it is a volatile area. It is the site of some of the Colonial Marines' most famous battles, including the Tientsin Campaign and the Arcturan Conflicts. Some worlds here have even declared their complete independence, while others are protected by the ICSC.



Requist System

DP-27: A crime-plagued world on the Outer Rim, the massive prison facility on DP-27 (sometimes called Detention Planet 27 by those who have served time there) is home to over 20,000 convicts. As the prison allows visitors, processing centers had to be built to accommodate them. Eventually, several visiting families decided to settle there, transforming the processing center into its own corporate run colony. Settlements developed in radiating lines from the massive prison facility and collectively became known as "the Sprawl."

Taking advantage of its natural resources, the Seegson Corporation built several factories in the Sprawl to mass-produce gyrocars. As Weyland Corp developed better technologies, the Seegson models became less popular. The factories closed, the colony became destitute and the future prospects for those living there grew increasingly bleak. Taking advantage of the situation, the Colonial Marine Corps opened their largest recruitment center in the Outer Rim on DP-27. The USCMC offers colonists the chance to see the galaxy, making soldiers the planet's major export.

REQUIST: DP-27

▶ **Location**	Outer Rim, American Arm, Borodino Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	United Americas, Seegson
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial moon
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, overcast, freezing rain
▶ **Temperature**	5°C
▶ **Terrain**	Urban sprawl on flatlands with large lakes
▶ **Colonies**	One, the Sprawl
▶ **Population**	60,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Soldiers, rare earth metals

GLIESE 326-3827B (BRACKEN'S WORLD)

▶ **Location**	Outer Rim, American Arm, Edge of Borodino and Cerberus Sectors
▶ **Affiliation**	United Americas, Alphatech Corp.
▶ **Classification**	Aquatic planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, tropical to cool, clear skies, some gales and tsunamis
▶ **Temperature**	27°C
▶ **Terrain**	Shallow seas
▶ **Colonies**	Two, Bracken's World and the Joliet Moon Mining Facility
▶ **Population**	200
▶ **Key Resources**	Kelp, fish, and byproducts

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Gliese 326-3827 System

Gliese 326-3827b (Bracken's World): An aqua-culture colony world, Bracken's World is covered with shallow seas and a small population of kelp farmers and their support facilities. It has abundant marine life, including large achelate crustaceans. Alphatech maintains an outpost among the kelp bed farms on this world and a mining facility on its moon.

8 Eta Boötis System

A binary system of twelve planets, 8 Eta Boötis is very close to Arcturus and is part of the Arcturus Loop. The system's resources and location a mere three parsecs from the UPP/UA border has made it the victim of many armed conflicts throughout the 2100s, culminating in the Tientsin Campaign of the 2160s.

8 ETA BOÖTIS A III (TIENTSIN COLONY)

▶ **Location**	Outer Rim, UPP/American Arm border, Borodino Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	Independent
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, hot and humid, rainstorms
▶ **Temperature**	31°C
▶ **Terrain**	Island chains with dense jungles, wetlands, and deep alkaline seas
▶ **Colonies**	Tientsin Colony, several small independent groupings
▶ **Population**	500,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Bauxite, chromate, promethium, yttrium, manganese, gold

"Alright, sweethearts. What are you waiting for? Breakfast in bed? Another glorious day in the Corps. A day in the Marine Corps is like a day on the farm... every meal's a banquet, every paycheck a fortune, every formation a parade. I LOVE the Corps!"

MSgt Apone

8 Eta Boötis A III (Tientsin Colony): An independent colony, 8 Eta Boötis A III is situated on the border between the UPP and the United Americas. When the UPP supported a government coup two decades ago, the UA sent in the Colonial Marines to support the old regime. Caught in the crossfire, many colonists took up arms to defend themselves from both opposing forces, splitting the main island of Tientsin into several warring factions. The conflict itself was never truly resolved, with the UA and the UPP eventually pulling their forces out and allowing the colonists to fend for themselves. Without support from either side, the colony dissolved into chaos. Nuclear strikes decimated the planet's resource-rich archipelagos, making mining operations difficult. In recent years, Weyland-Yutani offered humanitarian aid to the Tientsin Colony in the form of older model atmospheric processors, but their offer was rejected by the current government. Many senior officers in the Colonial Marines served during the Tientsin Campaign. ▶

Crestus Prime Cluster Garrison Systems

Major military shipyards, service bases, and staging areas, these UAAC Outer Rim installations are off-limits to any unauthorized visitors. While these systems themselves do not contain civilian or corporate colonies, there are colonial facilities for career military personnel and their families. These systems are fortified with deep space sensor arrays and patrolled by system defense frigates.

Located in the American Arm of the Outer Rim and close to the Borodino Frontier, the Crestus Garrison Systems are spread out across the star cluster and labeled Prime, Alpha, Beta, Gamma and Delta. Forces from the Outer Rim Defense Fleet, Canadian Colonial Armed Forces, the Latin American Colonial Navy, and the United States Aero Space Force and Colonial Marine Corps are stationed here at the ready. These systems also house top secret military and science facilities.

While the Crestus Garrisons support the combined UAAC forces, other institutions devoted to a single military force exist as well. For example, USCMC bases throughout the Core, Outer Veil and Outer Rim include Orbital Fort Nebraska, Surier 430, Georgia 525, and Third Base, as well as Camp Pendleton on Earth. The Outer Rim Defense Fleet maintains its own service station at Liberty Echo.

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Tartarus Sector

IF BORODINO SECTOR is on the brink, Tartarus is chaos off the hook. Largely ignored during early expansion efforts, this sector has vast areas that have not been developed by any single governing body or corporation. Instead, any enterprise – large or small – can lay claim to a find there. Other parts of the sector have been engulfed by both the Anglo-Japanese and American arms. Ready for conflict, the Outer Rim Defense Fleet operates out of base Liberty Echo in this sector. The least civilized and least explored area of the Outer Rim, Tartarus is rife with rebellion, open warfare and stellar anomalies. The cutting edge of the Frontier runs right through Tartarus.

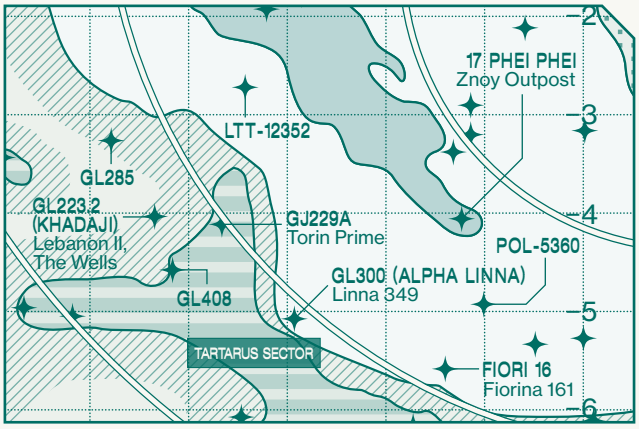
Note From MU/TH/UR: The Tartarus Sector is well-suited for a campaign game and is described in more detail in chapter 11.

GJ229A System

Torin Prime: Although it was nearly eight decades ago, Torin Prime has never really recovered from its failed succession attempt from the United Americas (page 164). Sanctions keep the colony from thriving like it used to. The local government is prohibited from arming itself, relying instead on direct protection from the UAAC. To the locals, it feels like they are living in a police state. Intelligence reports suggest the J'Har rebel faction is on the rise again, organizing and growing in strength as they plan a coup, this time not just for Torin Prime, but for the entire Tartarus Sector. UA intelligence believes this new revolt will be quietly backed by the UPP, and the Liberty Echo Fleet is preparing to respond accordingly.

GJ229A: TORIN PRIME

▶ **Location**	Outer Rim, Tartarus Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	United Americas
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, semi-arid, rainy summers and dry winters
▶ **Temperature**	18 °C
▶ **Terrain**	Mountainous glades and high peaks
▶ **Colonies**	Three
▶ **Population**	700,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Chromium, titanium, osmium, palladium, iridium, heavy metals



GL300 System

Linna 349: A member planet of the Three World Empire, Linna 349 is a forested world with two major colonies and a developed highway system. Years ago, a rebel faction revolted and attempted to take over the planet's government. Without the resources on the Outer Rim to handle the threat, the Three World Empire requested assistance from the United Americas Allied Command. Eager to help in exchange for new tariff and export treaties, the United Americas sent in the marines. Because the Colonial Marines considered the rebel raids little more than a nuisance, the rebelling colonists were nicknamed "Bug-Boys."

The situation changed when the Bug-Boys started using sophisticated weapons from an unidentified source – either a corporate or political enemy of the Three World Empire – and managed to cripple the USCMC frigate USS Sulaco with an orbital strike. The USCMC retaliated in kind, bringing in ships, marines, heavy equipment and tanks to retake the planet. The Bug-Boys were squashed, and the USCMC has maintained an occupying peace force on Linna 349 ever since, despite requests from the Three World Empire to release the world. Linna's major export is the exceptional timber produced from its native thorny Karyta trees. ●

GL300: LINNA 349

▶ **Location**	Outer Rim, Anglo-Japanese Arm, Tartarus Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	Three World Empire, UA occupying peace force in presence.
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, humid and wet
▶ **Temperature**	30 °C
▶ **Terrain**	Forests and lakes
▶ **Colonies**	Two official plus nomad tribes
▶ **Population**	30,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Timber, lanthanum, lutetium, and other rare earth metals

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THE FRONTIER

THE FRONTIER IS THE FARTHEST known area of space within any territory – and it's where you are most likely to be spending your time trying to build a life and make a buck. While the Outer Rim might be beyond the Outer Veil, the void is vast, and the Frontier cuts through the Outer Veil and Outer Rim before moving on into the unknown depths of space.

Sectors which touch upon the Frontier include Tartarus, Bao Sau, and Sector 87. As such, some planets and systems on the Frontier are also located within those areas. Frontier stations such as Anchorpoint act as a neutral zone for all corporations and governments. Backwater colonies like Bowen's Landing, LV-492, and LV-422 lie on the Frontier along the Far Reach of the American Arm – an area of UA aggressive expansion that extends well past the Outer Rim.

While part of the United Americas and protected by the Outer Rim Defense Fleet, mining and shipping hubs like Thedus and the Solomons are open to all entrepreneurs and pioneers. There are well-established star lanes to and from these distant worlds, but the space those routes cross through is between Frontier zones and therefore uncharted, unexplored, and dangerous. It's always recommended that ships stay at FTL speeds in these sectors.

Gamma Leporis System

Each of the trinary stars of Gamma Leporis has one world within its habitable zone, and all three were at one time colonized. Only one of those colonies has thrived. Dubbed Terraform 3, the planet listed below is actually the third attempt to terraform a planet in the Gamma Leporis system.

The first, orbiting Gamma Leporis B, ended in catastrophic failure when an asteroid collided with the planet. The second is more confusing. Contact was lost with the



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Seegson sponsored terraforming colony orbiting Gamma Leporis C in 2175. When the company went to investigate, they found that all the colonists had simply disappeared without a trace. The colony itself was undisturbed, save for the fact that the atmospheric processor had been shut down. The planet is generally avoided and whatever happened remains a mystery to this day.

Finally, the Gamma Leporis system is one of many locations of mysterious "ghost ship" sightings of the lost USCMC Conestoga-class troop transport the Sulaco. Following the Hadley's Hope incident, the ship ejected her EEV modules in the vicinity of the Neroid Sector and disappeared.

Gamma Leporis A3: "Terraform 3" feeds the Frontier and boasts the best steaks in the galaxy. A thriving bovine reserve, the terraformed farmlands of Terraform 3 supply the Frontier with fresh meat and meat byproducts. The planet suffers from severe dust storms every winter, during which free-range farms take their herds underground. While Weyland-Yutani has little interest in the world anymore, their atmospheric processor still maintains the planet's climate. More and more of Steer City's cattle farming is being industrialized as corporations like Lasalle Bionational buy up vast tracts of land and set up automated meat processing plants.

Khadaji System

The mineral rich Khadaji system was initially claimed and settled by the Three World Empire in the 2120s, but it was annexed to the United Americas thirty years later.

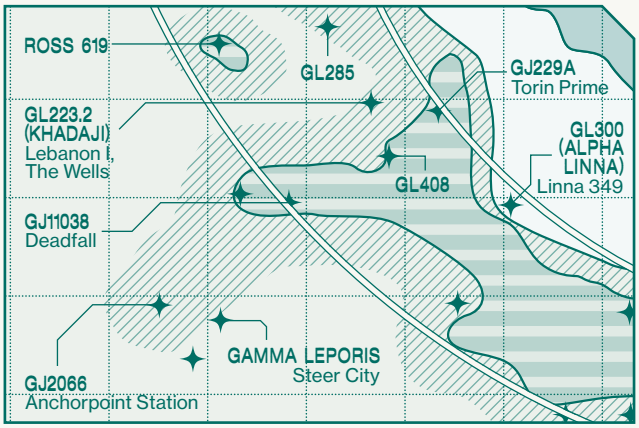
KJ-331b Lebanon II: In orbit around the ringed gas giant KJ-331, Lebanon II is a moon on the brink of a revolution. Decades of shifting governmental allegiances haven't helped the Wells colony prosper, but instead have helped line the pockets of many corporate execs. The Wells lies directly over a massive natural spring that produces fresh water with naturally occurring electrolytes – making it a favorite of the elite and sought after in the Inner Core Systems.

Contracts with several corporate concerns see that the moon is heavily mined for its water, iron, and uranium reserves which are sold at a premium while the colonists are forced to live in squalor. As petitions for better living standards have been ignored by the greater United American government, a small South American state has seen the plight of the Wells colony as a means to gain more power in the UA. As such, they have begun encouraging the rebels to sabotage supply lines while making demands for better wages and supplies. With the rebels growing bolder, it's only a matter of time before the Colonial Marines are called in. ▶

"Does the company know?"

"The company knows everything that happened on the ship."

Lt. Ellen Ripley and Bishop



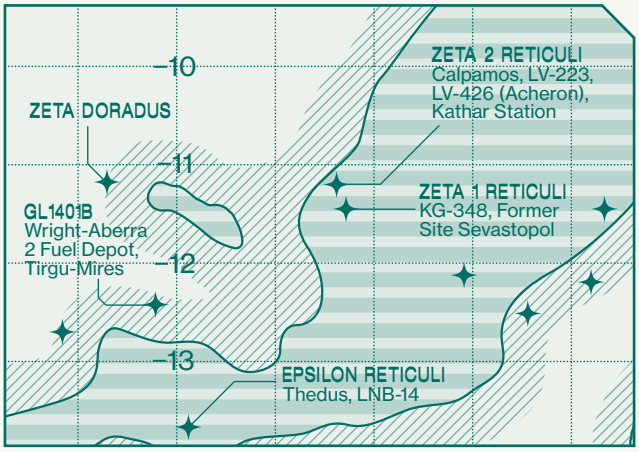
GAMMA LEPORIS A3 "TERRAFORM 3"

▶ **Location**	The Frontier, American Arm, edge of Tartarus Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	United Americas, Lasalle Bionational
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, terraformed
▶ **Temperature**	25°C
▶ **Terrain**	Grazing pastures, lakes and farmland
▶ **Colonies**	Steer City
▶ **Population**	9,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Agriculture

KHADAJI: KJ-331B LEBANON II

▶ **Location**	Frontier, Outer Rim, edge of Tartarus Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	United Americas, Lasalle Bionational, Weyland-Yutani
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial moon
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, hot dry summers, rainy winters
▶ **Temperature**	28°C
▶ **Terrain**	A network of rivers, springs and ravines crisscrossing a barren rocky plain
▶ **Colonies**	The Wells
▶ **Population**	40,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Spring water, iron, uranium

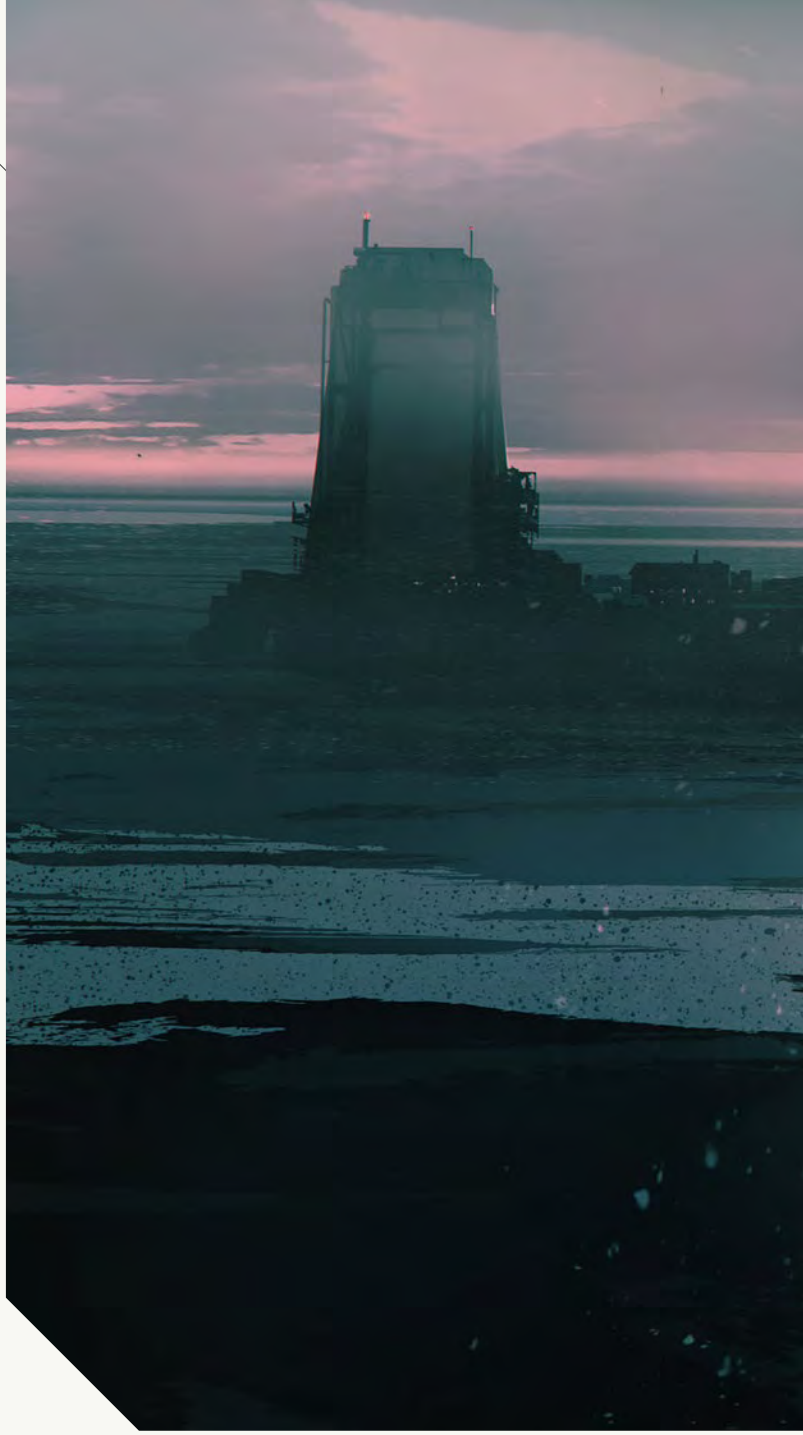
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Zeta Reticuli System

A wide binary star system on the cusp of the Tartarus Sector and in the southern constellation of Reticulum, Zeta Reticuli lay beyond the boundaries of known space just four decades ago. Since then, the United American Frontier has expanded to engulf the binary stars, claiming them as part of the American Arm. Sadly, the Zeta Reticuli system has been a reoccurring site of tragedy and misfortune. It is here that humanity had its first recorded encounters with both Chemical A0-3959X.91-15 and Xenomorph XX121, losing several starships and two colonies in the process.

KG-348 (Zeta¹ Reticuli): The former site of Sevastopol Station, KG-348 is a gas giant orbiting the star Zeta¹ Reticuli. KG-348 has a rare atmosphere that is rich in metallic gases and has long been considered as a site for an atmospheric mining operation. The Seegson Corporation ran Sevastopol Station until it suffered a catastrophic accident in the 2130s, fell into a decaying orbit around the planet and burned up in the atmosphere. While Seegson still maintains mining rights to the planet, they have yet to exploit them, and independent pirate mining operations are rumored to be taking place there.



KG-348 (ZETA¹ RETICULI)

▶ **Location**	Frontier, American Arm, edge of Tartarus Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	United Americas, Seegson
▶ **Classification**	Jovian gas giant
▶ **Climate**	Frigid molecular hydrogen atmosphere
▶ **Temperature**	−145 °C
▶ **Colonies**	Formerly the site of Sevastopol Station
▶ **Population**	–
▶ **Key Resources**	Helium 3, rare metallic gases detected

CALPAMOS (ZETA² RETICULI)

▶ **Location**	Frontier, edge of Tartarus Sector, Zeta Reticuli system
▶ **Affiliation**	Weyland-Yutani, United Americas
▶ **Classification**	Ringed gas giant
▶ **Climate**	Frigid ammonia atmosphere
▶ **Temperature**	−173 °C
▶ **Colonies**	–
▶ **Population**	–
▶ **Key Resources**	Unexamined

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Calpamos (Zeta² Reticuli): A large, ringed, and ruddy brown gas giant, Calpamos is the fourth planet in orbit around Zeta² Reticuli. The planet itself is unremarkable, and it is best known for the tragic rumors surrounding incidents that supposedly occurred within its system of moons.

LV-223 (Zeta² Reticuli): Orbiting Calpamos, LV-223 is a desolate, near Earth-like moon with sprawling deserts and mountainous valleys. Unfortunately, its atmosphere contains a deadly concentration of carbon dioxide, making it unbreathable by humans, and the moon is prone to deadly and swift-forming silica storms. The little data there is on LV-223 is compiled from garbled transmissions sent back to Weyland Corp Headquarters by the USCSS Prometheus mission in the 2090s. Various rumors claim it to be the site of a starship graveyard, a plague-ridden world covered in strange and ancient extraterrestrial ruins, and the home of several deadly species of fauna. Regardless, starship crews steer clear of LV-223 in search of brighter skies and greener pastures.

LV-426 "Acheron" (Zeta² Reticuli): With a rotation period of two hours and a gravity of 0.86 Earth Standard, the moon called LV-426 is a barren and inhospitable rock in space. Daytime is a perpetual twilight, and nighttime is cold and dark. Cataloged by a French deep space probe in the 2040s, the moon remained unexplored for the next century. In 2122, the USCSS Nostromo touched down on ▶

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LV-223 (ZETA² RETICULI)

▶ **Location**	Frontier, edge of Tartarus Sector, orbiting Calpamos
▶ **Affiliation**	Unclaimed, United Americas
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial moon
▶ **Climate**	Violent silica storms and poisonous atmosphere, with breathable atmosphere in the temple valley region only
▶ **Temperature**	12°C
▶ **Terrain**	Deserts, giant mountains, deep valleys, lush vegetation in the temple valley region only
▶ **Colonies**	–
▶ **Population**	Unknown
▶ **Key Resources**	Unexplored

LV-426 in response to an unknown distress call, allegedly encountering a hostile alien life form that eventually led to the ship's destruction at the hands of one of the crew. However, when the moon was extensively surveyed in the 2130s, it was discovered that it had no indigenous life, calling the Nostromo rumors into question.

LV-426 is perhaps best known as the site of the doomed colony Hadley's Hope. Thirty-five years after the Nostromo incident, Weyland-Yutani and the Colonial Administration set up an atmospheric processor on the swiftly turning moon and began terraforming procedures. The moon was renamed Acheron by its early settlers, and Hadley's Hope endured there for more than twenty years. The colony stopped transmitting reports in July of 2179, prompting a visit by a contingent of colonial marines. Whatever transpired next led to the nuclear annihilation

RUMOR CONTROL LV-223

IN SEARCH OF BOTH IMMORTALITY and humanity's origins, the SEV spacecraft the USCSS Prometheus set down on LV-223 at the end of the 21st Century on a mission led by Weyland CEO Meredith Vickers, Drs. Elizabeth Shaw and Charlie Holloway, and company founder Peter Weyland himself. Here, the expedition discovered a series of temples built by an alien race that Dr. Shaw referred to as "the Engineers." Investigating the nearest structure, the crew found evidence of a toxic outbreak that wiped out the Engineer outpost. That toxin was Chemical A0-3959X.91–15, a viscous black fluid that acts as an evolutionary accelerant on any biological host it contaminates.

Through a series of tragic events, some of the crew became infected with the accelerant, resulting in many deaths. A lone Engineer awoken from cryosleep killed Peter Weyland and most of the remainder of the crew. As the Engineer attempted to launch one of its species' Juggernaut spacecraft on a mission to wipe out humanity, Captain Janek of the Prometheus ignited the SEV's ion drive in the atmosphere and rammed the alien vessel. The Prometheus was obliterated and the Juggernaut crippled. Only Dr. Shaw and the mission's synthetic, David 8, survived, escaping LV-223 in another Engineer Juggernaut and heading towards the ubiquitous Planet 4 in Sector 87.

Much of what was there when the USCSS Prometheus was destroyed remains on LV-223 nearly one hundred years later. Contaminated by the released accelerant, however, the planet has undergone a metamorphosis in the valley where the damaged Juggernaut crashed. A lush jungle has taken root, producing a breathable atmosphere for those that stay in the area. Abhorrent mutated creatures inhabit the jungle zone, and a strange biomechanical structure has grown there – a living mountain that the moon's fauna is wary to approach.

The Engineer temples and Juggernaut hangers beneath them are still intact, as is a vast supply of Engineer ampules filled with Chemical A0-3959X.91–15. Its power cells long dead, the Prometheus' lifeboat still lies on the surface, as does a surprise: the Class 7 Excavator Vessel known as the Onager. A short-range orbital craft assigned to Hadley's Hope, the ship was used by a group of colonists from Acheron to escape the alien infestation of their colony and make an emergency landing here. Unfortunately, they brought several Plagiarus praepotens with them, and the Xenomorph species turned the Onager into a makeshift hive. The colonists are believed dead. Just like all other biological life, the Xenomorphs have proven to be susceptible to the accelerant as well – resulting in bizarre mutations amongst the hive.

Note From MU/TH/UR: Evolution out of control, the situation on LV-223 is insanely dangerous. Anyone visiting this moon is not likely to survive. Steer clear.

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of the colony and the death of both the colonial marine unit and all 158 colonists. What caused the destruction is uncertain – conflicting reports range from an attack by a rival government or unknown alien species to a simple reactor accident and meltdown. All that remains is a radioactive wasteland stretching over 700 km.

Soon after the incident, both Weyland-Yutani and the Colonial Marines sent search and rescue teams to Acheron in the hopes of finding survivors. While the colony and the atmospheric processor were vaporized, it was theoretically possible that any colonists who made it as far as the Ilium Range would be protected from the blast by the mountains there. The company set up a relief station in orbit, but no survivors were ever found. Called Kathar Station, it is now a minor research platform maintained by a custodial staff. ▶

LV-426 "ACHERON" (ZETA² RETICULI)

▶ **Location**	Frontier, American Arm, near Tartarus Sector
▶ **Affiliation**	Weyland-Yutani, United Americas
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial moon
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, partially terraformed, high velocity wind storms
▶ **Temperature**	10 °C
▶ **Terrain**	Barren lava rock, mountains
▶ **Colonies**	Kathar Station in orbit, former site of Hadley's Hope
▶ **Population**	Unknown
▶ **Key Resources**	None identified

RUMOR CONTROL ACHERON

RESPONDING TO WHAT APPEARED to be a distress call in 2122, the Nostromo altered course and landed on LV-426. Her crew soon located a derelict Engineer Juggernaut with a cargo bay full of alien eggs. Ship's first officer Kane was subsequently attacked by a Facehugger and impregnated with a Plagiarus praepotens embryo which, when fully formed, began stalking the crew. With no Queen present, the alien initiated the ovomorphing transformation on Captain Dallas and technician Brett, converting their bodies into viable alien eggs. Third officer Ellen Ripley set the ship to self-destruct and escaped on the shuttlecraft Narcissus, blowing the creature out of the airlock and blasting it with a burst from the shuttle's engines.

In 2137, Captain Marlow of the deep space salvage vessel Anesidora also traced the signal back to the derelict and shut it down – but not before his wife was impregnated by a Facehugger.

Decades passed. The derelict all but forgotten, the colony of Hadley's Hope was established on LV-426. When the current Weyland-Yutani administration learned of the crashed Juggernaut, the colonists were sent out to find it without being told what it was. It wasn't long before the entire colony was overrun by the aliens and the atmospheric processor converted into a hive.

A colonial marine unit sent to investigate was ambushed by an army of Xenomorph XX121s in the colony's atmospheric processor. During the ensuing battle the plant's reactor was damaged, resulting in a nuclear meltdown. Only Corporal Dwayne Hicks, colonist Rebecca "Newt" Jorden, mission consultant Lt. Ellen Ripley, and the unit's android, Bishop, survived. The hive's Queen escaped the destruction by hitching a ride in the landing gear of the marines' dropship and was finally killed by Ripley on board the Sulaco.

Weyland-Yutani has made quick work of covering the incident up as they search for viable alien eggs – even going so far as to start the rumors that Hadley's Hope was actually nuked by an unidentified military force – possibly the UPP – or even a rogue colonial marine team.

Kathar Station was placed in orbit to monitor LV-426 and collect any alien material that might have survived the nuclear detonation there. It is possible that the Engineer's derelict was not completely destroyed in the explosion – as the natural ore in the Ilium Range could have shielded it – although the wreck was already damaged by earthquakes and lava flows by the time the Jorden family located it in July 2179. Even if it is undetectable, the Juggernaut might have been swallowed by a chasm created by the blast and buried under an avalanche. Exactly what happened and what Kathar is doing in orbit years later is unknown.

Note From MU/TH/UR: While other sources have indicated that the Derelict did in fact survive, the validity of those works as canon has come into question. It's up to you to decide what works best for your campaign.

Licensed System (Order: 53151103)



The Far Reach

Alpha Caeli System

The Solomons (Alpha Caeli V b–h): Seven colonized moons (labeled b through h) out of the eight that orbit the gas giant Alpha Caeli V, the Solomons are rich in mineral resources and a primary source of the ores necessary for space travel. Several mining colonies are located there, as well as a Colonial Marine garrison on the moon Alpha Caeli V g. The moons boast the largest orbital solar array network conceived by man.

For several decades the Solomons represented the farthest recorded reach of humanity into the unknown. Many early expeditions exploring beyond Alpha Caeli were lost, prompting some scientists to suggest that radiation zones further out into deep space are deadly to humans. In the past twenty years the UA has pushed Rimward through this haze and begun establishing colonies there.

THE SOLOMONS (ALPHA CAELI V B-H)

▶ **Location**	Frontier, Far Reach of the American Arm, Orbiting Alpha Caeli V
▶ **Affiliation**	Corporate-owned interests, United Americas
▶ **Classification**	One Jovian gas giant with a system of eight moons
▶ **Climate**	Varies from climate-controlled pressure domes to cold terraformed atmospheres
▶ **Temperature**	Varies
▶ **Colonies**	Numerous, including USCMC garrisons
▶ **Population**	3,000,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Niobium, neodymium, chromium, helium-3, hematite, and platinum

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Alpheios System

The Alpheios system is located 65 light years from Earth, in the Far Reach of the American Arm, beyond the Solomons. It is one of a string of remote star systems that space truckers have nicknamed the "Pearl Necklace." The system contains two gas giants and an assortment of ice ball worlds and orbiting rocks. The only world of note is the ringed planet LV-410.

LV-410 (Jackson's Star): LV-410 is a Mars-sized planet with its own ring system and a dense but breathable atmosphere. It is thought that several million years ago, a collision occurred with another planet and that the ring system was created from the debris of that impact. The volcanism on the world's surface, as well as the high concentration of siderophile minerals found there can be attributed to this planet-wrenching cataclysm.

The ring system is composed mainly of fine-grained rocky debris, dangerous to spacecraft. Indeed, in 2142, Renaissance Station, a Weyland-Yutani research base, was destroyed when it impacted the rings, drifting out of its normal orbit for reasons unknown. ▶

ALPHEIOS: LV-410 "JACKSON'S STAR"

▶ **Location**	Frontier, within the Far Reach of the American Arm
▶ **Affiliation**	Weyland-Yutani, United Americas
▶ **Classification**	Ringed terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Dense atmosphere, with a perpetually unbroken overcast sky, preventing sunlight from reaching the surface; breathable with some traces of airborne microorganisms
▶ **Temperature**	15 °C
▶ **Terrain**	Mountains, lava plains and rocky wilderness, extensive active vulcanization across parts of the planet's surface
▶ **Colonies**	Jackson's Star and a small UA science outpost
▶ **Population**	9,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Platinum, iron, rhodium, iridium, rhenium

Prometheus System (Order: 5315 1103)



Epsilon Reticuli System

Thedus: Located outside the Outer Rim, Thedus was originally mistaken for a small gas giant due to its thick and cloudy atmosphere. Instead, it turned out to be a large terrestrial world with heavy metal deposits. The planet is rich in natural ores, a fact that Weyland-Yutani has taken advantage of for more than a century via extensive mining operations. Vast sections of the planet's surface have been strip-mined, leaving behind huge gouges and deep canyon trenches. Much of the material exported from the far Frontier is routed through either Thedus or Anchorpoint Station before heading to the Outer Veil and Core Systems.

EPSILON RETICULI: THEDUS

▶ **Location**	Frontier, Far Reach of the American Arm
▶ **Affiliation**	Weyland-Yutani, Three World Empire, United Americas
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Cold, thin atmosphere, terraformed
▶ **Temperature**	8°C
▶ **Terrain**	Mountains and canyons
▶ **Colonies**	Three
▶ **Population**	2,000,000
▶ **Key Resources**	Yttrium, niobium, helium-3, other rare earth metals

"The pit is completely enclosed. And it's full of leathery objects, like eggs or something."

XO Kane

Due to a severe environmental accident in 2109, parts of the planet were rendered uninhabitable for many decades. A miners' revolt over poor living conditions led to the troop carrier UAS Archangel being deployed to the planet to keep the peace. Through a series of classified events, the Archangel crashed, destroying one of the planet's atmospheric processors and causing the deaths of over 15,000 civilians and marines. As of the 2180s, renewed terraforming has repaired much of the planetary damage, but Thedus' atmosphere is still cold.

Thedus was the last port of call for commercial towing vehicle Nostromo before she went missing in 2122.

Tanaka System

The Tanaka system has six worlds, four of which are so close to the system's blue star that they are little more than burning lumps of slag in space. The sixth planet – a frigid ball of methane – is so far removed from the Tanaka star that on the first pass through surveyors didn't even notice it. The fifth planet lies barely within the star's habitable zone and is detailed below.

Planetary System (Order: 53.15.1103)

TANAKA 5

▶ **Location**	Frontier, near the Far Reach of the American Arm
▶ **Affiliation**	Unaffiliated
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, arid, hot days and cool nights, frequent sandstorms
▶ **Temperature**	45 °C
▶ **Terrain**	Sprawling deserts and canyons
▶ **Colonies**	–
▶ **Population**	Four dozen transients
▶ **Key Resources**	Vaccines, possibly metals

Tanaka 5: An arid desert planet prone to deadly sandstorms, Tanaka 5 was surveyed briefly in the 2170s and determined to be a likely resource for thulium, terbium, gold and manganese. This report has yet to be confirmed, but that hasn't stopped some prospectors from scouting the world and setting up temporary settlements. A 2–3-meter-long scorpion-like creature has been found to be indigenous to the planet, which has been both a curse and a blessing. While highly aggressive, the lifeform's neurotoxin has proven to be a counteracting agent for several ailments – making the planet a resource for medicinal needs. There is also talk of strange ruins amongst the underground springs beneath the deserts, but these reports have not been substantiated.

Sector 117

A REMOTE AREA OF SPACE that remains unsettled. In the early to mid-2100s, many colonization missions were launched towards this region of space and never heard from again. Beyond the Frontier, this far out in space truly represents the unknown.

Achilles System

A binary system not included on any commercial star maps, the two stars of the Achilles System hide a planet best left undiscovered.

G-435 (Achilles 2.4): A Xenomorph XX121 hive world, G-435 is overrun with the creatures. Covered in deserts and warm, brackish shallow seas, the terrain on G-435 is mostly flat, save for the alien hive complexes grown there. The steamy nightmare planet is caught in a constant state of dusk. It is home to several indigenous life forms that play host to Plagiarus praepotens, including an avian reptile species. There is little in the form of elevated terrain here, save for the massive alien hive structures that dominate the landscape. ●

G-435 (ACHILLES 2.4)

▶ **Location**	Sector 117, orbiting Achilles 2
▶ **Affiliation**	Unclaimed
▶ **Classification**	Planet
▶ **Climate**	Breathable atmosphere, hot and humid, perpetual twilight
▶ **Temperature**	40 °C
▶ **Terrain**	Wasteland, shallow swamps and salty seas, minimal vegetation
▶ **Colonies**	Dozens of alien hive colonies
▶ **Population**	Unknown
▶ **Key Resources**	Plagiarus praepotens

RUMOR CONTROL **G-435**

IF SPACE IS HELL, THIS PLANET IS WORSE. G-435 is the closest to a home world one is likely to find for P. praepotens. While they aren't from here, they definitely made it their own. Whether they arrived via intentional seeding, an experiment gone amuck, or just by way of a crashed starship, the aliens here are stronger and quicker than those found off-world. There are new adaptations of P. praepotens present on G-435 that exist nowhere else, including an immense Empress mother alien and her entourage of attendants and protectors. Each hive colony here has its own Queen, and order is maintained as long as the Empress lives. Remove her from the equation and the various hives go to war with each other, each Queen striving to dominate and become the new Empress.

Different colonies of P. praepotens here have exoskeletons of varying hues. Because it is uncertain what spectrum – if any – the alien sees in, the color change may seem arbitrary. However, it is theorized that the color shift is a byproduct of chemical pheromones released in the presence of other hives. This allows a Queen and her minions to know if an approaching warrior is a servant or an invader.

In order to breed, P. praepotens requires hosts. Luckily, at least for them, a number of mammal and reptile species exist on G-435. These creatures are cunning, able to keep themselves one step ahead of an eventual extinction caused by Xenomorph XX121.

Note From MU/TH/UR: Danger! Avoid at all costs. Chances of survival are negligible for any non-native lifeforms. Repeat. Avoid at all costs.

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

CHAPTER 10

ALIEN SPECIES

"The Titan Prometheus wanted to give mankind equal footing with the gods – for that he was cast from Olympus. Well, my friends, the time has finally come for his return."

Peter Weyland

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

HUMANS ARE ARROGANT sons of bitches. We leaped into space thinking we'd make it our own. Sure, some of us believed – hoped even – that we'd find other life along the way, but we were absolutely certain we'd always be at the top of the food chain. Our gods were dead, and we were the new gods.

Well, that all turned out to be far from true. Our gods may or may not be gone, but they definitely left us a few nasty surprises to humble us – living things that not only go bump in the night but also eat you from the inside out. There is life out here, and it wants us all dead. Here's a little sampling of what you can expect to find lurking in the dark.

THE ENGINEERS

THE RUINS OF THEIR MASSIVE necropoli and pyramidal structures are spread across the stars. The sophistication of their fossilized biotechnology mystifies explorers while their megalithic stone statues and busts bear testament to their artistic and architectural superiority. But who are they? If the company has its way, you'll never find out.

Hieroglyphic tablets unearthed on Tanaka 5 call them Ossians. The decoded derelict beacon on LV-426 made reference to the Mala'kak. Whatever they call themselves, to modern humans they are known simply as the Engineers.

Dr. Elizabeth Shaw coined the term when she and Dr. Charles Holloway discovered pictograms on many of Earth's continents depicting giant beings pointing towards the stars. Believing the beings to have engineered humanity, she dubbed them accordingly. That star configuration turned out to be a star map which led the Prometheus mission to a distant moon and the ruins of an Engineer outpost. Whatever they found there was erased from the archives, the destination of the Prometheus was classified and all but forgotten – but stray transmissions picked up by company satellites confirmed the existence of the beings.

Over the decades, covert corporate scientists have made attempts to classify them. Those with religious leanings have likened them to the Nephilim – fallen angels cast out of heaven for meddling with – or in this case creating – humanity. As the first remains of their kind were discovered at the helms of their dead ships, some have labeled them Mundus gubernavi, or "universal pilot." Like the misnomer Internecivus raptus – "murderous thief" – that is sometimes associated with Xenomorph XX121, the classification, in and of itself, is incorrect. There is no "pilot" genus to draw upon.

The late Dr. Shaw's scientific notes that were recovered in a garbled signal sent after the loss of the Prometheus provide the most shocking revelation about these Engineers – their DNA is human. They predate us, they are us, and we come from them. The re-discovery of Shaw's notes has led to a more scientific name for these giants – Homo genitor, or "creator of man."

The little more that is known about them has been gleaned from several extrasolar archaeological digs discovered within the past three years as the Frontier has advanced into the unknown. No living Engineers are known to exist – and the few xeno-anthropologists aware of them believe they died out thousands of years ago. Their passing is marked by their abandoned citadels, derelict ships, and their biogenetic and evolutionary experiments. What is also clear from Dr. Shaw's transmissions is that even though they created humanity, at some point millennia ago they decided to undo their creation – attempting to wipe out the Earth and start again.

Physical Traits

The Engineers were colossal beings. While some fossilized evidence places them at as much as 4.5 meters tall, most agree that they averaged 2.7 meters in height. On first appearance their bodies seem biomechanical in nature with a bulbous, trunked head. This is in fact a removable living pressure suit that melds with the Engineer's body, with the "head" actually being a helmet of some type. These living suits and helmets have only been found dead – ossified and fossilized over millennia of disuse.

Conjectural Analysis

Some theories suggest there are different breeds or castes of Engineers with physical alternatives bred into them – thereby differentiating civilian and militant factions. Others have postulated that not all the crumbling edifices unearthed on the Frontier are those of the Engineers, but that some belong to other species seeded by or cross-bred with them.

If that is the case, then these civilizations have likewise died out. And pointing to the enormous, fossilized remains of the so-called "Space Jockey" specimen reportedly witnessed by two starfreighter crews and colonists from Hadley's Hope, some xeno-anthropologists suggest the Engineers based their biomechanical technology on creatures greater than themselves – strange beings of immense size replete with pachydermic probosci. However, since the specimen in question was unfortunately destroyed and there are no Engineers around to ask, all of this is merely hearsay and conjecture.

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"A superior species, no doubt."

David 8

Underneath their strange garb, the Engineers are statuesque. They have hairless, chiseled physiques with translucent blue-white skin, heavy brows, high noses, and large, glassy black eyes. They are both beautiful and powerful in appearance. While they were once believed to be all male, there is now evidence to suggest that female Engineers exist as well. Dr. Shaw theorized that the females operated in a leadership capacity while the males assumed soldier, artisan, and philosopher roles, but there is no evidence to support this. Females are equally hairless and just as dangerous.

Architecture

Engineer architecture is on a grand scale, with monolithic stone citadels, impressive arches and massive domes. Most Engineer installations will have at least one giant stone head. It is believed these heads are meant to represent one of six elders of their civilization – intellectuals, artists, and wise men. Their culture appears to be steeped in both the sciences and the arts. In addition to their biotechnological wonders, beautifully painted murals and bas reliefs of bizarre alien creatures adorn the walls of their innermost sanctums. ▶

ACCELERATED EVOLUTION: AGENT A0-3959X.91-15

A genetic accelerant created by an ancient race of alien Engineers, Agent A0-3959X.91-15 is a black, tar-like substance with both destructive and life-generating capabilities. While it exists in a viscous liquid form, it atomizes when released in the atmosphere, killing or altering all living things unlucky enough to be within range. While the full extent of its potential is unknown, any corporation that finds out about it wants it.

The only thing known for certain about Agent A0-3959X.91-15 and its derivatives is that its mutagenic capabilities are responsible for the creation of Abominations, Neomorphs, and other abhorrent creatures. Simply put: any living thing that comes into direct contact with the black goo will either die horribly, give birth to monsters, or become a monster themselves. Tread lightly and look underfoot for alien spores.



Prometheus Synch (Order: 53.15.1103)



While not yet understood, their computer interfaces work on a combination of musical initiation plus the manipulation of depressible hieroglyphic symbols and rubbery, egg-shaped control nodules. There is evidence of terraforming at many of their sites, via a method that company scientists so far cannot explain. Vast underground hangars are hypothesized to hold the remains of their star-faring Juggernauts, although all such hangers discovered thus far have been vacant.

"We call them Engineers."
"Engineers? Do you mind telling us what they engineered?"
"They engineered us."

Elizabeth Shaw and Sean Fifield

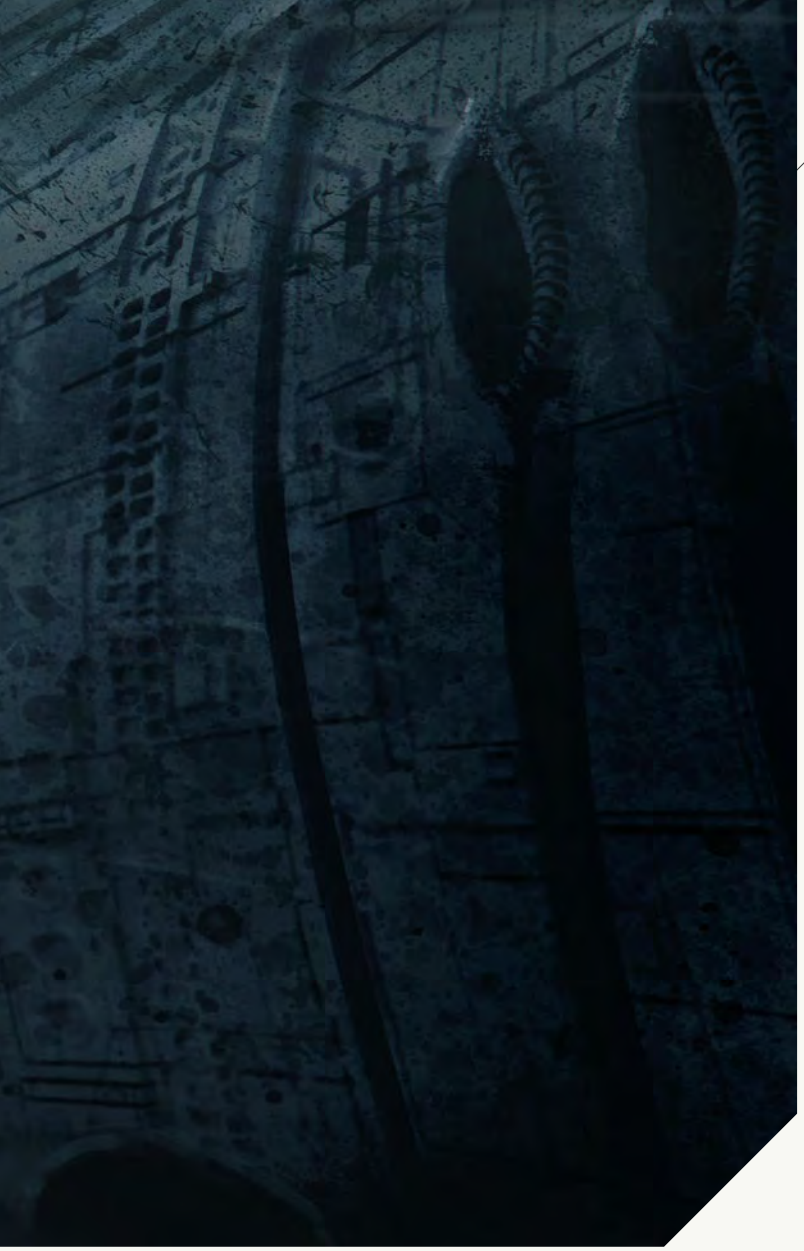
Technology

Engineer Flute: Music is the crux of Engineer society. It has been hypothesized that they can see melodies as colors, shapes, and words. As such, music is key to operating most of their technology. Different flutes function as keys to unlock different doors and technology, and playing different tones on these flutes will trigger different functions, such as turning on the lights, starting a Juggernaut, plotting a navigational course, or even unlocking a biosuit.

An android or human possessing a particular talent for music could conceivably learn to whistle the appropriate tones to activate and operate Engineer technology, but it is an exceedingly difficult skill to master.

Engineer Biosuit: It has been theorized that these pressure suits increase the wearer's strength, help them to process toxins, and act as armor against ballistic weaponry.

Licensed System (Order: 53151103)



Helmeted, one of these suits will keep an Engineer alive in the vacuum of space. Scientists believe an Engineer could survive in a toxic environment for at least one hour without a helmet, as the biosuit will breathe for them. The biosuit also acts as an advanced medkit, repairing damage to the Engineer's body and providing the wearer with limited sustenance.

Engineer Rebreather: Usually used by Engineers when placed in cryosleep, these bioengineered masks insert a tube down the wearer's throat and feed oxygen directly to their lungs.

Sarcophagi: Resembling large, translucent coffins, these Engineer hypersleep tubes can keep someone alive in suspended animation for centuries, if not millennia. An Engineer rebreather must be worn while in the chamber.

Holography: Engineers record everything within their installations using a memory gel that coats the interior walls and ceiling. When the proper electrostatic currents are channeled through the gel, holographic playback will occur in the actual environment, producing fuzzy, blue particle representations of various recorded events. Most evidence of the Engineers' past actions have come from such recordings.

Orrery: Engineer holographic maps of the galaxy are extremely detailed and interactive, allowing viewers to simply pluck a photonic representation of a world out of the air and have its statistics and coordinates feed directly into a navigational system. Orreries are located on the bridge of an Engineer ship and sometimes serve as observatories or command centers within Engineer installations.

Juggernauts: These massive, asymmetrical, horseshoe-shaped craft appear more grown than built. Each ship contains at least one massive cargo bay with an ampule delivery system (see below). These ships usually have four to eight hypersleep chambers arranged around a central dais on the upper level of the ship's center. In the middle of this dais is a retractable pilot's seat that interfaces with the pilot and makes them one with the ship. The entire chamber can be used to display a map of the galaxy, homing in on any world or system and charting a course to the desired location. Juggernauts are theorized to be war machines or bombers of some kind and are capable of FTL speeds that rival our own.

Mother Juggernaut: Colossal craft shaped like a scorpion's tail, Engineer motherships are defensive docking stations that hover over and protect major Engineer installations and cities. Juggernauts and other Engineer craft can dock with a mothership to replenish their energies and supplies.

Dreadnoughts: While none have yet to be seen, Dreadnoughts are hypothetical Engineer battleships. Partially translated hieroglyphics seem to indicate that these twisted, knot-shaped craft are larger than Juggernauts but still follow the same design philosophy. Dreadnoughts are believed to be extremely weaponized and FTL capable.

Steatite Ampules: Metallic storage containers roughly a half a meter tall, these urns each contain four glass conical containers – each of which in turn contains a strain of the Engineer's greatest creation – the genetic accelerant called Agent A0-3959X.91-15. Hermetically sealed, the urns are designed to release the black goo in response to pressure, temperature and other environmental changes. These are exceptionally dangerous and should be avoided. ●

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)

THE XENOMORPHS

NEOMORPHS, PRAETOMORPHS, ULTRAMORPHS, and Xenomorphs – forget anything and everything you've heard before about facing off against aliens. Ignore the macho bravado you've overheard drunken marines spout at bars – especially those with no scars on their faces and all their limbs intact. They are cocky and alive because they haven't actually seen a xeno in real life. If they knew anything worthwhile about these things, they would be shaken and reserved.

If you see a xeno, you do one thing: run. You don't stand a chance, you never did and you never will. You think you've got superior firepower in your hands? Use all your big and fancy toys to cover your escape, but get the hell out of there.

While the classic Xenomorph XX121 (P. praepotens) is the one whispered about most on the Frontier, there are also other breeds created by the various strains of the xenovirus pathogen. A range of them are presented on the following pages. Each one of these xeno types is terrifying in its own way, and will give you something to suffer PTSD over – if you can get out alive.

Xenomorph Combat Rules

In combat, Xenomorphs follow special rules, described below.

Skills: Xenomorphs don't have attributes like humans. They can use specific skills, and then roll a number of base dice equal to their skill level only. Xenomorphs can have skill levels much higher than humans. They never push rolls.

Speed: Xenomorphs get a number of full turns per round equal to their Speed rating. Draw one initiative card per point of Speed. On each turn, the Xenomorph may either perform one signature attack or move (below).

Ambush: When a Xenomorph ambushes a victim (page 59), it only gets the #1 initiative card for its first turn. Draw initiative cards randomly for any subsequent turns in the round.

Signature Attacks: Unlike human characters (and androids), Xenomorph actions are not split into full and quick actions. To determine which signature attack a Xenomorph uses, roll a D6 and consult the table for the creature. Re-roll if you roll the same attack twice in a row. Also, as GM you are not bound to always follow the random result – if a specific attack fits the narrative better, feel free to go with that. Signature attacks have Adjacent range unless stated otherwise.

⚠ **Interrupt Actions:** Xenomorphs never dodge or defend against close combat attacks. Signature attacks can be defended against (page 62) unless stated otherwise.

Movement: Unless stated otherwise, a Xenomorph may always make one move from Short to Adjacent range as part of a signature attack. Some signature attacks modify this basic movement.

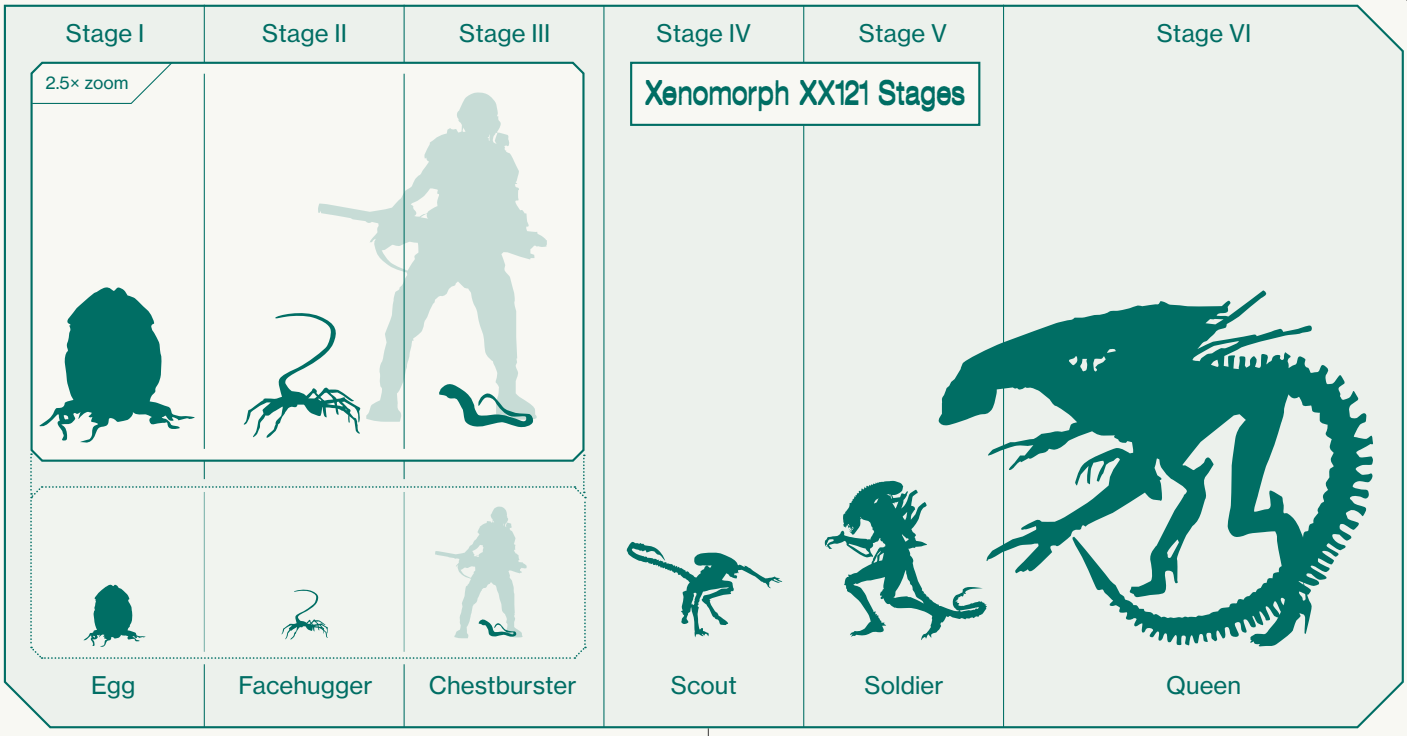
Xenomorphs may also choose to move instead of performing a signature attack. It may then move two zones (or one zone and then from Short to Adjacent range of a target). Such movement is typically used to close in on a distant target or to attempt to leave combat (page 61).

Grappling: If grappled in close combat (page 62), Xenomorphs will spend every turn trying to break free, rolling for **MOBILITY** against the attacker's **CLOSE COMBAT**.

Broken Xenomorph

D6	EFFECT
1	**Rise Again.** The Xenomorph falls to the ground, seemingly dead, but it's a ruse. On its next turn, it regains 1 point of Health and rises, fueled by instinctive hatred.
2	**Wounded.** The Xenomorph staggers, bleeding severely. It gets Speed –1 (down to a minimum of 1), but regains 1 point of Health. Roll D6 at the start of each of its turns. On 1–3, it tries to escape (see Leaving Combat on page 61).
3	**Desperate Escape.** The Xenomorph is severely wounded and cries out in alien fury. It regains 1 point of Health and tries to flee, immediately moving two zones outside of the normal turn order (see Leaving Combat on page 61). If it fails to leave combat, it acts normally on subsequent turns.
4	**Last Breath.** The Xenomorph is mortally wounded and contorts wildly. On its next turn, it will perform a signature attack, then the beast dies. If it's wounded again before then, it dies instantly.
5–6	**Torn Apart.** Instant death. The Xenomorph is torn apart or crushed amidst shrieks of rage.

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Armor: Many Xenomorphs have a thick hide, resistant to attacks, giving them a natural armor level.

Stun Damage: Xenomorphs are immune to stun damage (page 71) unless otherwise stated. If not, they roll for **MOBILITY** to resist it (instead of **STAMINA**).

Health: When a Xenomorph is reduced to zero Health, it isn't broken in the way a human is. Instead, roll a D6 on the table to the left – unless you play "Aliens mode" (see the sidebar below). This does not apply to Facehuggers and Chestbursters – when they reach zero Health, they are destroyed.

Recovery: Xenomorphs recover damage very quickly – in a single stretch of remaining immobile, they recover all lost Health points.

Special Abilities: Some Xenomorphs have special actions beyond their signature attacks. This is specified under each Xenomorph description.

ALIENS MODE

In a situation where the PCs face several Xenomorphs and have access to heavy weapons to dispatch them, you may rule that a Xenomorph dropped to zero Health simply dies. This creates a more Aliens-like feel to the combat, and makes for less record keeping.

Xenomorph XX121

KNOWN BY A VARIETY OF NAMES, the horrifically bizarre alien Xenomorph XX121 is an endoparasitic lifeform with a unique life cycle. The alien shifts from egg to parasitic Facehugger to embryonic Chestburster to adult creature and beyond before beginning the cycle anew.

While it has been classified inaccurately as either Internecivus raptus or Linguafoeda acheronsis by the few in the scientific community to have observed the alien and survived, recent research seems to indicate that Xenomorph XX121 is actually comprised of two separate species – the Facehugger (Manumala noxhydria) that inseminates a host, and the rapidly maturing Chestburster creature (Plagiarus praepotens) that results from that act – both operating together in a symbiotic relationship.

Allegedly blind, the alien still has keen senses and can detect even the slightest movement. These biomechanoid creatures shed their cells and replace them with polarized silicon, essentially growing their own refractive armor. They have highly caustic concentrated acid for blood and deadly prehensile tails. Immensely strong in their adult forms, a Plagiarus Drone or Soldier can easily lift a man by the head and crush his skull in its hands.

As to their origins, no one can be certain. Some believe them to be biological weapons created by some bygone race, possibly the enigmatic and godlike Engineers, while others believe they are a naturally evolved species that the Engineers themselves worshiped. Some religious cults take that a step further, believing the aliens were sent here by God or gods to exact divine retribution on ▶

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humanity for leaving our solar system and daring to enter the heavens. Still others believe that humanity had a hand in the creatures' creation, and that they are a corporate experiment run amok.

What is for certain is that they are dangerous to everyone. They are a parasitic plague that is working its way across the Frontier, and Weyland-Yutani, as well as other corporations, want to find a way to control and weaponize them for profit.

Xenomorph XX121 Special Abilities

The special abilities described below are common to all varieties of Xenomorph XX121.

Acid Splash: When a Xenomorph XX121 takes damage, its acid blood may splash on anyone within Adjacent range. Each type of Xenomorph inflicts a different level of acid splash damage. Fire damage does not trigger an acid splash.

The strength of an acid splash is based on the Acid Splash rating of the Xenomorph plus the amount of damage that the Xeno took from the attack (up to its maximum Health). Roll this many base dice for the acid splash attack against each potential target. The base damage is 1. Armor reduces the damage, but each point of damage reduces the armor level by 1, as the acid eats through it.

Acid Splash

1.	If a Xenomorph suffers **non-fire damage,** an **acid splash** occurs.
2.	Roll for an attack against all Adjacent targets, and the floor, with a number of base dice equal to the **Acid Splash rating** plus **the damage done**, base damage 1.
3.	If damage was done, **roll again** at the start of each new round, **halving** (rounding up) the number of base dice.
4.	**Keep rolling** each round until no damage is done, at which point the acid effect ends.

EXAMPLE ACID SPLASH

A Xenomorph with an Acid Splash rating of 8 takes a huge hit, suffering 5 points of damage from a Smartgun. Its blood splashes everywhere, inflicting a 13 (8+5) base dice attack on everyone at Adjacent range.

"You still don't understand what you're dealing with, do you? Perfect. Organism. Its structural perfection is matched only by its hostility."

"You admire it."

"I admire its purity. A survivor ... unclouded by conscience, remorse, or delusions of morality."

Ash and Lambert

A victim who suffers damage from the initial splash (even if absorbed by armor) suffers another acid splash attack at the start of each round. The number of base dice rolled is halved (rounding up) each round. As soon as an acid attack fails to inflict damage, the acid has burned itself out and the effect is over.

If on a ship or an upper floor of a building, an acid splash can also burn through the floor. Roll for an acid splash attack against the floor (see page 68 for typical armor levels). If damage is done, the acid eats away at the armor level as above. Keep rolling each round, halving the amount of base dice each time, until the acid inflicts no more damage.

Immunity To Cold & Vacuum: The resilient physiology of Xenomorph XX121 offers it total protection against cold and the vacuum of space. As such, the Xeno can act indefinitely in such environments without suffering any ill effects. It does not need to breathe, at least not in any way that has currently been observed.

Radiation: Xenomorph XX121 has proven extremely resistant to all forms of radiation, which counts as two levels lower than normal – i.e. extreme radiation counts as weak, while weak and strong radiation have no effect at all.

Darkness: Xenomorph XX121 is not affected by darkness in stealth mode (page 57). ▶

A Note From MU/TH/UR: It's important to note that different Xenomorph XX121 strains have different traits, and that the information provided here is based on the latest xenobiological information. As we study them more and advances in science are made, we will slowly begin to understand these creatures better, supplanting theory with fact.

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

	OVOMORPH	THE QUEEN'S EGG
▶ **Speed**	0	0
▶ **Health**	2	3
▶ **Skills**	–	–
▶ **Armor Level**	0	1 (0 vs fire)
▶ **Acid Splash**	4	5

Stage I: Ovomorph (Egg)

Large leathery objects, Ovomorphs are the beginning of the alien life cycle. They come in various sizes from 0.6 to 1.2 meters tall. While most open with four petals at the top, some only have a single slit that opens to reveal the Facehugger it carries within. These eggs are lifeforms in their own right, able to protect their precious cargo from blunt trauma and forced entry, while also sensing movement and awakening the parasite within accordingly.

Naturally occurring alien eggs are generated in one of two forms – either they are the result of a transformation perpetrated on a living host, causing it to metamorphose into an Ovomorph, or they are simply birthed by a Queen. Queen produced eggs are hardier and healthier than those produced through ovomorphing.

Opening The Egg: If there is a potential host (not an android) within Short range of an Ovomorph, roll a stress die at the start of each round. On a  , a Facehugger is released and immediately attacks. If a potential host comes within Adjacent range of an Ovomorph, they make a **MOBILITY** roll (no action) to avoid disturbing it. Failure triggers the release of a Facehugger. A new roll must be made on each turn.

Containment & Termination Protocol: **Fire** is a proven method of sterilizing alien eggs, and **explosives** do the trick as well. Keep in mind that the eggs are essentially vats of acid, and when exploding will cause acid damage accordingly. **Extreme cold** can make an egg dormant.

OVOMORPHING

When isolated from a hive, a Drone (page 217) will begin collecting hosts, typically incapacitating them by partially crushing their skulls. It will then cocoon its victims in a secreted saliva resin, introducing a series of enzymes and growth hormones to the hosts in order to transform them into alien eggs. This process is called ovomorphing.

Using the developing barb on its bladed tail, the Drone inserts genetic material from M. noxhydria into the host's eggmorphing body, allowing the newly formed egg to incubate a new Facehugger and thus continuing the alien's life cycle. If conditions are right, a new Queen will be along sooner or later. The ovomorphing process typically takes 24–36 hours (four to six shifts) to complete.

Stage II: Facehugger

Manumala noxhydria is a parasitic form of Xenomorph designed for one task only – the implantation of Plagiarus bacteria within a living host. Coming in a variety of sickly yellowish to brown flesh tones, a Facehugger has a small body, eight spider or crab-like fingers, two large breathing sacks, and a long and powerful tail which it uses to spring itself onto a startled host's face.

The Facehugger clutches its fingers around the victim's head, wraps its tail around their throat, and emits an anesthetic that renders the host unconscious, before inserting its proboscis down the creature's throat. There are several different Facehugger types which appear to vary only slightly in appearance. The major difference is the type of seed they carry – be it for a Praetomorph, Xenomorph Drone, or Queen.

Facehugger And Praeto-Facehugger: These typical creatures are described above. The Praeto-Facehugger is slightly bigger than the standard one but otherwise functions the same and is less dexterous.

	FACEHUGGER	PRAETO-FACEHUGGER	ROYAL FACEHUGGER
▶ **Speed**	2	2	2
▶ **Health**	2	2	3
▶ **Mobility**	8	6	8
▶ **Observation**	7	7	8
▶ **Armor Level**	1 (0 vs fire)	1 (0 vs fire)	2 (1 vs fire)
▶ **Acid Splash**	4	4	5

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Royal Facehugger: The royal variety of Facehugger has eight webbed fingers and is much larger than the standard type. Armored, it also possesses two serrated fingertips and a bladed tail with which to defend itself. Some specimens have also been known to have spikes on their back and spots on their air bladders. While it is theorized that a regular Facehugger can produce a P. praepotens with the ability to transmute into a Queen if necessary, the larger and more powerful Royal Facehuggers are known to specifically produce Queens, and hypothesized to carry not one but two P. praepotens spores – allowing the royal Facehugger to not only produce a Queen, but also a protector for the newborn royalty.

Embryo Implantation: Weyland-Yutani surgical scientist Dr. Matshuita believes that a Facehugger deposits a Chestburster embryo within its victim, making them the same species. Others believe what is deposited to be a cancerous growth that mutates and transforms into a Chestburster, while former W-Y geneticist Dr. Blue Grace Marsalis hypothesized a controversial third theory. Dr. Marsalis believes there is a symbiotic relationship between the Facehugger and the Chestburster, calling the former Manumala noxhydria and the later P. praepotens. She postulated that it is neither an embryo nor an implanted cancer, but an injected bacteria that is the beginnings of P. praepotens.

Facehugging: The Stage II Xeno will automatically facehug any immobilized potential host within Adjacent range. In combat, a successful signature attack #6 will do the trick. If the victim is facehugged, the Xenomorph infects its host via its proboscis, inseminating them deep within their chest cavity. ▶

Facehugger Swarms

When encountering several Facehuggers in the same zone, you can give the entire Swarm a Speed rating according to the below table. Each Facehugger still needs to be killed separately. Incinerators and explosives are great for this.

NUMBER OF FACEHUGGERS	SPEED
1–2	2
3–5	3
6–10	4
11–20	5
21+	6

Facehugger Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1–2	**Skittering Menace.** The Facehugger has chosen its host! It skitters forward, single-minded and horrifyingly spider-like. The victim gains stress level +1 and must make an immediate panic roll. The next attack from the Facehugger will be against the same target with +1 to the D6 roll.
3–4	**Tail Grapple.** The Facehugger leaps and catches its victim, its tail whipping violently. Roll another D6: 1–2 The victim's legs are caught and it falls down, making an immediate panic roll and is unable to move until the Facehugger makes another action or is killed. 3–4 The victim's arm gets hopelessly tangled in the beast's tail. The victim drops one weapon (or other item) of the GM's choice and must make an immediate panic roll. 5–6 The Facehugger wraps its tail around the victim's neck, choking it – it must make an immediate panic roll and roll for **STAMINA** or suffer 1 point of damage (armor has no effect). After any Tail Grapple, the next attack from the Facehugger will be against the same target with +2 to the D6 roll, if within range.
5	**Face Grapple.** The Facehugger leaps at its victim's face with horrifying speed. Roll for an attack with six base dice. It's possible to defend against the attack (page 62). If the attack hits, the target must make an immediate panic roll, and the Facehugger will perform The Final Embrace (result #6 below) on the same target on its next turn.
6+	**The Final Embrace.** The Facehugger gets to its victim, its acid making short work of any helmet or respirator in the way (armor has no effect, except the APEsuit on page 90). Roll for the attack with eight base dice. It's possible to defend against the attack (page 62). If the attack hits, the poor victim is facehugged and immediately broken. Their last sensations are horrible, yet strangely loving: a firm but gentle caress around their head, a smothering sensation followed by a warm burst of oxygen-rich air filling their lungs, a deep sensation of slow-motion falling, it's okay to fall asleep...

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There, the host's own cells mutate to form and incubate the Xenomorph until its next stage. The victim is rendered unconscious, impossible to wake. **Within one shift**, the Facehugger dies and falls off. The victim wakes up, typically very hungry. **After another shift has passed**, a Chestburster (Stage III) is born, killing the host.

Removing a Facehugger from a host's face will kill the host, unless the Facehugger is immobilized by extreme cold first. This takes roughly one stretch of time with the right equipment and a **HEAVY MACHINERY** roll. For each stretch that passes after the facehug, roll a stress die – on a  , the host has been inseminated and removing the Facehugger will not save the victim.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Facehuggers are effectively blind and rely on sound and temperature to find their victims. If the PCs win an **OBSERVATION** roll in stealth mode against a Facehugger, they can stay in the zone until their next turn without alerting them. Also, if the temperature in a zone is close to body temperature, Facehuggers get –2 dice to **OBSERVATION** rolls to detect humans.

A Facehugger is incredibly fast and strong for its size . While its polarized silicon skin protects it from most forms of melee attack, it is helpless against pulse rounds and laser tools. Again, fire works wonders.

DUELING DOCTORS

THE FOLLOWING MESSAGES were intercepted by ICC Comm Control on 5.23.82. These coded signals were sent through redundant comm arrays and rerouted to colonial carrier beacons on the Network, thereby making their point of origin untraceable. Taking place in a reoccurring dark network node called 1010121, the dialogue is believed to be a partial discussion between two competing scientists.

Cross corporation nodes like this pop up now and then, where scientists at rival companies discuss and compare notes on similar projects. This one appears to be a debate over various theories on alien propagation. Partaking in such a discussion is tantamount to corporate espionage. While the encryption code was broken by the FBI, joint jurisdiction to apprehend the offenders was awarded to W-Y and the Colonial Marshal Bureau.

TO: WYNTONJAZZ232 [UNDEFINED] FROM: NETWORK

COMCON NODE 1010121 | EIJA44146537

MESSAGE RECEIVED

HYPOTHESIS REVIEWED.
CONCEPT OF TWO SPECIES IS NONSENSE.
FACEHUGGER STAGE OF INTERNECIVUS RAPTUS
DEPOSITS EMBRYO IN HOST ORGANISM.
EMBRYO MATURES TO CHESTBURSTER STAGE
AND IS BORN, KILLING SAID HOST.
AWAITING ACKNOWLEDGMENT ▮

TO: EIJA44146537 [UNDEFINED] FROM: NETWORK

COMCON NODE 1010121 | WYNTON32

MESSAGE RECEIVED

ANALYSIS INCORRECT. FACEHUGGER PROPER
NAME MANUMALA NOXHYDRIA. DOES NOT
DEPOSIT. INSTEAD INSEMINATES VICTIM
WITH BACTERIA. SAID BACTERIA THEN MUTATES
HOST ORGANS INTO PLAGIARUS PRAEPOTENS
SO CALLED CHESTBURSTER STAGE.
QUERY INTERNECIVUS RAPTUS – MURDEROUS
THIEF? NAMING CONVENTION IS INCORRECT.
WHERE DID YOU GRADUATE FROM, DOCTOR?
HAVE YOU FORGOTTEN HOW TO DERIVE
SIMPLE SPECIES NOMENCLATURE?
AWAITING ACKNOWLEDGMENT
AWAITING ACKNOWLEDGMENT
AWAITING ACKNOWLEDGMENT ▮
[CONNECTION TERMINATED]

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Stage III: Chestburster, Bambi Burster, Imp

The alien grows within the host animal's chest, reaching a point of maturity where it is no longer dependent on the host for survival. While most hosts feel sick to their stomach as the parasite grows within them, some comment that they feel better than they have in ages. As the organs of the host are transformed into the embryonic alien, the host's ribcage is also softened to a point where the Chestburster can perform the act after which it is named. Gestation complete, the creature erupts from the host, killing it from a combination of massive tissue damage, blood loss, and organ transformation. A newly birthed alien exhibits different traits depending on its type.

Chestburster: Jaundiced beige in color, the snake-like Chestburster has a mouth full of metallic canines. Depending on the length of gestation, a Chestburster will either be born with tiny arms or stubs where the arms will eventually grow in.

Bambi Burster: Otherwise similar to the Chestburster, this fawn-like creature is the result of an alien embryo developing within a quadrupedal host. As animals generally mature at a faster rate than humans, the Bambi Burster is birthed with four spindly legs that it uses to propel itself at great speeds. ▶

Michael Syrett (Order: 5315103)

	CHESTBURSTER	BAMBI BURSTER	IMP	QUEENBURSTER
▶ **Speed**	2	2	2	2
▶ **Health**	2	2	2	3
▶ **Mobility**	8	10	8	8
▶ **Observation**	4	4	6	8
▶ **Armor Level**	0	0	0	1 (0 vs fire)
▶ **Acid Splash**	4	4	4	5

Imp: The immature form of a Praetomorph, the Imp has translucent skin, a carapace and rawboned features that make it look very much like a miniature version of its adult form. If an Imp doesn't feel threatened upon emergence, it will sometimes mimic the actions of the nearest creature. Like all Praetomorph stages, Imps mature at a substantially faster rate than traditional Chestbursters.

Queenburster: An embryonic queen, the Stage III Xenomorph nicknamed the Queenburster, gestates over days instead of hours. When born, the creature has a partially formed crest on its head, both sets of arms, and fully developed legs.

Birth: The birth of the Chestburster kills the host outright. The Chestburster has evolved to make a shocking display immediately after birth as a defense mechanism: it snarls, hisses and squeals whilst spraying the blood of its host in all directions. People who witness this for the first time must make an immediate panic roll. Within one shift, the Chestburster evolves to Stage IV.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Surgical attempts to remove an embryonic Chestburster to date have resulted in the **death of the patient** – and depending on how far along it is into the gestation period – the death of the alien as well.

Despite being able to defend itself, at this stage the Xenomorph is at its most vulnerable. It is easily killed by gunshots, explosives, knives, and fire – if it can be caught. Once birthed, it will immediately seek both a place to hide and a source of raw metals to consume in order to complete the transformation into an adult – in addition to organic foods, aliens eat metals to increase their mass.

Sufficiently fed, the Chestburster will begin to darken in color and shed its skin, cocooning itself in resin for the metamorphosis to the next Stage.

VARIABLE GESTATION

While under normal circumstances each Plagiarus species has a typical gestation period, various factors can retard or accelerate the process. For example, if someone is prone to cancer or has a compromised immune system, the rate of growth of any Xenomorph within them can speed up or slow down. Being infected while in hypersleep can slow the process upon revival, and being placed in stasis while infected will arrest the infection or incubation until the afflicted is awakened. It is ultimately up to you as Game Mother and the needs of the story to decide how rapid any xenovirus gestation period is.

Chestburster Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1–3	**Escape.** With a snarl, the Chestburster flees, moving two zones away, into the nearest vent, sewer or duct if possible. As soon as the PCs lose line of sight, the Chestburster has escaped. Stealth mode ensues as the Chestburster tries to hide and grow.
4	**Terrorizing Hiss.** The Chestburster jumps towards a target, flashing its razor-sharp teeth and hissing malevolently. The target must make an immediate panic roll. The Imp will instead mimic the actions of the target in an unsettling manner, with the same effect.
5	**Leg Slash.** With a snarl the Chestburster slashes its target's leg, metallic teeth flashing in the light. Roll for the attack using six base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing. If the attack causes damage on a human, the victim immediately suffers an Impaled Thigh critical injury (page 70) even if not broken.
6	**Throat Bite.** The Chestburster squeals a high-pitched shriek and goes for the throat. Roll for the attack with eight base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If the attack causes damage, it triggers an immediate panic roll.

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	DRONE	SCOUT	STALKER
▶ **Speed**	2	2	2
▶ **Health**	7	5	9
▶ **Mobility**	8	10	9
▶ **Observation**	8	10	6
▶ **Armor Level**	2 (1 vs fire)	2 (1 vs fire)	2
▶ **Acid Splash**	8	8	8

Stage IV: Drone, Scout, Stalker

Now young adults, Stage IV Xenos are able to adopt a bipedal stance, even though they might not always make use of it. Their now fully polarized skin is near black in tone; they have a bladed prehensile tail, six-fingered hands with enlarged nails, pronounced ribs, and translucent to opaque smooth-domed heads. In addition to their metallic, toothy mouths, they have an inner set of jaws that can strike like a piston – a favored mode of attack.

Save for the Scout, Stage IV Xenomorphs have four dorsal tubes affixed to their backs. While some have theorized the tubes are used for spinning and cocooning the resin for their hive, that has generally been discounted as a fallacy. The current line of thinking is that the tubes are a type of breathing apparatus, filtering out airborne toxins and allowing the creatures to breathe underwater. However, as aliens have been observed surviving in the vacuum of space, it is possible that they do not need to breathe at all.

Drone: Sometimes called Lurkers, Drones stand 2.4 meters tall and are stealthy ambush hunters. Their tails end in a deadly hooked blade and rudimentary barb for Ovomorph injection. In many ways, Drones are the most alien of the species. It is theorized that the strange behavior often exhibited by Drones is due to them reaching young adulthood without establishing a connection to the alien hive mind. The creature that wreaked havoc on the USCSS Nostromo in 2122 was a Drone.

The stealthy creatures' fluid yet awkward movements and unorthodox reactions to stimuli belie their methodical intelligence. The ebon Drone is a clever yet single-minded iteration of the Xenomorph. Development of P. praepotens will arrest at Stage IV unless a Queen's pheromones cause it to molt into a Worker or Soldier – whichever form the hive is most in need of. Until then it will eat, gather hosts for ovomorphing, and sleep. When it evolves to the next stage, it joins the hive mind.

▶ **Silent Assassin:** All **OBSERVATION** rolls to spot the drone in stealth mode (page 56) get –2 dice. ▶

Drone, Scout & Stalker Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Hypnotizing Gaze.** The Xenomorph, eyeless as it may seem, stares deeply into the soul of a victim at Short range. The victim is mesmerized by the dread beauty of such a beast. It stands in awe of what nature, or god, or the devil has created, gets +1 stress level and must make an immediate panic roll.
2	**Playing With Its Prey.** The Xeno attacks, but not to kill. The victim is knocked down and drops a weapon (or other item) of the GM's choice, but otherwise takes no damage. The Xenomorph stands over its prey, taunting them to run so the game can go on. The victim must make an immediate panic roll.
3	**Deadly Grab.** The beast launches through the air, grabbing its victim with its talons. It attacks with eight base dice, base damage 1. If it hits, the Xeno immediately drags the victim into an adjacent zone (free bonus move), dumping it on the floor. The victim drops a weapon (or other item) of the GM's choice and must make an immediate panic roll.
4	**Ready To Kill.** The Xenomorph grabs its victim with its talons, its inner jaws poised to strike. Roll for the attack with ten base dice. If it hits, the victim takes 1 point of damage and is grappled (page 62) and must win an opposed roll for **CLOSE COMBAT** against the Xeno's **MOBILITY** to break loose. All friendly characters in the same zone must make a panic roll. Unless the victim breaks free, the Xenomorph will use a Headbite attack (#6 below) on its next turn.
5	**Tail Spike.** The Xenomorph impales the victim with its razor-sharp tail. Roll for the attack with ten base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing.
6	**Headbite.** The Xenomorph opens its outer jaws wide, and the deadly inner jaws lean out, gnashing in anticipation before snapping forwards. The attack has nine base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing. If it causes any damage on a human, it automatically kills the victim in one dreadful blow. However, should the GM wish it, the victim remains just alive enough for the Xenomorph to initiate the ovomorphing process (page 212).

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Scout: 2.1 meters tall when standing upright, the brown-black Scout or Runner is a particularly fast adaptation of P. praepotens. Usually moving about on all fours, the Scout's job is to seek out a nearby source of hosts and alert the hive when one is found. If no hive yet exists, the Scout will begin capturing hosts and cocooning them for ovomorphing until a Queenburster is produced. Once the Queen is birthed and a hive location is secure, a Scout will metamorphose to its next stage. For reasons unknown, Scouts have no dorsal tubes – they do not develop them until Stage V. The Xenomorph that was reported on Fiorina "Fury" 161 in 2179 was a Scout.

Stalker: Averaging about 2.7 meters tall and comfortable moving on two legs as well as all four, Stalkers are the highly aggressive adult form of the Praetomorph. Classified as Plagiarus linesteres, the Praetomorph is a variant breed of Xenomorph XX121 created by the rogue Weyland Corp synthetic David. The Stalker is believed to be an evolutionary dead end for the Praetomorph, as no encountered specimen has ever metamorphosed further.

Unlike its phylogenetic relative P. praepotens, the P. linesteres does not appear to have a Queen stage. It also differs in that it has no biomechanical endoskeleton, and its teeth are translucent bone instead of metal. They are bigger, more powerful, resilient, and more resistant to fire than standard Xenos – they just happen to be less intelligent and more animalistic in nature.

- **Feral Hunger:** The Stalker has an insatiable need to kill. If it makes an attack that causes damage, it will immediately make another attack (with eight base dice, base damage 1) against the same target as a free action.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Stage IV Xenos are notoriously difficult to kill. They operate outside of the alien hive mind and are independent – but each exhibits traits that can be exploited. **Stalkers** and **Scouts** can be tricked into running into a hazardous situation. **Drones** are a bit smarter, but they follow a routine and spend most of their time hibernating in warm places such as somewhere close to a reactor core – and can be hunted down accordingly.

Stage V: Soldier, Worker, Sentry

As the hive mind takes a hold of them at Stage V of their development, P. praepotens molt to assume specialized roles within their community.

Soldier: Romantically referred to as a Warrior, a Soldier Xenomorph is the adult form of a Drone. As the alien matures, the creature's dome loses its form and melds with the ridged tissues beneath it. The alien's head begins to polarize and harden, forming an armored carapace. Blades will begin to grow from the Xeno's elbows, and its hands will mutate into five-fingered claws, dropping

Soldier & Sentry Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Call For Reinforcements.** The Xenomorph pauses, hissing quietly but all the more threatening for that. It looks like it's thinking, or maybe giving silent orders to unseen companions. Then, another Xenomorph appears in an adjacent zone, ready to act in the next round. All PCs in sight of it get stress level +1.
2	**Frenzy.** The Xeno leaps at its enemies, sweeping its arms, legs and tail through their ranks. All targets in the zone are knocked prone, take 1 point of damage, and must make an immediate panic roll. The effect is automatic but the attack can be dodged (page 65) with a successful **MOBILITY** roll, avoiding all effects.
3	**Talon Attack.** The Xenomorph launches into a wild attack with its large, clawed talons at its victim. Roll for the attack with twelve base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing.
4	**Capture For The Hive.** The Xenomorph attacks with its venom-spiked tail, with twelve base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If the attack causes any damage, just 1 point of damage is inflicted, and the paralyzing venom takes effect. The victim must make a **STAMINA** roll – the number ✦ of rolled is the number of rounds it can stay up, then it falls unconscious for one shift. The victim can be woken up with a **MEDICAL AID** roll (full action) by another character – otherwise the Xeno captures the victim for the hive, placing it by an Ovomorph to be facehugged at a dramatically appropriate time.
5	**Tail Spike.** The Xenomorph impales the victim with its razor-sharp tail. Roll for the attack with eleven base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing.
6	**Headbite.** The Xenomorph opens its outer jaws wide, and the deadly inner jaws lean out, gnashing in anticipation before snapping forwards. The attack has a strength of ten base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing. If it causes any damage on a human, it automatically kills the victim in one dreadful blow.

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the sixth digit. Blue-black in color, Soldiers are nimble and attack en masse, as happened at Hadley's Hope in 2179. The Soldier's tail has a barb at the end with a toxin that can cause paralysis in most known lifeforms. Once incapacitated, the Soldier will carry its prey back to the hive to be impregnated by a Facehugger.

Worker: The diminutive Workers build and maintain the hive. Also called Weavers, they produce and spin the resin of the hive with their long proboscis tongues, shape it with their hands and feet, position eggs near cocooned hosts, and feed and maintain the Queen. Physically, they are somewhat different from the other members of P. praepotens. Transformation from Drone to Worker will see an alien shrink to between 1.2 and 1.8 meters in height. Its skin will turn a sickly grayish white, while its tongue grows pink, elongates, and develops a funnel through which it will secrete the makings of the hive. Workers ignore threats within the hive and will run if threatened, leaving their protection to Soldiers and Sentries.

Sentry: After Scouts have secured a hive and a source of hosts, they mature into Sentries. Like Soldiers, their carapaces become ridged and armored. They are still incredibly fast and dexterous, with specialized gripping hands and feet that allow them to scale walls and ceilings with greater efficiency than other Xenos. Attuned to their Queen's needs, they will back off or attack as she signals. Also called Defenders, Sentries will not hesitate to sacrifice themselves to keep hive invaders at bay and protect their Queen.

Containment & Termination Protocol: As always, **fire** keeps Xenomorphs at bay. The non-aggressive Workers are easy to take down as they offer little resistance. A Soldier's carapace is armored enough t o shrug off regular ammunition rounds, but **pulse rifles** make short work of them. Soldiers tend to work in groups, overwhelming targets with sheer numbers. Because of this, it is possible to take out a large number of them with an area effect weapon, hopefully evening the odds a bit. Sentries will not leave the inner hive unless the Queen does, so stay out of there and you'll easily avoid them. You know what? Just stay out of an alien hive. Period.

	SOLDIER	WORKER	SENTRY
▶ **Speed**	2	1	2
▶ **Health**	8	4	8
▶ **Mobility**	8	4	12
▶ **Observation**	8	4	10
▶ **Armor Level**	2 (1 vs fire)	1 (0 vs fire)	2 (1 vs fire)
▶ **Acid Splash**	10	6	10

Stage VI: Praetorian, Crusher, Queen

Stage VI P. praepotens are monstrous horrors. Their immense size and crested carapaces mark them as the leaders of their hive. Stronger and smarter than those beneath them, Stage VI Xenos command alien armies. These Stages are only reached when an existing Queen produces royal jelly and exposes her Soldiers and Sentries to it.

Praetorian: When a hive reaches a certain size, Workers feed the Queen's chosen warriors with Royal Jelly until the transformation to Praetorian takes place. The penultimate form of an alien Soldier, Praetorians grow up to twice the height of their brethren. They develop a head crest similar to a Queen's, but maintain a more standardized bipedal form with only two arms. Lead protectors of the hive, Praetorians are the Queen's Royal Guards and army commanders. It is theorized that if a hive loses its Queen, a Praetorian can molt into a new one. If this happens before another hive invades, the old hive can be preserved. If not, the invaders take advantage of the leaderless Xenos and claim them for their own Queen.

Charger: Also called the Crusher, the Charger is the Xenomorph equivalent of a tank. After being force-fed Royal Jelly and raw metals by the Queen's workers for weeks, a bloated Sentry will cocoon itself in resin and undergo a massive transformation. Its quadrupedal stance is bulked up and its head grows an enormous, armored chitinous crest similar to a Queen's. Chargers grow to stand between 1.8 and 3 meters tall at the shoulder. Heavy defensive protectors of the hive, the Crusher will charge an enemy like a rabid rhino, trampling personnel and plowing through even lightly armored vehicles. Essentially the Runner variant of the Praetorian, the Charger's mobility is limited in that it cannot climb or jump very well. Luckily, they are relatively rare and only appear in long established hives. ▶

HIVE MIND

While a lone alien will operate well enough on its own, when half a dozen or more Stage IV Xenomorph XX121s get together, they begin to operate in unison. Add a Queen to the mix and they'll molt to Stage V. It's then that their coordinated movements become downright uncanny. While some theorize this is accomplished by the Queen through pheromones and other communicative stimuli, others believe it's a cumulative hive intelligence. It would seem that the more Xenomorph XX121s there are in a hive, the more intelligent they become.

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OTHER XENOMORPH TYPES

As has been implied, there are things out there we do not understand. Engineer murals depict horrifying monstrosities, the likes of which we have yet to encounter on the Frontier. They may simply be mythological, or they may be real. There are reports of Xeno-cobras and large squid-like starfish creatures, as well as an alien that appears to be a missing link between a Neomorph and Xenomorph XX121 – a dark blue, goblin-jawed Xeno lovingly dubbed the Deacon (because of its pointed head). Whatever is out there, just pray you don't run into it in the dark.

Royal Jelly

Secreted by a Xenomorph Queen, Royal Jelly is a gelatinous substance that a mother Xeno uses to shape the Sentries of her hive. Royal Jelly contains a specialized strain of Agent A0-3959X.91-15 that induces an accelerated metamorphosis in P. praepotens and M. noxhydria. Royal Jelly is extremely addictive to humans and other animals, and when ingested in large quantities causes an adrenal increase in strength, stamina, and aggressive tendencies – eventually bordering on the superhuman and homicidal.

Queen: The mother of the hive, at six meters tall or more, the alien Queen is perhaps the strongest and most intelligent of the species. While any adult alien is capable of initiating ovomorphing in a host organism, only Queens have the ability to lay eggs en masse. When her first molt is completed and the Queen is fertile, her Workers spin a resin cradle that holds her suspended above the floor of the hive. The Queen then grows an enormous egg sac that soon becomes distended and engorged with developing eggs. As each new Ovomorph is ready, she deposits it on the ground via ovipositor for her Workers to spirit away to nearby cocooned hosts.

The most astonishing thing about the Queen is her ability to communicate with her hive. While evidence exists to suggest she does so via a combination of pheromones and subsonic vocalizations, there are company consultants who believe she communicates telepathically as well, "speaking" with her children over immeasurable distances. In fact, corporate psychiatrists have documented that employees who score high on their company esper tests and find themselves within the proximity of an alien hive will have vivid dreams of the Queen calling to them, whether they are aware of her existence or not.

Additionally, professional dreamers seem to have a hard time producing after being exposed to an alien Queen. Of course, this could simply be a form of PTSD, but it bears further investigation. An alien Queen's distinguishing characteristics include her size, her large crested head, set of six dorsal spikes (instead of tubes), unique stance and a second set of grasping arms.

Containment & Termination Protocol: A Charger is nigh invulnerable while charging with its head shield down, but its body is only as armored as that of a regular alien Soldier, and well-placed explosives or heavy artillery will make short work of the beast. While they have few weaknesses, taking out a Praetorian will temporarily disorient the Soldiers it coordinates. As for dealing with the Queen... yeah. Don't.

Stage VII And Beyond

Not everything is known about P. praepotens and its development cycle. It has been suggested that a Queen will continue to grow as her hive does, reaching Tyrannosaurus rex proportions in Empress and Queen Mother stages that

	PRAETORIAN	CHARGER/CRUSHER	QUEEN
▶ **Speed**	2	1	2
▶ **Health**	12	20	18
▶ **Mobility**	5	4	6*
▶ **Observation**	8	5	12
▶ **Armor Level**	3 (1 vs fire)	5 (3 vs fire), 3 (1 vs fire)**	4 (2 vs fire)
▶ **Acid Splash**	10	10	10

*Zero when attached to the egg cocoon. **The higher armor level is for attacks to the front (GM's discretion).

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rule over several Queens and several hives. There are reports of Praetorians molting into something called Palantines, and rumors of a so-called Alien King, but so far reports of such transformations are unsubstantiated and only hypothetical. What will be found next on the Frontier is anyone's guess.

The Alien Hive

An alien hive is a large Xenomorph XX121 nest, composed mainly of secreted resin, that is either built into an existing structure or free standing on its own. Hives are full of twisting and confusing biomechanical tunnels and corridors that have been spun and crafted by Worker aliens. The damp, muted green-gray walls make it easier for P. praepotens to climb and maneuver, and are full of ridges and pockets for alien Soldiers to hide in.

The sticky walls also serve another purpose – hosts are cocooned and impregnated within them until they birth a Chestburster and are killed. The hosts' decaying bodies then grow into the resin, serving as nourishment for the Workers and Soldiers of the hive. The atmosphere inside the hive is usually hot, dank and humid. Soldiers lay dormant, hibernating in the walls and on the ceiling until called to task by their Queen. Deep within the nest's maze is a centralized and guarded chamber where the Queen sits atop a bloated egg sac and deposits her eggs.

Some hives have been found to contain diluted derivative pools of Chemical A0-3959X.91-15, likely secreted by the Xenomorphs themselves and used to perform genetic alterations on hosts in order to make them more suitable for the production of the type of Chestbursters the hive needs most. It's a nasty place and one you should avoid. ▶

SPECIES INTERACTION: WHY CAN'T WE ALL JUST GET ALONG?

Let's face it – there is no love lost on the Frontier. Aliens hate humans, and just like humans, they mostly hate each other as well. Creatures of different types generally don't get along. Sure, a Facehugger and a Xenomorph Soldier will work together, but a Xenomorph Soldier and a Neomorph will go for each other's throats. Feral Neomorphs will attack anything living not of their type – they find androids a curiosity and will only attack them if provoked. Xenomorph XX121s are similar, attacking any creature they perceive to be a threat.

Abominations hate anyone and everyone until they reach maturity – then they begin to settle and tolerate each other's presence (but still dislike humans, androids, and other aliens). Praetomorphs, on the other hand, simply will not tolerate any other alien species. Xenomorphs from different hives will clash with the intention of killing each other's Queen. When one hive kills the Queen of another, the leaderless hive is absorbed by the victor. The previous Queen's eggs and Praetorians are destroyed, while Scouts, Workers, and Drones are immediately assimilated. The Soldiers are another story. While a reigning Queen releases pheromones that bind the new Soldiers to her, many times she will simply have them destroyed as well.

Praetorian, Charger & Queen Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Call The Guard.** The enormous Xenomorph lets out a shrill cry for help, calling D3 Sentries (for the Queen) or Soldiers (for the Praetorian or Charger) to its defense. They arrive in the following round, then draw initiative and can act.
2	**Frenzy.** The Xeno leaps at its enemies, sweeping its arms, legs and tail through their ranks. All targets in the zone are knocked prone, take 1 point of damage, and must make immediate panic rolls. The effect is automatic, but the attack can be dodged (page 65) with a successful **MOBILITY** roll, avoiding all effects.
3	**Beastly Bite.** The Xenomorph takes a huge bite from its victim. The attack is rolled with ten Base Dice, Damage 1, armor piercing. If the attack causes any damage on a human, the victim is automatically broken.
4	**Charge.** Charger/Queen only (re-roll for Praetorian). Roll for the attack with eight base dice, base damage 4 (2 for a Queen), armor piercing. The attack can be dodged, but not defended against.
5	**Tail Spike.** The Xenomorph impales the victim with its razor-sharp tail. Roll for the attack with twelve base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing.
6	**Headbite.** The Xenomorph opens its outer jaws wide, and the deadly inner jaws lean out, gnashing in anticipation before snapping forwards. The attack has a strength of eleven base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing. If it causes any damage on a human, it automatically kills the victim in one dreadful blow.

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Neomorph

THE TERM NEOMORPH is the common name for the endoparasitic extraterrestrial organism (EEO) that was originally encountered by humans from the colony ship USCSS Covenant on Planet 4 of an uncharted system in Sector 87. It is believed that an ecological disaster there brought on by the release of Agent A0-3959X.91-15 in the atmosphere led to the accelerant settling on and mutating native fungal and insect life to produce a living nightmare.

Similar to a Xenomorph XX121, the Neomorph parasite (P. celerius) is delivered to a host via a carrier organism (Tachinidae tabellarium). Once implanted, the parasite gestates within a living host who is killed by the creature's violent birth. There are a number of differences, however, causing the creature to be classified separately.

Physical Attributes: Appearance-wise, Neomorphs are eyeless and have gray-white translucent skin, a fleshy spiked tail, an elongated bulbous head, and a sphincter-like facial orifice that distends to reveal a mouth full of cruel teeth. While their blood is translucent yellow like that of a Xenomorph, it is not acidic. They make subtle clicking sounds and exhibit animal snarls and screeches, as well as making a distinct hooting sound as adults. Neomorphs are more animalistic than their Xenomorph brethren and are clearly not as intelligent.

Stages: A Neomorph's life cycle is broken down into five known stages that are covered below, as well as various termination protocols associated with each stage.

Sterilization: Neomorphs are genetically programmed to kill all life. Believed by some to be a derivative of the black liquid, P. celerius was likely designed by the Engineers to clear a planet of any indigenous species still living after Agent A0-3959X.91-15 had wiped out the majority of a planet's population.

Stage I: Neomorphic Egg Sacs

Small, bulbous pods that grow like fungus, the egg sacs are the result of the mutagenic Agent A0-3959X.91-15 interacting with pollen and microbial elements on a planet or in a spacecraft. Once formed, these bird's egg-sized pods tend to grow in clutches of 2D6 – and there are often several clutches in any infected area. The egg sacs are the delivery system for the Neomorphic Motes (see Stage II).

Containment & Termination Protocol: The best way to be rid of the Egg Sacs is to expose them to severe **temperature changes** – they can be destroyed with fire or made inert with liquid nitrogen (at least until they thaw). ▶

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Stage II: Neomorphic Motes

When the egg sacs are disturbed, they release what appears to be a puff of pollen. In reality, it is a synchronized swarm of highly infectious Tachinidae tabellarium motes. Smaller than grains of sand, these parasites are sometimes visible when clustering together to increase their locomotive capacities. Possessing a primal hive intelligence, the motes target the nearest potential host and zero-in on an unprotected orifice such as the eyes, ears, nose, throat, or an open wound. From there they enter the bloodstream and inject microscopic amounts of Agent A0-3959X.91-15 into the victim's white blood cells.

Infection: Exposure to Neomorphic Motes is handled as a disease with virulence –2. If the **STAMINA** roll fails, the patient enters Stage III within one Shift. No further **STAMINA** rolls are made.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Like all insects – alien or otherwise – Neomorphic Motes tend to avoid **smoke** and are killed by **fire**.

Stage III: Neomorphic Bloodburster

Once the Motes enter a host's bloodstream, they deliver their microscopic payload and die. The injected Agent A0-3959X.91-15 begins to mutate white blood cells as they circulate throughout the body until they form a cancerous growth that becomes lodged in a vein or arterial wall. This tumor can take root in any bodily area of sufficient mass – such as the lungs, the digestive tract, the esophagus, or even the brain. Forming an amniotic sack, the tumor begins rapidly converting the host's own mutated cells into a larval Bloodburster.

If lodged in a region of the body with dense muscle or bone and no easy egress, the gestating creature develops dorsal spines to aid in its escape. When the newly formed Bloodburster is ready to be born, it violently removes itself from the host – using its inordinate strength, spines, teeth, and claws to cut and tear through flesh, bone, and sinew. The process causes severe hemorrhaging and massive tissue damage in the host, is always fatal, and results in the birth of a Bloodburster.

Bloodbursters have bulbous heads with sharp canines, and run about on all fours. These rabid quadrupedal creatures rely on their speed and agility to avoid damage. Emerging about 0.3 meters in length, Bloodbursters continue to grow exponentially, visibly getting larger as they move about. Highly aggressive, they lash out at anything and everything around them. They use their claws, tail, and teeth to savagely maul their victims.

Birth: A patient entering Stage III is immediately killed outright by the birth of the Bloodburster. The newly born Bloodburster takes one round to sluggishly free itself from its amniotic sack. As soon as it is free, it flies into a savage rage and attacks

Neomorphic Bloodburster Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1–3	**Escape.** With a snarl, the Bloodburster flees, moving two zones away in a single action, into the nearest air duct if possible. As soon as the PCs lose line of sight, combat ends and stealth mode ensues. After D6 stretches, the Bloodburster grows into a Juvenile Neomorph and starts stalking the PCs.
4	**Terrifying Hiss.** The Bloodburster jumps onto the victim, showing its razor-sharp teeth and hissing. The victim must make an immediate panic roll.
5	**Leg Bite.** With a snarl, the Bloodburster bites the victim's leg. Roll for the attack using six base dice, base damage 2. If the attack causes damage, the victim immediately suffers an Impaled Thigh critical injury (page 70) even if not broken.
6	**Throat Bite.** The Bloodburster bites the victim's throat. Roll for the attack with eight base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If the attack causes damage on a human, it triggers an immediate panic roll.

	NEOMORPHIC BLOODBURSTER	NEOPHYTE	ADULT NEOMORPH
▶ **Speed**	3	3	2
▶ **Health**	2	4	6
▶ **Mobility**	9	10	9
▶ **Observation**	5	6	8
▶ **Armor Level**	0	1 (0 vs fire)	1 (0 vs fire)

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any living creature it encounters. See the table of signature attacks on the previous page. After just a few stretches, the Bloodburster enters Stage IV (juvenile Neomorph).

Sprint: If a Bloodburster moves instead of performing a signature attack (previous page), it can move an additional zone.

Containment & Termination Protocol: The best bet is to attack a Bloodburster right after birth – before it has sluggishly freed itself from its amniotic sack. **Fire** or any serious damage done to the creature at this time causes it to run off and hide while it rapidly grows to its juvenile form.

Neomorph Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Terrifying Hiss.** The Neomorph leans in close to the victim (Adjacent range), showing its razor-sharp teeth and hissing. The victim must make an immediate panic roll.
2	**Tail Slash.** The Neomorph pivots, slashing its victim with its sharp tail. The victim is attacked using ten base dice, base damage 2.
3	**Deadly Grab.** The Neomorph jumps at its victim, grabbing it and dragging it away. Roll for the attack using eight base dice, base damage 1. If it hits, the Neomorph immediately drags the victim into an adjacent zone (free bonus move), dumping it on the floor. The victim drops a weapon (or other item) and must make an immediate panic roll.
4	**Leaping Attack.** The Neomorph jumps at the victim. Roll for the attack using eight base dice, base damage 1. If the attack is successful, the victim is thrown to the ground and must make an immediate panic roll, and the Neomorph immediately performs a free extra attack with ten base dice, base damage 2.
5	**Tail Spike.** The Neomorph impales the victim with its razor-sharp tail. Roll for the attack with ten base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing.
6	**Throat Bite.** The Neomorph bites the victim's throat. Roll for the attack using eight base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If the attack causes damage on a human, it kills the victim outright.

Stage IV: Neophyte (Juvenile Neomorph)

Growing from 1.2 to 1.8 meters in length, a juvenile Neomorph continues to maneuver on all fours. While their heads are still bulbous, they have begun to elongate and taper to a point. They are aggressive hunters who are hard to frighten away. Juveniles target one prey animal in a pack and devote all resources to taking that prey down, even going so far as to track it if it escapes. Feral and ferocious, a juvenile Neomorph uses its sharp-tipped tail and teeth to attack.

Evolving: After one shift, the juvenile Neomorph enters Stage V and becomes an adult Neomorph.

Sprint: If a juvenile Neomorph moves instead of performing a signature attack (see adjacent table), it can move an additional zone.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Even when taking weapons fire, a juvenile Neomorph is so focused on the attack that it **ignores damage** to itself until it becomes **critical**. Overwhelming concentrated fire will eventually take the thing out, if it doesn't get you first.

STAGE V: Adult Neomorph

As it reaches adulthood, the Neomorph's smooth, eyeless head becomes more elongated and pointed. Soon, it assumes a gaunt, bipedal stance, reaching a height of 2.1 meters or more. When the creature's mouth closes, its jawline is imperceptible, giving it an inquisitive, ethereal appearance. When provoked, the adult Neomorph's upper jaw protrudes in a manner similar to a goblin shark, allowing it to grasp prey and pull it in for the kill. As adults they utilize stealth tactics to hunt their prey, but they are still voracious carnivores.

Short Lifespan: The life cycle and metabolism of Neomorphs is so fast that they quickly burn themselves out. An adult Neomorph typically dies of natural causes within 24 hours (four shifts). Fungus interacting with the decaying corpse will be transformed into new spore sacs, continuing the cycle.

Sprint: If an adult Neomorph moves instead of performing a signature attack (see adjacent table), it can move an additional zone.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Adult Neomorphs go down quick with a full burst from a pulse rifle, but any automatic weapon does the job eventually. A finishing shot to the head is a good idea, as these creatures have been known to get up and attack even when they seem to be dead. ●

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OTHER EXTRASOLAR SPECIES

IN ADDITION TO ENGINEERS AND XENOMORPHS, some exoplanets have standard species of their own – swift fish, slow-moving land animals, dog-sized arthropods, insects, whales, pachyderms and more. Species of different classifications fulfill the same roles in an ecology as their counterparts on Earth. Some worlds like Arcturus and Zagreus are even home to several unique species. Below is a small sampling of what else lives amongst the stars.

Harvesters

Behemoth subterranean land animals, Harvesters are six-legged Ankylosaurus-sized nightmares that are famous for destroying the colony on Tartarus (page 266). These large, fast-moving burrowers have tiny, useless eyes, instead utilizing sonar to navigate. They have massive front claws and a mouth with a unique shredding mechanism that grinds organic materials and stores it in one of six stomachs. This mouth acts like a rotating circular meat grinder, crushing and pulping flesh, bone, plants, wood, rock and most metals. Only the strongest of materials will resist destruction, causing the Harvester to choke until the offending item is removed.

Typical targets of opportunity include farmlands, graveyards, food stores, or a gathering of people or animals. While Harvesters don't hunt living things, any creatures unlucky enough to be in their feeding zone are fodder. As the air in their natural habitat is higher in carbon dioxide than the human norm, Harvesters are capable of breathing in otherwise poisonous atmospheres. They carry their young beneath the folds of their armored shell – boar-sized creatures that will detach themselves and attack if their mother is overwhelmed.

While native to Tartarus, some corporate exec at Bionational got it in his head that the Harvesters could be used to tunnel out mines on other metal rich worlds. They were transported to several mining planets and moons on the Frontier and did so – before escaping into the wild and disrupting those colonies as well. ▶

"Look at this beautiful thing! In all the systems we've ever cataloged we have never found anything larger than bacteria, but-but this ... this is life. We found life."

"Our first alien."

Millburn and David 8

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HARVESTERS

▶ **Type**	Mammalian Omnivore
▶ **Habitat**	Tartarus and several mining colonies
▶ **Size**	6 meters or more
▶ **Traits**	Erupts from ground, stampedes when threatened, charges when cornered. Doesn't know when to retreat.

	HARVESTER	JUVENILE
▶ **Speed**	1	1
▶ **Health**	15	4
▶ **Mobility**	4	8
▶ **Armor Level**	5 (2 on the underbelly)	1

Harvester Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Sonar Sweep.** The Harvester takes in its surroundings by singing out a quick sonar pulse. Add +1 to the next roll on this table (for a maximum of 6). All PCs within Long range get stress level +1.
2	**Sonar Pulse.** The Harvester uses its sonar as a weapon. Everyone within Short range gets blasted by the ultra-sonic burst and must make a **STAMINA** roll (no action) or be stunned and lose their next turn.
3	**Charge.** The Harvester rushes the enemy it deems to be the biggest threat. It makes a manic charge against it and continues into the next zone. Roll for the attack with six base dice, base damage 3, armor piercing. The attack can be dodged, but not defended against.
4	**Stampede.** The Harvester goes berserk, like a bucking bronco, and flails around in a maddened frenzy. All targets in the zone suffer a crushing attack of eight base dice, base damage 2.
5	**Burrowing Claws.** The beast's claws are almost as bad as its maw, and it leaps on a poor victim. It suffers an attack with ten base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing.
6	**Pulverize.** The victim is dragged into the beast's dreadful meat-grinder of a mouth. Roll for the attack with eight base dice, base damage 2, armor piercing. If damage is inflicted, the victim dies, its body mercilessly minced and its agonized screams ringing in the ears of their friends.

Hidden Behemoth: When at rest the Harvester often sleeps just under the surface, with a thin crust of ground above it. If someone walks across this ground, they get an **OBSERVATION** roll to spot the weakened earth, but if not it will collapse under them and the startled Harvester will get a surprise attack (page 59).

Harvester Juveniles: A mother Harvester will carry up to 2D6 young safely under her armor plating. If she comes under attack and is in genuine danger these young will leap to her defense and attack too, rolling four base dice, base damage 1.

Containment & Termination Protocol: These things are large-scale destroyers. The inhabitants of Tartarus Colony lured the creatures to the surface and attacked them with aircraft with limited success before the beasts learned to avoid such traps. The best way to kill a rampaging Harvester is to attack its soft, unprotected underbelly – but good luck getting close enough to do so without being crushed or ground up.

Lion Worms

An aggressive carnivore covered in golden, fast-moving cilia, the Lion Worm is the apex predator on the xenobiologist jungle dreamworld of Zagreus. Eyeless, the Lion Worm instead has a series of ears running along its body with a group of nostrils in the center of its huge, razor-sharp beak. Like the Harvesters of Tartarus, the worm is a burrower, but unlike those giant land animals, the Lion Worm can only travel through soft earth. It is an ambush predator that actively seeks live prey. It's rumored that poachers have been removing Lion Worms from their natural habitat, slipping them past ICC quarantine and selling them to the corporate elite as pets. If this is so, it is a potential disaster waiting to happen – an escaped Lion Worm could reproduce quickly and upset the ecological balance of any colony world, as well as be responsible for a great many deaths.

LION WORM

▶ **Type**	Invertebrate Carnivore
▶ **Habitat**	Wilds of Zagreus
▶ **Size**	1.8–3 meters
▶ **Traits**	Relentless hunter, attacks first, retreats underground when confused.

▶ **Speed**	2
▶ **Health**	8
▶ **Skills**	**MOBILITY** 10, **OBSERVATION** 8
▶ **Armor Level**	1

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HUMAN'S BEST FRIEND

When humanity conquers a brave new world, they bring their animal companions with them – and with good reason. Pets are incredibly important to the psychological well-being of long-haul starship crews, and every ship should have one. While far from common, typical flesh and blood animals found on the Frontier include dogs, cats, mice, reptiles, fish, and birds.

Additionally, synthetic copies of both mundane and exotic Earth animals have been produced by a number of companies. Rats and insects have stowed away on many a spacecraft, spreading disease and altering the ecology of alien worlds. Apes are still used in laboratory settings and cattle, sheep, horses, and pigs have all been transplanted to extrasolar farming colonies.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Lion Worms can be disoriented by the release of pollen or pollutants in the air. They are easily distracted by the pheromones of another Lion Worm, something the colonists on Zagreus were wise enough to collect. A Lion Worm perceives the smell of another of its kind as an invasion of its hunting grounds and will seek out and attack the offender accordingly.

Ambush Predator: The Lion Worm is a top predator. In its own territory it will set up traps, pits, walls of vines, and tree lines that all help it capture its prey. In stealth mode, a Lion Worm's prey gets –2 dice to **OBSERVATION** rolls due to the Worm's cunning instincts, if they are in the Lion Worm's territory.

Tanakan Scorpionids

Although they are equipped with poisonous stingers, the desert scorpions of Tanaka 5 have more in common with Earth's prehistoric sea scorpions than the standard Terran variety. These tapered and segmented creatures have rounded heads, a set of large pincers, eight crab-like legs, and two large fin-like structures on either side of their bodies. While initially thought to be utilized in intimidation displays, the fins were found to have a different purpose when the planet's underground lake systems were discovered – Scorpionids are adept swimmers and spend at least half their life underwater. Those very lakes are teeming with aquatic life, making for easy hunting grounds for the arthropods. ▶

Lion Worm Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Intimidating Display:** The Lion Worm rears up, its golden cilia flowing in threatening patterns. But it's a bluff. The expert predator has seen a problem and is using an aggressive display to cover a tactical retreat. All PCs within Short range must make a panic roll. On its next turn, the Lion Worm attempts to leave combat (page 61) and stealth mode resumes. When it makes its next attack, it gets a +1 to its roll on this table (to a maximum of 6).
2	**Playing With Its Prey.** The Lion Worm attacks but for fun, rather than to kill. Roll for the attack with eight base dice. If the attack hits, the target drops a weapon (or other item) of the GM*s choice, but is otherwise unharmed. The Worm rears over them, wishing for its prey to run before it attacks again. The victim must make an immediate panic roll.
3	**Acrid Pheromones.** The Lion Worm releases a huge dump of pheromones into the air. They are so pungent that anyone near the creature starts to cough, and all PCs within Short range must make a **STAMINA** roll (no action) or lose their next turn.
4	**Feral Rage.** The beast attacks, throwing everything at its victim, with ten base dice, base damage 2. If it causes any damage, its insatiable desire to kill allows it to immediately make a second attack, with the same effect.
5	**Crippling Attack.** The Lion Worm attacks to incapacitate its target, either to eat later or get enough space to escape a bad situation. It goes for a crippling blow, making an attack with eight base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If it does any damage, the victim is automatically broken.
6	**Death Roll.** The Lion Worm goes full out for the kill, grasping its target and wrapping it in a vicious death roll. Roll for the attack with ten base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If the attack hits, the victim is grappled (page 62) and must win an opposed roll for **CLOSE COMBAT** against the Lion Worm's **MOBILITY** to break loose. On its next turn, the Lion Worm squeezes the victim, attacking with ten Base Dice, base damage 1 again. This continues until the victim is killed or breaks free.

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"What kind of bio-stock did these bugs punch out of?"

Cpl. Dwayne Hicks

SCORPIONID

▶ **Type**	Arthropod Carnivore
▶ **Habitat**	Tanaka 5, deserts and cavernous springs
▶ **Size**	1.5–2.4 meters
▶ **Traits**	Hides in dunes and rocks during the day, hunts at night, aggressive if provoked and surprisingly adept swimmers.

	ON LAND	IN WATER
▶ **Speed**	1	3
▶ **Health**	5	5
▶ **Mobility**	6	10
▶ **Observation**	6	10
▶ **Armor Level**	1 (0 vs firearms)	1 (0 vs firearms)

While they normally keep to themselves, Scorpionids will fight if they feel threatened. Their pincers can break a man's leg, and their sting can kill a grown human quickly unless an antidote is administered. The deadly venom in their stingers can be used for a multitude of medicinal purposes. While dangerous and somewhat unpleasant, collecting Scorpionids and milking their venom can make you some quick cash. Scorpionids run a gamut of colors from an orange-red to a deep blue.

Underwater Sprint: If starting its turn in water, when a Scorpionid moves instead of performing a signature attack (below), it can move an additional zone. It uses this ability to make sneak attacks against prey on the shore.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Their shells protect them from knives and other melee weapons but don't do much good against bullets.

The Swarm

Dubbed space locusts by Colonial Marines, the Swarm either originated on or came to rest on planet LV-KR 115. For untold centuries, they would ravage the grasslands for a season before going into hibernation for decades, only awakening when the lands were fertile once again.

Tanakan Scorpionid Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Retreat.** The Scorpionid isn't stupid and won't fight unless there's a good reason to. On this occasion it decides to flee the fight (page 61) as quickly as possible.
2	**Pinned Down.** The Scorpionid uses its powerful pincers to pin down its target. Roll for the attack using ten base dice, base damage 1. If the attack hits, the target drops a weapon (or other item) and must make an immediate panic roll.
3	**Pincer Grab.** The creature tries to seize its victim in its enormous claws, quivering with the anticipation of a quick strike with its huge tail. Roll for the attack with eight base dice, base damage 1. If the attack hits, the victim is grappled (page 62) and must win an opposed roll for **CLOSE COMBAT** against the Scorpionid's **MOBILITY** to break loose. If the Scorpionid retains its grasp, it will automatically make a Tail Strike attack against the victim on its next turn. If this attack hits underwater, the Scorpionid will also drag the victim deeper and one zone away from the group, causing them to also suffer the effects of drowning.
4	**Flailing Strike.** The Scorpionid's pincer swipes at its target. Roll for the attack with eight base dice, base damage 1. If the attack hits, the Scorpionid flings the victim into the next zone, causing another point of damage.
5	**Tail Strike.** The Scorpionid swings its terrible tail forward with deadly purpose. It attacks with ten base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If it inflicts any damage, it also poisons the victim with a deadly venom, counting as a disease with a virulence rating of –2 (page 76).
6	**Immobilize.** The Scorpionid wants to escape, but to do so it needs to take its attackers out of the fight. It lunges for its victim's legs with its huge claws, making an attack with eight base dice, base damage 2. If it does any damage, the victim immediately suffers an Impaled Thigh critical injury (page 70) even if not broken.

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Swarm Attacks

D6	ATTACK
1	**Consume.** The Swarm consumes everything in its path, and this place is rich in food. The Swarm's Health is restored by 2 points, making it harder to drive off.
2	**Pheromones.** The Swarm is getting increasingly agitated and more and more pheromones are being released into the air. The Swarm's next roll on this table gets +1.
3	**Suffocating Swarm.** The swarming creatures are everywhere. They are in the victims' eyes, ears and mouths, and it is almost impossible to breathe. Everyone inside the Swarm area must make a **STAMINA** roll. Failure means the victim loses their next turn, and the Swarm will perform a Stripped To The Bone attack against one victim on its next turn.
4	**Desperate Hunger.** The Swarm is so hungry it will eat anything, and right now the polymers and compounds in the players' armor look good. Everyone within the Swarm wearing armor suffers an attack rolled with eight base dice, base damage 1. Any damage is immediately subtracted from the armor level. Those not wearing armor find their clothes have been shredded, but the attack does not inflict any damage.
5	**Feeding Frenzy.** The Swarm is hungry and tries to eat anything it can envelope. All characters inside the Swarm suffer an attack rolled with six base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing (as the creatures look for ways to slip past it).
6	**Stripped To The Bone.** The Swarm focuses on one target, and that victim takes an attack rolled with twelve base dice, base damage 1, armor piercing. If the attack inflicts any damage, the Swarm will automatically attack the target again on its next turn. This will continue until an attack fails to inflict damage, the victim is stripped to the bone, rescued, or the Swarm is driven off.

Between cycles, the company discovered the world and devised a method for creating self-replenishing crops there. The swarm awoke once more to devour everything. But with crops that could grow back after any attack, the swarm had no reason to go into hibernation. Instead, their numbers grew exponentially until they blanketed the entire planet. The company was forced to bomb the planet with pesticides that rendered the planet uninhabitable.

While severe in its solution, the problem was solved for LV-KR 115, but that was only the beginning. The term space locust seems to have been apt, as scientists have drawn a line across the Frontier of worlds that have suffered repeated ecological blights, and dormant swarms have been located adrift in deep space. It is possible that these insects drift in space for millennia before reaching new worlds to ravage. No one knows how many are out there, nor how many already lay dormant on fertile colony worlds, just waiting to wake up and begin the cycle again.

Swarm Rules: The size of a Swarm is measured in the number of zones it covers. The Speed rating of a Swarm is equal to the number of zones it covers. The Health of a Swarm is equal to 5 times the number of zones it covers. The Swarm cannot be killed. Victims can only flee from it or try to drive it off. If the Swarm's Health drops to zero it has had enough and goes looking for easier pickings.

Containment & Termination Protocol: Good luck. Try shooting them all you want, there are hundreds to take the place of every locust you might hit. In space, you can cook the dormant critters in your afterburners. Once planetside, fire, electrical conductivity, and lethal pesticides are the only means to deal with this spaceborne environmental menace. ●

THE SWARM

▶ **Type**	Insect Omnivores
▶ **Habitat**	LV-KR 115, fertile grass and farmlands, or drifting through space
▶ **Size**	Around 15 centimeters each, but together they can form massive swarms a great many kilometers in diameter
▶ **Traits**	Swarm an area, consume everything there save for metals
▶ **Speed**	1 per zone
▶ **Health**	5 per zone
▶ **Armor Level**	Impervious to all attacks except fire, explosions, and electricity.

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)



CHAPTER 11

CAMPAIGN PLAY

"Folks, we have scored big this time!"
"What is it, dad?"
"I'm not sure. See if we can't get a closer look at this thing."

Rebecca "Newt" Jorden and her father Russ Jorden

Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

WHAT DO THE PLAYER CHARACTERS DO? Where do they go? Just what is out there? This chapter provides the tools to help you as the GM develop a framework for creating a campaign as well as colony worlds and other adventure destinations. It provides random tables that are bursting with ideas for missions, complications, encounters and more, whether your players are space truckers, colonial marines or frontier colonists.

Bear in mind that random rolls are an aid to imagination and that you can always simply pick an entry from one of the tables if you prefer.

THE CAMPAIGN FRAME

BEFORE YOU SET OUT to play a full campaign in the ALIEN roleplaying game, you need to decide which campaign frame to play – simply put, who the characters are and what role they have in the ALIEN universe. This is something we recommend that you do together with the players, as you will have more fun if everyone is involved in creating the game.

Three suggested campaign frames – space truckers, colonial marines, and frontier colonists – are described below, and later in this chapter you'll find mission generators for each of them.

Employees Or Freelancers?

Whichever campaign frame you choose, you should decide early on if the PCs are employed by a government, a corporation or the military, or if they are freelancers, taking whatever jobs they can find in their field.

As employees, the PCs get a steady paycheck (even though it might be a small one) and access to hardware that most freelancers cannot afford. Freelancers have a lot less security, but they are free to take whatever jobs they like, and if they're lucky they might one day strike it big.

Where To Start

You can start your campaign anywhere you like in charted space (see chapter 8), but such a wide freedom of choice can be daunting. At the end of this chapter, you'll find three campaign locations that are described in some detail and can function as a starting point or even a home base for the PCs: the Tartarus Sector, the Jackson's Star mining colony, and the Novgorod space station.

Starting Spaceship

We recommend that you let the players start with access to a spaceship. This way they are mobile right from the start and can explore the star map and discover the ALIEN universe piece by piece. Space travel is explained in detail in chapter 6.

If the PCs are employed by a government, corporation or the military, their spaceship will be assigned to them, and they are expected to take good care of it. If the PCs are freelancers, they can lease or even own their own spaceship, and use money they earn to repair and upgrade it. This can turn into a mini game on its own – read more in chapter 6.

Space Truckers

You don't give a damn about the colonies. You've got bills to pay – and the easy money is in hauling cargo and refineries from the Outer Rim to the Core Worlds. While there is plenty of difficult and frustrating work at both ends of the trip, most of the job is spent in hypersleep, traveling from here to there while the ship flies itself. Thanks to the cryo-chambers, you're aging a lot slower than your buddies back home. Keep on truckin' and you just might live forever. If you're lucky, you'll be home in time to see your newborn's third birthday. Until then, you've got to convince the Company that your work on this stint is worth a full share.

As the crew of a powerful tug-ship or cargo hauler, the PCs will be employees of the ship's owner and their jobs will vary tremendously depending on the client's needs. They may be ferrying ore to a refinery or taking colonists in hypersleep out to an unexplored planet. There are supplies to ferry to colonies, drilling rigs to tow out to the frontier and salvage jobs to carry out. Have ship – will travel.

The tables later in this chapter suggest some of the common cargoes to ship and the possible destinations for delivery. Although sounding mundane, this job is filled with problems, complications, and unexpected encounters with the unknown. You are on your own, often navigating on the fringes of known space ... breakdowns, emergencies and the frustrations of working with two-bit colonies can be turned into enjoyable scenarios in themselves.

- **Typical Jobs:** Cargo runs (page 244)
- **Suggested Employers:** Weyland-Yutani, Lasalle Bionational, Seegson
- **Suggested Careers:** Company Agent, Medic, Officer, Pilot, Roughneck
- **Suggested Spaceship:** Model CM-88G Bison M-Class Freighter (page 134)
- **Weekly Salary:** $400–960 (time in stasis pays 10%)

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Colonial Marines

Most of your friends will never see another world... but not you. As soon as you were old enough, you signed up for the USCMC. The pay is poor and the food is worse but you've always got a bunk and you get to shoot all kinds of weaponry at all kinds of targets. Life in the Corps is never dull, it's one gigantic adrenaline rush – but the luster has begun to fade. You've seen things that you'll never be able to forget – and plenty that you wish you could.

The life of a colonial marine can be tough and challenging, particularly when it comes to the missions. There is no employer table for marines, all their orders come from the Marine Corps HQ. The missions are typically combat orientated with military objectives, but you can substitute tables from the other campaign frame for inspiration if desired. Most mission locations will involve off-world installations, war zones, combat stations or fortifications. The key to playing a Colonial Marine game is to have the PCs be the squad leaders, those making all of the decisions. Also, keep the squad small. This is a roleplaying game, after all, not a wargame.

- **Typical Jobs:** Military Missions (page 247)
- **Suggested Employers:** USCMC (United Americas), Space Operating Forces (Union of Progressive Peoples), Royal Marines Commandos (Three World Empire)
- **Suggested Careers:** Colonial Marine, Medic, Officer, Pilot, Roughneck
- **Suggested Spaceship:** Conestoga Class Frigate (page 136)
- **Weekly Salary:** $500–760 (time in stasis pays 10%)

Chain Of Command

Marines, regardless of whether they work for the UA, 3WE or the UPP, are part of a military organization and are expected to follow orders. This means that the PCs don't get to choose which missions they are sent on, someone higher up simply gives them orders. In game terms, this means that you as GM prepare a mission and give the players a briefing on the objectives. If you want a more open approach, we recommend the PCs being a mercenary company instead. This way, they are free to choose where to go and which missions they want to take on.

"Hey, Hicks. Man, you look just like I feel."

Private Drake

Frontier Colonists

"Life on the off-world colonies is an adventure," they said. "Start a new life with the prospect for untold riches," they said. What they didn't say was that the colony worlds are tough and unforgiving, and while opportunities for making a fortune do exist, it always seems to happen to the other guy. But your chance will come – you are a surveyor, a prospector, a miner and an explorer – and if there are treasures out here, you will find them. And then you can sell your claim to one of the corporations for a fortune."

Frontier colonists are blue-collar working stiffs, and they follow up rumors, take chances on speculation or simply go in blind, to locate and extract valuable raw materials or salvage abandoned technology. Their skills and tenacity are sought after by third parties not willing to brave the dangers of the Outer Rim themselves. Finding the big bucks to fund your own expedition is not easy. This makes most explorers dependent on sponsors. The rewards are often permits to go on expeditions of one's own, or new, desirable knowledge.

- **Typical Jobs:** Expeditions (page 250).
- **Suggested Employers:** Weyland-Yutani, ICSC, Colonial Marshal Bureau
- **Suggested Careers:** Colonial Marshal, Company Agent, Kid, Medic, Pilot, Roughneck, Scientist
- **Suggested Spaceship:** Model CM-90S Corvus – M-Class Salvage Vessel (page 132)
- **Weekly Salary:** $500–640 (time in stasis pays 10%)



CAMPAIGN EXPANSIONS

The tools and information in this chapter are enough to get you started on a full campaign, but for even deeper delves, separate campaign expansions are available for the ALIEN RPG. These focus on a specific campaign frame and include more character options and a full campaign to play. The Colonial Marines Operations Manual and Building Better Worlds (for frontier colonists) are already available, and a book for space truckers is in development.

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CREATING STAR SYSTEMS

THE RULES IN THIS SECTION allow you to create a colony world on the Frontier or Outer Rim and with it all the information you need to start running scenarios with your players. Should the wider star system require further exploration, then optional rules are included to create all the planets around a star



Star Types

Stars vary wildly from moon-sized white dwarfs to immense giants and from dull red, cool M-types, to fierce white and blue stars. A star type is described by combining its brightness class and its spectral class, for example: MV, GIII, FV. There are no stars of brightness class type I and II within charted space.

TYPE	DESCRIPTION	BRIGHTNESS CLASS
Giant	Huge, bright and cool star in a late stage of evolution	Type III
Subgiant	A large bright star, exhausting its fuel	Type IV
Main Sequence	Small but incredibly common type of star	Type V
White Dwarf	A dead, burnt-out star, tiny and super-dense	Type DA
Red Dwarf	A red main sequence star, small and cool. Very common star.	Type MV
White Main Sequence	White main sequence stars that burn hot and brightly	Type A0V

Spectral Class: Stars are also given a spectral class, based on temperature. These are:

- **O** Blue
- **B** Blue
- **A** White
- **F** Yellow-white
- **G** Yellow
- **K** Orange
- **M** Red

PLANETARY NAMES

Inhabited planets are given names that often refer to Greek mythology, or to dark or foreboding themes. Unsurveyed planets and moons remain unnamed, while any surveyed moon or planet (prior to colonization) will be given a three-digit designation prefixed by the ICC code "LV" (for example LV-562). A suggested list of names is provided here:

- Hannibal
- Monos
- Requiem
- Nakaya
- Phaeton
- Nocturne
- Prospero
- Magdala
- Hamilton
- Tracatus
- Aurora
- Hephaestus
- Damnation
- Cerberus
- Doramin
- Solitude
- Euphrates
- Nemesis
- Moab
- Gorgon
- Napier
- Medea

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Main World Creation

HUMAN PRESENCE in a star system will be established on the most lucrative planet, not the most Earth-like. It might have poisonous air and seas of sulfuric acid, but if there's palladium or iridium to mine, then that's where the colony will go. This colonized world will sometimes be referred to as the main world, to differentiate it from all of the uninhabited planets and moons in the rest of the star system.

Each main world requires you to randomly create its size, atmosphere, temperature and geosphere. One random planetary feature can then be created (to give an initial impression of the world's surface) before moving on to the colony size, colony mission, factions at work and any orbital components.

Planet Size

The size listed is the diameter of the planet in kilometers, with examples of roughly equivalent bodies from our solar system. Worlds with lower than 0.7 G are considered low-gravity worlds while those of 1.3 G or above are classed as high gravity. On both low and high-G worlds, characters will have trouble moving around and get a –2 modification to all **AGILITY**, **CLOSE COMBAT** and **STAMINA** rolls. After a period of acclimation, this modification disappears. ▶

Planet Size

2D6	SIZE	SURFACE GRAVITY	EXAMPLES
2 or less	<1,000km	Almost 0-G	Ceres and other asteroids
3–4	2,000 km	0.1 G	Iapetus
5–6	4,000 km	0.2 G	Luna, Europa
7	7,000 km	0.5 G	Mars
8	10,000 km	0.7 G	
9–10	12,500 km	1.0 G	Earth, Venus
11	15,000 km	1.3 G	
12	20,000 km	2 G	Super-Earth

Use the below modifier if applicable (see star system generator on page 243):

▶ **Ice planet**	–2
▶ **Gas giant moon**	–4

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Atmosphere

The size of a planet may affect the atmosphere, with the low-digit entries (2–8) generally more common for small worlds and the higher ones (9–12) associated with larger worlds. Many planets have toxic and unbreathable atmospheres.

- **Thin:** In a very thin atmosphere, a pressure suit is needed. Without it, all **STAMINA** rolls get –2 dice and all PCs must make a fatigue roll every shift. On some worlds with a thin atmosphere, deep ravines can contain pressure high enough for humans to survive without suits.
- **Breathable:** The atmosphere is at Earth density and contains oxygen and carbon dioxide in quantities to sustain human life.
- **Toxic:** The toxic atmosphere has an Earth-like density, but it is not breathable without a filter mask. Anyone without a mask must make a fatigue roll every stretch (in combat, the fatigue roll does not count as an action).
- **Dense:** The air is so dense that it is literally too thick to breathe. Only at high altitudes can humans breathe comfortably without a pressure suit. Exposure can lead to reduced blood circulation, resulting in numbness, cramps and even life-threatening clots. Without a pressure suit, all PCs must make a fatigue roll every shift.
- **Corrosive:** Corrosive atmospheres are toxic and contain chemicals such as ammonia, fluorine or chlorine that burns the throat and lungs. These count as toxic (above) but in addition, anyone without a pressure suit suffers an attack rolled with five base dice at the start of each stretch. Normal armor has no effect.
- **Infiltrating:** Corrosive gases in great concentration can defeat pressure suits. This type of atmosphere is classed as infiltrating. It has the same effect as corrosive above, but roll for an attack with five base dice against each pressure suit. On a hit, the suit is breached and no longer offers any protection.
- **Special:** The atmosphere varies across the planet's surface. It could be dense at the equator and thin around the poles, have a liquid form or some other special properties decided by you. If stuck for ideas, re-roll.

Atmosphere

2D6	ATMOSPHERE
≤3	Thin
4–6	Breathable
7–8	Toxic
9	Dense
10	Corrosive
11	Infiltrating
12	Special

Modify the roll for the planet size:

4,000 km diameter or less	–2
4,001 km – 7,000 km diameter	–4

Temperature

The average surface temperature of a planet depends on its distance from the star as well as the planet's atmosphere. This temperature provides a clue as to its position in the star system.

Temperature

2D6	TYPE	TEMPERATURE	EXAMPLES
≤3	Frozen	–50 °C or less	Titan, Pluto, Enceladus
4–5	Cold	–50 to 0 °C	Alaska or Antarctica in winter
6–7	Temperate	0 to 30 °C	Boston or Paris
8–10	Hot	31 to 80 °C	Mojave or Sahara Deserts
11+	Burning	80 °C or more	Mercury, Venus

Modify depending on the atmosphere:

Thin atmosphere	–4
Dense atmosphere	–1
Corrosive or infiltrating atmosphere	+6
Special atmosphere	GM decides

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"You hear that?"
"What?"
"Nothing. No birds, no animals. Nothing."

Daniels and Oram

Geosphere

Results on the table below tell you the proportion of dry land to ocean that exists on the planet. Note that a frozen world will have locked up all of the seas and oceans as ice and a Burning world will have turned its oceans to steam. Also, it should be pointed out that, when it comes to other planets, not all oceans are comprised of water.

Terrestrial Planet Terrain

Roll on this table for a single distinctive planetary terrain type. If using the star system generator (page 243) these results are only suitable for terrestrial planets – for ice planets, use the ice planet terrain table instead. ▶

Geosphere

2D6	GEOSPHERE	DESCRIPTION
≤4	Desert World	No surface water
5–6	Arid World	Global deserts and dry steppes, with some lakes and small seas
7–8	Dry Temperate	Oceans cover 30–40% of the world's surface
9–10	Wet Temperate	Oceans cover 60–70% of the world's surface
11	Wet World	Global oceans with some islands and archipelagos
12	Water World	No dry land

Modify the roll for the factors below:

▶ **Thin, Dense, Corrosive or Infiltrating atmosphere**		–4
▶ **Special atmosphere**		GM decides
▶ **Hot temperature**		–2
▶ **Burning temperature**		–4
▶ **Frozen**		–2
▶ **No atmosphere**	=	desert world

Terrestrial Planet Terrain

D66	FEATURE
11	Huge impact crater
12	Plains of silicon glass
13	Disturbing wind-cut rock formations
14	Permanent global dust-storm
15	Eerily colored dust plains
16	Active volcanic lava fields
21	Extensive salt flats
22	Dust-laden, permanent sunset sky
23	Ancient, blackened lava plains
24	Thermal springs and steam vents
25	Tall, gravel-strewn mountains
26	Howling winds that never stop
31	Daily fog banks roll in
32	Deep and wide rift valleys
33	Bizarrely eroded, wind-cut badlands
34	Steep-sided river gorges cut into soft rocks
35	Huge moon dominates day/night sky
36	World-spanning super canyon
41	Impressive river of great length
42	Oddly colored forests of alien vegetation
43	Mountains cut by sky-blue lakes
44	Sweeping plains of elephant grass
45	Highly toxic, but beautiful, plant-life
46	Small, bright, incredibly fast moons in orbit
51	Vast and complex river delta
52	Immense series of waterfalls
53	Endless mudflats with twisting waterways
54	Impressive coastline of fjords and cliffs
55	Volcanoes, active & widespread
56	Impenetrable jungle
61	Dangerous tides – fast and loud
62	Vast, permanent super storm
63	Toxic sea creatures floating with the currents
64	Volcanic island chains
65	Permanently overcast with unrelenting rainfall
66	Mildly acidic oceans and rainfall

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Ice Planet Terrain

2D6	FEATURE
2	Huge impact crater
3	Geysers spew water into low orbit from long fissures
4	Deep fissures leading to a subsurface ocean
5	Dramatically colored blue-green ice fissures
6	Huge and active cryovolcano
7	Vast range of ice mountains
8	World-spanning super canyon
9	Disturbing, wind-cut ice formations
10	Black, dust-covered ice plains
11	Impressive ice escarpment of great length
12	Extensive dune-fields of methane sand grains

Colony Size & Missions

Colonial habitation on the Outer Rim and the Frontier is generally limited to small settlements with only one or two missions. These colonies have sponsors they are dependent upon. Roll first for the size of the colony and then for its missions. If you are creating an unexplored or uninhabited planet, don't use these tables.

Orbital Components

A colonized world will have objects of interest in orbit. If the planet is unexplored and uninhabited instead just roll D3–1 for the number of moons.

Colony Size And Missions

2D6	COLONY SIZE	POPULATION	MISSIONS
≤7	Start-Up	3D6 x 10	1
8–10	Young	3D6 x 100	D3–1
11+	Established	2D6 x 1000	D3

Modify the roll for the factors below:

- ▶ **Breathable atmosphere** +1
- ▶ **Corrosive or Infiltrating atmosphere** –2
- ▶ **Size 4,000 km or less** –3

2D6	COLONY MISSION
≤2	Terraforming
3	Research
4	Surveying and prospecting
5	Prison or exile
6	Mining and refining
7	Mineral drilling
8	Communications relay
9	Military
10	Cattle ranching/logging
11	Corporate HQ
12+	Government HQ

Modify the roll for the factors below:

- ▶ **Toxic/corrosive/infiltrating atmosphere** +1
- ▶ **Start-up colony** –1
- ▶ **Breathable atmosphere** +1
- ▶ **Established colony** +4

Orbital Components

2D6	ORBITAL COMPONENT	2D6	ORBITAL COMPONENT
2–4	Nothing	9	Survey station
5	Ring	10	Communications satellites
6	Abandoned or repurposed satellite or space station	11	Transfer station
7–8	D3 moons	12+	Roll D6 times

Modify the roll for the factors below: ▶ **Young colony** +1 ▶ **Established colony** +2

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Factions

No colony is truly harmonious – there are schisms, groups and factions vying for control. These factions can create tension and have a dramatic effect on any situation that may occur at the colony. First roll a D3 for the number of factions, then roll a D6 for the types of factions.

Colony Allegiance

A colony may owe an overall allegiance to a corporation or nation, depending on its location. In the Union of Progressive Peoples, the allegiance of a colony is always to the UPP itself. In the Independent Core System Colonies (ICSC), although colonies are technically independent, in reality each is heavily dominated by a corporation with interests there. Colonies within the American and the Anglo-Japanese Arms have strong allegiances either to the governing power in that part of space, or to a corporation with strong business interests on the planet. For colonies outside of the UPP, roll randomly for an allegiance, choose one, or create your own.

Campaign Hooks

You can add a campaign hook in order to make the world seem alive and dynamic – things are happening when the PCs get there! ▶

"There have been people living there for 20 years and they've never complained about any hostile organisms."

"What do you mean? What people?"

"Terraformers, planet engineers. They go in, set up these big atmosphere processors to make the air breathable. Takes decades. It's what we call a shake-n-bake colony."

Paul Van Leuwen and Lt. Ellen Ripley

Faction Type

D6	FACTION TYPE
1	Newcomers
2	Corporate representatives
3	Scientists
4	Workers
5	Security/military
6	Colonial leadership

Colony Allegiance

3D6	INDEPENDENT CORE SYSTEM COLONIES	AMERICAN OR ANGLO-JAPANESE ARM
3–4	Kelland Mining	Kelland Mining
5	GeoFund Investor	GeoFund Investor
6	Gustafsson Enterprise	Gustafsson Enterprise
7–8	Seegson	Weyland-Yutani
9	No allegiance (independent)	Seegson
10–12	Jĭngtì Lóng Corporation	Government representative
13	Chigusa Corporation	Chigusa Corporation
14	Lasalle Bionational	Lasalle Bionational
15	Lorenz SysTech	Jĭngtì Lóng Corporation
16	Gemini Exoplanet	Gemini Exoplanet
17–18	Farside Mining	Farside Mining

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Campaign Hooks

D66	HOOK
11	Pilfering and thefts force security to search rooms and lockers.
12	Incidents of sabotage are increasing – security suspects an organized campaign.
13	Colonial Administration is investigating the colony for illegal practices.
14	Colonists returning to base report sighting a 'monster' on the surface.
15	Petty crime, thefts and sabotage are rife.
16	Equipment failure has resulted in rationing at the colony. Tempers are frayed.
21	A ship recently arrived with some kind of parasite that will soon spread through the colony.
22	Stolen goods are on offer – cheap!
23	Unbeknownst to you, an old friend/flame is at the colony.
24	Unbeknownst to you, an old enemy/rival is at the colony.
25	A minor dignitary/notable is visiting in the company of several aides or guards.
26	Part of the colony is off-limits temporarily – no reason given.
31	Sudden restriction on free movement, unless you can find a way to avoid it.
32	An emergency means repair parts and vital supplies are being shipped in from a nearby colony.
33	Local crisis about to hit (storm, earthquake, riot, fire, etc.).
34	Period of solar flare – will cut communications for 2D6 hours (2D6 days if star type MV).
35	Spies from a neighboring colony have been discovered and arrested.
36	Operations manager and his deputy are in conflict; everyone is choosing sides.
41	PCs are invited to a formal dinner, meeting or party.
42	The local colonists are not what they seem.
43	A military ship is in orbit and the landing party is searching for someone/something.
44	A rival colony or corporation is about to carry out an act of sabotage.
45	The spaceport is currently quarantined.
46	Security situation at the colony.
51	A bunch of asteroid miners causing trouble while on leave.
52	Mystery ship landed at the spaceport.
53	Civil unrest is about to break out.
54	Colonists are trapped and need rescuing far from the settlement itself.
55	Authorities have just locked down the colony after a riot.
56	A religious leader is whipping up discontent.
61	PCs will be harassed by angry locals. Why the anger? And why directed at off-world personnel?
62	An expedition is being assembled for a trek overland – the PCs are invited.
63	An important colonial official is murdered, only an hour after you arrive.
64	Several colonists have gone missing – a search is underway.
65	A lifeboat has crashed on planet and contained an interesting individual.
66	The corporation or government paying for the colony keeps ordering teams out to search remote areas – but won't say what they are searching for.

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Star System Generator

In many cases, details about the main world are all that is needed for a scenario. But you may want the game to lead to one of the other planets in the star system. The tables that follow can flesh out these other planets with a series of dice rolls.

System Objects

How many planets are in the star system? Roll for each type on the table below. Once determined, roll again to add features to gas giants or asteroid belts in the system.

TERRESTRIAL PLANETS

Create details of terrestrial planets by using the rules for main world creation but stop at colony size. Temperate planets sit in the system's habitable zone. Use planetary temperatures to place the others, with hotter planets closer to the star.

ICE PLANETS

Create details of ice planets by using the rules for main world creation, except the temperature should be set at frozen. Stop rolling dice when you reach colony size. Ice planets exist beyond the habitable zone.

Gas Giants

A gas giant will have D6+4 significant moons which can be created just like terrestrial planets. Most gas giants exist in the outer star system, but sometimes they can orbit close to the star.

Asteroid Belts

These can occur anywhere in the system. ●

System Objects

OBJECT	NUMBER	MODIFIERS
Gas Giants	D6–1	–1 if subgiant, –4 if white dwarf
Terrestrial Planets	D6	–3 if red dwarf, –3 if white dwarf
Ice Planets	D6+1	–1 if subgiant, –1 if giant, –1 if white main sequence
Asteroid Belts	D6–3	–2 if white dwarf, –2 if subgiant

Gas Giants

D6	FEATURE
1	Storms
2	Single super storm
3	Rings
4	High winds
5	Intense radiation fields
6	Small gas giant

Asteroid Belts

D6	FEATURE
1	Bright and highly visible
2	High orbital inclination
3	Dust belt
4	Contains several large dwarf planets
5	Very wide – covering several orbits
6	Intensely mineral rich asteroids

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JOB GENERATOR

THIS CHAPTER PROVIDES YOU with tools and inspiration for quick creation of jobs and missions for your players. First, roll up the basics for the job using the guidelines below. Then, use the tables for each individual campaign frame to add the details.

- **System:** Roll D6–1 to determine the distance to the destination system. Pick a system on the star map on the inside covers of this book (or in the Hope's Last Day Starter Set) at this distance from the PCs' current location. On a result of zero, the destination is in the same star system
- **Difficulty:** Roll a D3 to determine the general difficulty of the job – a 1 indicates a routine mission while a 3 indicates something difficult and out of the ordinary. The difficulty will determine the number of complications during the job
- **Payment:** To determine the base payment offered for the job, add the two results above (getting a total sum from 1 to 8). Multiply the sum by the number of PCs, and then by $1,000. With a successful **MANIPULATION** roll, the PCs can negotiate to increase the payment by 20% per ✦ rolled, or instead spend ✦ to gain some bonus reward.

Cargo Runs

THE FOLLOWING TABLES are for use with the space trucker campaign frame.

Employer

Roll on the adjacent table to determine who offers the job to the PCs.

Bonus Rewards

For each ✦ spent on getting a bonus reward when negotiating the payment (above), roll on the adjacent table.

Cargo

Roll on the table on the next page to determine what cargo the PCs are to carry. ▶

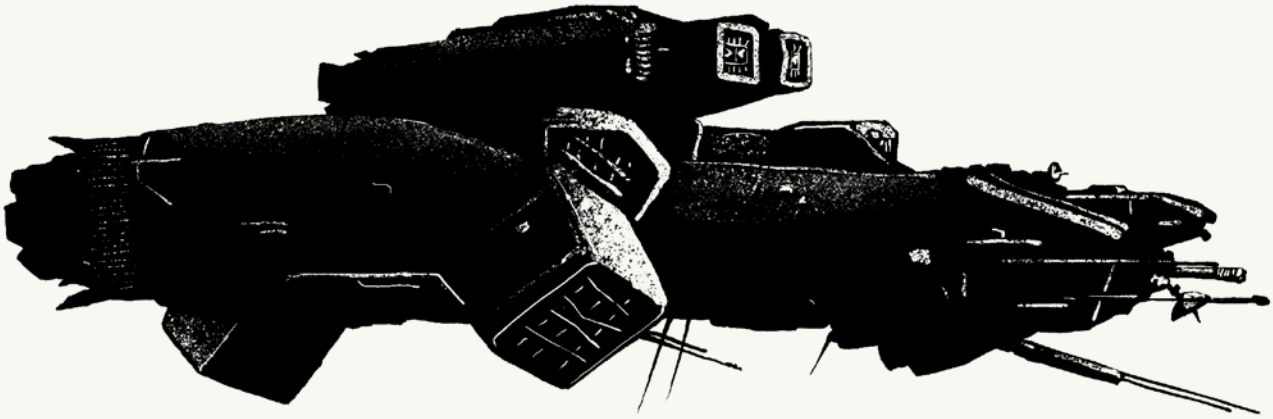
Employer

D66	EMPLOYER
11–16	Colony representative
21–24	Colonial Administration
25–36	Mining representative, roll D6 for the specific corporation:
	1–2 Chigusa
	3 Weyland-Yutani
	4 Gorham
	5 Kelland Mining
	6 Farside Mining
41–43	Shipping Corporation
44–46	USCMC Colonel or other military officer
51–52	Wealthy Individual
53–56	Geofund (or other group of investors)
61–66	Major corporation, roll D66 for specific corporation:
	11–13 Alphatech
	14–16 Chigusa
	21–23 Gemba
	24–26 Jĭngtì Lóng
	31–33 Lorenz
	34–36 Lockmart
	41–43 Seegson
	44–46 Lasalle Bionational
	51–53 Gemini Exoplanet
	54–66 Weyland-Yutani

Bonus Rewards

D66	BONUS REWARD
11–13	Discount on new cargo
14–16	New, guaranteed contract
21–46	Additional financial bonus
51–53	Ship module/feature
54–56	Faction contact
61–66	Debt cancellation (or credit granted)

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Cargo

D66	GOODS
11–12	**Industrial Gases.** Propylene, acetylene, propane, ethyl-formate, chlorofluorocarbon, ammonia, carbon monoxide, ethylene oxide, hydrogen chloride, sulfur dioxide, sulfur hexafluoride
13–14	**Metal Ingots Or Pellets.** Gold, platinum, palladium, silver, tungsten, copper, iron, etc.
15–16	**Colonists.** Humans in stasis, ready to begin a colonization project
21	**Timber.** Exotic alien tree products destined for Earth
22	**Ice/Water.** Water, water ice or some other rare frozen solution
23	**Industrial Chemicals.** Aluminum chloride, aluminum sulfate, calcium acetate, monosodium phosphate, ferric sulphate, sodium hydroxide, hydrochloric acid, sodium aluminate, polyaluminum chloride, ferrous chloride, borate, potassium acetate etc.
24	**Fertilizer.** Multi-nutrient fertilizer compounds made up of nitrogen, potassium and/or phosphate
25–26	**Oil.** Crude oil, or liquid petroleum by-products
31–32	**Foodstuff.** Bulk foods such as chickpeas, soybeans and other legumes, grains (corn, barley, rice, wheat) or refined versions thereof
33–36	**Ore.** Bauxite (aluminum), galena (lead), pentlandite (nickel), gold-quartz, cassiterite (tin), malachite (copper), magnetite (iron), platinum-bearing sand, trimonite (tungsten)
41	**Medicinal Goods.** Vaccines, medicines, disinfectants, surgical gear, scanning machines, hospital beds
42–43	**Technical Parts.** Different makes and types, for suits, refineries, vehicles, power stations, hospitals, prospecting gear, factories, atmospheric processors, weaponry or life support systems
44–45	**Starship Technical Parts.** Modules, features, parts for/from dismantled ships
46	**Pressure Suits.** Space suits for delivery to the colonies
51	**Single Oversized Item.** Wind turbines, power station generator, space station hull frame, solar panel assembly, drilling machinery, ore processing mill or furnace
52	**Vehicles.** Diggers, tractors, quad-tracks, all-terrain vehicles, power loaders
53–54	**Weapons & Armor.** Firearms, ammunition and armor for the colonies or remote stations
55–56	**Radioactives.** Processed uranium cakes or uranium dioxide powder, or fusion plant fuel pellets such as deuterium, tritium, protium or helium-3
61–62	**Colony Construction.** Beams, modules, airlocks, outer shells, roofing material, etc.
63	**Animal Feed.** Feed concentrates containing grains, high-protein oil meals and byproducts of sugar beet and sugarcane processing
64–65	**Livestock/Animals.** Cattle in stasis, ready for rearing on an off-world colony
66	**Wreckage/Salvage.** Shuttle, or escape/cargo pod requiring investigation and study

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Destination

Roll on the table below to determine where the PCs are going.

Complications

Roll on the table a number of times equal to the difficulty of the job (1–3, see page 244).

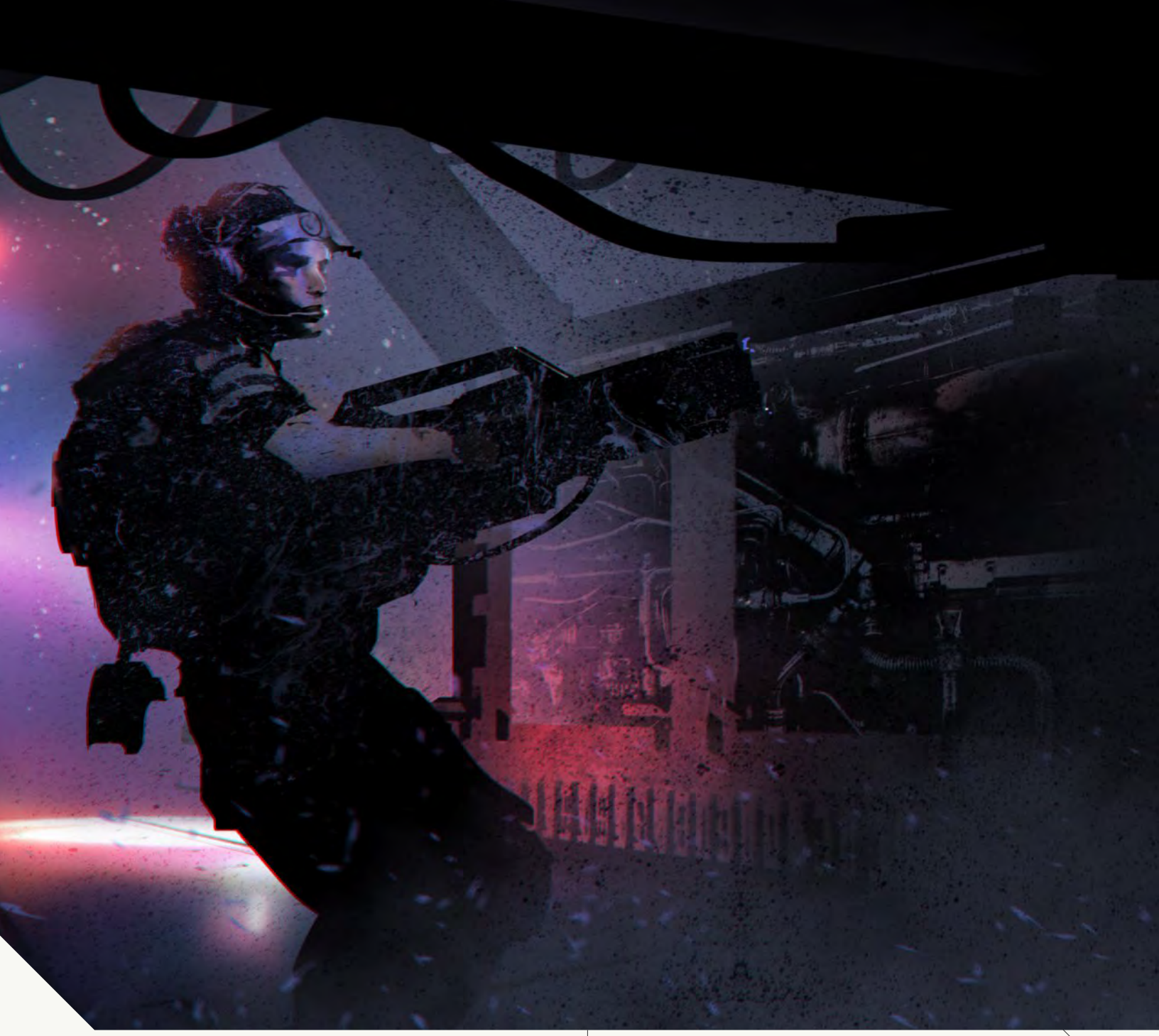
Destination

D66	DESTINATION
11–13	**Only Coordinates.** Coordinates for an area in deep space.
14–16	**Hostile Forest/Jungles/Desert.** Landing site is planet–side wilderness, far from human habitation, or on an uninhabited world.
21–26	**Mine.** A mining facility, far from a colony or starport.
31–33	**Spaceport.** Spaceport on an asteroid or moon, or a landing field near a larger settlement.
34–36	**Asteroid/Moon.** The surface of an asteroid or a smaller moon. Vacuum or dangerous atmosphere.
41–43	**Space Station.** An orbiting space station.
44–46	**Earth, Gateway Station.** The busy hub of interstellar traffic and commerce.
51–53	**Young Colony.** A small colony with only a few hundred inhabitants.
54–56	**Established Colony.** A busy colony with several thousand people and a thriving, local industry.
61–63	**Starship.** A starship in orbit, awaiting your arrival (roll a D6 to determine type).
	1 M–Class Starfreighter / 4 M–Class Commercial Transport Ship
	2 G–Class Deep Space Salvage Vessel / 5–6 Other type of vessel
	3 M–Class Commercial Towing Vehicle
64–66	**Outpost.** A small outpost, usually planet side. An outpost is commonly just a single complex with a specific function; corporate, military or scientific.

Complications

D66	COMPLICATION
11–13	**Embargo/Quarantine.** The destination is placed under ICC quarantine or an embargo.
14–16	**Intermission.** MU/TH/UR brings the ship out of hyperspace early, and then wakes the crew.
21–26	**Military.** A Conestoga frigate, or other military ship, sends over a small search party for a "routine" security check. Should the PCs be worried?
31–33	**Delay.** There is a delay in lift–off/undocking; perhaps fuel for the reaction drives or coolant cannot be pumped aboard, or there may be a strike, an administrative hold–up or loading equipment may have broken down.
34–43	**Maintenance.** A critical part (drive pump, plasma coil, coolant pump, water recycler, gravity compensator control unit, sensor gimbal motor, etc.) requires replacement before it fails, requiring most of the crew's participation.
44–53	**Waiting Game.** Problems at the destination mean they aren't ready to accept the cargo. Can the crew help speed things along?
54–56	**Cargo Mishap.** There is a serious problem with the cargo, either moving, leaking, over–heating or catching fire.
61–66	**Wreckage.** A small piece of wreckage is spotted on the sensor scope – a cargo container, EEV, frozen corpse, part of a starship, etc.

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Military Missions

THE FOLLOWING TABLES are for use with the colonial marines campaign frame.

Bonus Rewards

This table is used for mercenary outfits, not employed USCMC personnel. For each ✦ spent on getting a bonus reward when negotiating the payment (page 244), roll on the adjacent table. ▶

Bonus Rewards

D6	BONUS REWARD
1	Faction contact
2	Ship module
3–4	New gear
5–6	New weapon

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Missions

D66	DESTINATION
11–13	**Recon.** Scout a location, gathering intelligence and then reporting back.
14–15	**Assault.** Attack and hold an objective by force.
16–21	**Defense.** Defend a location/person/group and repel any attack until relived or until a set time.
22–23	**Combat patrol.** Patrol an area, looking for signs of the enemy – then attack.
24–26	**Sabotage.** Infiltrate an enemy location and destroy a key asset (bridge, uplink tower, radar dish, etc.).
31–32	**Raid.** Create chaos and destruction by attacking targets of opportunity behind enemy lines.
33–35	**Search And Rescue.** Search for a downed pilot, lost colonists, etc.
36–42	**Peacekeeping.** Quell a riot, re–establish order and protect lines of communication and essential services until authority can be restored.
43–46	**Bug Hunt.** Exterminate local alien life that is threatening colonists on an off–world planet.
51–52	**Civil Evacuation.** A colonial or space station population needs immediate rescue from a crisis or natural catastrophe.
53–54	**Space Assault.** A space station, orbital platform or starship must be captured (or recaptured) by boarding and seizure.
55	**Space Traffic Security.** The marines are aboard a Conestoga frigate that makes customs and security checks on civilian ships in the area, looking for drugs, illegal goods, arms, workers being trafficked etc.
56–62	**Snatch And Grab.** Locate and seize an item, person or group from behind enemy lines. It may be hostages, POWs, an enemy commander or a piece of high technology.
63–66	**Investigation.** A station, colony or installation is not responding to Network communications. Investigate.

Mission

Roll on the adjacent table to determine what the PCs' mission is.

Destination

Roll on the table below to determine where the PCs are going

Complications

Roll on the table on the next page a number of times equal to the difficulty of the job (1–3, see page 244). ▶

Destinations

D66	DESTINATION
11–23	**Colony.** Either an established or young colony.
24–26	**Isolated Outpost.** A research station or remote military outpost.
31–32	**Starship In Orbit.** An enemy ship, or an abandoned ship.
33–34	**Orbital Space Station.** A transfer station, space colony or orbital survey platform.
35–36	**Wilderness Location.** Far from civilization, a remote spot on a planetary surface.
41–43	**Planetary Warzone.** An active warzone, fought between colonies, corporations or nation states, with ruined buildings, wrecked vehicles and fortifications.
44–46	**Isolated Spaceport.** A landing field far from any colony, owned by a corporation, individual or military.
51–52	**Scattered Homesteads.** Colonial farmsteads, remote from civilization and scattered across the planetary surface.
53–55	**Mine And Refinery.** A huge mining and refining complex, with hundreds of workers and executives.
56–61	**Prison Complex.** Remote penal colony, housing hardened and violent inmates.
62–63	**Radar/Sensor Site.** An automated sensor site, perhaps with its own defenses.
64–66	**Impenetrable Area.** Harsh, inhospitable wilderness location such as thick jungles, deep caverns or volcanic lava fields.

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Complications

D66	COMPLICATION
11–12	**Role Reversal.** The marines find out that the bad guys are actually good guys.
13–15	**Passengers.** During the mission, the marines may find themselves saddled with enemy prisoners or innocent civilians that they must now guard/protect.
16	**Observer.** The team is saddled with a senior officer or a reporter from The Colonial Times, who gets in the way and asks stupid questions.
21–23	**Company Meddling.** A corporate representative joins the team and is there to ensure the company's assets and interests are protected.
24–25	**Civilian Advisor.** Technical knowledge or on–site advice is provided by a civilian advisor who has little knowledge of military operations. They may get scared or panic easily.
26–32	**Captured.** An NPC or even a PC is captured by hostile forces.
33–36	**Gear Problems.** The team has faulty gear. It could be anything from ammo or weapons to sensors or vehicles.
41–44	**Tough Resistance.** The opponents are far tougher and more ruthless than expected.
45–46	**Trapped.** During the mission, the team discovers that it is completely trapped, either physically, or tactically.
51–53	**Under Fire!** The mission location is hit by an airstrike, mines, or heavy weapons – triggered by the enemy, or, if they are unlucky, by their own forces!
54–55	**Glory Hound.** A new commanding officer, a lieutenant, is keen to get himself a medal or commendation, and pushes the marine squad into perilous situations. Someone is going to get killed!
56–62	**Traps.** There are hidden dangers across the mission site, varying with the nature of the location. They may be mines, IEDs, predatory carnivorous plants or improvised booby traps.
63–64	**Restrictions.** There are tactical restrictions placed on the mission – how the squad acts, where it can go, what weapons it can use, etc.
65–66	**Green Commander.** A new platoon commander is a green, untested and untried lieutenant. He's read the books, survived the training and ran the simulations – but he'll go to pieces once the bullets start flying.



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Expeditions

THE FOLLOWING TABLES are for use with the frontier colonists campaign frame.

Sponsors

D66	SPONSOR
11–16	Colonial Administration
21–26	Scientist
31–36	Geofund (or other group of investors)
41–46	Major corporation, roll D66 for the specific corporation:
	11–13 Alphatech
	14–16 Chigusa
	21–23 Gemba
	24–26 Jīngtì Lóng
	31–33 Lorenz
	34–36 Lockmart
	41–43 Seegson
51–56	Mining corporation, roll D6 for the specific corporation:
	1 Chigusa
	2–3 Weyland–Yutani
	4 Gorham Mining
	5 Kelland Mining
	6 Farside Mining
61–66	Government representative, roll D6 to determine the government:
	1–2 Three World Empire
	3–5 United Americas
	6 Independent Core Systems Colonies (ICSC)

Bonus Rewards

D6	BONUS REWARD
1–2	Ship module
3–4	Gear
5–6	Knowledge to use or sell

Sponsors

Roll on the adjacent table to determine who offers the job to the PCs.

Bonus Rewards

For each ✦ spent on getting a bonus reward when negotiating the payment (page 244), roll on the table below

Missions

D66	DESTINATION
11–16	**Salvage.** Locate an abandoned or destroyed ship, station or planetary facility. Recover items of value and avoid the wreck's fate...
21–24	**Survey.** Map a location or an area for the employer. Report back with sensor maps and other collected data.
25–32	**Mining.** Begin test-mining to determine the viability for later investors. The substance being recovered may be cobalt, gold, tungsten, oil, natural gas, lead or something else.
33–36	**Colony Assistance.** Assist a start-up colony with gear, information or expert knowledge about surface exploration, medicine, prospecting, construction or something else.
41–45	**Prospecting.** Command a prospecting expedition or secure a claim somewhere. It could be mining, asteroid harvesting, logging or gas trawling.
46–52	**Data Collection.** Find a specific piece of information for the employer. Sometimes, the group does not know the intended use of the information.
53–55	**Courier.** Make sure sensitive information, resources or goods are delivered safely from the employer to the receiver – without delay.
56–62	**Anomaly Exploration.** A unique phenomenon requires speedy investigation – is it a threat, or something that can be exploited for profit? It may be a wormhole, gravity lens, powerful radiation emission or other anomaly.
63–66	**Rescue Expedition.** Rescue a group, colony, survey expedition or correspondents from an attack or some other peril. Often, the PCs will be unaware of the fate of the missing victims.

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Mission

Roll on the table on the previous page to determine what the PCs' mission is.

Destination

D66	DESTINATION
11–14	**Abandoned Orbital Station.** Forgotten, abandoned, barely operative, drifting.
15–21	**Rogue Asteroid.** A fast–moving interstellar asteroid or planet passing through a star system.
22–24	**Abandoned Mine.** A failed Kelland mining project with tunnels and buildings, now abandoned and decayed.
25–31	**Moon.** The rocky moon of a gas giant or planet.
32–35	**Asteroid Belt.** An asteroid that sits deep within a complex and dense asteroid belt.
36	**Colonized World.** The target area sits in wilderness on a world that already contains colonists.
41–43	**Terrestrial Planet.** The target area sits on an uninhabited terrestrial planet.
44	**Abandoned Colony.** A failed colony with buildings and structures abandoned and decaying.
45–51	**Ice Planet.** The target area sits on an uninhabited ice planet.
52–63	**Wreckage.** The smashed wreckage of a spacecraft. Roll D6 for type and roll on the destination table again for its current location.
	1 M–Class Starfreighter
	2 G–Class Deep Space Salvage Vessel
	3 M–Class Commercial Towing Vehicle
	4 M–Class Commercial Transport Ship
	5–6 Other type of vessel
64–66	**Outpost.** A small outpost, usually planet side. An outpost is commonly just a single complex with a specific function; corporate, military or scientific.

Destination

Roll on the adjacent table to determine where the PCs are going.

Complications

Roll on the table a number of times equal to the difficulty of the job (1–3, see page 244). ▶

Complications

D66	COMPLICATION
11–21	**Natural Phenomenon.** Some severe natural event occurs during the mission: a rapid temperature change, forest fire, hurricane, tsunami, earthquake, mudslide, etc.
22–32	**Survey Blues.** The target area is either difficult to locate, or difficult to survey safely or efficiently.
33–35	**Presumed Missing.** If the PCs gained a permit to survey their target area, they may or may not realize it is inherited from a previous expedition that vanished without a trace.
36–44	**Rival Expedition.** A competing party has the same goal as the expedition and tries to get there first or stop the PCs. They have roughly the same gear as the PCs.
45–52	**Quarantine.** The target area is under quarantine or off-limits, possibly for reasons unknown. The expedition has no permit and will be breaking the law if they choose to proceed.
53–62	**Deadly Treasure.** Some terrible object(s) exist in the target area, unbeknownst to the PCs. This deadly find may be nuclear waste, a dump of biological weapons, a nest of xenomorph eggs or something equally horrific and life-threatening!
63–66	**Surveillance.** The expedition is under surveillance by the military, government or some other party. They will not intervene, although they may communicate their presence to the team. Why are they watching? What do they really want?

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Plot Twists

THE TABLE BELOW can be used to add an unpredictable element to the job of any campaign frame. The entries are intended to create even more drama than the complications. ●

Plot Twists

D66	TWIST
11–15	**Mayday.** Before (or after) the starship is in hyperspace, the crew receive a distress signal and are obligated by law to assist. Alternatively, the call may come whilst on–planet.
16–22	**Bad Intel.** Key mission information will prove false or misleading.
23–25	**Sabotage.** MU/TH/UR malfunctions – there is a fire, or an explosive decompression. It soon turns out to be sabotage, but who is the saboteur?
26–35	**Secret Plot.** NPCs or PCs in the game have another agenda that runs counter to that of the players and are busy working on it.
36–43	**Murder.** An NPC is suddenly murdered. Who did it? Why?
44–46	**Flare Event.** A burst of stellar radiation reaches the PCs location from a red dwarf flare star, a distant neutron star or other phenomenon. This could cause power interruptions, or at the very least complete communications blackouts.
51–55	**Malfunction.** A key component to the mission fails when needed – an airlock or drive, a demolitions charge or diamond cutting drill. What now?
56–64	**Time Limit.** The mission has a deadline; lives (perhaps their own) depend on it.
65–66	**Xenomorph Outbreak.** At the heart of this scenario is the presence of the Xenomorph XX121. It may be one egg or dozens, or the massacred remains of an unfortunate group of humans with a Xenomorph warrior still on the prowl. Good luck...

ENCOUNTERS

ADVENTURE, DANGER AND HORROR sit beyond the comforts of Earth, out in the off-world colonies, in the depths of space and on unexplored worlds. Travel by starship through hyperspace to reach these destinations will bring the PCs into contact with other ships, hazards and problems.

The tables on the following pages should only be used if doing so adds something to the game. You are completely free to ignore them and let the journey be problem-free, or simply skip the traveling and open the scenario as the group arrives at its destination.

Star System Encounters

Space is vast and empty, but humans still tend to cluster around habitable planets and ore-rich worlds. The PCs will sometimes encounter other starships, if only on their sensor screens or over the comms channel.

Roll on the star system encounters table before going into hyperspace, and once again after coming out of hyperspace. Ships lingering in a star system can roll once per day if near a habitable planet, or once per week if further out in the star system. Those brave souls in unexplored star systems only roll once per month.

Ship Reactions

Most ships are busy trying to keep to a schedule, but sometimes a ship will make contact. Roll on the table below to find out if this is so.

Surface Encounters

On a planet's surface, encounters each day may involve natural hazards as well as inconveniences to cross-country travel.

General Colony Encounters

Daily encounters inside colonial settlements are usually significant or noteworthy and probably involve an interaction or conversation. Add a +1 to the tens digit if the colony is established (page 240). ●

"Did you hear about the claustrophobic astronaut? He needed space."

Andy

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

Star System Encounters

D66	ENCOUNTER
<10	No encounter
11	Research vessel
12	Asteroid drill ship
13	Small survey ship
14	M–class commercial starfreighter
15	Military recon craft
16	Private executive transport
21	M–class commercial transport ship
22	Light shuttle
23	G–class deep space salvage vessel
24	Liquefied gas transport
25	M–class commercial towing vehicle (towing what?)
26	G–class deep space salvage vessel
31	M–class commercial starfreighter
32	Colony supply vessel
33	Refinery platform (automated)
34	G–class deep space salvage vessel
35	Conestoga frigate on patrol
36	G–class deep space emergency response vessel
41	Military heavy missile cruiser
42	M–class commercial towing vehicle (not towing anything)
43	Heavy shuttle
44	Fast courier vessel
45	M–class commercial transport ship
46	Large space–station
51	Light tugship
52	Starcub shuttle
53	M–class commercial transport ship
54	Communications relay station
55	UD–4 dropship in orbit
56	Starcub shuttle
61	Customs cutter
62	Heavy shuttle
63	Conestoga frigate on operations
64	Corporate space–station
65	Private security cutter
66	Mobile construction rig

Modify the tens digit roll for the factors below.
A result of 0 or less indicates no encounter.

- **Outer Rim or Frontier** –3
- **Uncharted Space** –5

EXAMPLE — STAR SYSTEM ENCOUNTER

The PCs are in the 8 Eta Boötis system (Outer Rim), heading for a colony world. The GM rolls a 3 (tens digit) and a 6 (ones digit), the tens digit (3) is reduced to 0 because of the Outer Rim modifier and so there is no encounter.

Ship Reactions

2D6	REACTION
2	**Unusual.** May be on an unusual trajectory, have the registration of a missing ship or simply refuse to respond to the PCs' signals.
3–4	**Dismissive.** If asked for information or assistance, the ship will decline.
5–8	**Radio Silence.** Ignores the PCs' ship, but polite if contacted.
9–10	**Friendly.** May pass on information or advice, if relevant.
11	**Assistance.** May request information, or ask for assistance or a spare part etc.
12	**Familiar Vessel.** The ship is known to you, you may even know the crew.

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Surface Encounters

3D6	UNINHABITED WORLD	COLONIZED WORLD
3–5	**Temperature Swing.** On a cold world, temperatures will drop dramatically. On a hot world they will rise.	
6–7	**Unstable Ground.** Ice, soft sand, swamp or other tricky ground.	
8	**Diversion.** An escarpment, canyon or other feature forces the PCs in an undesirable direction for a shift.	
9	**Cross A Ravine/River.** A ravine or river can be negotiated with great care, but it takes D6 hours and some tense moments.	
10	**Rough Terrain.** Rocky ground or thick vegetation slows travel to half speed for a shift.	
11	–	–
12	–	**Wildcatters.** Prospectors in a single tractor.
13	–	**Mining Operation.** Temporary drilling or mining operation.
14	–	**Lone Colonist**. On foot or in a vehicle.
15	–	**Scientists.** In a vehicle, studying some natural phenomenon, plant-life or geology.
16	–	**Abandoned Kit.** Useless, valuable or wrecked...
17–18	–	**Explorers.** In a vehicle, mapping the local area and cataloging what they find.

General Colony Encounters

D66	ENCOUNTER
11	Rowdy miners
12	Technicians making repairs
13	Exhausted workers arriving
14	Workers preparing to leave
15	Supplies being delivered
16	Colony workers off–duty
21	Family off–duty together
22	Medical crisis
23	Colony manager and deputy
24	Loud argument
25	Drunken revelers
26	Kids playing
31	Administrator making the rounds
32	Colonial Marshal conducting an investigation
33	Cocky shuttle pilot
34	Unhappy off–world official
35	Sly corporate representative
36	Harassed chief engineer
41	Scientists debating
42	Drug deal in progress
43	Overhear gossip

D66	ENCOUNTER
44	Colonist threatening another
45	Corporate investigator
46	Miners relaxing
51	Colony damage needing repair
52	Operations team having a discussion
53	Computer engineers at work
54	Unattended supplies
55	Maintenance crew
56	Marshal searching or arresting a suspect
61	Visitors from another colony
62	Security cordon
63	Mysterious scientist
64	Management meeting
65	Helpful android
66	Cleaning crew
71	Starship crew off–duty
72	Thugs
73	Security patrol
74	Colonial official with entourage
75	Accident in progress
76	Colonists on strike or protesting

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Public Area Encounters

D66	ENCOUNTER
11–13	Riot or civil disturbance, with security responding
14–16	Workers are relaxing outside a bar or cafe
21–23	Drug deal in progress
24–26	Security team is moving colonists on, keeping the area clear
31–33	Workers at a café or bar, laughing and joking
34–36	Taxi driver or guide offering to show you the best food/hotel/entertainment
41–43	Overhear gossip
44–46	Food vendor with a queue of customers
51–53	Colonial Marshal is arresting a suspect
54–56	A fight breaks out
61–63	Sanitation robot is moving through the area
64–66	Bored teens are looking for trouble

Habitation Area Encounters

D66	ENCOUNTER
11–13	Bored teens are hanging out
14–16	Workers are chilling outside their accommodation
21–23	Drug deal in progress
24–26	Colonial Marshal conducting an investigation
31–33	Colony official is scolding children
34–36	Young kids are playing
41–43	Sanitation robot is moving through the area
44–46	Work crew arriving off shift, joking and laughing
51–53	Repair crew is fixing part of a building or corridor
54–56	Overhear gossip
61–63	Argument between two inhabitants
64–66	Security patrol talking to locals

Operations Area Encounters

D66	ENCOUNTER
11–13	Unhappy off-world official
14–16	Sly corporate representative
21–23	Harassed chief engineer
24–26	Scientists debating
31–33	Colony manager and deputy
34–36	High alert. Everyone is too busy to talk.
41–43	Helpful android
44–46	Three members of the operations staff discuss a serious problem
51–53	Security cordon
54–56	Queue of colonists with pay or work disputes
61–63	Management meeting
64	Nervous colonist waiting to see the colony manager
65–66	Colonial Marshal processing a suspect in cuffs

Spaceport Encounters

D66	ENCOUNTER
11–13	Two pilots relaxing after a flight
14–16	Starship crew in heated debate with port supervisor
21–23	Cargo handlers in powerloaders
24–26	Maintenance crew struggling with a problem
31–33	Emergency. The area is cleared as a precaution.
34–36	ICC customs representative checking consignments
41–43	Starship crew eager to get a beer and then some sleep
44–46	Irate port supervisor shouting at workers
51–53	Problem unloading a cargo
54–56	Fueling crew frustrated at having to wait
61–63	Corporate passenger
64–66	Cargo is piling up ready to loaded on board

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SHORE LEAVE

DURING CAMPAIGN PLAY, life doesn't just come to a stop when the PCs arrive at a colony or space station following a mission. The players may want to enjoy their shore leave in-character, roleplaying some of their downtime away from life-or-death situations and constant stress. This interlude allows PCs to recover, to show a new side of their personality, and pursue their personal agendas. For each week of shore leave, each PC selects one of the following activities:

- **Heal:** A PC with one or more critical injuries will need time to heal (page 71).
- **Recover:** A PC who has suffered mental trauma (page 74) may attempt to recover by resting, soul-searching, seeking counseling, or something else. Make a roll for Empathy. It cannot be pushed. If successful, one mental trauma is removed.
- **Pursue Agenda:** A PC may pursue their personal agenda (page 27) in some way. This can be roleplayed, but keep it short to avoid keeping other players waiting. If the agenda is successfully pursued, the PC gains one XP.
- **Socialize:** PCs who don't need or want to do any of the above may instead socialize with the locals. Roll once on the appropriate table for shore leave events.

Expenses: During shore leave, the PCs must pay their way. For typical weekly living expenses, see page 116. ●

Industrial Area Encounters

D66	ENCOUNTER
11–13	Auditor checking procedures
14–16	Huge argument between two managers
21–23	Android carrying out routine work
24–26	Workers rushing to a shift
31–33	Power loader coming through!
34–36	Repair team fixing crucial infrastructure
41–43	Manager touring with his assistant
44–46	Workers responding to an emergency
51–53	Incident. First aid is being carried out.
54–56	Workers waiting to go on shift
61–63	Security guard checking passes and IDs
64–66	Lone worker waiting for their manager

Shore Leave Events, Colonial Marines

D66	ENCOUNTER
11–13	The gym on the base is quiet, the PCs have it all to themselves.
14–16	Asked to do a favor for a Marine in another platoon. They will pay the PC $300 but there might be a catch.
21–23	A fight breaks out and a PC is involved. What was it about?
24–26	A base logistics sergeant is selling some officer's luxuries at a discount. Roll D6.
	1–2: They got away with it.
	3–4: Logistics are investigating the theft.
	5–6: They stole it from one of the other companies, and they know.
31–33	There is an accident and a PC is hurt. How? Was it their fault?
34–36	There is an official ceremony on the base, and everyone must wear their dress uniforms.
41–44	An old friend arrives. Roll D6.
	1–2: They are in debt.
	3–4: They are in trouble.
	5–6: They offer the PCs a way to make some money.
45–46	The PCs' lieutenant might be replaced. Roll D6.
	1–2: They are being promoted.
	3–4: They are in big trouble (not their fault).
	5–6: They're in big trouble (and it's definitely their own fault). What did they do?
51–53	A senior NCO has got it in for the PCs' platoon and makes life difficult during shore leave.
54–56	The base commander cancels the PCs' platoon's shore leave, with immediate effect. What has your unit done to deserve this punishment?
61–63	There is training scheduled, and as a reward for completion, the instructor gives out tickets for laser tag, a movie or a gym session at the base.
64–66	A member of the platoon is marking a special occasion and invited everyone to an informal dinner, with a speech. Roll for a social encounter.

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Shore Leave Events, Others

D66	FEATURE
11–13	The PCs get a hotel upgrade, with executive-level luxury.
14–16	The PCs get offered a side job that will take a couple of days and pay D6 × $200, but is it legal?
21–23	Asteroid miners are in port all week causing trouble for port officials, other travelers ... and the PCs.
24–26	There is a ceremony or celebration at the location.
31–33	Red tape – the PCs' papers contain irregularities. Can they negotiate or bribe their way out of this mess?
34–36	One of the PCs' skills is recognized by a port employee. They have a problem that needs resolving – could the PC help them with it for D6 × $200?
41–44	The PCs overhear some interesting scandal about a local official, leader, corporate executive or gangster. What do they do with that knowledge?
45–46	A ship known to the PCs has limped into port this week with damage and crew casualties. What happened?
51–53	A thief has targeted the PCs and unless spotted, will get away with their valuables (on their person, or from their room).
54–56	The PCs find themselves with a group of locals and gain useful information.
61–63	The PCs are offered some local commodity, object or material that can be purchased for D6 × $400, and sold at any other world with a 50% profit. Roll a stress die – on a ☹ or ⊕, this is a scam.
64–66	The PCs find some kind of haven – a local beauty spot, an unused lounge, a little-known bar or restaurant. This brings the PCs peace and tranquility and is a great place to hide way.

NON-PLAYER CHARACTERS

THE UNIVERSE IS POPULATED by people other than the PCs, from forklift drivers to paramedics, marines on leave to starport officials – and everyone in between. You can use the adjacent list whenever you need an NPC. ●

NPC	ATTRIBUTES
Android, covert	Strength 7, Agility 6, Wits 3, Empathy 1
Android, curious	Strength 4, Agility 3, Wits 7, Empathy 3
Android, refurbished	Strength 6, Agility 6, Wits 3, Empathy 2
Asteroid miner	Strength 4, Agility 4, Wits 3, Empathy 3
Colonial Marshal	Strength 4, Agility 4, Wits 4, Empathy 2
Colonist child	Strength 1, Agility 5, Wits 4, Empathy 4
Colony manager	Strength 2, Agility 4, Wits 3, Empathy 5
Company bureaucrat	Strength 2, Agility 3, Wits 4, Empathy 5
Comtech	Strength 2, Agility 3, Wits 5, Empathy 4
Corporate executive	Strength 2, Agility 3, Wits 5, Empathy 4
Corporate killer	Strength 4, Agility 5, Wits 4, Empathy 1
Cultist	Strength 4, Agility 3, Wits 2, Empathy 5
Homesteader	Strength 5, Agility 3, Wits 3, Empathy 3
ICC Inspector	Strength 3, Agility 3, Wits 5, Empathy 3
Medical doctor	Strength 2, Agility 3, Wits 5, Empathy 4
Mercenary/soldier	Strength 5, Agility 4, Wits 3, Empathy 2
Mining wildcatter	Strength 5, Agility 3, Wits 3, Empathy 3
Pilot	Strength 3, Agility 5, Wits 3, Empathy 3
Rogue scientist	Strength 3, Agility 4, Wits 5, Empathy 2
Salvage expert	Strength 5, Agility 4, Wits 2, Empathy 5
Security guard	Strength 4, Agility 4, Wits 3, Empathy 3
Ship's engineer	Strength 4, Agility 2, Wits 5, Empathy 3
Smuggler	Strength 3, Agility 4, Wits 4, Empathy 3
Squad leader	Strength 5, Agility 3, Wits 3, Empathy 3
Thug	Strength 4, Agility 5, Wits 3, Empathy 2

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HEALTH	SKILLS	TALENTS	GEAR
7	**CLOSE COMBAT** 3, **HEAVY MACHINERY** 2, **RANGED COMBAT** 2, **COMTECH** 2, **SURVIVAL** 1	Cunning	–
4	**STAMINA** 2, **MOBILITY** 2, **COMTECH** 3, **OBSERVATION** 3	–	–
6	**HEAVY MACHINERY** 2, **PILOTING** 4, **COMTECH** 2, **OBSERVATION** 2	Spaceship Mechanic	–
4	**HEAVY MACHINERY** 3, **STAMINA** 2, **PILOTING** 1, **OBSERVATION** 3, **SURVIVAL** 1	EVA Specialist	Survival suit, cutting torch, bolt gun
4	**CLOSE COMBAT** 2, **MOBILITY** 1, **RANGED COMBAT** 3, **OBSERVATION** 2, **MANIPULATION** 1, **MEDICAL AID** 1	Investigator	Pump-action shotgun, handcuffs, flashlight
3	**MOBILITY** 4, **OBSERVATION** 3, **SURVIVAL** 2, **MANIPULATION** 1	Hard to Catch	Toy or doll
3	**HEAVY MACHINERY** 1, **STAMINA** 2, **COMTECH** 1, **SURVIVAL** 1, **COMMAND** 3, **MANIPULATION** 2	–	Penlight, motion tracker, Seegson P–DAT
3	**OBSERVATION** 3, **COMTECH** 3, **MANIPULATION** 2, **MEDICAL AID** 2	Personal Safety	PDT, Seegson P–DAT
3	**PILOTING** 2, **COMTECH** 4, **OBSERVATION** 2	Stoic	Systems diagnostic device, electronic tools
3	**OBSERVATION** 3, **COMMAND** 3, **MANIPULATION** 4	Cunning	Penlight, PDT, voice recorder, $2,000
5	**CLOSE COMBAT** 3, **MOBILITY** 1, **RANGED COMBAT** 4, **OBSERVATION** 2	Stealthy	M42A Scope Rifle, combat knife, medkit
4	**CLOSE COMBAT** 3, **RANGED COMBAT** 2, **OBSERVATION** 2, **MANIPULATION** 3	–	Knife, recreational drugs, .357 revolver
4	**HEAVY MACHINERY** 4, **STAMINA** 2, **PILOTING** 1, **COMTECH** 2, **MEDICAL AID** 1	–	Armat Model 37A2 12 gauge pump action shotgun, flashlight
3	**COMTECH** 2, **OBSERVATION** 4, **COMMAND** 2, **MANIPULATION** 2	Investigator	Seegson P-DAT, voice recorder
3	**STAMINA** 3, **MOBILITY** 2, **OBSERVATION** 3, **MANIPULATION** 3, **MEDICAL AID** 4	Surgeon	Medkit, surgical kit, four doses of Naproleve
5	**CLOSE COMBAT** 2, **STAMINA** 2, **MOBILITY** 2, **RANGED COMBAT** 3, **SURVIVAL** 1	Combat Veteran	Medkit, M41A Pulse Rifle, four grenades
5	**CLOSE COMBAT** 1, **HEAVY MACHINERY** 3, **STAMINA** 2, **COMTECH** 1, **SURVIVAL** 3	Hardened	Seismic survey charge, Seegson P-DAT
4	**PILOTING** 3, **RANGED COMBAT** 3, **COMTECH** 2, **OBSERVATION** 1, **SURVIVAL** 1	Full Throttle	Service pistol, compression suit
4	**MOBILITY** 1, **COMTECH** 3, **OBSERVATION** 4, **SURVIVAL** 2	Analysis	Electrostatic Pistol, system diagnostic device, electronic tools
5	**HEAVY MACHINERY** 3, **STAMINA** 2, **MOBILITY** 3, **SURVIVAL** 2	Spaceship Mechanic	Cutting torch, maintenance jack
4	**CLOSE COMBAT** 2, **RANGED COMBAT** 2, **OBSERVATION** 3, **MEDICAL AID** 1	–	.357 revolver, stun baton, medkit
3	**CLOSE COMBAT** 1, **HEAVY MACHINERY** 4, **STAMINA** 3, **COMTECH** 1, **OBSERVATION** 1	Spaceship Mechanic	Bolt gun, system diagnostic device
4	**CLOSE COMBAT** 3, **MOBILITY** 2, **PILOTING** 1, **RANGED COMBAT** 2, **MANIPULATION** 2	Stealthy	Rexim EVA Pistol
4	**CLOSE COMBAT** 2, **STAMINA** 2, **RANGED COMBAT** 3, **SURVIVAL** 1, **COMMAND** 2	Field Commander	Medkit, M41A Pulse Rifle, Seegson P-DAT
5	**CLOSE COMBAT** 2, **STAMINA** 2, **MOBILITY** 2, **RANGED COMBAT** 2, **SURVIVAL** 2	–	Knife

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TARTARUS SECTOR

"Hell, there are no rules out here – this is Tartarus!"

Alessandro de Sosa, Warden of Skyfire Down Corrections Facility, LV-2412

WELCOME TO TARTARUS SECTOR. This area in the Outer Rim Territories, briefly described in chapter 9, is expanded here as a possible campaign setting for the game.

With twelve planetary systems described in detail, and a summary of what's going down across the sector, here you will find everything you need to run any style of campaign in the frontier sector of Tartarus. Your player group – of space truckers, colonists, explorers, corporates, or colonial marines – will find all the challenge, excitement, and horror they can take.

Brief History

Tartarus sector occupies the rimward-trailward frontier of human settlement, beyond which lies unexplored space. Riven with conflict, its name – the infernal realm of torment of Greek mythology – is an apt description.

The United Americas (UA) has dominated Tartarus sector since it established Torin Prime in 2104, but that dominance is fragile. The sector is unruly, and the UA's military strength is thin and low on supplies. They rely on the Outer Rim Defense Fleet (ORDF), a ragtag militia of UA colonists in uniform. Their main challenge comes from the Three World Empire (3WE), but civil unrest within the 3WE's sphere of influence saw Colonial Marines step in as peacekeepers, but they never give the colonies back. The two superpowers have locked horns across the sector ever since.

Of the others, the Union of Progressive Peoples (UPP) shows the greatest interest in Tartarus. Efforts to support rebel factions, or those seeking independence, while quietly colonizing across the sector, are the extent of the UPP's ambitions thus far – but that is about to change.

With this volatile mix, some fear the Frontier War will come to Tartarus. In an attempt to bring calm, the Independent Core System Colonies (ICSC) established Argos colony, a commercial and political hub, and neutral ground. Deliberately kept separate from the new Anchorpoint station located just beyond the Tartarus Rimward boundary, Argos colony is a place to resolve disputes and keep the peace, while Anchorpoint is the waystation to the Far Reach and deep space.

Life for the average Joe is tough. Food is shit, the worlds are grim, and the wages... With the threat of conflict, it's a wonder any make Tartarus home at all. Unfortunately for most who live there, they don't have any other choice. But despite the hardships, Tartarus is awash with opportunities. ▶

- **System:** Ross 619 ▶ **Colony:** Skyfire Down
- **Public Knowledge:** A UA / Lunnar-Welsun penal colony with an orbital ORDF shipyard. Holds 100,000 convicts.
- **What's Really Going On:** The 3WE has infiltrated the convict population to incite a prison break and create a crisis.

- **System:** Khadaji ▶ **Colony:** The Wells
- **Public Knowledge:** A 3WE outpost that exports water. Controlled by the UA since a rebellion in 2154. The 3WE wants it back.
- **What's Really Going On:** A microbe in the water induces terrifying hallucinations in those who drink it.

- **System:** GJ-229A ▶ **Colony:** Torin Prime
- **Public Knowledge:** A UA colony, a police state since the J'Har rebellion 80 years ago. Notorious for incarcerating dissidents in the GR161 concentration camp.
- **What's Really Going On:** The J'Har are preparing to rebel again, seeking 3WE and UPP support with the promise of a cut of the planet's new-found riches.

- **System:** NN3325 ▶ **Colony:** Devil's Peak
- **Public Knowledge:** The system is barren.
- **What's Really Going On:** Devil's Peak is hidden here.

- **System:** Gamma Leporis ▶ **Colony:** Steer City
- **Public Knowledge:** A trinary system with one Lasalle Bionational colony, Steer City, the breadbasket of the sector. The system had two other colonies – one destroyed, the other deserted.
- **What's Really Going On:** The 3WE wants control of the colony. The UPP is using subterfuge to deploy Lasalle Bionational's own blight virus to destroy the colony's agriculture.

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- **System:** GL408 ▶ **Colony:** Liberty Echo
- **Public Knowledge:** UA and ORDF naval base, UA's sector headquarters.
- **What's Really Going On:** Weyland-Yutani has a bioweapons facility here, with the XX121 Xenomorph.

- **System:** GL300 ▶ **Colony:** Linna 349
- **Public Knowledge:** Once controlled by the 3WE, Linna rebelled ten years ago. The UA were invited to quell the trouble, and they never left.
- **What's Really Going On:** The 3WE is negotiating with the rebels to join forces and drive the UA out.

- **System:** HIP53020 ▶ **Colony:** Pala Station
- **Public Knowledge:** An ordinary system.
- **What's Really Going On:** W-Y are secretly exploiting Engineer archaeology and a Juggernaut. The 3WE has established a colony to monitor the situation.

- **System:** HIP51317 ▶ **Colony:** Mendel Station
- **Public Knowledge:** The site of a W-Y space station destroyed 45 years ago, although rumors say the base survived.
- **What's Really Going On:** Mendel Station survived. There are hypersleeping survivors, Xenomorphs, and valuable research.

- **System:** GL257AB ▶ **Colony:** Tartarus
- **Public Knowledge:** Tartarus colony was destroyed 20 years ago and re-established in 2170. Rich in mineral ore but riven with violent competition and the indigenous Harvester.
- **What's Really Going On:** Violent competition is erupting in the Prospector Wars.

- **System:** GJ2034 ▶ **Colony:** Argos
- **Public Knowledge:** An ICSC sponsored colony, a sector hub and neutral ground for resolving disputes.
- **What's Really Going On:** None of the superpowers approve, as it places a restraining hand on their options.

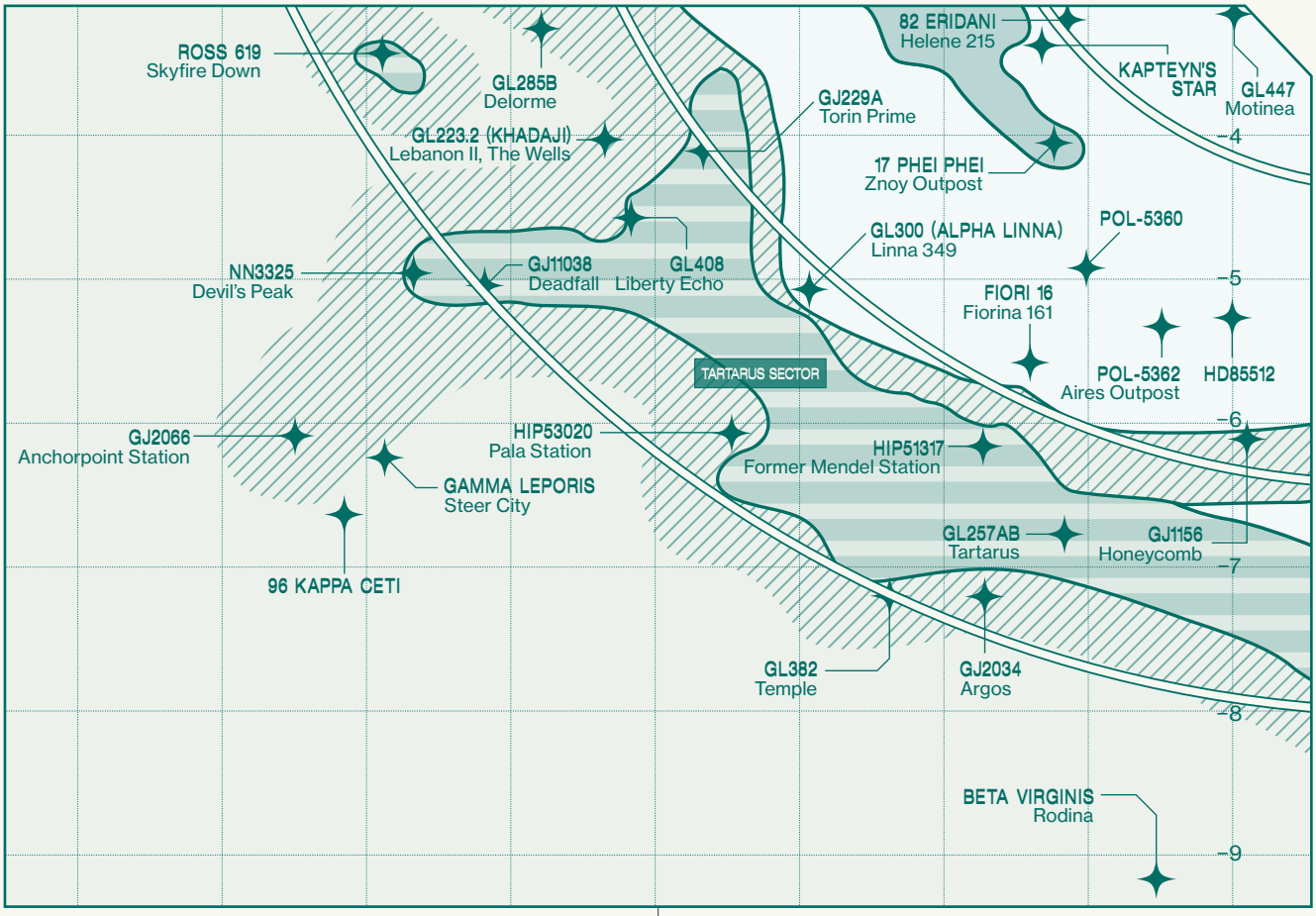
- **System:** Beta Virginis ▶ **Colony:** Rodina
- **Public Knowledge:** An Earthlike planet, Rodina, has two colonies recently established on it.
- **What's Really Going On:** Effects from the host star caused them to fail. The UPP has colonized elsewhere in the system and is actively keeping others away to save Rodina for itself.

- **System:** GL285 ▶ **Colony:** Delorme
- **Public Knowledge:** A rebellious UA colony destroyed by a USCMC nuke strike.
- **What's Really Going On:** The UA slaughtered the colonists

- **System:** GL382 ▶ **Colony:** Temple
- **Public Knowledge:** A barren and unexplored system.
- **What's Really Going On:** A religious order has established a small colony.

- **System:** GJ11038 ▶ **Colony:** Deadfall
- **Public Knowledge:** Deadfall colony was established 50 years ago. No one has heard from them since.
- **What's Really Going On:** What has happened?

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Systems & Colonies

Ross 619 – Skyfire Down

Skyfire Down is a penal colony, controlled by Warden Alessandro de Sosa, a Lunnar-Welsun executive. Protected by the USCMC, the planet is also home to a naval shipyard. It's a grim place, with radiation zones and industrial waste littering the landscape, illuminated by the perpetual display of meteors falling from a ring of orbital junk.

Inmates work in LV-2412's mines and shipyard, and off-world, on projects that need a disposable workforce. Escape attempts are common.

Five years ago, the 3WE shipped thousands of convicts to Skyfire Down, when their detention center on Fiori 16 was decommissioned. Within these ranks they hid a crack unit of Royal Marines with one mission – win over Skyfire Down's convicts and lead a prison break. This revolt is about to break out.

Newly built ships are transferred to Liberty Echo by a skeleton crew. The pirates of the sector have learned of this lapse in security and intend to hijack a Conestoga cruiser from under the UA's nose.

▶ **Designation**	Skyfire Down Correctional Facility, ORDF shipyard
▶ **Affiliation**	UA, Lunnar-Welsun
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, terraformed, temperate, rocky chasms and mines
▶ **Population**	100,000 inmates, 2,000 administration, 8,000 military
▶ **Resources**	Minerals, heavy metals, helium 3, convict labor

Campaign Hooks: The PCs are prisoners, needing to find a way to escape, or someone in Skyfire Down needs breaking out. Perhaps they are working with the Royal Marines, or trying to stop the break-out? And that unprotected Conestoga ... why should pirates get it, when the PCs might get the chance first?

Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

Khadaji – The Wells

The Khadaji system is home to Wells colony. Established in 2124, the colony exports water found in subterranean reservoirs. The locals rebelled in 2154 only to be crushed by a UA force, acting on the 3WE's request. Having secured the colony the Marines never left, and the 3WE wants it back.

However, the water of Wells is more than it appears. It carries an alien microbe that excretes a powerful hallucinogen. Reports have been heard of people going off their axle all across the sector, but they haven't been linked to the water from Wells colony – yet. The USCMC commander at Wells, Colonel Maia Winter, is aware of the microbe, but hopes to pin the blame on the 3WE.

Lebanon II is not the only moon of the KJ331 gas giant – Adana has chasms revealing mineral riches, Paphos is an irradiated rock, and Cinder glows with volcanism and indigenous life. The UPP has quietly colonized all three. They need more supplies for these dangerous settlements, and space truckers to ship them in – tough jobs, but the UPP pays well.

Campaign Hooks: The PCs witness a hallucinogenic outburst – the microbe's victim stalking the alleys of a base, murdering innocents – and must find the truth. Will they blow the scandal wide open or use that information for their own ends? Or are they explorers, sent to scout the other moons of KJ331.

KHADAJI: THE WELLS

▶ **Affiliation**	3WE (UA occupation), Lasalle Bionational, Weyland-Yutani
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, terraformed, temperate, Jovian moon
▶ **Population**	40,000 civilians, 1,000 UA security forces
▶ **Resources**	Iron, uranium, potable water

GJ229A – Torin Prime

Torin Prime didn't welcome the imposition of UA authority when it was formed in 2104. Two years later the so-called J'Har Rebellion blew up. The rebels were crushed, dissidents left to rot in the notorious GR161 prison camp. It says something about the J'Har's resilience that GR161 is as full now as it was 75 years ago.

An independent government in exile, under President Araceli Segarra, makes the J'Har's case, while another faction, under Para Guarani, turned to piracy.

Torin holds a secret – a vast supply of rhenium, vital for superalloys used in mega construction. The UA can't exploit it as the rebels sabotage their operations. Segarra is dangling the rhenium as a carrot for 3WE and UPP military aid. Both powers are tempted, but skeptical, and have sent covert missions to Torin Prime to check the J'Har's claims.

Campaign Hooks: The PCs are rebels, or freelancers trying to make a buck, smuggling the rhenium. They might work for the UA, tracking down Guarani and Segarra's agents, or looking to take them out of the equation, or they might be agents for the 3WE or UPP.

GJ229A: TORIN PRIME

▶ **Affiliation**	UA
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, temperate warm, mountainous, forested
▶ **Population**	700,000 civilians, 50,000 security forces
▶ **Resources**	Rare minerals, heavy metals

NN3325 – Devil's Peak

NN3325 is littered with barren asteroid fields – the ideal place for Devil's Peak Station.

The existence of Devil's Peak is only known within a tight community of morally bankrupt and evil people. The brainchild of Syran Hosse, CEO of Lunnar-Welsun, Devil's Peak is an entertainment resort like no other, where the select elite can come and gawp at the XX121 Xenomorph's brutality. Buried deep inside an asteroid, Devil's Peak is a theater of nightmares.

Hosse's operation needs a steady supply of victims, and he doesn't much care where he gets them. Teams of "recruiters" travel the sector, kidnapping those who no one will miss.

Campaign Hooks: One of the PCs' friends disappears, and they discover Devil's Peak. Or they are contracted to deliver a cargo of hypersleeping people to a location in deep space, a strange contract offering a big payday. Alternatively, they overhear loose talk from a foolish corporate exec, bragging about Devil's Peak. What do they do with that information? Can they bargain it for something, and who will come after them if they do? ▶

NN3325: DEVIL'S PEAK

▶ **Affiliation**	Syran Hosse, Lunnar-Welsun
▶ **Classification**	Giant asteroid
▶ **Population**	100
▶ **Resources**	XX121 Xenomorphs

Licensed Copy (Order: 53151103)

GAMMA LEPORIS: STEER CITY

▶ **Affiliation**	Lasalle Bionational, Seegson, UA security
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, terraformed, temperate, plains, hills
▶ **Population**	9,000 civilians, 250 military
▶ **Resources**	Agriculture

Gamma Leporis – Steer City

This trinary system had three colonies, but only Steer City on Gamma Leporis A3 survives. Colonnade colony orbiting Gamma Leporis B was destroyed by an asteroid, and Seegson's Wheatfield colony on Homestead, orbiting Gamma Leporis C, was found deserted. The mystery remains unsolved. There's still valuable gear for salvagers and scavengers, and the UPP is planning another colonization attempt.

Steer City thrives in the sweeping fields of Terraform 3, its automated farms producing the food that keeps Tartarus sector fed, making it a tempting target.

The 3WE wants control of the system and is blackmailing the Lasalle chief at Steer City, Pierre Rampier.

The UPP has long had agents in Lasalle's ranks. They are ordered to use Lasalle's own blight virus to devastate Steer City's agriculture, bringing starvation to the sector. The blame will be laid squarely at Lasalle Bionational's door and leave the way open for the UPP to sweep in and save the day. Who cares about the colonists who will starve as a result?

Campaign Hooks: The PCs are colonists at Steer City and uncover the UPP's plans, or infiltrators trying to make them happen. Perhaps they stumble across the conspiracy and must choose what to do. Wheatfield colony is ripe for exploration and salvage, but what will they find there? And what might be left of Colonnade? Was its destruction an accident, and if not, what secrets might it hide?

GL408 – Liberty Echo

The UA's headquarters in Tartarus sector, under the authority of Administrator Prescott Smith, the planet itself is one endless frosty plain. There is a standing fleet of six Conestoga cruisers, tasked with protecting Tartarus sector and the Far Reach. It holds a research facility for Weyland-Yutani's Weapons Division under Colonel David Fagan, with XX121 specimens on ice, and is also a listening post for Tanburro Station, in the distant 78 Nu Ceti system.

Rumors have hinted at something important going down, so important that the UA has sent four Conestoga cruisers to deal with it. No one knows where this flotilla is heading, but everyone knows that the UA's defense fleet in Tartarus now consists of only two cruisers – and their rivals are eager to take advantage of it.

GL408: LIBERTY ECHO

▶ **Affiliation**	UA, ORDF
▶ **Classification**	Small terrestrial, terraformed, freezing, Jovian moon
▶ **Population**	50,000 military
▶ **Resources**	Military forces, naval fleet, weapons research facility

Campaign Hooks: The PCs work for the UA or W-Y or deliver cargo as space truckers. Perhaps they infiltrate the place, to learn more about the research center or why the UA sent the best part of its fleet away. Many would pay well for that information.

GL300 – Linna 349

Settled in 2110 (Harare and Neusheune colonies) Linna is the lynchpin of the 3WE's ambitions in Tartarus sector. Linna's greatest export is timber from the Karyta tree. However, the wood carries the Yellowbelly beetle, a virulent pest that infests colonies, destroying them from within.

Ten years ago, the local government, under their leader Shane Boulton, declared independence. Desperate to stop the rebels, the 3WE called upon the UA for help. In a carbon copy of the Lebanon II crisis, the Colonial Marines took control then refused to step aside.

This outcome was not what either the Boulton rebels or the 3WE wanted. They have joined forces to drive their common enemy out. Boulton wants peace and to control his colony's future. The 3WE needs to regain control, give the UA a long overdue slap in the face, and bring Boulton to heel.

Campaign Hooks: The PCs are on a ship or base affected by the Yellowbelly beetle, rushing to defeat the infestation, or sent to Linna to acquire some larvae, to be used as a bioweapon. Or perhaps they are sent by the 3WE to mediate with Boulton, or by the UA to kill him.

GL300: LINNA 349

▶ **Affiliation**	3WE (UA occupation)
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, temperate warm, forests, lakes
▶ **Population**	30,000 civilians, 1,000 UA security
▶ **Resources**	Timber (Karyta trees), lanthanum, lutetium, rare metals

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HIP53020 – Pala Station

HIP53020 is home to the archaeological remains of an Engineer settlement and a Juggernaut, as well as dense tropical jungle, and predatory life, in the form of the tiger-like Leon.

Two secret colonies were established – Pala Station to explore the archaeology, and Site Two to examine the remains of the ship, with company ships transporting their finds back to the labs. But some ships have been lost. Where are they, and what happened to their cargoes?

Both Lunnar-Welsun and Lasalle Bionational suspect W-Y's activities on HIP53020. It's only a matter of time before their agents uncover something.

W-Y is worried about the 3WE's new colony on a planet in the same system. Bethlehem colony, on a world notable only for violent outgassing, is designated as a prospecting mission, but W-Y suspect it's a surveillance post – something they need to quietly neutralize.

Campaign Hooks: The PCs stumble across one of W-Y's lost ships, or are contracted as salvagers to find one – what secrets will they discover? Or they work for W-Y on LV-895, exploring the ruins or protecting against the Leon. Alternatively, they may be investigators for Lunnar-Welsun, or scouting the 3WE's new colony.

HIP53020: PALA STATION

▶ **Affiliation**	UA, Weyland-Yutani
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, temperate warm, tropical
▶ **Population**	500 researchers, 150 military
▶ **Resources**	Engineer archaeology, Juggernaut wreckage, indigenous life

HIP51317 – Mendel Station

HIP51317 is only notable as the location of Weyland-Yutani's Mendel Station, a bioweapons laboratory believed destroyed 45 years ago. Rumors are circulating that the station survived and is now in the Aventine asteroid field. W-Y denies the rumors and claims there never was such a facility.

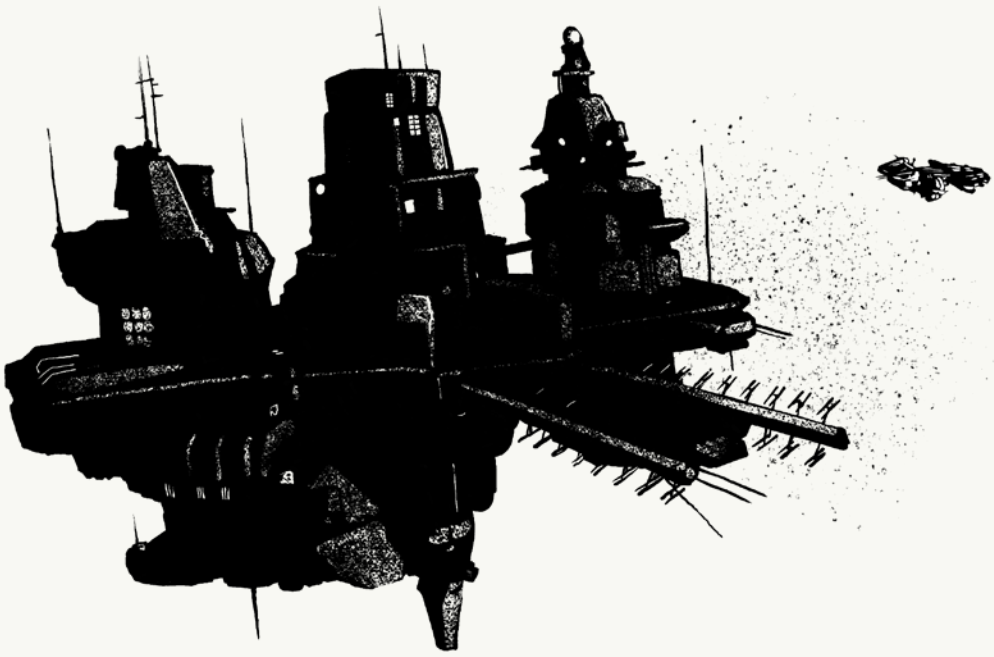
The station rests on the surface of a huge asteroid. It's severely damaged but hypersleeping survivors, research and equipment remain intact. Mendel Station housed XX121 Xenomorphs. They established a hive, preying on the crew. Classified reports indicate that the suspected Queen and all her Drones may have died in their decades of abandonment. Of course, there should still be enough material left to make anyone who finds the site rich.

Weyland-Yutani is putting together a team to get there first. The 3WE and UPP, and independent salvagers, are doing the same. It's a strange race – none admit where they are going – but it's a race nonetheless, to recover Mendel Station's secrets.

Campaign Hooks: The PCs are contracted as salvagers or for an exploratory mission, or just see the opportunities for themselves. Or perhaps someone they know was on the base, and they'd love to learn what happened to them. ▶

HIP51317: MENDEL STATION

▶ **Affiliation**	Weyland-Yutani
▶ **Classification**	Orbital research station
▶ **Population**	Three (was 350)
▶ **Resources**	Research, equipment, bioweapons, XX121 Xenomorphs



Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

GL257AB – Tartarus

Tartarus colony is a UA mining outfit on a forlorn world of deserts and ravines. Alongside Seegson and their Working Joe androids, the UA didn't account for the indigenous life, the Harvesters. In 2161 a massive herd obliterated the colony. Having failed to learn from this tragic lesson, the UA tried again ten years later.

This time they were cautious. However, illegal prospecting outfits sprung up, stripping the planet and leading to the so-called Prospector Wars. Seeing no other way, the UA accelerated their operations, before the independents picked the planet clean. Again, the Harvesters reacted aggressively. Some saw this state of affairs as an opportunity. Enterprising folk began rounding up the juveniles for sale off-world. It's totally illegal, but there's too much money at stake and no one to stop them.

Campaign Hooks: The PCs want their share of Tartarus's bounty and go prospecting. Or they exploit the new Harvester trade and go hunting juveniles. Alternatively, there are many who'd be willing to pay to see the independent prospectors put out of business.

GL257AB: TARTARUS

▶ **Affiliation**	UA, Seegson
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, temperate cold, rocky
▶ **Population**	10,000
▶ **Resources**	Minerals, heavy metals, rare elements, indigenous life (Harvesters)

GJ2034 – Argos

LV-1188 is an icy ball orbiting a red dwarf. The Independent Core Systems Colonies (ICSC) colonized the planet as neutral ground for all to use without fear or favor. Under the leadership of colonial supervisor Carol Sherrer, the colony is designed so antagonistic factions can stay apart while Sherrer and her administrators mediate between them.

While Sherrer hasn't managed to get the UA and 3WE to share the same conference room, Argos colony has been a great success as a hub for trade and transport. The UA and 3WE maintain a footprint here but challenge the UPP's unwelcome presence.

GJ2034: ARGOS

▶ **Affiliation**	United Nations
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, temperate cold, icy plains
▶ **Population**	750 Civilians, 300 ICSC administration
▶ **Resources**	Trade hub, neutral territory

Campaign Hooks: The PCs find supplies, repairs, jobs, information, colonial marshals, space truckers, and representatives of all the major corporations here – it's a melting pot for all who call Tartarus sector home.

Beta Virginis – Rodina

Beta Virginis is illuminated by a large, blue star (Beta Virginis A) and its brown dwarf companion (Beta Virginis B). Beta Virginis A hosts Rodina, a stunning planet reminiscent of Earth a million years ago.

Two attempts have been made to colonize it, by the 3WE and UA – both failed, the colonists succumbing to Neural Distortion Disorder caused by the host star, and violently harming themselves, or others, or both. They don't yet know their colonies have failed.

However, the UPP has established a colony in orbit around Beta Virginis B to study Beta Virginis A. They intend to settle Rodina for themselves and will colonize as soon as they can mitigate the NDDs. Cosmos Exploration Corps scout ships patrol the Cusp of Tartarus, to destroy ships heading their way. Their success has earned this zone of space a new reputation as "the Bermuda Triangle" of Tartarus.

Campaign Hooks: The PCs work for the UPP and are investigating Rodina. Or they are part of a rescue crew for the silent 3WE and UA colonies or searching for the ships that have gone missing. Alternatively, they are part of a new colonization attempt and must face the NDDs themselves.

BETA VIRGINIS: RODINA

▶ **Affiliation**	None
▶ **Classification**	Terrestrial, temperate, lush, Earthlike
▶ **Population**	None
▶ **Resources**	Ultra-rich, indigenous life

Minor Systems

GL285B, Delorme colony was another rebellious UA system. The USCMC solved the "Delorme Problem" by nuking the site from orbit. They said they evacuated the colonists first, but few believe them.

GL382 is a barren system where a religious order established a spiritual retreat called Temple – visitors are not encouraged.

GJ11038 is another uninspiring system. Fifty years ago, an independent colony, called Deadfall, was established on the moon of a gas giant. No one has heard a peep from them since or has cared enough to check. ▶

Licensed Systems (Order: 53151103)



Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

What's Going Down?

Holding The Line

The UA wants to remain dominant in Tartarus sector, but are under-resourced to do so, exacerbated by the garbled message from 78 Nu Ceti, and the departure of the fleet to investigate. They lean heavily on the ORDF and W-Y, but neither delivers the support they need.

Administrator Prescott Smith feels personally vulnerable, posted here as punishment for undisclosed misdemeanors – his career stands on a knife's edge. He will happily see recalcitrant colonies receive the "Delorme treatment" (and get nuked) rather than let them break away and fall under the control of another power.

The 3WE Making Their Play

The 3WE is determined to reassert its authority, by teaching Linna 349 a long overdue lesson, regaining control of Lebanon II and sowing dissent among the UA's colonies. The 3WE's military strength is mustering around Fiori 16. but developing asymmetric warfare options is top priority: the Xenomorph, Yellowbelly beetle, and Harvesters – all can do terrible, undeniable damage to the enemy.

The PCs get involved in these plots, as members of the 3WE, as mercenaries working for the right money, or bystanders forced to help through threats or blackmail. They may be contracted to find specimens of the Xenomorph, the Yellowbelly beetle, or Harvesters. They may work against the plots, or stumble across them as neutrals and must decide what action to take.

The UPP Wants In

The UPP wants to become a power in Tartarus sector. They covertly support rebels on Linna 349, Lebanon II, and Torin Prime, but avoid open conflict in this sector of space. Their number one priority is control of the dangerous but ultra-rich planet, Rodina. The UPP has a scattering of Space Operating Forces and Cosmic Exploration Corps in the sector but are gathering more at 17 Phei Phei.

The PCs become involved in the UPP story by supporting or opposing them in their plans. They may attempt to gain the UPP's support for a rebellious group, or work to keep them out of the sector entirely.

The J'Har Rebellion

The J'Har President, Araceli Segarra, has a chip in the big game to exchange for help. The J'Har need legitimate space truckers to get their rhenium to Argos, intermediaries to buy military equipment with the proceeds, and agents to work with the 3WE and UPP.

Para Guarani and his pirates operate from temporary bases, raiding easy targets, although Guarani has an audacious plan to capture a brand-new Conestoga cruiser. Segarra and Guarani don't see eye to eye, especially now that the UA has posted a bounty for his capture. The PCs can help Guarani with his ambitious plans or take him in for the UA's gratitude.

Someone the PCs know has been incarcerated in the GR161 camp, and they need to break them out. Why were they incarcerated? Do they know something vital to the UA's operations on Torin?

Trucking The Space Lanes

Life as a space trucker is tough. Whether you're paid-up crew knuckling under the Company for that extra share, or an independent outfit that's in hock to the W-Y dollar, you're always under someone's thumb. Despite the exploitation you still pull a few tricks: operating under the corporate radar you know how to keep things from your paymasters; you know the space trucker black market, for gear, information, and favors; you know how to play the system and get things done "off the books".

Nothing moves without the space truckers. Sometimes that means dodging local politics and petty blockades. The PCs are contracted to move food, equipment, livestock, criminals, weapons, juvenile Harvesters, or some other dubious cargo. Even if the Company says it's okay, the ICC might take a dim view. Maybe the pirates will fancy your sweet cargo too.

The Grass Is Always Greener

There are many systems to explore and planets to be colonized. New colonists must deal with the superpowers or vie against a competing colony on the same soil. Don't forget to keep your bosses happy too.

For explorers and scouts there is plenty of work. Quite apart from prospecting – their bread and butter – there are lost colonies to explore, suspicious activity to investigate ... and rumors of lost space stations and ancient relics to follow up on.

The Glass Ceiling

Lunnar-Welsun has been held back by Weyland-Yutani long enough. Now it's time to break that glass ceiling and step out from Weyland-Yutani's shadow. Lunnar-Welsun's Chief Executive in Tartarus, Melody Khim, is emboldened to keep pushing W-Y aside, employing the PCs to investigate W-Y's activities. Naturally, W-Y aren't going to take this lying down, and their leader in Tartarus, Byron Stokes, retaliates in kind.

Licensed System (Order: 53151103)



Where There's Brass There's Muscle

Don't forget the muscle – the sector is brimming with conflicts for PCs with a taste for the rough stuff and the equipment to match. Whether they are Colonial Marines or Royal Marines, the ORDF or the elite of the UPP's Space Operating Forces, or colonists taking up arms against their oppressors, there is always a conflict brewing and the need for people to fight it. ●

JACKSON'S STAR

JACKSON'S STAR IS A REMOTE frontier colony on the planet LV-410 in the Alpheios system in the Far Reach of the American Arm (page 199). It has been supplying minerals to Earth since it was established in 2133.

History

The world was initially discovered by Jackson's Resource Development Group, a freelance operation that has identified colonies on several other worlds throughout the Frontier. Despite being rich in mineral ores, LV-410 proved to be a hostile and unforgiving world. Its dense atmosphere cloaked the planet in thick layers of heavy moisture and clouds so dense that they block sunlight from reaching the world's surface. The atmosphere was also home to an ominous biological threat, a wind-borne microorganism that affected colonists in only minor ways to begin with, but over time mutated, causing ever-more serious illnesses.

Weyland-Yutani, which established the colonial operation on LV-410, attempted to mitigate the threat by building atmosphere processors across the colonized region. Even so, in the colony's early years, workers grew sick, with many dying of complications. Recruiting fresh workers became difficult as stories of the planet's lack of daylight and the threat of airborne sickness reached Earth, forcing the company to forcibly extend some of their workers' contracts.

Life In The Colony

In the intervening years, the atmosphere processors have reduced the threat from airborne microorganisms considerably. Both the population and productivity at the colony have increased substantially, but even so, the dense cloud layers still create a permanent darkness across the entire planet breeding isolation, depression and anxiety amongst the workers.

Nevertheless, with the colony thriving, some of the workers have extended their stay and even raise families there. For those born on this strange colony world, they have known nothing else but darkness, rain, hailstorms and wind. ▶

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)



The Mines

There are four thriving mines located around Jackson's Star, all extracting iron and associated rare metals. These ores are crudely crushed and processed ready for transport into orbit by mining haulers such as the Model CM-93 D Mule (page 130). Once loaded onto a waiting Tesotek mineral refining platform, the mining hauler returns to the colony, whilst a commercial towing vessel pulls the automated refinery back to the Core worlds, a journey that takes up to a year. During this time the ores will have been separated, refined and purified, ready for immediate use when they reach their destination.

Locations

Agricultural Area: Being so far from Earth, the colony's management maintains vegetable gardens in order to supplement the supply rations. Workers in transparent plastic overcoats maintain the gardens lit by the orange arc lights that provide the much-needed sunlight for growth. Part of the area is dedicated to several rows of enclosed hothouses.

Atmosphere Processors: Jackson's Star was built around the first three atmosphere processors on the planet. Each one creates a localized environment in the lowest layer of the atmosphere by processing it through a fusion reactor. They have (over several decades) scrubbed the air of microorganisms and reduced the incidences of sickness and death. The huge cone-shaped towers form a menacing backdrop to the skyline and are lit up with glowing red anti-collision lights.

Cargo Area: The cargo areas combine open concrete pads for the storage and stacking of shipping containers with dedicated freight warehouses. Harsh arc lights illuminate the areas to deter thieves, and armed security patrols are frequent. The great distance from Earth has made even humble consumables a valuable commodity at the colony. An office complex at each location tracks cargo arriving from Earth and the few cargoes heading back to the Core Systems. Spare shipping containers are often used to build walls, or as conversions into workshops or cheap colony housing.

Michael Syrett (Order: 53151103)



Landing Pads: Various landing fields have been designated around the colony for orbital cargo lifters as well as smaller personal flying vehicles. The cargo lifters bring supplies and cargo containers down from the supply ships. These fields are cluttered with cargo loading equipment and vehicles, maintenance carts and refueling bowsers, whilst ground crews work tirelessly to marshal the arriving and departing craft.

Market Street: There are three Market Streets at Jackson's Star. Each is a hub of human activity, since the standard accommodation is so cramped, and workers like to get out and mix with their friends when off-shift. There are a variety of neon-lit stores, bars and cafes, lounges, restaurants, strip clubs, and even outdoor play areas for children.

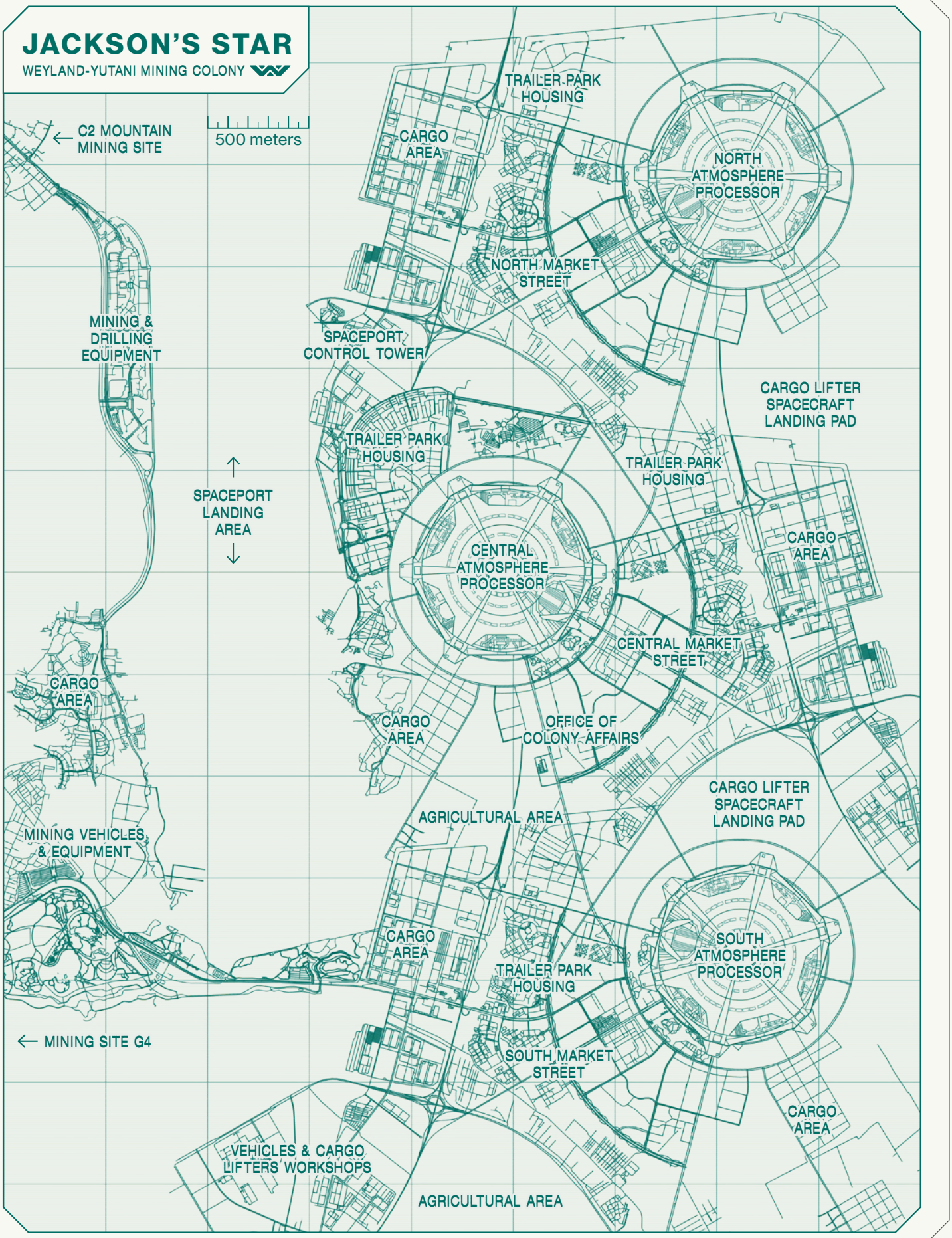
Market streets are brightly lit places, with crowds of people jostling for space and sometimes getting in each other's way. Nevertheless, such areas are the focus of human activity at the colony. Market Street areas also contain good quality housing units for supervisors, administrators and managers, as well as basic bunk-style accommodation for lower-level workers.

Mining Gear & Vehicles: Heavy equipment and vehicles are held in these areas for use at the mining sites. This equipment is big, brutal and industrial and comes in the typical yellow warning paint scheme. Most of it sits outside, exposed to the elements, but there are always maintenance personnel making repairs and modifications whilst underneath temporary transparent shelters.

Mining Sites: Mining sites C2 and G4 are the closest of the four mines in the region around Jackson's Star. Both are deep iron mines that are the reason for the colony's existence. Ore is briefly processed on site, ready for transport to the Spaceport Landing Area, to the east. The mines work non-stop and spew steam and smoke into the atmosphere.

Office Of Colony Affairs: Located along Central Market Street, Colonial Affairs is the Weyland-Yutani administration division. It governs the colony, managing the mines, spaceport and atmosphere processors. Colony Affairs has various departments including labor law, pay, workforce allocation, health, transport, infrastructure and franchise operations. ▶

Prepared Synet (Order: 5315 1103)



Licensed System (Order: 5315103)

Visiting the disinterested officials and clerks at Colonial Affairs, who sit behind armored glass under yellow-tinted strip-lights, can be a demoralizing and frustrating experience. The bureaucracy shunts the tired colonists from one department to another.

Spaceport Landing Area: This large landing ground is used to transport ore up to a waiting Tesotek refinery in orbit. Mining haulers take off and land every half an hour, on a continuous basis. Occasionally, a huge starfreighter will land to off-load a large cargo consignment.

Activity here is non-stop and frenetic. Ore arrives from the mines via elevated conveyor tracks and is stored in huge cylindrical tanks, then chutes deposit the ore into waiting mining haulers. The operation is coordinated from the Spaceport Control Tower, by the "Air Boss" and the "Ground Boss" (one responsible for landings, take-offs and ship turnaround, the other for ore storage and loading). Even a small delay in operations will cost the colony millions of W-Y dollars.

Trailer Park Housing: Groups of colonists (or families) can move out of the bunk-style accommodations found around the Market Streets, to pool their finances and rent a "trailer hab," a simple mobile home that can be moved to a new location by Colony Affairs as Jackson's Star expands and grows. There are three main areas of trailer park housing at the colony where these six-person metal habs are often crammed close together. Each one includes cooking, sleeping and storage facilities and has electrical, plumbing and data hook-ups. The widespread use of trailer habs indicates Weyland-Yutani's lack of concern for the colonists' comfort, and suggests they would rather ship in more of the prefabricated habs than build proper colonial infrastructure.

Adventure Hooks

Space Truckers: A valuable research specimen that survived the destruction of the Renaissance Station back in 2142 was missed by rescue ships. Today, it is now drifting along with other pieces of scattered debris, unnoticed within the ring.

The PCs are a ship crew ordered to rescue a shuttle or ship crew that has gotten into difficulties near the ring. The PCs might launch from Jackson's Star, perhaps as a mining hauler crew, or as a supply ship crew heading back to the Core Systems. Once on scene, the sample might be detected, or worse, the ship in difficulties has already picked it up, with disastrous consequences.

The great danger, of course, is to enter the ring, since it is made up of fast-moving grit, rocks and dust that are liable to rip holes in an unlucky starship. The sample might be a Facehugger, it might be a complete Xenomorph drone, or perhaps a stasis box containing Z-01, a Xenomorph-derived pathogen...

"Right, take a good look outside the window 'cause, the way I see it, we're never coming back."

Tyler

Colonial Marines: The Marines are en route to the Solomons when their ship drops out of hyperspace into the Alpheios system. Prepped and ready, their orders are to investigate an unresponsive Tesotek mineral refinery in orbit around the planet. A mining hauler from LV-410 is docked but has not unloaded its ore, the hauler's crew is not responding.

The Tesotek's telemetry showed unusual system malfunctions and a slight orbit change before comms went off-line. What's going on? Four colonists have stowed away on the hauler and entered the refinery via EVA in order to sabotage it. These men and women have reached breaking point and want to punish Weyland-Yutani after their leader lost her entire family to a new virus outbreak. The hijackers have killed or disabled the crew of the ship that got them to the refinery and are now sabotaging machinery that will result in it deorbiting and crashing into the colony below.

The colonists have also destroyed the communications array and reprogrammed the Seegson androids which will attack any Marine on command from the hijackers. The Marines will face four colonists in Mk.50 Compression Suits armed with M240 Incinerator Units and Armat Model 37A2 12 Gauge Pump Action shotguns, as well as a variety of ingeniously repurposed mining demolitions equipment. The hijackers' greatest weapon, however, is the automated machinery of the refinery itself, from maintenance robots to environmental controls, elevators to mobile ore processing machinery.

Colonists: A Weyland-Yutani research outpost exists on LV-410 in order to study and monitor the various wind-borne pathogens within the planet's atmosphere. One scientist has discovered that an "antigenic shift" is taking place with several airborne viruses combining and merging their genetic make-up as a survival instinct.

Whilst her colleagues are trying to harness this new phenomenon, she is certain that it is the prelude to a massive and catastrophic mutation which will see the airborne microorganism wipe out all human life on LV-410. She has arranged to hand her data over to a third-party at Jackson's Star but will be murdered during the exchange. Who is the middleman? Who is the intended recipient of the revelation? Who is the murderer? Has the data gone missing during the murder? PCs might be witnesses assisting the Colonial Marshal, or might instead be caught up in the affair either for money or for reasons of public safety. ●

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NOVGOROD STATION

NOVGOROD STATION (ICC registration: 1709556) is a 10,000-ton transfer station that orbits the star Alpha Fornacis. 140 personnel crew this lonely interstellar outpost which serves as a way station for long-distance freighters and survey ships as well as supporting in-system mining operations.

The star system is dominated by a debris disc made up of millions of mineral-rich asteroids and planetoids. Scattered mining outposts search for deposits of tungsten and trimonite. Novgorod is typical of the small station designs currently available, perfectly suited to low-traffic regions and cheap to tow in and out again as the situation demands.

Novgorod is very similar to dozens of other Seegson stations established along the Frontier and it serves as a useful model for other small space stations. As GM, you can use the layout and location descriptions for your own games, simply changing the name and/or location of the station to suit your current campaign.

Overview

Novgorod Station retains the "tapering spire" design of its much larger brethren. It has a wide, circular engineering base (A Deck), upon which are stacked nine increasingly smaller circular decks, for a total of ten. It can accommodate up to 40 visitors and can hard-dock with up to two starships at one time. Additional visiting vessels must stand-off and await transfer via the station's single Starcub-class shuttle.

Terminals

The A.P.O.L.L.O. mainframe can be accessed from one of dozens of public terminals scattered around the station. These terminals are wall-units, with a screen and manual keyboard, each requiring an ID card to be slotted in before coming online. They provide access to the A.P.O.L.L.O. mainframe, an in-station data and electronic messaging system, used as a library, data-log and administration and accounting system. The terminals are also video phones, activated by lifting the telephone-style receiver and dialing with the keypad. The image of the other caller appears on the screen.

OTHER STATION NAMES

- Junction Station
- Korosten Terminal
- Carlisle Station
- Platform KT3
- Thetis Station

Running through the center of all decks is the Transit Tube, which houses two passenger elevators, emergency stairs and a restroom, as well as conduits and service pipes running between decks.

Passengers are not allowed off the C Deck, the Concourse Deck, and the elevators will not operate for them. The elevators will only open on G Deck if the correct security level is held by the crewman. ID cards are slotted into the elevator controls to open the doors to that deck.

A Deck: Engineering

- **Engineering Platform:** An open plan deck, giving access to the fusion reactor and its operating machinery. There are two control stations close to the liquid hydrogen fuel tanks. Two coolant tanks behind the reactor hold liquid potassium.
- **Fuel Tanks:** Liquid hydrogen is stored here, used by the shuttle as well as forklifts, loaders and visiting shuttles. They do not have the capacity to refuel an interstellar freighter.
- **Fusion Reactor:** A 3.1 Gigawatt fusion power plant operating on a deuterium/tritium reaction that supplies power to the station.

B Deck: Cargo

- **Cargo Bays:** Three cargo bays, serving as a supply store for the station. Pallets and cargo containers are brought up from the starport via two freight elevators and maneuvered into place by a couple of power loaders and forklifts.
- **Airlock Access:** An airlock for access to the exterior of the station, including an EVA prep area with pressure suits and equipment lockers.
- **Offices:** Open plan admin offices, with terminals connecting to the A.P.O.L.L.O. mainframe.
- **Colonial Marshal's Office:** The marshal and his deputy have an office here, as well as an interview room, well-stocked armory and four holding cells.
- **St. Luke's Medical Center:** A small clinic, with four beds, an operating room, store, pharmacy and consulting room.
- **Workshop:** Technical area with lathes, testing benches, racks of spares, and equipment. ▶

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

C Deck: Main Concourse

- **Spaceport Lobby:** An open area with check-in desks, an information point, and seating.
- **Spaceport Transfer Gate:** Two arrival/departure gates and their lounges sit beyond the security desk, as does as an open-plan starport office.
- **Cargo Handling Modules:** Cargo airlocks used for moving freight to and from docked starships. The modules are connected to the cargo bays on B Deck via freight elevator.
- **Concourse:** The heart of Novgorod Station is a wide-open, spacious plaza, with seating areas and video screens, lined with offices, cafes, a gym, restrooms and the Marianas Inn. Opposite the Starport are the dozen or so stores of Galleria Nishi.
- **Promenade:** Wide walkway with large windows looking into space.
- **Gym:** Small gym used mainly by station personnel.
- **Security Station:** Security monitoring desk and office, used by the two starport security officers to screen passengers.
- **Galleria Nishi:** A dozen or so stores providing essentials and luxuries for station personnel as well as transiting passengers – clothing, personal electronics, tools, food, jewelry, bathing products, shoes, magazines and many other items.
- **Restaurant:** This facility is called Maxine's Diner and is open around the clock.
- **Marianas Inn:** Small, twenty-room inn used by visitors or transiting passengers. All rooms have en-suite facilities. A laundry room, office, and reception desk are included.

Mallory Bourne Chief Loadmaster

Mallory was dropped into the job and her crew of male loadmasters didn't want her there. But she's mean and tough and threatened dismissals, marking a line in the sand. Now she runs the cargo bay with an iron hand, and she looks after the other loadmasters when management starts giving them a hard time. Mallory keeps her eye on every piece of cargo and every ship movement, spotting anomalies, unusual Seegson shipments and unregistered flights. What is going on?

Attributes	Strength 5, Agility 4, Wits 3, Empathy 2
Health	5
Skills	CLOSE COMBAT 1, HEAVY MACHINERY 4, STAMINA 3, COMMAND 2
Talent	Resilient
Gear	Maintenance jack

D Deck: Life Support

- **Garden:** A hydroponic garden, separated from the rest of the deck by large, clear windows. It is used not for enjoyment or agriculture, but as a supplementary oxygen and water treatment system.
- **Water Tanks:** Drinking water is stored here.
- **Life Support Bay:** Sewage is treated and recycled into water, used water is recycled, and air is scrubbed and recirculated from here.

E Deck: Habitation

- **Crew Cabins:** Basic crew cabins, each with bed, toilet, shower, station-to-station videophone, desk, and storage units. A standard terminal gives access to the A.P.O.L.L.O. network, including various pre-recorded entertainment channels. A kitchenette allows simple meals to be prepared. This deck is double height, with stairs leading to a second level of crew cabins.
- **Mini Market:** Small convenience store for the use of station personnel who often buy food that can be cooked back in their cabin.
- **Restaurant:** A staff-only bar and grill called Drifters.

F Deck: Lower Tower

- **Shuttle Hangar:** Houses a Starcub shuttle, with space adjacent for maintenance and cargo loading.
- **Fuel Processor:** Pumps for transferring liquid hydrogen fuel from a tanker, and processors for refining it.

Jonathon Otaka Marshal

Otaka is in his late 40s, and Novgorod is his seventh station posting. He's good at this job, and in particular, at training-up his deputies to cope with the unique crimes and challenges on the Outer Rim. He is the kind of person who remembers everyone's name and knows everyone's business. If ever caught with his back against the wall, plenty of station staff would volunteer to help him out.

Attributes	Strength 4, Agility 3, Wits 4, Empathy 3
Health	4
Skills	CLOSE COMBAT 2, RANGED COMBAT 2, OBSERVATION 4, MANIPULATION 2
Talent	Subdue
Gear	.357 Magnum revolver, flashlight, Armat Model 37A2 12 gauge pump action shotgun

G Deck: Upper Tower

- **Operations Center:** Open-plan nerve center and command post for the station, set out like the cluttered bridge of a starship. Around six personnel are here each shift, running the station from day-to-day. Spiral stairs lead down to admin, allowing staff to move easily between the two.
- **A.P.O.L.L.O. Mainframe:** The A.P.O.L.L.O. mainframe servers are located here, adjacent to the operations center. The room includes a direct access and programming terminal.
- **Restaurant:** An exclusive eatery called Bistro Hibachi.

H–I Deck: Science Labs

- **Laboratories:** Multi-function labs, generously furnished with equipment, rented by Gustafsson Enterprise (H Deck) and the Seegson Corporation (I Deck).
- **Emergency Operations Center:** A back-up ops center, usually locked and disused.

J Deck: Comms

- **Avionics:** Sensor equipment and communications electronics bays.
- **Probe Bay:** Robotic science probes are launched from this bay.

Events

Unexpected events may provide interest or might signal the start of some crisis.

The Ship: A mysterious ship has pulled up outside the station and the shuttle has transferred the crew on board. But no one knows where they are or what is going on. In fact, the Weyland-Yutani ship has no crew – none living, anyway. A twitchy android (an early Hyperdyne model 120-A2) has killed the entire crew, all down to conflicting orders that forbade it from revealing the true nature of the company mission. The android, Glynn, has been removed for study by the Seegson science lab, and the bodies are shortly due for disposal in space from the shuttle. The nature of the ship's mission is, however, still classified or unknown.

Secrets: The player characters stumble upon an on-station secret, perhaps involving the top-secret mainframe experiments involving A.P.O.L.L.O. (See Dr. Alicia Svenson below). The PCs can try to profit from this secret, which may involve a risk of fines, imprisonment or even death. ▶

Dr. Alicia Svenson Seegson Scientist

Dr Svenson is a talented electronics and cybernetic engineer who helped to upgrade the Novgorod mainframe from its antiquated TYPHON server to the cutting-edge A.P.O.L.L.O. system. Svenson's work at Novgorod is devoted to top secret bioelectric and AI software and A.P.O.L.L.O. is a testbed for a whole new line of Seegson intelligent computers. She is passionate and very protective of her work, believing that Professor Arnuld Keenes, the Seegson Chief Scientist, is untrustworthy and incompetent. She wants his job and wants the kudos of perfecting the A.P.O.L.L.O. product for herself.

▶ **Attributes**	Strength 2, Agility 4, Wits 5, Empathy 3
▶ **Health**	3
▶ **Skills**	**MOBILITY** 2, **OBSERVATION** 4, **COMTECH** 4, **MANIPULATION** 3
▶ **Talent**	Xenomorphology
▶ **Gear**	Seegson System Diagnostic Device

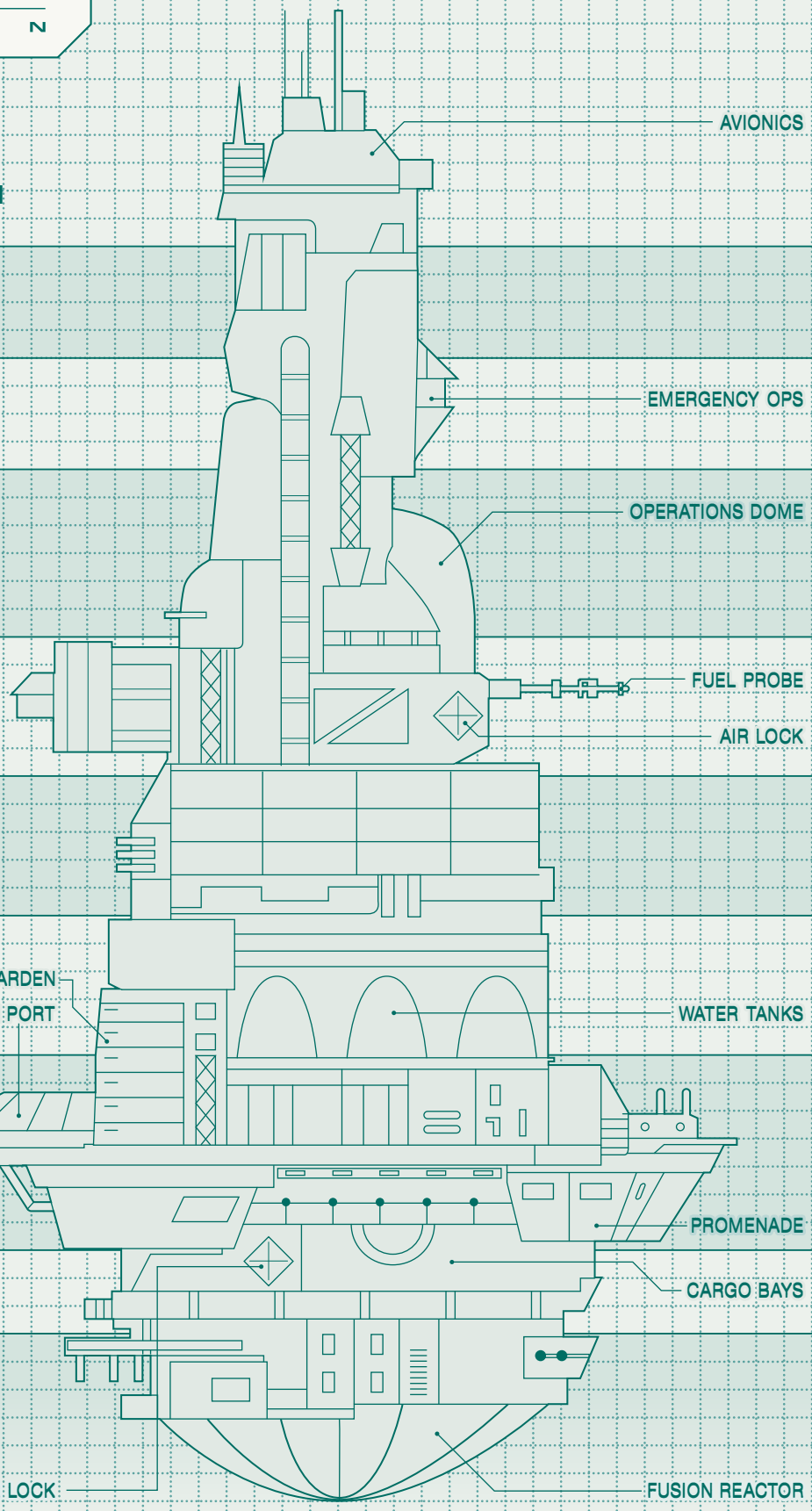
Sergei Morozov Engineering Chief

A dour but hard-working engineering chief, he runs his crew ragged chasing down malfunctions, carrying out daily maintenance and swapping out machine parts for routine testing. He commands an efficient department of 20 technicians and engineers but is always upsetting management. Morozov pushes his nose where it's not wanted, believing a lot of what goes on in Novgorod to be his business – and it isn't. This creates a clash with all the other department heads.

▶ **Attributes**	Strength 4, Agility 3, Wits 4, Empathy 3
▶ **Health**	5
▶ **Skills**	**CLOSE COMBAT** 1, **HEAVY MACHINERY** 4, **STAMINA** 1, **COMTECH** 2, **COMMAND** 2
▶ **Talent**	Hardened
▶ **Gear**	Maintenance jack, Seegson P-DAT

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NOVGOROD STATION



J DECK — COMMS PLATFORM

I DECK — SEEGSON SCIENCE MODULE

H DECK — GUSTAFSSON SCIENCE MODULE

G DECK — UPPER TOWER

F DECK — LOWER TOWER

E DECK — HABITATION

D DECK — LIFE SUPPORT

C DECK — MAIN CONCOURSE

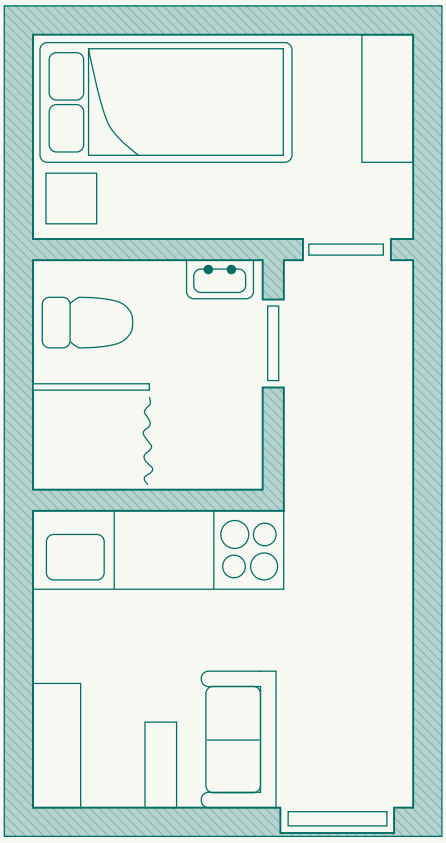
B DECK — CARGO DECK

A DECK — ENGINEERING PLATFORM

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NOVGOROD STATION

Typical Novgorod Station Cabin



Jailbreak: The PCs are approached by a pilot. His buddy (a ship's engineer) has been arrested for fighting in the bar and is likely to miss his ship's departure – losing him his job. Can they provide some kind of diversion to confuse or mislead the marshals, while the pilot frees the engineer from his cell down on B Deck? They will be amply compensated to the tune of thousands of dollars. The pilot is lying, the engineer has just turned state's evidence against his shipping company, and the pilot has orders to assassinate him in his cell. If the PCs assist, the pilot will vanish, leaving them to carry the can.

Shadow Games: A PC has a personal item stolen from his room, perhaps a gun or camera, a flashlight, or bag. Then something is stolen from their ship, or from the room of another PC. Are they being targeted? Why are these items being stolen? They must work with Marshal Otaka to catch the culprits, made harder by the investigation of a deluge of anti-Seegson graffiti across the station. There is a covert agent on-board, hired by Weyland-Yutani, who believes the PCs have been stealing company data and selling it on, possibly here at Novgorod. The agent is blackmailing one of the shuttle pilots who helped him get access to their ship, currently standing off from the station. He believes the data is hidden amongst personal items. When a Seegson agent contacts the group wanting to purchase their "data" things should get more confusing – and dangerous. Seegson believes, rightly or wrongly, that the PCs are data thieves and wants what they have!

Strike: The spaceport shuts down because of a loaders' strike due to a management dispute. This causes alarm, arguments in the concourse and urgent talks behind closed doors. The chief loadmaster, Mallory Bourne, is fighting the loaders' cause. There are some who are desperate to get off the station, perhaps because they have committed a crime. Will the PCs be tempted to help them? What other situations might occur during this worrying time? How is the Marshal managing the disruption? ●

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

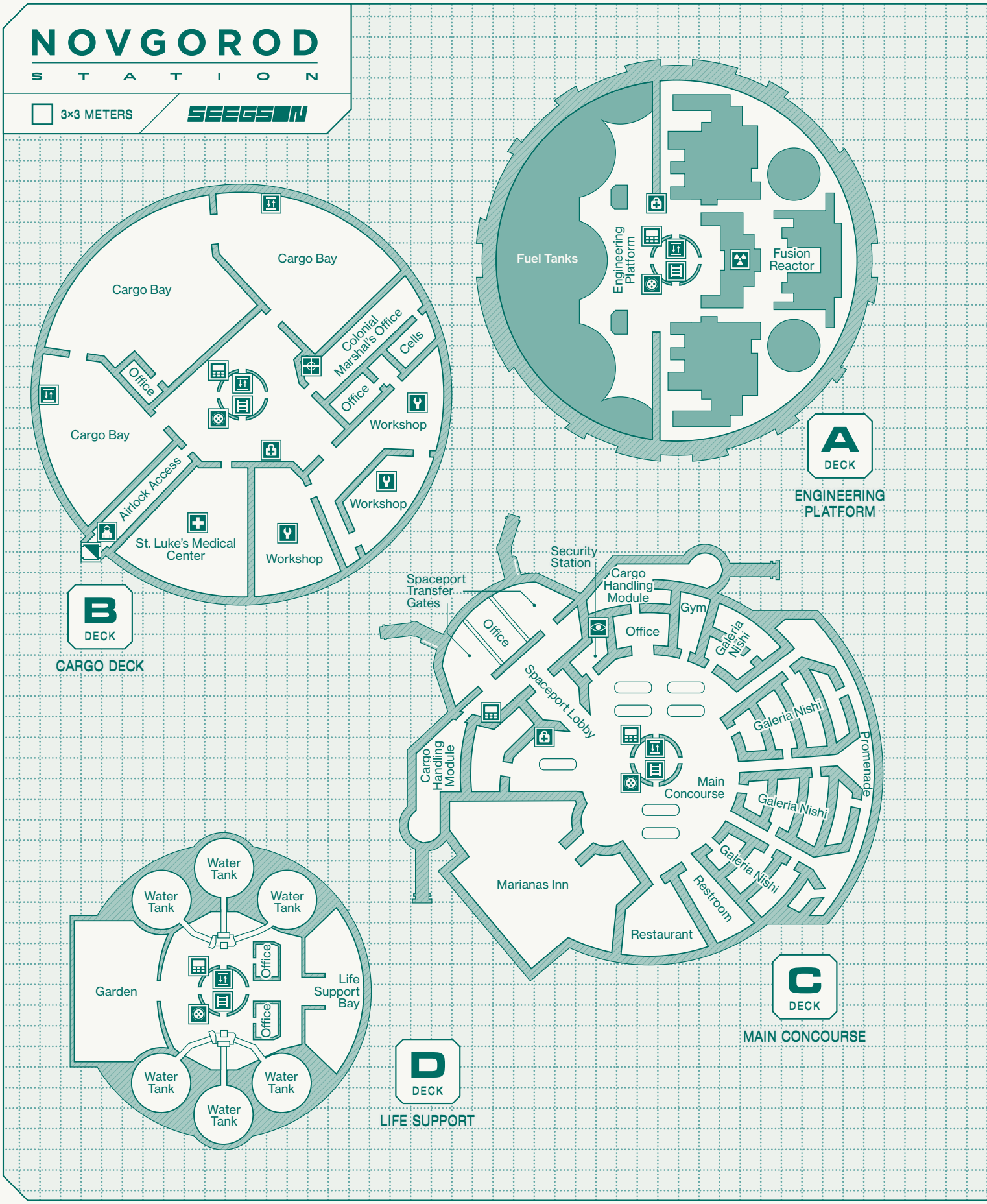
▶ **Height**	154 meters
▶ **Width**	81 meters
▶ **Engine Power**	3.1 Gigawatt fusion power plant
▶ **Decks**	10
▶ **Date Constructed**	5/11/2130
▶ **Personnel**	140 staff
▶ **Capacity**	40 passenger rooms
▶ **Cargo**	2,100 cubic meters

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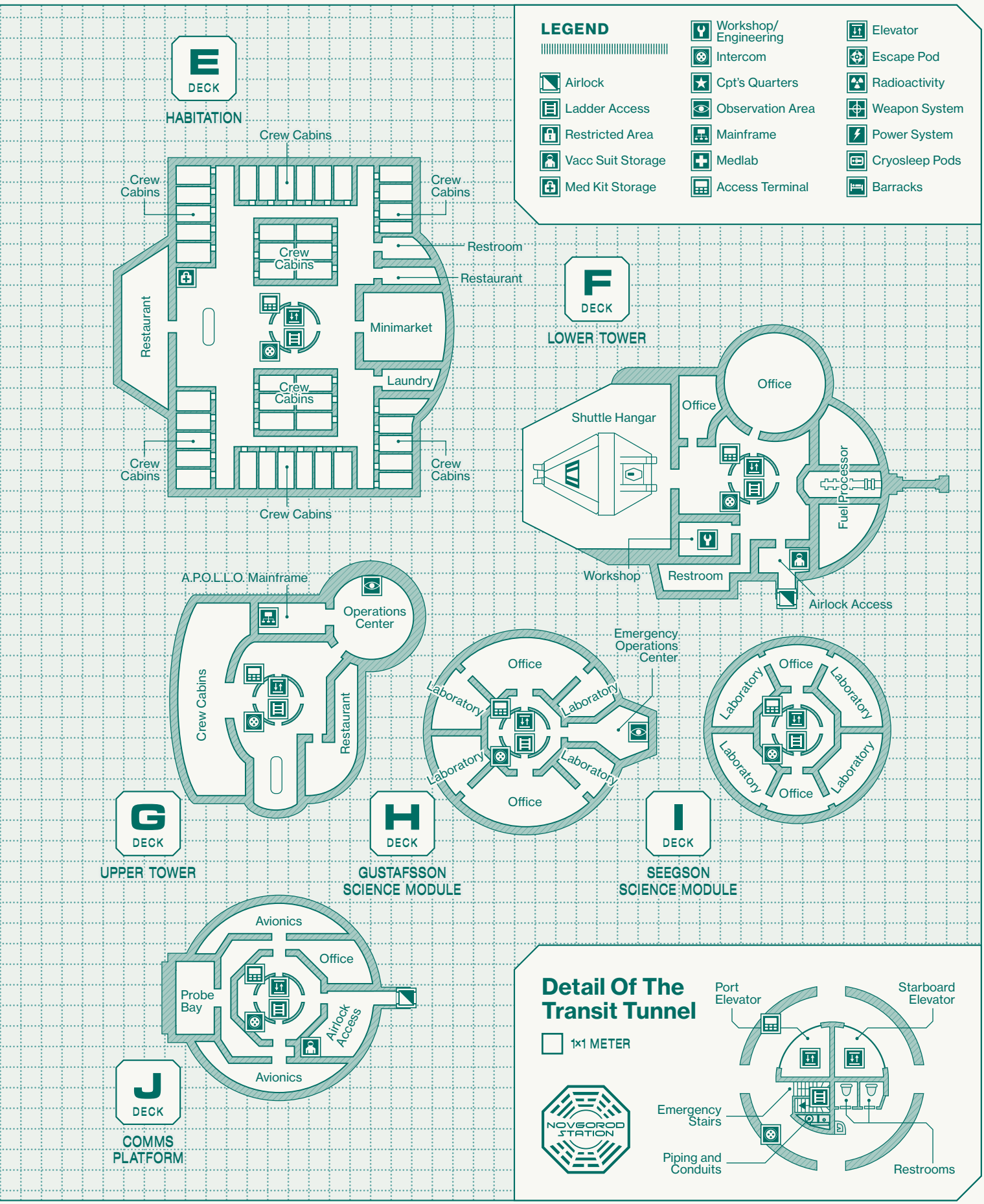
NOVGOROD STATION

3×3 METERS

SEEGSON



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Licensed System (Order: 53151103)

APPENDIX

LIFE PATHS

THIS LIFE PATH GENERATOR randomly determines most aspects of your PC's early life, with a few choices for you to make along the way. The circumstances and events revealed by the dice form the framework of your PC's backstory, leaving you to interpret those events and fill in the gaps in any way you want.

The life path system produces a wide variety of character outcomes and histories and can result in unbalanced PCs. However, there is huge enjoyment in playing a PC whose backstory has dealt them a challenging hand, especially when your PC overcomes their disadvantages to prove the doubters wrong.

The life path does not use the concept of a key attribute, but your choice of career still defines the skills and talents available to you.

Human Or Android?

Roll 2D6. On a result of 11 or 12, you are an android. If you are an android, decide with your GM if you are a secret android (page 25).

Base Attribute Scores

Humans start with a base score of 2 in each attribute. Androids may add +3 to two attributes of their choice before starting their life path. Don't worry about the low scores – you gain more attribute points as you progress through life.

Maximum And Minimum Scores

By the end of the life path, a human PC must have a score of at least 2 in every attribute and cannot have any score greater than 5.

Android PCs can finish their life paths with attribute scores up to 8.

Skill levels can never exceed 5 for any PC. If the random life path roll results in an attribute score or skill level outside of the allowed range, re-roll or choose another result.

Life Path Generation

Follow these steps to determine the life path of your character:

1. Determine if you are **human** or an **android**.
2. Roll for your **origin** and gain 3 points in random **general skills**.
3. Determine your **early life**, gaining 2 **attribute points** and 2 **skill points**.
4. Experience a **life event** – roll to see what befalls you and gain 2 more **attribute points** and 2 points in random **general skills**.
5. Gain 2 points in **attributes of your choice** and then apply for your first **career**. If successful, you gain 2 points in random **career skills**, a roll for **gear**, and a roll for your first **paycheck**.
6. Serve your **first term** – roll to see where you were posted and how well you performed. You gain 1 more point in a random **career skill**, a random **talent**, another roll for **gear**, and another **paycheck** roll.
7. Did you want to serve a **second** and **third term**? Follow the same process for your first term, but for each extra term you must **reduce an attribute** of your choice by 1 point.
8. Get your **psych evaluation**.
9. The **final touches** – your PC's **name**, **appearance**, **age**, **personal agenda**, **signature item**, **buddy** and **rival**.

Origin

Which super-nation were you born into or which one made you? What is your corporate or government sub-affiliation? Where do you call home? Roll 2D6 on the table on the next page to find out, then D6 twice for your sub-affiliation and home. Finally, gain 3 points in random general skills (page 286).

Early Life

What was your early life like, who did you share it with, and what experiences did you have? Roll D66 three times on the table on page 284, once for each column, and add the specified attribute and skill points (2 of each) to your scores. Decide the precise details of your early life experience, depending on whether you are human or an android. You may also gain modifiers to your psych evaluation roll – note these as you go. ▶

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Origin

2D6	SUPERNATION	SUB-AFFILIATION		HOME	
2–4	Independent Core System Colonies	1	Central Space Consortium	1	Sol Sector
		2	Weyland-Yutani	2–5	New Eden Sector
		3	Hyperdyne Systems	6	Frontier colony
		4	Jǐngtì Lóng Corporation		
		5	Lockmart		
		6	Minor Corporation		
5–6	Three World Empire	1–3	Weyland-Yutani	1	Sol Sector
		4	Lasalle Bionational	2–3	Core Systems
		5	Seegson	4–5	Frontier
		6	Minor corporation	6	Far Spinward Colonies
7–8	United Americas	1–3	Weyland-Yutani	1	Sol Sector
		4	Lasalle Bionational	2	Outer Veil
		5	Alphatech Hardware	3	Crestus Prime /Borodino/ Cerberus Sectors
		6	Minor corporation	4	Tartarus/Micor Sectors
				5	Frontier
				6	Far Reach of the American Arm
9–10	Union of Progressive Peoples	1	Space Operating Forces	1–2	Outer Veil/Sol Sector
		2	UPP Frontier Colony Directorate	3–4	Outer Rim colony
		3	Ministry of Space Security	5	Bau Sau Sector
		4	Ministry of Public Health	6	Frontier
		5	Cosmos Exploration Corps		
		6	Proletariat		
11–12	Independents	1	Minor corporation	1	Core Systems
		2	Weyland-Yutani	2	Rimward Frontier
		3	Seegson	3	Spinward Frontier
		4	Lasalle Bionational	4	Trailward Frontier
		5	United Nations	5	Coreward Frontier
		6	None	6	Far Spinward Colonies

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Early Life

D66	YOU WERE A	IN THE COMPANY OF	AND EXPERIENCED
11–13	Prisoner, convict or prison warden +1 Strength, +1 Wits	Your parents or siblings	A stroke of luck that made your life easy or boosted your prospects. +1 **HEAVY MACHINERY**, +1 **MOBILITY**, +2 to your psych evaluation roll
14–16	Space trucker living life in hypersleep +1 Agility, +1 Empathy	Your closest friend or friends	Life as the plaything of a rich dignitary or organization executive. +1 **MANIPULATION**, +1 **PILOTING**, +1 to your psych evaluation roll
21–23	Troublemaker following no rules but your own +1 Wits, +1 Empathy	Dangerous convicts	A job that you didn't hate, that had hopes of advancement and the chance to better your lifestyle. +1 **STAMINA**, +1 **SURVIVAL**, +1 to your psych evaluation roll
24–26	Homeless, surviving from hand to mouth +1 Strength, +1 Agility	Strangers	The opportunity to make someone else's life better, but at a significant personal cost. +1 **MEDICAL AID**, +1 **COMMAND**
31–33	Indentured worker, enslaved to your masters +1 Agility, +1 Empathy	A lover or ex-lover	Time in prison for a crime you may (or may not) have committed, or locked away in a warehouse with other unwanted androids. +1 **CLOSE COMBAT**, +1 **SURVIVAL**
34–36	Warzone refugee, fleeing destruction +1 Strength, +1 Empathy	A bitter rival or enemy	A period of slave labor, under the lash of a brutal chain gang boss. +1 **STAMINA**, +1 **OBSERVATION**
41–43	Religious adept in a brutal cult +1 Wits, +1 Empathy	Bitter indentured workers	Tedious years in space, working for peanuts and forever suffering hypersleep sickness or soul-sucking loneliness. +1 **PILOTING**, +1 **HEAVY MACHINERY**
44–46	Colonist on a backwater planet +1 Agility, +1 Wits	Soldiers or paramilitaries	Isolation on an abandoned colony, having to do unspeakable things just to survive. +1 **CLOSE COMBAT**, +1 **COMTECH**
51–53	Abandoned colonist or ship's crew that needed rescuing +1 Agility, +1 Wits	Androids	Years as a low-level stooge, watching the workers die as you made them do the deadly jobs. +1 **COMMAND**, +1 **RANGED COMBAT**
54–56	Wildcatter, living in your Daihotai tractor +1 Strength, +1 Agility	A super wealthy benefactor	A science facility where you were a test subject, suffering painful and dangerous procedures. +1 **MOBILITY, +1 COMTECH**, –1 to your psych evaluation roll
61–63	Minion working at research facilities +1 Strength, +1 Wits	Desperate or ill people	A no-win situation where you killed someone or through inaction let them die. +1 **RANGED COMBAT**, +1 **MANIPULATION**, –1 to your psych evaluation roll
64–66	Ward of a wealthy person or group of people +1 Strength, +1 Empathy	No one	Time on an isolated research station that malfunctioned, releasing test subjects that wreaked havoc. +1 **OBSERVATION**, +1 **MEDICAL AID**, –2 to your psych evaluation roll

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Life Event

Your life event can take place at any point in the lifepath of your choosing, but is decided now by a D66 roll on the table below. These events offer story hooks and may leave a lasting impact on your PC – the impact should be roleplayed. Agree to the specific details of any event with your GM. Your life event gives you 2 specified attribute points and 2 points in random general skills (page 286). ▶

Life Event

D66	EVENT	ATTRIBUTES
11–12	You live a charmed life – long may this continue! Gain 2D6×50 W-Y dollars, a bonus roll on the Career Gear column of your choice, +2 to psych evaluation roll.	+1 Strength, +1 Empathy
13–14	You commit a crime and think you've got away with it. +1 to psych evaluation roll.	+1 Strength, +1 Wits
15–16	Someone pulls some strings, and you get a place in a specialist school or company college. You gain 1 point in a random general skill.+1 to psych evaluation roll.	+1 Strength, +1 Agility
21–22	You commit a crime and get caught. You cut a deal and get released, but now you're in debt to someone.	+1 Agility, +1 Wits
23–24	You read Space Beast and draw the attention of a Weyland-Yutani exec, who tells you to keep your mouth shut – unless you want to join the team. He leaves you his card, just in case.	+1 Wits, +1 Empathy
25–26	You survive a serious illness but now cannot abide dirt and grime – they harbor deadly bugs.	+1 Agility, +1 Empathy
31–32	You survive a terrible crash. Now you always demand to be the driver or pilot.	+1 Strength, +1 Agility
33–34	You wake from hypersleep to find your crew has died. It was nothing to do with you, but no one believes it.	+1 Strength, +1 Wits
35–36	You find an official secret. Do you keep it, sell it on the black market, or trade it in for favors?	+1 Strength, +1 Empathy
41–42	You scam someone of something valuable, and as far as the law is concerned have done nothing wrong. But they want it back.	+1 Wits, +1 Empathy
43–44	A seismic event destroys your home. Was this a bad thing, destroying your one place of comfort, or did it help you escape the slums?	+1 Agility, +1 Empathy
45–46	An industrial accident leaves you trapped. Now you suffer mild claustrophobia.	+1 Agility, +1 Wits
51–52	You earned enough credits to escape the colony where you work, until they doubled the quota. Your hatred for your oppressors burns fiercely.	+1 Strength, +1 Agility
53–54	You kill someone, or through inaction let them die, and it lies heavy on your conscience. –1 to your psych evaluation roll.	+1 Wits, +1 Empathy
55–56	You survive a fire with horrible burns. Do you fear fire? Or do you love watching it burn? –1 to your psych evaluation roll.	+1 Strength, +1 Wits
61–62	Involved in an industrial accident, someone saves you but pays with their life. You witness their death. Since then, you have told yourself you couldn't save them, but did you really try? –1 to your psych evaluation roll.	+1 Agility, +1 Wits
63–64	You're abandoned and left to die. This betrayal has wounded you so deeply that now you trust no one. Perhaps you want revenge on those who betrayed you. –2 to your psych evaluation roll.	+1 Strength, +1 Empathy
65–66	You come face to face with beastly monsters, but escape. The creatures haunt your dreams. No one believes a word of it, that is, if you even chose to tell anyone. –2 to your psych evaluation roll.	+1 Agility, +1 Empathy

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Random General Skills

D66	SKILL
11–13	CLOSE COMBAT
14–16	HEAVY MACHINERY
21–23	STAMINA
24–26	MOBILITY
31–33	PILOTING
34–36	RANGED COMBAT
41–43	COMTECH
44–46	OBSERVATION
51–53	SURVIVAL
54–56	COMMAND
61–63	MANIPULATION
64–66	MEDICAL AID

Career

Next, gain 2 points in attributes of your choice and then apply for your first career. The table below lists the minimum attribute scores for each career. To apply, make a skill roll against one of the skills listed for the career. The roll cannot be pushed.

- If unsuccessful, you are **rejected** and must apply to a different career (however, you may pull a fast one, see above).
- If you roll one ✥ you join as a standard **recruit**.
- If you roll two or more ✥ someone has noted your potential, and you gain a **favor** – make a roll on the table on the next page.

PULL A FAST ONE

If you fail an application, you can pull a fast one. Your PC does something underhanded or illegal to get around the system, or begs a favor from someone in the hierarchy – settle the details with the GM. Your previously unsuccessful roll now counts as one success, and you're in! But a dangerous secret now hangs over you, or you owe someone a big favor.

PLAYING A KID

The Kid is not a career, it's a lifestyle. You don't need to apply to play a Kid, you may just choose this career. However, Kids are limited to only one term for their career, while the other careers can be extended up to three terms.

You're Hired!

Once recruited, you go into basic training, get geared up, and get your first paycheck.

- Roll D3 twice on the table below for career skills, gaining 1 skill level for each roll.
- Roll once on the gear table for your career (see chapter 2). Re-roll if you roll an item you already have.
- Roll for your first paycheck.

Careers & Career Skills

CAREER	REQUIREMENTS	PAYCHECK	SKILL 1	SKILL 2	SKILL 3
Colonial Marine	Strength 4	D6×$50	CLOSE COMBAT	STAMINA	RANGED COMBAT
Colonial Marshal	Agility 3, Wits 4	D6×$100	RANGED COMBAT	OBSERVATION	MANIPULATION
Company Agent	Wits 4	D6×$500	COMTECH	OBSERVATION	MANIPULATION
Kid	–	D6×$5	MOBILITY	OBSERVATION	SURVIVAL
Medic	Empathy 4	D6×$100	MOBILITY	OBSERVATION	MEDICAL AID
Officer	Wits 3, Empathy 4	D6×$150	RANGED COMBAT	COMMAND	MANIPULATION
Pilot	Agility 4	D6×$100	PILOTING	RANGED COMBAT	COMTECH
Roughneck	Strength 4	D6×$50	CLOSE COMBAT	HEAVY MACHINERY	STAMINA
Scientist	Wits 4	D6×$150	COMTECH	OBSERVATION	SURVIVAL

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Favors

D6	FAVOR
1	**Popular.** Gain +1 bonus to **MANIPULATION** when dealing with your organization.
2	**Free Rein In The Company Warehouse.** Make an additional gear roll for your career.
3	**Generalist Training Program.** You gain 1 point in a random general skill, but owe someone a favor for getting you in.
4	**Specialist Training Program.** You gain 1 point in a random career skill, but owe someone a favor for getting you in.
5	**Bonus.** Make an additional paycheck roll. But don't let this success go to your head, as others envy you.
6	**New Friend.** Someone owes you a favor. But are they really your pal? Can you trust them?

Disasters

D6	DISASTER
1	**Injured.** By accident or someone's design you are severely hurt. Lose 1 attribute point from either Strength or Agility.
2	**Trauma.** You can't forget a terrifying incident. Lose 1 attribute point from either Wits or Empathy.
3	**Lost Something.** Lose a random item of equipment.
4	**Misfortune.** Someone dies, and you are blamed. Branded a Jonah, no one will work with someone cursed with ill-fortune.
5	**Nemesis.** A rival stitches you up, and you are sacked. Time to join the big bad world.
6	**Sacked.** Either through negligence or incompetence your contract is canceled. Time to join the big bad world.

Career Terms

You must serve at least one term in your career but may choose to serve up to three (with the exception of the Kid career, which can only serve one). Follow these steps for each term:

1. **Posting:** What did you do during this term? Roll D6 on the relevant table for your career on page 288 to find out. This can give you a bonus gear roll, and you also gain 1 point in a random career skill.
2. **Performance:** How well did you do your job? Make a skill test against a career skill of your choice (you cannot push):
   - If you fail, you suffer a **disaster** (roll on the table above) and get –1 on your psych evaluation roll (page 288).
   - If you roll one ✦ your performance has been satisfactory.
   - If you roll two or more ✦ you have performed well and gain a **favor** (roll on the table above) and get +1 on your psych evaluation roll (page 288). Re-reroll any favors you already have.
3. **Talent:** Gain one random career talent (see chapter 2). For your second and third term, you may replace this with a general talent of your choice.
4. **Gear & Paycheck:** Make one roll for career gear (see chapter 2). Re-roll any items you already have and make a paycheck roll.

Another Term? Should you choose to serve another term, follow the process for the first term. However, subtract 1 point from an attribute of your choice for each extra term you serve – getting older and weather-beaten does that to you.

Psych Evaluation

Each character ends their life path with their psych evaluation, so the company can see what they've got on their hands. Androids undergo a "product cognitive stability test," and also roll on the table. Players should roleplay the results. Roll 2D6 on the table on page 288 and apply any modifiers you gained during your life path.

Final Touches

Decide your character's name, appearance, age, personal agenda, signature item, and buddies & rivals. To complete this, keep in mind that your PC's formative and life events may drive their personal agenda. Good luck out there – you're gonna need it. ●

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Career Postings

D6	COLONIAL MARINE	COLONIAL MARSHAL	COMPANY AGENT	KID
1	**Garrison Duty.** Tedious but safe.	**Backwater Posting.** There's nothing to investigate here, waste of time.	**Filing.** The worst job, but who knows what you might find in the files.	**Bad Kid.** You spend time in juvenile detention.
2	**Colonial Defense.** Just another bug hunt, dangerous and no one wants to do it.	**Frontier Policing.** Nothing but drunks and bar brawls.	**Seconded.** A flunkey's job and you're going nowhere, unless you can learn something interesting.	**Troubled Kid.** Making trouble to hold off the boredom, you're not popular.
3	**Peacekeeping.** Winning hearts and minds.	**Authority's Stooge.** You're not fighting crime, you're doing the company's dirty work.	**Recruitment.** A shit job, but you know everyone.	**Put To Work.** Thrown into a shit job to keep you out of mischief, it's no fun.
4	**Population Control.** Full scale riot suppression, bashing the strikers.	**Lawless Frontier.** It's you against the gangs, corporations, and racketeers.	**Exec Without Portfolio.** You go where you want, chasing the next big thing.	**School's Out.** You do your classes but play hard too. There's no stopping you once school's out.
5	**Assault Operations.** Lightning raids and nuking from orbit. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Big Colony Beat.** Urban policing, thankless and dangerous. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Special Ops.** Working for top secret facilities and the weapons division. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Permanent Vacation.** Free to do what you want, it's a great way to live. Make a bonus career gear roll.
6	**Combat Operations.** On the frontline, nose to nose with your enemies. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Roving Marshal.** You go where the big crimes are. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Troubleshooter.** Making surprise visits to corporate outfits, and enjoying the power. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**On Your Own.** No one cares what you do, as long as you're out of sight. It's fun and you find all sorts of things. Make a bonus career gear roll.

Psych Evaluation

2D6	PSYCH EVALUATION
≤0	Dangerous, unstable, volatile, prone to psychotic outbursts.
1	Flashbacks and hallucinations, unhinged and unpredictable.
2	Defensive, reactive to minor slights, prone to angry outbursts. An untrustworthy worker.
3–4	Night sweats, nightmares, distressing outbursts. Temperamental and self-pitying.
5–6	Mild trauma, nightmares, nervous episodes. Disruptive, likely to bellyache and bitch.

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MEDIC	OFFICER	PILOT	ROUGHNECK	SCIENTIST
Disaster Relief. You wait for ages, then are too late to help anybody. Soul destroying job.	**Security Detail.** A dead-end job, a punishment posting.	**Dusting Crops.** Shit work in a shit place, and no prospects.	**Colony Miner.** Working in the dark and in the toxic fumes is a job, at least.	**Backwater Lab.** The lowest lab tech, you do the cleaning.
Bad Side Of Town. It's rough and no one wants your help, you have to watch your back.	**Prison Detail.** Putting the convicts to productive work is a challenge when you can only kill a few of them.	**Cargo Hauling.** Short haul drops of toilet paper and toothpaste won't make your career.	**Lawless Colony.** Nothing works, you can never fix it all, and everyone blames you.	**Lawless Colony.** Science officer is a good job, but not in a shithole colony.
Lawless Frontier. Gunshot and stab wounds are your stock in trade.	**Colony Teams.** Getting things done on the frontier doesn't make you popular.	**Smuggler.** It pays the bills if you don't get caught.	**Stevedore.** Cargo gets nowhere without you. Some gets lost, and you get blamed.	**Headhunted.** You're hired for a secret project that goes well, until you're fired.
Training School. You're an instructor but your students don't care.	**Tough Decisions.** You make the big decisions and get the job done, even if some of your team don't make it.	**Space Truckers.** Piloting the interstellar haulers is a tough and respected job, but the pay is shit.	**Wrecking Crew.** Salvaging earns you more than the company dime.	**Science Officer.** Space haulers need you, and the pay is decent for sleeping for a living.
Military. You run with the grunts, keeping them and yourself alive. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Cool Head.** Disaster strikes, you lead those involved until rescue arrives. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Military.** Flying dropships and dropping nukes keeps you on your toes. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Hauler Engineer.** Space trucking is a good job, pays okay, and you sleep most of the time. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Pristine Lab.** Assigned to the best facilities, your research goes far. Make a bonus career gear roll.
Industrial Paramedic. Keeping the workers alive and productive. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Big Boss.** You lead a large team doing a dangerous job on the Frontier. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Chauffeur.** Pilot to the rich and important, you take your boss wherever they want to go. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Big Colony Maintenance.** You keep the lights on, the air breathable, and folks are glad for it. Make a bonus career gear roll.	**Field Research.** Part of a well-funded team out in the field. Make a bonus career gear roll.

2D6	PSYCH EVALUATION
7–8	Well balanced. A good worker.
9–10	Positive and compliant. Follows orders for an easy life.
11–12	Invested in their work. Keen, ambitious, worthy of promotion.
13	Zealously enthusiastic, confident bordering on arrogance. Too keen to please – what are they hiding?
≥14	Supportive of officialdom to the point of fanaticism. Suspect use of illegal mood enhancers. Warrants close monitoring.

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Michael Syrett (Order #53454103)

APPENDIX

LAST SURVIVOR

"This is Ellen Ripley, last survivor of the Nostromo, signing off."

Lt. Ellen Ripley

LAST SURVIVOR IS a solo mode for ALIEN The Roleplaying Game – no Game Mother required. When you take risks, utilize your skills, and encounter danger, make rolls as normal. When the outcome is unclear, lean on the tools presented in these rules to fill in the narrative gaps.

A Brief & Brutal Story

Last Survivor is intended for one-off scenarios. Your PC may survive – but they will most likely perish. Either way, focus on playing through a captivating story with high stakes and insurmountable odds. Depending on the length of your sessions, you might wrap up a mission in a single session, or over the course of a few sessions. ●

CREATING YOUR SURVIVOR

WHEN CREATING YOUR CHARACTER for Last Survivor, follow the guidelines presented in chapter 2.

Solo Survivor Talents

When selecting your talents, consider options that fit your character concept while also providing utility and survivability. See the lists below for recommendations of talents to consider and avoid, but ultimately, choose the talents that best suit your character.

- **Ideal Talents For A Solo PC:** Company Resources (Company Agent), Hard to Catch (Kid), Lucky (Kid), Reckless (Pilot), Resilient (Roughneck), True Grit (Roughneck), Fast Reflexes, Hardened, Last One Standing, Seen it All, Stealthy, Survivor
- **Talents To Avoid As A Solo PC:** Banter (Colonial Marine), Personal Safety (Company Agent), Field Commander (Officer), Frontline Leader (Officer), Bodyguard, Second Wind, Spaceship Commander

Playing A Solo Android

Androids in the ALIEN universe often find themselves alone. Because of this – as well as their increased survivability and resistance to panic – an android makes an ideal solo character. To create an android character, follow the guidelines on page 25.

Extra Talent

Your odds of survival as a solo character are low. To create a solo character with better survivability, choose an extra general talent (page 51).

Solo XP Rewards

Instead of the usual end-of-session experience rewards, solo characters earn XP as they complete objectives using an objective timer (page 302). The greater the starting rank of the objective, the more XP are earned when that objective is reached. See page 302 for details on objective timers. ●

MISSION STARTERS

WITHOUT A GAME MOTHER, you cannot wait for the story to happen to your character. Instead, kick things off with an immediate problem or goal. Before you begin, determine what dangerous situation the character has found themself thrust into.

Use these versatile mission starters to jump right into the action. Each mission is thematically tied to a career on the Frontier (page 16), but anybody can conceivably find themselves entangled in these scenarios.

Space Trucker Missions

- **Nobody's Home:** You finally touch down on a remote settlement after a long, dreamless hypersleep. Your ship carries much-needed supplies for the colony, but you find the settlement deserted, seemingly abandoned.
- **Unearthed Artifact:** The colonists discovered something ancient and alien deep below the settlement. With the colony deserted, you must uncover the truth of the artifact. ▶

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- **Company Meddling:** You quickly uncover signs of genetic manipulation or social experimentation. Discover the fate of the colonists before the colony changes you.
- **Salvage Worth Risking:** You've just been awoken from a dreamless hypersleep by MU/TH/UR, who has picked up something interesting on your sensors. It might be worth a detour to scout it out, but the rest of the crew still slumbers...
- **A Ship You Know:** The decrepit hulk adrift out here is a ship you recognize. Board the vessel and determine its fate.
- **Something Stranger:** This is an alien craft of unknowable make, impossible to separate from the yawning void around it. It could have been drifting out here for centuries. Whatever waits within could be worth a fortune...

Colonial Marine Missions

- **Escort Duty:** Whatever is in the cargo hold must be worth something for the company to spring for a marine escort, even if its just one of you...
- **Beast On The Loose:** The cargo contains an alien lifeform held in stasis. But when the coolant system fails, it bursts from its prison and disappears into a maintenance hatch.
- **Alien Outbreak:** It's an alien pathogen sealed away in the hold, and upon its release, shit hits the fan. Those who survive infection find themselves ... changed. Contain the outbreak, or escape before it claims you too.
- **Out Of The Frying Pan:** You've left the fire, smoke, and blistering pulse rifle rounds behind for some much-needed R&R. You catch a flight toward your destination, and settle in for an (ideally) uneventful trip back to civilization...
- **Pirate Attack:** Opportunistic raiders seize a chance to loot the vessel, unaware of the presence of a Colonial Marine. You alone now stand in their way – but you're outnumbered and outgunned.
- **Engine Trouble:** A ship-wide malfunction leaves you and the crew adrift in deep space. Identify the problem and restore power to the ship.

Frontier Colonist Missions

- **Stowaway:** There aren't many chances for folk like you to get off-world and seek greener pastures – but you've seized an opportunity, stowing away aboard a departing vessel. You emerge from your hiding place and find yourself alone...
- **Massacred Crew:** You emerge to find a bloody scene. The crew of the ship is dead, leaving you as the only apparent survivor. Determine who or what killed the crew and avoid becoming the next casualty.
- **On The Hunt:** You are not the only stowaway aboard this ship, and you soon become aware of something prowling the vents and tunnels, hunting the crew – and you. Discover what it is and live to tell the tale.
- **Falling Star:** A meteorite makes landfall near your home. Recovering the meteorite, you and your fellow colonists find more than you bargained for...
- **Alien Object:** The object defies logic, yet there it rests at the bottom of the crater. Inscribed with indecipherable images and humming with innate power, the object is sure to change the course of your colony – for good or ill.
- **Lurking Presence:** Something slumbers within the meteorite, an ancient malevolence that has known only the cold dark of space for untold eons. Now it yearns for release. What lies within, and can you survive its ire?

Company Rep Missions

- **Frontier Uprising:** Discontented laborers have seized control of a Company station in orbit over a mining planet. You are dispatched to help negotiate a settlement or otherwise quell the uprising.
- **Insurgent Infighting:** The once-united rebels have fragmented over differing ideals and fight for control of the station. Outlast the rebels or broker peace amid the chaos.
- **Falling Station:** The rebels have cut critical systems in their bid for control, dropping the station into a dangerously low orbit. Time is running out to retrieve valuable company assets.
- **Lost Company Property:** An item invaluable to the Company has surfaced. It is critical that you retrieve the item before other interested parties...
- **Flight Recorder:** You arrive at a station to negotiate the return of a long-lost flight recorder, only to discover that the station's leadership wants much more than expected in exchange...
- **Compromised Android:** A Company facility lies in ruin, with multiple casualties and incalculable asset losses. The only record of what transpired rests in the memory banks of an android, who has fled deep into the ruins to avoid retrieval. Track the android and recover it – and its memories. ●

Building A Mission With MAAM

As an alternative to the sample missions listed above, you can use the Mother Analysis and Answer Matrices (see next page) to quickly generate a spark of inspiration. Rolling on the Complex Response Matrix will yield a simple story seed, such as "aid settlement" or "discover wreckage."

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DANGER LEVEL

THE LONGER YOU SURVIVE, the greater the dread and danger. To help manage the pace of your mission, use the danger level. It starts at zero, and maxes out at 10. It determines the current danger phase:

DANGER LEVEL	PHASE	SITUATION
0–3	1	Low danger
4–7	2	Medium danger
8–10	3	High danger

The danger phase affects the result when you roll for a danger event (below), when setting the starting proximity on a danger timer (page 300), and when adding potential complications on an objective check (page 302). The danger level is increased as follows:

- Encountering a danger event prompts you to increase the danger level by +1 or +2.
- Triggering a danger timer (page 300) increases the danger level by +1. ●

MOTHER ANALYSIS & ANSWER MATRICES

"I've got access to Mother now, and I'll get my own answers, thank you."

Lt. Ellen Ripley

WHEN PLAYING LAST SURVIVOR, you do so without a Game Mother. In their place, you can use the Mother Analysis and Answer Matrices (MAAM) to help guide the way through your mission.

You needn't use these tools each time you have a question in solo play. Often, the answer will be obvious based on the situation. When in doubt, err in favor of a dramatic, dangerous story.

Event Check

2D6	RESULT
2	Roll for two danger events and danger level +2
3–4	Roll for one danger event and danger level +1
5–10	No event
11–12	Opportunity event (page 295)

Event Check

Through the course of your character's mission, you'll make event checks to add new and unexpected complications, troubling twists, or – more rarely – lucky breaks. Make an event check when:

- You roll on the Binary Response Matrix (page 295) or Complex Response Matrix (page 296) to ask a question or gain a detail. If an event is triggered, resolve the answer to your question and the details of the event in whatever order you like.
- You transition to a new scene with a time jump, move to a new location, or tie up a major element of your mission. Whenever you are uncertain if the situation remains as-is or if there's a wrench thrown in the works, make an event check.

To make an event check, roll 2D6 on the table above.

Danger Events

Rolling a danger event on the event check table introduces a new or evolving complication in your mission. Consider an event that fits the current situation or use the Danger Event Matrix on the next page for inspirational prompts. In addition, you must add +1 to your danger level when triggering a danger event.

You can also use the Danger Event Matrix whenever it feels like your session needs a jolt. If you are ever unsure what happens next, increase the danger level by +1 and roll for a danger event to make something happen.

- To determine your danger event, first roll D66 for the event focus and then 2D6 + current danger level for the event detail.

If the event doesn't fit your mission or situation, check adjacent rows for inspiration. Or just choose a focus and roll for the event details. ▶

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Danger Event Matrix

2D6 + Danger Level

D66	EVENT FOCUS	EVENT DETAIL: 2–10	EVENT DETAIL: 11–15	EVENT DETAIL: 16+
11	Adversary	Adversary revealed	Adversary gains an advantage	Adversary seizes an objective
12	Alarm	Under surveillance	Security protocols activated	Blaring alarms
13	Alien	Biological evidence	First contact	Major presence
14	Ally	Ally in danger	Separated from each other	True identity or motive revealed
15	Android	Malfunctioning or damaged	Twitchy	Corrupted or destructive
16	Clues	Troubling data	False leads	Distressing revelation
21	Command	New orders	Incompetent leaders	Left for dead
22	Comms	Distress signal	Desperate plea	Comms go quiet
23	Community	Isolated community	Threatened habitat	Abandoned or destroyed
24	Company	Scheming influence	Company takes control	True motivation revealed
25	Crew	Squabbling crewmates	Infighting	Betrayal or abandonment
26	Darkness	Flickering lights	Hidden danger	Total darkness
31	Enemies	Lone enemy	Enemy group	Swarming enemies
32	Environment	Minor environmental hazard	Hostile environment	Environmental disaster
33	Faction	Antagonistic faction revealed	Faction exerts force or influence	Factions at war
34	Fear	Fears kindled	Fear overrides logic	Panic takes hold
35	Gear	Depleted or malfunctioning item	Lost or broken equipment	Vital gear lost or broken
36	Gravity	Zero-G	Orbital decay	Crushing pressure
41	Infection	Signs of infection	Quarantined	Sudden outbreak
42	Isolation	Cut off	Left behind	Outnumbered
43	Machine	Minor malfunction	Dangerous malfunction	Total failure
44	Military	Minor military presence	Major intervention	Scorched earth
45	Mission	Minor complication	Major complication	Mission undone
46	Mutation	Parasitic infestation	Emerging lifeforms	Body remade
51	Pathway	Treacherous path	Blocked or sealed path	Deadly path
52	Power	Power fluctuations	Power fails	Reactor meltdown
53	Science	Mysterious specimen or artifact	Dangerous experiment	Containment breach
54	Sound	Mysterious sound	Unsettling sound	Horrifying sound
55	Space	Oppressive void	Collision course	Celestial catastrophe
56	Spaceship	Damage or malfunction	Hull breach	Impending destruction
61	Survivors	Strange disappearances	Casualties	Wiped out
62	Technology	Failing technology	Sabotaged technology	Rogue technology
63	Time	Wasted time	Impending deadline	Time runs out
64	Violence	Signs of violence	Grisly remains	Carnage
65	Weapon	Low ammo	Ineffective against threat	Lost or destroyed
66	Xenomorph	Facehugger	Drone or stalker	Queen

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Opportunity Events

An opportunity event adds a positive twist or helpful asset to your mission. Depending on the nature of your mission, this might serve as a milestone that triggers an objective check (page 302). An opportunity event is prompted by the event check table (page 293). In addition, you can introduce an opportunity event when a MAAM response indicates a positive twist is at-hand. Such rewards should be rare.

Opportunity Event Matrix

D66	EVENT
11–16	Early warning of a danger
21–26	Helpful item
31–36	Needed clue
41–43	Secure location
44–46	Shortcut or safer path
51–53	Significant device or artifact
54–56	Timely communication
61–63	Unexpected ally
64–66	Useful supplies

Binary Responses

Use this tool when posing a question with a simple "yes" or "no" response, such as:

- *"Are there weapons stored in the cargo hold?"*
- *"Does this dead guard carry a security keycard?"*
- *"Is the artificial gravity functioning?"*

If either answer is about equally likely, roll a D6. If a "yes" response has a high probability, roll two D6s and take the highest result. If a "no" has a high probability, roll two D6s and take the lowest. If your PC has a stake in the situation, phrase your question so that a "yes" response is the most positive. Check the adjacent Binary Response Matrix for your answer.

Rolling a "strong no" or "strong yes" response usually denotes additional details or unusual circumstances. The answer to your question is unequivocal, and you discover or realize something more.

- Your character explores a derelict settlement. As your PC breaks into a locked storeroom, you ask the Binary Response Matrix if the compartment holds anything useful. A "strong yes" might mean they have stumbled into a well-stocked armory, while a "strong no" could mean that the place has already been ransacked and cleared out.
- Your character flees through the bowels of a ship. As your PC rounds a corner, you ask the Binary Response Matrix if there are any good hiding spots in view. A "strong yes" might reveal a hatch that can be sealed shut behind them, while a "strong no" could mean that your PC stares down a dead-end corridor.

Binary Response Matrix

D6	RESULT	D6	RESULT
1	Strong no	4–5	Yes
2–3	No	6	Strong yes

Complex Responses

Throughout your sessions of Last Survivor, you may find yourself asking nuanced, open-ended questions that necessitate more than a simple "yes" or "no" answer. In these cases, the Complex Response Matrix on the next page provides more descriptive, thematic answers that you can apply based on the current situation, mission, and environment.

You can roll on a single column (Directive or Subject) for an answer, or roll on both columns to build a phrase. You can take the result literally and apply it to your situation, interpret it to fit the context, or roll again for a more applicable answer. ▶

Question	Result	Interpretation
"What data is stored on this terminal?"	Death (subject)	The computer contains death records for the colonists who once lived here.
"Why did the Company abandon this place?"	Explore (directive)	The facility was a base camp for expeditions into the surrounding alien landscape.
"What is the purpose of this facility?"	Sabotage Supplies (directive + subject)	An uprising by disgruntled laborers left the colony isolated and without supplies.

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Complex Response Matrix

D66	DIRECTIVE	SUBJECT
11	Abandon	Alarm
12	Aid	Alien
13	Alert	Android
14	Ambush	Artifact
15	Attack	Authority
16	Betray	Cargo
21	Breach	Company
22	Capture	Computer
23	Command	Containment
24	Construct	Darkness
25	Create	Data
26	Deliver	Death
31	Destroy	Device
32	Discover	Environment
33	Escape	Experiment
34	Escort	Fear
35	Explore	Focus
36	Heal	Gravity
41	Hide	Hostility
42	Hunt	Injury
43	Infest	Machine
44	Investigate	Message
45	Isolate	Military
46	Preserve	Mission
51	Protect	Organism
52	Quarantine	Outbreak
53	Reclaim	People
54	Repair	Planet
55	Sabotage	Settlement
56	Scavenge	Ship
61	Secure	Supplies
62	Survive	Time
63	Threaten	Trap
64	Transform	Violence
65	Transport	Weapon
66	Unearth	Wreckage

Location Details

While playing as the Last Survivor, you spend much of your time envisioning the world around your PC, imagining the strobe-lit corridors of starships, the claustrophobic confines or orbital stations and planetary colonies, and the enigmatic environments of alien ruins or derelicts. When you need inspiration, use the tables on the following pages. They offer aspects and discoveries for some commonly explored locations. They include:

- **Section Matrix:** Use the table below when you are exploring a human starship, orbital station, or colony to help reveal the purpose of an area. The answer should offer clues for what you would typically see or find there.
- **Access Matrix:** Use the table to the right to reveal the connection between sections of a human starship, orbital station, or colony. This can help if mapping out a location or imagining the potential obstacles when traversing from one section to the next.
- **Environment Matrix:** Use the table to the far right for a descriptive prompt for an area within a human starship, orbital station, or colony. The answer may reveal mundane details or unexpected mysteries or obstacles.

Section Matrix

D66	SECTION
11–12	Armory/Weapons
13–14	Barracks/Quarters
15–16	Cargo/Storage
21–22	Command/Bridge
23–24	Communal/Recreation
25–26	Cryosleep
31–32	Factory/Production
33–34	Galley/Kitchen
35–36	Garden/Hydroponics
41–42	Machine Room/Maintenance
43–44	Medical/Infirmary
45–46	Offices/Corporate suites
51–52	Power/Reactor
53–54	Science/Research
55–56	Security/Brig
61–62	Technology/Mainframe
63–64	Vehicle Bay/Hangar
65–66	Workshop/Engineering

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Access Matrix

D66	EVENT
11-26	Corridor
31-36	Stairs/Ladder
41-43	Crawlspace/Duct
44-46	Lift
51-52	Airlock
53-54	Catwalk
55-56	Vertical Shaft
61-66	Junction (roll twice)

- **Salvage Matrix:** Use the table below when searching or scrounging within a human starship, orbital station, or colony.
- **Anomalous Environment Matrix:** Use the table on the next page for details observed when exploring an alien derelict or ruin, or while navigating a ship or facility transformed by Xenomorphs or biological corruption. ●

Environment Matrix

D66	ENVIRONMENT	D66	ENVIRONMENT
11	Anomalous	41	Flooded
12	Abandoned	42	Illuminated
13	Acid-scarred	43	Inhabited
14	Airless	44	Radioactive
15	Barricaded	45	Ransacked
16	Bloodied	46	Sealed
21	Breached	51	Secure
22	Bullet-riddled	52	Silent
23	Claustrophobic	53	Smoke-filled
24	Collapsing	54	Sparking
25	Contaminated	55	Stinking
26	Corpse-strewn	56	Stockpiled
31	Darkened	61	Strobe-lit
32	Dripping	62	Toxic
33	Echoing	63	Trapped
34	Empty	64	Weightless
35	Expansive	65	Wrecked
36	Flickering	66	Roll twice

Salvage Matrix

D66	COMMON SALVAGE	RARE SALVAGE	D66	COMMON SALVAGE	RARE SALVAGE
11	Ammo	Weapon scope	41	Improvised weapon	Heavy weapon
12	Bloody jumpsuit	Vintage watch	42	Keycard	Hazmat suit
13	Bolt gun	Survival suit	43	Machine parts	Handwritten access code
14	Bottled water	Surgical kit	44	Magnetic tape recorder	Handheld x-ray
15	Compression suit	Stun baton	45	Magnetic tape cassette	Grenade
16	Cutting torch	Stash of recreational drugs	46	Medkit	Grappling gun
21	Data disc	Stash of hard liquor	51	Personal communicator	Geiger counter
22	Data tablet	Rifle	52	Personal data transmitter	Folding winch
23	Dog tags	Radiation detection kit	53	Pharmaceuticals	Folder of sensitive documents
24	E-series watch	Pressure suit	54	Pistol	Flare pistol
25	Emergency respirator	Neuro visor	55	Power cell	Explosive charges
26	Faded photograph	Muzzle suppressor	56	Prefab meal	Diagnostic device
31	Fire axe	Motion tracker	61	Religious symbol	Coolant canister
32	Flares	Maintenance jack	62	Rope	Combat knife
33	Flashlight	Incinerator unit	63	Stash of cigarettes	Body armor
34	Folded map	Hidden surveillance device	64	Toolkit	Biological specimen
35	Handwritten journal	Hidden corpse	65	Utility knife	Binoculars
36	Hastily scrawled message	Hidden access hatch	66	Voice recorder	Alien artifact

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Anomalous Environment Matrix

D66	DETAIL
11	Abandoned gear
12	Alien vegetation
13	Altered gravity
14	Ancient remains
15	Biological growths
16	Blood trail
21	Chitinous surfaces
22	Cocooned victims
23	Confounding device
24	Creeping mist
25	Dark pit
26	Discordant noise
31	Dismantled technology
32	Dripping ichor
33	Eerie light
34	Egg fragments
35	Empty vessels
36	Energy field
41	Enigmatic machine
42	Etched glyphs
43	Extreme temperatures
44	Flickering hologram
45	Leathery eggs
46	Mirrored surfaces
51	Moving architecture
52	Mutated remains
53	Organism fused with machinery
54	Ornate carvings
55	Pooled liquids
56	Radioactive hot spot
61	Remains of intruders
62	Rotting matter
63	Sealed cylinders
64	Strange altar
65	Unknown tracks
66	Unnerving shadows

MULTIPLE ⊕

WHEN ROLLING MULTIPLE ⊕ in a skill roll in solo play, either interpret the results and apply an appropriate narrative benefit, or choose a result from the adjacent table. Choose and apply only one benefit per roll, even if you roll more than one additional ⊕.

RESULT	EFFECT
Confident	Reduce stress level by –1.
Fast	Perform the action faster than expected. If making a danger timer check (page 303), roll –1 stress die.
Impressive	Impress others. Gain +1 base die within this scene when using Empathy-based skills.
Intimidating	Cause enemies to falter or hesitate. –1 base die for any skill rolls or attacks made against you.
Observant	Notice an important detail or clue. Gain +1 base die on next skill roll that relates to acting on this information.
Skillful	Gain +1 base die on next skill roll.
Unnoticed	Perform the action with subtlety or stealth. If making an encounter check or facing an **OBSERVATION** check by an NPC, –1 base die.

STRESS & PANIC

Stress Response

When playing Last Survivor, use the normal table for stress responses. It's repeated to the right for reference.

Panic Rolls

Use the below modified panic roll triggers for a solo PC. More broadly, make a panic roll when you face a horrifying event, such as the death of an important character, a terrible discovery, or a dreadful complication that makes it seem as if all hope is lost.

- You see a Xenomorph for the first time.
- A Xenomorph comes within Adjacent range (even if you have seen it before).
- Any other truly horrifying event occurs.

Solo Panic Response

When playing Last Survivor, use the alternative table on the next page for panic responses. ▶

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Solo Stress Response

D6 + Stress Level − Resolve

RESULT	RESPONSE
≤0	**Keeping Cool.** No effect.
1	**Jumpy.** When you push a skill roll, you gain +2 stress level instead of +1.
2	**Tunnel Vision.** All skill rolls based on Wits get –2 dice.
3	**Aggravated.** All skill rolls based on Empathy get –2 dice.
4	**Shakes.** All skill rolls based on Agility get –2 dice.
5	**Frantic.** All skill rolls based on Strength get –2 dice.
6	**Deflated.** You cannot push any skill rolls. If you are Jumpy (#1 above), remove that response, and ignore any further Jumpy results while Deflated.
7+	**Mess Up.** Your action fails regardless of ✠ rolled and you gain +1 stress level.

Solo Panic Response

D6 + Stress Level − Resolve

RESULT	RESPONSE
≤0	**Keeping Cool.** No effect.
1	**Spooked.** Stress level +1.
2	**Noisy.** If you are hiding or attempting to sneak past an enemy, an NPC in the same zone will immediately detect you. Encounter checks are made with +1 die.
3	**Twitchy.** Make an immediate supply roll for the gear that is most relevant to the current situation (air, ammo, or power).
4	**Lose Item.** You lose a weapon or other important item. Choose a relevant item, or assign a number (1–6) to each item and roll a D6 to see which is lost. In combat, you can pick up the item with a quick action. Out of combat, you need an **OBSERVATION** roll and a stretch of time to find the item.
5	**Indecisive.** Make a check on any active danger timers. If no timers are active, decide how your delay complicates the current situation.
6	**Hesitant**. You automatically get the #10 initiative card in combat until your panic stops.
7	**Freeze.** You're frozen by fear, losing your next turn and unable to perform any interrupt actions before then.
8	**Seek Cover.** You immediately seek (full) cover in the zone, if it is cluttered. This is an interrupt action breaking the turn order. Once in cover, your stress level is reduced 1 step, but you lose your next turn and are unable to perform any interrupt actions before then. If you are in an open zone, you Scream instead (below).
9	**Scream.** You scream your lungs out, losing your next turn and unable to perform any interrupt actions before then. Your stress level is reduced 1 step.
10	**Flee.** You immediately move away from the source of panic, into any adjacent zone, if such a move is possible. This is an interrupt action breaking the turn order. After the move, your stress level is reduced 1 step. On your next turn and subsequent turns, you must spend all your actions to continue to move away, until you find a (reasonably) safe place, where you must remain until your panic stops. You cannot perform interrupt actions before then. If you cannot move out of your zone, you become Catatonic (result #12) instead.
11	**Frenzy.** You immediately attack the nearest person or creature, friendly or not. You won't stop until you or the target is broken, or until your panic stops. You cannot perform interrupt actions before then.
12+	**Catatonic.** You're doomed! You collapse to the floor and can't move, rambling or staring blankly into oblivion, until your panic stops.

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Stopping Panic

As in the standard rules, panic stops after you are broken or when a stretch passes. In addition, since you don't have fellow PCs to talk you down, you can use the presence and support of fellow NPC survivors to help stop panic. To do so, make an Empathy roll. If you are using a survivor timer (next page) in your mission, you can add two base dice and one stress die to reflect their aid (next page). ●

DANGER TIMERS

"T-minus-45 minutes to impact event."

MU/TH/UR 9000, Renaissance Station

IN SOLO PLAY, danger timers tick away in the background for minutes or hours, counting down to new complications, frightening twists, and disastrous events. Danger timers motivate a balance of speed and caution. To keep the pressure on, always keep at least one timer running – especially when navigating or exploring a dangerous location.

Starting A Timer

To start a danger timer, first decide what event the timer will trigger when it counts down. You may have a specific outcome in mind which fits the context of the mission thus far. Otherwise, just flag a timer as "bad thing happens" and start the clock. In that case, your PC has only a foreboding sense of impending doom, but lacks specifics. You'll find out together.

You can also look to a MAAM tool for inspiration. Roll on the Complex Response Matrix (page 296) and interpret the answer. Or use the Danger Event Matrix (page 294), choosing a result in the rightmost column as the event.

Next, give the event a proximity using the adjacent table. If unsure, roll 2d6 to pick a proximity based on the current danger phase.

Checking Timers

Unlike the countdown timers described on page 55, you needn't make a check in each combat round for a danger timer. Instead, check your active timers as time passes between scenes, when you encounter delays, when you move from one zone to another in stealth mode (page 55), or if you linger in an area or perform a complex task.

To check a danger timer, roll a number of stress dice according to the event proximity, as shown in the danger timer table. For each ☣ rolled, shift the event proximity closer by one step. For example, from distant to approaching. Repeat this check for each active timer. As an event nears, you roll fewer dice when making a check – time seems to slow down, and every moment counts.

If you are engaged in a lengthy scene or action, or if you take longer performing a task than expected, roll +1 stress die on each active timer to increase the chance of a timer advancing. Similarly, if you manage to perform a task in less time than normal, roll –1 die (minimum one die). Creeping or rushing in stealth mode (page 303) also modifies the dice rolled by +1 and –1, respectively.

Triggering A Timer

When a danger timer drops to now, you have run out of time. If you survive, do what you must to deal with the consequences. If the timer was a placeholder for an unknown event, decide what happens (with the help of a MAAM tool if needed). In addition, triggering a timer increases the danger level by one.

Stopping A Timer

Depending on the circumstances, you might have a chance to stop a timer. For example, if you can reach the computer core before the ship self-destructs, you might convince Mother to stop the countdown. Racing against time to avert a catastrophe is the perfect foundation for a solo scenario.

Once a timer is triggered or stopped – assuming your character survives and their mission continues – it's time to add another. Don't let up.

Danger Timer

2D6 By Danger Phase			EVENT	STRESS
LOW	MEDIUM	HIGH	PROXIMITY	DICE
2–4	2–3	–	Remote	6
5–6	4–5	2–3	Distant	5
7–8	6–7	4–6	Approaching	4
9–10	8–9	7–8	Soon	3
11–12	10–11	9–10	Looming	2
–	12	11–12	Imminent	1
–	–	–	Now	–

- **Prolonged scenes or actions** +1 die
- **Creeping in stealth mode** +1 die
- **Speedy actions** –1 die (minimum 1)
- **Rushing in stealth mode** –1 die (minimum 1)

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Other Timers

Last Survivor uses three additional variations of timers: the survivor timer (detailed in the next section), an objective timer (page 302), and the encounter timer (page 303). These can function independently of – and alongside – one or more danger timers. ●

SURVIVOR TIMER

"We have twenty-five prisoners in this facility."

Harry Andrews

YOUR CHARACTER IS THE FOCUS of Last Survivor, but other characters might have a role in aiding your mission, or as the unfortunate victims of xenomorphs and other threats. Rather than tracking Health and stress for friendly and neutral NPCs, you can use the survivor timer to gauge the group's overall health, morale, and capabilities.

Setting The Survivor Timer

At the start of a mission that involves friendly or neutral NPCs, or when a group of NPCs is introduced, set the starting status on the survivor timer.

- For a group of NPCs who are going about their duties unaware of the dangers to come, set the timer to unified.
- If the NPCs are in the midst of a stressful situation, set the timer to strained.
- If they have already faced casualties, set the timer to diminished.

Survivor Timer

STATUS	STRESS DICE
Unified	6
Strained	5
Diminished	4
Overwhelmed	3
Desperate	2
Last Stand	1
You are the Last Survivor	–

- **Expertise bonus:** +2 base dice when survivors take actions suited to their role or capability. If the situation favors them to a great degree, roll +3 base dice.

Survivor Check

Whenever survivors face a threat or attempt a dangerous action, make a survivor check by rolling the number of stress dice corresponding to their current status. If they are performing an action suited to their particular role or capabilities, also roll +2 base dice as an expertise bonus. If the situation favors them to a great degree, roll +3 base dice. Then, interpret the result as follows.

- If you roll one or more ✦, the survivors gain some measure of success – at least temporarily. The more ✦ rolled, the greater the success or impact on the scene. When the survivors take action in a fight, convert each ✦ to 2 points of damage and apply that damage to NPC enemies as appropriate.
- If you roll one or more 🦂, the survivors suffer setbacks. For each 🦂 rolled, the status is shifted down by one step. For example, from overwhelmed to desperate. Depending on the situation, casualties can be interpreted as deaths, injuries, infighting, or panic – or some combination of those. If unsure, ask the Binary Response Matrix.
- A combination of ✦ and 🦂 means the survivors achieved some success – but at a cost.

Aid From Survivors

When a group of survivors directly aids one of your skill tests in a dangerous situation, add two base dice and one stress die to your roll. The extra dice represent the help provided by other survivors and the risk they are taking.

- ✦ are added to your roll as normal.
- You can apply the impact of any 🦂 to the survivor timer instead of triggering a stress response for yourself.

Multiple Survivor Timers

If your mission involves multiple groups of friendly or neutral NPCs, you can use a separate survivor timer to track the status of each.

Off-Screen Survivors

When the action is entirely focused on your PC, it can be helpful to make occasional checks on the survivor timer to see how others are faring. Make this check at least once per game session or per shift of in-game time.

- If survivors are undertaking an extended, risky project, make the check using bonus base dice for expertise as normal. This will determine both their success on the project and whether they suffer any casualties.
- If the survivors are not taking on a risky project or directly engaging a threat, make the check using only stress dice. Their expertise is not a factor.
- If these checks indicate that the survivor timer shifts down, consider how these casualties manifest. ●

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OBJECTIVE TIMER

WHILE DANGER TIMERS and survivor timers represent an inevitable countdown to doom, objective timers help gauge the pursuit of your character's mission-based goals.

You can also use the objective timer as a measure of your exploration or progress through a location when not using a map as a visual aid. For each zone you traverse (using the guidelines on the page 303), make a check on the objective timer.

- In your mission to retrieve the data from a lost flight recorder, you set an objective of "Find the flight recorder." After you complete that objective and reclaim the recorder, you set a new objective of "Extract encoded data from flight recorder."
- As you wind your way through the bowels of a spaceship on the verge of critical failure, you set an objective of "Find an escape pod." When the power fails and the pod won't launch, you are sidetracked by a new objective: "Restore the ship's power."

Setting The Objective Timer

To start an objective timer, give it a name and a starting status: out of reach, far off, manageable, or near. Your progress toward more distant objectives is slower, but they offer a higher experience reward once complete.

Progression

Whenever you make progress on an objective, make an objective check. Roll a number of base dice corresponding to the objective's current status. For each ⊕ rolled, advance the timer one step. For example, from near to within reach.

Objective Timer

OBJECTIVE STATUS	BASE DICE	XP
Out Of Reach	1	6
Far Off	2	4
Manageable	3	2
Near	4	1
Within Reach	5	–
Achievable	6	–
Objective Reached	–	–

- **Medium Danger** — Swap in 1 stress die
- **High Danger** — Swap in 2 stress dice

If you fail to roll any ⊕, consider how the objective remains unreachable, why this milestone fails to contribute meaningfully toward your goal, or what new minor complication crops up.

Achieving An Objective

Once the objective timer drops to objective reached, your objective is at hand. No other checks on the timer are necessary, although you might face skill rolls or encounters related to the nature of the objective. For example, you reach the shuttle on the landing pad of the crumbling facility, but must still launch the vessel and escape.

When an objective is completed, you earn XP based on the starting status of the objective, as shown on the objective timer table.

Complications

When the danger level (page 294) is medium, replace one of the base dice with a stress die as you make an objective check. When it is high, swap in two stress dice.

☠ results cancel out ⊕, one-for-one. If you roll more ☠ than ⊕, you must also shift the objective one step higher. For example, from manageable to far off. Consider the nature of the complication, using the Complex Response Matrix (page 296) for inspiration. Overcoming this new complication can act as a milestone for your next objective check.

Failing An Objective

If an objective falls out of reach due to circumstances in your mission or choices made by your character, discard the timer. ●

SOLO STEALTH & ENCOUNTERS

"... stay calm and stay quiet."

Andy

IN LAST SURVIVOR, an alternate stealth mode provides tools to navigate environments and trigger enemy encounters without a GM.

The solo stealth and encounter rules are used in tense exploration, stealth, or escape scenes where a hostile encounter might break out. Movement from place to place without the chance of encountering an enemy should not be tracked and resolved at this level of detail.

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Locations And Zones

A location represents a dangerous or unknown site, such as an alien derelict, abandoned station, or xenomorph-infested ship. As with standard movement, a location is divided into zones (page 54).

If you are using official maps for a location, use a token or miniature to track the location of your PC as you move from zone to zone. You can also use the map to mark the location of suspected enemies or important objectives.

If you are playing without a map, zones act as an abstract measure of your movement from one area to another. It may also help to sketch out a rough diagram as you proceed through a location, treating it like a flowchart of connecting zones.

Setting The Encounter Timer

When exploring an unknown location, or while attempting to search for, evade, or escape an enemy presence, use an encounter timer (below) to track the proximity of a potential encounter.

Encounter Timer

ENEMY PRESENCE	STRESS DICE
All Clear	1
Uncertain	2
Suspected	3
Confirmed	4
Closing	5
Near	6
Encountered	–

▶ **Making noise**	+1 die
▶ **Rushing**	+1 die
▶ **Creeping**	–1 die (minimum 1)

An encounter timer functions similarly to a danger timer (page 300), but in reverse. The number of dice you roll to check for an encounter increases as you explore a location. Rolling on this timer is called an encounter check and is done when you move from zone to zone or linger in a zone. The starting enemy presence should be set as best fits the circumstances.

- ▶ If you are navigating an unknown location without any forewarning or suspicion of enemies, set it to all clear.
- ▶ If there are known enemies, set it to confirmed to start.
- ▶ If enemies are already converging on you, set it to closing or near.

Using An Objective Timer

Optionally, you can use an objective timer (page 302) to track your progress through a location, especially when playing without a map. The timer will help set the pace of your exploration and mark the moment when you reach your objective.

Choosing Your Approach

Each time you move from one zone to another, decide your approach.

- ▶ **Stealthy:** You are moving cautiously from zone to zone, keeping a low profile and remaining wary of dangers. This is the default mode and has no effect on your die rolls.
- ▶ **Creeping:** You are moving with abundant caution. When you make an encounter check (page 304), roll –1 stress die (to a minimum of 1). When you roll **OBSERVATION** for your PC, gain +1 die, and any NPC using **OBSERVATION** to spot you loses –1 die. However, your wariness comes at the cost of speed – you must make danger timer checks with +1 stress die.
- ▶ **Rushing:** You attempt to outrun a deadline or flee from an enemy. When you make an encounter check, add +1 stress die, and any **OBSERVATION** rolls made against you gain +1 die. Your own **OBSERVATION** rolls are made with –1 die. The good news? Your speed gives you an advantage against any danger timer checks, which are made with –1 stress die. ▶

Movement Modes

MODE	ENCOUNTER CHECKS	OBSERVATION ROLLS BY YOU	OBSERVATION ROLLS AGAINST YOU	DANGER TIMER CHECKS
Stealthy (default)	–	–	–	–
Creeping	–1 die (min 1)	+1 die	–1 die	+1 die
Rushing	+1 die	–1 die	+1 die	–1 die (min 1)

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Making Encounter Checks

Make an encounter check as you move from one zone to another. You should also make an encounter check if you linger in a zone for a stretch or longer to search or perform some other activity.

To make the check, roll a number of stress dice equal to the current enemy presence. For each rolled, shift the enemy presence one step closer. For example, from confirmed to closing.

If you are exploring a location without a known enemy, the progression of the encounter timer – at least until the later phases – represents subtle signs that someone or something else is in this place. As the timer ticks down, the signs are more overt.

Sighting Enemies

You can use the number of rolled on the encounter check as a gauge for the certainty that an enemy is near. A single is a subtle indication that others are in this location. Two is clear evidence that an enemy is drawing closer. Three or more is an unmistakable sign that you are in danger.

ROLLED	EVIDENCE OF AN ENEMY PRESENCE
1	Imprecise pings on a motion tracker, vague sounds of movement, trails or tracks, evidence that someone has passed this way
2	Clear pings on a motion tracker, sightings of enemies on remote cameras, sounds coming nearer
3+	Urgent pings on motion tracker, shadows in your peripheral, nearby sounds, movement in the area

Triggering An Encounter

When you make an encounter check and shift the enemy presence to encountered, you must face a potential enemy. If the nature of an encounter is obvious, make it happen. Decide the specifics of the enemy you face and draw initiative. If you're not sure, use the encounter check to reveal additional details, as described below.

Revealing Encounter Details

The encounter check is multi-faceted. After you've rolled the check, keep the dice and use the same roll to reveal additional details about the behavior of your enemy.

- Using the highest die rolled, check the table for enemy behavior above. This indicates who has the advantage at the start of the encounter.
- Using the number of rolled, consult the table for enemy threat on the next page to gauge the severity of the threat.

Enemy Behavior

HIGHEST DIE	BEHAVIOR	EFFECT
	Stalking, hidden, or lying in wait	NPCs automatically spot the PC. PC rolls **OBSERVATION** to spot the NPCs.
5	Searching or hunting	PC automatically spots the NPCs. NPCs roll **OBSERVATION** to spot the PC.
4	Passive	PC automatically spots the NPCs. NPCs are unaware.
2–3	False alarm	Non-hostile NPCs or unfounded fear.
	Ambushing	Draw initiative. PC is surprised.

Enemy Behavior

The above table helps determine the behavior of an enemy at the start of the encounter. Check the highest stress die on your encounter check against the table below.

When playing Last Survivor, you can simply assume that zones are cluttered. However, a map or the nature of an environment can lead to a different situation from one zone to the next. If unsure if a zone is cluttered, ask the Binary Response Matrix (page 295), giving "yes" a high probability.

If the zone is open, the PC and the NPCs automatically spot each other at the start of the encounter. You can ignore the listed effect and draw initiative. If the zone is cluttered, the effect result may force an **OBSERVATION** check for either the PC or NPCs.

As with the standard stealth gameplay (page 56), If one side remains unspotted, they may:

- Reveal their presence.
- Back out the way they came.
- Ambush their foes.
- Hide in the zone.

NPCs with the advantage should take the most sensible action at the start of an encounter.

Enemy Threat

When an encounter is triggered, consider what you know of the location, your mission, and potential enemies. In most cases, the nature of the enemy will be obvious.

If you're not sure, you can use the Binary Response Matrix, asking a question such as *"Do I encounter a*

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Xenomorph Drone?" or *"Have the soldiers arrived?"* Or use the adjacent table for enemy threats to gauge the strength or danger of the enemy, referencing the number of rolled on the encounter check. Ask clarifying questions from there.

ROLLED	THREAT	EXAMPLES
1	Lesser foe	Lone soldier or security guard, cultist, Xenomorph Facehugger
2	Greater enemy or group	Squad of marines, android, Xenomorph Drones
3+	Over-whelming enemy	Large force of soldiers, corporate assassin, Xenomorph Queen

Avoiding An Encounter

If you remain unspotted once an encounter has occurred, you can attempt to avoid the enemy by hiding, backing out of the zone, or sneaking past them.

- **Hide:** If you hide, decide whether the enemy makes an active search for you. If unsure, ask the Binary Response Matrix. If the enemies do search, make an **OBSERVATION** roll for them. If they don't search or fail to spot you, the enemies move out of the zone within a stretch of time.
- **Back Out:** If you back out of the zone, you can do so without risk. However, you should consider how this impacts the way forward within the location. Retreating may not be an option.
- **Sneak Past:** If you sneak past the enemies, make an **OBSERVATION** roll for them. If their roll fails, you remain undetected and proceed to the next zone.

Once you've avoided an enemy, reset the encounter timer as described on page 306.

Escaping An Encounter

When all else fails, and if you aren't surprised by an encounter, you can attempt to flee before you are forced to draw initiative. Escaping uses a **MOBILITY** roll. Before rolling, consider any relevant factors that modify the number of base dice rolled as shown in the adjacent table.

- If you succeed, you escape the encounter. If using a map, place your character up to two zones away from your starting position. Reset the encounter timer as described on page 306.
- On a failure, you are caught up in the encounter. Draw initiative. If using a map, place yourself and the enemies in the same zone or an adjacent zone.

Escape Modifiers

FACTOR	MODIFIER
You are outnumbered.	–1
Fast movement is hampered by environmental conditions such as flooding or debris.	–1
You are attempting to escape a speedy enemy, such as a Xenomorph.	–2
Zero-G environment	–2

Advancing Time

Check any active danger timers (page 300) after moving from zone to zone or lingering in a zone. If your movement mode is creeping, roll +1 die. If it is rushing, roll –1 die. If you were caught up in an encounter, conducted a careful search, or suffered some other delay, also modify the timer check by rolling +1 die. These modifiers stack.

Making Noise

If you cause excessive noise, you are more likely to alert enemies to your presence. This can also happen by triggering the Noisy result on the panic response table (page 299).

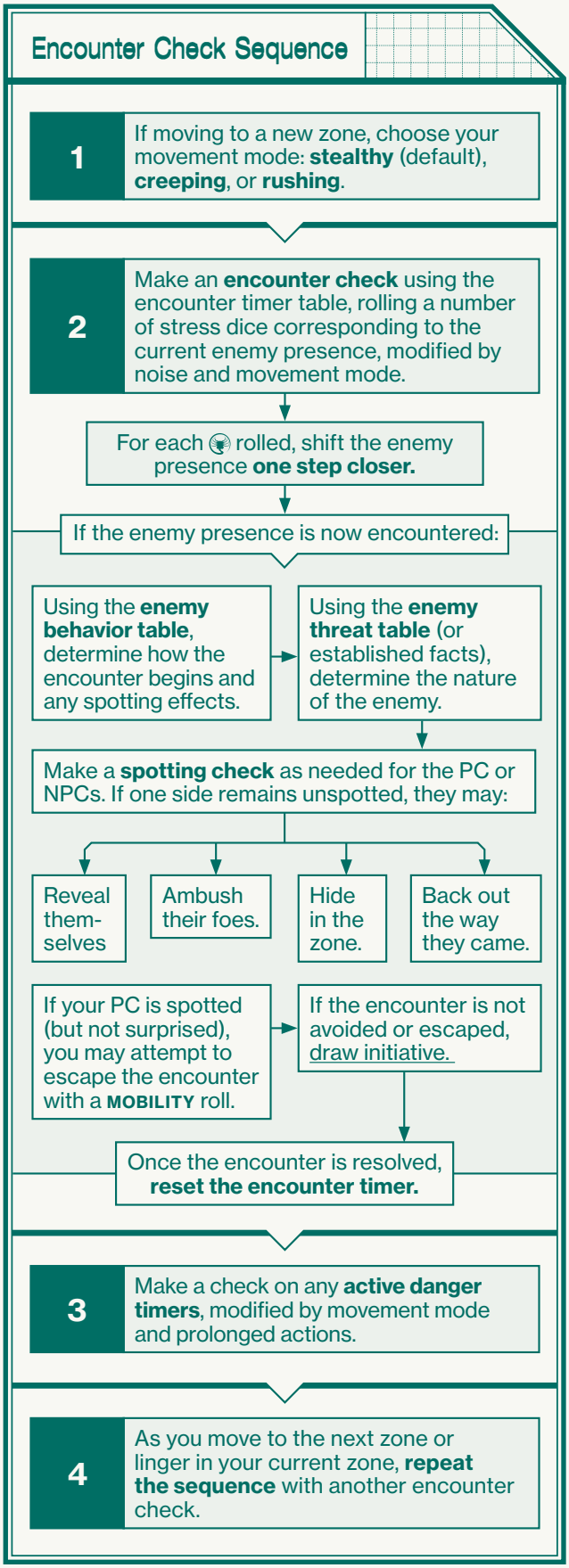
When making noise, add +1 die to encounter checks until you stop and move at least two zones away. If you are rushing, this die stacks – giving you +2 dice on your encounter checks.

Using A Motion Tracker

As enemies move within range, a functioning motion tracker gives you a better chance of outmaneuvering and spotting those enemies. If you roll at least one and no more than one on an encounter check without triggering an encounter, you may choose one of these two options instead of rolling for the next encounter check.

1. **Outmaneuver:** If the enemy presence is confirmed or greater (or closing or greater for a limited-range motion tracker such as the M314), shift the current enemy presence one rank farther as you move to an adjacent zone. For example, from near to closing. You are using the signal to put distance between you and the enemy.
2. **Prepare:** If the enemy presence is closing or near, you may immediately shift the enemy presence to encountered and ignore the spotting effects of the table for enemy behavior. You automatically spot the NPCs, and they must make an **OBSERVATION** roll to spot you. ▶

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Resetting The Encounter Timer

When an encounter is avoided, escaped, or resolved, reset the encounter timer as best fits the situation.

- If you faced and defeated a singular enemy or have no reason to believe other enemies are in this location, set the timer to all clear.
- If you presume that enemies remain in this location, but aren't sure, set the timer to suspected.
- If you are certain that enemies are still somewhere in the location, set the timer to confirmed. If you believe they are in the vicinity, make it closing.

You should also reset the encounter timer anytime the situation changes dramatically or if you gain a notable advantage that puts distance between you and potential enemies.

Revealing Details

As you move from zone to zone, take a moment to consider your surroundings. What is the function of this area? What dangers or opportunities does it introduce? If you are using a map, check the visual for insight. Otherwise, use MAAM tools such as the location detail matrices (page 296) to fill in the blanks.

Searching And Scavenging

Make an **OBSERVATION** check when searching an area. If you are looking for something specific, the check will reveal if it is found. If you are generally searching for useful items or hidden details, use the Salvage Matrix (page 297) to reveal what you uncover as follows.

ROLLED	SALVAGE
0	Nothing useful found and time wasted.
1	Roll for a common item on the Salvage Matrix.
2	Choose a common item on the Salvage Matrix or roll for a rare item.
3+	Choose a common or rare item on the Salvage Matrix.

Alternatively, with one or more successes, you can roll on the Complex Response Matrix (page 296) and interpret the answer.

Searching takes time, a stretch or more, and should trigger danger timer checks or additional dice on those checks as appropriate. If you spend your successes to perform a search faster instead of giving you more options, you can make the danger timer check with –1 stress die. ●

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SOLO COMBAT

COMBAT FOR A LAST SURVIVOR is managed as in standard play, although you'll need to take on the duties of a GM in determining NPC actions and making rolls for NPCs. Here are a few guidelines:

- Draw initiative as normal for your PC and any NPCs. Draw a single initiative card for groups of NPCs.
- When an NPC acts against or aids your character, roll for their action as a GM would. As with standard play, NPCs never push rolls and do not have a stress level.
- When deciding actions for an NPC in a fight, choose whatever is most sensible and expected in the current circumstances. If unsure, ask the Binary Response Matrix. For example, *"Does the soldier use a quick action to defend?"*
- When an NPC performs an action that doesn't directly affect your PC, you can simply decide if they are successful. If it's dramatic and dangerous, make it happen. If unsure, ask the Binary Response Matrix.
- Human NPCs are typically concerned with self-preservation. If things go against them, they act defensively or flee. Use the Binary Response Matrix to check their willingness to fight, giving sensible responses a high probability as appropriate.
- Xenomorphs close to Adjacent range and use their signature attacks. They never dodge or defend in close combat. When they are reduced to zero health, roll on the broken Xenomorph table (page 208) to see what happens. ●

SOLO SPACE COMBAT

IF YOU FIND YOURSELF caught up in a space battle, you can instead use the simplified system detailed below.

Objectives

First, set an objective timer (page 302) for your ship and crew. Decide your goal for the battle and make the status manageable for an evenly matched fight, near if you have a clear advantage, or far off if you are outmatched.

Then, decide what the enemy seeks to accomplish in the battle – such as boarding, disabling, or destroying your ship – and set a danger timer (page 300) to track their progress. Roll for a proximity using the current danger phase.

If unsure of an enemy objective, consider the most likely and interesting goal.

Phases

Once those pieces are in place, the battle proceeds in stretches – divided into four phases.

One solo spaceship combat stretch

1.	Action Phase
2.	Ship Phase
3.	Enemy Phase
4.	Damage Phase

1. **Action Phase:** Make a skill roll for your character that reflects your focus or the station you are manning. For example, **PILOTING** if at the controls, **COMTECH** if using the sensors to lock or spoof an enemy ship, or **COMMAND** if leading others. See the list of crew positions on page 140 for a summary of roles and skills.
2. **Ship Phase:** Make an objective check to represent the actions of the crew and the capabilities of your ship. Add one additional base die for each ✦ gained on your roll in the previous step. For each ✦, advance the objective timer one step. If you reach your objective, the battle is won, and your goal is achieved.
3. **Enemy Phase:** Roll on the danger timer for the enemy. For each ☣ rolled, advance the timer one step. If the timer reaches now, the enemy wins the battle. As appropriate to their goal, your ship might be destroyed, disabled, boarded, or left in their wake.
4. **Damage Phase:** Optionally, if the enemy is armed, you can use the component damage tables (pages 145–146) to help detail the hits taken by your ship. Whenever the danger timer advances by a step, roll two stress dice and consult the following table.

☣ ROLLED	DAMAGE
0	Damage to armor and hull.
1	Minor component damage.
2	Major component damage. A lucky hard hit can lead to catastrophic damage before the timer runs out.

If the objective timer and danger timer are both still active, the battle continues. Repeat the phases above. Along the way, consider the details of the battle as revealed by the dice results. Your character may need to change stations or deal with new compications as the battle progresses. ●

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APPENDIX

UPGRADES

THIS EVOLVED EDITION of the ALIEN RPG core rulebook can be used with game material for the first edition of the game, such as cinematic adventures and campaign books, with just a few tweaks. This appendix gives you the tools you need to upgrade the material to the Evolved Edition.

Talents

A small number of talents have been replaced in the Evolved Edition. If an NPC or pre-generated PC has a talent not present in this book, simply replace it with another talent of your choice.

Weapons

Some modules for the first edition, especially the campaign books, include several new weapons. If the same weapon appears in this book as well, use the stats in this book. If not, you can use the stats as they stand, but you will need to add an ammo capacity for each weapon, as that stat did not exist in the first edition. See the table below for guidance.

Spaceship Armor

FIRST EDITION	EVOLVED EDITION
1–4	0
5–8	1
9–12	2

Body Armor

FIRST EDITION	EVOLVED EDITION
0–2	0
3–5	1
6–8	2
9–11	3
12–14	4
15+	5

Body Armor

The rules for armor have been modified significantly in the Evolved Edition, meaning all body armor levels in first edition supplements need to be converted. This goes for the natural armor of Xenomorphs as well. See the table below.

Vehicle Armor

The armor levels for vehicles have been recalibrated in the Evolved Edition. To convert armor levels for vehicles, use the table below.

Spaceship Armor

The armor levels for spaceships are on a different scale from normal vehicles, and have also been recalibrated in the Evolved Edition. To convert armor levels for spaceships, use the table below.

Xenomorphs

Some cinematic adventures for the first edition of the game have rules and stats for Xenomorphs of various kinds. These can be used as is (just convert armor levels as per above), but if the same Xenomorph appears in chapter 10 of this book as well, use the stats and rules found in this book, as there may be minor differences.

Ammo

WEAPON TYPE	AMMO CAPACITY
Revolver	1
Pistol	2
Rifle	3
Heavy Weapon	4
Vehicle Weapon	5

Vehicle Armor

FIRST EDITION	EVOLVED EDITION
1–4	1
5	2
6	3
7	4
8	5
+1	+1

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Weapons

WEAPON	MOD.	DAMAGE	RANGE	AMMO	WEIGHT	COST	SPECIAL
M4A3 Service Pistol	+2	2	A/M	2	½	$200	
VP-70MA6 Service Pistol	+2	2	A/M	2	¼	$250	
.357 Magnum Revolver	+1	3	S/M	1	1	$300	
Rexim RXF-M5 EVA Pistol	+1	1	S/M	4	½	$400	Armor piercing
Weyland ES-4 Electrostatic Pistol	+1	1 (stun)	S/M	1	½	$1,000	Armor piercing
Watatsumi DV-303 Bolt Gun	–1	3	A/S	Single-shot	1	$400	Armor piercing
Armat M41A Pulse Rifle	+2	2	S/L	3	1	$1,200	Armor piercing, full auto, grenade launcher
F44AA Pulse Rifle	+3	2	S/L	3	1	$1,500	Armor piercing, full auto, unreliable
AK-4047 Pulse Assault Rifle	+1	2	S/L	2	1	$600	Armor piercing, full auto
M42A Scope Rifle	+3	2	M/E	2	1	$1,000	Armor piercing
Armat M41AE2 Heavy Pulse Rifle	+2	2	M/E	4	2	$1,500	Armor piercing, full auto
M56A2 Smartgun	+3	3	S/L	3	3	$6,000	Armor piercing, full auto, smart sight
Armat Model 37A2 12 Gauge Pump Action Shotgun	+2	3	A/S	1	1	$500	
M240 Incinerator Unit	+1	2	S/S	2	1	$500	Fire effect
SpaceSub ASSO-400 Harpoon Gun	–	1	S/M	Single-shot	1	$300	Harpoon effect
Armat XM99A Phased Plasma Pulse Rifle	–	4	M/E	1	2	$20,000	Armor piercing, aim needed
M5A3 RPG Launcher	–1	7	M/E	Single-shot	2	$1,800	Armor piercing, aim needed
Armat U1 Grenade Launcher	+1	2E	M/L	1	½	$600	Can fire smoke and Electroshock grenades
M40 HEDP Hand Grenade	–	2E	S/M	Single use	¼	$60	
G2 Electroshock Grenade	–	2E (stun)	S/M	Single use	¼	$400	
Seismic Survey Charge	–	3E	S/M	Single use	1	$200	
UA 571-C Sentry Gun	–	4	S/L	5	N/A	$12,000	Armor piercing, full auto, automation
Unarmed Attack	–	1	A	–	–	–	
Blunt Instrument	+1	1	A	–	1	–	
Combat Knife	+1	2	A	–	½	$50	
Fire Axe	–	2	A	–	1	$60	Armor piercing
Stun Baton	+1	1 (stun)	A	2	1	$80	
Cutting Torch	–1	3	A	3	1	$300	Armor piercing

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Suits & Armor

SUIT	ARMOR LEVEL	AIR SUPPLY	WEIGHT	COST	SPECIAL
M3 Personnel Armor	2	–	1	$1,200	Comm unit, PDT
Kevlar Riot Vest	1	–	½	$600	
IRC Mk.50 Compression Suit	–	5	1	$4,000	Vacuum protection, comm unit, head light, –1 to **MOBILITY**
IRC Mk.35 Pressure Suit	1	4	2	$2,000	–2 to **MOBILITY**
Eco All-World Survival Suit	2	6	2	$30,000	Vacuum protection, comm unit, head light, +2 to **MOBILITY** for movement in zero-G
Weyland-Yutani APEsuit	1	4	1	$5,000	Armor 3 vs. acid, facehug protection, **SURVIVAL** +2
P-5000 Power Loader	1	–	–	$50,000	+3 dice to **HEAVY MACHINERY** and **CLOSE COMBAT**, close combat base damage rating 3

Computer Mainframes

MAINFRAME	SKILLS	COST
MU/TH/UR 6000	**COMTECH** 5, **PILOTING** 5, **OBSERVATION** 5	$2,500,000
MU/TH/UR 6500	**COMTECH** 6, **PILOTING** 5, **OBSERVATION** 6	$3,500,000
MU/TH/UR 7000	**COMTECH** 7, **PILOTING** 6, **OBSERVATION** 7	$5,000,000
MU/TH/UR 9000	**COMTECH** 10, **PILOTING** 8, **OBSERVATION** 10, **RANGED COMBAT** 9	$50,000,000
A.P.O.L.L.O.	**COMTECH** 5, **PILOTING** 4, **OBSERVATION** 5	$2,000,000

[Priority one: Insure return of organism for analysis.]
[All other considerations secondary.]
[Crew expendable.]

MU-TH-UR 6000

Data storage

DEVICE	WEIGHT	COST	CAPACITY
Long-Data Discs	–	$30	10 zettabytes
Magnetic Tape	–	$5	120 terabytes

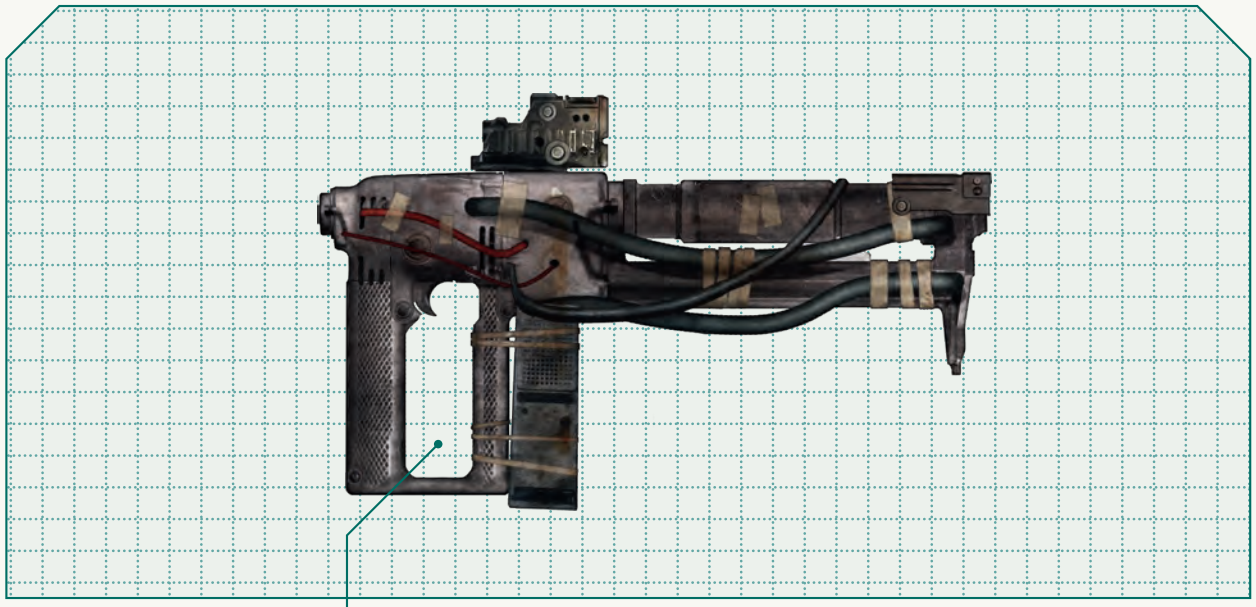
Diagnostics & Display

DEVICE	WEIGHT	COST	EFFECT
Computer terminal	N/A	Varies	Access and process data (**COMTECH** roll)
PR-PUT Uplink Terminal	1	$9,000	Remote control spacecraft (**COMTECH** roll)
Seegson C-Series Magnetic Tape Recorder	1	$80	Record and play music (**MANIPULATION** +1)
Samani E-Series Watch	–	$50	Tracks time, oxygen, and pressure levels (**SURVIVAL** +1)
Comm Unit	–	$50	Enables remote team communication.
Personal Data Transmitter	–	$100	Monitors location and vitals (**MEDICAL AID** +1)
IFF Transponder	–	$250	Prevents Sentry Gun friendly fire
Data Transmitter Cards	–	$50	Transfer of audiovisual data (**COMTECH** +1)
Seegson P-DAT	½	$500	Coordinate info for field teams (**COMMAND** +1)
Seegson System Diagnostic Device	1	$300	Troubleshoot computer systems (**COMTECH** +2)
HoloTab	N/A	$100,000	Strategic analysis platform (**OBSERVATION** and **COMMAND** +2)
Modular Computing Device	N/A	$8,000	Full audiovisual holographic projector (**MANIPULATION** +2)

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Vision Devices

DEVICE	RANGE	POWER SUPPLY	WEIGHT	COST	EFFECT
Flashlight	Short	–	½	$40	Removes the effects of darkness in a zone.
Optical Scope	+1	–	–	$60	Increases the range of a pistol or rifle by one category but only for aimed shots
Binoculars	Extreme	–	½	$100	+2 dice to **OBSERVATION** at Long range or more
M314 Motion Tracker	Long	5	1	$1,200	Detects motion in stealth mode
M316 Motion Tracker	Medium	3	–	$3,000	Detects motion in stealth mode
Neuro Visor	Long	5	1	$10,000	Monitor or interact with hypersleep patient (**COMTECH** roll)
"Pups" Parameter Uplink Spectrograph Mapping Device	Extreme	5	1	$50,000	Scans one zone per stretch in stealth mode, automatically detects enemies unless hidden
Seegson Microview-2000SE	Extreme	–	½	$250	Tracks current location



Tools

DEVICE	POWER SUPPLY	WEIGHT	COST	EFFECT
Watatsumi DV-303 Bolt Gun	–	1	$400	Ship repairs (**HEAVY MACHINERY** +2).
Mechanical Cutting Torch	3	1	$300	Construction and repairs (**HEAVY MACHINERY** +2)
Maintenance Jack	–	1	$150	**HEAVY MACHINERY** +1 die in relevant situations
Electronic Tools	–	½	$250	**COMTECH** +1.
Power Cell	–	¼	$30	Restores full power supply to one item

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Medical Supplies

DEVICE	WEIGHT	COST	EFFECT
Personal Medkit	¼	$50	**MEDICAL AID** +2 for giving first aid (single use).
Surgical Kit	1	$200	**MEDICAL AID** +2 for first aid and surgery on critical injuries. Base damage 2 if used as a weapon.
Pauling MedPod	N/A	$2,000,000	Can give first aid and perform surgery with **MEDICAL AID** skill level 12.
AutoDoc	N/A	$500,000	Can administer first aid with **MEDICAL AID** skill level 8.

Pharmaceuticals

SUBSTANCE	COST	EFFECT
Neversleep Pills	$2	Stress level +1 but removes the need for sleep for a day, during which stress cannot be relieved.
Hydr8tion	$5	Eliminates fatigue from hypersleep.
Naproleve	$20	Reduces stress level to zero. Each dose beyond the first in the same shift gives –1 dice to all skill rolls until the end of the shift.
Recreational Drugs	Varies	Stress level +1 or –1. Each dose beyond the first in the same shift gives –1 dice to all skill rolls until the end of the shift.

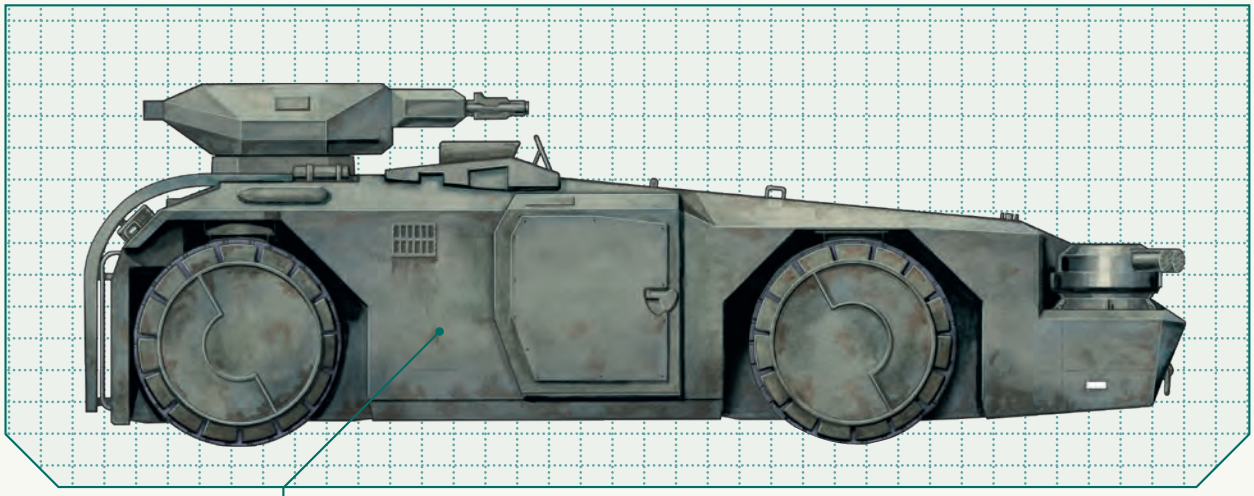
Food & Drink

SUBSTANCE	WEIGHT	COST	EFFECT
Prefab Meal	¼	$10	Satisfies food needs for one day.
Water Bottle	¼	$2 – $100	Satisfies water needs for one day.
"Bug Juice" Protein Drink	¼	$5	Satisfies food and water needs for one day.
Candy Bar	¼	$15	Satisfies food needs for one day.
Coffee	–	$0–$1.50	Stress level +1 and postpones fatigue from lack of sleep for one shift.
Colony Specialty Meals	¼	$20–$300	Satisfies food needs for one day, stress level –1.
Beer and Booze	¼	$5–$500	Stress level –1. Each dose beyond the first in the same shift gives –1 dice to all skill rolls until the end of the shift.

"The first thing I am going to do when I get back is get some decent food."
"I dig it man. Let me tell you, I've tasted worse food than this. I've tasted better, you know what I am saying."
"Well you pound down the stuff like there's no tomorrow."
"I'd rather be eating something else but, uh, right now I'm not thinking of food."
"Well you should know what it's made of."
"No man, I don't want to know what it's made of."

Kane, Parker and Lambert

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Vehicles

MODEL	PASSENGERS	MANEUVERABILITY	SPEED	HULL	ARMOR	COST
Daihotai Tractor	4	–	2	6	3	$17,000
Weyland NR-9 ATV	1	+2	2	2	1*	$3,000
M577 APC	13	+1	3	8	5	$500,000
Weapons:	Phased Plasma Pulse Cannon Turret 20 mm Gatling Gun Turret					
Aerodyne Gyrocar	5	+3	3	4	1	$40,000
UD-4L Cheyenne VTOL Dropship	15	+2	4	10	4	$3,100,000
Weapons:	25 mm Gatling Gun Mk.16 150 mm Banshee 70 Unguided Rocket Launcher 7 × AGM-220C Hellhound II Tactical Missiles 3 × AIM-90E Headlock Air-to-Air Missiles					
WY-37B Cargo Lifter Transport Sled	3	–1	3	12	2	$800,000

Vehicle Weapons

WEAPON	MOD.	DAMAGE	RANGE	AMMO	COST	SPECIAL
20 mm Gatling Gun	+1	4	M/L	6	$7,500	Armor piercing, full auto
25 mm Gatling Gun	+1	4	M/E	6	$9,000	Armor piercing, full auto
Phased Plasma Pulse Cannon Turret	–1	6	M/E	5	$54,000	Armor piercing
Multi-Directional Flame Unit	–	3	S/M	4	$4,200	Fire effect
Mk.16 150 mm Banshee 70 Unguided Rocket Launcher	–	3E	M/L	3	$48,000	Full auto
AGM-220C Hellhound II Tactical Missile Launcher	+1	8	L/E	Single-shot	$76,000	Armor piercing, missile cost $12,000
AIM-90E Headlock Air-to-Air Missile Launcher	+2	6	L/E	Single-shot	$64,000	Armor piercing, missile cost $9,000

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CHARACTER SHEET

NAME

CAREER

TALENTS

APPEARANCE

PERSONAL AGENDA

BUDDY

RIVAL

EXPERIENCE POINTS

STORY POINTS

STRENGTH		AGILITY		WITS		EMPATHY	
CLOSE COMBAT		MOBILITY		COMTECH		COMMAND	
HEAVY MACHINERY		PILOTING		OBSERVATION		MANIPULATION	
STAMINA		RANGED COMBAT		SURVIVAL		MEDICAL AID	

STRESS LEVEL ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

TINY ITEMS

SIGNATURE ITEM

STRESS & PANIC RESPONSES

- Jumpy ○
- Tunnel Vision ○
- Aggravated ○
- Shakes ○
- Frantic ○
- Deflated ○
- Paranoid ○
- Hesitant ○
- Freeze ○
- Seek Cover ○
- Scream ○
- Flee ○
- Frenzy ○
- Catatonic ○

HEALTH /

Fatigued ○

RESOLVE

Radiation

CRITICAL INJURIES & MENTAL TRAUMA

GEAR	Air / Power	Weight
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		

ARMOR	Level	Weight

ENCUMBRANCE /

CASH

WEAPONS	Modifier	Damage	Range	Ammo	Weight
			/	/	
			/	/	
			/	/	
			/	/	

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SHIP SHEET

NAME	MANUFACTURER	AI

CREW	LENGTH	SIGNATURE	HULL
PASSENGERS	FTL RATING	THRUSTERS	ARMOR

DAMAGE ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

MINOR COMPONENT DAMAGE	Effect

MAJOR COMPONENT DAMAGE	Effect

SHIP'S LOG Date and Location

UPGRADES	Effect

ARMAMENTS	Modifier	Damage	Range	Size
			/	
			/	
			/	
			/	
			/	

LEASE COST

INTERNAL MODULES	Size
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	
9	
10	
11	

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-4 -3 -2 -1 0

-4 -3 -2 -1 0

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0 +1 +2 +3 +4

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0 +1 +2 +3 +4

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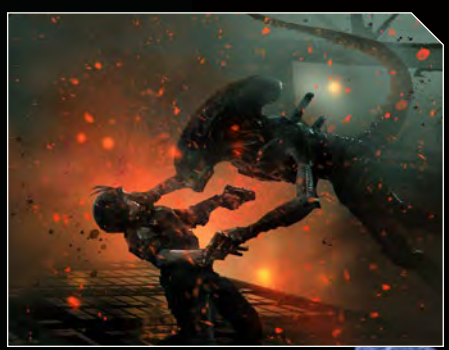
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